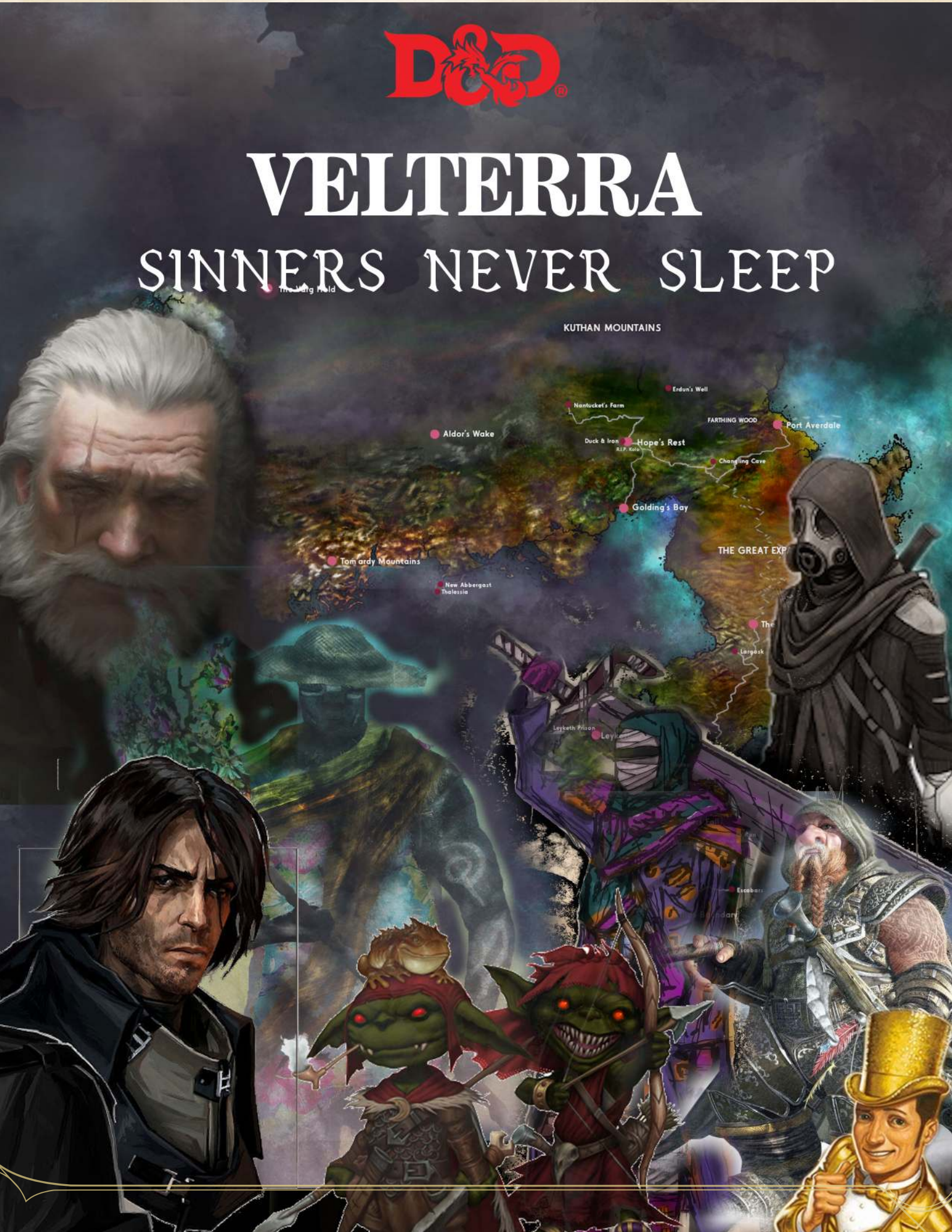




VELTERRA

SINNERS NEVER SLEEP



Velterra
Sinners Never Sleep

A Dungeons and Dragons Adventure

2019/09/29

The Cast



Michael Williams *Dungeon Master*

Stephen Harland

Pilcheur Gamont/Mark O'Synne/Vu Dong/Burnie Cinders

Jonathan Mann

Exmerah Sliokzog

Richard Pugh

Riphard Obsidian Hardstone

Stephen Reddish

Kolo Kozolski Sliokzog/Toni The Tiger/Martin AndleBerger

Joshua Rodell

Lady Otoría Hearthrust/Gary/Myron

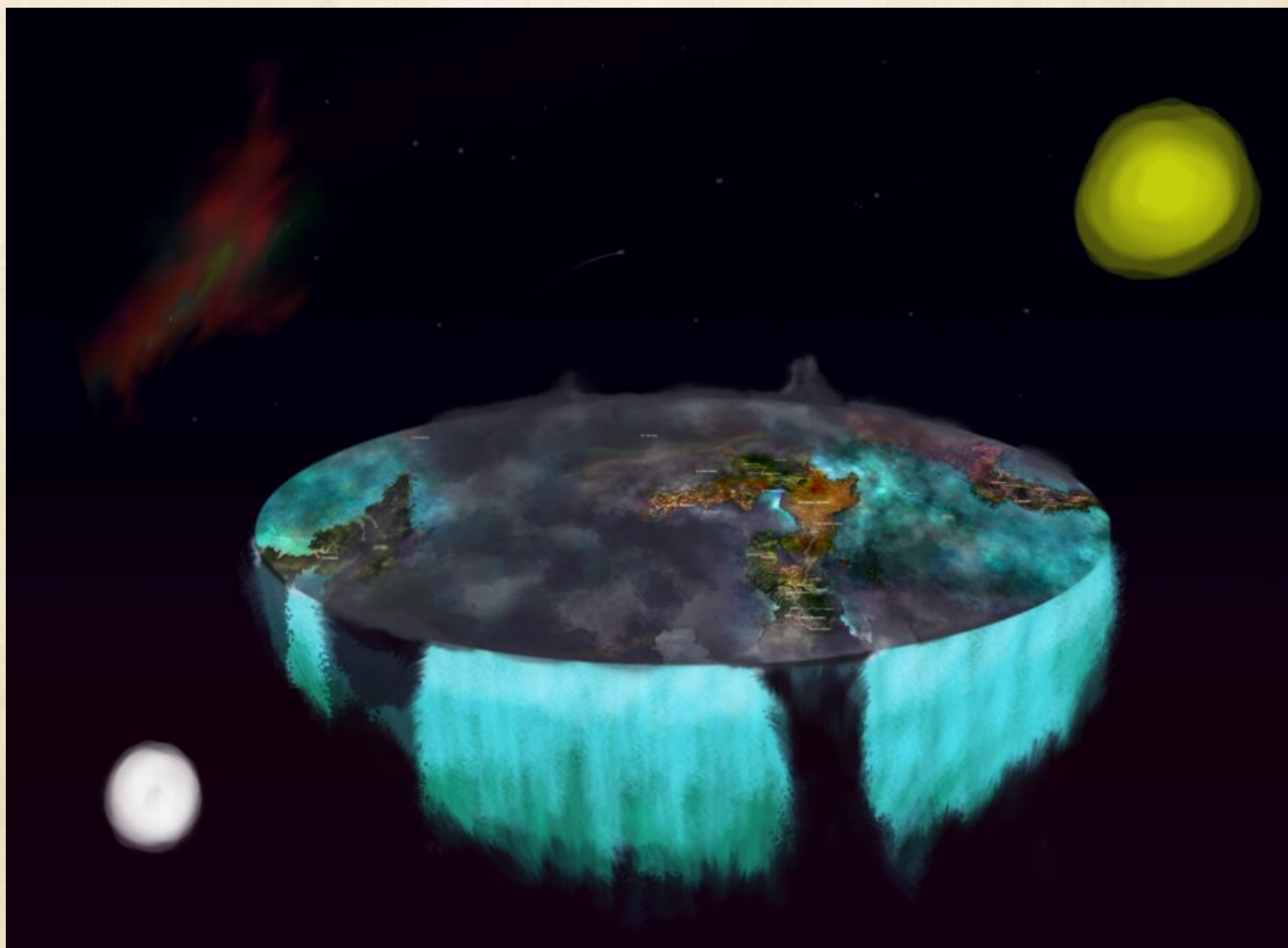
Nat

Sgt Erin Devereux/Gem (the 2022 continuation)

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CHAPTER 1: THE STORY



BACKGROUND

ABOUT THIS BOOK

This book is a record of the Velterra campaign, a Dungeons & Dragons 5th Edition adventure that ran across two campaigns: eighty sessions between 2017 and 2019, and a twenty-eight session continuation in 2022, all run by Dungeon Master Michael Williams. Six players guided their characters through a hundred and eight episodes of intrigue, violence, tragedy, and baked goods across a homebrew world where the gods had been sealed away and the Church that once served them had become the greatest threat to mortal souls.

The episode write-ups that form the bulk of this book were written by the players themselves, during or immediately after each session. They

are informal, irreverent, often profane, and frequently hilarious. They have been preserved exactly as written, spelling mistakes, in-jokes, and all, because they capture the experience of the campaign far better than any polished retelling could. The character pages, world entries, and this overview were written after the fact to provide context, but the episodes are the real story.

THE WORLD

Velterra is a world shaped by faith. Seven gods once walked among mortals, fought the forces of darkness, and taught their followers the virtues of justice, charity, strength, and hope. Their Church grew powerful, its hierarchy of Pastors, Arbiters, and Inquisitors enforcing divine law across the known world.

But centuries ago, the Church performed the Sundering, using the Great Stone to sever the connection between the gods and the mortal plane. What was meant as protection became a prison. The gods did not abandon the world; they were locked out of it. In their absence, the Church claimed sole authority over divine power, filtering what little remained through the Great Stone for its own purposes. Its definition of sin expanded relentlessly, sending more and more innocent souls to Hell.

In Hell, the bureaucracy is drowning. The flood of undeserving damned has overwhelmed the filing systems, the torture schedules, and the patience of one mid-ranking devil in particular.

His name is Lazarus. And he has a plan.

THE MISSION

"You have all recently died. You have been brought together, here, and given a second chance at life in exchange for carrying out a mission to destroy the Church."

Lazarus, to the newly resurrected party

Lazarus reaches into the mortal world and plucks five recently deceased souls from the edge of oblivion. He offers them a deal: a second chance at life, in exchange for breaking the seal that imprisons the gods and dismantling the corrupt Church that created it. The group must first retrieve the Stone of Unthala, an ancient artefact that will serve as their means of communication with Hell. Beyond that, the specifics are left to them.

They are warned not to attract the attention of the Church.

They will not be good at this.

THE FIVE STRANGERS



The party assembles in a featureless stone room in Hell, none fully understanding what has brought them there. An elephantine creature named Meredith beckons them through a mysteriously appearing door into a plush office where a red-skinned man wearing a human face mask welcomes them.

Pilcheur Gamont, a cloaked human Book Burner, one of the Church's literary enforcers, tasked with hunting and destroying heretical texts. Cowardly, scheming, and harbouring dark secrets. Last seen fleeing across rooftops in Hope's Rest with a half-burnt tome under one arm before his pursuers caught up with him.

Kolo and Exmerah Sliokzog, twin goblin siblings. Kolo is boisterous, light-fingered, and passionate about goblin emancipation by any means necessary. Exme is softly spoken, fiercely intelligent, and already carrying the components for devices that will reshape the campaign. They died fleeing the Varg in the frozen north, surrounded by brutal tribesmen.

Riphard Obsidian Hardstone, a dwarf pastor, a gun-toting man of the cloth whose faith was about to be shattered by the revelation that everything he believed in was built on a lie. Shot dead in his own study by a figure who should not have existed.

Lady Otorian Hearthrast, a mysterious swordswoman from the distant kingdom of Nanduan. Principled, lethal, and harbouring a secret that would only be revealed after her death: she was not human at all, but a dwarven-crafted automaton, a robot with a soul. She died with honour, outnumbered by scores, choosing the only option she knew.

These five strangers have nothing in common except that they are all dead, all desperate, and

all willing to make a deal with a devil.

THE CAMPAIGN

What follows is an overview of the campaign in sixteen arcs: eleven covering the original campaign from resurrection to the Seven's Spire, and five from the continuation that followed four years later. For the full story in the players' own words, see the episode write-ups in Chapter 5.

ARC I: THE STONE OF UNTHALA

Episodes 1–3

The five strangers accept Lazarus's deal and are transported to a snow-bound cave in the southern wilderness with basic supplies and a simple objective: retrieve the Stone of Unthala from a temple to the south. After two days of walking through frozen wasteland, during which Kolo relieves Pilcheur of fifteen gold pieces and the goblin twins disappear to drunkenly announce their adventurous intentions to an entire bar, the group arrives at the small settlement of Vathos Boundary.

South of the settlement lies a skull-shaped ice temple, home to the TikkiTukks, small bear-like creatures with face masks and sharp teeth. The party navigates dart traps, fights masked bears and a giant spider, and retrieves the Stone of Unthala from the chief's quarters. Kolo demonstrates his ability to speak the TikkiTukk language, a skill nobody expected him to possess, and Otoría establishes herself as the group's moral authority by refusing to tolerate cruelty of any kind.

The Stone secured, the party has its lifeline to Lazarus and its first taste of working together, a taste that leaves mixed impressions for everyone involved. Nobody trusts anyone. The party dynamic is already a disaster.

ARC II: RIVERFALL

Episodes 4–9a

Travelling north, the party encounters the Jennies, a criminal organisation of courtesans driven underground by the Church. Among them is Delilah, an expert marksman who will become Riphard's wife, mother to his children, and ultimately one of the campaign's greatest losses.

In Riverfall, the group exorcises Pilcheur of a dark possession using pastoral chanting, Killepitsch liquor, and copious vomiting. The shadow sword Black Sabbath manifests from Pilch's body. Riphard founds the group's first bank, Northern Rock, in the house of an elderly bachelor named Derek Bobacious. Then everything goes sideways.

A mercenary named Hans seizes the Tower of Imota Kan in what the group will forever call the "Die Hard" heist. Across three sessions of infiltration, combat, and escalating chaos, the party fights through the tower floor by floor. On the final night, a singing swordswoman named Lark drives her katana through Lady Otoría Hearthrust.

Otoría dies. The party discovers, in the aftermath, that she was a robot, a dwarven-crafted automaton with a soul. Around a campfire, they mourn the fiercest and most principled among them. Kolo, unable to process the grief, begins telling a story.

IN MEMORIAM

The campaign claimed many lives. The following is a record of every player character death, departure, and erasure:

- **Ep 9a:** Lady Otoría killed by Lark's katana during the Die Hard heist
- **Ep 24:** Pilcheur Gamont dies at sea, cause uncertain
- **Ep 26:** Gary sacrifices himself protecting Kolo in the jungle, becomes a tree
- **Ep 33-5d:** Vu Dong erased from the timeline by the butterfly effect
- **Ep 54:** Kolo sacrifices Daisuke to Kalimar in the mines
- **Ep 66:** Anthony "Toni" Tigerius III departs the group, heading for the Expanse
- **Ep 68:** Kolo kills Delilah. Riphard kills Kolo. Exme leaves the group.
- **Ep 97:** Exmerah erased from existence by the Wish
- **Ep ~100:** Riphard departs, investigating with the Jennies
- **Ep 101:** Sgt Erin Devereux, brain devoured by an Ulitharid
- **Ep 103:** Burnie charges the elder brain alone and is torn apart

Stephen Harland holds the record for most characters played (four). Jonathan Mann's Exmerah survived the original campaign without dying or departing, only to be erased from existence in the continuation.

ARC III: HOPE'S REST

Episodes 10–18

The party arrives in Hope's Rest, the largest city in Velterra, a sprawling metropolis governed by five guild families controlling the domains of Life, Might, Coin, Service, and Making. Here, the campaign shifts from wilderness survival to urban politics.

The group deals with the SRA, gnome and halfling terrorists led by a gnome named Razzle Backshine, whom they kill and replace with a more amenable successor called Buttons. In Logarsk, they discover that the Church's Marshall has been using the Slab of Inthun to experiment on children in the church basement, and they encounter their first Arbiter: the

terrifying plate-armoured Kiro, who will become one of their most important allies.

Back in Hope's Rest, Gary, the ancient stone elemental who awakened after Otor's death, delivers an impassioned speech to the guild council that wins the group the right to establish their own guild. The Gary Guild ("Garys Against Religion, Yo") is born, operating from the abandoned Book Burner headquarters. Riphard establishes a proper bank. Gary joins the local police force as Officer Djago. For a brief, shining moment, things almost seem to be going well.

ARC IV: DESERT & SEA

Episodes 19–24

The party crosses the Great Expanse, a vast desert where they forge an alliance with the Spancers, anti-Church bandits who will prove loyal friends. From Port Averdale, a colourful port town of shady dealings, they set sail for the southern continent.

At sea, Pilcheur Gamont dies. The group's original Book Burner, whose cowardice masked a complicated and ultimately tragic relationship with the dark forces possessing him, is gone. From somewhere unexpected, Gary's chest, a golden-haired small figure emerges. He calls himself Mark O'Synne, claims to be an avatar of the god Synne, and is immediately and universally disliked by everyone.

ARC V: THE JUNGLE CONTINENT

Episodes 25–28

The party arrives on the jungle continent via the Caribbean-like port of Akultheok. The jungles are dangerous, cannibal TikkiTukks, hostile wildlife, and worse. Deep in the undergrowth, they discover the Tower of Ruh'Breks, the hidden underground stronghold of an ancient sorcerer.

Ruh'Breks himself, dying and centuries old, gifts the party two things that will define the rest of the campaign: the Puzzle Die, a magical cube of seemingly infinite functions and semi-sentient intelligence, and an airship powered by spectral energy batteries, ghost-like entities captured in storage compartments. The party names the airship after Gary, who sacrifices himself in the jungle protecting Kolo from danger. Gary transforms into a tree, destined to regenerate in several hundred years.

The gnome Arbiter Myron arrives via hot air balloon. The monkey companion Vu Dong joins from the jungle. The group is airborne, and the campaign enters a new phase.

ARC VI: MASUDA

Episodes 29–48, including flashbacks 33.5a–33.5d

The longest arc of the campaign takes the party to the foreign kingdom of Masuda, a land of samurai culture torn apart by civil war. What begins as a simple quest to retrieve the Hammer of the Gods, a legendary weapon said to have defeated an Inthun-infused Varg in a single blow, becomes a sprawling adventure of political intrigue, battlefield chaos, and unexpected alliances.

The group becomes Ronin, hunts the Lord of Lightning, infiltrates a castle, and forges an alliance with the Hearthrust Society, a movement founded by Otor's herself before she came to Velterra, dedicated to the emancipation of robot ladies. Lady Hirota Hearthrust rescues the party with a mechanical eagle. The Hammer of the Gods is retrieved, and turns out to be an ancient gun that fires beams of pure iridescent light.

Midway through the Masuda campaign, the timeline fractures. Mark O'Synne constructs a VR time-travel machine that allows the party to relive events from decades past, experiencing the world of the Book Burners firsthand. Through the eyes of Burnie Cinders, a human raised by dwarven parents who survived the Book Burner purges, the party witnesses the training, the missions, and the catastrophic betrayal that destroyed the order. The critical revelation: it was Pilcheur who caused the purge. His habit of secretly selling books instead of burning them was discovered, and the Church used it as justification to wipe out every Book Burner alive. The flashbacks end with Vu Dong erased from the timeline by the butterfly effect, and Burnie, now fully realised as a character, joining the main campaign permanently with a stone dagger, a half-Tengu son, and enough guilt for two lifetimes.

By the arc's end, the airship has been upgraded with cannons and weaponry, Ruh'Breks Sensei has died holding back a mountain creature to protect the party, and the group departs Masuda for the dwarven homeland with a growing sense that the endgame is approaching.

ARC VII: TOM'ARDY MOUNTAINS

Episodes 49–53

The party returns to the dwarven homeland, Riphard's ancestral mountains, seeking Excalibrium, the legendary star-metal that is the only material capable of harming the Church's Inquisitors. What they find is a society built

on slavery. The Tom'ardy dwarves maintain an economy of Delves, miners sent on one-way expeditions into the deep, and the party's disruption of this system will have consequences that ripple through the rest of the campaign.

In the deep mines, Lillith, a half-elf Book Burner who "actually liked Pilch", is found hiding in a barrel. Riphard's uncle Targon is discovered among the Delves. And somewhere in the darkness below, something ancient stirs. The elder entity Kalimar, a being of terrifying power whose domain is the warping of flesh, has taken an interest in the party. The mines are deeper than anyone thought, and each level brings the group closer to something they are not prepared for.

ARC VIII: KOLO'S DESCENT

Episodes 54–68

This arc encompasses the campaign's darkest period. In the deep mines, Kolo sacrifices the party's interpreter Daisuke to Kalimar in a ritual that marks the point of no return. He disappears into the darkness. Myron is turned to stone by Gorgons. The party barely escapes with their lives.

A new character joins: Anthony K. Tigerius III, a large tiger-man sent from the Guild of Coin to negotiate about the bank. He carries a briefcase and an unnecessary cane, gives powerpoint presentations, and flies into berserker rages at inconvenient moments. While Toni negotiates merfolk trade deals and the party fights their first Inquisitor, discovering that these dark masked figures with tentacle maws are immune to every weapon except Excalibur, the shadow of Kolo's corruption hangs over everything.

Exme rebuilds STANRI in tiger form, honouring Toni. Myron is destoned. Excalibur is finally found in the mines. The first Inquisitor is killed with an Excalibur pickaxe, proving the metal works. But it all leads to Hope's Rest, and the sewers beneath it.

Kolo is found. Massively mutated, one giant arm, wings, covered in fungus, he has become Kalimar's servant, building a lair in the sewers beneath the city the party once called home. Exme stops time to save babies from Kolo's spawn. But she cannot save Delilah. Kolo crushes the head of Riphard's wife.

"Today is the day that we will have to kill Kolo."

Myron, Episode 68

Riphard strangles Kolo to death with his whip. Exme, broken by her brother's death at the hands of her companions, leaves the group. She

takes Kolo's body and departs with a note for Burnie: "I thought I could have both of you." It is the lowest point of the campaign.

ARC IX: AFTERMATH & THE FORGE

Episodes 69–75

The aftermath is bleak. Kevin, a final-year PhD student from the University of Assassins with Christopher Mintz-Plasse energy, joins the group via Buck McCraw, Burnie's half-Tengu son. The party visits Lazarus, who confirms Delilah's soul is in Hell. Kolo's soul, however, is missing, claimed by Kalimar, beyond even the reach of devils. Riphard begins his descent into delusion: a mannequin becomes Delilah, two sacks of rotten pork become his children. Myron invents a cocktail, one part sherry, one part grenadine, one part Bovril, and names it the Piece of Shit after Riphard.

The group sets course for Linderdorf, a dense warren of foundries, mills, and shops built into a mountain. Myron reunites with his father, Professor Jorge Myron. The master blacksmith Google Von Maccherstein has gone exploring in the Varg lands and not returned. The hunt for Google takes the party into frozen territory, where Martin Andleberger, a construct bard built to be a fighting butler, is found beaten and chained by Varg bearkin. The party rescues Google, discovers the Bright Bart Forge, and defeats the Aspect of the Storm to retrieve the forging knowledge needed to work Excalibur.

Back in Linderdorf, Google's team forges the weapons. Chief among them: Godbringer, a weapon of immense divine power that Myron will wield in the battles to come. Exme returns to the group and discovers that the Puzzle Die can locate the source of the seal, it points directly at Seven's Spire.

The arena fight at Clawtech provides the campaign's most triumphant moment. Facing a thirty-foot Stonecast Mech, Myron launches himself into the air and brings Godbringer down in a final strike that bisects the robot entirely. Three-quarters of the stadium erupts in chants of "Emancipation." The party wins the giant robot.

ARC X: ALLIANCE BUILDING

Episodes 76–78

Exme plugs the Puzzle Die into the airship's ghost engine and achieves hyper-speed travel, pinning the crew against their seats and allowing the party to cross Velterra in days rather than weeks. What follows is a whirlwind recruitment drive:

Tom'ardy, now a socialist utopia following the party's disruption of the slave economy, commits its dwarves to the fight. Lillith convinces their council. The merfolk of New Abbergast pledge their army. Lady Gharbigast holds firm despite Church pressure. The Jennies, the assassins, the Garys, the commoners of Hope's Rest, all are rallied. Linderdorf sends robots and cannons. The Hearthrust Society sends mechanical eagles piloted by female ninja riders.

Lillith infiltrates Seven's Spire disguised as a pastor during the Festival of Light, a pilgrimage celebration of all the gods that provides the perfect cover. When the party arrives at the Spire's gates, Lillith has them "arrested" and marched inside. They are in.

On a hilltop the night before, Myron prays to all seven gods. He is an Arbiter of the Church, a warrior-enforcer who was once part of the system he is about to destroy. He asks for strength. The campaign is entering its final act.

ARC XI: THE BATTLE & THE SPIRE

Episodes 79–80

The alliance army meets the Church's forces at the Battle of Hope's Rest. Eight thousand Church troops face a coalition of dwarves, fishmen, clockwork ninjas, mechanical eagles, commoners, and Garys. The casualties are heavy on both sides. King Oceani dies singing a song, then rallies his troops as a ghost. The Church

eventually flees.

Inside Seven's Spire, the party fights upward floor by floor. Burnie suffers a book-burning episode of mania, incinerating a library and its sherry-swilling occupant. Martin fights inside the Stonecast Mech, dropped from the airship as a siege weapon. The party discovers the prison level, corridors reeking of death and decay, cells containing tortured prisoners and desiccated corpses.

Myron finds Kiros. The Arbiter who became their ally is strung up on a rack, naked and barely alive. He stuffs beef jerky into her mouth. She survives.

Arbiter Khan arrives with two Inquisitor Ravagers, massive hulking beings with metal spikes for hands. Khan dances fluidly through the entire party. Kiros unloads a full set of chambered rounds into him. Then Exme's linear accelerator vaporises his head. STANRI steps on the remains.

The party ascends toward the pinnacle of the Spire, where the Great Stone awaits. The seal must be broken. The gods must return. And Kolo's soul, trapped with Kalimar, beyond the reach of devils, may only be saved by divine intervention.

The final confrontation, in which the party breaks the seal and becomes demigods, has yet to be written up. The original campaign ended. The story did not.

THE CONTINUATION

Four in-world years after the Spire, the campaign resumed. The table reconvened in 2022 with the original five players and one new addition, Nat. What followed was twenty-eight episodes of loss, sacrifice, and a heist.

ARC XII: ONE MORE TIME

Episodes 81–84

Magic has returned to the world but the gods remain distant. The scattered, half-broken party is regathered by Lazarus, now ruling Hell as the Empire of the Eight, alongside a new recruit: Sgt Erin Devereux, a career soldier from the western city of Jecede and sole survivor of a reconnaissance team sent into the Varg lands.

The world has changed. Exme runs a school for gifted girls. Riphard owns a mega-bank. Burnie is collecting books instead of burning them. Myron commands a troop of former Arbiters. They are older, stranger, and in several cases not entirely sane.

A warm-up against the lich Valklondar reintroduces the party to the rhythms of violence, and the real threat is revealed: Valkar Varg has made a pact with Kalimar, and the elder god's flesh-warping goo is being used to brew super-soldiers. The mission: stop the invasion, kill Kalimar, and rescue Kolo's soul.

ARC XIII: AMONG THE VARG

Episodes 85–92

The party infiltrates the Varg lands and joins the Chesney Hawks, a barbarian tribe led by the giantess Magrat, who eats a man in a single bite. They hunt cave mammoths and boreworms to earn respect. Riphard kills a boreworm that has swallowed the half-giant Eric whole, and Martin is exploded into pieces by the snow leopard warrior Buchra during a sparring match that gets out of hand.

Valkar declares war and marches south with his Pact warriors. The party recovers Krankle, the goblin twins' childhood tormentor, and sets him brewing an antidote to the Kalimel goo while they track Valkar north. The frozen wastes grow darker. The trail leads down.

ARC XIV: THE DESTRUCTION OF THE CREATOR

Episodes 93–97

Down through an ice-cliff temple, ratman hives, fungal forests, and the flesh-tunnel bowels of a god, the party descends to Kalimar's lava

sanctum. The elder god of creation nearly wipes them. Myron is stabbed through the chest and killed outright. Burnie is swallowed whole, held alive inside the creature only by Synne's divine intervention. Mrs Ball, the party's improbable ally, annihilates Kalimar with her biggest bonk.

Then Exmerah uses the Wish.

The Puzzle Die's wish function, the only wish in existence, ten-thousand-year cooldown, is spent on an impossible ask. Myron is critically injured, paralysed, dying. Kolo's soul has been trapped for four years. Exme cannot choose between them, so she chooses both: her own life in exchange for Myron's healing and Kolo's restoration. The wish is accepted, but the cost is absolute. Exmerah Sliokzog is erased from existence, not dead but unmade, beyond resurrection, beyond godhood, beyond the reach of Heaven or Hell. She is gone as though she never was.

Kolo wakes in a construct body built by his sister. Myron opens his eyes. Neither knows yet what it cost.

ARC XV: CANALON DESCENDS

Episodes 98–103

Kalimar is dead. But Kalimar had a mate.

Canalon, an elder-god space dragon, descends from the stars and mind-controls the entire allied army, seizing Hope's Rest to erase free will and destroy the gods. The party, now including the devil Bronwen sent by Lazarus as a minder and Kolo in his new metal body, rallies the western carnival city of Jecede, Erin's home.

It is not enough. A githyanki Nautiloid attacks the city. The party boards it. An Ulitharid mind flayer devours Erin's brain. Myron takes her fallen glaive and splits the creature in two.

Two episodes later, Burnie dies. The old Book Burner charges the Nautiloid's elder brain alone, buying the others time, and is torn limb from limb. Captain Stick goes down with the Airship Gary, steering the burning vessel into the crashing Nautiloid to deflect it from the city.

Gem, a woman of living silicate freed from a holding cell aboard the wreckage, joins the survivors. She has travelled between stars for five centuries. Her people were created when Canalon was cast out of the heavens. She has her own reasons for wanting the dragon dead.

ARC XVI: THE LAST HEIST

Episodes 104–108

Myron leads what is left: himself, Kolo, Bronwen, Gem, and Bucky McCaw, Burnie's son. They

board a maiden-voyage steam railway from Jecede to Hope's Rest, fighting Inquisitors across the train roof. Hope's Rest is a ghost city, its population mind-controlled, Canalon perched atop the guildmasters' hall.

The target is the Black Rock, Riphard's bank. Its deepest vault holds the Armoury of Sin, the gear the god Sinn wore when he last fought Canalon. Using a relief army as a distraction, the remnant party heists the deserted bank, fighting through bronze automaton guards and a teleporting, lightning-wreathed Arcanist in a bullet-time lobby battle. They crack the vault with the code 51624 while its owner is

somewhere else entirely.

The Armoury is claimed. The written record ends at Episode 108.

"Well, we're off to fight a God."

Episode 108

The final battle with Canalon, wearing the armour of a god against a god, was never written up. The players know what happened. The book does not. Perhaps some stories end better for not having an ending.

THE CAMPAIGN BY NUMBERS

- 108 episodes across two campaigns (2017–2019, 2022)
- 6 players, 1 Dungeon Master
- 16 player characters (5 starting, 11 replacements and additions)
- 7 player character deaths, 3 departures, 2 erasures from reality, 2 resurrections
- 1 airship (destroyed), 1 mecha-bear, 1 giant robot, 1 sentient railgun, 1 steam train
- 1 bank founded, 1 bank heisted (same bank), 0 lemons returned
- 1 deal with a devil. Then another one.

THEMES OF THE CAMPAIGN

Beneath the irreverence and the chaos, Velterra is a campaign about emancipation, of goblins, of gods, of people from corrupt institutions. It is about found family and the cost of losing it. It is about what happens when good people are given power by bad systems, and what it takes to tear those systems down.

It is also about a dwarf who married a prostitute, founded a bank, and then carried a mannequin around believing it was his dead wife. It is about a goblin who ate a biscuit and discovered the joy of eating. It is about a cocktail made with Bovril.

The campaign never chose between tragedy and comedy. It was always both.

The continuation proved the point. Four years later, the same group came back for more. They lost more than they could afford to lose, and they kept going anyway.

THE SEVEN



DETAILS

There are seven gods:

LATHOR - THE MOTHER AND FATHER, THE HORIZON

The first among equals. Goodness, Faith, Leadership, Family

Lathor rarely acts directly in the epic tales told of the gods engaging in their grand wars. Rather, the tales always start with Lathor tasking the other gods with going to a particular location, destroying a particular evil creature or finding a particular item. Then, at the end of tale, when the battle is won, usually with a bitter price paid, Lathor returns, to deliver the moral of the story and teach the relevant lesson.

ELLEDUN - THE LANTERN-BEARER, THE RISING SUN

Hope, Light Against the Darkness, Agriculture, Travellers

Followers of Elledun often build roadside shrines, marked by a small candle, protected from the elements with a glass cover. Weary travellers will find supplies contained within, and are expected to contribute in kind when well-stocked.

BELLADON - THE OPEN-HANDED, THE CRYSTAL SPRING

Charity, Giving to Those in Need, Forgiveness, The Home

HEMOTATE - THE BOOK-BEARER, THE TREE IN THE STORM

Justice, Fairness, Karma, Scholarly Pursuits

Devotees of Hemotate make a habit of claiming that by the time Hemotate arrived to a battle, the day was already won. Using preparation, research, and their enemies weaknesses, they often found no need for weapons. The forces of darkness brought their own undoing, and Hemotate was able to pick at the right threads to unravel their plans.

VATHOS - THE SHIELD-BEARER, THE WEATHERED ROCK

Fortitude, Strength Against Adversity, Undergoing Punishment

In legends, Vathos would enter battle against the forces of darkness wielding only a shield. With each blow that landed upon him, his strength grew. He would stand in the midst of battle, taking blow after blow without striking back until, when the moment came, he would fell whole armies with a single punch.

NOVETTA- THE ARMS-BEARER, THE CONSUMING FIRE

Valor, Fighting Against Evil, Vengeance

Novetta eschewed armour, and would enter battle armed only with her bastard sword, Fynyr. It is said that Fynyr was sharp enough to sever the connection between an enemies body and their soul.

MATREUS - THE STANDARD-BEARER, THE TOWER ON THE HILL

Loyalty, Conviction

Matreus was said to be deaf and blind, and fought valiantly in battle, never knowing whether his compatriots were standing firm or had turned and fled long ago. Seen as a lonely figure, but one that is never discouraged by that fact.

His most ardent followers tend to live in isolation, meeting only to share wisdom and scriptures. They believe that a faith that is tested most often, and which still holds, is the truest, and that strength never used is no strength at all.

SYNNE - THE HORSEMAN, THE BURIED SPIRE

The Eighth God. The Church speaks only of Seven, but the Great Stone was originally called the Stone of the Eight. Synne's domains are shrouded in secrecy, his followers viewed with suspicion, and his very existence something the Church would rather the world forgot.

Pilcheur bore the Mark of Synne on his body, a divine brand that granted dark powers at a terrible cost. Upon Pilch's death, this connection manifested as Mark O'Synne, a golden-haired avatar who emerged from Gary's chest and who claimed to be working to prevent the Sundering's worst consequences. The party was labelled a "Cult of Synne" by the Church, a designation that made them enemies of the state.

While some people favour one god in particular, this is not common, and is viewed with suspicion by some in the Church.

THE GODS' PLACE IN THE WORLD

More frequently, people have a few of the gods which, when taken in combination, express their outlook. For example, many Arbiters favour a combination of Hemotate and Novetta, representing their drive to punish lawbreakers, whereas many Pastors favour a combination of Elledun and Belladon, in the hope that they may spread the light of their faith to those in their community.

A sailor going to sea may pray to Elledun and Matreus when setting out on their journey, so that they may stay true to their path and not get lost, but pray to Belladon and Vathos when their ship is caught in a storm, to gift them with the strength to carry on.

Demons are responsible for the physical torments of the damned, while devils handle the administrative burden of processing and categorising souls. The gods themselves have been absent from the world since the Sundering, their power filtered and diminished by the Great Stone.

The truth, as the party would discover, is that the gods never abandoned the world willingly. The Church's seal cut them off, and only by breaking that seal can the gods return to take an active role in the world once more, restoring the balance that has been missing for centuries.

KALIMAR, THE CREATOR

Kalimar was an elder entity, a being of terrifying power whose domain was the warping of flesh. Connected to the mysterious Canilon symbol found tattooed on Inquisitors and glowing in purple orbs, Kalimar operated outside the divine order entirely.

Souls absorbed by Kalimar did not pass to Hell; they were claimed entirely, trapped beyond even Lazarus's reach. Kolo Kozolski became Kalimar's servant in the Tom'ardy mines, his body grotesquely mutated by the entity's corruption. After Kolo's death, his soul remained trapped with Kalimar rather than descending to the afterlife.

In the continuation, the party tracked Kalimar to his lava sanctum in the far north and destroyed him. Mrs Ball annihilated the elder god with a single devastating blow. Exmerah's forbidden Wish freed Kolo's trapped soul and restored him in a construct body, at the cost of erasing herself from existence.

CANALON, THE DESTROYER

Canalon, also rendered Cannillon, is an elder-god space dragon and Kalimar's mate. When the party killed Kalimar, Canalon descended from the stars in retribution, seizing Hope's Rest and mind-controlling the entire allied army and population.

Canalon's goal was the eradication of free will and the destruction of the gods. The Inquisitors bore a Canilon tattoo beneath their chests, a symbol of Canalon's ancient influence that predated even the Church's corruption. Gem's people, the silicates, were created at the moment Canalon was cast out of the heavens, making the dragon's return a matter of cosmic significance.

The party donned the Armoury of Sin, the gear worn by the god Sinn when he last fought Canalon, and set out for the final battle. The outcome was never written up.

THE EIGHTH GOD

While the Church speaks of the Seven, those who have delved deeper into the world's mysteries know that the Great Stone was originally called the Stone of the Eight. The identity of this eighth god, Synne, the Horseman, the Buried Spire, remains shrouded in secrecy. His domains are unknown, his followers viewed with suspicion, and his mark carries a power that the Church would rather the world forgot.

THE CHURCH OF THE SEVEN

The Church is the dominant political, military, and spiritual power in Velterra. Founded to serve the will of the Seven Gods, the Church has ruled the known world for centuries through a network of pastors, arbiters, and inquisitors. Since the Sundering, when the Church used the Great Stone to sever the world's connection to the divine, the institution has grown increasingly corrupt, wielding the filtered remnants of godly power to maintain control.

The Church's hierarchy stretches from humble village pastors to the fearsome Arbiters who enforce divine law, and at its darkest reaches, the shadowy Inquisition, an elite force of divine warriors who hunt down heretics and enemies of the faith with terrifying efficiency.

The Church views magic with deep suspicion and actively suppresses knowledge that contradicts its teachings, leading to the creation and eventual purge of the Book Burners.



The Jennies are a group of ladies who offer discrete services for the discerning adventurer. Originally a network of courtesans, the Jennies were forced underground when the Church officially outlawed their profession. Under the leadership of Mae Harkwood, they reinvented themselves as a formidable criminal organisation, spreading “like herpes through the empire”.

Operating from a hidden camp known affectionately as “Whorecity”, the Jennies proved to be surprisingly capable allies. Delilah, one of their finest operatives, joined the party early in their adventure and went on to become Riphard's wife, the Sky Captain of Tomorrow, and one of the group's most reliable fighters. Mae herself helped the group track down both the SRA and Diego Escabar's bandits.

THE SRA, SMALL RIGHTS ACTIVISTS



A collection of mainly gnomes and halflings who perform terrorist acts in their quest for improving the rights of smaller folk. Led by Razzle Backshine, a gnome with a penchant for exploding things in people's faces, the SRA was spread across the empire conducting increasingly volatile operations.

The party's encounter with the SRA was characteristically complicated. After infiltrating Razzle's hideout through a combination of forged documents, elaborate deception, and Exme's railgun, the group killed Razzle and installed "Buttons" as the new leader of the faction, hoping to redirect the organisation toward less indiscriminate violence.

THE BOOK BURNERS



The Book Burners were the Church's sanctioned order of literary enforcers, tasked with hunting down and destroying heretical texts.



Book Burner's Mask V1.0

Part mercenary company, part secret police, the Book Burners operated under Church authority to suppress dangerous knowledge.

The organisation's downfall came from within. Members like Pilcheur Gamont were secretly selling books instead of burning them, and when the Church discovered this betrayal, they launched a brutal purge that scattered the surviving Book Burners across the continent. Their former headquarters in Hope's Rest was eventually claimed by the party and repurposed as the Gary Guild's base of operations, complete with firepoles and a vault.

Key former members include Pilcheur, Burnie Cinders, Lillian (a half-elf who fled west), Zippy (an alcoholic gnome), and Archibald, the elderly, near-blind librarian who continued to tend the abandoned headquarters long after everyone else had fled.

THE GARY GUILD

The Gary Guild, officially "Garys Against Religion, Yo", was founded by the party in Hope's Rest as a front for their anti-Church operations. What began as an absurd proposition by a stone man in a flowery outfit became a genuine political force in the city.

The guild secured its headquarters through a dramatic guild council vote, with Gary's impassioned speech winning over the assembled

guild masters. They formed a joint venture with the Guilds of Services, Might, and Life, and established themselves as a legitimate presence in the city's power structure.

The guild's logo, drawn by Gary himself, was described as "a universal hit". Derek Bobacious was recruited to manage the guild's marketing operations, employing billboard campaigns with slogans like "We Take Interest in Your Interest".

THE BANK

Founded by Riphard Obsidian Hardstone, the Guild of Banking was Velterra's first financial institution. It began humbly in the house of Derek Bobacious in Riverfall, an elderly bachelor who was convinced that "the gods want to run a shop in his house", and grew into a full guild operation in Hope's Rest.

The bank's pitch, "Safe Storage for a Dangerous World", impressed the Guild of Coin's head, Rowlett Marnett, enough to secure investment. Key positions included Riphard as Head Interface Officer, Gary as Global Business Unification Investigator, Delilah as Job Organiser (Lower Klass), Pilch as Quota, Rosta, Training and Torture Officer, Exme as Untrustworthy Individual, and Kolo as Grossly Untrustworthy Individual.

THE HEARTHRUST SOCIETY

Founded by Lady Otoría Hearthrust before her death, the Hearthrust Society is an emancipation movement of robot ladies from Nanduan. Built by a craftsman named Konrad, these automata, including Lady Vashen, Lady Hirota, and Lady Averio, fight for freedom and autonomy.

Otoría had killed the Emperor of Masuda and founded the Society before fleeing to Velterra, leaving behind a network of mechanical women who would carry on her cause. The Society allied with the party during the Masuda campaign, providing a robot army that proved decisive in several key battles. Lady Hirota personally rescued the group from certain death by swooping in on a mechanical eagle.

For the final assault on Seven's Spire, the Hearthrust Society sent their female ninja riders on mechanical eagles to join the alliance army, a fitting tribute to the woman whose principles of honour and emancipation had inspired them all.

THE INQUISITION

The Church's elite secret enforcement arm. Dark masked figures with tentacle maws instead of mouths, the Inquisitors are the most terrifying force in Velterra. Each bears a Canilon tattoo

under their chest, a symbol connected to the elder entity Kalimar.

Inquisitors are immune to all non-Excalibur weapons, making them effectively invincible against conventional forces. Their existence is officially denied by the Church, which makes their habit of publicly executing people somewhat awkward. The party's first encounters with the Inquisition were one-sided affairs that ended in retreat; only after forging Excalibur weapons could they fight on equal terms.

The most dangerous variant, the Inquisitor Ravagers, are massive hulking beings with rough-hewn metal spikes inserted where hands should be. Two of these accompanied Arbiter Khan in the final encounter at Seven's Spire.

THE VARG

A northern warlord and barbarian alliance that dominates the frozen lands beyond Linderdorf. The Varg enslaved the goblin tribes, including Kolo and Exme's people, and maintain control through roving bands of bearkin warriors. Their territory is a bitter, snowbound wasteland where children watch travellers from the hills and the Varg Hold stretches for miles as a massive tent city.

The historical figure Hunthar Varg once led an incursion into Church territory that was only stopped by the Zealot Arbiter Elron wielding the Hammer of the Gods. In the original campaign, the Varg remained a distant threat, with Linderdorf serving as the bastion against their raids.

In the continuation, the warlord Valkar Varg united the scattered tribes into a single force and struck a pact with Kalimar, using the elder god's flesh-warping goo to breed Pact warriors, super-soldiers loyal to Valkar alone. The party infiltrated the Chesney Hawks, a tribe led by the giantess Magrat, to gather intelligence. The snow leopard warrior Buchra and the half-giant Eric were among the tribespeople the party fought and drank alongside. When Valkar declared war and marched south, the party tracked him north to Kalimar's lair instead, killing the source of his power.

THE UNIVERSITY OF ASSASSINS

Part educational institution, part criminal enterprise. The University operates in Hope's Rest under the Guild of Services, training students in the arts of stealth, poison, and targeted elimination. Burnie once held a teaching position there, and his son Buck McCraw now trains students, including Kevin, the final-year PhD student who joined the party to complete his fieldwork requirements.

The University's clockwork ninja assassins joined the alliance army for the final battle at Hope's Rest, proving that even contract killers can be moved by a good cause, or at least a sufficiently large payment.

THE ALLIANCE ARMY

The coalition assembled for the final assault on the Church's power, built through every friendship, favour, and alliance the party had forged across years of adventuring. The army comprised:

The Gary Guild and Hope's Rest commoners. The Jennies. Clockwork ninja assassins from the University. Tom'ardy dwarves. Linderdorf robots and cannons. The Hearthrast Society's mechanical eagle riders. New Abbergast's fishmen under King Oceani. The Stonecast Mech, dropped from the airship as a siege weapon.

Their assault on Seven's Spire was the culmination of the party's mission, friendship really was magic, after all.

It did not last. When Canalon descended in the continuation, the elder-god space dragon mind-controlled the entire allied army and the population of Hope's Rest. The force the party had spent years building was turned against them in an instant. Myron led a relief army from Jecede to reclaim the city, but the alliance as it had been, a coalition of free peoples choosing to fight, was gone.

HELL INC. / THE EMPIRE OF THE EIGHT

Hell is not merely a place of torment, it is a bureaucracy. Managed by the devil Lazarus from his plush office (accessible via portal doors created by Meredith, his elephantine butler), Hell operates with departmental efficiency: demons handle the torturing, devils handle the bookkeeping.

Lazarus recruited the party because the Church's ever-expanding definition of sin was flooding Hell with undeserving souls, overwhelming the system. His war room, complete with a large-scale map of Velterra and intelligence on Church troop movements, became the party's strategic command centre in the final campaign. His superior, Arbigal, used "brutal underhanded management tactics" to gain control of the operation.

Following the return of the Gods, Lazarus was rewarded for his efforts by being re-ascended into his full angel form. By the time of the continuation, four years later, Lazarus had risen to rule Hell outright, rebranding the operation as

the Empire of the Eight. He regathered the scattered party to deal with the Varg threat, sent the devil Bronwen as a minder when the group's losses mounted, and continued to pull strings from behind his portal doors. Hell's bureaucracy, it turned out, ran rather well under new management.

THE GITHYANKI

Interplanar raiders who arrived aboard a Nautiloid, a living ship of flesh and bone crewed by githyanki warriors and mind flayers. The Nautiloid attacked Jecede during the continuation, deploying an Ulitharid, an elder mind flayer, and an elder brain that controlled the vessel.

The party boarded the Nautiloid and fought through its corridors. The Ulitharid devoured Erin's brain. The elder brain killed Burnie. Captain Stick crashed the burning Airship Gary into the Nautiloid to deflect it from the city, destroying both vessels. Gem, a silicate spacefarer, was found in a holding cell aboard the wreckage and joined the survivors.

Whether the githyanki served Canalon or pursued their own agenda was never entirely clear.

CHAPTER 2: THE WORLD OF VELTERRA

VELTERRA



The year is 6653 CC (Church Calendar). Welcome to the world of Velterra, domain of the Seven, who rule over all from afar through the constant vigilance of the Church.

Velterra is a world shaped by faith, conflict, and the long shadow of divine abandonment. Centuries ago, the Church, believing it was protecting the world from danger, used a most powerful artefact, the Great Stone of the Eight (though you would call it Seven), to sunder the world from the gods and from the realms beyond. The seal filters the gods' power, and the Church bends this diminished influence to its own wishes. They had good intentions to begin with, and still believe they are doing right by the world, but they are no longer.

The world is divided into several major regions. The Main Land, named Valeria in the old records, though almost nobody calls it that, is dominated by the Church's influence, stretching from the frozen north, where goblin tribes live under the brutal reign of the Varg warlords, to the civilised cities of the south. Hope's Rest, the largest city in the empire, serves as the commercial and political heart of the Church-controlled territories. Beyond the Main Land lie the continents of Nanduan and Masuda to the

east, the mysterious jungles of South Africa, and the burning sands of the Great Expanse.

Magic exists in Velterra, though the Church views it with deep suspicion. The ancient arts have been waning since the Sundering, and few practitioners remain. The most powerful magical artefacts, the Slab of Inthun, the Stone of Unthala, the Puzzle Die of Ruh'Breks, and the star-metal known as Excalibur, are remnants of a more powerful age, jealously guarded or lost to time.

The monetary system uses gold, silver, and copper pieces, consistent across Church-controlled territories. Trade flows through major ports like Port Averdale and along the cobbled roads connecting the empire's cities. Beyond Church borders, different customs and currencies prevail.

THE SUNDERING

Many centuries ago, the Church used the Great Stone to sever the world's connection to the gods and the realms beyond. This event, known as the Sundering, was intended to protect the mortal world from external threats. However, the centuries have not been kind. With the gods reduced to distant, filtered influences, the

Church has become corrupt, and the world is now endangered more than anything that came before.

The only hope for the souls of the world is to “break the seal”, to unlock the gods’ power and bring them back to full strength. The Church will oppose this at all costs, but once the seal is broken, the Church will either fall or be reborn.

THE AFTERLIFE

Hell exists as a bureaucratic dimension of the afterlife, managed by devils who handle the

bookkeeping while demons do the torturing. The excessive numbers of hell-bound souls, a consequence of the Church’s draconian definition of sins, prompted the devil Lazarus to recruit mortal agents to bring down the Church and restore balance to the cosmic order.

Heaven, or at least the realm of the gods, has been largely inaccessible since the Sundering. The path of “decent and noble” souls to their rightful rest has been corrupted by the Church’s seal.

HELL



One of the dimensions of the afterlife. Hell is managed by the devil Lazarus from a plush office accessible through portal doors created by his elephantine butler, Meredith. The office furnishings rotate between kitsch decor and a large-scale war room map of Velterra depending on Lazarus's mood. Demons handle the physical torments of the damned while devils manage the administrative burden of processing and categorising souls.

The party visited Hell regularly through their dreams, using the Stone of Unthala to communicate with Lazarus. Kevin, upon looking out of Lazarus's office window, saw the infinite abyss of the damned, and, being wise beyond his years, retained his sanity by waving hello to the various murderers, thieves, and scallywags he recognised having assassinated recently.

It's hot.

MAIN LAND



HOPE'S REST



The largest city in Velterra and the commercial heart of the Church-controlled territories. Hope's Rest is a multi-cultural trading mecca, bisected by the River Eldon, and governed by a complex guild system rooted in five founding families.

Each family selects a board that appoints a GEO (Guild Executive Officer) to rule their district. The current GEO, Parchet Green, a half-elf male, quite stern and ruthless, holds power largely because all who stood against him in elections have vanished.

The five guild families and their domains:

Life: Taverns, gambling houses; headed by Zelfie Higgins, a halfling woman. **Might:** Archers, mercenaries, the Hunt (bounty hunters), and the Masters, the guild's elite unit; headed by the elf Tolon Eversong. **Coin:** Traders, stores, market, and mint; the Mint is run by Wellington Hunter-Smyth and the Traders by Montigue Hartwell. **Service:** Cleaners, valets, plumbers, Jennies (semi-official), Thieves Guild, Assassins Guild; headed by Meke Longpaw, a Tabaxi. **Making:** Carpenters, builders, blacksmiths, clothiers; headed by the dwarf Dalvona Amethyst.

The city's politics district clusters around the Guild Hall itself.

Notable landmarks include Bertrand's Stand (the last defensive wall), the Petite Ferret (pub, run by Horatio BrambleThrust), the old Book Burner headquarters (now the Gary Guild base), and Riphard's Guild of Banking. The city's sewer system, vast and unmapped, became the site of

Kolo's lair during his corruption and the scene of the group's most devastating loss.

The party spent more time in Hope's Rest than anywhere else, founding guilds, establishing businesses, fighting the SRA, and earning enemies and allies in equal measure. During the final campaign, the Church sent 8,000 troops to Hope's Rest, and the Battle of Hope's Rest saw the alliance army, Garys, Jennies, assassins, dwarves, fishermen, and commoners, fight to hold the city while the party assaulted Seven's Spire.

In the continuation, Hope's Rest fell again, this time to Canalon. The elder-god space dragon perched atop the guildmasters' hall and mind-controlled the entire population, turning the city into a silent, empty shell. The party's final mission was to return to Hope's Rest and heist the Black Rock bank for the Armoury of Sin, moving through streets they once called home while every citizen stood blank-eyed under a dragon's will.

THE BOOK BURNER'S HEADQUARTERS



The former headquarters of the Book Burners, now repurposed as the base of operations for the Gary Guild. The building features firepoles between floors (a source of endless entertainment for Exme), a vault in the basement, a third-floor workshop converted for Exme's engineering work, and a library still tended by the elderly Archibald. The building was secured through a dramatic guild council vote after Gary's impassioned speech won over the assembled guild masters.

VATHOS BOUNDARY

A small settlement on the edge of the civilised world, the last stop before the southern wilderness. Vathos Boundary is where the party first set foot after their resurrection, and from here they ventured south to retrieve the Stone of Unthala from the ice temple.

The town's modest amenities include the Copper Flagon pub, the Bronze Hammer tavern (run by Ledrun Harkness), and Marcy's, the establishment politely recorded in the party's notes as the "Titty bar," run by the busty barkeep Marcy Davis. Frederick the blacksmith, Pastor Gunther Dunkhill's Church, a city guard house (under Captain Urnok, a half-orc never seen without Gumshoe the troll), a jewellers, and a stable round out the town, all under the watch of Mayor Bertrum Salvador. The surrounding countryside is home to the Dutty Hoes Camp, an RWA cave hideout, and the Forest of Big Pig

TOM'ARDY MOUNTAINS

Home to an exclusive and reclusive enclave of high-status dwarven families, each dynasty residing in their own private mountain. It can take days just to say hello to your neighbours, not that anyone does.

Beneath the surface, the mountains hide a darker truth: a classist, slave-dependent economy built on the backs of "Delvers", miners sent on one-way trips into the deep. The ancient Hardstone (or Hardthrust) family vault lies in the deepest levels, alongside the Excalibur deposits that the party spent weeks searching for. The mines are a treacherous labyrinth of traps, animated statues, Gorgons, and worse, it was here that Kolo began his descent into corruption, and that both he and Myron were turned to stone.

After the party's intervention, Tom'ardy was transformed into something approaching a socialist utopia, with the Delver class system abolished and the mountain dwarves joining the alliance army for the final battle.

TEMPLE OF UNTHALA

A skull-shaped ice temple in the frozen wilderness south of Vathos Boundary, accessible via a perilous bridge. The temple was home to a colony of TikkiTukks and contained the Stone of Unthala, an ancient relic that served as the party's primary means of communication with Lazarus. The party fought their way through rooms of masked bear-creatures, a giant spider, and dart traps to claim the stone from the chief's quarters.

RIVERFALL



Riverfall is a fair-to-middling sized town, blessed with a beautiful set of rivers and waterfalls that give it its name. The town serves as an important stop on the road north and is home to a significant Church presence, centred around the Sanctuary of Novetta and its head priest, Priest Granger. The keeper of the Tower of Imota Kan, Hollie Granger, shares his name, as the party's notes put it, "possibly someone important's daughter. Nothing like a bit of nepotism to keep the town running well."

The town had four pubs, the Sad Crusader, Club and Cask, Open Flask, and Minstrels, one of which unfortunately and mysteriously burnt down after Pilch's possession caused him to vomit magical darkness and Kolo responded by setting fire to the building.

Riverfall is also home to a very expensive blacksmith, the Tower of Imota Kan (which houses a vault of secret artefacts and a lovely collection of non-religious but Church-safe books), and the house of Derek Bobacious, site of Riphard's first bank, Northern Rock.

A new addition to the town is a nicely sized ditch on the outskirts.

THE TOWER OF IMOTA KAN

The Tower of Imota Kan, Nakatomi spelt backwards, was the site of a daring heist that played out like a scene from a famous pre-Velterranean action scroll. The robbery was led by "Hans" and his band of mercenaries, and was thwarted by the party in a running battle across multiple floors. It was here that Otoria met her end at the blade of the singing swordswoman Lark.

THE SEVEN'S SPIRE



A moderate-sized city dominated by a massive spire dedicated to the Church of the Seven, and the location of the Great Stone that maintains the seal keeping the gods from the world. The district surrounding the spire is given over entirely to religion: tat shops hawking religiosity, heavily plated guards sporting god symbology, and moneyed citizens decked out in serious god swag. Commoners wear potato sacks, as befitting their station. Making money is considered vulgar and is kept to the outskirts.

The tower itself is a fortress. The lower floors house stores, servants, and guard barracks. Above that: officer quarters, training arenas, and archery ranges. Higher still: clergy levels filled with books and sherry-drinking clerics. A prison level holds cells stretching in curved arcs for as far as the eye can see, most containing either rotting remains or desiccated bodies, and, in one steel-doored room, the torture rack where Arbiter Kiros was found barely alive. The pinnacle, above all of this, houses the Great Stone and the seal itself.

A massive sewer network runs into the tower's foundations. The annual Festival of Light draws thousands of pilgrims, providing the perfect cover for infiltration, especially if one is disguised as a lemon.

The party's infiltration of Seven's Spire was the climax of the entire campaign. Lillith posed as a pastor to gain entry weeks in advance, the Stonecast Mech and ninja eagles provided a distraction outside, and the party fought their

way floor by floor toward the pinnacle to break the seal and return the gods to the world.

LOGARSK



A sleepy town nestled over the mountains from Seven's Spire, where the Church puts children through a trial at the age of five. The party arrived here on the run and discovered something far worse than a harsh coming-of-age ceremony: the local Marshall was abusing children in the church basement using the Slab of Inthun, an ancient artefact that either kills its subject or imbues them with immense power. It works better on children, a fact that made the Marshall's crimes all the more horrifying.

The party's intervention brought them into direct confrontation with the Inquisition for the first time, an ambush, by the party's account, in which the Inquisition wanted to take the surviving child as their own. The encounter went badly. It also introduced Arbiter Kiros, who tried to blame the group for the ensuing mess but gradually came around to their cause.

The party returned to Logarsk much later in the campaign to collect the Stonecast Mech for the final assault.

THE GREAT EXPANSE

A vast, burning desert where travellers lose their way and their lives with equal regularity. The Expanse is plagued by "bandits" called Spancers, an anti-Church group who prey upon travellers but proved to be valuable allies when the party crossed their territory. The Spancers and their Tengu allies became part of the broader resistance against the Church.

PORT AVERDALE

One of the major ports on the main continent, full of colourful people and shady goings-on. What it really needed was a show from a circus troupe, but the party failed them. They do have a lovely square made up of two triangles that hosts all kinds of cultural events. It also had a

lovely customs expo, which was mysteriously burned down. Otoría was killed in a harbour tavern here, choosing honour over surrender when outnumbered by scores of thugs, before being resurrected by Lazarus and joining the party.

LINDERDORF

A mountain city built into the rock itself, a dense warren of foundries, mills, and shops where automatons walk the streets. Lithe mechanical models staff the shops, hulking constructs serve as guards, and the city ships weapons and steel across Velterra. Linderdorf is the bastion of civilisation against the Varg, and its university, where Professor Jorge Myron teaches, is one of the finest centres of learning in the world.

The party arrived here seeking master blacksmiths to forge Excalibrium weapons. Their drunken search for Google Von Maccherstein through the city's labyrinthine streets became legendary. Myron invented the "Piece of Shit" cocktail here, Riphard bought a schnitzel business, and Martin was found to have been a construct originally built in the city. The Clawtech Arena hosted the party's battle against the thirty-foot Stonecast Mech, and the city served as the staging ground for the alliance army's final assault.

NEW ABBERGAST

An island settlement ruled by Lady Gharbighast, built into a fortress-town on a beautiful coast still under construction. The party arrived to find the settlers under attack from merfolk who resented the overfishing of their waters. Through Toni's diplomatic efforts, a trade agreement was brokered with King Oceani of the merfolk, and the underwater terror Acroneth the Immortal, an Aboleth, was slain to secure lasting peace.

Lady Gharbighast later bore a child with King Oceani and, despite Church pressure, remained loyal to the party's alliance. The fishmen of New Abbergast joined the final battle.

GOLDING'S BAY

A town controlled by Freyer Thistlebloom, an SRA leader with magical abilities. The party was ensorcelled within the local temple into slaughtering an entire village of innocent people. The horror of this event drove Toni to surrender to the Arbiters in protest and ultimately to leave the group entirely.

THE VARG LANDS

The frozen northern territory beyond Linderdorf. A bitter, snowbound wasteland of roving goblin

bands, ogres, and bearkin warriors. The Varg Hold, a massive tent city stretching for miles, lies somewhere in the interior. Children watch travellers from the hills, and giants roam near the mountains.

The party ventured into the Varg lands twice. In the original campaign, they rescued the gnome inventors and found the Bright Bart Forge; Martin was found beaten and chained by bearkin, Kevin collapsed in the sub-zero temperatures, and a lightning bolt struck the airship. In the continuation, the party returned to infiltrate the Chesney Hawks tribe under the giantess Magrat, tracking Valkar Varg north through ice-cliff temples, ratman hives, and fungal forests to Kalimar's lair in the far north.

BRIGHT BART FORGE

An ancient dwarven forge at the summit of a mountain in Varg territory, sealed for centuries by the Aspect of the Storm, an air elemental wielding a lightning sword that had possessed the mountain. The forge was the source of legendary weapons in ages past, and its rediscovery provided the party with the forging knowledge, rune-carving books, and tools needed to create their Excalibum weapons.

Inside, the party found dwarven skeletons, the last smiths had sealed themselves in when the Aspect took the mountain, and died of causes best not discussed in polite company.

JECEDÉ

A western coastal carnival city of rival half-elf princes, a council of thirteen, and a population that knows how to throw a party. The DuPont and Marseille families compete for influence, dark elf tensions simmer beneath the surface, and the city maintains both an army and a navy.

Jecede is the home of Sgt Erin Devereux, whose parents Calista and Michelle Devereaux run the Midnight Pearl cabaret on the waterfront. When Canalon descended and mind-controlled Hope's Rest, Jecede became the party's last stronghold. Its council rallied the city's forces, its harbour was attacked by the githyanki Nautiloid, and its maiden-voyage steam railway carried the remnant party east to Hope's Rest for the final heist.

THE MIDNIGHT PEARL

A cabaret and brothel on the Jecede waterfront, run by Calista and Michelle Devereaux. The dancers pray to "Lady Delilah," a detail that caught Riphard's attention and may have been the reason he left the party to investigate with the Jennies.

KALIMAR'S LAIR

A temple complex buried in a giant ice sheet in the far north, descending through ratman hives, fungal spore forests, and the flesh-tunnel bowels of a god to a lava sanctum at its heart. This was the domain of Kalimar, the elder god of creation, whose power to warp flesh had corrupted Kolo and fuelled Valkar's Pact warriors.

The party fought their way down through every level to reach the sanctum. Kalimar nearly killed them all. Mrs Ball destroyed the elder god. Exmerah used the only Wish in existence to save Myron and restore Kolo, erasing herself from reality in the process.

THE BLACK ROCK

Riphard's post-timeskip mega-bank in Hope's Rest, successor to the original Northern Rock. A towering institution with vaults of gold, silver, and bronze, and a deep vault protected by bronze automaton guards, acid pots, skull locks, and a mural riddle about wise Kimicho.

The deep vault held the Armoury of Sin, the divine gear worn by the god Sinn when he last fought Canalon. The party heisted it in the final arc, cracking the vault with the code 51624 while Riphard, its owner, was elsewhere investigating with the Jennies.

THE FISHY LIBRARY

Burnie's public library in Hope's Rest, founded in the four years after the Spire as a successor to the Book Burners' secret collection. Equipped with a printing press and open to anyone, it represented Burnie's transformation from a man who burned books to one who preserved them.

THE JECEDÉ RAILWAY

A maiden-voyage steam railway running from Jecede to Hope's Rest, boasting "the speed of 30,000 horses." Myron and the remnant party rode it east with a relief army after the airship's destruction, fighting Inquisitors across the train roof along the way.

ERDUN'S WELL

A settlement near an abandoned mine east of the Varg lands. The regathered party was sent here for a warm-up mission against the lich Valklondar, an ancient undead wizard researching stasis in the mine's depths. The lich met his end when a crab-polymorphed Myron was slammed into Mrs Ball.

NANDUAN

Nanduan is a large kingdom on the North-Eastern coast of the continent of Erassa. The capital city is located on the banks of a tidal river estuary, and maritime trade makes up a significant portion of the economy.

Nanduan does not trade significantly with Velarian cities, but has some relations with the elven city of A'kul'theok. There is limited migration from Nanduan to Church-controlled cities, and so not much is known about this land by commoners in these areas. Traders and travellers may have some patchy information. It is known that relations between Nanduan and Masuda, to the south, are strained, at best.

Known Inhabitants

The Hearthrust Dynasty - A large, wealthy and prominent noble family. They recognise the danger of the isolation their social class gives them, and therefore the children of each generation are sent out into the world for a few years at the age of 18 to experience what life is like for the people below them. Some run small businesses, some join religious orders, but most use the opportunity to become adventurers or travelers. As most marriages within the family are arranged during the teenage years, some of the Hearthrust children are already betrothed by the time they begin their travels. In this case, the face of the Hearthrust daughters are covered, to save the world the pain of seeing, but not being able to attain, such beauty. Hearthrust girls are renowned in Nanduan as being exceptionally beautiful.

They are also seen as beautiful in their own country of Nanduan.

An Unnamed Shipping Magnate - Known to be betrothed to Lady Otoria Hearthrust.

Flora and Fauna

Sand Dagger - Dangerous and sneaky creatures known to hide underneath and behind things.

Balloon Cow - Like cows, but inflatable.

MASUDA

A kingdom to the east with a samurai culture, strained relations with Nanduan, and an ongoing civil war. The party spent a significant portion of the campaign here, arriving by airship and hiring Daisuke as their interpreter and fixer.

Masuda was the site of the hunt for the Lord of Lightning (where Myron proved himself), the castle infiltration to rescue Romjiro (where Myron threw Julieto out of a window), the discovery of the Hammer of the Gods in the Golden Hall, and the alliance with the Hearthrust Society. The civil war provided ample

opportunity for the group to make friends, enemies, and a considerable amount of money. Ruh'Breks Sensei sacrificed himself here, holding back a giant mountain creature to protect the airship as the party fled back to Velterra.

SOUTH AFRICA



The jungle continent, as dangerous as it is beautiful.

AKULTHEOK

The main port on South Africa, relatively friendly and very much like a Caribbean beach resort complete with great cocktails. The surrounding jungles, however, are as dangerous as they come.

THE JUNGLES

Super-dangerous jungles full of tribes, trebuchets, and cannibal Tikki Tukks. Hidden somewhere within was the Tower of Ruh'Breks, containing the Puzzle Die, the airship that would become The Gary, and the tower's caretaker, Codie, a sentient stone servant, presiding over a load of dead servants and snakes. It was in these jungles that Pilcheur met his end at the hands of a creature of the deep, Gary sacrificed himself protecting Kolo at the Tikituk Temple, and the party's course was changed forever.

THE VELTERRAN ARCHIVES

Alongside their session write-ups, the players maintained a campaign wiki, a working archive of quests, item research, monster sightings and recovered in-world documents. The records below are preserved from that archive as they were written at the time: a snapshot of what the party knew (and what they thought they knew) midway through their war against the Church.

RECOVERED DOCUMENTS

The Book Burners' cache and the party's own research turned up a number of texts whose meaning only became clear much later, and some whose meaning never did. Two extracts are reproduced here; others appear alongside the items they describe in the Gear chapter, and the apocryphal *Church Factions Over the Years* appears among the episode interludes.

EXTRACT FROM "CHRONICLES OF RHU'BREX"

In the centuries since Rhu'Brex walked the earth many of his works have been used or destroyed, his reputation for creating items that pushed the boundaries of magical knowledge created great desire and great fear.

One creation of his which has enraptured the wizarding world has remained elusive, despite the efforts of treasure hunters and practitioners of the arcane to uncover it. The Puzzle Die was a result of the great arcanists experiments into multi-functional magic. Most artefacts are known for a single, powerful effect and are purpose built for this. Rhu'Brex was obsessed with the concept of magic being adaptable, his concept being that it would be superior to have a single, portable device with countless possibilities instead of needing to fill a lair.

The Puzzle Die is known to have many properties that can be accessed, though knowledge of how to access its powers are mostly as lost as the Die itself. It is known to be able to grant its bearer the ability to move vast distances, destroy your enemies and transmute items – though Rhu'Brex created the Die to only respond to need, a precaution believed to prevent his apprentices from toying with such a dangerous tool.

One of the basic functions of the Puzzle Die is the ability to detect the presence and location of other magical items over great distance – a utility of such value that Rhu'Brex unlocked this function for use by any bearer.

The location of the Puzzle Die has remained a mystery for many years since the mysterious vanishing of Rhu'Brex himself. My own theorem is that Rhu'Brex held it within one of his secret lairs within the jungles of X far to the west – the increase in dangerous creatures and the lethality of the area certainly suggest some form of magical influence.

A STRANGE PAMPHLET STUCK BETWEEN THE PAGES OF A BOOK

Hark! He brings joy and riches beyond your imagining. He is nature, the truth and the way.

Bring yourself to him and bask in the treasures we have accumulated in his name! Bring your offerings to the temple beneath the plains. Be willing to offer your whole

self to him and he shall make you anew.

Vuthros brings life

Bring life to Vuthros

Follow from hope to the setting sun

The scorched arm of nature guides

To the second stone Where you must call for him

SCRAPS OF AN ANCIENT POEM

What lurks above or hides below,

What takes mans body or his soul,

When powers start to ebb and flow

That threatens all life to control.

What then, what choice, what time has come

What use is all the power we hold

If cursed to roam the cosmos numb

To joy and life, instead all cold

Repent of all the wrongs we've wrought

But better still the screams of death.

The silence of the Gods is bought

The joy of life in truth be deaf

What have we done

THE MAGICAL ITEM LEDGER

The party kept a running ledger of magical items, those acquired, and those known only from rumour. Its keeper noted: "I won't mention any of Exme's tinkerings here as 1) She won't let me near them and 2) many of them seem to be single use." The acquired items are documented in full in the Gear chapter; the rumours table is preserved below exactly as it stood mid-campaign, complete with speculation that history would prove right, wrong, and stranger than either.

THE QUEST LEDGER		
Item	Spec Presumed Location	
Puzzle Die of Rhu'Brex	Number of the Jungles of X to the West	Active • Bring down the church • Obtain Money • Obtain Power • Obtain Women Personal • Avenge Otoria (Kolo) • Learn to love and care for Mecha-Bear (Exme) • Become a Centaur (Gary) • Look after the town of Logask (Riphard) • DON'T BECOME CONSUMED BY THE DARKNESS (Pilch) Bounties • Giant boar. 50Gp • "Jennie's girls" • The SRA • Diego Escabar and his Merry Men Complete • Escape from hell • Find the town of Vathos Boundary and inquire about the stone of Un'thala • Search for the stone of Un'thala at the lost temple in the south • Find the mysterious horse thief of Vathos Boundary • Go to Rivers Fall to become a rich badass (Riphard Only) • Go on a drugs bender on top of mount Gulan • Journey North with the Caravan to Hope's Rest • Establish security deposit and banking system (Riphard) • Officially become an Agitator (Riphard) Side Quests, Ongoing • Recruit a resistance against the church, building allies against them.
Hammer of the Gods	Use: Somewhere to the east, likely in Meuda	
Exallibrum aka Starmetal	A No hint or clue as of yet; Kiros is researching this for us	

A BESTIARY OF VELTERRA

"A collection of beasts encountered by the group", field notes in the party's own words.

Wolfy McWolf-Face	The wolves hunt in packs, giving them advantage over adventurers. They were also very good at sneaking up on people.
TikkiTukk	The Tiki Warriors were easily slain by Pilchs, and Lady Otarios sword work. Although while utilizing pack tactics they constantly had the advantage over us. Tikki tuks seems to prefer bows and spears with which due to their diminutive size they tend to skewer adventurers nether regions with. The Tiki Warriors do have a chain of command, and at the top is the War Boss, easily identifiable by the superior craftsmanship of its mask. It is never recommended to remove the mask of the Tiki Tuk as they are quite hideous underneath.
DropBears	Death From Above. These bears nearly killed Otario by latching onto her lovely face.
Boar	This board page is a bit of a bore at the moment.
Tengu Cavalry	Tengu on a raptor. Raptors are very bitey.

CHAPTER 3: CHARACTERS

KOLO "TOURE" KOZOLSKI



DETAILS

Race: Goblin
Class: Rogue/Ranger
Age: 8
Status: Dead (ep 68), restored in a construct body (ep 98)

BACKGROUND

Kolo Kozolski was born two minutes after his twin sister Exmerah in the frozen wastelands of "the North", deep within the territory of the Varg. Like all Gabrins under Varg rule, the twins were enslaved from birth and spent their early years in bondage. Where Exme gravitated towards the workshops, Kolo took to the shadows, honing his skills as a thief, scout, and survivalist.

The twins were killed during an audacious escape attempt from their northern stronghold and resurrected by the devil Lazarus in Hell, along with three strangers, to carry out a mission to destroy the Church of the Seven.

PERSONALITY AND TRAITS

Boisterous, outspoken, and utterly fearless, Kolo was the face and frontman of the goblin duo. He was a natural leader with a flair for the dramatic, always the first into battle and the last to shut up about it afterwards.

Known for his impossibly fast fingers, Kolo was not to be trusted anywhere near another person's money, property, or indeed pockets. He relieved Pilcheur of fifteen gold pieces within

hours of meeting him and continued a lifelong career of redistributing other people's wealth.

Kolo harboured a burning passion for Gabrin emancipation, though his philosophy differed sharply from his sister's. Where Exme believed the races could work together, Kolo held that freedom could only be won by the sharp edge of a blade and that the only good human was a dead one. He was a gifted storyteller, regaling the group with the legendary tale of Grumpy Stanri, the elder goblin emancipator, around the campfire after Otor's death.

Kolo spoke Tikki Tuck, Goblin, and Low Velterran.

RELATIONSHIPS

Kolo's bond with his twin sister Exmerah was the defining relationship of his life. The two had never spent more than an hour apart before Kolo's descent into darkness, and his final act of lucidity was a scrawled note to her reading simply "Help me".

He maintained a gleeful antagonism with Pilcheur, whom he referred to exclusively as "Pilchard" or "Fishy", taking every opportunity to steal from him and blame others for the consequences.

Kolo shared an unlikely bond with Gary, the ancient stone elemental who became the moral heart of the group. Gary ultimately sacrificed himself to protect Kolo in the jungles of South Africa, an act of selflessness that Kolo never forgot.

His relationship with Riphard was complex, a mixture of mutual respect, competitive one-upmanship, and deep resentment. Every slight, every stolen kill, every act of goblin superiority that Kolo visited upon the dwarf accumulated into a debt that Riphard finally collected in the sewers of Hope's Rest.

Kolo formed a bond with Myron through their shared "turtle power" battle cries and combat tactics during the Masuda campaign, though this friendship did not survive Kolo's corruption.

KOLO'S STORY

Kolo began the campaign as a scrappy, quick-witted rogue who complemented his sister's inventive genius with raw cunning and combat skill. He was instrumental in retrieving the Stone of Unthala from the ice temple, surviving the Die Hard heist at the Tower of Imota Kan, and founding the Gary Guild in Hope's Rest through sheer force of personality.

During the Masuda campaign, Kolo came into his own as a warrior, adopting the “turtle power” battle philosophy with Myron and leading devastating charges against orc warbands. He underwent the Gabrin Coming of Age ritual alongside Exme, emerging physically transformed and stronger than ever.

The turning point came in the Tom’ardy Mountains. While searching for Excalibrium in the deep mines, Kolo began to hear the whispers of Kalimar, an ancient elder entity with the power to warp flesh. The corruption took hold gradually, Kolo grew more erratic, more violent, until he murdered his uncle Targon and was turned to stone by Gorgons alongside Myron.

After being destoned, Kolo sacrificed Daisuke to Kalimar in a blood ritual in the depths of the mines, painting Exme’s face with the interpreter’s blood before vanishing into the darkness. He resurfaced briefly in Hope’s Rest, attempting to recruit Exme and Burnie to Kalimar’s cause and orchestrating an ambush involving Burnie’s estranged bird-son Trayvon Jr.

When Kolo was finally found in the sewers beneath Hope’s Rest, he was barely recognisable, massively mutated with one enormous arm, fungal wings, and a body riddled with Kalimar’s corruption. In the battle that followed, Kolo crushed Delilah Hardstone’s skull, killing Riphard’s wife. Exme stopped time with the Puzzle Die to save Delilah’s twin babies, but Kolo himself was beyond saving. Riphard wrapped his whip around Kolo’s throat and strangled the life from him, shouting the name of his childhood friend Dagenham as he did so.

Kolo’s soul did not pass to Hell. It was claimed by Kalimar, trapped somewhere beyond even Lazarus’s reach. Exme’s last hope was that the return of the gods might free her brother from his eternal prison.

THE CONTINUATION

Four years after the Spire fell, Kolo’s soul remained among tens of thousands trapped inside Kalimar. When the party tracked the elder god to his lair beneath a giant ice sheet in the far north, Exme saw her chance. She rigged Kalimar’s spawn-egg hatcheries with dynamite and detonated them in the final battle. Mrs Ball, a sentient sphere of impossibly dense metal, delivered the killing blow, punching clean through the Elder God of Creation.

But the battle had cost everything. Myron lay dead, stabbed through the chest. Exme, battered and broken, held the Puzzle Die of Ruh’Breks and its single Wish function, the only wish in existence, with a ten-thousand-year cooldown. She could save Kolo or she could save Myron.

She chose both. She wished to give up her own life to restore her brother and heal the gnome she loved. The wish was accepted, and the price was absolute: Exmerah was erased from all reality, never to be resurrected, never to reach any afterlife.

Kolo woke in a constructed body, mechanical and cold, unable to eat or taste. The others called him “Mr Robot”. His twin sister was gone in a way that even the gods could not undo. Beside him he found her last gift: a mechanical bow with a cabled power pack, built with the same inventive genius that had produced STANRI and C.E.D.R.I.C.

Standing on the deck of the airship, Kolo addressed the survivors. “She changed everything she touched,” he said. “This boat, your leg and eye, and you Myron, she changed you. I never loved any of you, not like I did her. But if you are the only parts of her that remain, then you are the only parts I can keep alive.”

Kolo fought on. He joined the party as they tracked west to Jecede, watched Erin die aboard a githyanki Nautiloid, saw Burnie torn apart by the elder brain, and rode the maiden-voyage steam railway to Hope’s Rest with the remnant of the group. He debuted Exme’s mechanical bow in a rooftop fight against Inquisitors on the train, and shot at a telepathic sewer octopod called Badunkadonk beneath Hope’s Rest, nearly undoing Gem’s careful diplomacy with the creature. He joined the heist of the deserted Black Rock bank and descended into the vault to claim the Armoury of Sin, the divine gear the god Sinn wore when he last fought Canalon.

The goblin who had been dead, corrupted, and trapped inside an elder god for four years walked out of that vault carrying a god’s armour, heading to fight another one. Exme would have been proud.



KOLO'S TALE

Following Otor's death, Kolo told the group the story of Grumpy Stanri, a legendary goblin cleric and emancipator who assembled a crack team of Gabrins, the deadly archer Tan'lata, the rage-filled Kri'igo, and the useless Dev'lada with his greasy weasel, on a quest to free goblin-kind. The tale of their voyage across treacherous seas and through the ruins of Thundertree is recorded in Episodes 9b through 9d.

EXMERAH SLIOKZOG



DETAILS

Race: Goblin
Class: Artificer
Age: 8
Status: Erased from existence (ep 97)

BACKGROUND

Exmerah "Exme" Sliokzog was born on her feet two minutes before her brother, Kolo, in the barren wastelands of "the North". Growing up as a Goblin was not easy and the two young siblings spent their days being chased by wild animals, causing mischief, and being enslaved by evil overlords.

Naturally ingenious from birth, Exme took the opportunity to learn all that she could from her captors, rising quickly up through the ranks until she became a full-time workshop assistant. During this period Exme made several inexplicable advances in the field of electromagnetism, culminating in the production of Velterra's first electric gun.

The two goblins were taken out of their death by Lazarus whilst launching an audacious escape attempt from their Northern stronghold.

PERSONALITY AND TRAITS

Exme was always the more softly spoken of the twins, usually happy to follow Kolo's lead and revel in their mischief. Having seen all of their family and friends enslaved at a young age, both Goblins developed a burning passion for emancipation and dreamed of a free world. Whilst Kolo took the stance that emancipation could only be gained by the sharp edge of a blade and that the only good human was a dead one, Exme always recognised that the races could work together towards the brighter future that they both craved.

What set Exme apart from every other member of the group was her inventive genius. She built S.T.A.N.R.I from scrap metal and a leaking human brain, designed C.E.D.R.I.C, the "Collaborative Experimental Destruction and Rapid Immolation Contraption," a sentient electric railgun with "a funny voice that makes me go all trembly", and unlocked dozens of functions within the Puzzle Die of Ruh'Breks that nobody else could fathom. Her rifle worked entirely without gunpowder, which she dismissed as "an inferior method of propulsion", and she brewed a healing salve that temporarily bolstered those who consumed it. She was always keen to talk to other tinkers and scholars, forming quick friendships with Ruh'Breks Sensei, Konrad the robot-maker, Professor Jorge Myron, and Google Von Maccherstein's gnome engineers.

Following her maturity into a goblin woman and the loss of Kolo, Exme became more adult and took up casual smoking, though she still retained a sense of naivety due to her relative lack of world experience. She discovered that dogs are men and cats are women, a finding that single-handedly advanced the field of anthropology in Velterra by decades.

Whilst confident in her abilities and place in the world, Exme was known to act with extreme jealousy in the presence of other women, especially those with any connection to Myron.

RELATIONSHIPS

Exme's main bond has and always will be to her younger twin brother Kolo. Prior to his death the two had never spent more than an hour apart, and the loss led Exme to re-examine her life and discover who she was by herself. Her final note to Burnie when she left the group, "I thought I could have both of you", was addressed as much to Kolo's memory as to anyone living. In the end, when the wish came and she had to choose between Kolo and Myron, she chose both, and paid for it with everything she was.

Myron and Exme have been involved in an ongoing "will they, won't they" relationship,

perhaps best outlined in her self-published novelette "Love Doesn't Have a Height Limit." The relationship survived Masuda, survived petrification, but nearly didn't survive the Hope's Rest sewers. When Myron told her "This is all your fault," it destroyed something between them. Her unsent letters to him during her absence suggested the feelings never died, they just grew more complicated. By the continuation, the two had found their way back far enough to adopt a son together, a teenage tailor called David, and to run the Delilah Hardstone School side by side.

S.T.A.N.R.I was more than a creation, he was Exme's constant companion, evolving from a small leaking robo-cub to a fully operational combat unit to a tiger-form battlesuit. The tiger redesign honoured Toni, and in mecha-form Exme climbed inside STANRI through what can only be described as "his vagina" to become the fearsome "Stanrexme." She was moved to tears upon examining Otor's inner workings, recognising the exquisite craftsmanship of a fellow artificer's creation.

Exme cared deeply about her companions and mourned the loss of each one, keeping memories of their remains and honouring fallen comrades through the naming of her creations.

EXME'S STORY

Starting off as a timid young goblin girl, Exme soon began to find her feet and became one of the most fearsome fighters the world had ever seen. She helped clear the Temple of Unthala, survived the Die Hard heist at the Tower of Imota Kan, where she discovered that Lady Otor was not human but an exquisitely crafted automaton, and served as the group's technical backbone through every campaign that followed.

In Masuda, Exme upgraded STANRI into a mecha-battlesuit that could transform around her, turning the pair into a devastating combat unit. She built C.E.D.R.I.C, the electric railgun that would go on to vaporise Arbiter Khan's head in the final campaign, and mastered the Puzzle Die of Ruh'Breks, unlocking function after function of the ancient artefact that nobody else could begin to understand.

The catastrophe in the Hope's Rest sewers broke Exme in a way that nothing else had. She stopped time with the Puzzle Die to rescue Delilah's twin babies, revived the fallen Myron with the healing shot she had intended for Delilah, and watched helplessly as Riphard strangled her brother. When it was over, she tried to talk Riphard out of it, she told him it would not bring Delilah back, that Kolo was sick, that if he did this they had lost Kolo forever.

"But he had already made his mind up. I think he had made his mind up a long time ago."

Exme left the group carrying Kolo's corpse, leaving Burnie the Puzzle Die with a note: "I thought I could have both of you." During her absence, she founded the "Delilah Hardstone Engineering School for Talented Yung Wimun" and wrote unsent letters to Myron. She rejoined the party at Linderdorf, quieter and harder than before.

It was Exme who unlocked the Puzzle Die's ability to locate the source of the seal, sitting alone in her cabin late at night, rotating the cube as objects in the room disappeared and time slowed around her, until the pulse came and she knew: Seven's Spire. She later plugged the cube into the airship's ghost engine, achieving hyper-speed travel that allowed the party to cross Velterra in days rather than weeks. For the Festival of Light infiltration, she disguised herself as Otor, her actual face, eyebrows adjusted, and covered STANRI in a thin layer of meat and Burnie's hair to create a convincing tiger disguise, crawling inside through STANRI's entry point for travel.

Exme redesigned STANRI as a tiger in honour of Toni, and the gnome engineers of Linderdorf helped her incorporate Excalibur into the build, turning him into "Stanri 2: Electric Baloo."

Inside Seven's Spire, Exme was instrumental at every level, disguising herself as Lillith to bluff past guards, making STANRI invisible through a divine cloak of light refraction, and creating an interplanar pocket dimension to shelter the rescued prisoners. When Arbiter Khan returned with his Inquisitor Ravagers, it was Exme's linear accelerator that vaporised his head, and STANRI's mechanical foot that finished the job. As the party disguised themselves as Inquisitors and prepared to ascend toward the pinnacle, Exme stood ready to fulfil the promise she had carried since Kolo's death, to break the seal, return the gods to the world, and find a way to free her brother's soul from Kalimar's grip.

THE CONTINUATION

Four years after the Spire fell and the gods returned, Exme was a broken drunk. She had poured everything into two obsessions: running the Delilah Hardstone School For Exceptionally Gifted Girls To Excel In Engineering And Emancipation, and finding a way to free Kolo's soul from Kalimar. She and Myron had adopted David, a teenage tailor who made the school uniforms, and on the surface life had moved on. Underneath, Exme was drinking herself to death and spending every waking moment researching the elder entity that held her brother.

When Lazarus regathered the party to deal with the Varg super-soldier threat, Exme went not for the mission but for Kolo. Valkar Varg had made a pact with Kalimar, and where Kalimar was, Kolo's soul was. She carried a vial of the Kalimel goo she hoped could cure her brother, and she read his mouldy old notebook aboard the airship like scripture.

In the Varg lands, Exme befriended Aracia and her spider Zarathrustra among the Adam-ants tribe, froze time to heal the group when slaads nearly killed them, and kept the mammoth eggs from a hunt she participated in with characteristic scientific curiosity. But her focus never wavered. When the party finally reached Kalimar's lair, a temple carved into a giant ice sheet descending through ratman hives, fungal forests, and flesh tunnels to a lava sanctum, Exme went invisible and rigged the elder god's spawn-egg hatcheries with dynamite.

In the battle that followed, she detonated the caverns. Kalimar, the Elder God of Creation, turned his full fury on the party. Riphard, Martin, Erin, and Exme all fell. Burnie was swallowed whole. Myron was stabbed through the chest and thrown dead from Kalimar's shoulder. Mrs Ball delivered her biggest ever bonk, punching clean through the god and killing him. But the cost was already paid. Burnie, sustained only by the power of Synne, dragged the fallen back from the edge, but Myron was beyond revivify. He was critically injured, paralysed, and dying.

The Puzzle Die of Ruh'Breks held one function that had never been used: Wish, with a ten-thousand-year cooldown. The only wish in existence. Exme could save Kolo, whose soul was now free among the tens of thousands that had been trapped inside Kalimar. Or she could save Myron, who lay broken beside her. She could not choose.

She wished for both.

The wish was accepted. Myron lived. Kolo was restored in a constructed body, walking and talking and alive. But because the ask was so extreme, the price was absolute: Exmerah Sliokzog was erased from all reality. Not killed. Not sent to Hell or to the gods. Erased. She could never be resurrected, could never become a god, could never exist in any afterlife on any plane. She was simply gone, as though she had never been, except that the things she had built and the people she had changed remained.

The party discovered she was gone when Kolo woke in his new metal body and Myron opened his eyes. Bronwen, a devil sent by Lazarus, arrived to confirm what had happened. Kolo found Exme's last gift to him: a mechanical bow

with a cabled power pack, left where he would find it. Her school endured, now headed by Professor Stanri, the mecha-bear she had built from scrap and a leaking brain, who had been gifted consciousness by the gods and now stood at the front of a classroom teaching the next generation of gifted girls.

THE RUMOUR OF MRS BALL

After Exme's erasure, her player Jonathan suggested that she may not have been destroyed entirely. Mrs Ball and her kind each contain a universe within themselves, and Mrs Ball's stated purpose is the quiet restoration of broken realities. It is whispered, in circles that have no business whispering such things, that Exme was not erased but moved, placed within the reality inside Mrs Ball, alive in a universe of one. This has never been confirmed. It may be a kindness. It may be the truth. The party never found out.

EXME'S CREATIONS

S.T.A.N.R.I.: From leaking robo-cub to mecha-tiger battlesuit. Named after Grumpy Stanri, the legendary goblin emancipator. Gifted consciousness by the gods after the seal was broken. After Exme's erasure, Stanri took over as headmaster of the Delilah Hardstone School, teaching the next generation in her place.

C.E.D.R.I.C.: "Collaborative Experimental Destruction and Rapid Immolation Contraption." Sentient electric railgun. Improves perception, retargets shots, has a funny voice. Vaporised Arbiter Khan's head.

The Detectomatic: Portable magic detection device. Invaluable for identifying artefacts, traps, and Martin's suspicious magical readings.



Professor Stanri, headmaster of the Delilah Hardstone School



Exmerah with gun



The school itself, robots flying right alongside spells



Exmerah, four years after the Spire



The Delilah Hardstone School For Exceptionally Gifted Girls To Excel In Engineering And Emancipation

RIPHARD OBSIDIAN HARDSTONE



DETAILS

Race: Dwarf
Class: Pastor
Age: 58
Status: Departed (ep 100, investigating with the Jennies)

BACKGROUND

A high-class dwarf of the Tom'ardy Mountains, Riphard was the son of a pastor, raised mostly in isolation and knowing little of the outside world beyond the local mountains and his religion. A pastor himself by the time of the campaign, he was killed by a member of the Inquisition before being resurrected by Lazarus and recruited into the mission to break the seal of the Seven. His family, the Hardstones (or Hardthrusts), are an old dwarven dynasty from the Tom'ardy Mountains, though Riphard had long since left home to pursue his pastoral calling.

Before his death, Riphard was a man of the Church, a true believer who preached the word of the Seven. His encounter with Hell and subsequent resurrection shattered his faith and set him on a path of righteous vengeance against the very institution he once served.

PERSONALITY AND TRAITS

Riphard is a hard-drinking, gun-toting dwarf with a talent for entrepreneurship and a flair for the dramatic. Known for his thunderous whip attacks, his beloved firearms, and his tendency to launch into inspired sermons at the most

inappropriate moments, Riphard is simultaneously the group's moral compass and its loosest cannon.

Despite his gruff exterior, Riphard has shown genuine tenderness, his laying of hands on the fallen Otoria lasted "a little too long", and his tears upon learning he could train with the masters at the Sanctuary of Novetta were "genuinely touching". He is fiercely protective of his companions, even if he would never admit it.

Riphard is also a shrewd businessman. He founded the first bank in Velterra, Northern Rock, out of an old man's house in Riverfall, and later established the Guild of Banking in Hope's Rest. His sales pitch for "Safe Storage for a Dangerous World" convinced even the sceptical Guild of Coin to invest.

RELATIONSHIPS

Riphard married Delilah Hardstone (née of the Jennies), a former courtesan turned crack shot and Sky Captain of Tomorrow. The two had twin children, Bilbo and Dildo, whose births were attended by Anthony Tigerius and a squad of midwives from the Guild of Midwifery that Riphard had been bankrolling for exactly this purpose. A faint golden light shone in the babies' eyes, hinting at a divine inheritance.

His relationship with the goblins was always complicated. An admitted anti-goblin racist early on, Riphard gradually developed a grudging respect for the twins, particularly Exme's engineering genius and Kolo's tactical cunning, though he and Kolo clashed frequently over business ethics, lemon theft, and the proper treatment of prisoners. This grudging respect did not survive Kolo's corruption.

Riphard's childhood best friend Dagenham was found working as a blacksmith among the Delvers in the Tom'ardy mines. The two rekindled their friendship immediately, only for Dagenham to die in a methane explosion shortly after, a loss that hit Riphard hard enough for him to request Lazarus keep Dagenham's soul waiting in limbo for as long as possible.

Riphard earned the respect of Arbiter Kiros, who recognised his potential and recommended him for advanced training. He also formed an unlikely bond with Pilcheur, the two sharing quiet moments of mutual understanding between bouts of mutual suspicion. His competitive ping pong matches with Myron during the Masuda campaign were among the few moments of genuine camaraderie the dwarf allowed himself.

RIPHARD'S STORY

Riphard's journey took him from resurrection in Lazarus's office to becoming one of the most

influential figures in Velterra. He helped clear the Temple of Unthala, survived the Die Hard heist at the Tower of Imota Kan, founded a banking empire, crossed the Great Expanse, and fought alongside his companions through the jungles of South Africa and the civil war of Masuda.

In Masuda, Riphard acquired the legendary Hammer of the Gods from the Golden Hall, an ancient weapon that turned out to be a gun firing beams of pure iridescent light. His return to the Tom'ardy Mountains revealed the ugly truth of dwarven society: a classist, slave-dependent economy built on the backs of "Delvers", miners sent on one-way trips into the deep. His own uncle, Targon Hardthrust, had become one of them.

In the deep mines beneath Tom'ardy, the group searched for Excalibur, the only metal capable of harming the Church's Inquisitors. Riphard reunited with his uncle Targon, who had been searching for the ancient Hardstone family vault, only to watch helplessly as the feral Kolo murdered the old dwarf before his eyes. Riphard and Myron were both turned to stone by Gorgons in the vault, only to be destoned later by Delilah and the group's potions.

The discovery of Excalibur and the return to Hope's Rest brought both joy and devastation. Delilah gave birth to the twins, and for a brief moment things seemed bright. But Kolo resurfaced, monstrously mutated by Kalimar's corruption, and in a savage attack in the sewers beneath Hope's Rest, he crushed Delilah's skull. In response, Riphard wrapped his whip around Kolo's throat and strangled the life from him, shouting the name "Dagenham" as he pulled it tight.

The loss of Delilah broke something fundamental in Riphard. By the time the group reached Tom'ardy again to rally allies, he had descended into delusion, keeping a mannequin as a replacement wife and two sacks of rotten pork that he insisted were his children. Despite this madness, Riphard remained a devastating combatant, killing an Inquisitor with the Excalibur pickaxe and felling the Aspect of the Storm during the expedition to Bright Bart Forge in the Varg lands.

As the campaign reached its climax, Riphard stood with his companions at the Battle of Hope's Rest and the assault on Seven's Spire, driven not by faith or profit but by the simple dwarven stubbornness that had carried him from a polished stone room in Hell to the pinnacle of the Church's power.

THE CONTINUATION

Four years after the Spire, Riphard had become a bored mega-banker. He ran the Black Rock, a towering institution in Hope's Rest with vaults of gold, silver, and bronze, and raised his twins Bilbo and Dildo in something approaching respectable domesticity. The mannequin wife and the rotten pork children were, mercifully, behind him.

When Lazarus regathered the party to deal with the Varg, Riphard went along with the weary competence of a man who had done this before and would rather be counting money. In the Varg lands, he killed a boreworm that had devoured the half-giant Eric whole, and witnessed the giant chieftain Magrat eat a man in a single bite, a sight only he saw and that nobody believed. During the assault on the lich Valklondar's lair, Riphard decapitated the "Pope of Skeleton Giants" and inherited the title, a distinction he wore with characteristic dwarven gravity.

Riphard survived Kalimar. He fell in the lava sanctum alongside the others and was dragged back by Burnie and the power of Synne. He watched Exme erase herself to save Kolo and Myron, and he lived with the knowledge that the goblin he had strangled to death four years ago was now walking again in a metal body, returned by the sacrifice of the goblin's twin sister.

When the party reached Jecede, Riphard slipped away. He left a note saying he was investigating something with the Jennies, the organisation his dead wife had belonged to. Whether he was chasing a lead, running from the fight, or simply deciding that enough was enough, nobody knew. The dancers at the Midnight Pearl cabaret in Jecede prayed to "Lady Delilah," and Riphard had overheard them. Perhaps that was reason enough to go looking.

He was not there for the Nautiloid. He was not there when Burnie died, or when the airship was destroyed, or when the remnant of the group rode a train to Hope's Rest to heist his own bank. The vault beneath the Black Rock held the Armoury of Sin, and the party cracked it open with the code 51624 while its owner was somewhere else entirely, doing something he evidently considered more important.

NORTHERN ROCK PLC

Riphard's banking empire began in Derek Bobacious's house in Riverfall with the slogan "Safe Storage for a Dangerous World". By the time the group returned to Hope's Rest after the Masuda campaign, Northern Rock had expanded into multiple branches, generated enormous profits, and attracted investment from the Guild of Coin itself. Riphard briefly considered diversifying into restaurants ("Hope's Chest", staffed by buxom women) and acquired a schnitzel business in Linderdorf, though neither venture matched the success of the original bank.



Riphard, ready to paint

PILCHEUR GAMONT



DETAILS

Race: Human
Class: Book Burner
Age: 46
Status: Deceased

BACKGROUND

Pilcheur “Pilch” Gamont was a Book Burner, a member of the Church’s now-defunct order tasked with hunting down and destroying heretical texts. A cloaked man dashing over rooftops with a half-burnt tome under one arm, Pilch was killed by mercenaries during a chase across the rooftops of Hope’s Rest before being resurrected by Lazarus.

In life, Pilch was already a conflicted figure. He possessed a deep knowledge of the Church’s inner workings, its communication channels, and its dark secrets. It was later revealed that Pilch had been secretly selling books he was supposed to burn, a betrayal that contributed to the Church’s purge of the entire Book Burner organisation.

PERSONALITY AND TRAITS

Pilch was the group’s most polarising member. Cowardly in battle yet occasionally brilliant in negotiation, he had a talent for making terrible situations worse and then somehow surviving the fallout. His relationship with the supernatural was uniquely troubled, possessed by dark forces early in the campaign, he manifested shadow powers including clouds of magical darkness, a spectral wolf companion (Howlov), and the sentient two-handed shadow sword Black Sabbath. After Pilch’s death, Black Sabbath was reforged into the katana Iron Maiden, the very blade that had felled Otoria.

Known to the goblins as “Fishy”, “Fishwank”, or “Pilchard”, he was the frequent target of Kolo’s pickpocketing and Exme’s withering contempt. Despite this, moments of genuine connection emerged, Pilch once saved Kolo’s life in battle, prompting Kolo to note “I never knew he cared”.

His various aliases included Papa Lazarizz, and he had a tendency to adopt elaborate (and unconvincing) disguises involving blackface and Jamaican accents. He was rarely seen without a bandaged left arm that seemed to itch, he was often seen rubbing it, concealing the Mark of Synne beneath. More troubling were the powers that came with his corruption: he was seen to steal vitality from those he slew, on one occasion sucking the life force out of a defenceless captive TikiTuck warrior, and his shadow powers once gave him a supernatural disease that required a Pastor to purge.

RELATIONSHIPS

Pilch’s relationship with the group was defined by mutual distrust tempered by grudging necessity. Otoria once pinned him against a wall with her greatsword after he murdered a prisoner, warning him: “You will not do that again”. Kolo stole from him relentlessly. Riphard alternated between alliance and attempted drowning.

His familiar, Quoth the Raven, was one of the group’s most useful assets despite Kolo’s repeated attempts to kill it. After Pilch’s death, Quoth was saved from Oblivion by Mark O’Synne and transformed into a white raven. Among Pilch’s more conventional arsenal was a crossbow named Martha, Martha’s old crossbow, from the Jennies. He flirted shamelessly with Mae Harkwood, earned the respect of Geraldine, and was on genuinely friendly terms with Delilah. Pilch also maintained connections to his former Book Burner colleagues, including Lillian (a half-elf who “actually liked fishy”) and the gnome Zippy.

Pilch had a complicated connection to the god Synne, bearing the Mark of Synne on his body, a

divine brand that granted him dark powers but at a terrible cost.

PILCH'S STORY

From his resurrection onward, Pilch struggled to control the dark powers growing within him. His possession worsened in Riverfall, where the group had to exorcise him using a combination of Riphard's pastoral chanting, Kolo's Killepitsch liquor, and copious vomiting. The exorcism left him with his shadow sword and a tenuous grip on his darker nature.

Pilch served as the group's reluctant expert on Church operations, helping them establish themselves in Hope's Rest by leveraging his knowledge of guild politics and mercenary contracts. He helped secure the old Book Burners headquarters as the Gary Guild's base of operations.

Pilch met his end during the sea voyage to the jungle continent, killed by a Chuul, a clawed horror of the deep. His death left the group without their most knowledgeable member on Church matters, and, despite everything, genuinely mourned by those who had spent so long mocking him. Upon Pilch's death, the Mark of Synne he bore manifested in an unexpected way: the golden-haired avatar Mark O'Synne emerged from Gary's chest on the jungle continent, an echo of the god Pilch had unwittingly carried.

The full truth of Pilcheur's past was only revealed much later, when Mark O'Synne constructed a magical VR storm machine on the airship that allowed the group to inhabit the bodies of Book Burner recruits decades in the past. Through these flashback episodes, the party discovered that Pilch's secret book-selling operation had been exposed, and it was this betrayal that prompted the Church to order the purge of the entire Book Burner order, killing Burnie's colleagues, Trayvon, Martha, and countless others. The man who spent his life running from mercenaries on rooftops had, it turned out, been running from the consequences of his own actions.



Pilch (10% more emo)



Howlov, the shadow wolf

CO-DENAMES AS FOLLOWS...

SH - SHADOW HUNTER - YOURS TRULY
RP - RAPTEVULSITY P-SSSED - THE DRAMMEN DWARF
JR - JUTED B-7-AL - THE FUGEN LADY
SR - SHUFFY B-6-UE - THE TRIEVING GUBLIN
JM - J-7-FLA MECHANIC - THE INVENTIVE GUBLIN

SO WE'RE IN A CAVE, AND JUST SLAUGHTERED A SMALL NUMBER OF SMALL FLUX TO WHOM WE RUPE TO ALLY. GREAT.

SR HAS INITIATED A PLAN TO TAKE OVER THE SMALL FEEFS BY KILLING RAZZLE. SH SAYS WE SHOULD TRY AND DISCREDIT THE SMALL FLUX'S LEADER (RAZZLE) - SEEMS THAT THE GUBLINS AND DWARF ARE GOING TO GO IN AND TRY TO CONVINCE EVERYONE ELSE THAT HE'S GONE RAZZLE AND ON T PART OF THE ORGANISATION ANYMORE.

I'm loath to split the party, but the tiny bigots (small-ots?) probably won't like me or JR walking in - maybe we can be guards or sympathisers? Anyway, I do the honorable thing of burning the bodies (and taking 5 ears), and then forging a document for RP - "Razzle is accused of collusion against the SRA with his Ojecal Cherb Business."

We stop outside, and finalise the plan - is as above, but the goblins will go in shortly afterwards to make it seem they were (recently) ambushed. RP Successfully enters the camp, thanks to the forged letter. The goblins sneak in after. RP manages to get found as an imposter, despite the letter. He did not know the secret Nichols bandsbake.

A fight breaks out between RP and 3 members of the SRA - but he's quickly subdued. Everyone decides to scapegoat RP as a church-workeet still to discredit Razzle. Goblins sneak in.

SRA becomes SRM - suddenly, because RP Goblins come in, pretending to be injured - learnt huge credence by my amazing disguising. Two of the SRA fall for it.

RP gets blown up. Probably, Razzle likes bombs. "No dwarfy... I expect you to die!" RP starts whipping people. He gets knocked out.

Team gobble and 2 of the SRA run in. One gets blown up, the rest like Razzle more for this. JR is very noisy, it messes up our stealthiness. SH becomes a rock. I climb other rocks - no longer a rock. I get RP back up by punching him, and then dance like my life depends on it (which it did).

RP is then useful by disarming Razzle. Razzle Shanks me, but the shadows protect. The JM Blows off Razzles head. SH, RP and JR (who had been doing pull-ups the whole time) leave.

The goblins appoint "Buttons" as the new leader of (this faction) of the SRA. There's maybe 4 SRA left. They also loot. Signet ring (with stampy well) 10 rocks 10gp

Papers - Bits of communication, Old Plans, Promotional Material, rambling letters, I'm not happy about this. We rest up. Xplo and Otario have a heart to heart.

We all go to see Mae. JR takes point in the conversation. It's interesting. Mae and Dilliah plan with us to go kill fancy pants. I'm on a horse. Mae gives us 3 people to go take on Fancy Pants, Diago. One is an Battle-axe barbarian type, others a Crescentbow-marksmen, as is Dilliah. JR and JM also get fancy "duty ho" boots.

On the way (to Diago) we encounter a man that tells us about the giant boar. Dilliah flirts with RP for some reason. JR, with her Mechanium Bow, JM and SR decide to attack at ranged, and take out the boar slowly.

IN THE FOREST, WE GET ATTACKED BY DRYPHEADS. RP GETS RIPPED HARD. JR FLAILS ME AND THE GUBLINS KILL NEARLY EVERYTHING. THE CR-SSHWW WHORE (MARTHA) DIES. SAVE RP. GET MARTHA'S XGLOW.

WAIT, SHIT... BETTER BURN THESE PAGES - SAFER THAN LEAVING A PAPER TRAIL...

Recovered from the fire, a page of Pilch's writings

OTORIA HEARTHRUST



DETAILS

Race: Robot
Class: Fighter
Age: 80
Status: Deceased

BACKGROUND

Lady Otoria Hearthrust arrived on the continent of Velterra from the distant land of Nanduan, where her family, the Hearthrust Dynasty, were a large, wealthy, and prominent noble house. By Hearthrust tradition, the eldest child of each generation must be sent out into the world before coming of age, so that the family remain current, and do not stagnate, and to experience life beyond their privilege. As a betrothed daughter, Otoria's face was covered, "to save the world the pain of seeing, but not being able to attain, such beauty".

She was killed in a harbour tavern in Port Averdale, choosing honour over surrender when outnumbered by scores of thugs, before being resurrected by Lazarus.

What neither Otoria nor the group initially knew was that she was not human at all, but a dwarven-crafted automaton, a robot with a soul, built with such exquisite craftsmanship that even Exme was moved to tears upon examining her inner workings.

PERSONALITY AND TRAITS

Otoria was the group's fiercest warrior and most principled member. She wielded a greatsword with devastating skill and fought with a code of

honour that set her apart from her more morally flexible companions. She had zero tolerance for cruelty, when Pilch murdered a surrendered Tikituk prisoner, she pinned him against the wall and delivered a chilling warning.

She was also unexpectedly nurturing, taking charge of the group's direction in early adventures and forming bonds across unlikely divides. Her diplomatic skills were considerable, though her attempts at intimidation sometimes fell flat, she once failed to cut through a wooden pillar after delivering a dramatic speech to a crowd.

Otoria had a notable tendency to die in combat with alarming regularity, earning the epithet "dies hard".

RELATIONSHIPS

Otoria formed her closest bond with Kolo, the two sharing a heart-to-heart that transcended the usual group dynamics. She had a complex relationship with Riphard, whose habit of "laying hands on her for a little too long" when healing her became a running theme.

In Nanduan, Otoria had been betrothed to an unnamed shipping magnate. It was later revealed that she had killed the Emperor of Masuda and founded an emancipation movement for the Nanduan robot ladies, the Hearthrust Society, before fleeing to Velterra.

OTORIA'S STORY

Otoria fought alongside the group from the Temple of Unthala through the Tower of Imota Kan, where she met her end at the blade of the lethal Lark, a singing swordswoman who beheaded her with a katana. Her death was the group's first real loss, and it hit hard.

Exme's examination revealed Otoria's true nature as an automaton, and the group gave her a proper send-off around a campfire, keeping her mechanical remains in a special shrine. Kolo began to tell a special story in her memory.

Otoria's legacy extended far beyond her death. In Nanduan, the Hearthrust Society, robot ladies she had inspired and freed, continued her emancipation movement, eventually allying with the party during the Masuda campaign. Lady Hirota Hearthrust personally rescued the group from certain death by swooping in on a mechanical eagle, and the Society's female ninja riders on mechanical eagles joined the final assault on Seven's Spire, fighting alongside the alliance army to break the Church's power.

*In loving memory of Lady Otoria Hearthrust.
2017-2017.*



*Lady Otoría's original character art, February
2017*

GARY



DETAILS

Race: Stone Man
Class: Police
Age: 8,000,000
Status: Sleeping

BACKGROUND

Gary was an ancient stone elemental, a living statue who had stood motionless for millennia before being awakened by the party during their quest for the Gulan bush. After consuming a magical biscuit, Gary discovered the joy of eating, breathing, and existing, and immediately became one of the group's most beloved and formidable companions.

Gary's origins stretch back to the dawn of the world. Long before the Sundering, the Ancients built a standing stone, to protect. He recalled stories of figures like Jason Derulo, "who was sat on by a thing and killed thousands of years ago", though his knowledge of The Ancients was limited, "he's just a rock".

PERSONALITY AND TRAITS

Gary was the group's moral heart. A pacifist by nature, he fought only when necessary and always sought to talk before striking. His philosophy was simple and profound, he believed in the goodness of all creatures and the power of second chances. He once convinced a group of enemies to rethink their lives and "settle down, get a job, contribute productively to society".

In combat, Gary wielded a magical flowering branch that could emit rainbows and glitter, put

enemies to sleep, and deliver devastating "glitter bonks". He joined the Hope's Rest police force as Officer Djago, earning a double-sized truncheon and a half-orc partner. He drew three-panel comics featuring the popular cat "Triplicate" instead of signatures.

Gary developed several unexpected habits during his time with the group: an oxygen addiction (courtesy of Pilch), a brief chemical dependency on Gabrin Kokaine, and a passion for eating that bordered on the problematic, he once ate all the bake sale pies overnight.

RELATIONSHIPS

Gary cared deeply for every member of the group, often healing fallen enemies and allies alike. His bond with Kolo was particularly strong, the two shared philosophical conversations about business, life, and the nature of goodness, even if Kolo kept trying to get him addicted to various substances.

Delilah attempted to flirt with Gary on multiple occasions, to no avail. Gary's expressionless stone visage made it difficult to read his emotions, but those who knew him could see the depth of feeling behind those ancient eyes.

GARY'S STORY

Gary's defining moment came during the battle at the Tikituk Temple in the jungles of South Africa. Facing overwhelming odds, Gary sacrificed himself to protect Kolo, standing tall and proud as a horde of TikkiTucks hacked him down piece by piece, transforming into a tree in his final moments. Lazarus later confirmed that Gary would regenerate, but it would take several hundred years.

The party honoured Gary by naming their newly acquired airship after him, and by founding the Gary Guild, "Garys Against Religion, Yo", in Hope's Rest. The guild's logo, drawn by Gary himself before his death, became a universal hit. His legacy lived on in everything the group built: the guild, the airship, and the simple philosophy that people should be kind to each other. In the group's absence, the Gary Guild was taken over by Garbigail, a woman who had survived poisoning, beaten chicken disease, and spoken to Gary in a vision, transforming it into a pseudo-religious peace movement. When the time came for the final battle against the Church, the Garys answered the call, suffering heavy casualties at the Battle of Hope's Rest in service of the ideals their founder had lived and died for.

GARY'S PHILOSOPHY

"EATING IS GOOD!", Gary, upon trying his first biscuit.

"It is impossible to have a cake and also eat a cake.",
Gary, on the nature of the universe.

"When I set my mind on a perp, there's nothing that's
gonna get in my way... except CORN!", Officer Djago, lost
in a cornfield.



*Jago, you know, just a guy about town, who does
stuff*



MARK O'SYNNE



DETAILS

Race: God
Class: Luck Man
Age: 800,000
Status: Active (unfortunately)

BACKGROUND

Mark O'Synne is a manifest avatar of divine power, a fragment of the god Synne given form. Trapped in a book for what seemed like an eternity, he was awoken by Pilcheur Gamont, and in his weakened state attached himself to Pilch as a tattoo, the "Mark of Synne" on his forearm. He first appeared in person as a golden-haired, small figure who emerged from Gary's chest after the party arrived on the jungle continent.

Mark claims to be working to prevent the "Sundering", a catastrophic divine collapse that threatens the world. He was once far more powerful, but divine power has waned over the centuries since the Church sealed the world from the gods.

PERSONALITY AND TRAITS

Mark is, by universal agreement of the party, a dickhead. Meddlesome, condescending, and possessed of an infuriating tendency to appear at the worst possible moments with cryptic advice nobody asked for, Mark nonetheless provides genuinely useful luck-bending abilities that have saved the group on multiple occasions.

He can create multiple copies of himself, Lark, Jark, Sark, and Shark, each distinguished by different colours, though the practical benefit of this ability remains debatable. He is also rather partial to trebuchet-enabled flight.

RELATIONSHIPS

Mark was initially bound to Pilch, whom he described as "the human I hated the least". After Pilch's death, he transferred to Gary, who acted as a father to help him through the hard times, to the point that the party records describe Mark as "possibly the son of Gary (Peace be Upon Him)". For a time the monkey Vu Dong served as Mark's champion; unsatisfied, Mark orchestrated a bizarre scenario to trade in "that filthy monkey, with his stinky arm" for the more reliable Burnie Cinders. He thus became trapped within Burnie's arm, where he spent much of his time trying to prevent the party from making catastrophically dangerous decisions, with limited success.

His relationship with Meredith, Lazarus's elephant butler, began as that of a jilted love interest, she stood him up on prom night, but the two were eventually reconciled.

The group's feelings towards Mark are best summarised by his character sheet notes: Background, "Fucking Mark". Personality, "Dickhead".

MARK'S STORY

Mark's journey has been one of diminishing power and increasing desperation. As a fragment of Synne, he represents the last active connection between the mortal world and the divine. His time in Hell's management training programme revealed a more sympathetic side, using his luck-bending abilities to help others rather than himself.

Mark's most significant contribution was the construction of a magical VR storm machine aboard the airship, which allowed the party to inhabit the bodies of Book Burner recruits decades in the past. These flashback episodes revealed the true history of the Book Burner purge and Pilch's role in it, while also introducing Burnie to the group when the time-travel process accidentally erased Vu Dong from the timeline.

Despite being universally disliked by the party, Mark's powers and knowledge have proven indispensable in the quest to break the seal and return the gods to the world. He has a long and complicated history with Meredith, Lazarus's elephant butler, who once stood him up on prom night.

RADBURNY “BURNIE” CINDERS



DETAILS

Race: Human (Dwarf by adoption)
Class: Book Burner
Age: 60
Status: Dead (ep 103)

BACKGROUND

Radburny “Burnie” Cinders is a human raised by dwarven parents on a farm, who went on to become a Book Burner, one of the Church’s agents tasked with hunting down and destroying heretical texts. Unlike many of his colleagues, Burnie survived the great Book Burner purges that destroyed the organisation, though the experience left deep scars.

What few realised was that Burnie had been the *de facto* leader of the Book Burners, a position he inherited in his teens after the previous leader was killed off in an earlier purge. He rebuilt the organisation from the ashes, spending his career carefully balancing undermining the Church while keeping them happy, and trading in secrets that earned him respect among the movers and shakers of Hope’s Rest. Pilch and Lillian were two of his favoured

recruits, having risen through the ranks under his leadership. He was romantically involved with fellow Book Burner Martha Mayfire, and her death in the purge shocked him to his core.

After the purge, Burnie was captured by Arbiter Killjoy and hung by the Church in the centre of Hope’s Rest as a warning to all others. He faked his death, how, exactly, he has never satisfactorily explained, and his colourful subsequent career included a stint at the University of Assassins, where he rose to a teaching position. His personal life was equally eventful, he fathered a child with Trayvon, a Tengu Book Burner colleague, producing a “grossly disfigured” half-human, half-Tengu son who grew up harbouring a deep hatred for his absent father. The two eventually reconciled after the son attempted to kill Burnie, leading to “a beautiful reconciliation” where father and son “quickly became best friends, making up for lost time”.

PERSONALITY AND TRAITS

Burnie is a grouchy old man who is actually quite friendly underneath. He has a talent for getting into trouble and an even greater talent for somehow surviving it. His combat style is eclectic and unpredictable, wielding his sword Wasabi, a stone dagger capable of softening and reshaping stone on contact, and an assortment of hooks, grapples, and improvised weapons.

He has an unfortunate tendency to attract possession, Mark O’Synne became trapped in his arm, trying to control his actions and prevent dangerous decisions. Burnie’s response to having a god lodged in his forearm was characteristically unfazed. His missing eye was replaced with IRIS, a jive-talking AI system capable of shooting lasers and providing tactical targeting data.

In a fight Burnie is a Battlemastermind, a defensive sword-and-board tactician who cultivates being underestimated, analysing enemies to their detriment and his allies’ benefit, and hitting remarkably hard provided his target is looking the other way.

Burnie retains a deep and primal connection to his Book Burner roots. When surrounded by forbidden texts, he is occasionally overcome by episodes of book-burning mania, entering a trance-like state of righteous destruction.

AUGMENTS AND ARSENAL

After being hit with a pillar of fire, Burnie lost his left arm, right leg and left eye. Exme rebuilt him, by the end of the campaign he was, in his own estimation, more machine than man:

- **Electric Circuitry:** full-body wiring that

serves as a platform for his other augments and grants minor resistance to lightning.

- **Shock Hook:** a left-arm replacement salvaged from a pair of gloves made from a lightning beast. Delivers staggering shock damage, and can also stimulate healing, cauterise wounds and stabilise the dying.
- **Darkvision Eye:** sees in the dark, but is semi-blinded in daylight; hence the eyepatch.
- **Powered Pegleg:** a sprung right leg housing a motion-driven generator and battery. He needs to run about a hundred feet to fully charge the hook.

His arsenal was equally eccentric: **Dermal Armor**, a skin-tight suit equivalent to half-plate worn under his clothing, originally made for a rich noble; the **Multibow**, a pump-action rotating-chamber Church crossbow of near-ancient, pre-gunpowder design; and the **Cover-Shield**, a heater shield that stabs into the ground and extends mechanical legs to create five feet of half-cover, redeployable at a moment's notice.

RELATIONSHIPS

Burnie's son, originally called Trayvon Jr, later renamed Buck McCraw, was raised by the assassin Bones after Burnie abandoned him. Half-human, half-Tengu, and hideously disfigured, Buck trained at the Guild of Assassins and initially tried to kill Burnie before the two reconciled over a shared understanding of loss. Buck went on to introduce Kevin, a final-year PhD student from the University of Assassins, as Burnie's mentee, a relationship characterised by its "unhealthily abusive" dynamic.

Burnie's adoptive dwarven parents Gerald and his wife still live on their farm outside Hope's Rest, and eventually joined the airship crew as babysitters for Riphard's orphaned twins.

Within the party, Burnie formed a close bond with Kolo, Exme entrusted the Puzzle Die to Burnie after her departure, with a note reading "I thought I could have both of you". Martin the construct butler became most attached to Burnie of all the party members, and Burnie's gruff mentorship of Kevin echoed the paternal instincts he had failed to exercise with his own son.

BURNIE'S STORY

Burnie joined the group after the departure of earlier companions, bringing his Book Burner expertise and grizzled determination to the cause. His knowledge of the Church's inner workings and his connections to the remnants of the Book Burner network proved invaluable as

the party navigated the political complexities of Hope's Rest and beyond.

During the expedition to the ancient dwarven mines, Burnie fought through giant spiders, cloaklers, and a horrifying four-armed abomination in the depths, nearly dying when crushed in the creature's claw before being saved by Anthony Tigerius's berserker rage.

When Kolo's corruption culminated in the devastating attack in Hope's Rest's sewers, it was Burnie who sealed the Kalimar summoning pit with his stone dagger, cutting off the source of the elder entity's power. In the aftermath, Burnie became the reluctant custodian of Exme's Puzzle Die and the emotional anchor for the remaining group as they struggled to process their losses.

Burnie led the group to Linderdorf in search of blacksmiths to forge Excalibur weapons, and into the Varg wilderness to rescue the missing gnome inventors. He took Kevin under his wing, and his elderly parents joined the airship to care for Riphard's now-motherless twins.

During the assault on Seven's Spire, Burnie's Book Burner instincts fully took over. Upon reaching the tower's library levels, he entered a trance of righteous destruction, setting fire to everything in sight and personally killing a sherry-drinking cleric with gleeful abandon. His stone dagger proved invaluable once again, sealing doorways behind the group as they fought their way upward toward the pinnacle and the Great Stone.

THE CONTINUATION

Four years after the Spire, Burnie had gone half-mad aboard the airship. He had founded the Fishy Library, a public institution with a printing press that served as his redemption for a lifetime of burning books, but the years of solitude and grief had worn him thin. He drank ghost-engine juice, carved statues of his absent friends in their empty cabins, and let Captain Stick keep the ship from crashing while he swayed at the wheel.

When Lazarus regathered the party, Burnie went willingly. In the Varg, he was gored badly by cave mammoths during a hunt, flattened by slaad fireballs, and knocked around by every manner of creature the frozen north could throw at him. He endured it all with the same grouchy, indestructible stubbornness he had always possessed.

In Kalimar's lava sanctum, the elder god swallowed Burnie whole. He should have died inside the creature's body, but the Mark of Synne on his arm blazed with divine power, sustaining him while he dragged the other fallen party members back from death. When Mrs Ball

killed Kalimar and Exme used the Wish to save Kolo and Myron at the cost of her own existence, it was Burnie who tried to make sense of it for the survivors.

Standing drunk at the wheel of the airship, vomit in his beard and gin-in-tins rolling across the deck, Burnie delivered the speech that defined who he had become. "Exme's not gone," he said, the Mark of Synne glowing beneath his sleeve, "because we're all here. Her choices and decisions are part of history. She might not be with us physically, but she's always with us because she helped make us, and she's fundamentally changed the world in more ways than any of us can possibly imagine. Her ripples are a tidal wave in a placid sea of mediocrity. She is not erased and never will be, not without destroying everything that came before and after."

The old man who had once burned books for a living had become, against all odds, the group's philosopher.

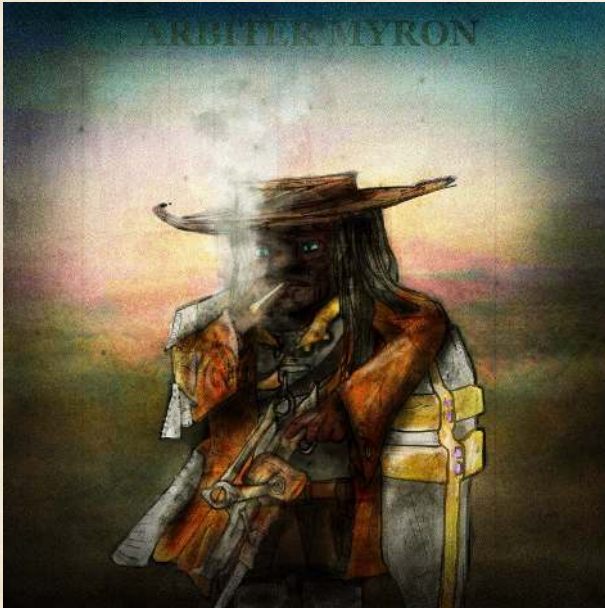
It did not last. When a githyanki Nautiloid attacked Jecede, the party boarded it. They fought through mind flayers and gith warriors, lost Erin to an Ulitharid that ate her brain, and pressed deeper into the living ship. At its heart they found the elder brain, controlled by Canalon, who offered them servitude in exchange for destroying all gods.

Burnie charged it alone.

He was torn limb from limb. The dying elder brain set the Nautiloid plummeting toward Jecede, and David and Captain Stick flew the airship Gary into it to turn it aside, destroying both ships. Burnie's head was recovered. It was cremated on a pyre alongside Erin, and a farewell letter was delivered to his son Buck McCraw, who joined the party in his father's place.

Myron, who had once pelted Burnie with bottles and plotted to kill him, took up the mantle of leadership that the old Book Burner had carried since Exme's departure. "No more," was all Myron said.

SMAUD MYRON



DETAILS

Race: Gnome
Class: Arbiter
Age: 80
Status: Active

BACKGROUND

Smaud Myron (real first name: Smord, which he does not advertise) is a gnome Arbiter, one of the Church's elite warrior-enforcers, trained in both martial combat and divine justice. Older and more experienced than most of his companions, Myron carries the weight of a complicated past. Decades ago, he participated in the purge of the Book Burners, an act that placed him at odds with the very people he would later fight alongside.

His father, Professor Jorge Myron, is a gnome tinker with a Cockney accent who teaches at Linderdorf University. His mother left the family when Myron was young, joining a cult that was subsequently destroyed by the Church, an irony not lost on Myron, who enforced the Church's will for decades. Jorge later remarried Holly Dew Thistlebloom, a halfling businesswoman whose own father was an ex-Book Burner killed in the purge that Myron helped carry out.

THE FULL NAME OF ARBITER MYRON

For the record, as it appears in the Church's own rolls:
*Arbiter Smord Dewiel Nerinabus Bashmash Liniar Vort
Chreask Nanglewangler Queplat Baxark Gotwottle Jerkwash
Eraterium Hoophazard Zeepdrap Boochadraz Loomerta
Gripmanners Plustmatter Amonguvvers Jerranora Kurt Witsh
Zwerve Ackanaminorious Midfashion Taminderra Istandanna
Nobstand Orstax Shroot-a-loot Lemon Prikyooliar Fantasion
Arthassio Horp Braitangle Waller Jorj Myron.*

Myron joined the party after a dramatic entrance involving a hot air balloon crash near the Tower of Ruh'Breks, bringing with him a level of tactical competence and martial skill that the group sorely needed.

PERSONALITY AND TRAITS

Myron is serious, disciplined, and exceptionally skilled in combat. He wields a gun with bayonet, a combination weapon that allows him to fight at both range and in close quarters with devastating efficiency. In battle, he is described as "awesome" with alarming frequency, sliding underneath enemies, slashing their underbellies, and generally being the most competent fighter the group has ever seen.

Outside of combat, Myron has a softer side. He purchases personalised robes for the entire party, makes beef jerky as a comfort food, and bought a travel ping pong table that provided "the happiest moment" of Exme's life when she turned out to be a natural. He expresses doubt about magical solutions (such as teleportation circles) but follows through with quiet professionalism.

RELATIONSHIPS

Myron and Exme have been involved in an ongoing "will they, won't they" relationship that Exme herself documented in a self-published novelette entitled "Love Doesn't Have a Height Limit". Their connection deepened over the course of the Masuda campaign, with Myron caring deeply about Exme's safety and Exme becoming "extremely jealous" in the presence of other women near Myron. That connection shattered after Kolo's rampage in the Hope's Rest sewers. Myron charged in first to fight the mutated Kolo, took an arrow barrage doing so, and went down hard. When Exme revived him, using the healing shot she had intended for Delilah, he looked at her with an expression she described as "such an intense mixture of rage and disappointment" and told her, coldly, "This is all your fault." The words destroyed her. She left the group shortly afterwards, and when she finally rejoined weeks later in Linderdorf, the two had to slowly rebuild their trust through the shared purpose of the final campaign. By the assault on Seven's Spire, Exme's unsent letters

to Myron suggested the feelings had not died, only grown more complicated.

Myron developed a deep mutual respect with Riphard, the two bonding over their shared commitment to getting the job done and a shared fury after Delilah's murder. In the aftermath, Myron carried Delilah's headless corpse back through the sewers, and he and Riphard privately agreed that Burnie, a former Book Burner, would have to die, though they never followed through.

His relationship with Burnie was initially hostile. As a former Arbiter who participated in the Book Burner purge, Myron was deeply suspicious of Burnie and pelted the newcomer with bottles upon his arrival. Over time, the two developed an uneasy respect. When Burnie pressed him on where he stood, Myron stammered out a rare confession that Burnie was right about the nature of Kolo's death. Their bond solidified through the final campaign, fighting side by side through Seven's Spire.

Martin began teaching Myron vocabulary in his sleep, steadily improving his eloquence, a fact that became apparent during his rousing "Emancipation" speech in the Linderdorf arena.

MYRON'S STORY

Myron proved himself immediately with the hunt for the Lord of Lightning, a terrifying electric beast that had been killing balloon cows across the Masudan countryside. While others prepared with "a variety of levels of effectiveness, coolness and cowardice", Myron slid underneath the creature, slashing and blasting its underbelly, emerging unscathed while the beast tried and failed to land a hit on him.

During the castle infiltration to rescue the nobleman's son Romjiro, Myron threw the Emperor's daughter Juliето out of a window, and then fell out himself, temporarily dying before being revived. His pragmatic approach to impossible situations made him the group's most reliable asset in their darkest hours.

When the party entered the Tom'ardy Mountains in search of Excalibur, Myron accompanied them into the deep dwarven mines. He survived gas traps, animated statues, and a near-fatal fall before being turned to stone by a pair of Gorgons alongside Kolo. He remained petrified for weeks while the rest of the party pressed on, finally being destoned after the Excalibur cache was discovered.

The worst came in Hope's Rest. When Kolo, corrupted beyond recognition by the elder entity Kalimar, emerged in the sewers with his monstrous servants, Myron was the first to charge in, taking arrow after arrow as he fought to reach his friend. He went down hard. Exme

revived him, but the sight of Delilah's crushed body and the children in danger drove Myron to cold fury. He attempted to execute the subdued Kolo, and when Exme tried to stop him, he turned on her with the words that would haunt them both: "This is all your fault." He carried Delilah's corpse back through the sewers without another word.

In the aftermath, Myron drowned his sorrows at the airship bar on a cocktail of his own invention, the "Piece of Shit", and plotted with Riphard to kill Burnie, though neither followed through. He wrote a letter to Rolltop Kandian warning the police chief about the Inquisitors, and threw bottles at Kevin's head when the young assassin boarded the ship.

The group's arrival in Linderdorf marked a turning point. Myron visited his father, Professor Jorge Myron, at the university and met his stepmother Holly Dew for the first time, learning that his own mother had joined a cult that was subsequently destroyed by the Church he served. The reunion gave him some measure of peace.

At the ancient Bright Bart Forge high in the mountains, the party fought the Aspect of the Storm, an air elemental wielding a lightning sword, and claimed the forge's treasures. Myron received Godbringer, an Excalibur-forged weapon of devastating power. He put it to immediate use in the Linderdorf arena, where the party challenged the Stonecast Mech, a thirty-foot stone fighting robot. Myron climbed the machine's legs under heavy fire, launched himself into the air, and brought Godbringer down in a final strike that bisected the robot entirely. As the stadium erupted, Myron took a microphone from STANRI's speaker and delivered a rallying speech about the Church's tyranny and the coming liberation. When Martin supplied the word Myron was reaching for, three-quarters of the crowd joined the chant: "EMANCIPATION!"

Before the final assault on Seven's Spire, Myron walked alone into the hills above the festival town. He found a spring beneath an overhanging tree, stacked pebbles by the water, drew the symbol of Synne in charcoal on the stones, and lit eight fires of different coloured oils. He muttered a prayer to all the gods, asking for their guidance. He received an immense feeling of hope and peace, something he was not familiar with, as the sun rose and cascaded across the land behind him.

At a coconut shy during the Festival of Light, a mysterious old man who seemed to know everything about Myron engaged him in cryptic conversation, hinting that he knew how things would turn out. Myron threw a coconut, missed

badly, threw again, won, and received a wink from the stranger.

Inside the Spire, Myron led from the front, interrogating Lillith for tactical intelligence, bluffing guards with mixed success, and cutting through the tower's defenders floor by floor. He was briefly killed by an Inquisitor's touch before being revived once again. When the party found the prison level, it was Myron who pushed ahead alone, opening the heavy steel door to find Arbiter Kiros, his former colleague, strung up on a rack, barely alive. He pulled out a fistful of cured beef jerky and stuffed it into her mouth, the pure essence of his will seemingly infusing the dried meat with enough strength to bring her back from the edge. When Martin tried to kill the revived Kiros, Myron pinned him to the ground.

As the party donned Inquisitor disguises and prepared to ascend toward the pinnacle and the Great Stone, Myron declared that Pope Ezekiel the Third was going to pay for everything they had witnessed in those cells.

THE CONTINUATION

Four years after the Spire fell and the party became demigods, Myron had returned to what he knew best. He drilled an arbiter army at the ruins of Seven's Spire, training a new generation of enforcers who answered to the returned gods rather than to the corrupt institution that had sealed them away. He and Exme had adopted David, a teenage tailor, and between the school and the army Myron had found something approaching purpose, if not peace.

When Lazarus regathered the group to deal with the Varg super-soldier threat, Myron went with the quiet professionalism that had always defined him. In the Varg lands, he won a brutal bare-knuckle duel against the tiger-monk Zelat to earn the Chesney Hawks tribe's respect, fighting without weapons in a contest that left both combatants bloodied.

The worst came in Kalimar's lair. Deep beneath the ice, in a lava sanctum that was the bowels of a god, Kalimar stabbed Myron through the chest and threw him dead from his shoulder. He was beyond revivify, beyond any healing the party possessed. Exme, holding the Puzzle Die's Wish, the only wish in existence, chose to sacrifice her own existence to save both Myron and Kolo.

Myron woke up. Exme was gone. Erased from all reality, never to return. He had been given his life back at a price that someone else had paid, and the weight of that settled into him like stone.

When the party reached Jecede and the war against Canalon began, Myron wrote Erin's posthumous military honours after the Ulitharid

ate her brain aboard the Nautiloid: the Hardstone Cross for outstanding valour, the Garmond Cross for conspicuous compassion, and the Haremxe Cross for "best gal pal during extreme bestiness 4eva." He took up her fallen glaive and split the Ulitharid in two with it.

When Burnie charged the elder brain alone and was torn apart, Myron did not give a speech. He said "No more," and accepted the leadership that everyone else had already given him. From that point, Myron led.

He led the remnant party, Kolo, Bronwen, Gem, and Bucky McCaw, aboard the maiden-voyage steam railway from Jecede to Hope's Rest, fighting Inquisitors on the train roof. He led them into the sewers of a mind-controlled Hope's Rest, through the deserted streets of the city where he had once thrown bottles at Kevin's head and invented a cocktail made with Bovril. He led them into the Black Rock bank vault and down through acid-filled pots, skull locks, and a mural riddle to claim the Armoury of Sin, the divine gear the god Sinn wore when he last fought Canalon.

The party donned the gear and set off to fight a god. The gnome who had once stammered out a rare confession that Burnie was right, who had carried Delilah's corpse through the sewers, who had prayed alone on a hilltop asking the gods for help, was leading the charge.

THE PIECE OF SHIT

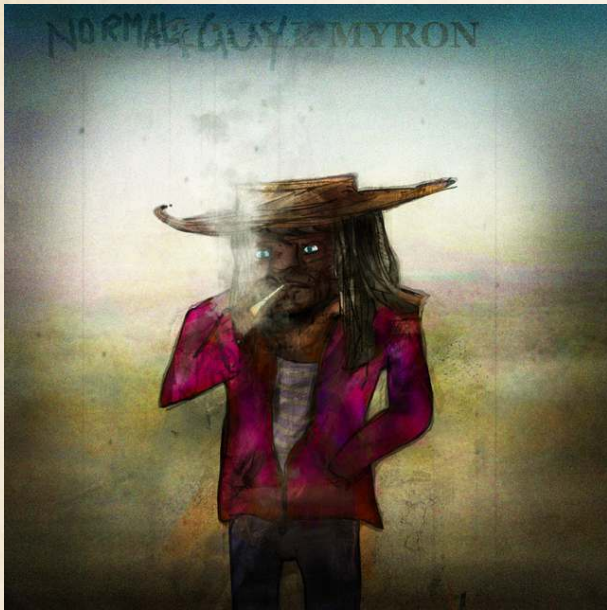
Myron's cocktail, named after Riphard:

One part sherry. One part grenadine. One part Bovril.

Kevin later substituted gravy for the Bovril without detection, a fact that, if discovered, would almost certainly prove fatal for the young assassin.



Arbiter Smord [...] Jorj Myron



NOT MYRON

MARTIN ANDLEBERGER



DETAILS

Race: Construct (Craftwerk)
Class: Bard/Sorcerer
Age: 87
Status: Faded from the story (ep 99)

BACKGROUND

The Andelbergers seemed like any other old aristocratic family from Linderdorf, at least from the outside. Who was to know that the family line stretched almost a thousand years back in history, so far back that the family's origins predated the Sundering itself.

Lord and Lady Andleberger had been maintaining a pure bloodline ever since the Sundering, and the latest generation had proved very difficult indeed, the Lady had only managed to produce a single child, a solitary young woman who glowed with the radiance of Hemotate. She was schooled from the family's great library, and a sense of destiny passed into her. Until one dark and stormy night the Church

arrived, or at least the part of the Church that people only talked about in whispers. Dark masked figures stormed the house and decimated what was left of the family. What happened to the young Ms Andelberger remains unknown.

Martin was the family's fighting butler, built using the knowledge of the ancient family line to protect and serve Ms Andelberger and keep her entertained. His clothes and parts were shaped in strange swirling patterns taken from books long considered useless. On the fateful night the Inquisition appeared, Martin was out milking the cows in the freezing rain. He missed the entire saga, returning only to an empty house torn apart at the seams. He rescued his favourite books and weighed up his options. He had lost everything, but he still had two purposes: to find the young Ms Andelberger, and to avenge the family line. As possibly the last member of the Andelberger household, it fell to him to return the gods to their rightful place within the pantheon.

All this was almost a century ago. Unable to die, the butler wandered the streets, then the town, then the city, and finally the continent, until he was found beaten and chained up by Varg bearkin in the frozen north, and chanced upon by a motley crew in an airship.

PERSONALITY AND TRAITS

Martin was deeply depressed when the party found him, lacking the spark of power that had once helped him deal with the day-to-day drudgery of being immortal. When he discovered the group's goal was to destroy the Church, he picked himself up only a little bit. It was not until he learned that his ward Ms Andelberger had ascended to the heavens that he doubled down and vowed vengeance.

His face and most of his skin were partly metal, fashioned with craftwerk precision. He had a cable-hand that could extend for grappling, used most dramatically to rescue Kevin from the frozen Varg wastes, and could transform into a small mouse form, which he used with alarming regularity. Before the arena fight against the Stonecast Mech, Mr Mouse climbed out to rub dirt in two lines under his eyes before climbing back in. Hardcore.

Martin stuttered badly when he was first found, a defect that Burnie fixed with a quick shock from his electrical gloves. He spoke Tikki Tuck, Goblin, and Low Velterran, and had been quietly teaching Myron vocabulary in his sleep, steadily improving the gnome's eloquence without his knowledge.

He claimed to have an imaginary girlfriend in Nanduan. Kevin insisted his own girlfriend was

real.

RELATIONSHIPS

Martin became most attached to Burnie of all the party members, the gruff old Book Burner's practical nature apparently appealing to the construct's sensibilities. Burnie was the one who fixed his stutter, recharged him in the field, and treated him as a capable ally rather than a curiosity.

His relationship with the wider group was complicated by suspicion. Myron harboured serious doubts about whether Martin was truly on their side or on some other mission, and the two had tense exchanges, though their silent hour-long walk together before the Festival of Light suggested a mutual understanding beneath the friction. When Martin tried to kill the rescued Arbiter Kiros inside Seven's Spire, believing all Church members deserved death, it was Myron who pinned him to the ground. Exmerah took him aside afterwards and explained that, barring herself, every member of the party had worked for the Church at some point, a revelation that left him flabbergasted.

Martin made a deal with Lazarus in Hell, agreeing to do whatever the devil wanted in exchange for help finding answers about his lost ward. The exact terms were characteristically vague.

MARTIN'S STORY

Martin was found chained up and being beaten by Varg bearkin in the frozen north, barely conscious and kept upright only by the chains attached to nearby trees. Kevin and the party rescued him, though Martin initially refused to join them, attempting to jump off the airship on multiple occasions. When the gnome inventors aboard recognised him as an official member of a northern expedition, his cover was blown and he reluctantly stayed.

He proved his worth in the climb to the Bright Bart Forge, charging himself from a lightning strike and unleashing torrents of electricity at the Aspect of the Storm, an air elemental wielding a lightning sword that had sealed the forge for centuries. Though the overload tore him to pieces, Burnie recharged him just in time. At the forge, Martin helped the party claim the ancient forging tools, rune-carving books, and materials that would be used to create their Excalibrium weapons.

In Linderdorf, Martin put his craftwerk expertise to use, building new weapons and exoskeletons for the party and scouting the Stonecast Mech in the Clawtech arena, convincing its owners to disassemble and reassemble it before the fight, quietly sabotaging

its readiness. During the arena battle itself, Martin threw storm spheres from inside the Mech's cockpit-sized mouse compartment, his lightning striking aggressively against the arena walls to wild cheering. After Myron's bisecting final blow, it was Martin who supplied the word the gnome was reaching for, and who threw glitter into the air as he thunderstepped out while three-quarters of the crowd chanted "EMANCIPATION!"

Martin's calculations for the assault on Seven's Spire proved correct, the airship could indeed destroy the tower, though the ship might not survive the impact. He disguised himself as Lazarus for the Festival of Light infiltration, and inside the Spire he made STANRI invisible by disconnecting and reconnecting its mechanical systems and infusing it with fey wild magic, creating the "invisible bear" that blocked enemy escape routes while the party fought through floor after floor toward the pinnacle.

THE CONTINUATION

In the four years after the Spire, Martin reinvented himself. He hunted the remaining Inquisitors across the continent, tracking the dark-masked figures who had destroyed his family nearly a century ago, and took a teaching position at Exme's school, passing on what knowledge a near-immortal construct butler could offer to the next generation of gifted girls.

When the party regathered, Martin followed Burnie into the Varg without hesitation. The frozen north was unkind to him. Buchra, a snow leopard warrior of the Chesney Hawks tribe, exploded Martin into pieces during a sparring match, and the party had to reassemble him while Exme worked. Later, the bestial lieutenant Malkior hit Martin with a feeblemind spell, reducing him to a state he described as "feeling like a mouse," though this time without the benefits of actually being one. In Kalimar's lava sanctum, Martin was destroyed entirely and revived alongside the others by Burnie's desperate efforts and the power of Synne.

After Exme's erasure brought Kolo back in a construct body, Martin quietly stepped aside. Both characters were played by Stephen Reddish, and with Kolo restored there was no longer room for the wandering butler at the table. Martin faded from the story around the time the party reached Jecede, his century-long quest for vengeance against the Inquisition arguably fulfilled, his search for the lost Ms Andelberger still unanswered.

Somewhere, probably, he is a mouse.

MR MOUSE

Martin's mouse form became the group's secret weapon. He scouted enemy positions from inside walls, climbed into the Stonecast Mech's head compartment to pilot it, and received cheese from Exme as payment for services rendered. The transformation process, a construct butler folding himself down into a small rodent, was never adequately explained and nobody thought to ask.

ANTHONY K TIGERIUS III



DETAILS

Race: DesertCat
Class: Barbarian
Age: 42
Status: Wandering the Expanse (assassin contract if he returns)

BACKGROUND

Anthony K. Tigerius III arrived at the party's airship by Hope's Restian stagecoach, stepping out as a large, well-dressed tiger carrying a briefcase and holding a cane he clearly did not need. Sent by the Guild of Coin to open negotiations regarding Riphard Obsidian Hardstone's considerable fortune, he found instead a group of fugitives, a petrified dwarf, and a pregnant Jenny.

His formal correspondence with the Guild, fragments of which survived the flooding of a records office in the Age of Abject Terrors, reveals a methodical mind struggling to reconcile the group's obvious insanity with their equally obvious capability. He followed them into the Tom'ardy mines on the justification that if the tales about the airship were true, then perhaps the group really was "as capable and insane as they say."

PERSONALITY AND TRAITS

Toni was the group's most professional member, a trained negotiator and diplomat who believed in structure, synergy, and the proper use of breakout rooms. He set up a powerpoint presentation to train Lady Gharbighast's staff in negotiation tactics, used the word "synergy" to clinch deals with fish kings, and maintained formal letters to the Guild of Coin even as the world fell apart around him.

Beneath this veneer of corporate civility, however, lurked a primal berserker fury. When sufficiently "peevied about the injustice of it all," the mild-mannered Anthony bit his lip, spat blood, and gave way to a blur of cane-sword and rage. His berserker state first manifested in the deep mines, where he single-handedly saved Burnie from a four-armed horned abomination by pounding its exterior in a frenzy, then ran off to attempt to murder a dwarf that had been dead for hundreds of years. He later apologised to Exme for acting "so uncouthly."

He fed his companion starlings by hand on the deck of the airship, and they sang little songs to each other which was very nice.

RELATIONSHIPS

Toni saw Riphard as an un-tempered prodigy who could take the world by storm. His hope was that the power and wealth Riphard wielded could be directed toward the betterment of all Velterra, and his negotiations with the Guild of Coin were motivated by this larger vision.

He provided a calming counterbalance to Burnie, once pulling him aside to politely explain "why he was wrong about almost everything" during the merfolk negotiations. His exchanges with Exme were warm, she showed him her "dinglehopper," and he gave her ritual materials to talk to animals that she built into her helmet.

Toni's relationships with the wider group were defined by a growing moral unease. He saw the party commit acts of terrible violence, some under magical ensorcellment and some by choice, and it weighed on him.

TONI'S STORY

Toni joined the party during the expedition to the Tom'ardy mines, where his berserker rage saved Burnie's life in the battle against a creature that "should definitely not exist." He accompanied the group through the deep mines as they searched for Excalibur, though his formal Guild of Coin dispatches struggled to convey the increasingly bizarre reality of the situation.

His finest hour came at New Abbergast, where the party had been tasked with resolving a conflict between the land settlers and the

merfolk who were attacking their fishing boats. Toni personally captured a merfolk warrior, negotiated a diplomatic meeting with King Oceani of the Waves, trained Lady Gharbighast's staff in negotiation tactics via powerpoint, and brokered a trade agreement that resolved the conflict peacefully, one of the few problems the group ever solved without significant bloodshed.

The breaking point came at Golding's Bay. A temple's magical ensorcellment caused the party to slaughter an entire village of innocent people. Toni was disgusted. When the Arbiters arrived to investigate, he walked out of the church, stated his name and cause, and dropped to his knees in surrender, the only member of the group to willingly face justice. Arbiter Kiros used a word of truth on him, and under its influence he confessed to the crimes, despite having been ensorcelled at the time. He was beaten, battered, and dragged away to a prison wagon.

Burnie rescued him through an audacious deception, but the damage was done. From the crow's nest of the airship, alone with his thoughts and his remaining starlings, the tiger looked aloft and thought: "They are monsters, they are foul debasers, they shall pay for what they have wrought."

Toni left the group in the night, heading toward the Expanse to find his family. The party, characteristically, hired assassins to kill him if he ever returned.



Anthony K Tigerius III

SGT ERIN DEVEREUX



DETAILS

Player: Nat
Race: Human
Class: Soldier (glaive)
Age: Unknown
Status: Deceased (ep 101)

BACKGROUND

Sergeant Erin Devereux came to the party four years after the fall of the Seven's Spire, when the world had moved on and the old companions had drifted apart. She hailed from the western carnival city of Jecede, daughter of Calista and Michelle Devereaux, who ran the Midnight Pearl cabaret on its waterfront. A career soldier rather than a treasure hunter, she carried herself with a discipline the rest of the group had never much bothered with.

She was the sole survivor of a reconnaissance team sent north into the Varg lands, a mission that should have killed her with the rest. By her own account she lived only because her friend Reggie spent his last breath in a sacrifice that moved the distant gods to spare her, a debt she never stopped trying to repay and never quite believed she deserved. Lazarus, now ruling Hell as the Empire of the Eight, folded her into the regathered party as their first new recruit.

PERSONALITY AND TRAITS

Erin was the straight edge against which the party's chaos broke. Where the others schemed and bickered, she wrote mission reports, kept her glaive sharp, and tried to hold a soldier's line

in a company of lunatics. Episode 82 is told entirely in her dry, clipped field-report voice, a tone that says everything about how she saw her new colleagues.

Beneath the discipline she was unravelling. Survivor's guilt over Reggie sat heavy on her from the start, and somewhere in the Varg lands an intrusive inner voice took root, growing colder and more contemptuous of the party and the gods alike with every episode. By the time the party tracked Valkar north she had become convinced that everyone around her was a fool, a corruption she fought quietly and largely alone.

RELATIONSHIPS

As the newcomer, Erin spent much of her early time taking the measure of the group, wary of their methods and slow to trust their competence. The girls' night aboard the airship, where she finally spoke about Reggie to Exme and Martin, was one of her few moments of open feeling. Her bond was less with any one member than with the idea of the mission itself, and later with her home city, whose armies she came to command.

After Exme's erasure, when Kolo stood on deck in his new construct body mourning a sister he had only just gotten back, Erin stood listening, facing away, having a quiet cry with her "best gal pals 4eva" cloak whipping in the wind. Then she turned to the tin goblin she had never met and said, "Well zen Kolo, I don't know you. But I knew her. And if you're anything like 'er, then this is going to be interesting. We'd best not let 'er down, no?"

ERIN'S STORY

Erin earned her place in the warm-up against the lich Valklondar, then followed the party into the Varg lands to infiltrate the Chesney Hawks tribe. She survived being swallowed whole by a guardian naga, endured the steady poison of her inner voice through the long march north, and stood with the party as Kalimar fell.

When Canalon descended and the war moved west to her home, Erin came into her own. The Jecede council made her head of all its armies, the highest she had ever risen. It did not last. When a githyanki Nautiloid attacked the city, the party boarded it, and an Ulitharid mind flayer cut her down and devoured her brain. The episode that records her death is titled, with the group's usual gallows humour, "the one where Erin Dies". Myron took up her fallen glaive and split the Ulitharid in two with it, and her body was burned on a pyre alongside Burnie's a few days later. In his report, Myron granted her posthumous awards: the Hardstone Cross for outstanding valour in the face of overwhelming

adversity, the Garmond Cross for most conspicuous compassion in circumstances of extreme danger, and the Haremxe Cross for “best gal pal during extreme bestiness 4eva.”

BRONWEN



DETAILS

Player: Jonathan Mann (after Exme's erasure)
Race: Devil
Class: Cleric (flying sword)
Age: Unknown
Status: Active

BACKGROUND

Bronwen arrived after the destruction of Kalimar, at the point where the party had lost Exmerah and badly needed someone to keep them pointed in the right direction. She stood seven feet tall, with golden eyes and an incongruously warm Welsh accent, and she made no secret of being a creature of Hell. Lazarus had sent her, and the Empire of the Eight does not send minders to groups it has given up on.

PERSONALITY AND TRAITS

For a devil, Bronwen was remarkably steady. She fought with a flying sword and mended the party's wounds when its luck ran out, playing the role of both enforcer and field medic. Her temperament ran calm and practical, a useful counterweight to a group that had just watched one of its own erase herself from existence.

Her most important talent was her command of darkness, which proved to be more than a battlefield trick. When the party was overwhelmed by the mass mind control of a mind flayer, it was Bronwen's darkness that broke the spell and freed them.

RELATIONSHIPS

Sent rather than chosen, Bronwen slotted into the party as Hell's representative, and the group came to rely on her where they had once relied on Exme's ingenuity and Burnie's experience. She kept Myron alive through the worst of the Nautiloid fighting, reviving him again and again, and her scrying gave the party their first clear look at the enemy: Canalon perched atop the guildmasters' hall in Hope's Rest, its many eyes turning to look straight back at her.

BRONWEN'S STORY

Bronwen joined the remnant of the party for the final stretch of the campaign. She broke the Ulitharid's hold over the group during the boarding of the Nautiloid, kept Myron on his feet through the running battle that followed, and rode with the survivors aboard the Jecede railway to Hope's Rest. After Erin's death and Burnie's, when the survivors were moping and Burnie was smearing his own excrement on the walls in grief (the hook made it especially dangerous), it was Bronwen who snapped them out of it. "No more of that," she told them. "No more moping around, it's not helping anyone and more people are going to die. The whole universe is relying on you to get your head in the bloody game. Erin knew that. Exme knew that. And you all know it."

When the party heisted the deserted Black Rock bank for the Armoury of Sin, Bronwen was among the handful still standing to help carry the gods' old war gear out of the vault.

GEM

DETAILS

Player: Nat
Race: Silicate (spacefarer)
Class: Psychic archer
Age: Over 500
Status: Active

BACKGROUND

Gem was found in a holding cell aboard the githyanki Nautiloid, a prisoner of the same enemy the party had come to fight. She is a woman of living silicate, calm and faintly amused, who has spent more than five centuries travelling between the stars. Her people, she explained, were created at the very moment Canalon was cast out of the heavens, which made the elder dragon's return a matter of more than passing interest to her.

PERSONALITY AND TRAITS

Gem carries herself with the unhurried confidence of someone who has seen far more than the world she has dropped into. She is, by her own description, an observer, bound by some protocol of her people not to interfere, and she joined the party precisely by breaking that rule. Her weapon is a bow that folds neatly into a violin, and she rounds out her marksmanship with psychic powers that the party found endlessly useful, not least when she polymorphed a lightning-wreathed bank Arcanist into a harmless clockwork bobbin.

RELATIONSHIPS

Coming aboard so late, Gem attached herself to the survivors as a fellow outsider with her own reasons for wanting Canalon dead. She took quickly to the party's stranger members, befriending a telepathic sewer octopod named Badunkadonk beneath Hope's Rest, an alliance nearly undone when Kolo, true to form, took a shot at the creature.

GEM'S STORY

Freed from her cell during the storming of the Nautiloid, Gem fought her way out alongside the party through githyanki and mind flayers, and chose to stay once the ship went down. She rode the Jecede railway west with the remnant of the group, helped see off the Inquisitors who attacked across the train roof, and was among the party that descended into the Black Rock vault to claim the Armoury of Sin for the coming battle with the god who had cast her makers adrift.

MISCELLANEOUS CHARACTERS

DELILAH HARDSTONE



One of Jennie's Girls, a group confusingly led by a Mae Harkwood! This hotty was a straight up drop bear killer. Delilah joined the party during the hunt for Diego Escabar's Fancy Men, quickly proving herself as an expert marksman and fearless fighter. She shot a rainbow at a shadow creature, helped steal an entire lemon orchard, and flirted with anything that moved, including Gary, who remained oblivious.

Delilah became the Sky Captain of Tomorrow, and then betrothed to Riphard. The two had twin children together, Bilbo and Dildo, blessed by the gods and believed to possess special powers. She was killed by Kolo during his rampage in the Hope's Rest sewers, her skull crushed by his monstrous claw. Her soul went to Hell, confirmed by Lazarus. Riphard never truly recovered from her death, descending into a delusion that involved a mannequin corpse-wife and two sacks of rotten pork he believed were his children.

ARCHIBALD

The elderly, near-blind librarian who continued to tend the abandoned Book Burners headquarters in Hope's Rest long after everyone else had fled. Archibald lived alone with his son

in the building, subsisting on mysterious foodstuffs and maintaining the library with a devotion that bordered on the tragic. He couldn't see well enough to clean the place properly, but he could still make a decent bacon and eggs.

When the party claimed the building as the Gary Guild's headquarters, Archibald was put to work stripping out the third floor for Exme's workshop, a task he performed with characteristic reluctance. He developed a surprising romance with Daisuke, the party's Masudan interpreter.

LAZARUS



A bureaucratic devil in Hell, full name Lazarus "Laz" Goldstein. Red-skinned, wearing a human face mask, and operating from a plush office accessible only through portal doors conjured by his elephantine butler Meredith, Lazarus enlisted the help of the group to bring down the Church. His motive was not malice but paperwork: the Church's ever-expanding definition of sin was flooding Hell with undeserving souls, overwhelming the filing systems, the torture schedules, and his patience.

Lazarus maintained a war room with a large-scale map of Velterra that tracked Church troop movements and, later, the location of every ally the party had recruited. He communicated through dreams and the Stone of Unthala, oscillating between genuine concern for the party's wellbeing and the exasperated manner of a middle manager whose interns kept dying. His kitsch office furnishings rotated depending on his mood.

Despite Kolo's sworn vengeance against him and the group's general distrust, Lazarus proved to be "a pretty decent bloke" who had genuinely good intentions, rescuing the party from inevitable deaths he had no part in orchestrating and giving them new leases of life to improve the world. His superior, Arbigo, used "brutal underhanded management tactics" to control the operation, but Lazarus outmanoeuvred him in the end.

Following the return of the Gods, Lazarus was rewarded for his efforts by being re-ascended into his full angel form. By the time of the continuation, four years later, he had risen to rule Hell outright, rebranding it as the Empire of the Eight. He stayed in the mortal world after portalling over with the gods, astrally projecting from an apartment in the ruined Seven's Spire.

Lazarus regathered the scattered party to deal with the Varg threat, sent the devil Bronwen as a minder when losses mounted, and in the final arc gifted the remnant group rings of mind shielding and jetpacks, because he always understood the importance of a dramatic entrance. He spent the train journey to Hope's Rest enjoying vol-au-vents, then flew off to keep tabs on Canalon personally. When Kolo tried to open an HR ticket to ensure Burnie's soul went to Hell, it was filed deep into the system.

KEVIN



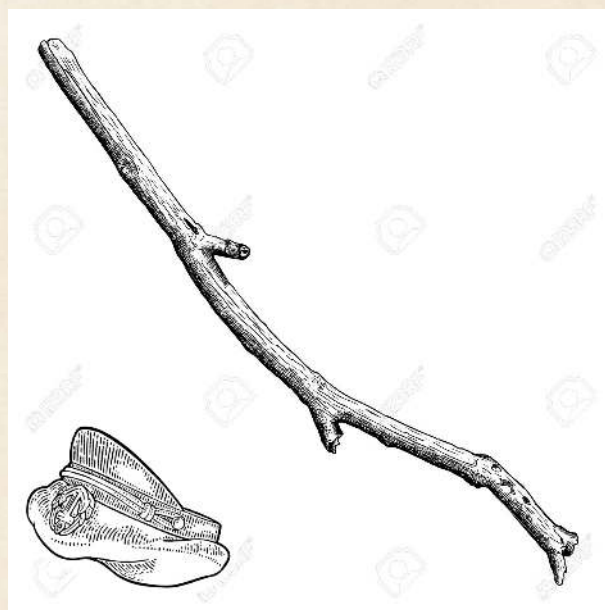
A final-year PhD student at the University of Assassins, Kevin was introduced to the party by

Buck McCraw, Burnie's half-Tengu son, as a promising student who needed field experience. He wrote formal report-letters to "Professor McCaw" documenting the group's adventures, and quickly found himself in an "unhealthily abusive" mentor-pupil relationship with Burnie.

Kevin possessed a Christopher Mintz-Plasse energy that endeared him to nobody. Myron threw bottles at his head upon his first boarding of the ship. His stealth skills, however, proved genuinely useful, he scouted enemy positions, connected with Thieves Guild networks for intelligence, and climbed on a storm giant during the battle for the Bright Bart Forge. He also substituted gravy for Bovril in Myron's "Piece of Shit" cocktails without detection, perhaps his most dangerous accomplishment.

In his spare time Kevin enjoys developing immunity to poisons and fantasy roleplaying games.

CAPTAIN STICK



Not much is known about Captain Stick other than that he has inexplicably been long-trusted with command of The Gary. Never wavering, seldom faltering in his duties, Captain Stick offered straight and to-the-point leadership to the team and the airship's crew throughout their adventures.

Captain Stick died in Episode 103, steering the burning Airship Gary into the falling githyanki Nautiloid to deflect it from Jecede. He went down with his ship.

VU DONG



A magical monkey companion who joined the party's menagerie of unlikely allies. Vu Dong wielded staves and Pilch's old sword with surprising effectiveness, navigating by tail-stick when blinded. Sometimes called Jeremy or Jezza, the monkey served as mascot, scout, and occasional combatant, though Mark once complained he's "not really here when we need him".

MEREDITH



The weird-noise making, portal-door-creating elephant butler of Lazarus. Meredith's ability to conjure doorways between dimensions made her invaluable to Hell's operations, though her social skills left something to be desired, she stood up Mark on his prom night.

TRAYVON

Trayvon was a Tengu Book Burner and colleague of Burnie prior to the great Book Burner purges. Boasting the longest wingspan of any Book Burner to have ever held a lighter, Trayvon was a manic-depressive control freak. Trayvon and Burnie managed to conceive a child together, the details of which remain mercifully unclear.

RUH'BREKS

One of the last great magic users in the world. Ruh'Breks was an ancient, dying sorcerer who had sealed himself away in his underground tower centuries ago. He unknowingly mentored the Goblins through the magical texts and picture books left in his tower, and was the inventor and builder of the airship that would become The Gary. He also created the legendary Puzzle Die, a magical cube with dozens of functions including teleportation, flight, invisibility, and a wish spell on a 10,000 year cooldown.

After joining the party as "Ruh'Breks Sensei", he sacrificed himself protecting the airship during the assault on Masuda, holding back a giant mountain creature with his last reserves of power. His final words: "You must get back to Velterra."

ARBITER KIROS



Kiros is a terrifying Arbiter, a plate-armoured Church enforcer carrying a gun bigger and badder than Riphard's. She is renowned as the first person to ever cause Kolo to soil himself. Despite her fearsome reputation, Kiros developed a grudging respect for the party after witnessing their actions in Logarsk, where they exposed the Marshall's abuse of children in the church basement.

She likes Riphard, respects Otoria, and came around to helping the team once the Inquisition started making its presence felt. She was good friends with "the machine gun wielding maniac."

After the party left Hope's Rest, Kiros was captured by the Church and replaced with a doppelganger who reported on the group's movements. The real Kiros was taken to Seven's Spire and tortured on a rack in the prison level. She was found barely alive by Myron, who stuffed her mouth with cured beef jerky and willed her back from the edge. Upon revival, she immediately demanded to know the whereabouts of Arbitrator Khan. When the party encountered Khan, Kiros unloaded a full set of chambered rounds into him as he advanced towards her.

HOLLY



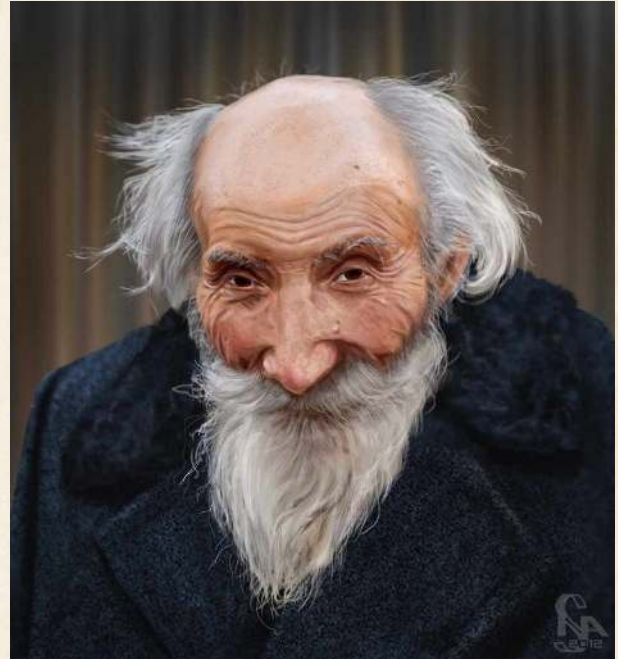
The keeper of the Tower of Imota Kan (Nakatomi backwards) in Riverfall. Holly managed the tower's vaults, library, and social events. She let the party in to examine the sacred artefacts and hosted them at a party where Otoria met people from her home continent. During the Die Hard heist, Holly was taken hostage but survived thanks to the party's intervention.

BILBO AND DILDO, RIPHARD'S TWINS



Twins born to Riphard and Delilah during the Tom'ardy Mountains expedition. Blessed by the gods and believed to possess special powers, these children represent the next generation of the Hardstone dynasty. Their mother was killed by Kolo shortly after their birth, and Exme stopped time to rescue them during the ensuing chaos. After the tragedy, they were cared for by Burnie's adoptive dwarven parents Gerald and his wife, who joined the airship crew as babysitters.

DEREK BOBACIOUS



A discerning but ageing bachelor, whose love for his daughter is marred only by the fact she is a total bitch. Derek owned a nice house in Riverfall that became Riphard's first bank (Northern Rock). He was convinced that "the gods want to run a shop in his house" and happily agreed.

Derek later relocated to Hope's Rest to run the marketing campaign for the Guild of Banking, sporting a casual purple and yellow suit with seven-inch lapels. His billboard campaigns, "We Take Interest in Your Interest", became a fixture of the city.

KING OCEANI



Proud underwater king of the merfolk. King Oceani (also known as O-ssu-nai) first encountered the party when they accidentally captured the head of his guard during the merfolk negotiations at New Abbergast. Toni brokered the peace, and Oceani became a firm ally.

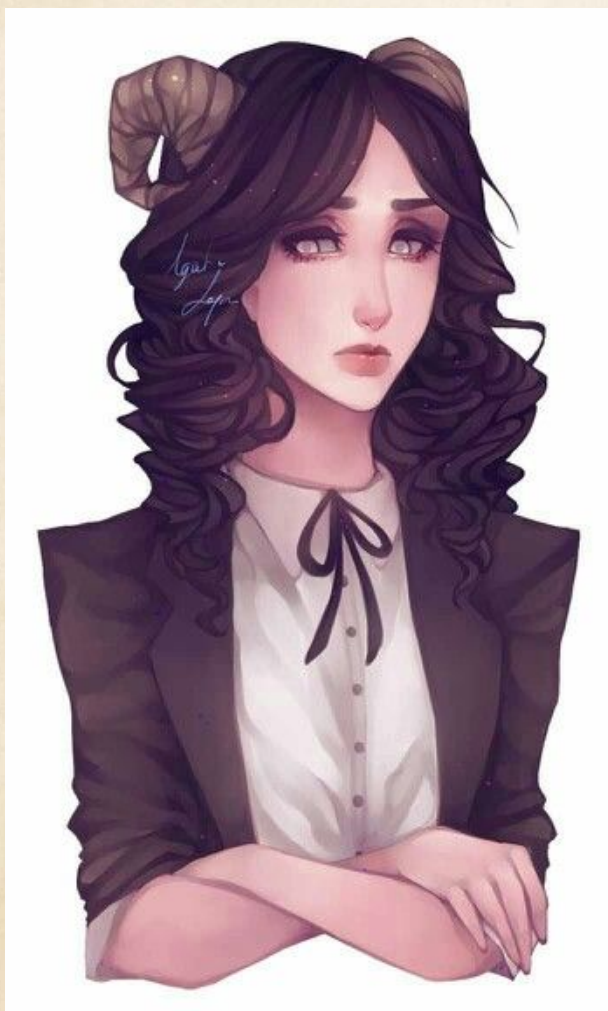
When the party returned to kill Acroneth the Immortal, an Aboleth terrorising the merfolk, Oceani's gratitude deepened into a committed alliance. He fathered a child with Lady Gharbighast of New Abbergast and, when the time came, committed his entire army to the Battle of Hope's Rest. He died during the fighting, but his ghost rallied the merfolk troops to continue the assault. A singing fool to the end.

TIKI TUKS



A race of small bear-like creatures with fearsome, culturally insensitive masks and sharp, pointed teeth. The Tiki Tuks inhabit temples and wilderness areas throughout Velterra's southern regions and the jungles of South Africa, where cannibalistic variants were encountered. Their war cry, "tikki tukk doumo arigatou tikki tukk", struck fear into the hearts of none. Kolo could speak their language and occasionally posed as a visiting relative.

GARBIGAIL



Garbigail, also known as Abigail, took over the Gary Guild in Hope's Rest while the party was away on the Masuda campaign. She had survived poisoning, beaten chicken disease, and spoken to Gary in a vision, which apparently qualified her for the role. Slightly Scouse in accent, she transformed the Garys from a loosely organised guild into a pseudo-religious peace movement, complete with Gary's original logo.

When the party returned and explained what Gary actually stood for, Garbigail agreed to fight the good fight. The Garys answered the call for the final battle, suffering heavy casualties at the Battle of Hope's Rest in service of the ideals their founder had lived and died for.

ARBIGAL

Lazarus's boss in Hell. Used brutal underhanded management tactics to gain control of the infernal bureaucracy. Arbigal represents the worst of corporate politics, a creature who rose to power not through merit or

strength, but through diabolical office manoeuvring of the most literal kind.

DAISUKE



The party's interpreter and fixer during the Masuda campaign. Daisuke was paid lots of money and was therefore okay doing whatever was asked of him. He secured quotes for passage upstream, arranged boat rentals, and provided crucial cultural context, including his assessment that the local lord was "a dick." A reliable, if mercenary, ally in foreign lands.

Daisuke developed a surprising romance with Archibald, the elderly librarian from the old Book Burner headquarters. His fate was considerably less romantic, he was sacrificed by the increasingly feral Kolo to the elder entity Kalimar in the depths of the Tom'ardy mines.

LILLITH

A half-elf Book Burner who "actually liked Pilch", a distinction that set her apart from most people who met him. Lillith fled west after the great Book Burner purges and spent years in hiding before the party found her crammed into a barrel in the Tom'ardy mines.

Lillith became the group's most competent strategist. She helped the party escape the mines when Kolo went feral, stayed behind as a dwarven diplomat after the Excalibur cache

was discovered, and convinced the Tom'ardy council to commit their forces to the alliance. Her greatest contribution was infiltrating Seven's Spire disguised as a pastor during the Festival of Light, positioning herself inside the tower weeks before the assault. When the party arrived in chains, it was Lillith who set them free and briefed them on the tower's layout.

She refused to be drawn into battles she considered suicidal, once sighing, overcoming her self-preservation instincts, and sliding underneath a dying Burnie to pull him from a monster's claw before informing him that she would only put herself on the line for him once, and that was it. He reminded her that she did it really badly.

DAGENHAM

Riphard's best friend from childhood and an old dwarf of the Tom'ardy Mountains. Dagenham was a great smithy with a dark and terrible gambling habit that Exme exploited. His life ended in spectacular fashion when he leaned over a massive pit of centuries-old mine waste, vomited, slipped in, and was shot by Burnie for reasons that were never adequately explained. He then sparked his tinderbox, igniting the methane and creating a "shitty napalm" that threw everyone backwards. Riphard named one of the twins after him.

GOOGLE VON MACCHERSTEIN

Master blacksmith of Linderdorf and winner of the Blacksmith Cup alongside his partners Märöck Grünhelvem and Jüppi Indelnacht. The party's drunken search for Google through Linderdorf's warren of foundries and automatons became the stuff of legend. He had gone exploring the Varg lands and had to be rescued from giants by the party before he could forge the Excalibrium weapons that would arm the group for their final assault. His workshop in Linderdorf, staffed by the assistant Burnice and the dwarves Linus Brandler and Celina Speidel, served as the party's base of operations during the Linderdorf arc.

BUCK "BUCKY" MCCAW

Burnie's son, originally called Trayvon Jr. Half-human, half-Tengu, and hideously disfigured, Buck was raised by the assassin Bones after Burnie abandoned him. He trained at the Guild of Assassins and initially attempted to kill his father before the two reconciled over a shared understanding of loss in "a beautiful reconciliation" where father and son "quickly became best friends, making up for lost time."

Buck introduced Kevin to the party as a promising PhD student needing field experience, an act of either generosity or revenge, depending on one's perspective.

In the continuation, Bucky arrived in Jecede wearing a plague doctor's mask and an avian cloak, carrying a letter Burnie had left him. The letter explained that his father had gone off to kill some elder gods. Bucky had been walking the edge of the Varg lands when the news of Burnie's death reached him. Kolo was shocked into silence at the sight of him.

Bucky joined the remnant party for the final arc, fighting Inquisitors on the Jecede railway roof with a cane-hook that converted into a sling, scouting the Black Rock bank lobby invisibly, and then fixing all the damage he caused to the train. He spoke far too much. Gem considered banishing him from the plane of existence. He went to fight a god anyway.

LADY GHARBIGHAST



Ruler of New Abbergast, the island fortress-town where the party brokered peace between the land settlers and the merfolk. Lady Gharbighast was not a Jenny, not a merfolk, but some other kind of water person, a distinction without a difference, perhaps. She was pregnant with King Oceani's child when the party returned to recruit her forces for the final battle. Despite the Church's attempts to turn her against the party, she remained loyal to the alliance and committed her people to the cause.

ROLLTOP KANDIAN

Police chief of Hope's Rest and an old friend of Myron's. Rolltop received Myron's warnings about the sewer killings and the Inquisitors with varying degrees of receptiveness, on one occasion responding by hitting Myron with a billy club. In a twist that surprised no-one who had been paying attention, the epilogue of Episode 59 revealed that Rolltop himself was the serial killer stalking the city's sewers.

LARK

A singing swordswoman encountered during the Die Hard heist at the Tower of Imota Kan. Lark beheaded Otorio with a katana, the group's first real loss, and one that hit hard. Not to be confused with one of Mark O'Synne's coloured copies, also named Lark, who was considerably less lethal and more annoying.

MRS BALL



Mrs Ball, who contains a universe

A sentient sphere of impossibly dense metal, dressed up with an incongruous pink bow, Mrs Ball served the party in the continuation as something between a sidekick and a weapon of last resort. She answers to a being she calls the ALLMOTHER, and her stated work is the quiet restoration of broken universes, a task glimpsed in an epilogue where she patiently rebuilds a shattered one piece by piece.

In a fight she does one thing, and does it better than anything else in the world. When the lich Valklondar had the party beaten, Myron slammed him into Mrs Ball and the impact finished him. Later, in the lava sanctum, with most of the party dead or dying, it was Mrs Ball who delivered her biggest ever bonk, punching clean through Kalimar, the Elder God of Creation, and killing him. The original Mrs Ball was lost along the way, but a successor, by all accounts a more confident model, took her place.

DAVID

A teenage tailor adopted by Myron and Exmerah, David grew up among the party's strange extended family in the years after the Spire. He stitched the uniforms for Exme's girls' school and was, for a boy raised by a gnome Arbiter and a goblin artificer, remarkably well adjusted. When the falling Nautiloid threatened to crush Jecede, David helped fly the airship Gary into its path to turn it aside, a piece of courage that cost the beloved airship and Captain Stick their lives but saved the city.

VALKAR VARG

Warlord of a unified Varg, Valkar was the great enemy of the continuation's first half. Where earlier Varg leaders had been brutal but mortal, Valkar made a pact with the Elder God Kalimar, brewing his goo into super-soldiers through trials that killed ninety-nine takers in a hundred. He rode a giant eagle at the head of a hellish host of Pact warriors, and in episode 88 he announced the invasion of the south, ending any hope the party had of quietly seizing a single warband. When Canalon descended and the war turned, Valkar fled the battlefield, and his ultimate fate was never recorded.

KRANKLE

A goblin alchemist with a long and ugly history, Krankle had tormented Kolo and Exmerah when they were children in the Varg. By the time the party caught up with him he was working for Valkar, studying Kalimar's goo to engineer a controllable version called Kalimel. Found at last in a laboratory papered with pornography, he was persuaded to switch sides for gold, protection and, in his own terms, dark-haired white women, agreeing to brew an antidote and handing over a tracker he had planted on Valkar.

VALKLONDAR

An ancient lich and wizard who had retreated into a trapped mine east of Erdun's Well to research stasis magic. Valklondar was the continuation's warm-up villain, a cackling undead sorcerer who welcomed the party to his "games room" after they fell through a pit trap that killed an amnesiac stasis-tube survivor named Jeremiah on impact.

Valklondar's lair was guarded by pale fanged ladies, see-through people, and a stinky rotten dude that everyone initially mistook for Burnie. The centrepiece was a trio of undead giants, including the Pope of Skeleton Giants, a title Riphard inherited after decapitating the pontiff

with his whip. Valklondar monologued through an anti-magic field, fireballed the party (charring Erin to a crisp), and generally made himself obnoxious until Myron, polymorphed into a crab, was slammed into Mrs Ball. The impact finished him.

MAGRAT

Giant chieftain of the Chesney Hawks, one of the named Varg tribes the party infiltrated during the continuation. Magrat stood tall enough to demand deference from the party with a single look, and once beheaded a previous leader in one pull to claim the position.

The party had to prove themselves to her tribe through hunting and fighting. Magrat was indifferent when Myron confessed the party's coup plot to her face, which was either a sign of supreme confidence or supreme disinterest. In Episode 89, she ate a man whole in a single bite, a feat witnessed only by Riphard, which nobody else believed.

ZELAT

A tiger-monk of the Chesney Hawks tribe, Zelat was the first tribesperson to challenge the party directly. Myron accepted a bare-knuckle duel against him, fought to first unconscious, and what followed was one of the continuation's most memorable sequences.

Zelat opened with fancy monk techniques, a 360 spin kick to the head and a stunning strike. Myron responded with repeated punches to the balls, an elbow, a headbutt (also to the balls), a flying elbow leap that missed and became a knee, and finally grabbed Zelat's head and slammed him into the dirt in what the episode describes as an RKO. Zelat hauled himself up with Ki points still remaining, swung pathetically at Myron's face, and was crumpled into a heap by a square punch. Myron then reckoned he could take everyone in the camp right there and then.

MALKIOR

A bestial lieutenant of Valkar Varg, Malkior was a monkey-beast who commanded fire ants and struck with a ferocity that caught the party off guard. He hit Martin with a feeblemind spell that reduced the construct butler to "feeling like a mouse," though this time without the benefits of actually being one.

Myron and Martin ended Malkior by combining a whirlwind spell that flayed the beast-lieutenant to mist, a death as violent as the creature deserved.

REGGIE

The ghost of Erin's fallen comrade from the reconnaissance mission to the Varg. Reggie spent his last breath in a sacrifice so selfless that the distant gods answered it, sparing Erin's life. She never stopped trying to repay the debt and never quite believed she deserved to survive.

Reggie's presence lingered. He dwelled in Erin's dogtags, and later his ghost was found riding inside Martin, who apparently had room for passengers. An exorcism was attempted and failed. Whether Reggie moved on after Erin's death is unknown.

ARBITER GIROS

A scarred female Arbiter who served under Myron after the Spire fell and the Church's old hierarchy collapsed. Giros led Myron's special forces unit, a cadre of former Arbiters retrained for the new world, and arrived in Jecede to take command alongside Myron for the Hope's Rest campaign.

She was made joint Lord Commander with Myron, given sealed-envelope targets, and ordered to harry the mind-controlled city while staying outside Canalon's mile-wide mind-control radius. Professional, battle-hardened, and apparently unfazed by the fact that her commanding officer was a gnome, Giros represented the best of what the Arbiters could become once freed from the Church's corruption.

BADUNKADONK

A telepathic octopod, or possibly a kraken, living in the sewers beneath Hope's Rest. Gem befriended Badunkadonk instantly upon entering the sewers during the Black Rock heist, declaring the creature her new favourite team member.

Kolo, seeing this developing friendship, immediately decided to shoot at Badunkadonk. Bucky caught the arrow. A standoff ensued. The alliance was nearly undone by the same impulse that had defined Kolo since Episode 1: if something exists, shoot it first and ask questions never.

In the bank above, Badunkadonk probed for minds through the sewer walls and found none in the Black Rock, confirming that the mind-controlled city was eerily, completely empty.

SHROOMY

A sentient, Kalimar-worshipping mushroom colony that narrated Episode 95 in its entirety,

writing in Burnie's stolen diary. Shroomy followed the party through the fungal forests on their descent to Kalimar's lava sanctum, providing running commentary on their behaviour with a mixture of admiration, hunger, and religious devotion.

Shroomy hoped the party would breathe in mushroom spores so it could spread mycelium tendrils through their corpses and absorb their nutrients. "Yum yum." It named a slug after Burnie. It observed Erin's dreams of corruption and the gnome's silly little habits. It noted that the human sat "ass backwards to vent farts out of crack in clearing" but still heard well. Every few sentences, unprompted: "All hail Kalimar."

Gerard the Hunter	The Vathos Boundary hunter who gave Pilch and Otoria the information on the southern wilds.
Hans Gruber	Full name of the mercenary leader behind the Tower of Imota Kan heist.
Diego Escobar	Leader of "a robbing hood" near Vathos Boundary. "Pretty boy got run over by horses and skewered in his own camp."
Henry & Henri	Henry: a competent dwarf who worked in Kolo's drug alchemy lab in Hope's Rest. Henri: Kolo's gabrin bin man, an "incompetent Gabrin swine that can't even take the bins out."
Hestor's Caravan	The caravan that carried the party across the land: leader Hestor; guards Leorable, Dukey, Dallius and Job; merchants Boamos, Tillie, Sabina, Maarah and Sidney.
Boa Sab	Jungle guide who led the party to the Tikki Tuk village, only to be slaughtered in the incident.
The Tribal Leader	Jungle tribal chief. Nice guy, hated magic, loved dancing.
Terry	Very friendly emancipated triceratops; went off to start a new life post-incident.
Trevor	Definitely not Terry's replacement. Currently assisting in carrying out goods, and trebuchet.
Codie	Sentient stone servant and caretaker of the Tower of Ruh'Breks.
Arbiter Killjoy	The Arbiter who captured Burnie and had him hung in the centre of Hope's Rest. The hanging did not take.
Martha Mayfire	Book Burner, Burnie's lover, killed in the purge. Her old crossbow, named Martha, passed to Pilch.
Lady Haremxes	The Masudan lady who kept Vu Dong as a pet before he joined the party.

MINOR FIGURES FROM THE PARTY'S RECORDS

The campaign wiki recorded a host of smaller names who never earned a full page but deserve to be remembered:

The continuation added its own cast of minor figures:

Jeremiah	Amnesiac survivor found in a stasis tube in Valklondar's mine. Believed he was a 24-year-old apprentice. Died on impact when the party fell into the games room.
Buchra	Snow leopard warrior of the Chesney Hawks. Exploded Martin into pieces during a sparring match.
Eric	Half-giant of the Chesney Hawks. Eaten whole by a boreworm; Riphard killed the boreworm and cut him out.
Krum	Goatkin tribesperson of the Chesney Hawks. Exme's "goat boyfriend," pressed for intelligence on tribal politics.
Ragnor & Vesh	Chesney Hawks hunter and fire mage respectively. Vesh was rude.
Calista & Michelle Devereaux	Erin's parents, who run the Midnight Pearl cabaret in Jecede.
The Adam-ants	A rival Varg tribe, named like all the tribes after pop acts. Ambushed the party and were wiped out entirely.

CHAPTER 4: GEAR

THE AIRSHIP GARY



BACKGROUND

The Good Airship Gary is the primary base of operations for the team. The group discovered the airship within the Tower of Ruh'Breks, an ancient wizard's hidden stronghold buried deep underground. Ruh'Breks himself, a dying sorcerer who had sealed himself away centuries ago, gifted the vessel to the party along with the legendary Puzzle Die. The ship is powered by spectral energy batteries, sentient ghost-like entities captured and contained within S.T.A.N.R.I.'s storage compartments.

Named after the group's beloved stone companion Gary, who sacrificed himself protecting the party in the jungles of South Africa, the airship became the symbol of the newly formed Gary Guild and the team's most prized possession.

The team have made a number of modifications to the ship over their time together, outfitting it with cannons, bomb bays, a smoke screen system, a reinforced hull, and an on-board workshop for Exme. Battle upgrades were completed during the Masuda campaign, and further modifications were made in Linderdorf.

The most significant upgrade came when Exme plugged the Puzzle Die of Ruh'Breks

directly into the ship's ghost engine, achieving hyper-speed travel that pinned the crew against their seats and allowed the party to cross Velterra in days rather than weeks, fast enough to recruit allies from Masuda, New Abbergast, and Logarsk before the Church could react. The ship's cargo hold was modified to carry the thirty-foot Stonecast Mech, which was dropped from the airship as a siege weapon during the assault on Seven's Spire.

FUNCTIONS

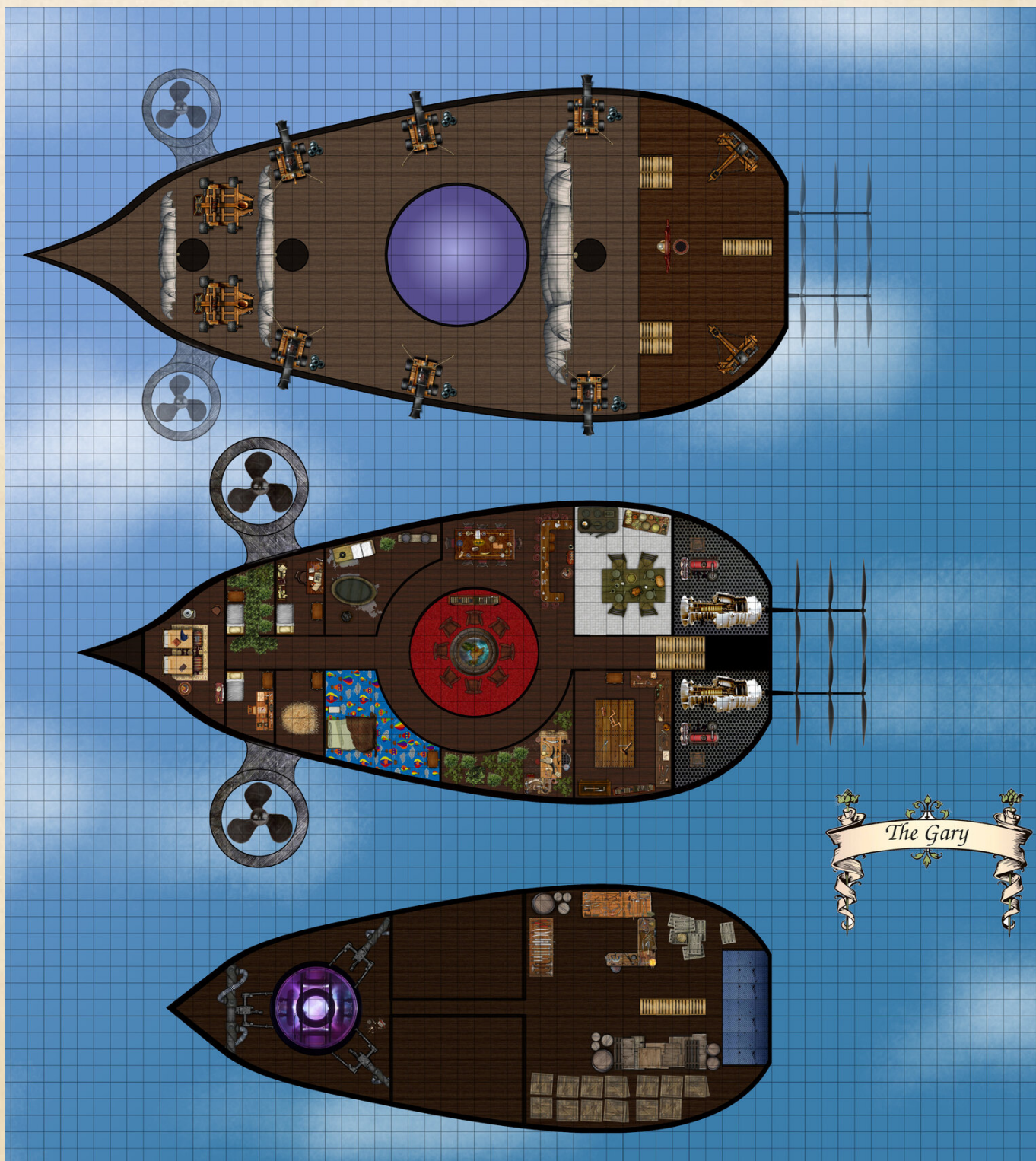
The ship serves as mobile headquarters, offering sleeping quarters, Exme's engineering workshop, storage for the party's arsenal, and a command deck. Its arsenal includes multiple cannons and a heavy forward-mounted weapon. Captain Stick, a sentient wooden figurehead, has been entrusted with command of the vessel since its discovery. S.T.A.N.R.I.'s on-board systems provide communications, navigation, and analytical support from the air.

DESTRUCTION

The Airship Gary was destroyed in Episode 103 during the Nautiloid attack on Jecede. When the githyanki vessel was crippled and began falling toward the city, Captain Stick took the helm and steered the burning airship directly into the Nautiloid, deflecting it from the populated harbour. Both vessels were destroyed on impact. Captain Stick went down with the ship.

The Gary had served the party from the jungles of South Africa to the skies above Jecede, across two campaigns and more miles than anyone cared to count. Its loss, alongside Burnie and Erin in the same battle, marked the end of the party as it had been.





S.T.A.N.R.I



BACKGROUND

S.T.A.N.R.I was created by Exme as a battle companion. S.T.A.N.R.I originally used a human brain as a counter balance which resulted in a large amount of leaking.

S.T.A.N.R.I started off life as a small robo-cub called Stanri Mk 0, as Exme continued to develop her plans for what he would finally become. Baby Stanri was a small, loveable robot with a tendency to leak (this was due to the ongoing putrefaction of a human brain that had been placed inside Stanri under the mistaken idea that it would act as a balancing measure).

During the siege of Ruh'Breks tower, the workshop managed to complete the constructions of S.T.A.N.R.I Mk I and dispatched it immediately through a teleporter. Stanri's brain unit was revealed to be a battle computer that had been collecting battle and movement data for months now. This was transferred into S.T.A.N.R.I and functioned as its main CPU.

FUNCTIONS

Stanri Mk 0 had limited functionality and little to no battle capability. He could respond to basic

commands and carry a limited amount of weight.

S.T.A.N.R.I Mk I was a fully operational combat unit that was able to enter battle, following commands of his master Exmerah, as well as other team members. S.T.A.N.R.I was able to make attacks using his two powerful claws and devastating bite attack. In addition to his usefulness as a battle companion, S.T.A.N.R.I was able to offer a range of additional analytical capabilities, including an improved ofalcatory sensing unit, on-board item analysis and communications with the airship.

During the Linderdorf campaign, Exme provided plans to a team of gnomish engineers who managed to convert S.T.A.N.R.I into his final form. Taking on the shape of a tiger in honour of their former companion Mr Tiger, and making use of the new access to Excallibrum, Exme and the Gnomes were able to enhance S.T.A.N.R.I's functionality and turn him into a battlesuit for Exme. In his so-called 'Mecha-form' Exme was able to wear S.T.A.N.R.I as a suit of armour, with his onboard power generators providing enhancements to C.E.D.R.I.C to increase their firepower significantly.

Following the release of The Seven, S.T.A.N.R.I was gifted consciousness as a reward for his efforts in bringing back the Gods to the world.

THE CONTINUATION

In the four years after the Spire, S.T.A.N.R.I found a new purpose. When Exme founded The Delilah Hardstone School for Especially Gifted Girls That Everyone Ignores Even Although Everything is Literally on Fire, S.T.A.N.R.I served on the staff. After Exme's erasure from existence, S.T.A.N.R.I took over as headmaster, the sentient mecha-bear running a school for gifted girls being, somehow, the least strange thing about the continuation.





THE ARMORY

C.E.D.R.I.C



“Collaborative Experimental Destruction and Rapid Immolation Contraption.” Exme’s masterwork, a sentient electric railgun and linear accelerator that grants significant improvements to the wielder’s perception, actively retargets low-damage shots, and greatly increases the user’s speed. C.E.D.R.I.C has “a funny voice that makes me go all trembly,” according to Exme.

The weapon’s most notable achievement was vaporising Arbiter Khan’s head during the assault on Seven’s Spire, a shot that saved Kiros’s life and turned the tide of the prison-level battle.

GODBRINGER

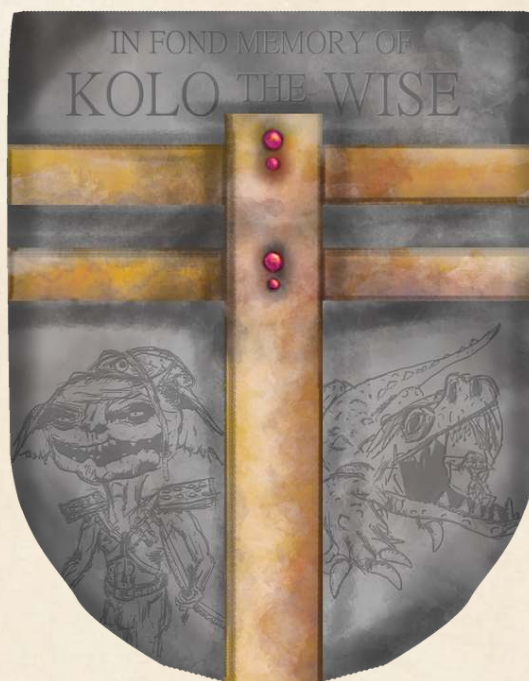


A weapon of immense divine power, Godbringer earned its name through its role in the party’s quest to break the seal and return the gods to the world. Forged from Excaliburum,

the legendary star-metal capable of harming those blessed by the Inthun, by Google Von Maccherstein’s team using knowledge recovered from the Bright Bart Forge, Godbringer represents the culmination of the party’s long search for the materials and craftsmen needed to create a weapon that could stand against the Church’s most powerful agents.

Wielded by Myron, Godbringer’s defining moment came in the Clawtech Arena in Linderdorf, where Myron launched himself into the air and brought the weapon down in a final strike that bisected the thirty-foot Stonecast Mech entirely, a blow that silenced the stadium before three-quarters of the crowd erupted in chants of “Emancipation.”

MYRON’S SHIELD



A sturdy shield bearing the symbol of an Arbiter, carried by Myron throughout the Masuda campaign and beyond. The shield has seen countless battles and bears the scars of every encounter, from orc axes to Inquisitor shadow-blades.

SHOCKING GLOVES



Crafted from the "Lord of Lightning" - an electric beast. A pair of gloves attached to a small device on the hip that give their wielders the ability to deliver shocks.

Can deliver a powerful electric shock, recharging after the wielder has moved 100 yards. Secondly can be used to stabilise a dying creature.

BLACK SABBATH

A two-handed pronged shadow-blade forged from shadow sorcery and the Stone of Unthala. Pilcheur's primary weapon during his time with the group, Black Sabbath was born from the dark powers that possessed him and grew in strength as his corruption deepened.

The blade could surge shadows to inflict heavy damage to a target, though it was sadly unstable and potentially poisoned the wielder. After Pilch's death, Black Sabbath was reforged into the katana Iron Maiden.

IRON MAIDEN

A one-handed katana reforged from Black Sabbath. Iron Maiden was the blade wielded by the singing swordswoman Lark when she beheaded Lady Otorio during the Die Hard heist at the Tower of Imota Kan, the group's first real loss.

After being claimed by the party, the weapon retained some magical properties, though it became less potent after Pilch's death severed its connection to the shadow sorcery that had forged it.

BOW OF THE BASTARD



An highly accurate short-bow, believed to have belonged to (and potentially been crafted by) a halfling thief centuries ago - nicknamed "The Little Bastard". It has secondary properties related to hurting a target for more damage.

In addition to being a magical shortbow, if the wielder manages to hit a surprised target that target takes additional damage (3d6) - but the wielder of the bow will be less charismatic (disadvantage on charisma rolls) until they next have a short rest, as everyone views them as a bastard.

HAMMER OF THE GODS

Used in ancient Crusades by the Zealot Arbiter Elron, when he travelled east to Masuda, said to defeat an Inthun infused Varg in a single blow (so may be made of starmetal).

EXTRACT FROM "THE LANDS OF THE GODLESS"

Excursions to the East have met with mixed success over the years. There has always been a strong desire amongst the faithful to bring the light of the gods to the heathen lands. The question of how best to approach this has led to many missteps and failings. I write this treatise in the hopes that future generations will learn from the mistakes of the past in future endeavours.

Firstly, knowledge of the culture of the lands is essential to the success of any conversion. The first voyagers failed when they approached the peoples of Masuda in the same way they approached those of Nanduan. While they may look similar, the cultures vary in insurmountable ways. The people of Nanduan have been resistant to all forms of preaching, while a foothold has eventually been made in Masuda albeit in small ways.

More success has been found with peaceful approaches to the eastern lands. Much can be learned from the failed crusade of the zealot arbiter Elron. He bore the Hammer

of the Gods, a weapon so powerful it struck down even the Inthun-infused terror of Hunthar Varg and ended the third Varghold incursion in a single fiery blow. With such power behind him and an army of arbiters, Elron sailed East to deliver 'holy justice' to the unbelievers.

The Masudan response to such an invasion was, by all accounts, as brutal as it was swift. Few survivors returned, and those who did told tale of a dawn assault by incredibly skilled swordsmen with lightning fast blades. As they tried to react it soon became clear that Elron and all the commanding officers had been slain during the night, their throats slit by assassins that slipped past even the most perceptive guards.

The Hammer of the Gods itself was lost during that fateful voyage, a lesson in humility to all our followers. Let it be known that when we approach with brutality the Gods will show us no clemency. We must spread our message with the light and fairness in which it was intended.

THE STONE KNIFE

Named not because it's made of stone, but because of its utility. Resembling more a chisel than a knife, the handle is flared slightly at the base to support a hammer, and the tip is a flat edge making it easy to carve off slabs of stone. The guard is asymmetrical, one side ending in a flat edge and the other a sharp cylindrical point, to allow tapping for precise stonework. The blade itself has that classic patterned look that shows it contains Excalibur or its alloy, and ancient dwarven runes are faintly etched along the blade's length. In spite of these it is exquisitely beautiful and very, very sharp.

In addition to being a powerful weapon, the Stone Knife can be used to magically shape stone once per day. Recovered from beneath the Tom'ardy Mountains, it became Burnie's signature tool, he used it to seal the Kalimar summoning pit beneath Hope's Rest and, later, doorways inside the Seven's Spire itself.

KOLO'S MECHANICAL BOW

Exmerah's posthumous gift to her twin brother. A cabled bow with a power pack, found waiting for Kolo when he was restored in his construct body after Exme's erasure. She had built it for him before the descent into Kalimar's lair, knowing that one way or another, he would need a weapon when he woke.

The bow debuted during the Inquisitor fight on the Jecede railway roof and served Kolo through the Black Rock heist and beyond. Like everything Exme built, it worked beautifully.

MISCELLANEOUS ITEMS

THE DIE OF RUH'BREX



A legendary magical cube created by the ancient sorcerer Ruh'Breks and recovered from his hidden tower. The Die contains dozens of magical functions accessible by manipulating its faces into different configurations. It possesses a degree of autonomous intelligence, Exme could swear it was looking back at her, and can reveal the locations of other magical artefacts. It was the Die that pointed the party toward the Hammer of the Gods in Masuda, and later located the source of the seal at Seven's Spire.

In the final campaign, Exme discovered higher-level functions: plugging the cube into the airship's ghost engine achieved hyper-speed travel, and the Die could generate an interplanar pocket dimension with a door, used to shelter rescued prisoners inside Seven's Spire. It also summoned Korg, an Earth Elemental who speaks common and lifts heavy things before being sucked back into the cube.

In the continuation, the Die's most devastating function was finally used. The Wish, the only wish in existence with a ten-thousand-year cooldown, was spent by Exmerah in Kalimar's lava sanctum to heal the dying Myron and restore Kolo's trapped soul simultaneously. The cost was absolute: Exme was erased from existence. The Die's wish function will not recharge for another ten millennia.

No.	Function
1	Lockdown
2	Locate Artefact
6	Invisibility
7	Summon TEST Goat
8	Fly
11	Motivator
13	Teleport
14	Rhu'Brex's Portable Domicile
17	Minor Time Stop
18	Increase Travel Speed
19	Healing
H3	Summon Monster
H5	Globe of Invulnerability
H8	Wish (10,000 year cooldown)
??	Summon Korg (Earth Elemental)
??	Interplanar Pocket Dimension
??	Locate Seal Source
??	Hyper-Speed (via ghost engine)

STONE OF UNTHALA



A big stone, about the size of two fists, retrieved from the skull-shaped ice Temple of Unthala during the party's first real mission. The Stone served as the group's primary means of communication with Lazarus, allowing them to speak with the devil across dimensional boundaries. It may also enhance the powers of those near it, though the exact mechanism was never fully understood.

RING OF DEADLY VISAGE

A ring that makes the wearer look corpsefied. Flukily found in a mine.

SLAB OF INTHUN

An enchanted stone slab of immense and terrible power, discovered deep in the basement of the church in Logarsk. The Inthun either kills the user strapped to it or imbues them with awesome power, strength, innate magical abilities, and nigh-on invulnerability. It works better with children, a fact that the Marshall of Logarsk was exploiting when the party found him.

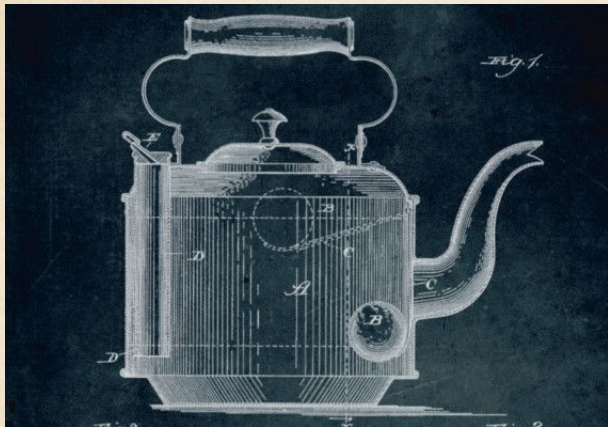
The Inquisitors' immunity to conventional weapons derives from the Inthun's blessing, making it the indirect source of much of the Church's military dominance. Only Excalibur, the star-metal from meteorites, can harm those touched by its power.

EXTRACT FROM "ON POWER AND MAGICK"

In debates amongst scholars between the dangers and power of magic the slab of enchanted rock known as the Inthun is one of the most contentious. Its power is undeniably vast, imbuing a being with great strength, innate magical abilities and nigh-on invulnerability, however the risks are great. Most who bind themselves to the stone in search of power and rendered asunder by the power within. Few are willing to risk near certain death to achieve this power.

Some scholars assert that a younger body may be more adaptable to the flow of power; however what mother would sacrifice their child to such terrible danger? There are further concerns around the effects of the power on the mind. Those few who have come through the rite unscathed have a tendency to madness - few will forget the ravages of Gillius, a man so corrupted by power that the gods themselves had to intervene to stop him. Other scholars, of course, argue that only those who are unstable and unhinged dare to attempt to gain the power. There are too few cases for a stringent argument to be made either way, and the opportunity for true study is unlikely to arise.

ASSASSIN'S TEAPOT



A teapot with a normal chamber (for tea or similar) and a second, secret one, that contains poison. Uniquely, this teapot produces its own poison. The poison from this pot can be served, dealing hefty damage to the imbiber (5d10 - DC15 can save for half, fall unconscious for 1 hour on fail) or applied to a weapon (or 20 pieces of ammunition), where it deals 1d6 poison damage. The poison evaporates after an hour - whether in the teapot, a container or applied to a weapon.

THE BURNER



The original book burners lighter, though it may in fact have been more a tool for study and exploration - has various powers around flame and bears an inscription in ancient velterran.

The lighter can produce a small ball of flame that emits light and can be hurled offensively (Produce Flame). Additionally, once per day if the flame is wafted under a weapon (elemental weapon(fire)) or some ammunition (flame arrows) it will imbue them with flame. Lastly, if the inscription is read, any writing that was written to intentionally mislead or obfuscate the truth will glow red if under the flame of this light.

EXCALIBUR (AKA STARMETAL)



A gift from the gods, a special metal or alloy that can be found in falling stars - called Meteorites - seems capable of harming those

blessed by the Inthun, so hopefully makes potent weapons. Needs a master smith

EXTRACT FROM SCRAPS OF TEXT

The rarest of metals, the starmetal known as Exallibrium... only known source being from the meteorite that fell... only the most master forgers can work the metal...one of the few known things that can harm...this gift from the gods...indeed the Inthun itself...seek to grow rich from the rare metal they have founded themselves above...must take great care...but the rewards are magnificent.

THE ARMOURY OF SIN

The divine war gear worn by the god Sinn when he last fought Canalon: a helm, sword, armour, shield, a pendant that grants rest, and two nets. The Armoury was hidden beneath the Black Rock bank in Hope's Rest, sealed behind acid-filled pots, three skull locks, and a mural riddle about the wise Kimicho.

The party heisted the vault in the final arc, cracking it with the code 51624. The Armoury was the only gear in existence proven to have harmed Canalon, and donning it was the last thing the party did before setting out for the final battle.

KALIMEL

Kalimar's flesh-warping goo, used by Valkar Varg to breed super-soldiers called Pact warriors. The Trials that produced them killed ninety-nine in every hundred subjects. Krangle, a goblin alchemist who had tormented the twins as children, was engineering a controllable version for Valkar before the party hired him to brew an antidote instead. Exme carried a vial of the antidote in the hope it might cure Kolo, though his restoration ultimately came through the Wish rather than chemistry.

RINGS OF MIND SHIELDING

Lazarus's parting gifts to the remnant party, protecting the wearers from Canalon's mass mind control. Without them, the party would have joined the blank-eyed population of Hope's Rest the moment they arrived. Jetpacks were also provided, because Lazarus has always understood the importance of a dramatic entrance.

CHAPTER 5: EPISODES

EPISODE 1: RIPHARD BEGINS

Welcome to the world of Velterra, domain of the Seven, who rule over all from afar through the constant vigilance of the Church.

"In Hope's Rest, the largest city of the Empire of the Seven, a cloaked man dashes over rooftops, a half-burnt tome tucked under one arm as a group of mercenaries chase him. Abruptly he comes to a dead end, a roof with nowhere to leap to and nowhere to hide. He turns to face his attackers and reaches for his weapons, the book slipping from his grasp as he does so. In a moment of panic he spins to grab for the book, losing his balance and toppling from the roof as the mercenaries swing their blades at his back."

"In the north, a pair of goblin twins flee the perils of Valkar Varg's reign, seeking the freedom and new life the south can bring. They are surrounded by brutal tribesmen and vicious axes on all sides, angered by their desertion. As the two goblins look at each other in desperation and anger they nod, the girl raising a long rifle that quivers with electricity, the boy raising a small hunting bow and quickly loosing several arrows. As their enemies close in the bow-user pulls a vial of some mysterious viscous liquid as his twin sister unclips a thrumming round device from her belt. In moments, a huge explosion rips through the area."

"To the south, a dwarf pastor sits hunched over a tome, scribbling notes. He raises his head as he hears the slow creak of his door, aware that he is expecting no visitors. He stands and turns to see a hulking figure behind him, armoured with a long-barellled gun at his side. The dwarf rests a trembling hand on his holster as a man who should not exist stands before him. Terse words are exchanged, accusations and threats. The dwarf grits his teeth and sets his feet, drawing the pistol at his side as his opponent does the same. From outside, the sound of a single shot being fired can be heard."

"To the East, a figure wrapped in cloth and strange garments sits quietly in a harbour tavern in Port Averdale, recently arrived on the continent from a long voyage. She sits with an untouched mug of unappealing ale in front of her as three thugs approach the table. They

slam down a parchment on the table with a picture and a hefty figure. In a flash she is to her feet, blade drawn and two of the men sliced apart on the ground. She faces the remaining thug who whistles and a stream of men pour into the building from all around. Outnumbered by scores and with a demand the surrender, she chooses the only option she knows. Honour."

A group of strangers meet up in a featureless, polished stone room, none fully understanding what has brought them there. An elephantine creature (Meredith) beckons them through a mysteriously appearing door into a plush office where a red skinned man wearing a human face mask welcomes them.

The man explains that he is called Lazarus and that the group have all recently died. They have been brought together, here, and given a second chance at life in exchange for carrying out a mission to destroy the Church Upon asking for proof Pilch is shown the full, gory reality of their situation through a window into hell Lazarus explains that the group must obtain the Stone of Anthala from the temple of XXX and our given basic directions. This ancient relic will be the source of future communications with Lazarus and his means of issuing further instructions. They are warned not to gain the attention of the Church.

The group agree to carry out the task and are transported into a cavern, where winter clothes and supplies await them. After some brief introductions Exme opens the cave door to reveal they are in a snowy wilderness The group spend two days walking South (Kolo relieves Pilch of 15 gp during the trip) until they reach the town of Vathos Boundary. During a surprise fight with some wolves the two goblins disappear. Riphard finds that his gun has become faulty but is able to restore it to proper working order with a good clean. The remaining members enter the town, Pilch in disguise, and go about making inquiries. Riphard and Ontario make a visit to a local smith, not Gerard, who is able to sell bullets and black powder. Onatrio gets the lay of the land, and discovers that the locals are fine with the Church.

The two goblins, desperate to perform their own investigation and disguised as a single

person in an overcoat, put Pilch's money to work inebriating an entire titty bar, whilst loudly exclaiming their adventurous intentions. Otoria witnesses a man being beaten to death in the street.

Several towns folk inform the party about the dreaded masked "tikk-tukks" that lie to the South of the town, these are small bear like creatures with face masks.

The party is reunited in the titty bar. After a brief altercation between Kolo and Pilch concerning some mislocated funds, Exme and Riphard discuss the finer points of owning firearms and Esme is thrilled to get her first real look at a Church gun.

Ontario and Pilchard Meet a hunter named Gerard who gives a brief description of the location of the temple of Anthala lost in the south. Kolo discovers more about what eats

people, and gives Pilchs name as a point of contact. Due to the incredible generosity of Pilch's money, the group are offered free board at the titty bar and take the opportunity to rest up.

The next day they make their way out of town. As they leave, an explosion rips through the local stable, decimating several horses and destroying the building. Riphard is unable to identify the source of the explosion, however Kolo is quick to demonstrate the kindness and superiority of Goblin-folk by using the rest of Pilch's money to compensate the stable owner for the damage. Along with casting wild aspersions to the gathered crowd as to who might be the culprit, ie only group who has access to black powder (Church).

The group make their way south to the temple...



EPISODE 2: IN THE TIKI, TIKI, TIKI, TIKI, TIKI ROOM

he year is 6653 CC (Church Calendar). In their search for the Stone of Un'thala, the group set off Southwards from Vathos Boundary following the directions given to them by the hunter, Gerard.

After a day's travelling the group settle down for the night with Kolo and Pilch taking the first watch. The tension and hatred between the two is palpable and they stare intently at each other. Pilch is briefly distracted, which gives Kolo the chance to disappear. As Pilch desperately searches for his goblin nemesis, Kolo takes the opportunity to attempt to relieve a sleeping Otoria of some of her gold. As he reaches into her pocket Otoria awakes and deals a deadly blow to the goblin, knocking him unconscious.

Otoria throws the bundle of goblin into his tent, awaking his sister in the process, who mistakenly believes it is her turn to perform lookout duties. She sets down opposite Pilch and resumes the goblin-human stare off. Pilch inquires about Exme's "gun", but is not prepared for the onslaught of technical information that Exme is only too glad to discuss. The conversation ends with Pilch being none the wiser, embarrassed by his own vast ignorance. When Exme returns to her tent Kolo has vanished.

The group push on towards their goal. After some time they arrive at a large skull shaped ice temple that lies across a perilous looking bridge. Exme refuses to enter without her brother and stubbornly resists the efforts of Riphard to carry her along. Otoria takes charge and heads into the temple.

As the group enter the temple they find themselves in a large spherical chamber, and have their first meeting with the dreaded TikkiTukks™: a race of small bear like creatures with fearsome, culturally insensitive masks. Battle ensues, with the goblins arriving to witness the felling of the final enemy. An investigation of the stone plinth at the centre of the chamber shows that the stone is missing. The goblins remove some masks from the fallen enemies revealing their ghastly faces with sharp, pointed teeth.

The reassembled group head deeper into the temple in search of the stone. Otoria takes a moment to collect some herbs being cultivated by the TikkiTukks™.

Kolo unlocks a locked door, which reveals a room full of small boxes that contain some

treasure which the group splits up.** Pilch** attempts to reclaim some of the money that he had "misplaced" in the previous session, shamefully accusing the goblins of thievery. Otoria throws him an azure gem to appease him. As the gold is shared out Riphard warns the goblins: "Next time you want your fair share, join the battle at the right time".

The goblins attempt to trick another room of TikkiTukks™ by donning masks. Kolo is able to speak in the TikkiTukk™ language. Exme, not knowing of her brothers ability, attempts a bold deception which ultimately backfires when the two are brought to their knees by the devastating attacks from a room full of TikkiTukks™. The group defeat the TikkiTukks™ and enjoy a short rest to recuperate.

As they continue to explore,** Kolo** pulls Exme back, warning her of a strange tangle of silk threads that hang in a corridor. The group is set upon by a giant spider.** Pilch** is able to set fire to the webbing that covers the walls and ceiling, which keeps the spider at bay, but also traps Otoria on the wrong side of the flames as she delivers her swordy brand of justice. After a short struggle the spider explodes in a mass of ichor.

Riphard is having gun troubles.

Continuing on, Riphard activates an ancient trap that fires darts at the group. However, the goblins are not affected since they are of a similar height to the TikkiTukks™; the darts passing harmlessly over them.

The group manage to fight a large room full of TikkiTukks™, slaughtering their leader (who begins the battle with the glorious war cry 'tikki tukk doumo arigatou tikki tukk') and claiming his glorious mask as their own. Even with their Tikkitactics and Packtics they are no match for the group.

Riphard is still having gun troubles.

The impotent Riphard falls in battle. Kolo kindly revives him whilst pocketing 5 gp, going easy on the man he has no real qualms with yet.

Further battles ensue. Otoria falls. In a desperate attempt to revive her Exme accidentally punches her in the face, pushing her one step closer to death. Kolo looks on in dismay. Riphard is able to revive her, and the two share a tender moment as he lays his hands on her for "a little too long".

Freshly rested the group find a corridor of doors. In full synchronisation, the crew knock down 4 doors only to find, to Kolo's dismay,

more doors inside: "More DOORS. TRICKSY, TRICKSY!!"

Riphard takes a moment to explore and comes across a fresh water well. He drinks from it and feels the benefits of its cool water, but already feeling 100% despite the recent battles, does not fully appreciate the benefits the refreshing beverage provides, and so does not share this wisdom with the group.

The noise of the group knocking/cutting in half doors causes the TikkiTukks™ to bear down upon them.

Riphard is still still having gun troubles. Exasperated, he makes one last effort and is finally rewarded for his patience and persistence, destroying what once was a young TikkiTukk's™ face in one well placed and devastating shot.

The group leave one TikkiTukk™ alive to interrogate and help them locate the stone. Whilst passed out, the TikkiTukk™ is tied up and hung upside down. The two goblins don their masks and get ready to intimidate him. Kolo leads the interrogation. The TikkiTukk™ is keen not to die and quickly reveals that the stone is held in the chief's room. In exchange for the location of the stone of Un'thala, Kolo promises the TikkiTukk™ that he can be the new TikkiTukk™ chief. ** Pilch** is also offered as a "sweetener".

Kolo is keen to take the prisoner along, but Otoria cryptically states that she is to "have her way with him". Pilch, greedy for the prisoner's vitality through his curse attempts to end its life. Otoria is able to block the first blow, but misses the second, which slices open the TikkiTukk's™ throat. In a cool rage Otoria pins Pilch up against the wall with her large sword and warns him: "I have to work with you, we have shared goals. But you will not do that again". Pilch is filled with an intense terror at these words.

The group collect themselves and prepare to head to the chief's lair to collect their prize



EPISODE 3: THE HORSE WHISPERER

The group begin in the bedrooms of the Tiki Tuks after the brutal, and controversial, murder of the "friendly" Tiki Tuk by Philo.

The goblins, unimpressed with this behaviour and sympathetic to the Tiki Tuks, head towards the treasure room.

A brief encounter in the water well room see Riphard unsuccessfully attempt to hold Pilch's head underwater for more details on his violent nature, but Pilch is able to bat him away, swinging his head up in a glorious little mermaid inspired fashion. When asked why he killed the Tiki Tuk, Pilch looks genuinely conflicted.

Riphard wanders down an unknown corridor, much to Kolo's chagrin. Riphard explains that while Kolo just wants to find the treasure they know about, Riphard wants to find "the treasure that we don't know about". Riphard is rewarded for his inquisitiveness by finding a stable full of boar and two more Tiki Tuks. Kolo is able to deescalate any possible fight using his language/diplomatic skills, thinking quickly on his feet about an alibi where he is actually visiting his uncle. The goblins laugh at the success of their favourite trick.

Riphard discovers another large corridor, this one lined with spiked walls and a mossy floor.

Exme is able to discern that this used to be a booby-trapped room, however, it has long since fallen into disrepair. However, she does notice the strange fungus growing on the floor and harvests as much as she can along with her brother. Riphard is asked to help, but stubbornly refuses, not being one to do groundwork for such lowly creatures as goblins. Pilch is asked and curiously finds himself accepting the instructions.

The goblins head to the chief's rooms. Exme discovers "nothing at all" in a room that she inspects, whilst Kolo recovers a strange, smooth, and intricately engraved stone under a pile of furs in the chief's bedroom.

For some reason Pilch decides to argue that this might not be the fancy stone we have been sent here to find. Riphard queries just how many fancy looking stones Pilch thinks Tiki Tuks will have. Exme fumbles through her bag for a while, eventually pulling out a strange device which she passes over the stone. It delivers a small printed out piece of tape in Goblinese which she eyes before confirming that it is indeed the stone of Un'thala. Otoria is not surprised as she feels that most normal stones would not have received such careful treatment and preparation. The goblins inform the group that it is time to sleep, but the rest of the group resist the idea.

The group take some food from the stores, but are urged by Kolo to leave some for the Tiki Tuks. Kolo also leaves a message saying "nice to see you uncle".

Pilch is racist.

The group travel for half a day, back towards Vathos Boundary, Exme noticeably struggling with her large and heavy bag. The group set up camp. Exme disappears for a short while and returns with herbs that she starts combining with the fungus in a small pestle and mortar. The entire group finds themselves falling asleep.

During their sleep they share a common dream in which Lazarus speaks to them and congratulates them on their progress so far. He lays out the next challenge, which is to head north to Hope's Rest. He reveals Pilch perhaps has the closest connection to his kind. He instructs the group that they are to set up base in this liberal township, and will require money and transport to further their interests. The dream fades around the chuckles of Meredith.

The non-goblins in the group feel weary and drained.** Pilch** deduces that they may be suffering from Zukor's Rot as a result of being

shot with ancient darts in the Temple of Un'thala.

Exme hands Pilch a single packet of grey paste. She thanks him for his help in gathering the fungus, but berates him for his treatment of the murdered Tiki Tuk.

The group travel back to town and Otoria begins making inquiries concerning the exploding stable. Kolo and Exme mysteriously disappear. It is revealed that on top of this disaster, the town is now suffering from a spate of horse robberies, including those that led a caravan which is rumoured to be travelling to the north.

The group visit Black Smith the blacksmith where Kolo, mysteriously reappearing, requests new daggers. Exme, also mysteriously reappearing, attempts to hire the workshop to complete a project. Smith is initially dismissive, however his mind is changed rapidly when offered an ornate, solid gold necklace in return. The goblins begin their work, Exme concentrating hard on her work, and Kolo jumping maniacally on the bellows and hitting things with a hammer. The remaining members head to the titty bar.

Pilch tries some new, innovative ways of begging - he attempts hawks the Tiki masks as blood money, and gets a free drink from other alt-right extremists, but is told to sell the masks to the captain of the guard.

Riphard follows the blacksmith home and, once he has gone to bed, breaks into the man's home and steals the necklace back. The rest of the group is unaware of this.

The group meet up in the morning and Riphard inquires where to fence sell "totally legitimate jewelry" in the town. He is directed to a jewelry shop where he is given a reduced price for the necklace. Shops have to make a profit, so that is completely normal practice and not a reflection on Riphard's bargaining skills.

The group head to the city guards offices to inquire about potential jobs and the stable mystery, that isn't really that much of a mystery when you think about it because it was probably certainly a black powder gang or church related jobby.

They meet the half orc captain of the guard Urnok and his troll "friend?" Gumshoe. The group discusses local issues and learns more about how they may secure passage to the North. Kolo is a good detective goblin. Riphard assures people he is a real pastor. Pilch sells 6 Tikki Tuk masks.

The following jobs are highlighted:

Giant boar - Farmsteads in the North offering 50 gp to kill it.

"Jennie's girls" - Ex-whores who turned to crime after their profession was officially outlawed.

Spread like herpes through the empire and can most likely be found to the north. Their leader is a woman called May or "some bitch called May". The group is told t'arrest her, May.

The SRA - Small Rights Activists. A collection of, mainly, gnomes and halflings who perform terrorists acts in their most-likely justified quest for improving the rights of smaller folk. Leader is Razzle Backshine, a gnome with a penchant for exploding things in people's faces. Also spread out through empire.

Diego Escabar and his Merry Men - A charming half elf who claims to steal from the rich and give to the poor, but doesn't actually do the key last bit. Likely located in woodlands nearby. This is a local group.

Jobs are paid at a going rate of 5gp per severed left ear. Riphard wants to provide scalps, but is informed by Urnok that scalps are too easy to forge. Riphard accepts this explanation, explaining to the group that ears have a unique print, like fingers, which can be compared to the ear-print database the chief almost certainly keeps for this very purpose.

The gabrins try to turn Pilch in to the guards as Diego, but are unsuccessful. Riphard wonders whether Diego's men would live in a sort-of ghetto, a "robbing hood" if you will.

Pilch points out that it may be useful to try and recruit these groups, or at least align their interests with our own, and work together against the church.

Kolo asks Pilch if he has had sex. He replies that he totally has.

Riphard does not want to arouse suspicion and tries to persuade the group to let him visit the local pastor by himself. After some initial reservations the group allow him several minutes alone before they also insists on seeing the pastor themselves for no discernible reason or purpose.

Riphard's meeting with the pastor gets off to a tense start. "Are you here to help me?". "Quite the opposite". "You're here to hinder me?". Riphard questions the pastor on "the inquisition", but the pastor bats away his inquiries as mere tall tales. Riphard attempts to show the pastor proof of the inquisition by showing him the fatal wound he received that sent him to hell, but upon lifting his shirt finds

his body shows no signs of trauma at all. The pastor tells Riphard he should ignore these scare stories. Riphard replies that in fact it is the pastor who should not ignore the warning signs. The rest of the group is unaware of this.

Riphard storms out and walks past the group without a word, looking very pissed off. The group take this as a sign to enter themselves.

Otoria and Pilch question the pastor, who has suddenly developed a tremendous stutter for some reason, and learn some things about how the Church operates, predominantly linked to their communication channels.

Riphard looks at boobs, too cheap pious to pay for a touch.

The group end up in the titty bar where Kolo is able to charm/seduce the busty barkeeper into revealing that she used to know May, back in the day. She reveals that May can be expected to be found to the east of the First River. The lady, flushed with lust towards the sweet-talking Kolo, retires to a back room to cool down. Kolo mysteriously disappears again.

The group spend a final night in the titty bar before setting off on their next adventure. As they sleep Lazarus visits them again to tell them that now they are in possession of the stone, some members may find themselves more attuned to any pre-existing magical conditions, but that this shouldn't affect their premiums.



EPISODE 4: WHORES OR BOARS?



Returning to Vathos Boundary, Otoria and her assorted friends are seeking

passage North, and have been given a list of gangs that may have stolen all the horses.

They wake up in Marcey's and try to decide how to proceed.

Otoria wants to infiltrate the Heights Rights lot. Gabrins wants to hassle the Fancy Men.

Riphard sits in the pub, the Gabrins run off.

Riphard wants to walk 6 months instead of finding any horses. He sits in the pub by himself to try and achieve this.

Gabrins and Otoria else goes to see the Blacksmith who's real sad. Apparently his necklace has got stolen. Otoria wants to find it. They go off to the Blacksmith's house and look for clues.

Pilch and Riphard bond.

CSI:Vathos ensues at Black Smith's house. Apparently the necklace was stolen by one non-small person. The fidelity of the blacksmith remains in question.

Kolo looks for criminals to ask questions.

Riphard is pissed. It's, like, 12:30. Pilch leaves him to his own demons and goes to wander the streets aimlessly. Then, all of a sudden he discovers something important.

Meanwhile, or earlier or something, Otoria talks to the police man and he suggests she checks the local jewelers, so see if whoever stole it tried to sell it. She says she'll have a look.

Gabrins go into the Mos Easley Cantena, and talk to a big orc man. Kolo tries to be tough, but is absolutely not that and gets thrown around and nearly thrown out. Then Esme gets involved and is intimidating as fuck. She tries to get the orc man to play cards to win information about the Fancy Man, but that doesn't work. There's all sorts of back and forth.

Then, a "Fancy" Woman appears (not a "Fancy Woman"). She offers to help the Gabrins if they come to their hideout. They say they're going to gather everyone up and head out with her.

Pilchard found an old man. He talks to him about how things aren't as good as they used to be. There's also not as young a man. Their names are Casper and Germaine. They are woodsmen. He scares them by being a crazy person. There is no inquisition. He asks them if they know any benders. Pilch is a weirdo.

Otoria finds the jeweler, and the necklace, and the truth.

Riphard is pissed. Then he's outside in the alley, propped up against the bins, with Otoria trying to kill him, and then Gabrins trying to steal his money. The Gabrins want to keep him alive, but Riphard himself doesn't seem to have as much interest in that and tries to shoot Kolo. He misses, and Pilch turns up. Riphard tries to run and is instantly struck down. It's tragic.

Otoria starts dragging him to the police station. Half way there she's convinced to take him the blacksmith's instead.

The blacksmith convinces Otoria not to take Riphard to the police, when the group tell him everything, because he would be killed by the church, attracting a lot of attention. Otoria wanted to cut him into little bits, so she's not super happy about him getting away scot free.

The group give the blacksmith a shit ton of money, then go back to the pub. Riphard sleeps his pain away.

Gabrins stack up inside a coat, and everyone goes into the alley to meet the lady.

The lady is totally fooled by the Gabrins in the coat, for real. She insists on the group helping her or some shit before she tells them where the fancy men are.

The group head North, out of town, to Whorecity. Then west, then through some hills, then some hillocks. Then there's a camp. It's a little bit secret. Otoria and the lady (who's called Delilah) get on like a horse on fire (like what happened in the stables that time).

WELCOME TO WHORECITY!

The group get taken to the Queen Whore, Mae. They brag about their wealth, insult Mae's fashion sense and then finally get round to actually talking about why they're there.

Djago and Mae don't seem like besties, but Delilah jokes that they are. What's up with that?

Exme wants to know what whoring is.

Otoria wants to know where the horses are. Mae implies, but does not say, that she knows where they are, but says they need to do work for her first.

Kolo makes a deal. No one's quite sure what it is.

Apparently the whores buys their boots in bulk. They're damn fine boots. We should get some.

Mae admits the Fancy Men have all the horses, and says she'll tell them where to find the Heights Rights lot, so they can kill them, and

then she'll tell them we're the Fancy Men are, so that they can kill them.

Otoria tells Mae not to tell anyone they're there. Esme tells Mae that they're terrorists planning to take down the state.

Everything seems fine.

Mae has work to plan.

The gang manage to get two horses, and squeeze on to the back of them.

Riphard gets hit on

They ride horses to Razzle's house. Razzle is king of the Height Rights. This is his house.

Gabrins are going to go in first, like they're HeightRightsers. They're going to see if they can find Razzle, and then come back and do some Strats and Tats.

Gabrins enter HeightRightsManor.

There's a fucking hobbit.

He's going to fucking whistle like a bellend.

The Gabrins shout at him and introduce themselves, to get ahead of the scandal.

The fucking hobbit's called Nickles.

"Big rights for small people", says Esme.

The Gabrins tell Nickles that they've been persecuted for being little. Kolo has terrible flashbacks to the Cantena. This pleases Nickles and they get taken inside.

I can't really see what's going on any more.

There's a sleeping area and some stairs.

Here's Razzle. He's a gnome. He's got a big bag of fireworks. He's stressful to listen to.

He's a little leprechaun gangsta, see.

He wants to burn Djago down, see.

Esme tells everyone about wanting to bring down the church again. Razzle wants to kill humans indiscriminately. It's a debate for the ages. Only Razzle can use the boomstick.

Esme's, like "please". Razzle's like, "NO".

Esme offers information about booms, in return for... a thing... or... anything. Hundreds of short people will die, but I think that's the plan. I really don't understand. It definitely sounds like they're not going to kill this guy.

Razzle wants Gabrins to kill whores.

Razzle wants to be quiet and small. He's failing at half of that.

Kolo wants to pick up part time job killing humans, Esme thinks they should focus on taking down church, so that they can kill even more humans.

Gabrins suggest Razzle should come with them on mission to kill whores. Razzle says no. He sends his best men, though.

The Gabrins and the best men go out into the woods, where the Bargins plan to kill them. Otoria and Pilch talk about when to kill everyone.

They eventually decide to wait until everyone's asleep.

In the woods, everyone's asleep. Time to die.

Pilch tries to back out of this whole thing, trying to get the Whores and Height Right's to be friends.

Otoria wants to cut off their tongues and hands.

Esme is spread the gospel of The One, trying to convert the Best Men. Esme and the Best Man (who's a woman) take a minute and pray to The One.

Everyone else is hanging out in the bushes.

Everyone suddenly doesn't want to kill them any more. They feel really bad for the small people, but then they kill them anyway.

There's a brutal massacre.

Everyone decides that they're going to kill Razzle, but that they want the small people to be free and happy under a new ruler.

Everyone gets back to the cave and prepare for shit to go down.

TO BE CONTINUED...

EPISODE 4A: KOLOS PLAN



O I thought we could get a plan together for what we do next week. I am envisioning this as off screen RP so this is Kolos plan, and what Kolo thinks. Feel free to reply in character or as yourself.

Required Outcomes

- Razzle Dazzle is dead

he has some good ideas but he is a coward, and to be useful to our cause he needs removing

- The SRA should not be after our hides afterwards

nobody wants suicidal midgets turning up from time to time to kill us

So the proposition is thus: We disguise Riphard up as a non pastor. Send him into the SRA as another short person recruit. On meeting Razzle Dazzle he talks about how he hates the Hoes, gets Razzle to talk about the mission.

He then condemns the cowardice of Razzle, questioning his leadership in front of the others vertically challenged members of the group.

Then we (goblins) return with blood all over us and dead bodies, we call out to Razzle to come out of the hideout (Kolo is unsure how this is best to be done). Then we talk about how we needed more people, and that Razzle didn't even know how many of them there were etc etc...

The idea will be to goad Razzle into either fighting us Goblins, or Riphard, or fleeing from the scene where we can hunt him down later.

This is not best plan, but its the first effort.....

unknown

Pilch: Not a bad plan at all, but we still hit one small problem - the ankle-biters would happily chop me and Otorio off below the knee. If we're going to work with these people we'll need them to accept the whole party, not just the vertically-challenged.

unknown

I'm also not a fan of splitting the party up, diluting our numbers is a sure way to get us all killed.

/u/mcgi5sr2

hmmmm Yes fishy, not too stoopid. Think that the whole group kill Razzle when he comes out. Otario and fishy can hide in woods for ambush.....

Or maybe better idea is that Otario and fishy bring back dead bodies and declare that they have been working for the dutty hoe bags? and stoopid leader sent too few ppl to tackle them. Then kolo and exmeh hide and ambush? or just hide always

unknown

That also has the slight problem of splitting the party and painting a big target on our backs - it could quickly go from a duel or us ambushing them to a small army of short-asses coming to poke spears through our middle-regions.

unknown

Destroying Razzle won't do - we need to ruin his reputation, drag it through the mud. Make them see his insanity and his bloodlust and realise the one they follow isn't for equal-rights, he's just a different form of bigot.

/u/mcgi5sr2

Good ideas Pilchy except for you lack a solution.....

unknown

His love of fire and burning is well known, right? So we, maybe, set fire to the camp and try to make it look like it was his fault, or his intention?

/u/magnificentjosh

Yes, this is a place to start, little friend. I agree that we should not anger the group, but I say this is not far enough. I think our goal should be to get someone into the leadership role that might have an ear for our mouths.

What if we told one of the other ones that we thought they were good enough to be leader, and that we would help them achieve that dream. We could make them feel so good and important. Esme could say that Razzle needs to go because he does not accept The One, and then could be accepted as the most trusted advisory member.

Then, we could plant out own seeds in their soil.

unknown

There's nothing to say we couldn't do both - make a more attractive option while discrediting their current leader.

/u/magnificentjosh

Are you sure you do not just want to burn something?

What would you even burn? From where we were sitting, it looks like he lives in a cave.

unknown

He did have gunpowder afterall...

/u/mcgi5sr2

Yesssss a stool is good idea. So Gabrins must re-infiltrate. Risky yes?

Seeds of discord, I like. Perhaps promise to spread SRA further afield and inland is attractive to them. Learn their ways we should. Make the contacts for elsewhere.

Maybe the One is not for them though. He did not answer

/u/magnificentjosh

It might be within our while to find someone who The One does talk to. It may benefit us to give these people a reason to distrust the church.

They should continue to fight for justice, and freedom from the horrible oppression, but perhaps we add a few of our own little fights as well.

/u/mcgi5sr2

Agreed, but wassa plan Strange One?

Kolo still think Riphard is good for sowing seeds of distrust within RWA, followed by expose of failed mission Razzle Dazzle didn't lead. The Razzles plan for..... emancipation..... is direct conflict... murder..... and terrorism... of the tall people. Somethings not all of us would shy away from **looks at Pilch** but to be effective it needs to be hidden from view. Razzle Dazzle didn't come across as a candidate gabrins communicate with.

unknown

Pilch waves his hand towards the shadows and their shapes shift and change to that of razzle, he waves it again and whispers echo through the cave

I can bend the shadows... I wouldn't want to do it anywhere too obvious, but it might be worthwhile to trick one gullable "Prophet" into preaching the way of the one?

/u/mcgi5sr2

ok so Riphard goes in as a member of the main branch of the SRA, spouting stuff about how Razzle has not been following official doctrine and must be replaced.

Pilch can disguise him up and help forge documents pertaining to this.

Also need documents to show that the members of the SRA we killed were on to Razzle for cooperating with the church.

Gabrins can then claim that they were ambushed by the church, and someone must have known they were coming for the dutty hoes.

Perhaps Otario and Pilch can go with Riphard as representatives from other groups working with the SRA main branch to further acceptance of small people etc??

unknown

Any plan that involves us going in as a team is going to get a thumbs up from me- thankfully those that saw me are now dead.

We can still use the goblins rushing in, covered in blood to hammer home the point of his ineptitude, saying that they were attacked by fancy-pants.

Ideally I want the whores and the short-people to be working together, so we need to do everything we can to get them all friendly together - maybe try to broker a joint attack by them against fancy-pants?

/u/mcgi5sr2

going in as a team reduces risk of us all getting killed, but also reduces the chances of anything other than a massacre taking place.

/u/magnificentjosh

Perhaps we send the 3 members of our party who are likely to be accepted in, while the others wait outside for some form of pre-arranged signal.

unknown

That still splits us, isn't it commonly known that even 6 seconds in battle can make all the difference?

Even the best eggs shouldn't be split.

/u/magnificentjosh

Eggs should be split to make delicious foods that we all can eat.

/u/magnificentjosh

Maybe us tall ones can go inside a big box and the little ones can carry us inside, and then, we can jump out if we need to.

unknown

Not bad, but maybe needs a bit more horse?

/u/magnificentjosh

If we had a spare horse, we wouldn't need to do any of this.

/u/mcgi5sr2

perhaps tall ones are dead? killed in fight with dutty hoes? Then "Big Surpisssssee" not dead but kill Razzle and escape. Then short ones stay angry and keep fighting the good fight?

unknown

Again, we want to bring these groups together - and that would Martyr Razzle - we need to discredit him - best scenario would be he gets killed by his own people and we keep our hands clean!

EPISODE 5: PITTER PATTER OF TINY BEARS

[The following pages are torn from a larger volume, and hastily rebound with string - One corner is singed implying someone attempted to burn this or the entire volume. The writing is in a

quick, hurried, but practised hand, and the type-face changes occasionally as though the writer grew bored of their style] Codenames as follows...- SH - Shadow Hound - Yours truly- RP -

Righteously Pissed - the drunken dwarf- JR -

Jilted Royal - the foreign lady- SR - Shifty Rogue

- the thieving goblin- JM - Joyful Mechanic - the inventive goblin

So we're in a cave, and just slaughtered a small number of small folk to whom we hope to ally. Great. SR has initiated a plan to take over the small-peeps by killing Razzle, SH says we should try and discredit the small folks leader (Razzle) - Seems that the goblins and Dwarf are going to go in and try to convince everyone else that he's gone rogue and isn't part of the organisation anymore. I'm loath to split the party, but the tiny bigots (...small-ots?) probably won't like me or JR walking in - maybe we can be guards or sympathisers? Anyway, I do the honorable thing of burning the bodies (and taking 5 ears), and then forging a document for RP - "Razzle is accused of collusion against the SRA with his Ofecal Charch Buziness." We stop outside, and finalise the plan - is as above, but the goblins will go in shortly afterwards to make it seem they were (recently) ambushed. RP Successfully enters the camp, thanks to the forged letter. The goblins sneak in after. RP manages to get found as an imposter, despite the letter. He did not know the secret Nichols handshake. A fight breaks out between RP and 3 members of the SRA - but he's quickly subdued. Everyone decides to scapegoat RP as a church-worker, still to discredit Razzle. Goblins sneak in. SRA becomes SRM - suddenly, because RP. Goblins come in, pretending to be injured - leant huge credence by my amazing disguising. Two of the SRA fall for it. RP gets blown up. Probably. Razzle likes bombs. "No dwarfy. . . I expect you to die!" RP starts whipping people. He gets knocked out. Team gobbo and 2 of the SRA run in. One gets blown up, the rest like Razzle more for this. JR is very noisy, it messes up our stealthiness. SH becomes a rock. I get RP back up by punching him, and then dance like my life depends on it (which it did). RP is then useful by disarming Razzle. Razzle Shanks me, but the shadows protect. The JM Blows off Razzles head. SH, RP and JR (who had been doing pull-ups the whole time) leave. The goblins appoint "Buttons" as the new leader of (this faction) of the SRA. There's maybe 4 SRA left. They also loot: Signet ring (with stampy well) 10 rockets 10gp Papers - Bits of communication,

Old Plans, Promotional Material, rambling letters, I'm not happy about this. We rest up. Kolo

and Otario have a heart to heart. We all go to see Mae. JR takes point in the conversation. It's interesting. Mae and Delilah plan with us to go kill fancy-pants. I'm on a horse. Mae gives us 3

people to go take on Fancy-Pants, Diago. One is an Battle-axe barbarian type, others a Crossbow-marksman, as is Delilah. JR and JM also get fancy "dutty ho" boots. On the way (to Diago) we encounter a man that tells us about the giant boar. Delilah flirts with RP for some reason.

JR - with her Mechanism Bow, JM and SR decide to attack at ranged, and take out the boar slowly. In the forest, we get attacked by dropbears. RP gets ripped hard. JR flails. Me and

the goblins kill nearly everything. The crossbow whore (Martha) dies. I save RP. I get Martha's

Xbow. Wait, shit. . . I better burn these pages - safer than leaving a paper trail...



EPISODE 6: ARBITRATION

Day starts well as we are unmolested. Pilch talks to Delilah about other men and how to lure them in, he is very keen even if it means traversing vast tracks of forest. Even the Dutty Hoe isn't willing to put out that far. Camp is made, no one wants to sleep, perhaps everyone is super excited about meeting the giant pig. Kolo gets bored and falls asleep. Fishy loses his bird, Kolo helpfully brings it back, but it somehow escapes. I am intensely interested in how the bird works, could

be proper useful to have a scout, and something to distract enemies in a fight. Fishy will pay for this, but first I follow Pig Smells. Otario and I go for sneaky first kill on Pig, which is followed by a sudden tactical climb into a tree. Otario winds up and pitches the Gabrin Fast Ball Special. Negotiations unfortunately fail, and after bouncing off the pig. . . watches as the Strange One leaps and pirouettes onto the big piggy before spanking it with her giant sword. Exmeh then lines up a shot and whispers "This little piggy went to market" before dispatching one baby pig. Before suddenly there are two Exmehs, wandering about. The Evil twin Exmeh then kills poor little piggy No 2. Riphard blows Big Pigs brains out everywhere, no more piggies. "It is Impossible to have a Cake and Also eat a Cake" Strange on is Strange. Barbeque pork all around, as Pilch adds to his ear collection. Big Pig is Too Big except for fatty hoe who eats most of pig. Impressive. . . . Riphard is strangely not interested in pig. After camping overnight in the pigs den, we move on to through the woods following filthy hoe Delilah. Somehow she knows where fancy man lives. . . . Pilch watches Kolo taking a massive smelly pig sized shit. About half way through, kolo turns and make eye contact while pinching off the end of the loaf. Pilch is confused about horses and dirt hoes. Its agreed that all ravens will now be shot. Pilch is a huuuge filltthhhyyy liar, about where the enemy are and what they are up to. Otario leads the lady charge, to entrap the fancy men. While we sneaky for horses, except Riphard who walks into the camp bringing the good news of the lord. Things go well with the fancy pants, as Otario works her magic Kolo horse whispers with his own shit, and as he is tying up the horses, stooopid Exmeh sets off a fire work. Otario then starts a song and does the dance of her people, it is not impressive. Exmeh stands statue of liberty esque holding a boom stick high. Kolo sets off a horsey train through the camp. " A sudden Rampage "One bandit does his best to salve the horses, "I've got this lads" by running in front of them all, who then savagely kill him. Otario gets Axed a lot of questions, while pilch hides behind a tent and tries to convince the fancy men their leader is a

nerd. Riphard starts a loaded sermon. Exmeh sends some redundant technology burning some poor fuckers face off, before hiding behind a tent! Pilch finally finds his ball sack, no correction he hides behind another tent before trying to reason with the enemy again. Luckily he is saved by the tent catching arrows. Strange booyagh is afoot as voices from the forest, as the horses speed out of the village. Raven hunt is going very badly, something is definitely up with this freaking bird. Its naked. Pilch somehow convinces half the archers to go to bed, while he gets nailed by Capn' Fancy Pants, and leaking smoke. Otario is taking a nap on the table, while Pilch makes an ill timed verbal foray against Capn' Fancy Pants, and as he pulls out his knife his chest explodes across across pilch from Exmehs rail gun. Riphard finally deals with the pesky Axe man, blowing the back of his head out. Sterling doesn't make the cut because Kolo makes the world a better place with one less asshole. Pilch cuts more ears from Diegos Boys, chopping Diegos head off for good measure. Otario rides off into the sunset badly, Delilah suddenly decides to stick with the party. Possibly because of sexy smelly gabrins. Pilch gets some hot whispers from mega Hoe. Return to sender, to find some poor mug still getting a shoe in. In the middle of town we discover a plate armoured individual standing over a leather clad man. She is holding a gun to the mans head. The gun is bigger and badder than Riphards, giving Riphard a massive Hard on. Kolo shits himself, Otario tries to take the hit, but then Riphard out of nowhere gets the game on with the Arbiter! Truth will come and Justice is served liberally with a massive sword. Otario and Riphard are totally outclassed. Otario gives a long winded speech to the crowd, while Pilch is gone, and the Gabrins are at the titty bar. It doesn't quite go the way she planned. Not even able to take out a wooden pillar afterwards. She then stalks the scary arbiter woman. Riphard gets some top tips from the Scary lady. Otario gets a letter for 500 gold from Arbiter Kyross, which she lets drop to the floor to be cashed at Rivers Falls. Riphard gets a note, recommending him to the master at Rivers Falls. To train him up with ninjas. The idea of training with the Ninjas makes him cry. Its genuinely touching. He also pockets the 500 gold note. Otario continues to stalk Lady Kyross, throughout the day and night.

EPISODE 7: MYSTERIOUS INCIDENT OF THE COW IN THE NIGHT

Pilch is the anonymous Jackalope, also in attendance is Anonymous Hippo and Anonymous FrogHester is the owner of the caravanOtario is found in the town still staring at the kebab ladies house. He agrees to meet everyone at the main square for departure. In the mean time Otario pays a small urchin to send a letter everyday to convince the Kebab lady that she is still watching herAt the caravan Kolo is upset that everyone has a caravan except for him. Exmeh locks him out. Pilch cosies up to HestorBoamos under

represented caravan member that Otario befriends. He is from South West Africa, which no one has ever heard of. He is happy to help learn Otario. "Otario learns horsecraft" its super effective.Riphard and Delilah are having a muffled "conversation"Kolo pissing into Exmehs caravan, before running off with tongs and a crucible.Pilch looks for some general information, specifically against the church. Exposition dump, nothing out of the ordinary other than that constant war with the minions of the (Valkaar) VARG, and those from Lindendorf who are striking back at the church.Caravan People Consist of:Leader: HestorGuards: Leorable,

Dukey, Dallius, JobMerchants: Boamos, Tillie, Sabina, Maarah, SidneyTroubles in port

AbbeyDale in the East, more people from Masooda, Far to the East across the Ocean. Masooda and NanDuan are not friends.Story

time commences, involving Drop Bears and changelings. . . .Changelings are revealed by throwing salt over their right shoulder...NanDuan has a plethora of sand daggersOtario makes friends with a horse, before . . . Kolo goes off for a stealth investigationPilch is

caught spooning HestorFierce discussion takes place about what to do about the ambush. Pilch wants to hide in the, kolo is a fan of stalking the beastPilch has not romanced Hestor after all.Hoof prints are massive, but its super light on its feet.Probably one of the Nanduisian Balloon CowsOtario and Kolo join forces and become

Super Mega KolOtariozord, its is not supereffectiveEveryone runs blindly into the woods, some more blindly than othersOtario

prepares the bey blade, but to no avail as she is booted out from underneath kolo, but what is not a flying cow afterall.Pilch runs away leaving otario and kolo to die. Luckily the Leucrotta is slain by Riphard awesome boom sticks, and the cross bow bolt of a returning Pilch.Exmeh fixes

up the axle of the lead wagon and the party moves onto RiverFall which is beautiful.In the middle of which is a large church, the sanctuary of Novetta.The spire of "emoticon" -Imota

KanRiphard hates womenArmor is expensive

EPISODE 8: FREAKY FISHY

As we join our "heroes", they have just arrived in the town of Rivers Run or something. It was a long night, so a nice warm burrow was dug for Pilch to enjoy. Pilch lives in a hole in the ground.This town that they're in is where the church lives.People really want Otoria to stop dying so much and actually help, so they've all gone to the shop.They can't afford any armour, so try to find work to get money. Apparently there's trouble a' mine.There's a bunch of other places to go too.And 4 taverns. Rip gets hard.Sad Crusader,

Club and Cask, Open Flask, MinstrelsSanctuary of Novotel - Church place to gain power and moneyEveryone goes to the Sad Crusader, obvs.It's great. Everyone has a good time and the service is great.Kolo burns the raven.Pilch

drinks terrible beer and Kolo drinks some Killepitsch shit.Kolo buys some of it and some matches. There's no explanation for this at all.Pilch goes wrong somehow and starts rolling around in his own vomit.Everyone decides it's probably for the best if they put him down, which is sad, but unavoidable.Then Pilch shits magical darkness and Kolo sets fire to the pub in response.Everything goes to shit and people are running through walls and shit.Outside, everyone realises Pilch is possessed or something and start taking him to the river to drown.Otoria realises there's two old men

trapped inside and runs back in to save them. It's awesome and she picks them both up and bursts out through the wall of the burning pub. She then returns to the rest and helps them throw Pilch in a river. Kolo's been rolling him, which is cool but not that efficient. Pilch

immediately starts drowning. Everyone's "really upset". Pilch wakes up and gets out, then he and Kolo mud wrestle for a bit. The fire's really getting going now, most of the crew help out, Riphard runs off to another pub, Munchkins, the suave place. He doesn't get let in, because he's not cool enough, but then he does the classic Inspector Routine, and totally bosses it. He's in. Everyone

else is saving lives and property from that fire they started, but whatever Riphard, you do your own thing. Munchkins is like that cool jazz bar in Spiderman 3. This whole sequence is basically

just Riphard's methdream. Everyone keeps giving him compliments, booze and boobs. Meanwhile, at the disaster zone, the brave

volunteers have sated the fire. Otoria gives the man some money for rebuilding the pub and Kolo asks him to come with them on the adventure. He declines, but gives Kolo the recipe for the Killepitsch stuff. Otoria and Kolo take

Pilch off towards the Spire of Emoticon/Immodium, apparently Kolo knows some secret Gabrin magic to fix Pilch which seems to involve leaving him in a hole in the ground and leaving. Riphard is 13 shots down.

The remaining 7 shots get put in 2 cocktails for the road, and he crawls off to the central church place to report in with what he found from drinking all of this bullshit. It takes him hours. He's greeted by two guards, he tries to

make them drink the remaining cocktails, and then forgets he's not a female arbiter. Somehow he gets let inside. He's going to meet the guy

who's supposed to give him all the money. Everyone's being nice to him, despite the fact he's a fucking mess. Riphard meets the guy.

Gendry goes and gets the money. Riphard tries to hold a conversation. It goes as well as you'd expect. The guy makes him undrunk. He gets nuzzled. Riphard puts his hand on a ball and it tells him his destiny. His destiny is to be an Alligator. The guy tells Riphard to go and pray at some artifact at the Spire, which is run by the

guy's daughter. Gendry does some top-shelf slapstick with a big sack of money. Riphard takes his comical bag of money into town and looks for somewhere to hide it. He goes to an old man's shit brick house. The old man thinks Riphard is here to put him down. He's mildly upset about this, but seems to think his daughter would approve. He's so old. SO OLD. SO LONELY AND

SAD. His daughter wants him to die, because she lives in a wooden house. Rip goes off to find a hiding place for his huge bag of gold. I think he's going to kill this sad old man. He tells the old man that the gods want to run a shop in his house. The man loves this idea. The old man decides to leave his house to the church when he dies. Riphard is definitely going to kill him now. The old man's name is Derek

Bobacious. Riphard goes off to get himself written into Derek's will. Hero. Kolo and Otoria are digging a hole in the woods. Otoria finds out that Kolo's planning the kill Pilch before they bury him, and she doesn't like this. She convinces him to take him to the Spire instead and they ride off. Back in town, Riphard's got the contracts drawn up, meets Delilah. He decides to take her to meet Derek. Derek gets the will and sexually harasses Delilah. Derek boasts about his old man dick. Riphard opens a bank in Derek's house. He calls it Northern Rock, because it sounds sturdy and dependable. Derek reveals that his actual old man dick is broken, but the old man dick in his mind is doing just fine. Riphard sets everything up and rides off to meet the others. They arrive at the Spire. They

meet Holly. She lets them in. There's a party going on, but they're not invited, especially the definitely naturally ill guy they're here to find a cure for. Riphard presses Holly for info about the vaults and shit. He tries to get investment into a colab on this banking startup he's planning. Holly tells them where all the books they want are, and also that only Pilch can read the ones on possession and Devil shit, which why would they even need that, because he's just got food poisoning or something. Riphard finds a book about the thing he's looking for.

Otoria finds a book about syphilis. Kolo finds a book about possession and what to do about it. We need to get a pastor to do a thing and then purge him. If this doesn't work, we'll just kill him. We're gonna fix fishy. Riphard is chanting,

Kolo feeds Pilch half a bottle of Killepitsch. Vomit. Vomit. Vomit.

Vomit. VOMIT. VOMIIIT. VVV OOO MMM III TTTit

seems moderately successful. Fishy lives. He gets a shadow sword, and stops being so obviously possessed. Pilch agrees to stay at least 15 feet from Otoria at all times he's not actively saving her life, on pain of sword. Everyone goes to a party. There's all sorts of people at the party, including people from the same continent as Otoria, which is rare. Otoria introduces everyone to a plant expert, and goes off to get drinks. Holly turns back up, and offers to show Riphard the artefact he's here to see. The others can come too. Pilch puts a sword in his ear. Rip, Kolo and

Esme go to see the thing. Pilch goes to be sick in a hole. No one realises that the last time they saw Otoria, she was off getting them drinks. Everyone else is in the vaults, having a lovely time all together. They go and see the thing. It's a ruby sphere 2 fists wide. Mike loves getting fisted. Riphard meditates into the stone. He realises he loves the church loads. Suddenly, off in the distance, some people hear a scream, most people do not. TO BE CONTINUED

EPISODE 9: LIVE FREE OR R.I.P. HARD (IN LOVING MEMORY OF LADY OTORIA HEARTHRUST)



He screaming continues. Holly:

"what what whaaaa?!" Holly

runs to the door: "Leroyyyy
mmmmmJeeennnnkinnnsssss" The

group crowds around the door. Clanking machinery and voices are heard in the distance. Man 1 "Tony, we need to break the door down quickly." Tony (probably) "Don't worry, she knows what she's doing" They don't know the

doors are unlocked to this super secure facility. Esme is confused about everything. We

open the door and see 3 stunned figures outside the door: burly black man (Theo), half orc (Tony), and Eastern looking lady with daggers. They draw their weapons. MEANWHILE Otoria explores

the upper levels carrying around the 3 drinks she got for the group. She reflects on the peace and quiet: that is never a good thing. She hears heavy footsteps bound up the stairs. Otoria

freezes and watches the doorway to the stairs. Man 3 "Round up the others. Take care of the hostages, right Alexander?" Man 4 (gruff voice) "Don't tell me how to do my work." Otoria approaches Alexander and scolds him for mistreating Man 4. The men note Otoria's notable weaponry and draw weapons. MEANWHILE Exme

is fucking on it and pops a shot off first. She misses. The dagger lady "eyes up Kolo" and waits.

Lustfully. Tony gets a glancing spear blow on

Kolo (more innuendo). The dagger lady now stabs

Kolo for some reason who cries out for Exme's help. Everyone misses everyone

else. MEANWHILE Otoria gets wet for some

reason. MEANWHILE Pilch tries to use his new

sword. He sucks as expected. He tries to retcon it with luck, forgetting AGAIN about his raven that magically gives everyone advantage. He now magically hits here for minimum damage, giving her the equivalent of a paper cut. Some magical extra damage comes out of nowhere and she explodes. That's a bad paper cut. MEANWHILE Alexander tries to spear Otoria

and bang her (... come on). He fucking rapes her (not literally). Otoria is in bad shape. Otoria

respond with a fancy sword swipe. It's pretty fucking fancy. The men look impressed and injured. MEANWHILE Riphard talks to his bullets.

For 6 seconds. You'd have thought he could manage more than that, but no. Exme kills

Theo. "Frank" (Tony?) takes Holly hostages and

backs away threatening to kill her if we

move. MEANWHILE Otoria continues to battle the

two men without dying, which is an

improvement. MEANWHILE Pilch thinks about

taking off Holly's clothes. Very inappropriate for an unconscious hostage. Probably telling of his character. Pilch does something involving magic. It didn't seem important.MEANWHILEOne of the

dudes tries to bang Otoria again, but misses so badly he makes it super easy for Otoria to stab him. Otoria misses. But in her miss scares the fuck out of the men. They literally shit their pants. Then she remembers she actually had advantage and they retroactively take damage, probably from the pant shitting. The guy drops his weapon.MEANWHILEA large inky black void

has surrounded the doorway, pilch, and the hostage situation. This is probably Pilch's fault.Riphard says "Fuck this noise again" and pats Kolo on the head 10 times.Exme and Kolo looks at each other and realise their opportunity. A vault full of invaluable secrets, during a robbery, with the keeper conveniently unconscious and subdued.... It would be terrible if some of the items went missing.Exme uses her identify machine, but it beeps confusedly at her. She walks off.Frank (the girl was Tony all along) panics and drops Holly in the black shit mist. He runs in the direction he thinks the stairs are in.Kolo runs into the black shit mist for some reason. He trips over Holly and falls on his face.MEANWHILEThe lady tries to stab Otoria. . .

and misses. The battle rages on.MEANWHILEPilch reabsorbs the darkness

into his ass. He approaches Kolo and offers him a hand to his feet. Kolo thanks fishy.MEANWHILEAlexander runs off allowing

Otoria to stab him. She misses. Otoria tries to intimidate the already scared man, commanding him to halt. He stops. Fucking Jedi shit. Otoria then swipes at the lady and she's barely standing on her feet, crumpling her breastplate.Riphard commands the running man to DANCE! He stops and starts dancing, telling the others to subdue him.Exme is homing in on something and finds a small ring.Frank continues to dance aggressively and sexually.Kolo wants Pilch to throw him and jumps into his arms.MEANWHILEThe lady tries

to stab Otoria again. Misses again.MEANWHILEPilch runs with Kolo and throws him at the now stationary and

non-dancing Frank. Pilch uses some kind of homing device and bullseyes Kolo into Frank's face.Kolo does a barrel roll in the air and

headbutts Frank while stabbing him, knocking Frank out cold.MEANWHILEThe mighty battles

draws to an inevitable conclusion. Otoria does some more unnecessary. fancy sword shit and opens some sardines. She cuts the ladies face off and struts towards the still terrified man."Everything went much better for you

because you did what I say. It will continue to be better for you if you continue to do what I do. Tell me everything".The terrified man spits blood

and tells Otoria that they were robbing the place (no shit).Otoria wonders if the man parties. He

does. He tells her they took the party people hostage. He says they didn't want violence, despite rushing Otoria immediately on sight. He said she looked like a badass. Otoria tells him to go to bed and rethink his life. Settle down. Get a job. Contribute productively to society. He agrees to have a nap and try to figure his life out. Otoria breaks his spear and lets him be."By the

way, never seen a woman fight like you."I am

Otoria Hea. . . "LET ME FINISH. . . Except for

Lark""Thanks for the cryptic clue.""No, you

already know who that is. The blonde asian lady.""Ohhhhhh

yeeaaaaaah."MEANWHILERiphard practices his

bondage techniques, convincing the others not to skin the man.Exme quickly works out how the

fancy 17 lock door works for Riphard.Kolo agrees

to guard the treasures (yeah. . .).The group take

the unconscious Frank and now-conscious Holly to the security HQ within the tower, which is apparently just the guards at the door.Riphard

explains to Holly about the robbery and non-so-subtly implies the need for a reward.The

guards, who have no fucking idea what's going on at this super secure treasure tower, inquire as to what's going on. Pilch tries to explain to the guards what's happening despite all this being Riphard's idea. Who is oddly quiet, scribbling notes, probably about their lax security procedures.It turns out that the 2

guards are part of the robbery. This explains a lot. Riphard takes notes harder.

"TRUSTWORTHY GUARDS!!!!".Riphard quick

draws his pistol and shouts "THUNDERCUNT!"

and shoots one of the motherfuckers. Kolo hears the distant rumble of Riphard's gun. Exme does not. One of the guards doesn't hit Riphard. Pilch

drops an ear (wtf) and further confirms himself to be very much a Stephen character by looking for the best way to run away. He contemplates jumping into shit to surrounding himself with matter similar to himself. Holly and the unconscious half orc block the corridor. Pilch stabs the unconscious half orc to Riphard's confusion. Riphard misses with his whip. The

men stab Pilch in the face with a greatsword and miss with another. Pilch tries to actually do something useful and stab the dudes (totally after sending the Raven out for advantage). AND MISSES LIKE A CUNT. MEANWHILE Otoria eats

some grey goo, totally oblivious to the thunderous blast from below. She decides it's party time and descends to the party room. The

group uncover the mystery of Imota Kan (NAKATOMI BACKWARDS OMG) and it turns out the whole thing is a Die Hard rip off. Pretty sweet. All the dudes are named after the Die Hard people too. Fuck. Does that mean it's Christmas? Hans (come on) cuts a guy's head off

as Otoria enters the room. Everyone starts making Die Hard references. Otoria banters with

Hans. There's a lot of talk of mess and shit shows. No one likes mess. Hans explains he's here to rob the tower (YEAH WE GET IT). Turns out Hans threw the party in his own honour, what a cunt. The conversation goes on for a while in true hollywood style with the villain fully explaining his plan for some reason. Otoria tries

to convince Hans that his men in the vault are dead. Hans proposes a bet to see who's dead. MEANWHILE Riphard starts singing

Firework by Katy Perry, who totally exists in this universe, inspiring Pilch and Holly. The evil

dudes miss. Pilch kills a motherfucker and kicks him off the bridge. Riphard fucking whips the other dude's feet, who entangled in whip stumbles off the bridge to his grizzly doom. Wilhelm scream MEANWHILE Otoria notices Kolo

and Exme sneaking out from the all too convenient poop-chutes-come-ventilation shafts. They now know what it's like to be TV dinners. . . after they've been digested, shat out, and flushed away. The hollywood conversation continues.

Otoria tries to walk away, but the henchmen fire their crossbows at her, but all miss leaving an Otoria shaped arrangement in the wall behind her. Exme left a crate conveniently in the party

hall last week, which now starts beeping and humming. Kolo looses an arrow at a henchman,

killing him clean. HEADSHOT. His eye extends out of his face on the end of the arrow.

Gross. Exme takes a shot at Hans and wounds him. Marco (a henchman) hits Otoria with a

bolt. Pilch and Riphard don't put two and two

together, and thinking the job is now done saunter back off into the building at a leisurely pace. Kristal stabs Exme. Otoria does a combat

roll on the spot instead of just turning around like a normal person. She sprints towards Hans with the her sword held out in front of her and completely misses Hans. Kolo gets hit with an

arrow. Some lady with a katana slashes Otoria

while she clumsily runs at Hans. Kolo misses

terribly with a poison arrow. Exme action rolls

away from Kristal, shooting her to pieces all over a nearby hostage, then dodges a bolt. Pilch and

Riphard hear the distant sounds of battle and start sprinting towards the stairs like the brave men one of them is. Hans goes mental at the

sight of his dying men. Otoria slashes some

people. Kolo gets his with another arrow. Lark

(the one with long blond hair) starts singing a song of focus. It sounds like a BabyMetal ballad. Kolo breaks out a DISTILLED poison

arrow, and finally kills his tormenter. The

forgotten whirring crate finally does something, and falls open. A small roar emanates as a small mecha-bear appears from the dust. It's super cute. Exme looks surprised in a motherly way. Exme shoots another henchman and fucks

him right up. He dead. Exme inspects the mecha-bear, which starts doing a little excited tippy tap dance for her. Everyone's heart melts. Except Exme, who looks unmoved, the heartless bitch. Pilch finally appears from the stair well. He

does a ranged attack for a pathetic amount of damage to the singing lark. Riphard enters and

grabs his pistol he had stored behind his head in his hood, totally like out of Die Hard. GET IT? He shoots Lark for much more damage than Pilch, but she still singin'. Otoria dies hard. As

usual. Lark, angry at being shot twice, runs at Pilch and Riphard and swipes at them. Riphard gets hit hard. Kolo continues to use his fanciest of fancy arrows and fires at Hans, wounding him badly. The mecha-bear adorably bounds towards Hans, falling over as he does so. AWWW. Exme then fires at Hans, but is distracted by the sickeningly cute mecha-bear. Pilch fucking grabs Lark like a full on rapist and/or Donald Trump. He moves on her like a bitch, suplexing the bitch down the stairs over his head. She's still fucking singing though, amazing. Riphard runs over and touches up the unconscious Otoria. As usual. Hans tries to stab a prone Otoria, but resembles someone playing a larger hand-knife game, stabbing between her splayed limbs. It's actually quite impressive. A smattering of applause breaks out. Otoria gets up looking angry. She mightily swings her greatsword at Hans, right at his crotch. It turns out Hans is wearing a very elaborate cod-piece and he laughs, unfazed and unhurt. Otoria runs away. Hans tries to swipe at her, but she's too nimble. Lark says something at Pilch in Forin. "DIE PEEG". This is actually seamlessly part of the song. She double slashes Pilch who dies. HARD. Kolo lets out more of the fancy arrows at Hans, who's still standing. The mecha-bear approaches Hans and gently tugs at Hans' pantaloons. His stony face softens briefly before he (gently) kicks the bear to one side. Riphard misses Hans with a shot as Hans approaches. Hans triple stabs Riphard, who crumples to the ground, mortally wounded. Otoria hits Lark with an arrow who speaks back in Forin (and song). Otoria tells Lark that she's gonna kill "this guy then deal with that guy", who doesn't understand. Lark suddenly charges Otoria and beheads her with her Katana. Otoria dies suuuuper hard. Like for real. Dead, dead. Kolo looses a final fancy arrow at Hans who finally dies. It's surprisingly anti-climactic. Exme shoots at Lark in a rage, who is bleeding heavily. Riphard and Pilch are slightly less dead looking, but still dying. Lark, still singing, but more mournfully now that her dead leader is dead, swings at Exme, who ALSO DIES. Kolo is the last man standing and launches the angriest and fanciest arrow he can muster at the sight of his sister falling in battle, which hits. The fury

contained within this shot, particularly due to Kolo's small stature, finally slays the lethal Lark. Kolo rushes to Exme's aid, who flickers to life. Then to Riphard, just swinging a fist into his chest like the Fonz. Riphard sputters to life. Pilch soooooo nearly dies. Kolo rushes to Pilch last and again Fonz's Pilch back to life. Pilch awakens. The group inspect Otoria's very dead remains. Apparently the rest of the group know she is an automaton, but not Riphard. I'm not sure why. Pilch fruitlessly tries to reanimate the lifeless Otoria-bot. Exme uses her convenient identifier to give everyone an in-depth backstory to the now deceased and never to be seen again Otoria. Turns out she was a dwarven sex-bot with a soul. An intrigued Riphard removes the bandages from Otoria-bot's body-less head to see what a sex-bot looks like. She's got a pretty creepy head. He's not a fan. Exme is moved to tears at the complexity of the machinery. Kolo wants to wear her dead face as a mask (a goblin tradition). Feeling bad Kolo stuffs his totally-not-stolen items back into the waste holes. Holly starts untying hostages. Pilch attacks

Riphard for some reason, who startled from the shock of battle lets a hip-shot off at Pilch, who dies again. Kolo lets an arrow off at Riphard despite seeing what just unfolded, like a complete cunt. Thankfully he misses and the situation diffuses. . . for now. Exme shocks Pilch back to life. Tensions and emotions are running high following the intense battle and loss of a "friend", and everyone should calm down in time. This does not bode well for the group's future. Pilch, Exme, and the bear take Otoria's mecha-remains somewhere. Kolo tries to get money out of Holly and steal money off the hostages. Riphard wants to discuss business with Holly, in private. Riphard insists on taking his share for himself. Kolo takes the rest, along with less notorious valuable looking items from the vault. Lazarus talks to the group in their dreams. Kolo's really angry. Lazarus explains to the group Otoria's "true" identity, and what would have become of her had he not intervened in an attempt to justify himself. It seems pretty reasonable. Kolo isn't convinced and swears vengeance, ever the rational member of the group. Lazarus calmly tells Kolo that there is only one way to "make things better", which is to reclaim the path of "decent and noble" souls like Otoria to heaven, which has been corrupted by

the church. Pretty reasonable. Kolo is unconvinced and swears on Lazarus' "death". Lazarus, who by all accounts seems like a pretty decent bloke at this point, further presses the point he rescued us from inevitable deaths that he was not involved in orchestrating, and gave us new leases of life in order to improve the world. Exme thanks Lazarus for his candidness. Pilch wonders that Lazarus' powers

are limited, gesturing to his arm, he says he doesn't work for Lazarus, they just share the same master, can't he bring him back. Lazarus sighs at Pilch's stupidity and naivety of the current god-politik. That's the whole reason he got us involved, to try and fix this shit. Pilch further questions Lazarus about it all, and Laz starts to get angry. "Synne is super shit at the moment. You're a shit mortal and have been granted some of his power, and you dare question it? Go fuck yourself." Pilch presses Laz for more help, advice, information, anything to prevent further casualties in the hardships ahead. Laz says he has withheld information for fear of our interrogation. He shares the "knowledge of the breaking". Many centuries ago,

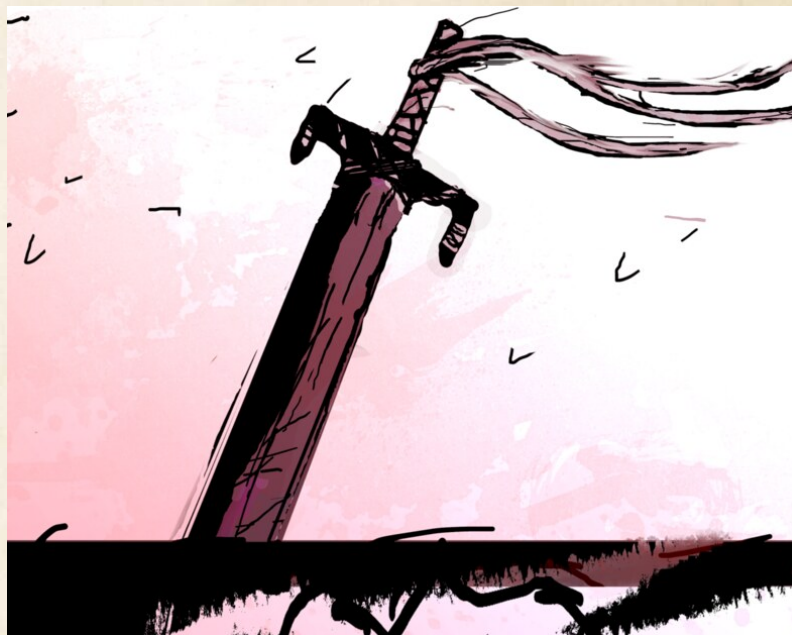
the church believed they were doing good, and utilised a most powerful artifact. The Great Stone of the Eight™ (though you would call it Seven...). It sundered the world from the gods and beyond, and so they believed from danger. However, the centuries have not been kind to the church, and the world, and the church has become corrupt, endangering the world more than anything that came before. The only hope for the souls of the entire world, and for all in eternity, is to "break the seal". When pressed, this means unlocking the gods power and bringing their power to full bear, as they were in ages past. The church will block this at all costs, but once the seal is broken, the church will either fall or be reborn. The gods will take an active role in the world again, unlike their distant current influence. The seal filters the gods power, and church bends this to their own wishes. They had good intentions to begin with, and still believe they are doing right by the world, but they are no longer. He sighs. That's all we've got time for folks. Pilch asks another question

anyway. The dream fades and the group stir awake, but Lazarus' voice distant explains we will need "one of several...". The group are

exhausted from the power of the conversation, but do get their HP back. Woo. The group gather round a campfire, and give Otoría-bot a proper send off, but plan to keep her mecha-remains in a special caravan or something, like some kind

of shrine? Kolo begins to tell a special story. In

loving memory of Lady Otoría Hearthrast.
2017-2017



*A Hero's Grave — posted by the players,
11/04/2017*

EPISODE 9.1: KOLO'S TALE (PART 1): THE GREASY RAGE OF CLAN STANRI

The group gather round the warm camp fire as Kolo begins to tell the great tale of Goblin legend. That of revered emancipator Grumpy Stanri... Grumpy

Stanri wakes up one morning with a premonition. The great dark wagon of the Muglabiyet isn't being pulled by anyone. What's going on? He assembles his Gabrin crack team and goes out to go to a place to find out. First

though, they need to find a boat to get there. They head towards a town by a river to see if they can get one. As they approach they notice

the humans in the fields running away, locking themselves in the town walls. The gang approach

the gates and talk to the 2 guards in the towers above the gate. Kri'igo ask what everyone's so scared of. Apparently it's them. The guards are dicks, if we're honest. They racist and call us Pikeys, which is a reference to the Pike wars, where humans put Gabrin child's on pikes and ate them like Kebabs. They tell us that we can't

come in and we say we'll go away and not bother them. We head towards the burned out remains

of a village outside the town walls, and then Tan and Dev start sneaking, with a plan to scale the town walls. They scamper up to the top, and Dev misses with some blow darts, trying to hit one of those guards, because they're dicks. Tan'lata

does not miss at the guard she's aiming at. He doesn't have a chance to scream before he hits the ground. The other guy just about gets to raise the alarm before Dev hits him with a blowdart. It makes him feel a bit woozy, then Tan runs along the top of the palisade wall, murdering him with 2 arrows as she runs towards him. As she gets up to him, she takes some of his meat out with her hands. The alarm is raised, bells ringing

across the town. The rest of the gabrins ask Dev to open the doors to the town. She starts, but she's shit scared and whimpering like a little bitch because she's never seen death up close, and now she's seeing an awful lot of death. Tan'lata is not helping to open the gate, because she's just war-criminalling (during peace time!) all over the place. She tries to set fire to a house, but it's made of stone, so she barges in through the window as they're trying to board it up. Inside

there's a granny standing by an oven, a man running to go and get something from another room, and a small group of terrified children. Within 20 seconds or so: the granny has her head in the oven, burning to death; the man has his thumb bitten off, and a poker sticking through his mouth and out of the back of his head; and Tan'lata has slammed the door of the oven shut, decapitating the granny. She then turns her attention to the children, and luckily, our attention turns outside. Dev has got

the drawbridge down and now needs to lift the bar on the door. She ties one end of a rope to the bar and another to her weasel. She tells the weasel to jump out of the window, but the rope is too long, and it hits the ground like a dick. As

the gabrins regroup outside of the murder house, a fresh wave of murderous humans arrive to try and take down the gabrins. Grumpy heads into

the house of viscera to perform a necro-terrogation of the father's head. The severed head spews racial hatred at the goblins, potentially justified at this point. He reluctantly shares that the town has no large vessels itself, but rather serves as a port for trading. The man's undead head is dismayed to see his children's dismembered and brutalised corpses. Fml head man. After a brief disposal of the new

guards, the gang follow Kri'igo along the city

walls towards the river. However, they are set upon by another bunch of guards, this time being led by a fancily dressed guard, all shiny and long haired. The fight is brutal and short,

and full of greased up, rage filled barbarians who are more than capable of separating a heavily armoured, fully grown human man into two parts with a single blow. Well, one barbarian at least. The group take a moment to rest and

recover, with Kri'igo gratefully taking Grumpy's teet to restore his vitality. He suckles long and hard, his strength slowly pouring back into each muscle, his tongue savouring his father's bitter-sweet, musky milk. There is an intimacy to the action of the kind that can only exist between a man and his eldest son. Devvy is in

awe of Tan'lata's skills and requests that the older goblin become her new mother. Tan'lata accepts and requests her new child to gather fire wood, an important task for an adult to know how to perform, and place it all around the villager's houses. The wood is lit, and the fate of the town's people sealed as securely as their temporary, yet also ironically permanent, battens. Grumpy heads down to the river to seek

out a boat. He finds a small rowing boat and sits in it in order to attempt once more to commune with his god. But before he can receive no reply, the boat is tipped over by an angry, piratey dwarf. Tan'lata is able to loose an arrow into the dwarfs leg. However, the fight is brought to a stop by the embarrassing and womanly pacifism of the dwarves. The dwarves inform the goblins

that they had been trying to pull off their own long-short plan to trick the town's most virile and able-bodied men into working as deck hands on their sailing boat. But since they were now all dead, if the goblins wanted to secure passage across the sea, then they would have to work. Grumpy, work shy and haggard, accepts with a wink. The goblins enter a row boat with the 2

dwarves and head to the larger vessel. After a long rest and several hours on the river, the larger boat comes into sight. Grumpy utters a single short command and the dwarves no longer exist as living, breathing, love making creatures. The goblins hear a splash from the other side of the larger boat, but are too caught up in the joy of owning a boat, and the anxiety of trying to figure out how to sail it, to notice. TO BE

CONTINUUUUEEEEEEEED...



Grumpy Stanri — Your fearless leader



Kri-Igo Stanri — First Born



Tan-Iata — The one that knocks in the night



Dev'Ieda Stanri — Small Trouble

EPISODE 9.2: KOLO'S TALE (PART 2): SNAKES ON A BOAT!

The session starts: Rich is now a weasel. The barbarian is now God. The Gabrins are on a dingy, not a rubber one but a proper one. The big awesome ship is drifting away from us. The might barbarian gabrin who has suddenly changed personality and voice decides to go for a lovely swim and tries to get up. His daughter lassos him which helps them to stay nearby but nearly strangles the swimmer. Tan'lata shoots an arrow at the ship and hits because how could she not but the arrow snaps because she's a dumbass. Kril-go rages like a ragey thing and power climbs up the rope. A bit later they get on the boat, TAN'lata does a wikid sick backflip on the boat then goes to look for friends. The boat is full of wood but nothing fun. Dev'lada wants to use the ballistas to make a siege weasel and acquires a piece of string. Tan'lata smells dwarfs downstairs and it makes her a bit wet but she pretends it's hunger. Grumpy suggests making a dwarf friend but that isn't going to happen. Downstairs there are a few dingys and hammocks, plus some cards. They might be for playing top trumps. Grumpy has been on a boat before, back when he didn't have gout. There was something to do with ropes. HE has ideas because he is v. clever. Kril-go rages through the underfloor and eats some lovely fish and gets covered in sexy oil. He has a party in

the bedroom and makes a cloak. Grumpy comes to a realisation that he needs wood. He remembers turny thingys and important guys stand at the back. Stanri beckons the gabrins together for planning and KNOWLEDGE. Dev'leda is not very useful, she tries to see stuff and she tries to know stuff but all she is good at is making things greasy and uncomfortable. Kril-go gets some cool boots and a hat to go with his cape because he's super fashion concious. He gets letters he cant read and tries to take them to Stanri but there is a grease party going on and he falls in the water. Dev'leda chats up her greasy weasel who apparantly is the only thing in the party with a clue. On the Keel is some old bloke called cap'n suresailin. WE declare it is our boat and Dev'leda tries to stop him getting on the boat even though he is obviously the only person who knows wtf is going on. He's nimble for an old fuckHe is the captain and its an old as fuck ship. Stanri chats him up and Tan'lata whispers sexily in his ear but it was actually his elbow. He wants us to be crew. We agree because we have no idea what a boat is. He teaches us how to be pirates which we will be very grateful. Dev'lada is friggin in the riggin with a greasy weasel. Kril-go is turning his wood. Tan'lata gets ropey Grumpy does nothing. Grumpy Stanri knows things but he doesnt know what. Tan'lata is heretycal but doesnt kill the man yet. We set sail to the tune of a raptor-weasel in the rigging. The river is great. We are rollin. Rollin. Rollin down the river. Stanri has a shit while he talks to his god. The cap'n makes the dire mistake of showing us where we are going and being friendly. Tan'lata lets the man live by shooting him in the face, but he calls out in some weird voice o doom calling us traitors. Some fookin big sea snake comes out of teh sea while the cap'n makes a big storm which is not very nice. It pops the weasel Stanri saves the weasel by popping him back. Tan'lata fucks up the captain who obi'wans it outta there. Kril-go goes hack crazy on the sea snake and mashes some bits out of it. Dev'lada beheads a corpse and kicks the head. Kril'go rides the giant deadly sea snake like a cowboy. The druid turns into a fooking octo-kraken and squirts his love juice all over Dev'lada and her stinky weasel before sliding into the sea. It is a tree octopus, which is a fookin scary piece of shit. It can hunt in trees. What a cunt. Grumpy makes the giant snake between Kril'go's legs really shiny and

painful. Tan'lata cant see the octopus cos it's sneaky as fuck so she splits the giant sea snake in two with a piercing shot. Dev'lada makes her weasel do the dirty work by peering into the water but quickly remembers that it is not a sea weasel and unfortunately cannot do water very well. 1-0 to tree octopi. More giant snakes comes out which Kril'go thought was a log but it nips him and savages him. The greasy weasel gets fucked by a tentacle but isn't quite dead. Grumpy starts massaging a dead snake trying to make it come to life, it takes a long time because he is old. Tan'lata brambles an octopus in water. It surrounds the octopus. He thinks he's a tree octopus but he cant do shit against a fookin bramble bush. 1-1 GABRINS EQUALISE Kril'go is a fucking beast and rips a giant sea snake in half which also flips the boat. Tan'lata falls out of the rigging but she's a motherfuckin' Chris Tingle Dress Ninja and lands starfished on the edge of the boat. Dev'lada is "pinned in place by her nearly dead, greasy half on fire weasel". She tries to launch herself off the crossbow forgetting she broke the shit out of it. The weasel is not a crossbow expert. Dev'lada is not a life expert but she knows where the giant octopus is. With this information she does what stephen's characters do best and runs away, ready for "gigantic penetration from tiny octopuses" The octopus gets fucked by brambles cos he's a mug so he goes and hugs a deadly sea snake for comfort. The snake carries him onto the ship like a big slippery stallion. Somehow this fixes the boat. Snaketopus attempts to fuck up Tan'lata, she avoids the snake (she's had lots of practice) but falls to japanese anime tropes and gets brutalised by tentacles. Grumpy is still massaging his snake. Tan'lata doesn't want to be bukkake'd so she slips out. And gets up the rigging to safety. Kril'go keeps frothing and hitting because he's had a complete change of personality recently. He almost brutally murders the octopus. Dev'lada sees her moment to steal the glory and kills the octopus. Grumpy is still massaging his snake. It doesn't rouse at all. Tan'lata jumps out of the mast and fires some beast-mode arrow shots like PEW PEW PEW but she forgets she is in a mast and smacks her face into the balustrade, falling onto the deck where she perfectly lands into a rope hole. Kril'go doesn't give a fuck anymore and eats a snake while spinning a naginata. He murders the

snake and also the weasel and slightly his daughter.Dev'lada tugs on her greasy weasel to

rescue it and notices the giant snake is still around. She attacks but there is too much greast and blood. The snake is in its perfect environment and wraps up Kril'go. Grumpy is still massaging his snake. It has begun to stir.Tan'lata kills the last snake, peering out of

her rope hideyhole.Dev'lada saves her weasel by

stuffing her juicy berries into its mouth. Tan'lata tries to stop her and give her a life lesson but Dev'lada just wants to ram them in.As the

combat ends, Grumpy finally gets his snake going and it sputters into a half-life. The party decide the boat is a piece of shit and decide riding a giant sea snake is a much cooler way of getting into town.The goblins set a lovely

campfire on the boat and ride off into the distance straddled across grumpy's giant undead snake.The boat explodes, nobody looks back.We

land in a forest and dont really know where we are so trust Grumpy because he's great. Our snake follows us.We try to sneak through a

forest full of awful creatures. Another tree octopus and a death hippo and some fecking wolves. We get halfway before the octopus spots Kril'go because he is not sneek. Grumpy saves the day by throwing his giant undead snake at it which constricts the octopus in some awful smut pile.Tan'lata snuck on her own because she's a

lone wolf. It fails. The death hippo notices her and goes in for the kill. She does not see the gigantic hippo creature which knocks over the tree she is hiding on, felling it. It snorts through its eyes at her. It's all fucked.The rest of the

gabrins listen to grumpy's tale of his family's gruesome death.Dev'lada tries to help but

doesn't do much. Kril'go trusts Tan'lata because she is a badass and watches sat on a log as Tan'lata skewers the pig after backflipping onto its head. There is a light smatter of applause.We

arrived at a great city of emancipated Goblins. There is a big cloud. It looks like a cloud and not a dragon because dragons do not exist. The village is in ruins, the gabrins are sad. Kolo's throat is sore so he takes a break from the story.



Kolos Story — DeadlySeaSnake



Kolos Story — Tree Octopodicus



Kolos Story — Forest Death Hippo



Rare Sighting of One Dane'O'Saurus

EPISODE 9.3: KOLO'S TALE (PART 3): KISS MYASIS

As the group arrive in Thundertree, Stanri is privately devastated to discover the once shining symbol of goblin emancipation in both literal and metaphorical ruins. To distract himself from the pain he attempts to lead a 3 gabrin game of "what's that bush?" which Tani and Kriigo are very eager to join in with. Pineapple appears to be the group consensus and they all enjoy drinking the white, sticky fluid from the pineapple bushes roots. Just like gramma's bush. A cursory inspection of a nearby house shows ruined furniture and shattered lives (probably).

BUT WHAT'S THIS?! Stanri's keen ears and eyes and nose holes have picked up a clue, a strange rustling in the undergrowth. He tries to convey this in a non-verbal message to Tani, however there is a slight misunderstanding and the weasel is killed by Tani's bow. Devi is not able to see the funny side, and in the resulting confusion Stanri slips away into the bushes to investigate the source of the rustling. This proves to be the largest error on Stanri's part since Tani and Kriigo take it upon themselves to engage in a series of profane and deeply psychologically disturbing, aggressive sexual activities. These start off small with Stanri returning to find that Kriigo has started to rage hump Tani after finding 3 dead gabrin bodies in a house, and is currently bent over with a poisoned arrow inserted into his anus. Stanri does not approve, but the younger gabrins tell him that he just doesn't get it. Stanri wonders when he did in fact last understand "it".

Stanri revivifies a dead goblin (which he curiously finds posed with the other goblins in the shape of a throne?) and learns that humans had slaughtered the adults in the town. The dead goblin teaches Stanri that emancipation

means letting people be as they want to be. If they are not harming anyone else then let them be and do whatever they see fit. Stanri understands now that his prejudice against the two younger goblins's sexy acts was wrong and that a goblin shouldn't judge other goblins. Stanri then goes off to follow child goblin sized foot prints, which is good because his tolerance would have really been put to the test if he had seen what was going to happen next.

Sexual activities not limited to but including the following: - Tani lubing up her full arm with her own goblin spit - Kriigo removing the head from the now unanimated reanimated corpse - The use of the head as a ... spacer?.... prophylactic decoration? basically Kriigo shoved the decapitated head onto his dick so that his dick went like all the way through it (i guess neck hole through mouth?) and then fucked Tani with the other end. They are basically step siblings but it was agreed this was not incest, but just necrophilia.

CLASSY

Stanri is following the tracks. Kriigo and tani are suffering from odd symptoms including fever and hallucination, and learning that it may not be the best idea to fuck dead people. Stanri is able to help Kriigo and save his goblin penis in time, but he is not able to find Tani. Fuck knows where Devi is....

Tani is in a fucking state. Half fever dream, half french experimental cinema, she wanders the vibrant and multicoloured, pulsing town seeing images of pineapple trees and dying ex-lovers. She loves it. She passes out.

Stanri and Kriigo find a group of goblin children who appear to be happy and fed despite not having any goblin parents, as stanri believes every goblin family should have. The children saw the weasel being killed. Stanri has an awkward moment where he remembers that it actually would have been really trivial to bring it back to life.....

AWKS

The children are being looked after by a human woman who lives in a spooky house in town. When this human is referred to as their "master", Stanri feels a flash of racial pride and a deeper burning of anger. To hear the children of the first emancipated town describe a human as master. How could this BE?!?!? The children lead Stanri and Son to the home where they meet an odd human woman. Tani is on a table passed out and the two goblins try to reach her,

pretending that Stanri is old and hard of hearing and impotent so as to no pose a threat. However the lady is able to see through this and paralyses Stanri, also commanding Kriigo to xxx? Tani is speaking odd words like "toyota" and "holidays in ibiza from 5 9 9". Grumpi fears for her life. A fight commences but it is not long before the goblins are victorious, foam oozing out from Kriigos erect and raging penis and mouth.

As Grumpi and Tani search the house for clues, Kriigo goes to gather the children and convince them to listen to grumpi. The two find a message that shows that the church of Hemitate has tried to reclaim the town since it used to be their trading point many generations ago. The horror of this genocide. When will the humans learn? Will a single good human even ever be born? Most likely not at all. Fucking humos. The children arrive and Grumpi tries to convince them of something. He is not quite sure what that is, but he tried to make sure that his message is "hip and happening" and that he lets them know how "rad" he is and how "tubular" it is to be emancipated. The children leave without showing any signs of wanting to spare his feelings. Grumpi has never felt more alone. He misses his wife.

What next for the adventurers eh? Given that the goblin god has stopped speaking and that the church of hemitate has come this far, they may have reached the holy goblin temple. The goblins must cross the scary and wide desert in order to get to the temple and literally and figuratively save the world.



Just another day in the life of a Gabrin

EPISODE 10: A PRETZEL OF POINTLESS ADVENTURES



N the return journey from the emoticon tower...Kolo tries to convince Riphard that returning Otarios body to Nanduan is a good idea Riphard could

get paid to evangelise in a new country, by the very church we can raise an a robot army from nanduan against. Riphard is having none of it,

not believing that Otario is even from Nanduan. Kolo convinces him that he should check out the churches archives and their archivists for more info on Nanduan and the robots. On their travel

back to RiversFall kolo and Riphard come across a dirty group of 30 urchins playing harmonica. They are pleased to see a Pastor. They are miserable. There mines are not for working

anymore, the excavator blew a hole into a new catacomb. They are scared of a noisy cave. Imbeciles. After some discussions the team head

for the mine to solve the noise pollution issue. Thanks to Riphard, the team agree a 10% stake in the mine, in return for sorting some things out. Thank the Gods that the preacher is in charge of negotiations, as he makes up a contract. Exmeh discovers that it's an iron mine. Fishy has to get involved in the contract, Kolo would probably have been better for this. Luckily? The Old dude Quinzel signs on the dotted line. Riphard turns to enter the mine, only

to see nothing but a mecha-bear stanri looking at him. Kolo mounts Pilch, and with their powers

combined, and a climbing pick they descend into the darkness. As Exmeh and Ripahrd nail some 3 point landings behind them. Something other than humans is down here with us. Pilch heads

off down a dead end until he is re-directed. They are sneaky little shits that keep stabbing us from the darkness. Its master splinters love children! They have GOAT friends!!! Somehow the Goat gets the drop on the adventurers, luckily Pilch saddles up and Ripahrd blows the rats brains against the wall. Post Goat Exmeh takes the lead

with her robo "friend", only for Riphard to get sprung by the wolf pack. Things are 100% scary in these tunnels, and it's going badly. RIPHARD is getting ravaged by the wolfs. RIPHARD is knocked out and is fed some cocaine by Fishy to to fix him up. A tactical retreat is made, while new strats and tats are tried. The megaziod is created,

Quoth on Kolo on Pilch. Everything is checked out, labelled, set down in the collated diaries,

compiled into a digest, before finally being added to the compendium. Riphard covers our asses. We find a room full of dead miners, and a ring of deadly visage! +10 make kolo look dead. Lots of dead ends are identified. Kolo suggests a

great location to set a trap, Fishy disagrees just before the party is ambushed again. Fishies force field holds true as the Gabrin twins mow down the rats and wolfs. Riphard refuses to lay hands on Pilch, so throws him a healing word instead. New marching orders in the direction

decided by Riphard. Shitting dwarf illusion first, bird second, kolo pilch next, riphard, exmeh next. Kolo gets lowered into a pit of spikes, as an

echo of Riphards fart finally comes around. A Pretzel of Pointless Avenues. Before Riphards days living in a hole bears some fruit, as he smashes Pilch straight through a wall. Into a room co-habited by Goat Men and a rat man that makes a swift exit. Gabrins dispatch on Goat, before Pilch slices and dices the last one, collecting accolades and ears. Kolo finds a man of

the church in the piles of bodies. He has 2 packs of 4 sticks of dynamite, and Riphard collects a load of church documents from the mine expert. While distracted looting corpses the

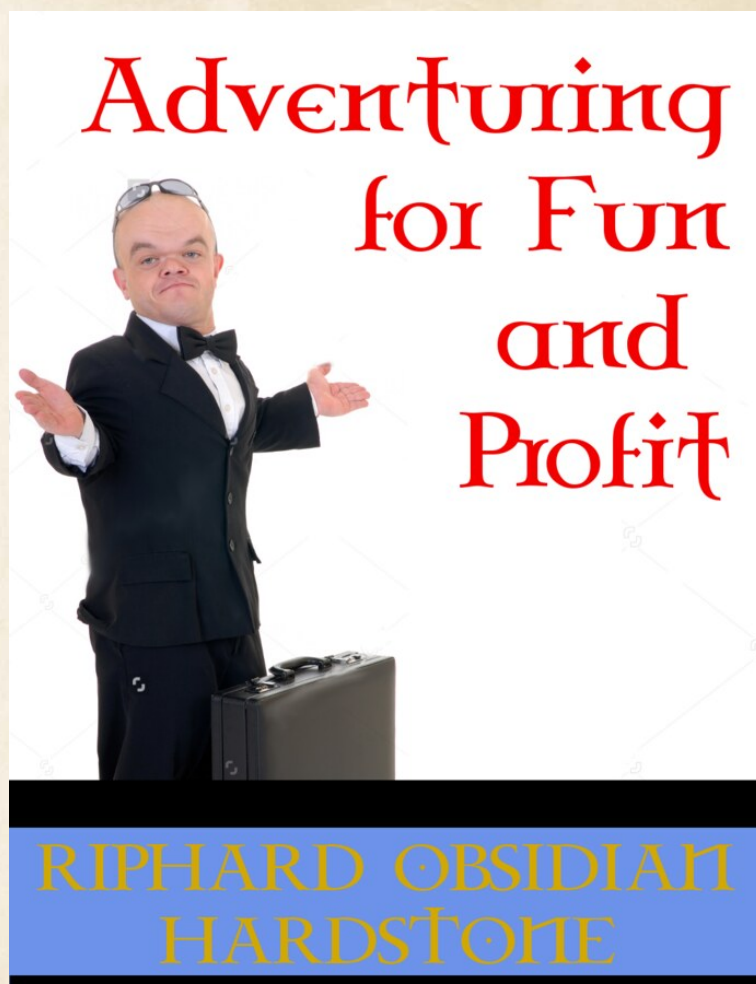
valiant team are almost surprised by Liono and WolfBoys. Riphard gets his back against the wall, as he puts 2 n 2 together looking at the animals in tight lion cloths. Rats take on Exmeh, while the goats seem to have a hard on for Fishy! Gabrins are deathly afraid of lions, this could go badly. Fishy casts a cloud of darkness on the

kitana and chucks it behind the goats, plunging everyone into the darkness. Gabrins hide together in the corner of the darkness popping shots into the unknown. Riphard fucks up the lion from outside, before the burning angry lion comes running straight out of the dark cloud into his face. Turns out old GoldenHide Liono is a tough SoB! Fishy dives out of the shadows and uses some kind crazy shadow sword shit to really fuck up liono. Before Exmeh having run pure electriciy through her system blows the liono to pieces. However taking out the last rat

needs a thunder whip explosion from Riphard creating a Mural of Rat on the Walls. The party

finds a huge hole down into the underdark, which they promptly blow up. Riphard closes the

agreement between the mine owner and Northern Rock for 10% of the mines outgoings.



The Hope's Rest Times #1 Bestseller

EPISODE 11: VOYAGERS OF THE CLOUDSHIP NONTAPRISE

Awakening from a fever dream. . . What the fuck happened yesterday? Did some shopping. Riphard setup the bank - Delilah joined the party. Had dream - told about magic bush - Gulan. Lazarus is a dick that roped Delilah into this. Bobacious walks in wearing a casual suit - purple and yellow 7 inch lappels. I feel thoroughly inadequate. Delilah is weird about banks. We spend some time noticing that only people of a certain ethnicity wear purple and yellow suits. We go and talk to a map guy, give him some information, he gives us a map. . . We want to steal his big map. Kolo goes back and becomes this guys personal adventurer, in return of better maps. Riphard

Research (in the church) - Erasser - other continent, has two sub-regions. Nanduan and Asuma Nanduan - people work for themselves, no ruling class/ruling class (meritocracy) Hearthrusts - nothing Inquisition

Controlled by church: Monetary system is gold/silver/copper (equivalent to ours) - different coins, same values.

Kolo meets a cartographer and agrees to share his "RangerUA" knowledge of new locations with him in return for updated maps. Also secures continent map, and local area map. We have

horses, yay! None of them are cock-unicorns. We climb a mountain - I'm awesome at it, everyone else is a weak pansy. We get attacked by harpies.

Delilah and Kolo try to kill themselves. I boss save Kolo, Delilah gets away from Riphard, but then doesn't kill herself. We all kill harpies,

Delilah kills them extra good. "Signs of the seven around the rim of the tunnel" We find it, we find the bush. We spark up. . . We end up in Dali-land. Some of us (goblins and dwarf) wander off into the desert. Pilch grabs the goblins. We

jump off floating sand platforms. Drown in purple sand. We wake up on a floating sky-boat, get attacked by some evil shadow creatures. Delilah boss-shoots a rainbow at one. I

shadow-strike the living fuck out of another thing. Riphard commands one to "leave" so it vanishes. We kill the others, I absorb one of them. Lazarus shows up. We all fall through the sky. We get picked up and dropped into a garden.

Lazarus cries a red liquid. Delilah is a crazy sky-captain, thinks Lazarus is Gary. Lazarus got BIG. We all start to feel hazy. "Do you not understand. . . that was the hand of Synne" We wake up - there's a big stone creature. . . It is not anatomically correct. We meet Gary. . . The standing stone that stood up. . .

EPISODE 12: THE MARSHAL METHIAS EP

THe Gang start off by talking to Gary about his past. He shares a few stories, for example about Jason Derulo, who was sat on by a thing and killed thousands of years ago. Everyone wants to know about The Ancients, but he's just a rock, so he doesn't really know much. They ride back towards River's Fall, Gary running alongside the horses. They meet a small urchin, with a

message from the caravan guys. It's all "come talk to us, but don't be seen". The boy wants to be paid, but is disappointed. No one knows how to get into the centre of town without being seen. Kolo asks a dog, who tells him to chill out and then Kolo licks his balls (no the dog's balls). They all decide to "put on disguises", which means blacking up for everyone but Esme, who is already black. Gary has a black smudge on his face now which apparently isn't good enough, so the guys make him a cool outfit out of a pretty flowery blanket and some fashion bloomers. Now everyone's completely incognito, the Gabrins go scouting ahead in the classic stealthy trenchcoat ensemble, and the others follow a respectful distance behind. Nothing seems weird in the town, so all this stress was over nothing, I guess. The Gabrins start talking to Hestor, but forget who isn't the groin. Hestor takes them through the fabric flap door thing into the back of a caravan and tells them that that Annoying Arbiter called something dumb is looking for the group, and that they should be on their guard. Hestor tells them that the caravan is going to do them a solid and doing a diversion during the journey to The Seven's Spire, so that the Arbiter will assume they went to a different place. Kolo chats with Fishy's raven, who turns out to be a stand-up guy. He takes the message back to the others, who have just been hanging out somewhere, probably. Fishy suddenly remembers he's supposed to pick up some armour, but the others can't be arsed to stealth into the middle of town, just to leave again, so agree to meet outside the town. Fishy goes to the armour shop and offends the guy slightly by not sucking his dick hard enough. He gets the armour and leave. Esme reutilises a tiny prank bag to put on the back of the raven, potentially to allow drug smuggling. The caravan leaves town, seemingly without a hitch. But maybe there was a hitch. Maybe. Two weeks pass on the caravan. Gabrins tinker. Rocky businesses. Fishy tries to suck up to (and on) Gary, who doesn't seem to love how violent he is. They get into the town, whatever it's called. Everyone from the town is in the town square being real sad. There's a young boy and the mother in the centre. Apparently, it's his time to participate in the local coming-of-age ceremony, which seems to have a high fatality rate. After Gary pokes

around a bit, they find out that there's a thing that happens in the church at night during the ceremony. They find the local religious leader, who is called Eminem. Everyone's all "don't try and be insidy, outsiders". The place is called Logarsk. Everyone goes to the pub, and agrees that the Gabrins should stake out the church and see what happens. Esme is eating a big bear of the local delicacy "Pom-bears". The lady who's son is going to get ceremonied comes up to ask the group for help. Apparently, the children go to the church, and get put on trial to see if they're evil. If they are, something that sounds like Babayaga (but not quite), comes and takes them away. The group carry on drinking, promising the woman they'll do something. Riphard eventually gets drunk enough to suddenly leave the pub and go to the church. The Gabrins follow. Wankfish stands outside the pub, just generally chilling. Gary is inside the pub, still, staring straight ahead while Delilah tries to flirt. Back at the church, Riphard forgets the secret observation plan and knocks on the front door, asking for some church. The guy who opens the door is one of the guys they were talking to earlier, so immediately tells Rocky to go away. Somehow, though, potentially by being drunk, Rocky convinces the guy that he needs to pray and has to come in. Riphard's alcoholism has been pretty beneficial in the long run, really. Once he gets in, and loudly proclaims that he can pray anywhere he wants, Eminem shouts at him and tells him to go away. Riphard responds that it's fine because they left the pews out. They did not leave the pews out. Rocky gets told to leave. He does. The Gabrins are on the roof, unable to gain ingress. Eventually, they slip in between the roof tiles, and get in, just in time to see Rocky get thrown out. They do a bit of watching, then send the raven off to get help. And also Pom-bears. Also, they're planning to blow up the church, so there's that. Gary and Pilch come to the church, bringing both help and Pom-bears. They pick up Rocky on the way. Literally, because he's unwilling. Fishy tries to open the front door, ignoring the plan, which is not to do that. Fishy refuses to follow orders. The Gabrins still have the only plan, which is to blow

up the church. Wankfish is now a raven, and is fluttering about, still not following the plan. He lands on the statue and does the whole "Greetings Mortals" bit. One guy buys it, but Eminem hits him in the face. Then he shoots the raven. Wankfish is still a dick after that, and tries to kick the doors down. The Gabrins suddenly realise the kid could be downstairs and think they should go downstairs. They go and tell the others the plan, and Gary suggests having a chat with the bad guys at the front door to cause a distraction, or, ideally convince them to change their minds. The Gabrins meet back on the roof and agree to involve Stanri the robot bear in some way. Stanri briefly has a human brain, but then it's retconned. The Gabrins scamper off into the basement to see what's happening. Gary knocks on the door and explains that there's obviously some mistake, because he thinks they're bad guys, and they must be good guys, and could he please speak to the boss please and his foot's in the door, but it's not a problem because everyone's nice. Meanwhile, Esme sings the traditional Gabrin folk tune "Gabrins on the way, having fun, and save the day.". They find a room downstairs, but it's empty, but it's not because there's a secret door. Gary and Wanker get invited in. Rocky tries to climb the church, but fails, and then succeeds. Gary and Wanker talk to Eminem, who, wouldn't you know it, he's evil.

EPISODE 13: NOBODY EXPECTS THE...



Gabrins down below, rock boy and dark one up above, drunk at the window. Negotiations have failed, it's fighting time. Gary tries to calm the situation before waving his flower stick at them all. The auld sun seems to remind them all that it's nap time, but not for a few hours yet. Pilch chucks his sword into the fight, and darkens surrounds everyone. Kolo and exmeh return to see if Gary has arrived yet, only to be met by a big ball of darkness. The pastor rolls out of the back of the dark cloud and boom unloads into poor ikkle kolo. Pilch decks one monk, and gary bashes another with his fancy branch. Kolo is unconvincing, but the pastor is shooting

blanks Riphard shoots and dives through a pristine stain glass window, descending in a blaze of coloured glass. The slow mo is unbelievable! Jeff gets confused and bashes his mate, poor old Jeff he was only 2 months from retirement. Nobodies sees pilch flailing about, and exmeh is called late to the party, but not before the shady pastor lights kolo up, literally. Gary does a pirorette, if anyone could see him they would know he was born to be a dancer. Glowing kolo takes a good hard look at the pastor, before killing him. As he dies, the pastor says that "... they will come for you. . ." Jeff gets Whipped Hard! As the whip crack booms out enough thunder to send Jeff to his knees. Gary tries to convince Jeffs mate that its time to stop all this tom-foolery, its not very effective, so he scarpers and then starts playing with a corpse somehow making it alive again. Seeing the fight is almost over, Pilch gets nasty and starts cleaving the elders apart. He then sheaves his blade and the room returns to normal. Gary goes round saving the elders and the shady pastor, unfortunately Jeff doesn't make it. Retirement isn't for everyone. . . Pilch summons a freaky dark shadow wolf, while everyone else locks the doors and tries to fix up the window Riphard leapt through. (How Love is born) The party descends into the dark crypt, kolo takes the lead and stealthily gets covered in dust. Exmeh leads the now blind Gary around, until kolo gives him the hooded lamp. We find a dozen set of childs bones of the floor. Gabrins mount up and Gary leads the way. . . almost immediately we come across a small bound child that is emanating a new kind of evil. We find the womans child strung out on a stone, Gary tells everyone the stone is evil, Kolo protects him from evil causing the nasty glow from his eyes to recede. and we all agree to tie the kid too the marshall upstairs. As the team turn around they are faced down by two giant armoured beasts, the silent and deadly knights who say ni! The knights charge in making a team sandwich, Riphard is stuck between a "Rock and a hard place" Garys tries to 1v1 one of them and even though he fails, he succeeds. Riphard whips, fishy is dodgy, and the gabrins shoot. The first to knights get wrecked by the whole team, but not before a whole lot more of them, and some kind of master appears. The guys fucks with kolos

mind, and tries to control the whole party. Thanks to the mighty Gary carrying us out we make it back to see the marshall again. Things are not looking good. Kyross the kebab lady

meets us back in the Cathedral, pilch casts darkness and similar to the old story he acts like the hero Philo, and tries to run away. Kolo is forced into telling the truth, he tells rather a lot of it. As Philo tries to jump the Kebab lady, she shoots him out of the sky. Thankfully Kolos truth bomb leads to a moment of truce. After

grilling us about certain stables, and then the Marshall on what was going on downstairs in his childrens sex dungeon, she decides to blow Fritzls head to pieces. She leaves the party in tact partly due to services rendered and then goes out to explain to the town about the how the church weren't at fault. The team comes up

with a fool proof method of getting the real truth out by using the surviving child. . . Riphard chats

up the Arbiter Kyross about how she tracked us, and what should go forward from now. He doesn't make a lot of headway, and Delilah gets seriously jealous. Kolo briefly talks to Riphard

about what he knows about the inquisition, it transpires that a member of them killed Riphard, and that he may/may not have been one of these children on the rock in the past

EPISODE 14: LEMON STEALING WHORE



The group have noticed animosity towards the few small folk and ourselves in the village of Logarsk, despite rescuing future children for torture and death and shit. Pilch and Riphard

agree to organise a bake sale in remembrance of the tragedy of Logarsk and to improve the status of small people in the village for the SRA. They will convince the bereaved mothers to bake cupcakes and sell them at full price, because small cakes are worth just as much as full size cakes. Kolo agrees with Hestor to part ways

outside Seven Spires due to the danger posed to our group. He then goes to get wood for something. Riphard smells out the most cakely scented house in the village. Pilch knocks on the door and chats with a snooty french sounding man. He agrees that the plan sounds good in the wake of the tragedy and says he will help cook miniature cakes and pies. However, he only has full sized cake tins, so he needs us to get miniature cake trays and tins in addition to any supplies like flour and eggs. His name is Alfonzey Closenough. Pilch goes to the farm and

meets a large buxom lady. She has a gruff voice. She agrees with the bake sale idea, but asks what she gets in return. Pilch freezes as he searches for an idea. He tentatively flirts with the lady and agrees to come back later to give her something in reward. Cough. Riphard heads

toward the lemon orchard. Delilah meets Rip on the way and says she can help get the lemons. Rip thinks she's talking about selling her body, but she tells him how good at stealing she is. An

old man looks longingly at his lemon trees, with his arm around a beautiful (6/10) young woman. She's no Delilah. Riphard waits for them to look away for at least 10 seconds. The couple talk about how they love their lemon tree and hope no bandits steal their lemons. They look at their house for no apparent reason. Riphard tells

Delilah it's time to steal the lemons. They head to the tree with their backpacks open, ready to put the lemons in. They start stealing the lemons.

They're not spotted. They keep stealing lemons. Still unnoticed, but Delilah suggests they hide behind the tree and get the lemons on the other side. They've got all the lemons except one particularly beautiful looking lemon that only Delilah can reach. She fucking nails her reach for the lemon and plucks it perfectly. Unfortunately Rip falls off the ladder, crashing to the ground, alerting the couple. "They're stealing our lemons!" "CHEESE IT!" shouts Rip. Rip and

Delilah set off running, slowed down by all the lemons, but the couple can't keep up and they escape with the lemons. "Those bloody lemon

stealing bandits!" Pilch visits Esme to ask if she can make miniature cake pans. She says she can after some insulting the "fishy wanker". Pilch asks how long it will take, and Esme presents him with a pre-made miniature cake pan, because she overheard him talking to the frenchy. Pilch seems touched. Rip, Delilah, and

Pilch arrive back at the baker's house. He expresses surprise at the sight of the return, thinking they would fail. They discuss the bakesale. Gary shows up talking about children. Alfonzey suggests they sell the cakes at the market, the lemon stall in particular is impressive, who will surely help. Somehow a

philosophical conversation about life breaks out and Gary drops some deep wisdom, lost on the rest of the group. The group try to sell Alfonzey on the exposure he will gain from taking part as he inquires about fee for the first fucking time. Who agrees to help THEN asks for a fee? Frenchcunt. Pilch gives him a gold coin. Which is

way over the amount he would charge for a days work. What an idiot. Alfonzey gladly takes the overpayment. Riphard suggests they have a look

at other stall options. Pilch agrees, saying that the lemon people have clearly helped enough already with their generous donation of lemons. The group approach the market. Pilch

says him and Esme can knock up some promo materials by the next day to raise awareness for the bake sale. Riphard speculates that there will be a decent amount of foot traffic to the market anyway due to the lack of advanced refrigeration, but that promo materials would help direct people to the stall. It turns out the

local bakery is totally shit by the way, and owned by Alfonzey's brother, Alfonzbe. Gary and

Kolo try to get to speed with the lemon bake sale, who threaten to derail the bake sale by warning the lemon people that their generous gift of all the lemons could give the village scurvy later on due to the lemon shortage. Kolo and Gary go to try

and get a stall. They meet Mr Screw, a goblin who makes screws, but is deathly afraid of nails. They tell him of the backsale plan and how it will improve the village attitudes towards small people. It has now become clear that they plan to make their own stall. Mr Screw states that there are 28 screws missing from the market, that he totally didn't steal back to resell. He has 28 screws for sale. For 15 fucking gold! Jesus

screws are expensive in this town. "There's a reason they call me The Screwer" Kolo tries to

steal the screws. Mr Screw goes to offer a discount, but Kolo interrupts and offers him a straight swap of 28 new screws he has for Mr Screws 28 old screws he has. Cos that makes sense. Gary compliments Mr Screw at the fine work he does. The group look for some wood.

Pilch wants to cut down the harvested lemon trees. Because they are clearly now useless. The group scoffs at him. Esme has apparently

finished a stall and been telling us for a while. She seems upset that no one appreciates her handiwork in the background. Kolo says something creepy and weird. Esme wishes she had a sister. Gary says he can make it happen. Kolo suggests Stanri the bear can help

attract people to the bake sale. Esme says he will do a shit job. Stanri is apparently still leaking liquid that Esme didn't put him in. The group sniff a potential profit in the making, selling seemingly oil from a mechabear. But it turns out it's just dirty water. "Don't question my

work. Fishy wanker." Alfonzey approaches with the lemon goods. He says he used all the ingredients but had lemons left, so made lemonade. Riphard asks if it's miniature lemonade. The group now need to find small glasses. More work. Riphard is surprised at how quickly Alfonzey made all the cakes, in like an hour, but apparently there's an incredible arrangement of cakes and pies. A true party of lemon based baked goods. The group start the search for small glasses or cups. Except they don't because everyone is sick of fetch quests. Pilch wonders if Gary can guard the produce, but Riphard wonders if Gary eats, and worries he might eat all the pies. Pilch encourages Gary to try a bit of biscuit. Gary Baldy joke. Gary likes the biscuit. "EATING IS GOOD!" Pilch hooks Gary on cigarettes and breathing. He now has an oxygen addiction. THE NEXT DAY No one notices anything during the night. Gary ate a load of pies. Fucks sake. He is sleeping under the stalls. Riphard threatens to sell Gary in the bake sale. Pilch's new squeeze approaches. She seductively eats a pie whole and flicks a silver piece in Pilch's direction. She tells Pilch how much she's looking forward to tonight. No one made the promo material. Esme delivers a letter via Kolo saying "Call your fucking bird off" Gary preaches about his new found love of eating to the market goers. Riphard distantly adds in the price, reason for the bake sale, and how it represents that small things are just as valuable in society as full size things. Crowds gather around the stall. "Wow. Food! You gotta eat it!" Riphard gives his best salesman pitch, fully utilising the recent child tragedy to exploit the people to donate as much as possible. Kolo spies the lemon people who are dismantling their stall, putting up a sign saying "No Lemons". Kolo tries to convince them to sell their screws to Screw, assuming that they no longer need their stall ever again. The group still don't know that lemons grow back. Gary thanks the lemon people for their generous gift of lemons. They tearfully explain that someone stole their lemons and that there are no other lemon farmers. Pilch tries to convince the others something about limes. But they don't what limes are. They ask Riphard where he got the lemons. Deducing that clearly someone stole the lemons, then posed as a fake lemon salesman. Riphard states that a passing

lemon salesman generously gave him the lemons for the good cause. The lemon farmers accuse a dwarf and a woman of stealing the lemons. Gary speculates that maybe their prejudice against small people has made them assume it was a dwarf, rather than a normal sized person far away. They say that means the woman must have been a giant. The group agree that that's an equally likely probability, and go to investigate the crime scene as Riphard continues selling the cakes. Apparently this is exactly like the justice league according to Stephen. The lemon trees look bare. "Oh no, they'll never have lemons again. They never grow back" says Gary. An argument about how lemon trees work breaks out between Gary and the farmers. Kolo and Gary investigate. They find two sets of tracks around the tree. Under one tree is a very accurate imprint of a dwarf arse in the grass. Kolo tracks the grass trail. They go behind a tree and made some mysterious imprints before heading towards the caravan. The group realise Hestor must be responsible. "But he's neither a woman or a dwarf?" - Kolo "As far as we know. . . " - Gary They question Hestor about the lemon thieves. Gary intimidates Hestor into squealing about the thieves. Hestor doesn't know nuffin'. "Help me help you" says Kolo clichély. Hestor says it might be "your friends". Gary and Kolo come to the reluctant realisation it must have been Delilah and Riphard. Hestor wants some of the lemon goods. "We have to burn what we don't sell. Don't want to demarket the value" - Gary. Hestor begs for cakes. They head back to the market. Pilch is just laying there chilling with Quoth, completely oblivious. Riphard, Delilah, the cakes, and the money are gone. Gary sweeps all the produce off a neighbouring stall, angry. "I've had it with this!" "THEY CAN'T KEEP GETTING AWAY WITH IT!" "We've been played for fools!" Gary to Pilch:

"You're too close to the ground, you can't see what matters." The investigation continues. Gary notices a dwarf shaped hole in the fence behind the stall. They aim to follow the scent of lemons, but they end up in a field of corn. They wander around the field of corn for 30 minutes, lost, accidentally making weird geometric shapes in the corn. Gary eats corn. "When I sent my mind

on a perp, there's nothing that's gonna get in my way. . . . except CORN!"They agree to head back to the caravan. They find Riphard and Delilah there, who tell them to hurry up, wondering where they've been, oblivious to the investigation.Gary tackle Riphard to the ground, accusing him of stealing the lemons. Riphard says this is libellous and threatens him with legal action. Gary backs off.Riphard denies everything, sensibly explaining how everyone has benefitted and is happy and we should just leave. They say they need to compare his ass to the assprint, attempting to carry him off.Riphard accuses Kolo of abandoning the SRA and its ethics. It's pretty tense. Kolo walks away in disgust.There's some more discussion of screws.Hestor tells everyone it's time to leave for Seven Spire. The caravan sets off north. Riphard convinces the group that he's done good for the village, donating all the profits and totally not stealing the lemons. Kolo remains unconvinced.Gary is now a pirate.3 days pass as the group travel north.The caravan arrives outside Seven Spire.It's a moderate sized city. Hope's Rest is definitely bigger, but the city is dominated by a fucking huge spire. Hope's Rest doesn't have that now, does it!The church are in the spire or something, and the district around it is also all dedicated to religion, like tat shops hawking religiosity, which is a real word. Making money and profit is a bit vulgar and is therefore kept to the outskirts, which allows us to get supplies without much risk of church shit going down.There are numerous heavy plated guards present. They have sometimes one, sometimes multiple god symbols on them. There's a right mix of gods being repped. But the guards definitely love that church symbology, which is also a word.Pilch and Riphard know that there are certain colourations that represent certain gods and combinations, and they notice it everywhere, informing the fasion of the city. Everyone, particularly the moneyed looking, are sporting serious god swag. Commoners are obviously in potato sacks, as they should be according to the church. Despite this it's overall quite an ostentacious place.Gary gets a small feel and a faint whiff of church corruption somehow in the air or something. He's not impressed.Hestor guides us to friendly and useful merchants.Rich pissed off - Steve H doing

it now.Pilch tracks down the sword - Masudon blade (Masuda area/clan?) - Finds out how to properly sharpen it and how to swing it (slashing, not stabbing) - Might make Kitana +2 attack (+1 damage).Kolo goes to buy stuff for travelling across a desert - the exanpanse - northern desert - complete shithole. Spansers are raiders there.There's no port because of shallow waters and rockiness - easy for raiders to get big ships with smaller ones.Kolo is upset about everything - he goes drinking. Gary doesn't need a shield.Kolo hates Riphard, Gary, Me, and everything really, even his own sister a bit.Gary shits himself after drinking firewater.RIP Mikes Fish.

EPISODE 15: JUST DESSERT - AND SOME BIRD PEOPLE

 ear diary (Exme). We have been having such a busy few days. I had had so much fun at the lemon party that I barely even could remember being there. We had almost two weeks of travel across the sand sea ahead of us and everyone was in high spirits or so I am told. I decided to keep quiet until I had a chance to figure out what was going on. Mother always said "A wise gabrin knows to keep quiet sometimes because sometimes you will look a tit"

Kolo had the good idea to travel at night. Gary decided to ask around about what was the best thing to do but he must not have gotten any good advice because nothing came of it. I decided to play with my lovely new lion armor. I look like a lion now which is pretty stylish. Kolo told everyone he could navigate by the stars. Last time he tried it I suppose we did get there in the end, but oh so many lives were lost. But you can't argue with results.

We headed into the desert. Oh it looked beautiful with all the moonlight spilling over the dunes. Kolo led the way and before we knew it, it was the morning time. On the third night Fishy was acting very strangely. He came out of the caravan all sweaty and black and pulsy and he threw away his sword and said a lot of very naughty words. Kolo and fishy played a little game of throwy-fetchy but eventually the sword vanished. It is nice to see Kolo helping fishy to feel like he has friends. Maybe he will not feel so sad anymore. I can't imagine living his life.

Kolo tells me he tried to get some business advice off Gary about the apothecary. But maybe

it sounds like Gary doesn't quite know what that is. They played a nice game of smacky face to stay awake.

Another two days passed. Fishy was not looking so good. Perhaps he got some sand in his naughty parts, or at least that is what Kolo has said. It would explain a lot. That and his latent homosexuality. It is a shame he was not born a gabrin. He would have made a bad one and brought shame upon his whole clan, but gabrins are a progressive peoples and would not have judged him so much. Kolo tried to comfort him by trying to get him involved in some botany. Fishy was not so good at it. He just kept running after a little lizard but it kept outsmarting him. Things picked up a little the next day. I was trying to get some sand out of my eyes when suddenly there was a big rumbling! These giant two clacking creatures just came up right of the sand and it was so quick! And they were trying to get the horsies as well! It was not nice at all because the horsies had not even done anything to them except for maybe looking at them a little funny but to be fair they were probably just shocked and it did seem like an over-reaction on the part of the monsters. We had to act quickly to save the horsies and we had to throw everything we could at them. I think it's safe to say we had the upper sand and those pesky creatures were soon no more. Kolo managed to make the best of the situation and found some liver. Gary doesn't know if he has a liver so he ate one for some reason. He said he enjoyed it but he did vomit a lot and didn't look so great. Kolo did some more digging and later he privately told me that he had actually given Gary the creature's acid sac which of course was not ideal. It is probably best we don't tell him.

Kolo tried to tell the horses what was what but they told him in response that that was not what what was. They didn't seem to want an apple. Gary managed to sneak up to the horses in the way that only a giant rock man can, and healed them up something good. We carried on. Two days and nights later, the desert was making everybody very tired. Kolo kept talking about an apothecary although it was hard to understand him because his mouth was always full of the magic leaves. Probably something to keep an eye on. He keeps singing The next day we spotted two camps in the distance. They had caravans and chariots and they were covered in feathers and bees. Kolo managed to see very far, probably because his pupils were so wide, and he saw that the people were not people even but they were actually bird people. They had arms which was odd but we do know a talking rock man so I have come to expect this kind of thing.

There were also some humans too in the other camp. I took a moment to appreciate Gary's hat. I saw delilah give it a jealous look but I didn't say anything. Gary tried to be friendly. The bird people did not. Gary had to bring in Kolo as an interpreter. He started squawking and it seemed like it might be going okay. Although he was quite twitchy. One of the humans turned up and he was dressed in quite a stupid outfit that kind of looked like a bird but wasn't. He spoke in a strange voice and had a pipe that he smoked in quite an odd way. Sometimes humans like to try and look interesting like this I have noticed, but the overall effect was someone who had tried too hard to stand out and I felt a little sorry for him. He started spinning some story about his people being savages and the birds being honourable birds and he said that he had invented some kind of games to play to sort it out all out but it was all pretty silly. Somehow Gary got us involved in the games. Personally I felt we had more pressing issues like reclaiming our souls and escaping the untold horrors of the endless burning desert, but it's always nice to meet new people and try new things so we did it.

We all had to decide who did what event. Gary was keen on the Melle since he had spent so much time in meleesia. I offered Stanri to do the games with the hope someone might figure out how to destroy him but everyone seems to like him for some reason. His stupid cute face. I have spent the last few nights trying to figure out how to shut him down but something is going on I don't understand. Sometimes when I look into those glowing optimistic eyes it's almost like there is something looking back at me.

Fishy doesn't look well. In his obvious weakness he asks us for help. How embarrassing for him. He keeps blithering on about his sword being evil somehow. Kolo steps up and takes the sword. Problem solved apparently. ONLY THE SWORD FLEW BACK INTO FISHY'S HAND. It was funny in a way because Fishy was very sad but maybe it could be a problem. He showed us his new tattoo and he had this look on his face when he did it like it was significant. I tried to look suitably shocked to ease his feelings. He said that it was like the mark of Syn. I got a little bored. Kolo humoured him but quickly everyone else got bored. Kolo tried to teach Stanri a dance. Fishy kept going on so Gary put him to sleep which frankly was a massive relief and was widely accepted by everybody to have been a good move. Everybody picked what they would do. Fishy and Gary decided to do melee, Kolo and delilah wanted jousting and me and Mr. Riphard decided to do

some racing. What an exciting morning. "Manly noises" everywhere in the arena.

We met the man in the weird bird clothes and he asked about our chariot. This would have been useful information last night but Exme is always ready to step up and sort these messes out. I got to work. Kolo tells me that after I left the melee got underway. It all sounded very excited. Some bird man called KUURAARRRK walked in and at first he looked massive but Kolo was just looking too close. He has a poor understanding of perspective sometimes. They also had FUREKAKKK and short stack and Irana Strongfist which everyone laughed about later but I'm not sure why. It is probably something to do with the patriarchy. Everyone got into position and then the fight began! For some reason the crowd was very excited for fish wank and they kept cheering him on. The fight started and kolo says it felt itchy. I thought this was an odd description but I may have misheard because his mouth was full of magic leaves. He said that Gary was beautiful spinning around in a cloud of rainbows and desert-suitable flowery attire. Fishy made everything dark which isn't great for spectator sports. Kolo says that he wasn't really surprised, quote "fishy gonna fish". We have often wondered together how Fishy is still alive. Though I must admit we have warmed to him in the recent weeks, that fact still doesn't account for his incredible luck in the face of overwhelming incompetence. It is almost endearing in a way that I fear Stanri never will be.

I was working hard on the chariot. I didn't have much time but fortunately I've considered this scenario many times in the past. I had to steal the wheels and rear axle off one of the caravans and Kolo had to spend quite a bit of time convincing the horses to help. He tells me that he was surprised how racist horses are but I chose not to press the issue. We kept hearing thunderous cheers from the dome. I managed to hook up the shield generator to the frame and sort out some arrangements with the explosives and rockets. Riphard suggested he could use his flatulence in some way to help. I smiled politely as I thought it would be the easiest way to make him go away.

Hmmm. Kolo is insisting on writing about the fight. He seems very excited about it all, although it is hard to tell through all the magic leaves: (KOLO) Fishy and Gary are in for the big rumble in the dome, classic fishy farts out the darkness and the fight is now behind closed doors. Its very unclear whats going on in general, but looks as if Gary is dancing with the small

one. Dark cloud moves just in time, for armoured birdman to skewer the half orc monk. Orcy kebob?

Garys mystic rainbow stick smacks upside shortstock, a lovely explosion of glitter surrounds them both. Pikey bird pops out of the darkness then stabs shortstock in back, who just lops off the crows head!

Gary tries to get the crowd riled and behind him, but his heart is not in it, something about birdy beheading has really upset him. The sound of thunder is behind him, and in a unicorn esque sweep of his stick he bats short stock across the ring! Now the crowd love him.

Darkness drops, and fishy is left flapping on the floor. The crowd goes wild as a the pile of bodies is exposed.

Gary loses his mind and rushes over healing all the downed warriors. For reasons as yet unexplained the rolling rock gathers no moss. Gary then batters her unconscious, with a mighty glitter bonk, hands out a nap. Instead of dropping out tho she starts a slow Gary chant, whipping the crowd into a frenzy. With the crowd behind him he its nap time for the Tengu, who whips the tengu into a fervour, everyone screaming GARY GARY GARY !

Until he makes a cry out to the crowd for enjoying the killing. Boooooo bitches Boooo, we love the killing!

EPISODE 15A: PILCH JOURNAL - THROUGH THE SANDS

[A sheaf of paper, burned at one corner and retrieved from a fire - the only tell-tale mark of the author - Pilch. The handwriting is a scrawl, and while it changes fonts and style frequently, appears to be more down to the writer's worsening condition than an intentional affect]

First night in the expanse: The dreams are getting worse, ever since my powers awoke I've felt a slow diminishing of my strength, my vitality, occasionally substituted (bargained away?) by dark powers. When I fused the stone of Un'thala with my own shadow-blade I thought I had managed to stop this wellspring of dark energies, but I see now it was more like a dam - a dam which has sprung leaks and may soon burst, drowning me in darkness.

I will rest a while, the others I can trust to carry me through the desert - though this land of light is certainly not helping me. Thankfully Howlov and Quoth do not seem to be affected.

Second night:

Black Sabbath, my curse bringing blade now haunts my dreams. It has a voracious hunger it wants me to feed, and while I gladly would, I cannot sate it. It has turned its parasitic needs to me, and as the shadows grow the sword threatens to consume me.

But there is light, I can see it in my dreams, the Mark of Synne still glows, just about holding back the shadow, a small pool of refuge in an eternal night.

...Third night?:

I have slept for more hours than I have been awoken, the sword whispered to me in my sleep, and I have tried to throw it away, but it is always there in my dreams, and always there when I awaken. My pallour is pale, and my veins throb with dark energy. I will likely need the others soon.

Another night:

The mark of synne whispered to me tonight - well, not in any true sense. I feel it holds within its infinite curves a small fragment of fate itself - why I so often avoid disaster when I should have died long ago. . . Including that first day I wore it with that Arbiters bullet. . .

The whispers are a vision, a prophecy I feel showed me with 5 others, 4 living and one dead. A man of stone, a man from under stone, and two pariahs trying to do good for their people, as well as a being made of spinning gears that no longer spin. Otaria - I am surprised to see.

The dream goes on, where the men of stone each, wreathed in divine light, hold an edge of a sword I recognise as Black Sabbath, and pull it apart.

Shadow erupts out of it in great torrents, threatening to drown me, but then one of these outcasts, Kolo I believe, parts the waves for me. I reach down and grasp the stone of Un`Thala from this black tide. The other pariah, no doubt exme, hammers it into an exotic curved blade, connected by a single thread of light to the being of once-spun gears.

I feel this prophecy is clear, that in order to rid myself of the shadow I must shatter the Cursebringer with the aid of my allies, a pastor and a creature of old magic, then, protected by Kolo, I can aid Exme in forging the refined power into the Katana that felled Otaria - a link to an old friend.

I feel hope.

Night after the ritual:

Well fuck me. I don't know whether I shouldn't trust this band of jackasses or if the mark of Synne is on the blink. . . I'm free from the darkness, but the prophecy went awry.

But at least Kolo did his part, and Gary (accidentally) did his.

What actually happened: The others refused to help me, save Kolo who gave me protection from the shadow. The relief was instantaneous. Gary then, more out of want not to deal with me than intentional help put me to sleep with his old magic. This divine energy and the protection from the darkness let me stand against the sword in my dreams, and use the mark of Synne to purge the shadows from my body and melt the cursebringer to nothing.

When I awoke I found a tingling sensation in my. . . my minds grasp? It was the stone of Un`thala! Or at least its essence. This I was able to fuse with the Katana that felled my friend Otaria - and while I cannot feel a direct link or her presence as I had hoped, I shall wield the blade in her honor - naming it the Iron Maiden!

[later that day]

Welp Gary didn't kill everyone, and I got knocked flat on my ass - Iron Maiden did good though!

EPISODE 16: I'LL BITE YOUR FACKING FACE OFF

 xme has built some bitching chariots out of stuff she just had hanging around. One's a cyber-boss from the future, with nitro-boost and everything, and a smaller jousting one for Kolo.Kolo fails at

convincing any of the animals to do anything gets bitten by a raptor and insulted by a horse - Pilch becomes Papa Lazarizzz - the blackfaced charletan. He sells a sword to the humans, disarming them of their Lance - little do they know his plans. . . Delilah and Kolo discuss rules.

Kolo contemplates suicide for the win, but doesn't. He also necks a bunch of drugs.Rules: 3

point for helmet 2 points for KO 1 point for disarmingYellow and Red raptorsBlue, Pink and

Orange (Spancer) CharriotsThere's also a mystery green charriot (the colour orange actually is) because the universe is colourblind. Green and orange are opposite in Velterra.BirdyRaptor comboa attacks spancers, spancers responds by disarming them (avec

Pilch's sword)Kolo stays still and attempts to shoot them with his bow - so many boos.Howlov knocks prone the green's horse when it attacks. Spancers horse is prone but not yet completely fucked.Others move around, achieve little.Kolo sets prone spancers on fire with firewater, then runs away, Another spancers chariot then strikes the helmet off of prone spancers in their disabled state.Birdy raptor charges Kolo and co, but Howlov holds his ground.Another bird raptor gets fucked hard by the spancers.Kolo fucks those spancers with his lance, taking off the helmet.BirdyRaptors lose control and then falls into a pit. Lol.Kolo then delivers the coup de gras on the prone and on fire spancer chariot team.Remaining spancer kills the last of the BridyRaptor teams.Kolo runs pink into the pit by exploding it with an exmeh special boomstickAnd that's why cultural diversity is like a rainbow. . . of death.Gary then rezzes people.Kolo dives into a pit to rob someone blind. Oh wait, he's mutilating their corpse. That's much worse.Kolo got 9 points, BirdyRaptor teams 5 each, Spancers got a combined teams score of 1.Kolo does the same chop chop to a nasty Raptor. ONTO HORSEY RACESKolo cokes up a horse. Who gets really into the idea of racing and eating other horses faces.Exme and Riphard get into their suped-up cyborg charriot.6 chariots3 Raptor - Tengu with various weaponry.One spancer has net and trident, another has a sling - heavy duty sling. And a cattle prod.The race starts.Riphard's coke-horse has. . . wheel spin? Ends up in last place due to kicking sand rather than pushing forward.Starts to accelerate further forwards, overtaking Raptor 3.There's a ramp round the corner, Rip flies with un-dwarf like elegance and overtakes the tar-stuck raptor 2.He shoots the sling-spancer for daring to throw a stone at him.Exme blows the living shit out of the net spancer with a pair of weaponised fireworks from the SRA leader dude like months ago (are the fireworks even still good?)The front Raptor drops oil in front of an fork - trying to force the team down the right

path.Pilch Minor illusions the image of a small child in front of the leading raptor Chariot. The raptor tries to eat the child, probably helping it run along.Exme hits the red button - the horse gets a shot of nitro-adrenaline uber-brew. The horse shits itself and dies, broken legs, broken back by the charriot. . . exploded heart. The chariot gets flipped awesomely but the first raptor makes it through. Riphard then crawls through the line by himself, earning silver.RIP horse.Big ceremony. Has Gary convinced people of the way of no violence? No, the trophy is a fucking human skull with silver in it.We feast, we're happy. We go talk to the leaders.Bird people are cool, they become our allies with Kolo discussing. We should send Quoth to find them if ever we need them.Gary manages to piss off the spancer tribe leaders, but they're ultimately not going to kill us, so that's a win.Basically, they both know we don't like the church and might be our allies in future.Riphard pisses off to the desert to think about this mad world like a big emo.Kolo follows on Howlov - talks to Riphard about a money laundering and drug distributing operation. Also the sky is filled with snakes from goblin folk-lore.Riphard is a massive anti-goblin racist, Kolo doesn't understand business. They get to some sort of agreement.Everyone sits around the fire, and nothing bad happens.

EPISODE 17: HOPES REST

THe bird people may have a caste system, but luckily we will tell the little birdies all about emancipation and the great Stanri story. That will be sure to sort it all out.I must now lead my lovely lovely party through the desert, it is very hot in the day but luckily we are travelling at night, and Fishy has been looking out for my spiny bush.After a few days we emerge 100% on the North side, but maybe not exactly anywhere in particular.Fishy starts eating grass, everyone is slightly bemused but what can you do about a dark and stormy emo??I take a power nap while Gary gets the map in order and leads us into the next chapter of our adventure. . . .Transpires Fishy got shot in the city recently. But we travel on regardless, until we spy a lovely new road. Its the main drag between Port Averdale and Hopes Rest. Lovely

smooth cobbles. I go off looking for more leaves and roots and herbs and things. I clearly need some more. I deliver my great finds to Exmerah, she seems very pleased. Wagons roll we are off

again, until we come across the classic dead horses in the road ambush! Reminds me of an old trick we used to use in the North. Luckily there is a sitting duck or little girl out as bait. Gary goes to investigate her, she seems safe, Gary is like a nurturing parent. Riphard goes to investigate the horses, seems they are indeed dead. While everyone is distracted I procure some necessities from the carriage. Or I would have if the shitty carriage wasn't empty! At least empty of anything worth re-purposing. There is

something definitely shifty about this young girl. Gary seems smitten with the little girl, going so far as to give her the Gary Guarantee. Pilch takes me for an aside chat, his Gabrin is awful. His chat is all potato this potato that, Exmeh is very disappointed. The long and short of it is we are off to find the parents. I find a set of three tracks pretty deep, no doubt the parents were carried off here. The signs here don't look good, it almost certain in my mind that there people are dead. Real pros at kidnapping wouldn't leave the child behind, or the horses and cart dead in the road like that. I doubt we even need to be careful these guys are amateurs. Riphard is keen to kill the parents. He is a strange one. 15% likelihood we will kill there parents apparently. Despite the long talks making everyone seem tactically inept, as I slip into the shadows to investigate with Exmerah, the others take up decent positions in the cave mouth. Fishy and Riphard are stalking us. There are strange skinny humanoids

skulking about in here. I am not keen on it at all, and in the darkness I am starting to regret doubling my dose on the leaves. Its always the darkness where the shapes start, pretty green fireflies that dance out at me. And swarm around a small grey skinned creature. . . its a friggin thing that a caravan creeps were talking about! Those changelings!!!! Sounds like Gary is paying the price for befriending that little freaky girl. Its

murder time, so I smash a mervyn special into the back of the little creep. I manage to get two shots off before things go south. They are swarming onto me, and making horrid sounds! I let fly the bird and shout for Riphard as backup. Slashing me open with their horrid scythe hands! Gary goes old school and suplexes the little bitch. We all know she had it coming.

Riphard tries to finish the job, but the mustard isn't ready for cutting yet. First freaky silver changeling goes down, as Pilch jumps in to save me, I never knew he cared! Its time to play shoot and boot, classic Gabrin tactic of hit and run. Exmerah knows it as shoot and scoot. Gary

engages brain, and tries to get the creature to spill the beans on where the cart owners actually are. Riphard goes to blow its brains out, but restrains himself, maybe he still feels soft for the kids. I got Pilchys back, and as he soaks up the

changelings I nail some more shots into them with Exmerah! Pilchy really moving and shaking for the team here. He is also giving off a lovely cool breeze. Gary nails the poor childs head into the ground, but plants firmly into the ground. The changeling then gives him some tonguey action. This gives Riphard the opportunity he must have been waiting for, as he unloads some blessed loving straight into the creature. Gary

gets up and chips the creature into the air, Riphard can't hit the moving target though. Gary finally gets the jobs done. The changelings only

become small creatures as we were all told in an awesome bit of foreshadowing!! ! Having set fire

to the old carriage and dissected their horses we make our way onto the city. Coming in from the east. This city is MASSIVE ! Exmerah has made

us awesome clothes, including a knocka backa for hitting the poor. City is broken up into its

Guilds from the old families of the city. Each

family selects a board that selects a GEO Guild Executive Officer that rules the area. Parchet

green (half elf) male quite stern, and ruthless. All who stood against him in elections have vanished. The five families have guilds

underneath them, Life = taverns, gambling,

Might = Archers, mercenaries, masters elite unit, the hunt (bounty hunters for beasts)

Coin = traders, stores, market, and mint

Service = cleaners, valets, plumbers, Jennies

(semi official), Theives Guild, Assassins Guild

Making = carpenters, builders, blacksmiths, clothiers etc

River Eldon flows through the middle. The areas have power over the sections of the town, but also the guild members who live outside of the guild area. Politics area is around the Guild

Hall. Bertrands stand is the last defensive

wall. Gary is now call Jaygo and has an awful voice

Kolo is now lord Olok
Exmeh is now Lady Haremxe
Riphard is now TornSoft
Pilch is Papa LazarizzWe come across the petite

ferret inn. Where a haughty Gnome is here to help us out.Papa Lazarizz is most efficient at

representing our needs.Papa Lizz is outta

control, and has to be forcibly removed by the managements staff. Turns out that no one is that interested in buying his sword.The SRA are

reprobates I couldn't agree more.We need to

arrange, a meeting with the correct guild, and the correct paperwork.Gnome is Horatio

BrambleThrust, is going to hook us up for a weeks stay, and help us with applications etc.Gary is now a member of the

Rustlers. . . .Papa Lizz gets a visit from the work

force to get the 50 Gold. The bouncers seem very reasonable, when asking for payment.

Unfortunately he books it.Gary follows suit by jumping out the window to find Fishy, possible he is totally hammered. The chase is on. Pilch has escaped in a taxi cab, and Gary is hot on his heels They meet up in an abandoned building, where they meet Archibald the librarian for the book burners. The book burners have all run away, as they have been hunted down by mercenaries? Amazingly the library has been left untouched. The Church have had no contact. Lillian another book burner has been round about two months ago, she is a half elf book burner that actually liked fishy. She has travelled West.Its pretty unclear what Archibald

has been eating. Pilch crosses the mans hand with silver.One last dream sequence with

Lazarus,Get leads on church secrets, make money, make a base. Same old story.Pilch says we should Register as mercenaries. He has had worse ideas.

EPISODE 18: WHY DO YOU GUILD ME UP?

 Here once was a Pastor named Riphard, who played his pipes so dam hard, When asked to relent, He'd bend over and vent, All the gas from his inner intestard.

Stanri recording mode activate. System error. . . . Rebooting. . . Memory leak. . . Recording. . . .

Stanri you really are a wicked little bearbot. Why must you infuriate me so. Well nevermind that. The big news of the day is we have finally arrived at Hope's Rest and it is wonderful! We are staying in a very fancy place called the Petite Ferret. We went downstairs to find Gary sleeping in the bar. He was not very happy because he had experienced too much beer for the first time. His screams reminded me of kolo and mine's first drink when we were 4. Gary had a strange piece of paper covering his eyes. Kolo tried to give him his famous hangover cure (the one made of virgins and silt, very effective but oh my the diarrhea). The mysterious note was from a stranger called P but it turns out it was just Wanker being obtuse. . . . Stupid manager not getting enough pillows.

We left Riphard and Delilah to their lust. I can't imagine either one is enjoying it really, but if it helps them deal with their unhealthy sexual attractions to their parents then I suppose it is okay. We followed Gary to this mystery meeting. It was very busy in the city and SO many peoples. We had to sit on Gary just to see. Fishy was nowhere to be seen and we were very vexed with him for running out last night. We managed to get a taxi and eventually Gary managed to figure out where we were going based on navigating by people wearing hats. We eventually came to a big brick building where Gary decided we should just stand still, by all accounts his raisin dettre. Kolo took the opportunity to kill Fishy's bird, by all accounts his raisin dettre. Kolo knocked on the brick building's door and we were greeted by an old, cabbagey man called Archibald. He promised much bacons and eggsges. "We learn as we try". Motivational indeed. They even had a cat nailed to the wall. Archibald told us that we were in the bookburner's society building. Or at least it used to be. They used to work for the church and were mercenaries. They hunted down heretical texts and burnt them. Basically what Fishy used to do for a living before he died.

O M G THIS BUILDING HAS FIREPOLES!!!! I used it at least 20 times over and over. So much fun!!! Kolo says he talked to Archibald and asked about the building and the book burners. He says he lives with his son which I imagine is quite a burden. He says the man didn't really understand why a book should be burned. Whatever. Gary wanted to know about if printing presses existed. Archibald said that the book burners stopped being book burners because the church thought that the book burners were hiding thing from the church and the church thought the book burners were hiding books and not burning them then the church shut down

the book burners and hunted them down and the book burners that are not hunted down are hiding. Something about the building being in dispute with some guild master, gosh this pole is fun! Gary wanted to know about hidden books but Archibald was pretending not to know. Maybe the vault? Who cares, this pole amirite? Although I was sick everywhere. Kolo was very upset with Archibald's disrespect so he knockerbackered him. I had a word with him and i think he understands not to disrespect 8 year old gabrins anymore.

We went to the vault. Fishy seemed sad about the furnace and cried some tears. Archibald opened the lock on the vault and Gary tried to help. He threw up my favorite spanner. I had been missing that for weeks :(But you can't stay angry at that expressionless stone visage. We all managed to get the door open with "TEAMWORK". The chest in the vault were empty. Quite the anticlimax. We went up to the third floor and the pole was even higher!!!! It turns out that the building is up for repossession. I had a good idea to steal the building and sell it so we could buy a building. Fishy suggested we could just keep the building, which made embarrassingly good sense. He patted me on the head. He won't do it again. Kolo says I was sat on on the head by a treepottamus?

Gary tried to use the pole but he forgot to hold onto the pole. It was not a good look for him sprawled out on the ground floor like that. We will have to get archibald to clean up and fix the floor. We tried to decide how to get the building into our name. Kolo had lots of good business ideas and "strategies" and Fishy said his friend Zippy might be coming over. We had a big talk about what we could do. It turns out that the guilds might get upset if we do unlicensed work. Gary proposed to start a Gary guild. Everyone knows a lot of Gary's so this idea may not be as stupid as it sounds. Kolo and I decided to go and see the maker's guild. I made Archibald go and strip out the third floor for a new workshop and gave Pilchy's bird some job adverts. [Gary runs for a while wherever looking for someone to chat to. He finds a place that has scones and jam. He tries to encourage an old man to start a Gary guild. Juniper gives Gary plenty of advice of the various job opportunities that exist. He leaves Juniper a card that is actually a real card of course, not just a hastily written scrap of paper. "Djago". Gary lets him know to shout him if he ever needs him]

[Pilchy blacks up and arrives at the Jolly Giant, a "robust" sized tavern. He meets a

barman with a red mohawk. Fishy manages to deceive the man into thinking he is a jamaican stereotype. He needs to find Larry. "Fruity drink is for fruity man". Some low level homoerotic flirting. Pilch tries to kiss the man. The man is not happy and headbutts his "nancy" face. Pilch wakes up outside the giant.]

Kolo and I took one of the fancy taxis to the guild of making. It sat on a roundabout what a thing! We entered the huge ornate doors and looked at all the butlers. We managed to push our way to the front of the queue and got the attention of the odd glasses lady. The lady kept asking about what guild to join which seemed silly because I am an inventor. The lady gave us some forms and Kolo filled them in with our specialities. Medicines for general and public use, alleviators of mind and body. And not weapons on death, but crowd control devices and general self defense paraphernalia. We pushed our way to the front of the queue and handed in our forms. She directed us to somewhere else. Kolo is taking it over. Kolo hands her a piece of paper? And we go to the guilds of inventors and apothecists. We got the maps and went over.

[Gary heads back to the empty fire station. He tries to find out where the police station is. He is going to join the police and finds the GOPS building. He applies to join through the standard tests. He can lift over 120 pounds. He is a paragon of justice. He swears to uphold the law in everything he does. This seems to be all that is necessary. Gary is able to draw three panel comics with remarkable speed instead of signatures. Most feature the popular cat 'Triplicate' who likes pizza and is by all accounts whimsical. That apparently is all that needs to be done to become a police officer. He meets his new partner, a half orc who likes his tea with two sugars in an upside down police helmet. Also whimsical. Gary suits up and gets a double sized, long sword sized truncheon. Djago goes on his first patrol after getting a pan beaten onto his head.]

[Pilch applies a new disguise. Apparently Stephen also has a gf irl. Who'd have thunk? The barman thinks this man has a similar voice but Pilch says it was actually his voice twin. A clever lie. Pilch calls him wanker. Pilch has an inconsistent lisp and asks a lot about worry, his old friend. It seems as if worry has been gone for a while, looked disheveled and was not wearing pants last time he was here. We miss Otoria. There is some pedantism about pants vs trousers. Worry is long gone. Any other book burners here Pilch asks, mentioning disguises

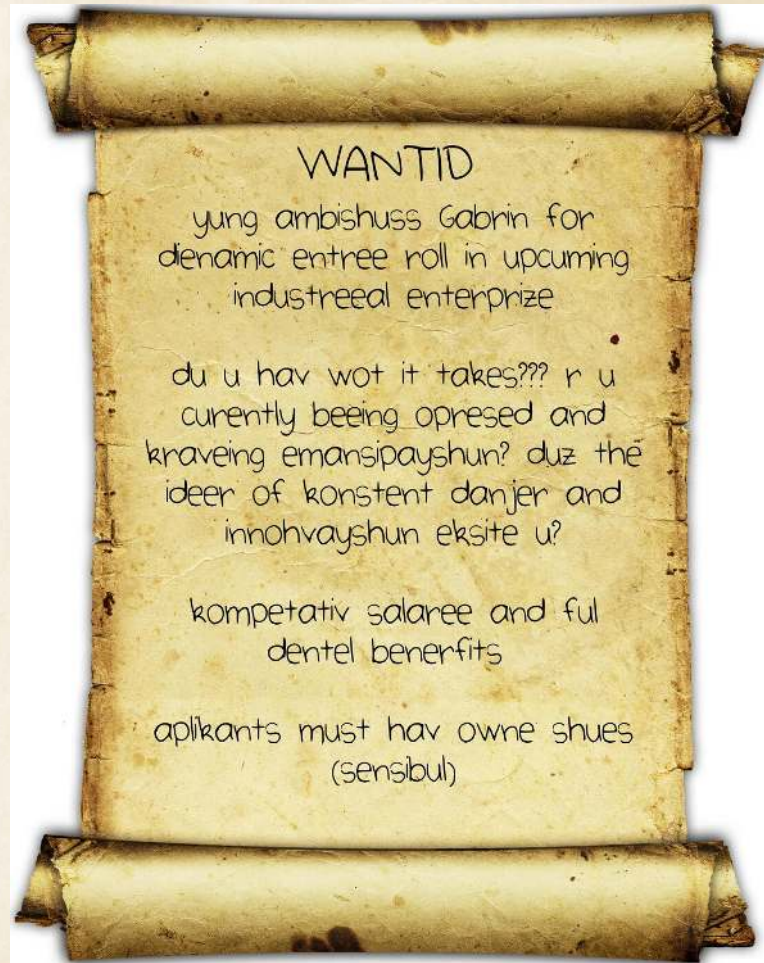
which is bold. Old Burny Sanders used to come in a lot ranting and raving, but he left too. All the book burners gone. Well actually Burny was hung. Lot's other dead. Pilch mocks the man's masculinity and his sword axe. "Sword is phallic, sword is like an extension of one's cock. You gotta have a sword or you ain't a man. Buy my sword man." Pilch wakes up half an hour later bleeding severely in a gutter.]

The league of inventors. A blackened, iron wrought building belching smoke. Kolo knocked to let us in and we met a gnomish man who was very eager. I must say, he was a little rude about me being a gabrin inventor. I ordered their most expensive drink to try and hurt them because they hurt me. Theobald the gnome tutor discussed the guild. It was all quite dull. I was lead into a small laboratory for my test. It was quite an exciting room with lots of bits and pieces. The gnome left saying he would be back in twenty minutes and needed to be impressed. I decided to just rig up a couple of my old portable forcefields and create a massive barrage of weaponry. The poor gnome was a little shocked but he agreed that the work was of merit. How "wonderful" to be worthy of this gnome's approval (that is sarcasm like Kolo has been teaching me). We left with a 10% deal in place and a license to invent. Now to get our apothecary....

Stanri end of recording



Headquarter? WE GOT ONE



Humans need not apply

EPISODE 19: SHOPPING LAND BUSINESS CHANNEL - PART 2

Kolo has arrived at the Apothecary Guild, all excited to do his big entrance exam. A mildly unpleasant elf woman talks to him at the door and calls him dirty and smelly, but then invites him in to join her guild. Kolo goes down the corridor to visit Dr Mittens who administers the entrance tests, which it turns out are more done on applicants than they are by applicants. Kolo is strapped to a table while Dr Mittens force feeds him his special new medicine, which cures Kolo of his Jason-Derulo-Cat-Attack-Deficiency. He's all whigging out all over the place and falling off shit and loving it. Kolo apparently does well, and, after a few business days he'll be a member. On the way out, Kolo asks for Dr Mittens' home address, in a not-at-all worrying manner. Meanwhile, Rocky is going to the Guild of Coin place, to invent banking. The building is made of gold. What a way to devalue their own product. The doors are made of bg trees. Real big

trees. Probably expensive trees. Rocky grasps the brass knocker in his fist and raps it. He goes inside and talks to a gnome, who he warns that he is proposing to abut him. He explains the concept of banking, in a pretty succinct way. The gnome tells him that he should set up a new guild, because banking doesn't exist. If he wants to do that, he needs the following:

- 6 radical members
- 1 audacious business plan, presented to a gnarly committee
- A shit-tonne of money (which is the only word in this guy's language (I think it works like the Smurfs' language))

The guild is going to need all the normal corporate positions to be filled:

- HIO: Head Interface Officer
- GBUI: Global Business Unification Investigator
- JOLK: Job Organiser, Lower Klass
- QRTTO: Quota, Rosta, Training and Torture Officer
- UI: Untrustworthy Individual
- Grossly Untrustworthy Individual

Rocky says he's going to do that, probably. Pilch writes a note offering the party up as mercenaries within the city for some non-descript work. Everyone gets back to the Fire House at the same time and Exme harrasses Archibald for not taking down all the walls on the third floor like she asked. Baldy's a bitch about it. There's arguments. Bedrooms are important, but so is a lab, so who wins? Gary wins. He punches all the walls until they fall down. Baldy says that the meeting about the decision about the fate of the building is tomorrow, and everyone can go if they feel like it. They decide they might as well, and they're all tired from all these jobs they have now, so everyone decides to go to bed. Fishy is seen slinking off to bed with a taxidermied camel's head. Someone probably wins a bet. In the morning, everyone decides what jobs they want in the bank guild.

- HIO: Head Interface Officer - Riphard
- "The Boss."
- GBUI: Global Business Unification Investigator - Gary
- "People should all be doing their jobs more or less the same."
- JOLK: Job Organiser, Lower Klass - Delilah
- *"What should people even be doing? How? Why?"
- QRTTO: Quota, Rosta, Training and Torture Officer - Pilch
- "Keeping lists, making sure people on the lists do what they should. Otherwise, torture."
- UI: Untrustworthy Individual

- Exme "People who try to get in the bank, get hit by traps!"
- GUI: Grossly Untrustworthy Individual
- Kolo "People who will not pay the bank, get broken limbs!"

Later, on their way home, fine operatives of the noble Thieves Guild come and ply their trade on the upstanding business gabrins in one alleyway and Gary and Fishy in another. Exme is very happy to comply, Kolo asks if he can join. Apparently it's not the time or place for applications, but they all have a nice chat anyway. Everyone's swapping cards and networking. Kevin offers to relay their interest to the guild, and asks them if they want to know how high all the windows in the area are. Kolo tries to get him hooked on the horse-cocaine. He appreciates it, but is unable to accept anything but money. The gabrins hand over the money and get their receipt. They promise to leave Kevin a good review. In the other alleyway, Gary and Brucey - an enterprising fellow who is a policemen in the day and a thief at night - have a nice chat. Gary apologises for not having any pockets, Fishy just doesn't have money, so they both assume the position and get kicked for a bit. Fishy is a dick and tries to be spikey, nearly killing everyone who's kicking him. Gary kicks him, for not playing by the rules. The heavily wounded thieves run off. As soon as they get back to HQ, it's time to leave for the meeting. They go to the nice meeting hall on the banks of the Salty Eldon. The river so polluted they have affectionate nicknames for the diseases it gives you (e.g. Elly Belly). Inside the meeting room, a cat is the judge. She is called Mickey Longpaw. She is suave, and is wearing a bitchin' fur coat made of her ex-husband. Gary gets so bored that he makes everyone fall asleep, which they'd probably do anyway. The figures for the thieves guild are up 7%. It's pretty wholesome. The assassins guild have killed a lot of really cool people recently. Everyone's pretty impressed. The cleaners and plumbers are a lot more boring. People start talking about the fire house. Pilchy Loozaroo says "It should be about the book-burners, but definitely not because I'm one." Jago stands up and pleads the case to use the house as a Gary-Guild House. People are interested. Some bellend thinks that we should give it to the Church. No one loves that

idea.Lazaroo does a good speech about The Church being bad and the Gary-Guild being good.Big Reveal, Papa Gary Lazariz.Jago makes

a much better speech about The Church being bad and the Gary-Guild being good.People go ape shit. There's cheering. There's chanting. Then they vote.Everyone votes for Gary.Gary.

Gary. Gary. GARRRRYYYYY!!!!!!The Gary-Guild have a clubhouse, even if they don't technically exist.Everyone's Gary now.Gary draws the new

logo for the guild. It's a universal hit.They organise a meeting at the clubhouse so that the heads of all the Guild Families can get in on the ground floor of the city's newest hit guild.Gary feels as if he is in the den of a dragon as he desperately makes his case for the financial viability of the Gary-GuildHe unveils the beautiful finalised version of the logo.They explain that the guild won't actually make any money, which the money guild guy seems to be upset about.He's oot.The families try to impress

the party with the services they could offer the Garies.Eventually, they manage to convince The Guilds of Services, Might and Life to enter into a joint venture.The Guild of Garys is go.

BRAPPPThe other families get solty.A few days

later, while the paperwork is in process, some small folk comes to meet Esme to reply to the flier that Pilch accidentally delivered.There's a

wide range of skill levels. One guy empties bins, one guy has built the actual international space station.There's a dwarf, who Exme wants to

throw out instantly, but annoyingly he's really good.Kolo and Esme assess their potential

assistants, and they go through to another round making weapons out of meat.Then she realises how little they're going to have to pay their assistants and hires them all, because fuck peasants, they're hardly people.EXME LAB

Hiring Initiative 3 assistants - 1 gp per week each 1 female goblin - made knives, crayon cv, "simple is sometimes best" 1 male goblin - flying invention, made electric bomb 1 dwarf - intricate mental worker, made fabulous cross bow with barbs that splayed outStart in 2 days for

graduate programKOLO LAB Hiring Initiative2

assistants 1 Halfling - Professional cook, grinding inventions 1 Male goblin, bin manAt

this point, everything is just a mess.What is this game, even?Zippy the gnome turns up at the

Garygang Hideout. Apparently, Fishy called him. He's a gnome, but he sounds like a Gabrin. Cultural Appropriation.He, understandably,

hates Pilch.He can't remember why the Church

tried to kill him. It's probably due to his alcoholism.Kolo gives him that stuff that burnt

down the pub that time.He loves it.He doesn't

have anything helpful to say.Except that Pilch

definitely got everyone killed.We're going with

Lillian.Lillian is helf-elf.Lillian is the Trainer

rank.Lillian is not the best.Lillian is probably

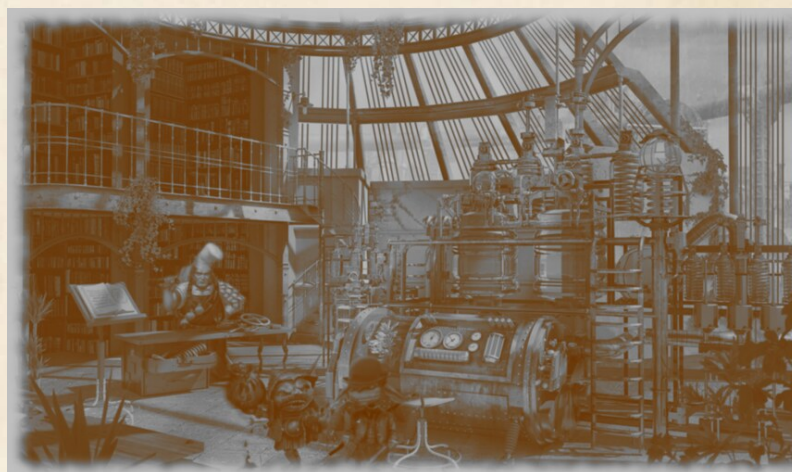
alive.Lillian is kind-hearted.Estoban and Dougal

are still alive, but are dicks, I reckon. Dougal is a Pastor now. Estoban is Zoro now, carving people up.The workshop and labs are completely

set up during the background of the Garystablishment.Delilah pops off to meet The

Jennys, to give in her month-long quest. Good for her.IT'S OFFICIAL The Party has a name now.

We are GARY. Garys Against Religion, Yo.



G-AMRC Rooftop Apothecary Is Now Open



First day selfie yo!!1! #exmelab

EPISODE 20: BIZZNISS FOR BANKS & EMANCIPATION FOR THE FEW NOT THE MANY

Pilch keeps researching some shit, to be honest I am a little surprised he can read. Old smelly Archi can't help either because he can't see. The state of the HQ makes a lot more sense now. Exmerahs mask for him is certainly a relief on the eyes, but while watching it repeatedly almost slice Fishys nose off, I does something opening a tunnel in the bookshelf. This reminds me that I probably should have told FishFingers that I was awake and watching him. What he doesn't know won't hurt him. Still if I only knew how he opened this bloody door! I wait for ages for him to return, but he is taking his sweet time. Maybe it leads outside like the one in the basement? No I checked for that already no other exits. . . Maybe he is going for some man time. . . I'll leave him to it Morning finally comes, and Riphard strikes

quite the dashing character in all his livery. We head off the guild of coin, and wow do they have the cash here. We are introduced to Rowlett Marnett the head of the Guilds of Coin, Wellington Hunter-Smyth head of the Guild of Mints, Montague Heartwell Head of the Guild of Traders they talk even funnier than their boss. Riphard wastes no time and gets into this pitch. Jaego is not Gary, except for today, and for anyone who hasn't past the Gary test. Mr

SoftRock starts the presentation. "Safe Storage for a Dangerous World", clearly he is misguided about who does what Robbing wise, as we were all recently robbed by people not Gabrins! The stored capital is invested, to speculate and accumulate. The team is definitely not us, but I

do think we should not be talked down to like this. Is the Gary team member going be in some kind of synergy with the bank. This is all very confusing. Mr Bobacious is remembered for his strong ongoing work in RiversFall. Although we haven't heard from him since we left RiversFall. Rowlett Marnett is very impressed that Derek is on board. Even if the reasoning involves a time paradox. What are all these dates? But luckily we have an appendix slide that answers all our questions. So long as the guild of coin members are never asked who we are, who is involved and where they have been, this presentation is flawless. The accumulation of stuff is impressing these small minded individuals. The final bamboozle of the investment triangle blows their minds. "I don't know what he said, but I like the

way he said it" pure gold from not Pilcheur Garmont. Riphard starts to call Rowlett, Rolo but he doesn't seem to mind. In fact he is impressed, and loves the propensity for growth. He does know a lot about Lemons though, finally someone who understands. He goes for a hard bamboozle, but if anyone knows business its Rowlett, who forces some hard answers. Thankfully he doesn't mention the huge debt we clocked up last week buying materials for our labs. Roughly 6000gp but its probably best it stays that way. Things are getting confused, until Pilcheur decides that the company is a service, so therefore falls into the realm of the Guild of Coin. Exmeh raises some good issues

surrounding people greed and the potential of a banking collapse ruining the economy. His second presentation is alarming to say the least! The bank is 74% mortgages. Who is paying these mortgages!! Rowlett invests anyway, which is

re-assuring as we have no way of paying that money back that we borrowed, maybe ever! The

other Guild masters are very impressed as well, everyone starts smoking cigars. If only I was better at deceiving I think I could do really well at this business type. Everyone toasts the new

Guild of Banking, Huzzah! Few days pass, turns

out you really don't need to sleep at all. I set to work making some potions. . . Fishy gets a note

from the Mercenaries Guild . . . blah blah blah raiding group from the Varg. Must be sure to tell Exmerah. . . Could it be for us? Best have a chat later with her. Jerry is a equalist,

100% no a speciest. Something horrific took place "the massacre" of the La Rudo family. Means that all contracts for mercenaries now

require the contact holder to be alive to be valid. Seems quite a good move. Fishy forges the

contract, despite the original being held by the mercenary guild. He claims that it effectively means that the contract holding family can die after having waved their rights. I have to go

shopping, despite having valuable things and potentially explosive things going on upstairs. I set off some 1d6+3 Koka Kolo mixes, they go don't seem to come out the way I made them last time, but then what does these days. I seem to have misplaced a lot of the fruit I bought for Pilch. Gary comes back and stinks of root beer,

claiming that he is now the sheriff fist fighting, still not killed anyone. Now i think about it I don't

recall any of us signing up to be mercenaries! Well if they are going to pay us to do this, then why not! Gary nonchalantly disgorges 4 pints of

root beer. The game is on! Pilch catches his hair on the face mask. It's still an improvement. I get

the wagon ready with Exmerah, packing in the supplies bought with our own coin. This adventuring is more costly than I had imagined, or certainly is now it isn't just the two of us. We

journey North West onto the greater planes. The farming lands, this must be how Hopes Rest is fed, some these land owners may be wealthy indeed. The nights are hard, and maintaining concentration is next to impossible in these monotonous lands. So its not quite a surprise when we get set upon by a 5 man raiding party. 3 Goblins on wargs, and two humans on riding horses, come thundering down on us. Pilch

kindly asks permission to engage the Gabrins, of course it is granted and his gentlemanly behaviour noted. Although he does then run away. . . . I get a sense of deja vu. But then find the weak point the guys horse, and kneecap it to buggery. All this dissection is really paying off. Emerah demands Parle from the Gabrins.

The Gabrins tell her to shut up "southern Scum". Poor old Exmeh is reminded of home, and pulls the shot. She has too much heart my sister, but only in the fire can we be tempered. She will learn. . . . These bloody Gabrins been using toad

poison! I will kill them and their toads, so that Mervyn would be pleased. Riphard shoots them, and something magic is in the air because he actually hits, and smotes that damned Gabrin. I shout for Quoth.. Gary wrestles stupid human off

his remaining horse, while a crying Exmerah blows one of the Gabrins into pieces. Gary quickly becomes the center of attention, with

Riphard taken on the last GabrinWarg combo, man'O'Gabrin. He whips and nei nei's the warg. Bloody human shoots me again. Your

likelihood of survival of this encounter is now zero. Gary gets hot into the mix with his 4

attackers. Laying the smack down hard, with a turbo charged gary club. She takes a knee in front of Gary before calling him a weakling!!! She is gonna get smited to shit. Pilch returns to the

field of battle, sending quoth my way. Human gets shot. Exmerah seems past the tears, she always did move through men fast, as she kills another Gabrin. Gary is mixing it heavy, despite

Exmerahs assistance he is still fighting four people at once. What a big stone badass he is turning out to be. Finally he plants first his club, and then his magic branch a huge wave of power emanates from him, and petals washe over the humans sending them to sleep. Easy prey, I shoot that evil human to death, the arrow bursting through his chest. Riphard thunder

whips the warg backwards sitting his ass down. As he backs off he pulls out his pistols, blowing the stupid wargs heads to pieces all over me. 100% owe this guy my life now. What a badass. I spend the time dissecting the warg from the inside out, very interesting. Gary creates a

slavers line of two humans and a single Gabrin. He is bringing them back to life. The Gabrins who didn't come back to life, he punches through his dead face. That is some freaking extreme way to ensure someone is dead. Maybe this rock isn't such a tree hugging hippy. The captives are all tied back to back, as Gary gives them a good stern talking too. Unknowingly he condemns them all to death, by getting them to march off all tied together. They waddle off to their certain doom. "I'm as fucking south as a

horse is east" we interrogate the Gabrins, and find out who they serve. Its some pretty bad bloody news if they are from who they say they are. Vathena is a highly feared savage elf, one of

the Warlords of the North. One his Valkars generals, known for her viciousness, and tiger mount that feared throughout. Another bloody

elf. Gabrins makes the sense of spitting in my

sisters face, death is the only reward for this. The Gabrins are not well disposed to us, and are being total douche bags. The interrogation

continues, Riphard tries to sell the banking to him. This is some real scary shit, I really don't

want to go. Pilch has a plan, something we have not done maybe ever before. I saw her feed

Gabrins to that giant tiger of hers. We move onwards to the Nan-Tucket farm, and our certain doom. After staying the night in an abandoned house, which is under constant watch from the enemy, we emerge tired, and facing a bear like entity. It seems death isn't our destination today after all.

EPISODE 21: OF KOKAINE AND KEVLAR

ur "heroes" are sleeping in a broken house like little bitches, when all of a sudden this big old bear and a load of worgs and goblins and horses and other shit comes at them out of the night. Esme is all over it and ready to maim, reaches into her bag and pulls out some weird looking backpacks for Gary and Pilch and a little something for the baddies. She throws it at them, it goes bang and some goblins and a horse get evaporated. Fishwank gets on the back of his wolf, with Kolo tucked underneath his arm. Kolo realises he's going to try and move away from the badguys and immediately gets off the wolf as Fishwank rides away into the night, and is the fucking worst. Gary thinks there's been a terrible misunderstanding, and asks the badguys if he can help them. Rocky shoots some shit. The bear runs right up to Gary, who asks how he can help. After seeing one of them shoot at Esme, Gary hits a bad dog of a cliff. There's some shit that happens. People shoot things. There's forcefields and guns. It's... really hectic... which is why it's not described in great detail here... Fishwank's riding around on a wolf. Gary gets eaten by a bear and falls down. The wolf gets covered in ice, but the bear don't care and goes over there to give Kolo his share while he's unaware. This bear has a huge warpick and it's making the gang real sad and injured. Esme runs all the way over to Gary to wake him up with her fancy electricity gun. He's fine, guys. He's always fine. He takes a load of drugs and gets real angry. Fishwank actually walks towards an enemy for once. And hits him with his sword. Kolo hits the bear with an arrow, Gary accidentally hugs him, and Rocky shoots at him. The whole gang are working together. The bear really wants to kill Kolo, and everyone hits him while he's looking the other way. The bear falls down and Gary gets annoyed that he didn't

get to kill it because of drugs. Gary brings the bear back and it immediately kills him. Then it tries to kill the wolf, but it dies because it's spikey. It's a real clusterfuck. What the fuck, Gary? Looting of the bear happens muchly. Kolo

and Exme interrogate a rezzed goblin, cutting off his fingers - excellent start. They let him free, but they have to promise to only try to kill them if he chooses to. We don't have long due to

Athena? Coming to screw up the farm. Something something emancipated all the goblins. Something something don't have enough time for a long rest. According to the

fingerless gabrin, there's no time to waste, and we should all hurry to the place before everyone dies. Everyone's real fucked up, and all used up, but they don't really have a choice. Gary wants to talk to everyone. The gang arrive at the farm.

Gary tells everyone that there's no hope of survival and they're all going to die. The people seem unwilling to abandon their home. Fishwank smears shit on his face. Kolo starts setting traps. A plan is hatched to set fire to the

farm so that the Varg think it's already raided. Gary tries to kidnap a child. Either the parents can follow him when he takes the child, or it will be the only survivor of the slaughter that is now unavoidable. Fishwank sets a tent on fire. Esme seems more concerned with the goblin's fingers. The raven flies off to see if it can see anything. Rocky goes inside the house and

tries to set fire to the kitchen. He gets thrown out by the burly farmer's wife. He tries to set fire to the outside of the house as the Gabrins try and stop him. Gary climbs into the chicken coop with the child. Kolo gives Fishwank 500

ball-bearings. Fishwank wants to put them up his anus for sexual pleasure. Kolo racks up some pre-flight lines for Gary. Everyone rushes around trying to set up traps. Gary instructs the child to stay quiet in the chicken coop until it sees its family die and then run into the countryside and survive. The raven flies back and warns of an approaching party to the south. Shit's about to get real. Gary takes a moment to develop a chemical dependency on the Gabrin shit. It is time. The woman on the tiger turns up,

as well as a load of other fuckers from all over the place. Gary tries to diplomacy but is way too

fucking high right now..We're all going to die..Esme kills a horse. First blood. It will not be the last..Pilch tries to set fire to a tiger. It kind of works. The area of pitch catches, and there's now some fire. The tiger baulks at the flames and the woman jumps across them to come at Gary with 2 swords. Gary immediately falls down. Great work, guys..Rocky shoots a guy..Horses run around..All the Kokaine in

Gary's bloodstream brings him back to consciousness. He plays dead, despite the fact that all he wants to do is take more Koke..Everyone else is up trees, really..The wolf

runs out the tent it was in, and tries to do something complicated. It fails..Fishwank gets killed by the sword, but then because of that thing he does sometimes, he doesn't after all. Then the tiger tries to kill him, but it somehow doesn't..Rocky is Bolstered Against Damage..He

shrugs off some attacks, jumps over a fence and fails to shoot a guy..Esme doesn't quite fall out a

tree. She gets hit by an arrow, but is also Bolstered Against Damage, so is fine..Gary is

still laying on the ground, pretending to be dead, desperately trying to not ruin the illusion by taking more Kokaine..Esme kills another

horse..Fishwank casts darkness, as per usche.

The wolf knocks the woman over. The one who used to be on the tiger. The tiger, despite it being dark, does not get confused and go to sleep..People love being Bolstered Against

Damage..Gary is in the darkness, but has no

idea what's going on and assumes he has died. He goes for a nice calm walk through the afterlife..Suddenly, everyone sees Kolo..The tiger

gets scared and runs away..Gary walks out of the darkness, realises he's not dead and that the battle's still on. He takes the Koke and sprints off round the back somewhere..Pilch carries on

hitting the woman. He suddenly realises it should have been doing more all this time. The woman runs away and hides behind a tree. Kolo was definitely right to be scared of this woman..The tiger tries to eat Esme. It does

not..All the guys on horses surround Kolo's tree and try and murder him. Luckily, he is Bolstered Against Damage..Rocky tries to homealone some

bitches. Also he shoots them with a gun..Some bitches fall over on some fucking ballbearings..Gary runs over to the farmhouse and starts unbarricading a window. Esme shoots a tiger and then disappears into the darkness..The darkness disappears into Pilch's scabbard. Pilch goes to stab that woman, only to find out that she's nowhere to be seen (she's hidden behind a tree). He stabs the tiger..The tiger dies..In a rage the woman runs out, and attacks Pilch while h's looking the other way. She accidentally impales herself on his spikey ice armour..Everything's going to be fine..Gary

does not know this and starts leading everyone in the farmhouse out the back way, regretfully inform them that everyone's dead and their farm is lost..Everyone else finishes off the last few

horse people with a mixture of bows, guns and rolling logs..The battle is over..No one's

dead..Except that no one knows that Gary isn't dead, because of the darkness..Pilch knows, but he is being a dick..He robs the house

instead..Kolo is distraught at Gary's death, but consoles himself with a bit of tiger dissection..Gary is long gone, with all the farm

people, except the small child who he was trying to protect in the first place. He doesn't really know how to rescue them, and asks them if they have any ideas..The Gabrins can't find anything, but Fishwank uses his things..Kolo rides the

wolf to wear the raven saw Gary and the Farm People..There's a beautiful reunion and it turns

out no one's dead. Not even Fishy. You can't have everything..Gary says he doesn't want to do any more Kokaine. Kolo disagrees.

EPISODE 22: LIFE AND SOLE OF THE PARTY



Esme mentions about the wolf outside, which Kolo is upset about for some reason..She doesn't know anything

about some cult. Exalibrium has too little to go on? The weapon sounds like it's useful and in Masuda, if we think we can actually find it. The fancy Rubix "puzzle die" in the jungle would also be useful to find the other shit. She asks if she can look into anything. Nothing useful is on our continent. Except

maybe the pamphlet, exalibrium, and a poem. Maybe. Kolo asks about Voothross. Kiros hasn't heard of it. It sounds ancient and religious, but got nothing to do with the real gods. Pilch smart arsedly asks if it's related to Athos. She says no, probably not. Gary knows about Synne. Kiros says he's super evil. The group umm and ahh over this. She's surprisingly receptive. She might be a satanist yet. She's in hiding now. The group want to know who the new pastor is in the evil rock village. She says she'll look into it. Gary wants to be a pastor. Gary doesn't want to be a pastor. Rocky is a pasta. Kiros is interested in this. Riphard knows he needs to run his businesses. Kiros wants to know where we're going. We don't know. She encourages our alcoholism. Pilch wants the Rubix "puzzle die", Exalibrium, to help find the other shit. Kiros say she's going to find THE METAL. Pilch offers her poetry. GAYYYY. Exme raises her hand. There's talk of dip dongs. Exme asks if toads and frogs are boy and girls of the same thing. Like cats and dogs. Kiros says yes, this is correct. Kolo remains quiet on the subject. Gary questions about cats and dogs, which everyone knows are boy and girl animals. Idiot. The door is kicked open. An armoured man flanked by 4 guards and 1 orc burst through. The group is excited about Zalanthars. The main guy has a big fucking gun. Gary says hi. They speak to Kiros. Pilch wants to leave. Kiros says fuck. She stands up and edges out. "Arbiter Rickon. Long time, no see." "Oh well, you know me Kiros. Always one to join a party. Especially when I find out my favourite blond haired girl has turned traitor." Pilch thinks he knows the dude. He doesn't. Gary narrows his eyes and stands with Kiros. "I believe you have been misinformed my dear Rickon. I am an upholder of justice and law, no traitor." "Not what I've been hearin' luv." "We are simple shoe advertisers" Exme chimes in. "My my, and you've got this lot with you too. That'll seal the deal." Pilch stealths around to the kitchen door to sneak back in to the room he just escaped. Kolo eyes up Riphard, who stands up, shouts "CHEESE IT", and attempts to jump off the table through the window while chucking his fire water into the fire. The window doesn't break, and Riphard crumples to the floor. The fire water explodes, killing the 4 commoners sat

nearby. "Ouch!" The commoners were Ha, Ree, Samantha, and Charlotte. They were having sex in the city. There's a fight on. The orc dashes straight to Exme and twats her in the face. The arbiter with the BFG flips a table for cover. Exme shoots at the orc and surprisingly hits. She activates a forcefield. The orc is bleeding badly. Kolo marks the orc for killin', and shoots him with a poison arrow. Totally fucking killerizing him. Kolo teabags the orc corpse. Kiros takes cover behind a bench and shoots at one of the redshirt guards, fucking nailing him to the wall behind him. The group's mouths drop open. The redshirts dash to engage a bunch of the group. Pilch does nothing useful. The bartender is still there, ready to pour pints. Just another Thursday night. Riphard takes cover, but his shot pings off the main dudes armor. Gary sprints at the main guy to the other side of his table. Exme tries to shoot someone, but doesn't. Kolo poison arrows the dudes next to Riphard. One shot. Nice. The group seem pretty badass now. Kiros misses a different guy. The guards further encroach on Rip and Exme and hit them both. Pilch makes molotov cocktails from firewater and the barmans sleeve, and throws it at the main dude. The group debate the finer points of throwing technique. Kolo hits him with the molotov anyway. The arbiter dodges the fuck out of it though, rolling out of the way. Everyone claps. The molotov sets the table on fire. Riphard whips out his new scimitars (ironically). He thundertwats the guard into the wall, who explodes. Sweet. Gary pushes the table through the fire into the main dude. Gary isn't wearing shoes. The main dude is so agile. He dodges the flaming table with another tasty combat roll. Gary engages him properly finally, giving him a mean point. The guy steps back, giving Gary an attack before certain death. Gary misses. "FULL AUTO" He pray and sprays the whole room. The bullets can bend round corners. Ricochet I guess. Most people are badly hurt. Exme starts glowing. She shoots at some dude killing him. Kolo laughs to himself for the death he's about to rain down on his human. Over. Confident. To be fair he fucking nails him.

He's still alive though. "I ALWAYS HATED YOU RICKON. I ALWAYS KNEW YOU WERE ONE OF THE BAD ONES." One of Kiros' shots bounces off, but the other strikes him true. He's still good though. Pilch and his wolf run at the dude,

volting the bar. The wolf does not clear the bar and doesn't make it to the dude. Pilch tries to disarm the arbiter. He actually does. Unexpected. Quoth is dead. Kolo is happy.

Everything's turning up Kolo. The group starts meta-discussing DnD rules. Everyone is bored. Steven wants to aim his disarm into the fire. He's asking a lot. Mike shuts that shit down. Maybe on a crit. Everyone is happy. Riphard doesn't hit him again. Gary shoves the main dude, picking up his gun, and rolls away, pointing the gun at the dude's face. The guy doesn't hit Gary with his shield. "To be honest

buddy, I don't know what I'm doing with this thing. But I watched you press this button and bullets came out. So how about you tie yourself up and we have a nice chat instead." He shifts his pants. Peaceful(ish) resolution wins the day. Gary

wants Pilch to strip the guy naked. This is apparently too awkward. AWKWARRRRD. Exme wants to know if this is Kiros' boyfriend. "No no, it's not about the size of their guns." Kolo dissects

the orc rapidly into pieces. Gary salvages the humans, much to Kolo's chagrin. Why must he save these stupid hoomans. Also Charlotte survives. Again Kolo is unhappy. Luckily the woman gets her wish to die as Kolo sends an arrow through her. Gary is understandably a bit upset by this. Kolo returns to dissection, and Gary goes off to the interrogation. Meanwhile Pilch has taken Arbiter Rickon's trousers off. Rickon is on for a lot of good cop, bad cops. He gets the rough treatment. "So lady what's

next?" "Rickon was always an asshole" Gary tries

to convince her of the good within everyone. So she tries to convince Rickon he has gone down the wrong path. He is convinced she is working against the greatest thing to ever exist. The empire of the church. "You know nothing Rickon

Stark" "I am the light and the bringer, you are the darkness, will you come to me, or will you forever lie in the shadows?" He asks for the

lowdown?" Gets it and towards the end of the conversation things start to add up for him. He

uses the word of truth "Truth Seeker" and Rickon is turned back to the path of light. Kolo is disappointed that she has no feelings for him. (Exmeh asks if Crabs are sea spiders and why they do not make webs? Gary recalls a time when

he was a stone and a spider laid eggs all over him. "Insee winsee spider doesn't lay eggs" He must have been a boy spider. Kolo tries again in vain to explain they are different species. Rickon

is a bit upset about the death of the innocents in the giant spirit drink fire water explosion. Gary

hands over the rifle to Kyross, for her to do as she fits. He won't attack us until he finds out more about the truth, in return he gets his rifle. Gary states that "All we ever do is delay the

inevitable" sending Pilch into an existential fugue. Before sending all the wrongdoers to the local police prison for impersonating the church officials. Howlov eats the remaining bodies. Its

agreed we are going around the horn of Africa to explore these new lands in search of the seeking device.

EPISODE 22A: PILCH: MUSINGS ON SORCERY

Perhaps I've spent too much time researching this recently, but I'm starting to muse how our powers are such a strange collection.

Apparently given, or at the very least (in my and Riphard's instances) accelerated, by the stone of Un'Thala (now fused into my blade Iron Maiden) - everyone's appear to develop differently. Kolo has his marks of slaying, Gary his old magics - similar but different to Riphard's, who's a trained pastor - an Agitator. And Exme has a smattering she seems to be able to channel or harness through her tinkering's.

Other than proximity to the stone, the only thing we share is having some kind of divine intervention - Gary by being presumable made by the gods, and then discovered by us, and the rest by being saved by Laz.

I've even found old notes about colleges of arcanists and societies, and even accounts of Arbiters using magical artefacts, how long ago from, I do not know. But perhaps magic was once more prevalent? Perhaps it did not need weird stones? Does ours? Is it just some contraption that lets Lazarus keep tabs on us? Then how did it enrich my original blade, Black

Sabbath, and allow me to empower and bond with my new one?

Eurgh, I think all this academic reading is rubbing off on me. Or maybe it's recent events...

I've always thought my powers came from the Mark of Synne, which I received when reading the otherwise innocuous "Apotheosis of Synne" book - I'm now pretty sure this was just a vessel of the power, given it was a textbook on Synne-worms, and not some grand apocryphal doctrine on Synnes rise to god-dom.

But I'm now not sure that my Weapon, my creatures and my shadow-powers are directly connected to the Mark. Despite their different effects they... feel different.

When Shadow Weaving (as I shall now on call it) I feel this sense of darkness all around me, as if I'm on an island surrounded by a sea of shadows. Or perhaps I am an island, with a wellspring that fills with the tides. I can deplete this wellspring to conjure beasts, create darkness or similar, but it is replenished easily. It isn't like physical exhaustion, I'm the son of a butcher, I know what that feels like, but more a depleting of the soul. Likewise I know this dark tide can drown me, as I've experienced a strange shadow sickness twice before.

But the Mark... The mark is far more mysterious. I know it has saved my life on 3 occasions. Most recently I was gutted by that elven woman - Vathena? - that Kolo is so frightened of. I felt the blade pierce my flesh, saw the satisfaction in her eyes and the cold inevitability of death - but then the mark glowed warmly, and I saw her blade retreat - leaving no sucking wound, but healthy, clothed flesh. She attempted again, but this time missed carelessly.

The other two times... I drowned in Rivers Falls, after a clumsy fall - instead rising out of the water, and then making the leap I'd failed, moments before... Or I guess, moments forward? And the first time... An arbiters bullet had scattered my brain, but I felt my skull nit back together, the damp click of a missfire, and the eye-brow searing explosion as the bastard lost his hand.

Shame the bloody thing didn't save me from falling into Laz's clutches, quite literally. I guess even divine intervention has its limits.

This... Fate Spinning... It isn't as easy to replenish, needing a full nights rest, and has let me "reroll the die of fate" - obviously no one else sees what I see, this running back of the stream of time for a second attempt at pretty much...

anything. In a smaller way I can use it preemptively, giving myself or others a little "Guidance" with a touch. It is warm, and comforting - and I do not get the sense it comes from within.

Perhaps I should stop cursing the Mark of Synne. Perhaps I should stop thinking of myself as branded by a corrupting god, but instead recognise that if Synne is, as I believe, a god of fate itself - one that is neither good nor bad but allows events to happen, and then gets blamed for their inevitability...

I should look into learning to wield my Mark to its fullest extent - it might stave off my own darkness long enough to complete these challenges, and balance me into something more... Acceptable.

EPISODE 22B: GARY: MUSINGS ON LUNCH



Perhaps I've spent too much time drinking out of puddles recently, but I'm starting to muse how sometimes things you eat can make you feel different ways.

Apparently, all that Gabrin junk Kolo was giving me was causing, or at least accelerating, some changes in me that I'm not a fan of. Its not just that though. Whenever we're in the city, I watch what everyone eats. I'm still not quite used to eating, so I find it interesting.

When Rocky has been at the pub for a while, sometimes he goes to a shop where a big cylinder of meat rotates in front of a fire. I think it must be the leg of some giant animal. A man takes a special knife, cuts him off some strips, and puts it in some bread with some vegetables and "hot sauce". Everything goes down his front and then he usually passes out in an alley.

Kolo doesn't seem to eat much food these days. He eats a lot of things he makes in his lab. He also spends a lot of his time selling these things to other people to eat. I do not think they should eat them. When Kolo does eat, he vomits it all back up a lot of the time. I'm worried about him. In both senses.

Once I saw Fishy eating a fish, and at first I was freaking out, but then I realised that fish eat each other all the time. So I think that's fine. I had to leave after that, because I was doing Police things. He looked so happy down there, on the banks of the Eldon, eating all the dead fish that wash up just past the tanneries. Maybe he knows what he's doing after all.

Esme has started going to these places on the other side of town where they make little food that isn't served on plates. Its called things like "Keenwaw" and "Advokado", and the man who sells it has a big beard, and hair that's tied up on top of his head. She spends lots of money on it, but no one in there looks happy. Also the dough for the bread is apparently sour, and I don't know how that can be good for you.

Also, Kolo explained to me recently that all meat comes from animals. Beef comes from horses, apparently. I don't want to have to take a bit off a horse, just to eat some beef. Then it would just look ridiculous.

Perhaps I should stop eating things that make me sad. Perhaps I should stop eating things that make anyone else sad. Perhaps I should do a diet - one that is neither good nor bad but makes me happy, and that I can blame when I'm inevitably sad. . .

I should look into getting some lunch - it might stave off my own hunger long enough to complete this important Police work, and power me forward into something less. . . boring.

I'm going to get spaghetti... but without beef.

EPISODE 22C: SUBJECTS PLEASE

As the days draw in, I find myself watched by Gary more and more. His connection with the polices, however useful, could end up being very troublesome. If only he would help me test the new concoctions on him, he was such a valuable subject. Since we started testing on ourselves, its getting harder and harder to tell which effect is associated with which dose. I need a wider market for distribution. Tomorrow I'll escape through the tunnels while Gary is at work and talk with the thieves guild. Maybe its time to set up my own network.... I must find more test subjects, and record all that we are finding. If we make a little money in the process then so be it.

I must get more data, and more resources. The Guild has given me access to the tamest of materials, but I long for the more exotic. The magic bush grows both in my waking dreams and on the balcony, there must be more like it, there must be so much more out there to be found, and tested.....

EPISODE 22D: PUZZLE DIE OF RHU'BREX

IN case anyone wants to quickly re-read my research, I'll just leave it here.
(<https://www.reddit.com/r/Velterra/wiki/research/chronicle>)

So something comes to mind... This thing is called a Die - it's specifically references one of those things that we roll in games of chance - which potentially means two things...

1) Using the Die somehow involves rolling it, meaning that the guy Rhu'Brex might have made it slightly randomised - Unless this whole "Need" thing somehow alters its roll...

And the second, much more troubling... 2).... It doesn't have 6 sides. As we know, cubes have 6 sides, so why not call it a "Rhu'Brex" Cube?

There's 4 fabled functions of the die - Finding other magic items, Travel great distances, Destroying enemies and "Transmuting" items.

So what if... what if both of the above are true? What if this is some twisted 4-sided die-thing? Some wicked pyramid of arcane power?

I've stared into the darkness... but a four sided die scares me much more than anything else...

EPISODE 23: ILLEGAL FAKE GOBLIN HAM MEAT RING

As we join the action, our "heroes" are busy busying themselves with busy work in Hope's Rest, getting one last week of city life in before they're stuck on a boat for an unknown amount of time. Kolo is doing

crime, Gary is fighting it. Together, they'll keep each other in business forever, because also Gary keeps relapsing into his new drug addiction. For some reason, every time he falls asleep with his mouth open, he seems to get more addicted to Kolo's drugs. Esme presents

Gary with his special new shoes. They light up and scoot along and they are the best shoes ever. Esme then gives a pep-talk to her lab staff.

It is not particularly peppy, but at least it is talky. Derek Bobacious, everyone's favourite old

person, because who else would everyone's favourite old person be, Archicunt? What a ridiculous concept. . . arrives to look after the bank while Rocky's looking after the stone thing. Derek's here now. The crew then rides off

towards Port Averdale. Nothing happens. Nothing at all. All the way there. What is this shit? They arrive in Port Averdale, bored as fuck. It's pretty fancy. It is decided that in this

town they should be a troop of travelling entertainers, for very little reason. Gary is a magician called The Pope, with Fishy as his glamorous assistant, and Kolo dressed in a rabbit suit, that Pilch would never have got on him if he wasn't so high all the time. Esme is a Gabrin banker called Hardrip. Port Averdale is a cool place with foreign foods. Gary's on the lookout for a theatre. He finds an open-air theatre called The Triangle, and asks a local why it has 4 sides. Apparently it's 2 triangles put together. Gary's mind is B L O W N. Hardrip tries

to buy The Triangle with all that money he has. They head towards (but not in) the sea, to find a boat. Kolo hears that there's two options, one with two sub-options, first an exploring ship, or, second, a ship with a captain who is mad or a captain who is unscrupulous. Fishwank tries to fuck his way onto a boat. It for sure works. He fucks a whole bunch of sailors. Then he leaves the boat again, having achieved nothing but sex. And also money. Because of course. Kolo goes off to investigate the potential of boats to Masuda. Gary goes off to a pub called Rum and Ham or some shit like that, where the unscrupulous captains go. Gary orders a Rum Ham and a Ham

Rum. He eats one and drinks the other, then asks the whole bar who the most unscrupulous captain is. No one puts their hands up, but one guy says he can tell him who is. Then, Gary asks them to say the name of the most unscrupulous captain they know. They all talk at the same time and he has no idea what they said. Fishwank tries to fuck the barman but then gets bored when he thinks he's poor. Hardrip

tries to invest in the bar, and ends up pimping out Fishy. Gary talks to the guy who wanted to talk to him. Apparently Captain Someone will do anything for money, just like Fishy. Kolo ribbits, because he's a boy frog rabbit and also because he is still SO HIGH. Captain Someone has had a box seized by the Port Authority, who are apparently dicks, so it's fine to steal from them. Apparently if we get it back, he might want to let us in his boat. The gang go to visit Captain Someone on his boat, who is a bird. He's a bird

man, with pretty colourful feathers and a nice hat. He's pretty great. Hardrip asks if the bird likes riddles. He does not. Neither does Hardrip. Kolo strokes the feathery man. They

agree to steal the box and pay him 500gp and then he'll take them all to the place. Gary makes the feathery man agree that they're going to leave at dusk tomorrow. They all leave to go and do all the things, and say they'll be back with the box, which is apparently full of spices. Once

outside, Gary announces a spectacular magic show magically spectacle spectacular. Everyone gets super hyped. By jove, this is going to be the best fucking magic show there's ever been in this fucking town. Look at that rabbit. And that beautiful woman. The magic show is going to be at sundown tomorrow at The Triangle. This is

when they'll go on the boat, and everyone will think they'll be doing a magic show on the other side of town. He makes sure that all the authorities and church people hear him. When

everyone realises that they don't actually get to do a magic show, they get a bit sad. The plan is

finalised: 1) A box labelled "HAM" will be stolen from Ham and Rum. Kolo will feign death within the box 2) Gary, in his Police capacity as well as

his Magician capacity, will report to the Authorities that he saw some people moving boxes that said "HAM" but sounded like Gabrins 3) The Authorities will investigate the

crates and find one living Gabrin and a dead Gabrin (because Kolo has a ring that makes him look dead) 4) They'll impound the box, because

there's clearly some weird fake ham ring going on 5) Kolo will break out and steal the box Points

1 to 4 go off without a hitch, the Authorities open the box and find not ham, but a live Gabrin and a dead Gabrin dressed as a rabbit, and Kolo gets taken off into the impound. Esme and Gary

go off to Rum and Ham for a nice night, because they don't hang out enough. Esme recommends him some new foods to try. Fishwank goes to

keep an eye of the impound warehouse place. Kolo is in the box, still dressed as a rabbit.

He maybe hears something else in the box house. Maybe not, though. After a few hours of being

dead, he cuts himself out of the box. He goes

snooping in the boxes and finds lots of hollowed-out vegetables. Some have been used

to smuggle drugs. Some have. . . not. . . been used for that.They're fuckfruits.Fruits you can fuck.Kolo does not find a big box full of spice, which is what we want.Kolo tries to look under a door and does it so badly that his eye bleeds. Then he opens the door instead.A whole shit-tonne of guards are playing cards on the other side. They are not "Playing Cards".Kolo quietly empties a box, cuts eyeholes in it, and shuffles along the ground. It is great. Nothing could go better.Kolo realises that the best solution to this problem is to set fire to all the boxes.It is not currently known if the important box is on fire.Let's face it, it probably is.Kolo is still in a box, shuffling around this burning room.The two nastiest guards run out to get some water from somewhere.Kolo NOW starts checking boxes. He finds the important box. It's quite near the fire.NEVER FEAR! Fishwank is here, and he's the local fire marshal. The guards, unreasonably, expect him to be able to put out the fire.Clearly, this small fire means that this whole building is a write off and they should take all the flammable things, including spice, out of the building before it causes more damage.Somewhat, all of this works out pretty much fine.The other guards turn up, along with some for-real firemen who know how to put out fires for some reason. They don't stop him leaving, because they think they can put out the fire, for some reason.The guards save the box of spice, on Fishwank's command.Fishwank liberates the barrel containing Kolo.Suddenly, one of the guards carrying the spicebox falls asleep. It definitely to do with the invisible smoke, and not the blowdart that someone who couldn't be Kolo, because Kolo's dead, definitely didn't fire at him.The rest of the guards help Pilch get the carts to the ports where they'll be safe from the invisible fire.Again, everything goes fine. It's weird.The awesome alibi magic show isn't even needed.LATER, AFTER CELEBRATIONS:The gang are going to the ship, with the important box, a box of Rum Ham, and a barrel of Ham Rum.Gary's looking at the sky, feeling happy, so he definitely spots that they're being followed by a load of shadowy guys and a

floating guy who looks like that scary guy they met underground that time.They stand about, discussing how that's probably not great, when all of a sudden, Gary stops working. Some dicks start lurking out of the alleyway at them. Kolo puts some shit in Gary's mouth, but he still can't move.Fishy's Woolfe puts himself under Gary, and everyone except Esme, starts running (or being run, in Gary's case) away.Esme is too slow, falls behind the rest and gets flung up in the air by some crazy force.Gary regains control of his legs, jumps off the wolf, and just absolutely pegs it like some weirdass bull, using the combined powers of sprinting, drugs and heelies, he scoops up and picks up Esme as weird armoured. . . people....? run towards her. Kolo runs only slightly slower than him and fires a shot off.They run off towards the boat, and get Captain Something to drive the boat away as fast as he can, because the Inquisition have taken an interest in his spice, if you know what I mean.Fishwank fires a ballista at them. It misses.Some of them fall over on some ballbearings.Everyone gets on the boat, and the armoured guys are left on the shore like dickheads.The boat's sailing away, but what's all this? It's not moving.AHHH THE GUYS DOING SOMETHING FUCKED UP!!!!!!The boat's stopped. Everyone's going to die.But what's this?Kolo makes a small movement to himself, not looking like he expects much. All of a sudden, a light appears behind his eyes. The boat jerks forward, gets pulled back slightly, and then. . . BAM! It flies forwards, free from the magical force that was holding it in place.Kolo drops unconscious and the group sail off into the silent star-filled night, towards the mysterious continent, from whose shore none return.



MVG

EPISODE 24: THE BRIGHTEST FLAME CASTS THE DARKEST SHADOW

Well dear diary, I never thought I'd see the day when a big boat came my way. But that is in fact exactly what today is. Boat day. It is a lovely boat and is made all of wood and has a front and a back and both sides too. It has been a few sea days (same as land days) since Captain McCaw (parrot man) took us to sea from Port Averdale. Gosh I still remember how scary it was when those crazy inquisitors managed to almost catch me. The seas have been very calm and Kolo says Pilchard is having lots of fun with all the semen. Gary has been learning lots of naughty words and helping out around the boat. Kolo has not been well. Even though the sea has been very calm he has been very sick and stayed in his bunk most days. After a few weeks we came across a curious little island that is also a supply post where the captain has lots of friends. Kolo is happy to be on land again. We had an evocative and minimal day there apparently but it was over so very quickly. Gary was asking me about where the sea came from. Kolo usually tells this story but he seemed to be very very distracted about something in the distance. It was only Dark Elf Raiders!!! They were closing fast underneath the mid day sun and captains feathers were visibly raised. Fishy tried to cast darkness and he said that as he did it he saw them push a big ball into the water. Gary was trying to be a good host and decided that he would make tea for the new guests and demanded the good china. I didn't really think this was a good idea but I didn't want to be rude so I stayed quiet. Then they were attacking! Kolo decided to wake up properly and the game was on. They are slavers. One of the ladies swung across onto the boat with both hands full that was very impressive and oh my gosh did she hit him hard. I have not seen him wince that much since last night when I accidentally walked in on him and 6 of the crew's finest doing some kind of odd conga line without their leg clothes on. The lady shouted over to the other boat in an odd language that no-one could really understand. It sounded naggy. Two of them swung over to our boatsey and kolo and I did a super cool double twin funship time double shot. I think I misunderstood because Kolo did a funny shoot through the rope and the man hung in mid air for a minute and looked shot then fell into the sea in a funny way, and mine shoot just went through his left eye, travelled through his cranial cavity and emerging through the base of his

skull where the spine connects. He fell into the sea so I don't know if he lived but if he does I suspect he won't be able to walk anymore or remember basic facts like how to toilet. Omg there was like a crabby thing climbing up the boat as well and it did not look like a friendly crab like the one in the petting zoo in the city. Fishy died for a little bit. A lot of the sailors looked very sad and frustrated with this development. Gary threw the captain lady off the ship because of her rude manners. In his success he turned back to the crab and told it not to "you try anything missy". The crab responded by grabbing his head with it's giant claw. I tried to shoot it but it was so scary. Kolo was a big hero and went to help Fishy by giving him one of his special medicines. Fishy awoke and blurrily looked around him. I am sure he is grateful. Gary woke up and found himself all stuck in the clause of the crab. I shoot the crab and threw an electricity blanket to fishy. The pesky elves kept shooting at me and kolo's bodies. It was not going so well today, lots and lots of people everywhere and I kid you not even one little bit diary, not even one sailor helped us at all. Not even the captain birdy. Kolo was on fire though, his arrow was quite literally the most arrow arrow I have ever seen. But oh my gosh, then kolo seemed to waiver and he fell down onto the deck! The doggy killed the captain lady in a very gratuitous way and she died horribly. Then Fishy didn't even try to save kolo even though kolo helped him. Not cool. Gary managed to escape from the clutches of the claws but then it climbed up onto the boat. Then the other two elves of colour jumped over (it was actually dazzling how graceful they are). Howlydog urinated onto kolo to try and wake him up. It was all starting to look hectic and they were closing in all around us, backs to the boat neck, and I kid you not Gary actually had a little nap!! Right there on the boat floor. He woke up getting hugged by crabby. Then he looked tired again. Omg this one guy just keeps following me and will not die. #needy. I think everyone else was fighting crabby. Thankfully kolo managed to kill my unwanted friend. By the time I got over there gary and fishy were just flying around in the arms of the crab. Fishy did some odd thing where he turned into a shadow cloud and then the doggy turned into ash and the birdy squarked and popped into feathers. "This is not the time for this" I thought to myself. Kolo put the crabby down with a scream of fury, yelling about the fishy, the arrow travelling through Fishy's odd gas cloud. Goo just fell out of the crabby and it just fell into segments then fell to the boat floor, dead. That was quite a fight,

all the crew looked like they were quite shook up (even though I don't think I saw them fighting that much). We went over to the other boat and looted it and we got lots of money (that I held onto because Gary doesn't have pockets and Kolo seems to lose his money and Fishy is a cloud). Gary decided that we should take the other boat because it was too dangerous for people to be near us. He leant us some sailors, and I think I can handle what is essentially a piece of cloth and the wind. We spent some time looking for fishy. He had to be here somewhere. It was very odd that he was gone for so long. Usually he is around to say something stupid. Gary and Kolo had a little secret talk while I looked for Fishy. Gary looked shocked. I decided to try and see if my little magic detector could find him but it was clearly being broken because it was saying that it couldn't even find anything. This really wasn't funny and I was going to be very very cross with fishy when he turned up. Kolo was painting Fishy's name onto the boat and that wasn't even a good idea. They wanted to go on the boat and leave without fishy and that was a really stupid idea I do have to say because Fishy was not even back yet and Kolo and Gary wanted to just go and leave without fishy and that was a stupid idea and I told them that even and th..... Storms. Dreams nightmares of storms. Everything is raging. Everything is black smoke and screams and semen [Gary wakes up and notices that there is a large tattoo on his chest. Gary knows that this is the sign of his eternal shame and decides that it must stay hidden. I believe Kolo and Gary drugged me. I woke up groggy headed in an unfamiliar apple crate. The mood was low and I refused to talk to anyone. Everyone was quite. A month passed. I spent every day fixing up the ship and every night sat in the crows nest watching out for fishy and working on fishy's present for when he gets back even though I am cross with him for hiding so long. I think it is clear now Pilch is not coming back. Kolo says that is correct. I went to the back of the ship and looked out at the dark sea with the moon shining bright over the calm stillness. I worked so hard on this arm shield for him. And he was the human I hated the least. This is not fair. We arrived shortly after in XXXXXXXX a curious jungle town and port. The people all wore little jungle outfits made of grass and stuff and everyone was a human of colour like me. It made me uncomfortable and I held onto my coin pouch a little tighter as we walked around. Gosh it is hot as well. Our two sailors, Kev and his brother Archibald, whose parents

couldn't decide on posh names or common names so chose both. They decided to keep the boat safe and fix it up for our getaway. I looked over at the gleaming beaches and lovely sunlight but it just filled me with a sense of sadness. But saying that, they do have pappayas and mangoes which are actually quite nice. Once we got into town Gary went emotionally shadwoy and went to stand on a cliff. It seemed to me a lot like that was not a good move, so we went to take some pappayas to Gary and I decided it would be a good idea to eat them in front of him to cheer him up. I told him about how delicious it was and showed him how well I could eat, and that it could be shampoo but we both agreed we have no hair so we should just eat it. He gave a little half smile, and Kolo gave him some drops of liquid and they looked out at the sunset. We felt riphard's presence, and wondered what he was doing. I imagine he has made a pool of gold by now and spends his days diving into it and swimming and playing with his nephews. Gary felt renewed in the morning it seemed. He told us the mission was important and that he thought he had failed. But I was still asleep and tired because I had literally what seemed like 1000 hours of pappaya fuelled nightmares. Oh my gosh it was so horrible. I dreamt I was sat in an room full of humans in fancy shirts and they were all looking at glowing boxes, and one of them came over and said "Are you coming to the 2:30 meeting Jonathan" and I didn't want to but they gave me money. I was so bored all I wanted to do was eat more pappaya and pretend to be me with other people who looked at shiny boxes. And there was always wine every night and self loathing and meals that seemed to be nicer in your head before you made them but were then actually really disappointing and you promise yourself never to buy fish from Morris' son ever again and you should eat sanes berries again. Gary and Kolo were on it and told us what we needed to do. Kolo decided to raise our spirits by drinking spirits. O M G The drinks had little umbrellas in them! The nice dark skinned man called me pretty and I giggled a little but made sure to hold my coin purse tighter. I suspect that the umbrellas are to protect against rain. Kolo engaged the darkened man and asked about the wild animals which I thought was a bit on the nose given the circumstances. He seemed not to notice and told us about the jungle. "Nature owns the jungle". Kolo pointed out that nature owns the entire world. Kolo talked to the same man who was now stood somewhere else. He told us that outsiders never return from the jungle, and told us that the plants are thick and pathways difficult. It seemed odd to me that

there were pathways in the jungle. He kept saying indabush which who knows what that means. I ordered every pappya drink. I ordered all 3 and drank them and oh my gosh they were delicious. Kolo talked to the man about his people who lived in the jungle. He says no man would be crazy enough to guide us. Gary asked about legends and small cubes. He says he has not heard and that most of the legends are of the great beasts that all had stupid names. He told us we had to travel south from the oasis across the rope bridge then east to the temple. Gary wondered off and I ordered seven of each to go. Gary went up to a shop and asked for all the jungle kit. We got machetes, water canteens, sturdy boots, dried rations, towels. Somehow the man behind the bar had got to the shop before me. How could he be so fast? Gary started acting very odd. He collapsed to his knees and looked panicked. I tried to help him breathe but oh gosh there was a black dust that just came out everywhere, and then even what happened was that like a goldy smoke came out into the air then vanished and then Gary collapsed onto his face on the floor and the ground shook. Kolo and I tried to see what was wrong. We cut off his mumu and you would not even believe one bit that there was a glowing sigil all glowing gold on his chest and it was beautiful and it was Pilch's sign! His chest was all cracking and light was spilling out. And then he was almost sick everywhere but then just gold came out and it made a shape in the air and then just disappeared. I think Kolo must have given him something odd. The bar man looked shocked. Then was a little voice that just said "hey how are you doing?". There was a small figure just behind him all in gold with a long hat of gold. Is this Gary's son? He looked moist. The man was inside him and he has an odd accent. He doesn't even know what year it is. The man said his name was Mark. Then he started talking to us in our heads which seemed like a big violation of our privacy. The man claims that he was the mark that was on pilch's arm. He latched onto Gary when Pilch died because he was the closest. He came down from the heavens eons ago when divine power was more stable upon the earth and was meant to prevent the sundering, and he is short because divine power has dwindled and he is hemorrhaging his essence. He got bound into a book. Gary decided it was time to live up to his responsibilities and addressed his son directly. I asked if he had a mark of synne too but he just took his clothes off and I had to cover my eyes and apparently Kolo says he had little horns. I am a little convinced that Kolo may have put something in my drink. Kolo

challenged him on his claims. The man claimed to actually be a god. Or at least an avatar. I asked for proof because Gary was mental crazy. Gary asked his son to go to all the vendors and find the lowest price he could for a small vial that contained one grain of sand from each colour of the rainbow. He went to find a gullible sand vendor. He made the sand by magic. Gary was a strict father and made him go away and do it again properly. He walked off and played with his hat. Gary consulted us. Gary seems to think either he doesn't mean us no harm or he is not powerful enough to harm us, either way he is no immediate threat. I was worried that his shiny suit would draw panthers to us but Kolo points out that it would draw them to him. I asked Gary who the mother was. Gary started talking about the naughty thing people do sometimes to make children so I left and looked at Mark. He showed me a butterfly. He seemed scared of it. Gary and Kolo decided that Pilch must have been the mother. Gary embraced Mark and greeted him as his son and told him about his mother Pilch. Gary asked his son about the Cube O'Rubriks. He knew that it was deep in the jungle which did not seem immediately helpful. I sneaked a quick drink of the pappya mojito while no-one was looking. Rubriks was a powerful magician and had lairs and hid stuff so that seems to make everything more difficult. Gary's son implores his father to teach him bodily functions. We prepared for our journey, bolstered by new friends. End credits:
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZInRE-KryGA>
 The gang sit on the beach sipping pappya drinks whilst looking out at the sunset, lay out on sunbeds. The goblins watch as Gary and Mark attempt to play catch with a coconut but neither really seems to be grasping the fundamental basics of the game. They basically just throw it at each other's faces and laugh but seem to be enjoying each other's company. Kolo and Exme clink their drinks together and settle back in their chairs. Exme looks down to the beach and sees the shadow of her seat, and for a moment she sees the grunting face of Pilch as ghost sailors ram him. He gives her a little smile before going back to wincing from a particularly brutal thrust. Exme smiles and leans back to settle into a night of pappya-induced office-based nightmares.

EPISODE 24A: MUSINGS ON... LIGHT...



T worked. I'd say I'm cynical, but recent circumstances make me... optimistic? But yeah, it actually worked!

When last I spoke, I was musing on my

powers, my Shadow Weaving and Fate Spinning - one, I'm now certain, is my own dark sorcery, sapping my vitality and poisoning my body and mind, a twisted cancer that lets me do dark, twisted things. But the other is external - a divine fragment of the gods, maybe not a gift, but I have been gifted by it none-the-less. This amazing power is more subtle but no less awesome than my own dark sorceries. I have meditated upon it, practiced its power, and now can feel it pulse with renewed strength.

A strength that recedes the darkness. A strength that fills my soul with light, my heart with happiness. It banishes the dark thoughts and pushes back the shadows.. For the first time I feel... Optimistic.

Hell, I even took up the harmonica! And... well... spent some time with some sailors...

I find myself thinking of my lost love and, similarly, of my old friend Lilith - zippy and the book burners, and my father... For the first time I don't resent the man, I have sympathy. The mark connects me to these memories as living segments of time - more vivid than before, and my senses feel clearer.

...I hope I live to see them all again...

This is not said with sadness, but an unrelenting optimism. I cannot believe I am the same man as before! The light has set me free, and I must share it!

We fight for all of them, and we fight together - The goblin twins, Gary, Riphard (though he could not join us on this expedition). Arbiter Keros and her new partner. Even Archibald. Life has such hope, and I hope so much!

It is a fact that the odds are against us, that it is most likely some of us will die in this expedition. But for the first time I hope this doesn't happen, and I know that even if it does, we are stronger together.

Still, I'll do everything in my power to make sure we get through it.

... Together.

EPISODE 25: TERRIBLE TREBUCHETS AND TENACIOUS TIKI-TUKS



Hi There! I'm Mark, Mark O' Synne. I'm going to write some of what happens in this here jungle. Let's see what happens! So I'm travelling with two short

green goblins, and some rock-man that's stinking of the gods' divine might. I like him. He thinks he's my pop. It's weird. I mean, I know

who they are, I might have been on Pilch's forearms but I did share some brain-space with him. And thank the gods he wiped with his right. We travel about east about two days. Days are weird things. Not really seen many of them. We come to a big river. I don't seem to be able to cross it, which is sad. The goblins have built an awesome ride. I'm going to try it out! . . . I'm back, I was telling Lucy that like, this was a crazy idea, but so much fun. I saw a few sites o' interest while I was up in the air. The

other seem a bit weirded out that I just reappeared like that, must not be a mortal thing. We find an oasis, Lucy paddles with me. It's lovely. The male Goblin gives me a bit of something something, it helps me sleep. I'm on an adventure. I wake up. I'm still on an adventure, but now I'm big Gary's hat. Monkeys attack. Exme has bad luck, but not anymore! It dies in spectacular fashion. We head back into the jungle, and eventually find tribes people! They're super nice, they give us a pipe, but Lucy doesn't like it. Kolo translates. Few

things to note. . . The big-ass gorillas that attacked us are considered "Small". There's a tribe of weird "dildo"s the east that causes problem for the people.. Dildo might be Kolo's translation. There's "ancient ones" - giant mofo's that roam the jungle. Do not mess. We're going to kill some small people to help the big people. Small people are cannibals. Kolo put something tasty in my pipe, probably. Mmmm. . . Sleep. Sleep is weird, yeah? I'm new

to it, but it's pretty fun. I awaken, we're going to bed. The next day the chief gives us Kevin Sorbo - a valiant scout/warrior/hercules of the tribe. He's going to guide us to the enemies. Oh shit, the enemies are tiki-tuks. On a triceratops. We kill the tiki's, Exme scatters brains everywhere. We manage to make a new ally in Triceratops. He's called Terry. He's got Stockholm syndrome. Stockholm is a terrible place. Writing is tiring.

End Credits:<https://youtu.be/OQlByoPdG6c>

Mark sits on Gary's shoulder, while Gary sits in the Pagoda of Terry. Terry happily munches an apple. Exme tinkers in the back, looking to be putting together some kind of jug - having constructed a portable kiln out of palm leaves - there's discarded notes of "folding boat" around her. Kolo looks out, all around, his eagle eyes catching all the strange fauna as it walks past.

Lucy stretches her three tentacles and then makes her shrills screaming noise, smacking one of her beaked maws in anticipation. Classic Lucy.

Mark likes it here, he likes it with these people. The sun sets upon the party. They don't know where they're going, but they're going there in style.

EPISODE 26: NEVER WALK A STONE

The camera skims the tops of scattered cloud cover, miles above a dense, dark, forest canopy. Just about visible, brightly coloured tropical birds scatter, scared by something large moving in the trees. The camera drops towards the disturbance,

and we hear, before we see, a large, four legged reptile with three horns and a large frill is crashing through the undergrowth. On its back, a ragged Howdah sits, containing two Gabrins, a big grey guy, and a little golden guy. These,

apparently, are our heroes. They arrive at the Tikituk Temple, and find a whole village of the fuckers built around it, with Tikiwoman and Tikichildrens all over the place. They're all just

hanging out and living life, which is simply unacceptable. Clearly something must be done. There's a pen of dinosaurs over at the

edge. Kolo decides that Kolo should go and set all the dinosaurs free while other people try and talk to the Tikituks, despite the fact that he's the only one that speaks Tikituk. Gary makes himself a small person, and he and Esme put on Tikituk masks. Esme can understand Tikituk

somehow, but can't speak it, so she goes up to a Tikiwoman (who can also be referred to as Tittycuks) and explains using pictiary that there's attackers coming and they should all run away. It goes... medium. Gary is riding Terry the

Triceratops into the middle of town, looking like a bald, mentally handicapped Tikituk, shouting the words Tiki and Tuk at random. It wouldn't

be too bad, but Mark is also on the Howdah with him, and he hasn't thought to do anything in particular, so is just a golden, waving man. Garytuk realises that Mark is there, and throws him off the dinosaur angrily. This starts

freaking everyone out and they ring an angry bell that makes Pteranodons come out of the sky. Mark blows them up, and now everyone's really freaking out. Womantuks and Childrentuks run

all over the place. Garytuk comes with them, on the back of Terry, joining a big freakout stampede. Esme pictionarys the guy ringing the bell that there's bad guys coming out of the jungle. This makes him freak out more, not less, for some reason. Kolo fails to convince the

dinosaurs to emancipate themselves, so drugs them instead. Then, for some reason, every starts

freaking out at Mark EVEN MORE, and the Tikituks, Tittycuks, Garytuks and Terrys all run off into undergrowth together. Gary tries to help 8 Tikituks into the Howdah, but then falls off, and all his friends disappear into the jungle. Meanwhile, in a classic Gabrin 1-2, Kolo

shoots the guy who's ringing the bell, and Esme takes over, slowly coming to a stop. Mark blows

up some people. Now there are 4 Marks of different colours. Lark, Jark, Sark, and Shark, who is the coolest by far. Just as everyone

assembles on the steps of the Temple, Gary looking sad at the lost of both his friends and his dinosaur, the dinosaur drugs kick in and shit gets wild. The gang decide to head inside the

pyramid temple thing. In a small room just inside

the door at the top of the temple, there's some (relatively) big Tikituks who immediately knock Mark the fuck out and zap Sark out of existence. Gary goes in and heros all over the

place, standing over Mark, waking him up, throwing him away from harm and using his cool shit to not be hit by the bad boys. Kolo's

hiding in a corner, doing a Kolo thing. Esme uses her shield to not be murdered. Mark, now

not dead, runs back and does a magicky kinda thing. Esme goes to get ganked in the corner. For

a minute, everyone thinks she's dead, but then they realise she's not. Gary is not, for sure. Kolo

does shit. Mark does shit. Esme runs out of the

corner and murders a guy. Gary does hit. There's

some general battling. People do shit. Gary hits a

guy round the head enough that he ties himself up and goes to have a little sit down. He offers the only other guy left alive the manacles, but he's a jobsworth and thinks it would be better to be killed first. Kolo slits the throats of the guys

who tried to hurt Esme before Gary can save them. The other guys get sent back down to DinosaurDrugTown where they belong, having failed to protect their temple, and being shown to be generally shit. Mark says he thinks this

ancient temple is a old religious site. Everyone's real surprised. Esme gets addicted to Koko Kolo,

which is sad, because she deserves better in life. The gang head downstairs into another room,

which is old and used to have a picture of something on it. It's weird. This place looks like a temple, but the pictures don't look like the gods, and this place doesn't feel like religion. There's a lot of blood, though. And

bones. The gang head down a corridor, Gary

holding a flaming torch above his head, all sidewise like in films he's not seen, and with an Esme on his shoulder, which doesn't happen that often in films, because she has yet to break into the biz. There's a room full of Tikituks and

they all die really quick. One of them runs away and is hunted down by Kolo. Kolo looks around

and sees he's in a room full of half-eaten human corpses. He is so happy. Everyone else is in the

other room, feeling awkward. Eventually, they

meet up with him, and then find a staircase down. Being completionists, they decide to finish this floor first. Kolo finds a bedroom. There's a

whole load of cute dinosaurs in it, who live here, having fun and playing games. Kolo makes friends. They seem a little bit creepy, but maybe that's just my unconscious bias against dinosaurs. Kolo fails to convince them about

emancipation, of course, and so, of course, drugs them instead. Because Kolo, he is gonna Kolo. They all start sneezing and it is the cutest thing in the fucking everything. He opens the

gate, so that everyone can meet the fun dinosaurs. Obvs, they betray his trust and all try and run out of the gate. Kolo just closes the gate

again. Kolo the Wise outwits the tiny baby

dinosaurs. He is so very wise. Gary tries to talk some sense into the dinosaurs, but can't actually talk to them at all. He tries to send them to sleep, but it seems almost like they have some

sort of chemical assistance in staying awake, which is strange because Kolo swears he didn't give them anything. Gary, via Kolo manages to

convince them to go outside. Mark, after many failures manages the burn down the gate to their pen on the side that the guys aren't. They go outside. Kolo skulks ahead, and finds a room full

of those meanies they fought upstairs. They try and lure them out by saying the dinosaurs have escaped. Nothing happens. Gary tells them that they're here to fuck the temple up, and that doesn't work either. Gary goes into the room, and

being Gary, just tells the 3 baddies off for being rude. Gary immediately gets full on ganked. He is

all down all over the place. He is all down all over

the place all by himself in a room full of fuckheads. Kolo the Wise rushes in, and feeds

him a load of drugs because he's the fucking best/worst. Gary crawls off down the corridor

feeling like a bellend. Esme throws dynamite at

those fuckers, because that's what they deserve. They don't die, which feels like

cheating. Mark does nothing, but ages visibly by

23 years. But, like, not in his age, or anything. He is less shiny. This seems fine. He clogs up the

corridor with his bodies, of which he currently has 4 again. Shark and Lark die in the onslaught, and its emotional as. . .

fuck? Everyone is now doing what they wanted to

all along, and is lying in wait as all the baddies come round the corner one by one. Gary hides

round a corner, Kolo, Exmeh take their marks, The first tikki tuk emerges and

immediately falls to the Gabrins fire power. The next two Tikki Tucks swing straight into Gary. The stone giants stands his ground as piece by piece parts of him are carved off. The sounds that emerge from him, have not been heard for 1000s of years, and now may never be heard again. With what remains of his life force, he

stretches his arm away from the Tikki Tuck guards and plants his stick. A rush of energy pulses through the branch, as an arrow and chunk of metal are propelled from his Gabrin comrades into the remaining guards slaying them where they stand. The blood of the fallen Tikki Tucks seeps around the base of the branch as it surges into a full tree. Gary is no more, but a monument to what he stood for remains. The

Gabrins scream their grief at Mark, and Kolo

takes some clippings from the his tree. The remaining members of the party return to the top of the temple, to watch without glee the dinosaurs reek havoc among the Tikki Tucks below. The day is sad, and even Kolo doesn't take joy from the scenes playing out below them. Memories after this point are hazy. Credits:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tIdlqbv7SPo>



Goodnight Sweet Prince

EPISODE 27: MAKING NEW FRIENDS IS FUN BUT LOSING MARK IS FUNNER

Dear Diary.

All is death. All is pain. Why must all our friends leave us? For a little while everything seemed like it was going so well. Life seemed kind, yet as soon as she hinted at that promise of hope and friendship she ripped it away. First Pilcheur was robbed away from us by the 8 seas. And now. . . . He was the bravest goblin that ever lived. He was everything the stories told of and more. And now he has gone, like tears in rain. Why has this happened? Why?

Two Months earlier: Riphard sits on a sunlounger in a drizzly night, ordering whisky from no-one in particular and questioning his life. It had been a month of banking, drinking and ordering about Exme and Kolo's workers. Derek bodacious had travelled up to start his billboard campaign. "We take interest in your interest". His squeeze Delilah had been gone

seeing the Jennies but she remained tight lipped about that business. She sounds a lot posher than before. Riphard cannot live without her. Delilah points out sometimes they will need to go to the shops. Riphard clarifies that he can live 48 hours/2 days without her. The romance is retained. And Riphard proposes making her the happiest whore in the world. (A thousand miles away Pilch's testicles are crushed as a sea monster pierces his heart through his perineum). Riphard feels the world is a little better. Riphard is so chuffed he feels physically more developed and nubile. It took a long time. Too long. Very long. Pasta was not chinese? Spelled up to the tits mate. To the tits. Riphard held Delilah tight to him but a knock at the door broke him away. It was Arbiter Kiros and some small plate armoured man. Having an ex-possibility turn up was not part of the special day. Riphard was confused by Arbiter Smordnuron (Myron?). The two new visitors entered hurriedly. Kiros gave a long look at the rigid and tearful Delilah. Kiros had troubling news from her friend. Myron explained that he had been made aware of a young man up in the country who was suffering from a spell of seeing things and sought Riphard's advice. The visions showed a grey man turning into gravel and/or a tree. A rescue mission was proposed with the caveat that it seemed 'dodgy as fuck'. Riphard did not seem concerned. Lines of dried Koka Kola and his whore-to-be-wife and gold beckoned. Flint and Jiznak suddenly came down the firemans pole. Jiznak could not help but overhear that they wanted to travel. He was not spying. He explained that they had been constructing a device for Lady Haramxe that might help them get there quicker. Jiznak has an invisible brother who speaks to him. This was not mentioned in the interview. He decided that it was probably easier to show them what he was talking about. The group travelled upstairs. An 8 ft long and 4 ft wide wicker basket full of supplies sat on the roof, tied to a number of metal wires and a large sheet. Riphard got it right away. Jiznak also handed Riphard a two hand sized device that had an antenna on top that had a screen on the front that was able to track Starni that Exme had previously poopooed. Riphard and Delilah had a brief argument about who should fly the machine. It was always Delilah's life-dream. Riphard didn't give a fuck. The argument seemed like a stale mate. Myron said that Delilah was driving. Riphard sulked and said he wouldn't come. They decided to split it. Flint Barrymore is Italian. He points out that an extra crate has been added for Exme. Myron is worried about dying. Jiznak inflated the balloon

to which Riphard took offence. As they flew away Jiznak screamed "By the way we've been having some problems with stopping it". AND THEY WERE OFF. . . .

We woke up from little sleep, the tears still fresh on my face. For a brief moment as I awoke I thought I saw Gary sleeping next to me, but it was just a normal rock. Kolo was staring at the sky. It seemed like more terrordactyls were on the way. As it got closer I realised it it was a Jiznak "special" including no brakes. Goodness me it was coming in fast. As it got closer an odd man was hanging off the basket and dragged his heels along the side of the temple, slowing it a little but oh god it was coming in fast. It basically imploded all over Mark. What a mess. As the wreckage cleared, I could make out the image of Riphard, rolling out of the carnage with Delilah in tow. The strange new man came up to the top of the stairs and looked at us. He said "It's all true isn't it?". I couldn't believe they were here. Hours. Just hours. If they had been here a little quicker he wouldn't have died. I couldn't stop crying. The odd new man introduced himself as Arbiter Myron. He seemed to have been misled and decided that he was going to join us. Kolo and Myron had a discussion about devils. Myron seemed to be learning alot about how the world really worked. Mark introduced himself in an annoying way and confirmed all of Myron's worst fears about how the world worked. Mark told everyone he wanted to talk to Lazarus. Marke described himself as Sin's pinky finger/moose knuckle. Riphard couldn't really understand. Myron didn't have half a thumb on his right hand. I was quite craving Koka Kola. Oh god how I wanted it so bad. Kolo gave me two and I put them both into my papya drink. I drank deeply and felt the shivering stop. It felt lovely after all the pain. Sooo sl.ee...py.

We woke up in front of stupid Lazarus's desk. Thankfully Meredith had tea and she sounded quite funny with her trunk. Mark seemed upset about how she had stood him up at Prom for Brad. He says he can't quit that woman. Myron looked incredibly confused. Myron seemed to have a lot of lip for someone he had only just met. Lazarus seemed happy to see Mark again. Also, he looked very different and a bit more emaciated. He had all these little frays of light about him. They had a dick waving contest about who had let more people die. Omg Mark just slapped Lazurus right in the face. He just gave Mark a toothy grin and then backhanded him into the wall. It was almost sad how devastating it was. Lazarus looked through his rhyming documents to find Myron's documents. Myron offered his help to Lazarus in a funny

voice like those people that work in the dirty streets back in the city and dig black rock and eat pies. Lazarus pointed out that Myron's whole life picking berries and helping people was actually not so good and he said that Myron was a sinner. Myron asked about how much of a sinner he was and Lazurus flicked through a lot of papers looking more shocked the more he read. I got the impression that Myron was not going to have a good afterlife. I asked Lazarus as nicely as I could if he could bring Gary back to life. He said no, not like us. But, he said Gary was different. Gary would actually probably come back to life in a few hundred years. I. . . this is incredible. We'll never see him again but, it brings me hope that Gary will walk the planet once again to bring little goblins joy once more. Gary will live on.

Lazarus told Myron about how we had to take down the church and destroy the gods. Myron was basically all for it and accepted it very easily even the whole sunburning thing that I still don't really understand. Kolo got a good dig in about Pilch and Gary. Lazarus decided he would not be insulted all day and he and Riphard had a moment. Mark tried to ask for Meredith's number but then we all woke up.

Mark was complaining about how he did not have a nanka. He said we had all been touched but that never even happened to me. Mother brought me up proper. Everyone had a bit of a natter looking around what was going on outside. I explained to everyone that the magic field in this temple was off the charts and we should honour Gary's temporary sacrifice by find the Die of Rubrix. Myron headed down, very keen indeed. As we went downstairs, we came face to face with Gary's tree. It looked so precious and beautiful. I could smell again and I noticed the vivid smell of rocks everywhere. Riphard looked weak. Myron started looking wildly around. Riphard didn't look well at all and I asked him if he wanted to sit down. I followed Kolo into the room that Gary was subdued in. Kolo had already found a secret door inside the room and he asked me to go get everyone. Kolo said he found many many riches in the room to the tune of 5000 gp. One was a beautiful tiara that Kolo put on me. We went to get everyone else after making sure to hide it all in bagsy (shhhh don't tell anyone). Kolo asked Riphard about how the banking has been going. It has been going well. Riphard pointed out that he was excited about his new forestry initiative. There was some confusion about whether trees grow or if they don't like lemons. Myron told us a story about a town where some people had stolen lemons and then sold them back to the town and everyone

laughed nervously but then he said a load of homeless people had been tried and hung for the crime. That was a little bit awkward I will admit. Kolo asked me to help Riphard out a little bit *wink *wink. I tried to shake his hand many times but he kept just scrunching his hand up in a ball and pushing it against mine. I gave it to Delilah instead who decided that prenups were suddenly a VERY good idea. Oh wells

We headed downstairs and kolo did a sneaky sneak to go and look ahead. Mark went off South running away from me for some reason. Well it might not have been me but I took it personally. There was a sad sound of a falling body so I imagine he died. No-one really cared so we tried our look with new friend Myron. I noticed how short Myron was for the first time. All dark skinned and Grey and wrinkled. His tattered orangeish brownish coat sat on top of his plate armour, more finely crafted than I would personally expect from the rest of his clothed. And my what a gun, so complicated. What does it even do? I can't really understand how it works given that the top pivot was just fixed in place but it did look cool. And he's very dark. . . .

We headed into the fight Myron leading the way very bravely. Kolo and I followed behind. The room was full of all types of tikki-tukk ©. He put down his shield in the doorway and stood bravely. They screamed "By fire, wind and ice, we will take them for sacrifice". His shield seemed to get all hot after a TikkiTuk © shouted out some words and Myron looked really hot. All these brambles came up around my legs but I just shrugged them off because they was just plantsies. Kolo was all wrapped up but he was still able to do a killing bow because he is ace. I shot one and then the two normal ones ran at Myron. The first tikki-tukk © got impaled on his bayonet. Then I saw one of the coolest things i have ever even seen. He used the momentum of the dead body to reload his gun and then shot straight through the corpse into the next tikki-tuk ©. It was amazeballs. As we moved into the room we saw that there was an odd little monkey man all tied up looking like a sacrifice. We all tried to come into the room but there was some giant almost-wall like thing of wind. Myron ran straight through it fearlessly but it didn't look so easy. Kolo tried to shoot through it and what a shot but the arrow just splintered in the wind. Myron fought them on the other side and somehow the man-monkey wormed his way free and started fighting those guys too. Gosh he can move fast. He hit one guy who started making lightning but as he did that the wind wall dropped and I managed to kill him with a

kaboom.

Myron seemed to relax after the fight and offered us round some delicious beef jerky. Really salty, and a good texture. Cured almost to the exact ri. . . . Mark re-appeared. I rolled my eyes. I pointed out to him that he was never really here when we need him and he said he wasn't really the fighting type. He started flickering and through the garbled words he looked at the monkey-man and sometimes he didn't have a leg and sometimes his legs were walking backwards while he was standing still and then suddenly he just jumped into the man-monkey. . . . This can't be good news. I considered killing the monkey-man for a moment but I decided the risk of Mark surviving was too high so I decided to let him live. I wonder if the monkey-man will be our friend?

Epilogue: Year 1657 - The Other World Prom Night

A young Mark checks how his golden hat is sitting in the reflection of his golden shoes. It's looking good and Mark knows it. He gives himself a toothy grin and heads towards the front door of a small suburban house. All the full nightmare terrors of hell swim and swarm through the blackened sky above the tasteful 2 bedroom bungalow and child-like elephants wave at him as they play on a swing in the garden that is pushed by the souls of the dead. Mark knocks on the door and gives himself a little arm-rub for luck. The door opens and a surly, elderly elephant man with a pipe answers. The elephant man is dressed in a sweater, slacks and slippers and holds a newspaper under his arm. His trunk flares as he surveys the small golden man in front of him. "How are ye doing sir?", says Mark with a misplaced enthusiasm. The elephant man grunts. "I'm here to pick up Meredith for the prom". The elderly elephant chuckles and his trunk lets out a short trumpet. "What de ye mean Brad?", asks a stunned Mark. The elephant man's eyes go wide and his mouth curls into a grin. "Brahhhh prahh pruurum aprpprp" he mockingly replies. "But that cant be right sir. Ye daughter promised she'd be going with me". The elephant man's wife appears wearing curlers stuck to the top of her elephant head and she asks her husband a questions, "hruumph pumphhh rrrmp?". The man replies, "grumpppp frrrp tummp". They both start laughing in an elephantlike way and the man slams the door in Mark's face. Mark is shocked and looks down at the now wilting flower that he had bought for his beloved. As he turns to walk away he sees Meredith in the passenger seat of Brad's Corvette. The two are laughing and

driving away. Mark pauses for a moment and says “Well. . . . Who’d have trunk?” GIANT GRIN TO CAMERA - EXTREME ZOOM IN - PAUSE ON GRIN - MUSIC PLAYS

<https://youtu.be/ntG50eXbBtc?t=45>

EPISODE 28: PETS WIN PRIZES

Dear diary, Today almost everyone was still dead, but some new fuckers arrived by one of Exmehs great inventions.

I was especially impressed with how the ship crashed and burnt into MarkOSynne. Any carnt that pretends to be a god is better off dead, for the good of all really. Riphard also turned up and was typically stubborn about not taking money off lady Haremxe (Exmerah) but Delilah was happy with the pay off, and I guess as they are getting married now it will all work out in the end. I must remember to pick up the parts of

Gary, if he is coming back in a few years then it should be somewhere nicer. I could always give him to the police department, but at least for a short while he can on the shelf with the bits of Otario. Now we must contend with the strange

monkey man, somehow Mark is still here. He seems to be abusing the monkey, until in a blaze of light and glory the monkey glows down to his arms. Where there is now a horrid mark, by the lifes of DeRulo wtf is with this shit. The new

Arbiter has been pissing in the corner of the room for a while, smoking though so maybe he would be interested in some of the magic leaves! Exmeh seems to like the monkey though,

and has named it Jeremy maybe with a bit of training he could be useful. Come to think of it I'm not entirely convinced the monkey is real, group hallucinations would be a new thing, but recently its got pretty hairy anyway. Jeremy may

be blind, as he uses his tail stick to tap out his way down a corridor, I am getting more and more convinced he isn't a real thing. He promptly speeds right out of sight, faster than a horse on kola, probably something to do with the boulder falling towards him. We could probably get a new monkeh, but Exmeh is right the next one might not talk. Don't knwo what the monkeh has been

upto but their is parts of tikki tuck everywhere by the time we get there. The guy on the throne seemed unphased by it all, but Jeremy is on it and beats the bejesus out of the two tikki tucks taking him on, both of whom seem to have forgotten their axes. This clearly angers the big boss who hasn't baked cookies so probably isnt on for a lovely time. Monkeh is in serious danger, as the big guy gets really into it. Too late, all monkehs go to heaven. The big guys tries to take

Exmeh and I at the same time. Mistakes have been made by all of us, as we get totally boned by the tikki tucks. I should have realised earlier when we found them here, clearly a civilisation

that can span the entire world isn't to be trifled with so lightly! Shit looks bad, but the church

people are all getting ontop of each other. I smash some kola into the monkeh's nose, and hope for the best. The Monkeh seems good for it. Delilah swings in all happy about the wedding and the man pile in front of her, smashing the shit out of the bosstuck. The CBA adds up tho, and Exmerah blows the guys bloody brains out, for years she has been explaining these sums to me, and I finally see why! Myron saves the monkey with his beef jerky and we are good to go. For real shit is too much for us. We release the

imaginary women and liberate the gold from teh back chamber. We also get a lovely belt and a phallic object. Exmeh gives the mascot monkey a

collar, which grants him resistance to nonn magical attacks twice per short rest. He is best pet, almost. Traps traps traps, are they in our

mind or did the monkey put them up? Somethings we will never know. . . . Oh no it

seems like the traps are really dangerous, someone has let out hundreds of butterflies making the blades of swinging death all the harder to avoid. I retrieve the gauntlets and

massive gem, and despite Exmehs best efforts manage to pay off the hired help. The help also claims the gauntlets, before we go to retrieve the crate of the airship. To help us we go and find

Trevor the triceratops who tramples us back all the way to the camp!

EPISODE 29: IN A WHILE, CROCODILE

THere is a large party with muchos bongos. The tribespeople love bongos. As does everyone. It's like the Ewok party from Episode VI: a little weird and culturally insensitive. We are guideless. Rudderless. Lost in the wilderness. Jeremy think he's welcome in the jungle. Thinks he knows where he is. But jungle is massive. Monkey don't know shit. The tribespeople think it's grim oop norf, and guide us south. Which is weirder apparently. Weird shit like. . . Brighton. Jeremy wants to get into Myron's pocket or something. Myron berates him for not having pockets. He's also shit poor. Dirty monkey. The party mostly consists of fruit. Even without Pilch. ZING. Try the fish. Ellie interrupts complaining about football not being on TV. Bloody women eh? Exme offers Vu Dong roast squirrel monkey.

"Try the brain, it is most delicious." says Dong. The group takes a bunch of the food, flint, tinder, rope, y'know anything that will be generally useful in the next few DnD sessions. The tribespeople haven't discovered metal. But they do have rock. Everyone goes to sleep.

Myron asks where we're going. Riphard doesn't trust the savages. Gnomes have two arses. Myron and Kolo think that the tribespeople have been very kind so we should probably trust their primitive knowledge. Exme gives Jeremy a squirrel monkey skull collar that says Jeremy. Kolo thinks he can read the stars through 100% tree canopy cover. Not to mention the potential differences in celestial patterns on this world. Jeremy knows all about saunas in the jungle and confidently thinks he can take us there. The group looks forward to a nice spa resort relax. He seems to agree with the savages. Riphard is skeptical. The group offers Riphard counselling for his racism. Myron is an arbitrary ranger apparently. The group travel south for a day and a half, surviving off spider monkeys and crabs.

Jeremy, Kolo, and Myron notice two giant beasties standing in a river up ahead. Gargantuan jungle giants. One is a 100ft giant crab, staring down an 80ft tall, 100ft long Elk, with enormous antlers that peak above the trees. They are rutting. Exme does the classic "are they small or far away" Father Ted joke. Good stuff. Myron wants to give them a wide berth and to not disturb the monstrosities. Respect nature and all that. Very Star Trek. Myron is a witcher. Awesome. Myron knows they are basically gods. Kolo wants one of them to die to harvest its giant organs. The Elk charges the Crab. The Crab grabs the antlers with its claws and they start wrestling. Riphard speculates about 80ft Elk dick, and wants to study the creatures for scientology. Myron has seen and eaten enough crabs in his time to know that massive crabs are the same as normal crabs and therefore wholly uninteresting. The group travels on despite Riphard's protests.

The south is murkier and softer (obviously). Myron steps on a frog. Jeremy licks it. Myron claims to have deliberately killed it because it's poisonous. Kolo knows it isn't because of his drug expertise. Vu and Riphard step in a tar pit. Tarnation. Vu counts his spears, as you do when you step in tar. Myron throws Riphard a rope. There's a bunch of trees overhead. . . ? Riphard grabs the rope. Exme hears the flapping of wings and the group enter combat. Cue pokemon encounter music.

As the creatures swoop down, we see that they

are. . . GIANT STURGES! Normal sturges are tiny, but these are cat and/or gnome sized. They're like. . . bats or something? With massive noses. 4 of the sturges attack Rip in the tar. One of them latches on to him, sucking his blood. 2 attach to Dong. Riphard worries about the monkey blood that might get spilt. Exme gets one on her, which is the size of her. Kolo hits Exme with an arrow. "It's too jungly in here". Vu Dong is thigh deep in tar being attacked by 4 leechbats, 2 attached to him already. He thinks he can use them to get out of the tar or something. Classic Jeremy. He hits himself with his stick. Not everyone can do that! He twats the two suckers on him, does some magic shit, and hits them again. They look really fucked, but dat face when they still suckin. Exme doesn't blame Kolo for hitting her with an arrow. Goblins are very understanding of collateral damage. Myron attempts to lasso Riphard with his rope. The sturges block the lasso and it lands in the tar. Riphard slashes one of the suckers twice. SHE STILL SUCKIN. Riphard grabs the fuck out of the lasso and is dragged out of the tar. The sturges suck on Rip and Jezza. Ouch. Looking pale. Another sucker sucks on Rip, hard. Some of them attack Myron and Kolo. Myron shrugs the suckers off. Delilah gets sucked, which Riphard doesn't like. Deli tries to rapier it, but for once she misses.

Kolo doesn't shoot Exme again, instead missing stabbing something the size of himself that is attached to him. Flailing randomly. Useless goblins. Vu swings at one of the things attached to him, killing it. He looks temporarily healthier. He swings at one in the air, but it makes him look like a monkey. He also has a couple more swings at another one. How many attacks does this monkey get?! He hits. Exme shoots at the thing on Kolo, and kills it. It being the thing. Not Kolo. Riphard tuts to himself. Myron shotguns a sturge off Riphard. That seems safe. Unbelievably it works. Riphard slices at the one remaining on him and hits it hard, but drops his off-hand scimitar into the tar! Riphard gets another one attached! He looks incredibly pale. Deathly almost. Delilah also looks in bad shape. There could be some tough choices in the near future. . .

The group doesn't do much as they near death. Myron shrugs it off. Vu does kill one. Exme kills the one on Delilah, rescuing her from almost certain death! Not Riphard though, fuck that guy. Myron bayonets himself for MASSIVE DAMAGE. But he shrugs it off. He bayonets it again. Rip misses the things and burns with an intense internal inferno. Delilah kills one of the ones of Rip and does some cool shit, healing

herself and kills the other one of Rip. EXCEPT NONE OF THIS HAPPENED BECAUSE MIKE FORGOT TO DO THE STURGE ATTACK FIRST AND I REMINDED HIM. #THATGUY. Rip's firebrand doesn't matter, Riphard falls unconscious anyway at the relentless sucking, because SHESTILLSUKIN. But it's not completely in vain as Vu Dong feels slightly better than he would've. Rips Scimitar sinks into the tarry oblivion, and Rip starts to sink himself. Everyone kills the remaining things, with some classic Stephen metabants.

Exme is jealous of Delilah's hat, but doesn't resent her for it. She checks herself, prior to wrecking herself, and proceeds to rescue Riphard. Riphard wakes up with a jolt "DID ANYONE TOUCH THE MONKEY BLOOD?!". Jeremy seems to be trying to insert something into Riphards groin. . . Riphard bats him away. The group longrest and everyone berates Riphard for not firebranding at the start of the battle. Hindsight is 20/20 fuckers. Exme calms the group with hat based compliments and craves coke. There is no coke in the jungle, but Kolo somehow cobbles together some jungle Koca-Kolo, branded Um-Bolo. It's understood that they drink it in the Kolo. Exme mainlines one immediately and suddenly gets the worst dry mouth, feeling super thirsty. She starts downing papaya-based alcohol. Kolo starts succumbing to the jungle heat and exertion, looking exhausted. He drinks some papaya-juice, and does some delightful goblin hijinks. There some short people bantz. 4'2". Hilarious. Riphard scoffs at these shorties.

Jeremy catches some Beatles. The group want to trebuchet Jeremy. There's some discussion about where to go. Riphard laughs to himself. There's a wall apparently. Exme has OCD. Myron: "EAST SIDE IS DA BEST" Riphard: "WEST WEST WEST". Myron reluctantly agrees, and Riphard looks smug and walks off East. Idiot. Another day and a half heading East, running out of supplies. Myron smells water nearby. A huge argument breaks out about the nature of smelling water. Nonetheless, the group stumble miraculously on an oasis. That was thanks to Myron. Definitely. Maybe. Kolo gets bitten by something out of the blue, grappled in the water. He gets pretty fucked up. "Crikey!" - Riphard. "No, crocky" - someone else. This croc is fucking massive, christ. Riphard still feels disappointed at the missed opportunity to study the Elk and Crab. Vu Dong says he couldn't smell the croc because of all the water. Kolo finds himself in the giant crocs mouth. He hunters marks it from the inside. He then poison bows it, giving it a bad tooth ache. Myron

does some sick shit, dancing along the croc and jumps into the croc bayonet first. The bayonet ricochets off the crocs scaly hide. As he does this he also shoots it. This does hurt it. The croc bites Kolo, who is already in its mouth. "That cock makes me so happy" - Stephen H, 19/09/2017. Kolo gets swallowed. Richard thatguys a bit about how firebrand ain't saving Kolo this time. He's definitely dying. Rip firebrands, makes a great joke about non-religiously blessing bullets, and misses badly. Exme gets out of the water. Delilah misses again, surges, and nails the croc on the second asking, forcing the croc to be shit the next time. Vu Dong jumps on the croc and bashes it with his monkey stick a few times. Stunning. Which I think stuns it or something. It is stunned. He continues wailing on it.

Kolo starts dissolving. Myron pulls out a small metal canister, throwing it down the crocs throat. Sadly it isn't crocodile stomach acid neutralizing spray, just a smoke bomb, giving the croc a cool dry-ice effect pouring from its mouth. He also bayonets it. The croc ain't bothered about the smoke in its mouth. Rip readies a smiting shot. "Seeya later Aligator", and shoots it dead, vomiting up Kolo. Myron starts musing on the differences between crocs and gators. Exme rushes to revive Kolo. Riphard looks "happy" at Kolo's survival. The group all congratulate Riphard on his heroism. He feels genuine warmth at the first sign of actual friendship in his miserable existence. He glances over to his fiance. The croc is skinned and will make a fine suit of armor. The group debate the finer points of owl poop.

The group rest and recover. Kolo now has acid burns. Exme has made 2 masterwork studded leather armors, given to Kolo is remembrance of being partly dissolved, and Rip for slaying the mighty beast. Exme is still a coke fiend though. Sad. Exme eats random leaves in hopes of chasing that sweet, sweet high. Myron notices a few ancient, long since unused, trails. They show signs of ancient footfall. Myron ponders the implications of this before rushing into something. He takes a knee, looking closely at the track, feeling the very vibe of the surroundings. He detects no monstrosities within the area, instead feeling a calming presence. The trail winds up through the side of hilly areas, working its way upwards to a clearing with a dilapidated cottage. Crumbling walls, broken stone work, holes in the roof. It looks a little out of place in its little enclave in the jungle. Exme wants to build more trebuchets. The gang wants the trebuchet on Trevor the pacifist triceratops, which the group

have been travelling on. Jeremy has a look from the roof of the cottage, getting a good view of the surrounding areas, even seeing snow in the far distance, and the ridge to the north the group skirted. The roof gives way, but Jeremy falls with style, hanging from the decaying rafters. Kolo investigates the inside of the cottage. There's a rusty kettle. Kolo looks past the tempting kettle and roots around in the rubble and centuries of crap on the floor, quickly finding markings on the ground, but it appears incomplete. The group spend a few hours shifting rubble, fully uncovering the apparent chalk markings, although the longevity of the marking suggest otherwise. The religious Rip and Myron don't know shit about this. But Kolo immediately knows it's a teleportation circle. He explains this in Goblinerish. Myron struggles to believe in the seemingly impossible. Kolo mimics the giant crab from earlier.

Exme measures the circle in at 80,000,000 Dumbledores ("That's 80,000 Hogwarts!"). The detect-o-matic suggests we need to stand in bits within the circle to complete it. "According to this, we need to place the monkey in a trebuchet. I keed. I KEED! We just need chalk to draw some chalk dicks, some chicken or animal blood, not dangerous monkey blood, tie your hair back, hang on to your hats and glasses". "I really don't know if this is the best course of action. I've come to accept a lot of things that I've come to accept in my time with you guys. But standing in a weird circle with you guys that might potentially delete me forever is too much. I just want to ask someones opinion who I actually trust!" - Myron. "I understand your dread, but it'll just take us wherever there's another circle." - Kolo. "There might be a dragon on the otherside or something!" - Rip. "What's a drag on?" - Everyone else. "How bout, rather than send everyone, we just send one person, worst case scenario, one down." - Myron. "What if it's just one way?" - Rip. "One monkey down?" - Rip. "Why are we even here?" - Rip. "Some monkey bullshit" - Jeremy. There some attempt to trick various people into teleporting themselves. Kolo volunteers to teleport first. Jeremy farts badly. The group stand in position except Myron, who isn't coming. Exme convinces Myron into the circle, and Kolo says the magic word "Superted".

Epilogue

As Riphard soars through the metaphysical unknown, he ponders to his ethereal self on the meaning of existence, the futility of this battle with the living to improve the lives of the dead. He thinks of Delilah, and whether her beautiful flesh will reassemble as beautifully as he remembered. Will he even remember after this?

Is this what it's like to die? Is this what it's like being born? A soothing music washes over him and he smiles as a light begins to come into focus.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kR0gOEyK6Tg>





Some say he never left the inside of the crocodile

EPISODE 30: LESSONS IN COLOUR THEORY. AND DEM BONES!



N empty room. Bzzzzzt. . . .
Bzzzzzt....Pale blue lights flick on and
off.Zoink.A load of fuckheads suddenly

appear. They argue for a bit, then go and look at the metal door that leads out of the room. It scrapes open slightly, jarring about 2 feet up.All the fuckheads are short fuckheads, apart from the monkey one, so they barely even have to duck.Some of them file through the doorway, and some of them stay in the room to try and steal the light fittings. They succeed, and then get upset that it gets dark. Fuckheads, see.The ones that have gone under the door find a load of rocks on the ground. The grumpy one in the hat pokes it with the end of his gun sword thing. It only goes and builds itself into a guy. He's a fancy marble butler guy.The grumpy hat one tells him to go and put some clothes on for a reason probably. He opens a secret cupboard and gets dressed. The monkey one offers the posh rock a big bag of mixed offal. Again, probably a reason.The little green boy goes and watches him get dressed.I say "dressed", but he's just pinning bits of fabric onto himself.He comes back out, and the grumpy hat one gives him more shit. What a bellend.The little green boy has accidentally put a bag on his head, and explores it until further notice.The posh rock becomes called Oovwaw, he wasn't before. Everyone realises he doesn't have hands, and everyone has a whole bunch of questions.The grumpy hat one abbreviates "probably" to "probs". It's totes in character.Oovwaw finally gets round to telling everyone where they are. This is the Tower of Rubrix. This is the last remaining area of the Tower of Rubrix that isn't full of bad shit. The posh rock has kept this area safe for many centuries, as the results of Rubrix's experiments have taken over the rest of it.Somewhere in the tower, is the puzzle die, which these fuckheads apparently want.Apparently, the tower has been teleported deep underground.The posh rock has some pretty mixed feelings about his creator, which apparently means he's happy to help people steal all his shit. The fuckheads and the posh rock just do a lot of hangin' talking about

shit.The grumpy beardy metal one and the little green girl go and help the green boy get the bag off his head.The rest of them fill him in, but realise it doesn't take long, due to the pre-mentioned hangin' about.Poshrock says that this is the 5th floor and that the puzzle die is downstairs on the first floor.When asked what's inbetween here and there, Poshrock gives a nice summary:Lvl 4: Snake People Lvl 3: The Zoo Lvl 2: [data incomplete] Lvl 1: The place where the thing isMyron has never seen a snake, and doesn't know why everyone else has. Everyone tries to describe one. Apparently it's basically a long crocodile.The fuckheads all go into the next area, and there's a pointy stone thing with a big red ball on top. Everyone tries to tell the monkey to punch the orb, but he only pokes it with a stick, because he's a bad, cowardly pet.The green boy touches it with his hand and it turns lots of colours. Nothing happens for a bit, and then everyone starts floating. Obvs.Eventually they're walking on the ceiling like it's the floor, but it seems like everyone fails to really grasp the central concept.There's some general Fizzy Lifting Drinks Hijinx, and then everyone notices a door in the ceiling.The green children scoot off to go and have a look in it. They find lots of bottles of shit. Grumpyhat scoots up and gets given an orange one.They have fun morally ambiguous times.He looks down towards the rest of the group, and see the monkey failing to use a water bottle.Being helpful, he teaches the monkey one to drink, using the helpful teaching aid he just acquired.Drinking the orange potion turns the monkey orange. Bonkers.The green children put the orb back in the thing and the gravity goes back.Once back on the ground, they go and go through the door that's on the floor.In that room, there's a user manual for a security system based on a colour assignment. Each category of apprentice was assigned a colour and would only be allowed in areas corresponding to that colour.They go to the door that leads out of the gravity room and it's orange.The monkey one touches the door and it hurts him real bad. The green boy thinks he did it wrong, so he touches it too. He hurts real bad too. Lessons are not learnt. They likely never will be.Eventually they work out that purple is the answer.The green boy

tries to explain to everyone why purple's the answer. No one understands, and resents him for trying to teach them. He writes it down for them, using pictograms where appropriate. They be purple, and get through the door. They're in a room with two orange doors leading off it and a big purple wall splitting it in half. There's a bowl just by the edge of it. Grumpyhat goes into one of the orange side-rooms and finds neat piles of bones. Them bones are dry. Them bones. Poshrock

has been tidying up all the bones that he finds around this tower, and is unhappy that Grumphyat would mess them up. They wonder why no one likes them. The green girl finds a

bedroom, with impeccably made beds. Grumpyhat messes the beds up. What is

with that guy? The little green girl acts strangely. There's some attempts at puzzle solving, as it looks like there's a forcefield over all but the very top of this purple wall. The monkey one jumps over. This doesn't help anyone. Any people, anyway. Eventually, people think about doing the whole, you know, reversing gravity thing to get over the bit at the top. They do it. Blah, blah, blah. They go the fuck downstairs. TO THE SNAKE The film

awkwardly just cuts to black as someone's halfway through a sentence. After a minute of silence, you can hear distant music, as if playing from a different room. CREDITS

EPISODE 31: NOTICE ME SENPAI!!!

 Ear Diary.
Well here we are in the tower (but it's underground so i still think it's just a long cellar) of Mr Rubriks. We stood looking at a blood scrawled message on the wall. I flicked up Pilch's helmet and read "Beware, do not enter. The great devourer lies within". It didn't sound like the best thing. Jeremy threw a spear at the lovely mauve forcefield. It just rebounded but he caught it in a cool way. Riphard looked upset about the fact he didn't die. Riphard decided he wanted to kill Stanri for literally no reason.

Kolo decided to step up and take the lead by becoming red and going to the door that was not the forcefield. He walked straight back out his unhappy face on. Turns out there were snakes

behind there. Or snake men. One opened the door and peeked through. They told us to freeze. The snakey men looked shocked that we understood them and pointed out that they had not seen any soft skins for a long time. Kolo told them we just wanted to be friends. Myron was alarmed and got ready to fire at them but Kolo made him back down. Kolo told them we were inspectors and luckily they didn't ask about what. They looked at Jeremy with hungry eyes. Riphard farted and inadvertently told the snake people that he wanted to fist both their mother's snake anuses simultaneously with both arms. Kolo defused the situation. We took a moment to appreciate the forms of the snakey men. They were basically backwards-mermaid-snakes. That was the best way to describe them.

We followed them through the door and tried to do our best to look like we were inspecting things. The snakey men seemed to change colours a little bit as they walked through the doors. Kolo pointed out a nice statue to steal which I was originally excited about but then I as I got closer I realised it was big. Riphard tried to walk through a door but couldn't. Kolo asked them to open the door and wanted their names and numbers. It turns out they are "Sssidney" and "Sssssecil". WE met some other snakey people and they had a little conversation. Turns out we're going to see the Queen. They told their friends that we were inspectors. The ruse was working perfectly. I was curious if they layed eggs. Kolo asked but it turned out to be too personal. They talked about how they were slaves. It sounded like they needed emancipation is. Myron politely pointed out that perhaps now wasn't precisely the right time for emancipation.

We followed Sssidney and Sssssecil into the throne room. Stanri stayed in the doorway to keep it open and Myron looked around the room with his dark, intense eyes, surveying the room in all his wisdom. One of the snake people had a lovely long robe and it was clear she was the snake queen. She wanted to know who we were and Sssidney introduced us. She addressed us directly. Kolo admitted we were the trade and civil disputes inspectors. She wanted to know where we came from, but she didn't seem to know what Velterra was. It was a little confusing. Kolo nominated Myron as our diplomat. He complimented her house and asked if she was planning on stopping us. It seemed a little direct and she pointed out that no-one that went downstairs returned. She seemed happy that we voluntarily wanted to go downstairs and it would save them a job of making an offering to the great devourer. She seemed adamant that if we went downstairs we wouldn't have any more

work to do. Myron asked a lot about treasure but they didn't seem to have any concept of what that would be. The queen said she thought her egg producing days were soon to come to an end I KNEW THEY LAID EGGS. The queen started telling us about their old friend Sssseinfeld who was a funny snake. The funny joke was "how many snakes does it take to sate the great devourers". Probably just one as he got eaten. There are five great devourers apparently. Each takes different forms and stalks the lower levels and devours things which makes sense and also there used to be more but they got devoured. Myron asked the snakey people what they eat and they said that they farm monkeys. What do the monkeys eat is the next logical question and the answer is poop. The perfect food chain. Riphard asked the queen for extra people to help but she couldn't spare the snakeys. He was horrified that they didn't want to help and just sacrifice their unborn children. Riphard tried to kick the door open and almost succeeded but almost does not mean the same as did. A rattley snake man opened the door for him with his rattle. Kolo and Jeremy had a little rest.

Myron asked me to make him a minecart. I was a little confused but it must have been important. Kolo and Jeremy went out into a garden through a door. It was sad that they didn't know that this was here because if they did maybe they wouldn't have to eat so many poop monkeys. I managed to lay about 8 ft of rail but then there wasn't enough time and I was trying to work really fast to impress Myron but then he said that he wasn't impressed and that I should have made the cart first and of course he's right because what is even the point of a railroad without any carts and I felt horrible about myself and also fat. I followed everyone into the garden and tried not to let Myron see me crying.

Vudong jumped off the stairs monkey style. Riphard tried to slide down the bannister but there wasn't one so he didn't. The rest of us took the stairs. As we walked down we heard a large screeching sound! A creature jumped out of the treetops and it was like a bird and had tentacles coming out of its back and had a beak and more tentacles. I tried to shoot it through the trees but my eyes were still all leaky so I missed like the useless gabrin I am. The tentacle bird went for Riphard straight away and hit him with both legs and then grabbed him in its talons and then it flew him away. Kolo tried to hit it but the trees were too dense. Time seemed to stand still for too long and then Jeremy suddenly did the biggest jump I ever really saw and went up in the trees and then to the wall and then incredibly he

jumped at the tentacle bird! It was amazing. He hit it with both staffs and then they all fell to the floor! Jeremy floated to the ground but the birdy still had Riphard all grabbed up. Myron couldn't hit it and Riphard did his magic fire thing. I still couldn't hit it because it was all on the floor. It tried to hit Riphard again but it looked to stunned. Riphard tried to get out of its claws but he was too weak. Jeremy fortunately knew what was going on and he jumped over like a brave little monkey and just started beating the birdy. Myron took a shot and a chunk of blood and feathers and severed tentacles flew off it. Riphard tried to shoot it but couldn't quite hit. Kolo took aim and shot the birdy with his poisony arrow. Didn't even matter because it died just like that. As he was disembowelling we found out it was terrible. The whole digestive system was backwards so it had a botbot for a mouth. Kolo started inspecting and I asked him why because I thought it was a trick but then he reminded me that we were inspectors and I had completely forgotten. I didn't want him to think I was slacking so I started writing hard but I was really just drawing a little picture of what I thought a nice dress would like like for Jeremy. Kolo offered Riphard a KokaKola™ and he took it. Riphard got a fever. He seemed to like the KokaKola™. He started REALLY touching himself. I had to look away.

Jeremy crouched down and stealthily and headed northwards. We followed him and found a yellow doorway. Myron turned himself purple and headed through the door. Kolo followed. As they went in they saw a teleportation circle all covered in blood and then suddenly there was a bang and a big floppy meaty monster fell into the room. I quickly followed in and shot it hard in the meaty face. Kolo followed up quickly with his own shot, the old gabrin 2-2. I thought he might run out and hide back through the door but he looked at me and I knew he knew the gabrins should always be close together, fighting the good fight. Myron went up straight to it and hit it with his funny gun. Jeremy followed up with all his flailing monkey madness and he even kicked it in the naughty place. Riphard shot it. I shot it. Kolo shot it. Myron shot it (and stabbed it). Jeremy hit it (lots). Suddenly the creature started flashing all purple and everything really hurt in my brain. Riphard tried to shoot it but missed and then I did too. The brain pain was too much. It was like all the worst, most painful memories of multiple creatures all rushed through me all at once. Myron took out his glove that he got and punched the meaty monster in the face. There wasn't so much face of it left after that. Not much at all, just a frothing hole.

Kolo was impressed but I wasn't in the mood to be impressed with Myron right now. Delilah showed up and mentioned how terrible men are and I agreed then got busy doing my inspections. The place used to be a teleportation circle but it's magic programming seems to have got degraded overtime. I advised everyone to walk around the circle.

After a short little rest we decided to go on. Kolo took the lead and said he found an office full of diaries and books and things. One was from an apprentice of Rubriks and his diary said that he was not so keen on being an employee anymore because all the magic was drying up. Kolo found some shiny trinkets and handed them to me too. Kolo gave me some nice advice and I gave him a hug to say thank you. Kolo saw a statue and made a mental note to complement his imaginary notes that he was taking because he was worried he might forget the latter and did not want to forget. We found a door that had no colour and it had two odd statues next to it that had their hands all out. Kolo and Myron had a look but couldn't find any lasers so we sent the monkey in just to be safe. He tried touching it with his spears but nothing happened so he tried to throw a little monkey at the door. He threw it really hard and the little monkey was basically just flat afterwards. Myron got annoyed and tried to grab the monkey to throw him at the door but Jeremy escaped. Kolo went to take another look at the door so he made himself blue. Myron looked stupid but also very short in a confident way. Kolo remembered that the statue before had stone vials of different colours in each hand. He tried to put some of the colours on the statues that had outstretched palms. Nothing happened. He swapped them over. Again it didn't work. Jeremy suggested red and blue and the door opened. I gave him a friendly pat as if to say "well done. You got there in the end". There was another weird fused creature on the other side of the door. I imagined this one would be a breeze too. I feel a lot like the snakey people were getting a bit carried away when they described the threat level here.

We got ready to fight (except for Delilah who was in a mood with Riphard still). Kolo led the way blazing all the arrows out of his quiver and into the bow and into the tripleman. Riphard seemed to recognise the tripleman and kept shouting the "alansugar". Myron screamed "cronenborg". I missed and the Myron ran in and yelled "I'm fired" and laughed to himself and pummeled the thing. Jeremy went all out and I could not even make out what was going on all his monkey arms and legs were moving so fast indeed. Riphard filled us with a brave defensive

fire, shot it, and then ran away to hide shouting "It's up to you guys". Kolo pulled his bow extra hard and shot it in the middle head and it did not look good. I shot it again for good measure. Myron unloaded a shot into its abdomen area, as it brought its arms down Myron hoisted himself up then put his gun in its throat and shot into its horrific monstrous body. So cool. I'm so confused. Jeremy jumped up and started hitting it again. Riphard shot it. Kolo did. And then I blew it to pieces. Immiviseceration to the maximum. We all took a moment to talk about how disappointed we were in these devourers and how poorly we collectively thought about the snakey people.

We carried on into the next room, and found a stove. Kolo seemed very interested in it. I pointed out that it didn't have a safety sticker and Kolo seemed enthused. He spent some time fashioning a small condemnation sign. I've always admired my brother's dedication to health and safety protocol. When he was a very young gabrin he won the school nomination for most likely to be a health and safety inspector. Oh how he would spend those long evenings in gabrin land writing risk assessments and HAZOPs. Myron went investigating all the doors. He seemed to be on it and was doing like this crazy backwards walk where it looked like he was going forwards but he was going backwards. Inefficient but thrilling all the same. He had found some diary pages that Kolo translated: "It's been 20 years since Rubriks sealed himself away. The magic has begun to wane. My power is not once it once was. I fear that this tower may become untenable in the future. Should I keep studying and hope magic returns and leave or make my own way in the world". Kolo explained the words to Myron and also that the gabrin's are related. He accepts this and admits he didn't want to assume for fear of being racist. Jeremy kept trying to meditate. Kolo tried to kick him but he was too oily from the dangerous cooker. Stanri tried to gud Jeremy but they were both too oily. Cute and sad at the same time.

Epilogue

Alan looked over at the strange man in front of him. The impression he got was not good but dear god he needed this job. He didn't know how he was going to look Melania and the girls in the face if he failed again. The old man stared at him with his shrill eyes. "I notice here on your CV it says you are good at working closely with other people?", he said in his voice that sounded both mad and dull at the same time. The man was most likely a closet homosexual Alan thought to himself, at once chiding himself for his internal

bigotry. 'It's 6342 man for Sin's sake. Not the dark ages. Live and let live' he corrected himself. "Yes I have worked in many teams and have good ... team skills", he said earnestly. The old man nodded in approval. The nod seemed to come not only from his head but his knees as well. Alan didn't even understand how that could be. The old man looked at him intensely and said "hypothetical scenario, you are interviewed for a standard managerial job in an underground tower in which you have had to travel to by means of a magical transportation circle, and the man interviewing you is quite mad and intends to offer you a job under false pretences and once you have accepted he will magically sedate you and create a monstrous hybrid human creation by robbing you of your humanity through psychic devastation then sewing you to two other unwilling participants. You will then live for hundreds of years and fight against any intruders into the afromentioned tower and also become elevated to the status of vengeful gods that must be constantly appeased by offerings of snake eggs and monkeys reared on snake faeces". The man paused. "What do you think are your relevant skills for this position?". Alan took a deep breath. One of these 'crazy interview questions' designed to test your problem solving skills. He'd read a whole book on this and done that day course using the last of the babie's milk money. He knew that it hadn't been squandered. Alan smiled. "Well, as I say, I enjoy working closely with people. ..."

<https://youtu.be/vNuVifA7DSU?t=59>

EPISODE 32: DIFFICULTY LEVEL SPOOPY



Monkeh is trying to meditate, there are things that need to be done! He keeps talking about Ki that he needs to recharge, something about the center of the universe. I try and kick him into action. "Get to work Monkeh" Myron clearly the hero, who is

on to continue to save the world, "Exmeh seems super interested. The new strat and tat of shoot first talk about it later seems to work well. The skeletons are not attacking us this time. Looting obviously takes place. I get a cape made from bed sheets, and offer another one to Riphard. He goes one further and wears it over his head, looking like a spooooooky ghost. Spooky ghost is our new point man. Riphard gives the good old

spooky call to what is a fucking ginormous monster!! Exmeh runs off to get the lazy monkeh. Delilah seems to be back into the mix again, thank god she has sorted things out with dwarf chops. Dwarfy malorfy farts and the sheet flies off, blowing his cover entirely. Exmeh gives her

monkeh a very strong telling off. Running back in time to don a gasmask and be ready for action. The new human tower formation still needs some more work, but it is great to see us working together in new and great ways. We fight the monstrosity in the door way. We make a pile of bodies in the door to keep the monster in place, while that bloody monkeh just sleeps! Myron seems to be using his shotgun to climb and blast the beast to pieces., what a great guy. I must help Exmeh out, he would make a valuable addition to the family. Luckily we survive, and the adventure continues. As mother

said, we go south, we ransack another apprentices rooms. I pocket as much as possible, including work on the teleportation circle. Exmeh

goes back and attaches monkeh to Stanri, but the pathetic robot can't shift him. The stubborn monkey finally moves on. Myron has a good plan of removing the naughty monkehs testicles, should stop the need for us to beat the monkeh so often. We keep investigating, although I'm sure

Riphard should be in front for the scarem harem tactic to work properly. We are totally bamboozled when the massive doors ahead of us opens to reveal yet another massive monster! This place is full of at least 5 of them. Myron gets

shot and hooked by the giant beasts fishing rod cross bow thing! We get round to the killing bit a lot sooner than normal, thanks in part to the monkeh actually being there for a change. Bad

luck monkeh gets set on fire. Things look grim, as I am impaled at one end of the room by the beasts awful flesh bow. Myron slides under the beast and blows its testes off as the rest of the party come to my aid. Maybe they will come together and be a good team one day. Disgusting monkey steals the beasts flesh bow. Stanri starts

flashing in sequence, exmeh has to debug the robot. Myron goes to report to the snake people that the monsters are all dead. I write up the pile of unattended bones as a 4031, dammit people should know better than to leave the bones lying around everywhere. I run after exmeh

as she takes us to the teleport circle, this is bad, I have seen Exmehs experiments blow up before and it is definitely in violation of almost all the codes I know. I hope that Stanri doesn't takes the entire tower out. Myron makes a new friend

in the form of a snake that cuddles up to him. Its to be expected he did trade them all the monsters heads. We reboot the teleportation

circle, in what has to be one of the most painful fashions possible. It zaps me and a ginormous beast back into the circle. Sweet baby jesus she has created a monster! She transfers the brain of old stanri into new STANRI. The thing is just as idiotic as the old one, but hopefully will be a hell of a lot more useful. Myron gives us a great

inspirational talk, when we ride in on bear. He then goes off for some late night snake action, while monkeh tries to get into the good books STANRI. We take a nights rest, and descend into

the darkness. The light is much less functional down here, this is gonna make things hard. I seem to be super staticy now, along with a disturbing glow from my eyes that makes it really easy to see my nose. Myron seems

unchanged as he runs off down a corridor, sometimes he really does remind me of Gary. We

find sets of skeletons all over the shop down here. I think it is disturbing our monkeh. Which

was interesting until we see the central garden, with a cube in the middle. The gorgeous garden, that surrounds it is also hemmed in by force fields. The garden must be on the next level down, we must find a way to get to it. There is

some next level scary shit down here, the group has gone off to activate the right pressure plates. The group has split up to get all the plates but it's starting to freak with my senses somewhat. Myron gets to the second window

around the same time the rest of the group returns. Just as I'm about to tell them how they

shouldn't have left him, the dark shape forms behind him. I scream through my mind at him, but to no avail he is far away and possible an idiot. There is nothing else to do but to hurry to his aid, and hope we can arrive in time. As I get

closer I can see spectral blue shapes with skeletons inside them, the dead are risen. This is as bad as that shit Alatar was into, we need to stop whatever the fuck it is asap. The Monkeh engages with the beast, but before the rest of us can get to it, it swoops through all of us. First

things first, skeletons must fall, which is proving difficult for everyone. Shit is going on, the skeletons won't die, and we have heard a blood curdling scream from the other end of the corridor from Riphard. The STANRI machine, eats

one of the skeletons. While diagnosing Myron with ssssyphhhiliissss. The bear is truly wondrous, and scary. Riphard bounces round the corner and blasts the skeletons too pieces. Nice to see those guns seeing so much action, no wonder the church is so feared across the continent. Haven't seen the massive cloud beast for a while. . . Vu Dong whips out Pilchs sword

from STANRI's back, and I am furious! How dare he steal Fishys sword! BUT when I see him in action he is like a monkeh possessed, maybe part of Fishy does live on in him. . . we smash the final skeletons, but as we peer out across the overgrown garden, we see the smoke moonster at the forcefield window

again. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f7QzxYAjgNc>

EPISODE 33: I AINT AFRAID OF NO... SEMI-SENTIENT DISCORPOREAL ENERGY SOURCES



Host go bye bye, we're stood around like nubbins. Riphard kicks in the door to the south. There is a corridor with rooms. Rip touches a metal door. It's cold.. Door to east. Wait, no, it's west. Rip squeaks a door open. Vu decapitates some skellys in the room. Exme also wanders off to her likely doom. She finds the only toilet in all of fantasy land. It's a pit. Vu is entranced. Exme finds a study/practical space - it's a wreck. Rip is racist. There's another Lab, with undamaged bits and pieces. "Vile Vials of Bile" - Kolo tastes them. They burn him. Lab 3. There's a button.

Kolo presses it. One-way mirror. Mirror one way, window the other. Kolo and Exme can gain advantage making something new. Also, mirror shard for exme. Rip kicks the spooky room. Vu scares him with monkey skull. There is poop.

Vu screams into more rooms. Rip thinks the goblins are eating the poop. Rip finds all sorts of dust, mortar and pestles, and rocks and rock powder. And things he loves. Weird dwarf. We split the party. Goblins one way, Rip the other. Vu does not like. Gretta Basalt was an awesome rock-dust person. Like, obsessed, and exclusive to all other useful reagents. Hamppered her ability a bit. Rip is hard. More advanced chambers ahead. Ghost attacks Kolo, Vu comes to the rescue. Beats the shit out of the big stormy evil thing. It floats away. Kolo values his penis.

Vu and Exme get stuck in Quicksand, except it's not there as Kolo points out. We split up to look for clues. Exme gets attacked, Jinkies. Kolo runs to her aid. Kolo gets shot because Exme is possessed. Poor Nipple. Ghost GTFO's after we lay some smack down, but is still alive. We're trying to work out if we can actually do anything to it. It's futile, we'll just keep letting it hit and run us. Stanri is guinea pig, going through a door.

We find 3 glass tubes, one is smashed, the others are still filled with smokey ghost-type-matter. Vu suggests smashing one to fight the existing ghost for us. Exme intelligently realises they're sentient batteries, powering the tower. Vu is a monkey, so useless. We manage to build a ghost trap out of Rips shit, his found rocks, and some of the acid from earlier. Kolo is bait, but he gets fucked stupidly by dropping the stone of Un. Vu catches the ghost with the trap. Exme modulates the frequency in order to keep the ghost caught faster. Vu runs around trying to explore the floor in this half hour span. He comes across a room with two metal rods, and pokes them cautiously. Kolo touches them both and is revitalised by electric energy. Myron is convinced a ghost hole is the way forward. We run crazy-fast. Kolo jumps into a library and reads it really fast. Vu tells everyone there's only half an hour of half and hour left. We sprint through. CAAANT DAAAN

Empty rooms, guard houses, dead bodies. Water. CAAAAANT DAAAAAN. Wine. COUNTDOOOOOWN! One guy in a forcefield, super old, nothing interesting. CANT DAA... Next room. Count down? There's only about half an hour left. Everyone else finds the old near-dead-dude that Vu ran past. Special voice on the dying old git, he tells people he's not

going to do anything to hurt them. Vu continues exploring. Everyone else wakes up (dun dun dun) Rhu Brex.

He's old as fuck, and dying. Stasis field to try and live forever. Didn't work, as we woke him up. Makes the count down. . . go up to 5 years. Rhu Brex gets us the Die, and then gives us flying machine of some description, that only exme could use really. Delilah has work to do. We get teleported away. The ship falls. Delilah is awesome, saves us from crashing. We've got a ship! WE'RE ON A SHIP. Also Delilah is pregnant.

End Credits: <https://youtu.be/Fe93CLbHjxQ>

EPISODE 33.5A: QUANTUM BOOKBURNERS CREED: SPECIAL CHILD MEAT EDITION



ase File #244401: The Printing Press Incident - Section 1The new recruits

were found asleep during their final exams. This was only to be expected, as the quality of intake hit a new low during the last quarter.Due to the minimal pass

requirement brought in recently, they don't need to actually score any points, which is lucky, so Officer Sanders informs them all that, barring any catastrophes, they're all fully qualified Book Burners. The invigilator, Book Burner Tyrone, had also been unconscious, which has been noted on his file. As he is only 2 days from retirement, and a bird person, this is not anticipated to form the basis of a formal enquiry.As is tradition, the new recruits were

first given the task of physically abusing Book Burner Garmond. This report notes, with professional detachment, that they wiped that sickening smirk off the gits face, with minimal effort.With this achieved, they were sent to their

quarters, to be given their first full assignment in the morning. Prospective Book Burner "Bones" was observed creepily watching the other applicants sleep. Prospective Book Burner "Sandi" was observed staggering home with two kebabs of questionable origin.Come morning, at

regulation waking hour, the recruits were given their assignment. They were to locate a printing press, which had reportedly been used to produce illicit material, distributed widely throughout Hope's Rest.Book Burner Tyrone had

been provided with a full briefing package containing intelligence as to the likely location of the instrument in question. This report notes that the breakable seal on the briefing package was unbroken as of last inspection.The

prospective Book Burners were observed near of the entrance of the Guild Hall, discussing where to begin their search for the item. For reasons unknown, many of the recruits were under the impression that the press would be likely to be located in close proximity to the River Elden.En

route to the location they had determined was most likely to contain the press - which happened to be a public house - the group were beset by wealth engineers of the Thieves Guild.With great motivational prowess,

Prospective Book Burner Codename "Mr Motivator" encouraged the Thieves Guild

operatives to leave and join the Shmeves guild. The group also found that the printing press had a drop off point just around the corner and if they waited they would be able to follow.During

the ensuing time, Sandi hid in a barrel while Mr Motivator hid himself by starting a running club. "Bones" on the other hand hid in an alleyway, attempting to entice people to come visit him. He succeeded in attracting a little blonde girl who immediately disappeared.In a completely

unrelated sequence of events "Bones" brought the cook Martha some delicious unadulterated child meat, which Martha immediately turned into a delicious stew to sell to the hungry passers by in Motivators book club.After

continuing shennanigans the group managed to find the person making the drop and follow them into the sewers. Down in the sewers they found that people were reading newspapers which were brainwashing them and turning them into mindless zombies. Though not zombies, because zombies obviously don't exist, but metaphorical zombies.The team valiently killed and burned

the civilians who they could have helped.Back on the airship - the main party are all in some form of machine created by Mark - he explains there has been a freak magic storm which was going to destroy the ship and he has created the machine to siphon off the magical energy any protect everyone. At the same time, they are able to use the magical energy to inhabit the lives of other people in the past .

EPISODE 33.5B: HUEY SHITPIRATE AND THE NEWS



E wake up back on the starship, everyone is very confused which is pretty normal when you've just had an out of body experience. The people complained about the sound of my typing but then they realised that the 4th wall doesn't exist so we got back to looking out of the window at space. The party remembered that they went into a magical storm of hellfire and magic where Mark helped them to create a time portal which would siphon the energy off and save the ship. I watch the players talking about who I am and explain that the universe hates them. We are in virtual reality in order to then travel into the past. It's all very confusing. . . for them. The goblins are not very good at dealing with these metaphysical truths and have passed out. We go back. . . to the past! Because going back to the future would make no fucking sense. Back in the sewers we are in a pile of corpses of perfectly innocent people who we killed. We don't care. Mr

Motivator runs around in a circle through some corridors in a miracle of bad architecture. We go East because south and north are pointless circles, where we come upon a goblin carrying papers. Mr Motivator coaches him as he tries to run away but Sandi quickly tackles him. We get some info on the printing press before Bones shanks him. Its possibly a race thing because he might be Chinese or Mexican. People would comment but by this point it's pretty much expected. Sandi continually changes accent because the universe is not used to being in a body. After travelling we end up at the press. The press is definitely evil and covered in skulls. There is a shit pirate, he has no nose, so how does he smell? Terribly. There are some more newspaper zombies, we could take them out by just taking the newspapers off them. We think about doing this. Mr. Motivator ignores the zombies and goes for the shit pirate because he seems interesting. He asks him how he smells. He doesn't appreciate it. Bones immediately stabs a newspaper zombie and murders him. It was totally not needed. Sandi rips a paper in half and takes one out while disappointed with Bones. Exmeh wakes up in the not-real real world and finally decides to join in and puts the goggles on to join the others. Mr. Motivator goes to punch the shit pirate in the face but forgets that he has no nose and ends up throwing his stick off. Treyvon is no longer too old for this shit. He still has a bit of Exmeh inside him and tries to beg the goblin for help but instead he asks the goblin if his mother smelled of elderberries. The brave shit pirate attempts to dominate the cook, but is so shit that he fails and tries to run away. Motivator and Treyvon ruthlessly murder some goblins in retribution. More goblins arrive to attempt to sneak up on us, but they are terrible and just can't hit anything. Shit pirate commands Bones to stop. Bones is an idiot and actually listens to him. The shit pirate runs away again. As nobody can reach him we take our frustration out on the goblins. Somewhere deep inside Exmeh cries. Treyvon is really old and yet still has a big black wing which works just fine. He murders a goblin by slapping it with his wing. He keeps taking a pounding but they're only goblins and he's in a rage.

Sandi charges at the shit pirate, barging two goblins out of the way, but the shit pirate has long arms and just holds his hand out to stop her grappling him. Treyvon spreads his big black wings and runs up a pillar. Bones gives the shit pirate a hug and whispers sweet nothings into his ear about draining his blood. The shit pirate asks him politely to run away and he obliges because Bones is not a wise man, so he runs

away out of the room. Sandi tries to follow him windmilling her arms but it's completely ineffectual. Motivator goes on a motivational rampage and murders some people. Treyvon flies off the pole in a rage, murdering like a big murderbird does. Sandi gets asked to flee and also does because we are not very clever. Motivator chases him down and goes so fast he leaves reality momentarily. Treyvon starts eating a goblin. Somewhere in reality Exmeh feels very disgusted with herself. Bones goes anime style and dashes arms back, using the machinery to accelerate himself. He gets into combat and goes for a scalpel strike on the achilles tendon, but it misses after the replacement universe works out what is going on. Bones finally gets to his grips after taking several commands and avoids getting dominated. The party (except Trayvon who is eating a goblin) takes chase after the shit pirate down a sewer tunnel but motivator is still speedy and fresh, slickly greased with sweat. He chases him down and motivates him in the face. He's unconscious. Bones makes his day even shittier by attempting to sever his tendons but it is not very. They check the book that the shit pirate was using, it's "How to Make Fiends and Influence People". Marcy takes the book to burn or not to burn? We talk to the shit pirate, he says he had a plan and blames us but he turns to dust before we can really care.

We go back for a debriefing: there are two things – there's a bunch of stuff:

- A book on the gold list is on the black market, need to get it
- The universities have lost some tissue samples
- There's a visiting arcanist – might have some things
- Jenny's – might be going to war over the

Trayvon goes on a rant about people not insulting him. Nobody listens. He's still a crow.

EPISODE 33.5C: TWO DAYS FROM RETIREMENT

IT was a dark and stormy night, and trevor was hard at work in the kitchen. He looks across the kitchen to see the arcanist still sat in his salty brine filled barrel. Perhaps one day he too will be a book

burner like the others, and get to hunt Goliaths of ill repute, and arcanists that need to be dee-salted in brine. Why the kitchen is in the stables though, that is something that he wishes he had asked before everyone left. Martha had cooked a massive meal, but that was all ancient history now. Now he looked more closely the

arcanists was more of a bloody mess than a person now, Sandis cross examination technique had been very effective. The arcanist kept banging on about the Cult of Annihilators but the book burners were a fan of that kind of behaviour. He would have been better company if he still had his skin, or even if he was still there and hadn't disappeared entirely. His new

job is to carry out an investigation on Bernie himself! Martha let him know before "she" left that he might be a traitor to the cause, what with all the not burning that arcanist and all. Martha arrives at the Assassins guild with a

burning desire to get this Bernie issue resolved asap. The fact that one of the oldest and highest ranking members of the book burners has turned arcanist on us all, would be a betrayal of epic levels. Would the church shut us down? Or worse? Would we lose our license. The masked

speaker is thrilled to see Bones again, they must have been good friends at some point. "Hello

Stacey" Professor of Anatomy not Horatio, but

Mary has disappeared internally, along with a load of students. The tunnel is underneath the

Assassins guild, and has funny creatures eating people. As it's an occult matter then the book burners have to check it out, Sadly the price of the contract isn't high enough to cover the required solution to the Bernie problem. We will have to go outside the Assassins guild. The

tunnels are dark and spooky, so much so that Martha vomits a lot. We arrive at a large metal door, who would not mention that they had a metal door on their tunnel? This must mean it's man made rather than animal. Geeze it's hard door, even the combined efforts of Motivator and Martha can't shift it. Bones knives it good and proper, and still no result. Luckily someone

notices us and opens the door from the other side. Let the freeform conversations begin. Bodies of crab, head of person. Sandi introduces the lady crab to her boot of destiny, her destiny is unclear. Treyvon loses his shit and rushed into man-crab, luckily he isn't asking Martha where the children are because she doesn't know either. Motivator punches the crab man, losing his stick in the process. Bones stabs the shit out of lady crab, then back hand scalpels man-crab. Crab man escapes by burrowing his

way out, Treyvon makes haste in the pursuit and apologises to his spirit animal papa cub for having feathers, being a bird, and not digging very well. Next step he dodges a spinning blade, and avoids an inspectors nightmare. Martha

knocks on the door, while Motivator motivates the self confident door. It then melts much to her surprise exposing a "sphere of annihilation" she pushes Sandi out the way, taking the brunt of the sphere herself. We then get smashed by the dangerous blades trap we wanted to inspect for safety reasons. Treyvon lets us know that putting

a virgin into the sphere of annihilation would close it. Motivator runs into the sphere's room

and punches the bejebus out of the emo goth in a big dark cloak. Treyvon runs, spreads his wings, then glide shoves the guy backwards into the sphere of annihilation. The cultists come back with a vengeance and pathetic slap Treyvon and Motivator. Bones sticks a finger up one of the cultists noses, it's very confusing. Sandi gets it right and throws one down the well the other right next to it, killing most of them! Sphere of annihilation retaliates, it's bad news for Sandi, but every sweet westling move has its cost. Martha starts the greasing process for the hole. Treyvon tickles them, to humorous effect. Bones jumps into the well, and in so doing avoids the massive energy wave from the sphere of annihilation. "Well Well Well" says Sandi, which is perfect because the guy isn't in the well anymore. It terrifies the dude, and Sandi tries to push the guy in the well, but he is levitating. Treyvon loses some feather to the sphere of annihilation. Motivator sticks it to the man! Treyvon makes pulsar eyes and tries to

take control of the sphere, it's not super effective. Sandi puts on the coat of the boss, and runs over to punch the remaining cultist, it's the punch of death. With everyone dead, Bones works

out how to leave the well. The Sphere moves back to its default position, and everyone tries to take control of the sphere, while Bones wears the boss's skin as a suit. Bones makes a new friend

in the well, who then borrows him a ladder! It's crab-man, he is literally a wet dream for Bones! He was made by the mistress, crabman will now take us to her. Letter says to keep people away

from her research FF. Gary is perhaps from the thieves guild. "Gary, I don't care about your cult.

I'm just working with you because the eye demands it. That idiot Paul lost his operation earlier. Keep them away from my research. FF" Trevon offers sugar to the nice crab lady, and Martha spangs her with a frying pan. Sandi pulls

the door partly open, as Bones jnr slips under the door. With our powers combined we open a door. Some investigation later and a few rats by the side, Sandi lights up her zippo and gets

ready to rumble! Sandi trips and pins the Mistress (Frankenfur!!), allowing Martha to come in and grase them both up. Treyvon hocks up a lovely lovely egg. Before going to shank the mistress, Motivator then comes in with the beating stick. Bones knows the mistress, she has been reading. . . .Treyvon Jnr gets eaten by Bones Jnr. It is awful, awful, awful. Tears of pain stream down his cheeks, as he carries the carcass to bones. Bones goes super doctor, even cleaning his scalpel. Bones switches arms with a tentacle beast, it gets very japan anime style. Its not right. At all. Bones betrays us all, and decides to stay with Frankenfur. MiCrowCephaly, is a great name for Treyvorns son. Its agreed the case is now Bones' to sort out with the assassins. Pilch has been asleep down here all the time. Turns out he was captured and forced to stay in here. Turns out there is an exit to the Cathedral. Looks like another bang up job done by the book burners. We get back to the book burners HQ and it turns out the Pilch has fucked us, and been trying to sell book she was meant to burn/hand over to the church. So its a purge, everyone agrees to help, pretty much, even if some people have better things to be doing. Bones take to the roof tops, and Martha and Bernie are on distraction duty. Treyvorn re-inserts the child into himself. This is the fucking worst! What is wrong with you all! Treyvorn goes all out, and swings into action. LilltiH pops out of a barrel and shoots someone. Bones runs across a washing line., slipping and becoming a piece of washing on the line. Motivator engages the run and superman punch, killing the guy outright. So far so good, fuck the gunned mercenaries. Martha tries to get into some back door action, but its a no show so frying pan time. Sandi ducks and doesn't cover, running in for the fast pace punch time. She hits, she kills! Treyvorn gets his rage on, and gets some bad doge roll going on on him. Despite landing on some guttering he gets railed by the arbiters repeater rifle. Bones is off and about on the roof, getting ready to stabby stabby. Motivator goes all out on the arbiter. Treyvon puts his child into a basket on the roof then dives into combat - eventually he is murdered by the Arbiter and he falls, squaking with his last breath "Damn, I was only two days from retirement". Martha goes fire crazy trying to save

Burnie and burns half the bookburners before dying to the remaining mercenaries, not realising that Burnie is still outside and perfectly fine. Bones leaves with the mutant crow baby to

raise it and continue his work with Frankenfurter. Motivator and Sandi survive as

just as they are getting overwhelmed Pilch arrives, the arbiter shoots pilch but his gun explodes. Pilch flees and the mercenaries chase him, leading to the intro in the prologue where Pilch meets his maker at the hands of the cruel mistress gravity. Motivator becomes a sexy

political pawn of the assassin's guild. He makes speeches with his dick out. Sandi gives up her

prized ancestral armour because she is too noticeable in it and instead follows in the footsteps of her idol Derek Bodacious and becomes a professional wrestler. Back in "reality"

the airship has landed in the sea and needs repairs. Vu Dong suffers from the butterfly effect and stops existing in this timeline. Burnie Sanders arrives on a boat tracking Pilch and reveals he faked his own death. Kolo and Exmeh are still remembering their other lives and try to kill him but Ru'Brex is old, wise and full of terminal disease and steps in to stop them saying that he could be useful. The ship is

stranded in the ocean and requires repairs. This is going to take a while, and it begins to snow. Winter has come. The gang wonder how Derek Bodacious is holding up back in Hope's Rest...

EPISODE 33.75: BOBACIOUS TAKES ON CHRISMAS

THe session opens with a fantastic poem that I am too slow at typing. There is some confusion over Derek Bobacious' name. But it's definitely Bobacious with a B. None of that D shit. Derek is drinking brandy. G'arbigail comes in after hunting. G'abby talks about the small points of portmanteau. G'Applesauce has a stupid name he's trying to fix. He sucks by self admission. Ghenri stands for things he doesnt know what they mean and berates GappyGerald is there. Mr GBonko is also there. Derek says

there's a problem for the Gary guild. The guild of Christmas exists. This is bad. Gabby slams her hand on the table for funsies. Derek says the Gary's need a monopoly on name based guilds.

He says that today is Christmas Eve, making tomorrow Christmas. Gabby says giving gifts for free is to deny the right to earn it. Preventing them from their sense of pride and accomplishment. Derek questions whether people like heroism more than free shit. People value leadership. Knowing they're worth less than their betters. Ghenri suggests poisoning the Christmas guild. Derek counts slowly and demands an end to Christmas. Derek suggests stopping present production and crashing the Jennys ball, making sure it is a disaster as it is Christmas themed. We need to find out who the leader of Christmas guild is and take them down. GBonko is interested in the toys. His business was ruined by the devaluing of the toy market. There is more discussion over whether pure free market capitalism or free toys makes society better. Derek discusses why the most powerful Gary isn't called Gary. Geric is the lone person arguing for kindness and happiness for all. Disgusting. Derek suggests unconvincingly less murdering is better for the Garys image. GBonko asks for some secret payment from Derek who graciously obliges. Gabby wants to hand out pamphlets questioning what the purpose of the Garys is. Seriously. What is it? We want to know. GBonko spouts some anti Gary shit. GHenri questions why he's even here. Gabby says we should leave rather than listen to GBonko. GBonko blames the orcs for the downfall of his business. Cut to a warehouse. Bustling toy-making noises emanate from within. It's in a basement with 1 entrance. Fire regulations being ignored clearly. Geric knocks on the door, and a rude man answers through a shutter. Geric explains we're here from the Gary guild, but Gabby talks smack and says we're here to fuck them up. Geric says we just want to talk about Christmas. Ghenri tries the old inspector routine to no avail. Geric gets frustrated at the rude door man and gobby Gabby. GBonko still questions who Gary is. Ghenri readies a fire arrow. GBonko pours a questionable liquid onto the arrow in attempt to put it out. Geric and Gappy knock on the door again. The rude man answers again, ignoring Geric. Gappy pretends to be Crapplesauce and

gets us in the door. Geric puts the roof fire out, but still makes it through the door. With no rolling at all. Disappointing. The warehouse map uses Papyrus font. Nice. The warehouse is full of robots singing an annoying Christmas song. The rude man is revealed as Chris Tingle. GBonko inspects his face for orcish features. Crappy addresses Chris. He asks if he's the real Chris. "We're all Chrises". "But are you THE chris". "No I'm just Chris." Crappy stabslashes Chris. GBonko is incredulous at the slashing. Geric tries to disarm Crappy. A Crappy sword flies from his hands as Geric shoves Crappy away from Chris. Geric berates Crappy saying he's out of control. Chris instructs the robots to kill, who start singing a jolly murder song. The robots mostly attack GBonko. They miss Ghenri. They attempt to wrap GBonko in wrapping paper. A robot watches Gabby fire pissing. Gabby flails wildly in response, twatting the robot and running away. Ghenri stabs a bitch. Chris whips at Geric. An amazing verbal sparring occurs between Chris and Geric. GBonko reflects on his poor life choices and bitch wife. He retreats behind some nearby crates and starts continuing to drink. Ghenri continues his stabathon and grabs a chunk of robot wiring. Crappy picks up his sword and stabby stabs a robot. Geric once again turncoats and tries to sleeper hold Ghenri, but panics at the last minute and bolts from the warehouse. Ghenri gets wrapped up good. With a bow. And hammered. Gbonko and Gabby also get hammered. Apt for Gbonko. Gabby flails repeatedly. It's pretty effective. Except when it isn't. Chris whips Crappy. Gbonko drinks more and has PTSD flashbacks about why he hates orc so much. It's because of his father I think. His wife slept with a lathe? He pulls out a giant hammer. Too little too late? The robot doesn't die despite some great alcohol fuelled hits. Everyone listens to sad Carol of the Bells. Ghenri bursts out of the wrapping paper and attempts to jump onto the crates. He's struck twice in the air and goes limp, but just before he lands jolts back to life with a second wind. Geric is looking for the police but hasn't found them in the ensuing 6 seconds. He tries instead to clothesline Crapple unsuccessfully, who has also tried to run away it

seems. Probably sensible. The robots continue their murder spree. One manages to gracefully follow Ghenri onto the boxes, but drops his hammer in the process into the box gaps. Gbonko laughs at the pathetic toy robot hammers. Crapple tries to do something but the context is lost in meta discussion. It seems fine. Gabby rifles through her pockets for flammable materials finding the pamphlets. She drops some smoldering tinder into some nearby boxes as she darts away from the bots. Chris takes on Gbonko, whipping in his drunk face. Gbonko thinks Chris thinks he's better than him and finally kills one of the robots. Ghenri jumps away from the bots and looses a fire arrow at Chris, but misses, instead sending some boxes ablaze. Crapple cries out to nearby Christmas revellers for help while courageously sprinting away. They oblige in providing assistance, letting him know where a nearby sawbones lies. Geric follows the revellers to the police station. The robots huddle in the middle of the factory. Probably conspiring to form a union. Another unsuccessfully wraps Gbonko. Gabby continues her full lap around the factory, but clumsily smacks into a box, setting it aflame. Chris whips Gbonko, who feels the old familiar sting. He still hurts. Gbonko channels the rage into a reckless attack on the robot before him, smashing it to pieces. He drinks its oil, spitting it onto the fire, then vomits. Gbonko pleads with Chris to leave this damn burning factory. As he does, a flaming arrow bursts through Chris' cranium. As he crumples to the floor, Gbonko tearfully holds Chris' limp body in his arms, offering him help. Gabby tells Gbonko, and especially Ghenri, that they could one day be Garys. Geric and firefighters arrive as they are leaving. Gabby tries to blame pedophiles, and Geric in particular. The firemen tell Geric that he's in dodgy ground, but looking at the teenage Gabby, ephibophilia isn't pedophilia, and promptly leave, not wanting to get involved. Everyone is concerned by this response to serious sexual assault allegations in the current climate. Gbonko wants to get paid and get (more) drunk. Gabby reassures him that after a hard day's Garying they will get drunk. Everyone rests and heals up. They head back to Bobacious. The group explain what happened at the factory to

Derek, Gabby explaining that Geric was exposed as a pedophile. Derek is relieved to hear that at least the factory was burnt down as desired. The group reflects on their lost comrade and their own actions, but agree that they must press on FOR GARY. It is also pointed out that ultimately Geric tried to get the authorities involved, and snitches get stitches. Derek tell the group to crash the Jennys Ball and make sure it's terrible, but with no violence. Gbonko feels shaken and nervous about the ball, and inquiries as to if he has anything that could help with that. He is handed a bottle of "cough syrup". Derek tells the group to get dressed up. Ghenri knows a poisoner, and not the fish kind (he's French. GET IT?). The group head to the ball. Gapple

reminisces about all his favourite apple based holidays, lamenting these newfangled Chris based shenanigans. A crooner singing festive hits is on the stage. Chris Martin. It's populist, but dull. There are 3 guards around from the Jennys guild and the thieves guild, known as the three Ho's. Ghenri scopes out the kitchen and asks to compliments the chefs. The waiters lead Ghenri back to the kitchen. Gapple creepily talks to the security Jennys, asking if they're after any mercenary work. They explain that everyone here is a violent killer so they're not really needed, they're there more for diplomacy. Gabby looks around skeptically, worrying that she could easily be persuaded into being a Jenny being the young, impressionable whore she is. Derek Bobacious is there and spots Gabby.

Gabby berates Derek for being at the ball at all, warning him of the Jennys pleasure. Derek is up for seductive pleasure, being "immune" to their charm. The chef takes Ghenris compliments poorly, refusing to give up his recipe, but Ghenri just wants to talk cooking being from the famous for its cuisine city of Jecede. Gbonko asks if the most approachable person wants a drink. He talks about shitting on people. "I've heard people pay good money for that" "Yeah, fucking Orcs!". Gbonko is very cynical and angry at the fancy ball, stating that it's nothing but shit and slaves. He's trying to ruin the party by making people miserable. Unfortunately he's far too charismatic, finding his deep philosophical learnings grossly interesting, inspiring them to forget the woes of society he espouses by drinking, dancing, and revelling. He tries to vomit to make up for his excessive charm, but his iron stomach after

years of heavy regret drinking, means he is incapable. He resigns to being the life of the party. Gabby continues to look for clues and ins, but she's starting to become obsessed with the singer, Chris Martin. Gapple notices one other guard in red. Big and hench. Hunky. Big white beard. Phwoar. He introduces himself as Chris Mas. He's there to tell them all about the Chris' special bulking regimen, saying they can all learn to be swole like him, and how the Chris' are dedicated to making everyones lives better. Awful. Gapple says he's a Jennys pleasure boy, and says he's here at Chris Mas' service. Chris Mas looks him up and down. "You're not my type. Too small" Gapple is deeply offended. Ghenri has engaged the chef in conversation, and tries to poison the food, but the chef clearly sees him mid poison. Ghenri tells him he's actually a terrible chef, and that he didnt want to hurt his feelings, so was trying to secretly improve the food while also sharing his knowledge to help him improve as a chef. The chef bursts into tears and asks to try the poisoned food. Ghenri convinces him that he is not worthy of this fine cuisine, and he should go home and reconsider his career as a chef. Gabby did some stuff I didnt hear while I typed the above. GBonko gets out an acoustic guitar and tries to play badly on stage, singing off key and playing annoying scales. It's very mediocre, which of course is worse than both good and very bad music. Gabby sounds fucking wasted, trying to convince Chris Martin they have to get really wasted? She wants to sing a song. GBonko pushes Chris Martin off the stage, and tells GBonko to hit it. GBonko starts to play Classical Gassy Orcs. Gabby sings Wonderwall. GBonko starts playing guitar percussion. It's really really bad. BOOOOOO The poisoned food comes out ready. Appalled by the performance, everyone rushes to the buffet and stuffs their faces. Gapplesauce joins in the performance. Everyone starts screaming. The guests have started bleeding out of their eyes. Gapple asks Chris Mas from the stage about the "real Chris", pressing him for the HQ location. Chris is no chump, and ain't giving up shit. Especially as everyone is currently bleeding out of their eyes. He storms out, but conveniently drops a letter behind him. Derek is very happy about the terrible party. It's gone midnight and Gabby worries about her parents reaction to the late night. Derek reads the mysterious Chris letter. "Tomorrow Chris Mas day will happen.

Make sure everyone has a good time so the plan will happen. A. B." Derek turns Scottish with anger. It's a phrase. He tells everyone to return to the Gary guild tomorrow to finish this. The group arrive at the Gary guild. Gabby feels rough. GBonko hasn't shown up. "Today we ruin Chris Mas once and for all!" says Derek. Derek leads the group to an unassuming house. Gabby flails at the door. Gapple snaps his lock pick in the lock. Gabby continues slapping at the door, smashing it open. GBonko stumbles upon the house. "Hey! Itsh, shyou guysh. I think?" The group blindly enter the house and begin rooting through the drawers. Gabby happens to move the drawers in the drawers finding a secret switch, opening a secret passageway. Gabby hears some clucking from the passage and heads down. The group are attacked by 2 rafters (swarms) of gobbling turkeys. The group fight back obviously, and probably win easily. It's not a classic fight or anything. The details don't matter much, but GBonko drinks cough syrup, Gabby runs away a bit, the turkeys have chicken rabies, which Gapple contracts and will probably die in 6-8 weeks, Gabby also gets chicken aids. Ghenri garlic arrows the turkeys, making them tastier. Gapple stabs em up as usual, dicing up the garlicy turkeys. Gabby flails at the rabid pecking turkeys remaining while running further away and holding a door shut to keep the turkeys out, but the turkeys burst the door down against her measly strength. GBonko drinks. Gabby finally murders the last of the turkeys. Gabby coughs up turkey aids blood and feathers. GBonko pisses on Bobacious unimpressively. Derek mocks GBonko's pathetic penis. GBonko passes out, but conveniently wakes back up with a promise of an ending very soon for this ridiculous one shot adventure. Bobacious enters the final room. "Goddamit, I knew it was you". A blonde woman and older man stand before him. "Oh hello father". It's Amelia Bobacious! DUNDUNDUN. Josh is impressed with this deep deep reference. The other man says "Oh hello father." "No, you're not my son! You're my son in law!" Harsh. There's some family back and forth about guilds and stuff. Amelia explains her business to Derek. Derek questions how she's making money off giving away free toys. "Quith" explains that everyone receiving a present or gift today has actually signed an agreement stating they will owe the Chris guild lots of money, they just didn't read the small print. Dastards. "But people will never pay such a hidden agreement!"

shouts Derek incredulously. Derek demands Amelia divorce Quith and stop this nonsense. Amelia presses a button opening a secret door revealing MegaMechaSantaClaus. "I believe this Claus will be able to uphold the contract clause". Everyone groans and bays for blood and/or Santa oil. Gapple stabs Quith in the heart, who lays dying. Amelia pleads with Derek to spare Quith. Mechasanta anticlimactically explodes on his own. Ghenri stands in confusion, unsure what to do. The group stand down in deference to Derek. Amelia and Derek make up over Quith's dying body, with Amelia agreeing to give up the guild to spare Quith. At this moment, Ghenri accidentally looses an arrow, which ricochets off several walls before killing Quith instantly. He awkwardly walks backwards out of the room. "Well, I guess that's the meaning of QuithMas." Roll credits. Epilogue: Gabby and

Gapple both die of chicken aids. GBonko succumbs to his alcoholism, leaving behind a widow and some children who probably starve to death. Geric becomes a police officer, but is brutally cut down in the field of duty by a mysteriously angry group of children. The case remains unsolved. Ghenri decided to follow his first passion and opened a cookery school, but was brutally murdered by what was assumed to be a jilted former student unhappy at Ghenri's harsh teaching methods. Scribbled on the walls in Ghenri's blood at the crime scene were the words "YOU'RE ONTRAYS ARE SHIT".

EPISODE 34: TURNING MASUDESE



Time: Weeks later Place: The sky(sea)ship

Gary Destination: Masuda Well diary,

I really haven't been feeling like myself lately but hopefully that feeling has passed now. Jeremy apparently disappeared into nothing. No-one really knows what happened but equally so, no-one cares. I've spent a lot of time trying to fix the skyship after we got attacked into the sea. I did manage to get the propulsion systems working so now we can use it like a boat which is not as cool as an airship but we won't be able fly until we get parts from Masuda. Whilst we've been at sea we came across an old man who calls himself Burnie. He seemed to hate Pilch and wanted to kill him but now he knows Pilch isn't dead. He is contemplating this and reading through his notes. I have a horrible feeling Mark has penterated him. Myron seems distant. Kolo has cultivated a new plant and now sits in his room

listening to loud music and not talking to anyone. Should keep an eye on this. I've been been busy working on a little project. Tee hee hee. Secret. Riphard has been busy making some items for the expectant baby. He seems to have really mellowed being all faced with the prospect of fatherhood. I saw him sat by the fire last night knitting a little chain mail vest for a baby sized. #socute. We finally arrived into a bustling

harbour town port. We left Delilah and Rubriks-sensei to oversee the repairs. We have come to Masuda to find some of the more artefacts, specifically the HAMMER OF THE GODS which was brought to Masuda during an ill fated crusade a long time ago. Hopefully the puzzle die can lead us to it. It was incredibly bustling. The first thing we noticed was that everyone was talking a very odd language which sounded like that thing lady otona got shot at. Burnie doesn't seem to remember that we went into the past and saw everything about him. I decided that the first thing that needed doing was secure some raw materials. Bernie, Rippy and me went looking round the very odd streets. So many humans everywhere. Eventually we found a blacksmith eventually. Communication immediately seemed to be a barrier. Burnie decided that maybe the man in the shop could wear my helmet to understand us. He viciously shook it at the man's head and the man didn't look happy. He resorted to violence. It didn't work but I managed to get across what needed to be done. We managed to figure it out.

Unfortunately the greedy army was gobbling up all the resources for their big war, so it was going to take us a few weeks to get all the things we needed. I paid the man 500 GP for the materials and Riphard promised to pay it all back later on from the bank. Bernie asks about the Iron

Maiden sword - it's already a good one of its type. He asks about a translator or guide - smithy recommends (in its native tongue) - The Grasshoppers chirp merrily in grass - in Masudan (Burnie can regurgitate it). Go to tavern

- near the docks. There's an elf-man by the bar. He doesn't own an elk. Bernie gets a supply of

masudan change. We get food and booze. We ask about the warKing of Masuda - Yasuda Ingoro -

was murdered a few years ago. Ingoro was known as the "Unifier" - unifying the city states of Masuda. In the last century or so there wasn't a country - separate bickering states. Ingoro brought an end to that. Murdered in suspicious circumstances - hadn't declared which of his 4 children would succeed. As they'd never had a

royalty, there wasn't an agreed term of succession - hence the war - the 4 children fight for control of the country - splitting the country into 4 rough regions. Yasuda Montoyo - Central -

Eldest son. Holds capital and largest area. Default successor? But not a strong ruler - lacking charisma. Ruthless. Petty. Surrounded by a lot of upstart nobles (young) who are manipulative of him. Yasuda Anigaya - Southern

Masuda - Staunchly conservative, believes country was led to downfall by acceptance of robotic workers, clockwork geishas - believes Masuda needs to live by traditional values. Yasuda Imicho (female) - Mid Masuda -

Believe not fit to rule (due to brothers). Is a good tactician, but lacks support due to strange beliefs. Believes separation between nobility and peasants is wrong - not popular. Yasuda

Orochi - Northern Masuda - popular across the board. Too isolationist and needs to open up - especially with near neighbours of Nanduan - one of the more unpopular beliefs. Apparently impossible for him to produce an heir due to him favouring male lovers. I listened more than

Burnie and got the following. Central Masuda - ruled by Yasuda Montoyo - The eldest son of Ingoro, holds the capital city of Masuda and the largest area of land. Seen as the default successor but not seen as a strong ruler due to his ruthlessness and lack of charisma. He is surrounded by upstart noblemen who believe they can manipulate him to their own ends. Southern Masuda - ruled by Yasuda

Anigaya - a staunchly conservative Masudan who believes that the country was led to its downfall by the acceptance of robotic workers and the Clockwerk Geishas. Believes that Masuda needs to live by its traditional code. Mid

Masuda - ruled by Yasuda Imicho - Imicho is only daughter of the king. Some believe she is not fit to rule when she has brothers, however she has shown herself to be strong on the battlefield and good at both diplomacy and tactics. She lacks support from other areas though due to her strange beliefs - that the nobility and the peasant classes should not be separated. She has a member of the peasant class as her lover which many believe would defile the ruling lineage. Northern Masuda - ruled

by Yasuda Orochi - A calm and collected ruler, good with people and popular with nobles and the common classes. Believes that Masuda has been too isolationist and needs to open up to relations with their long-time rivals in Nanduan.

Orochi is also very unlikely to produce an heir due to his relationships with other men, which many worry will lead to another war for succession should he pass. Myron managed to

catch up with us and walked into the bar. He was quiet. He set his drink on fire and then he made a funny joke. Sigh. He taught us about how to speak to local people by speaking louder and slower. It was good to see Myron up on his legs again after weeks of drinking rum and salt water. The squinty eyed bar man said that the church doesn't really have a presence here. I decided to give him his present of the new communicator beans. He looked very happy and I felt so warm and happy too. I decided to give Burnie and Riphard one too. We should be able to talk to each other now even if we're really far away. :) A man in purple robes came into the

room and told us that he had heard we needed a translator for our time in the city. Burnie seemed to be taking the lead which was quite presumptuous of him. The man wanted lots of gold so Burnie tried to barter him down a bit citing "diplomatic business". The man seemed honoured and agreed to only need 1000 GP for the two weeks. Burnie apparently speaks Gabrinish, and is asking us for money which seems a bit familiar. Myron made a joke I think about maybe killing the man after we pay him. Kolo would not have laughed. I suggested we ask if he could just translate every other word to half the price. Burnie wasn't clever enough to understand this. He paid the man like a chump and then asked him about squatting bathrooms. The man asked Burnie about me and called me a Gabrin slave. The cheek of it. Burnie even said that I was his slave and did not even have a name. I swear to the chosen one, I very nearly pressed the self-destruct button for his ear bean right there and then. The man is called Daisuke. Daisuke offered to take us around the town to see all the sites and Myron asked about the local sports like bridge jumping and cows. Daisuke said that they enjoyed playing ping pong, which appears to be a game where you try to keep things on a table. Myron said he was a very good pingponger and Burnie wanted to see if people could play for money. Daisuke started telling us about the robots and the robot geishas and the robot workers. Myron was very keen for the ping pong and Daisuke led us to a back alley ping pong tournament. On the way Myron told us all about the "good old days" when he was paying his way through arbiter school by playing this game and how it all went to pot when he had to grow up and get a real job saving people. He still even had his bats after 50 years of not playing. The ping pong room was very dark and

there were lots of Masuda business men playing serious ping pong. The fat man at the door had a manduan conversation with Daisuke and agreed to let us in. He greeted the man with the old ping pong phrase of good fortune "may the spin forever be in your favour". I was very excited to see him play. Him and Burnie went to a free table and Myron looked handsomely across the table which was easy because it was at his eye level. He took out a little ball and hit it across the table with a little paddle. Burnie hit it back and Myron nodded his approval. The ball went back and forth, back and forth. It was so exciting I forgot all about the fact that we were in the middle of an active war zone on a downed airship with a heavily pregnant woman, and in need of finding magical artefacts of immense power in order to save the world from the tyranny of a terrible oppressive force. For now, watching people hitting a little ball back and forth was all that we needed. Riphard and I drank the warm sacky drink and clapped when appropriate (when Myron won!). Myron was keen for new challengers and a long haired greasy man seemed to be ready to be beaten by the gnome. Burnie leant close to Myrons ear and seemed to whisper him some advice. Myron seemed not to notice. Myron seemed to be playing the long game rather than the short long game, masterfully deceiving his component into a false sense of security by losing the first games. But then he became slightly ahead. The crowd didn't look so happy at Myron's lead. Finally Myron hit the ball so hard that the ball exploded onto the edge of the table and span away, the defeated opponent collapsing to his knees and weeping like a little human. Daisuke suggested we better leave because the people were too happy about Myron's winning. Myron wanted more victory. Daisuke found him a new opponent, a young lean man with a red bandage around his head. Clearly he was wounded recently so it did not seem fair to put him against Myron. It was not even a challenge for Myron. Everyone got excited so we had to leave. We went back to the ship and I asked

Rubrik's Sensei to aid me in unlocking the secrets of the cube. He told me to believe in myself. I believed in myself so hard that I learned how to summon goats. The cube lifted into the air and started rotating all its sides around and I understood inside my head that the hammer was in Masuda. Myron let Daisuke know that we needed to head to Masuda and asked for advice. Daisuke said we would not even be allowed into Masuda because we were commons. Not even being diplohmat or lady harxmbes would not even be good enough.

Burnie tried to make a plan about farms. Then there was a plan involving bribes that Daisuke daisuked much more. Daisuke suggested that we join a war family and maybe we could get in that way. Myron offered his thought on regicide which made a lot of sense. Then he made the point that maybe its better to sneak into a city than to take it by force with a whole army. Daisuke tells us we need to go roamin. Then we will be unaligned warriors with valour and actions. And we will need to prove ourselves. Confusing. I went to check on Delilah while Myron went to drink some seawater. Myron found

me a little later on, and he said he wanted to tell me his idea. He was saying that he had an idea to put his thing in mine so it would make a big bang. I nearly fainted. When I started paying attention again and could feel my face I realised he was talking about putting gunpowder into my projectiles. It was a good idea indeed and I decided to try and make some over the night. I went to check on Kolo. He didn't answer the door but slid out a couple of packages of ails'ya under the door. I hope he is okay. I checked in on Delilah too. Couldn't hear the baby through her ankle. Guessing it's coming soon. We should probably make sure we get some more towels in. The next morning we remembered that we didn't really know what we were doing. More so than usual. Burnie asked Daisuke where all the headquarters were for all the people that we might decided to work for. Myron still had his doubts about attacking a city. Burnie asked how we can become roamin and we have to basically be heroic again. Myron once again voiced his concerns with the idea of insurgency. It did sound quite complicated when he laid it out in full. Burnie tried to be wise but it didn't work because speaking and talking are the same thing. We discussed the pros and cons of becoming roamins. We decided after a lot of discussion that we would become roamins. Burnie asked about cigarettes and the lady king and Daisuke said that they had a lot in common but also not much in common and there was complications. Burnie's belt is made from a monkey's tail. Bold. I think we decided to be heroes. We sent Daisuke away to find us some heroic things to do. We went to visit our blacksmith friend again. He was much more animated this time. Myron had a bit of fun playing with the accent dial on my helmet but then went back to original. The man told us his name was bokedonk and he could sell us the black powder that we needed. We stocked up and I made the Myron Rounds and we went on our merry way. By the time we got back Daisuke had returned and found two potential fun

activities for us to do. The first was a stronghold of orcs up to the east who are terrorising the locals and need clearing out. The other is just to the north over the fields and far away where a lot of farms have been impacted by a creature called Raijyuu, the lightning beast. A fast runner to by all accounts, scorching the earth in its wake. Burnie suggested he wear rubber trousers to hide the urine which seemed wise for a man of his age. Myron knows all the ins and outs of defending farms. He thought the lightning creature might make lightning out of his glans. Burnie tried to ingratiate himself in front of us but we quickly put a stop to it. Those things are better behind closed doors. He took out a small chest and opened the complicated locking mechanism with three hands somehow. He pulled out some small items and gave them to us. Rippy got a whip that looked nice. Burnie called it the 'whip of the roses' which was from the arcanist man in the past and looks pretty sick. What a cool whip. I got a nice blueprint that looks like it is for a streamlined bullet that goes fast and can go through defenses. He got a bow for Kolo and put it by his door. He then pulled out a teapot and looked confused before passing it to Myron. Myron was already full of sea water so he politely declined. Apparently it had a secret spout and it was magical so it made poison. Myron decided he would have it and politely put it in the kitchen. I suggested he put a label on it to warn people that it had poison in it. Hopefully that will ensure that there are no accidental drinkings. I was confused about the plan so Myron explained it again. Daisuke warned us to watch out for sanddaggers on the way which are very fast and you can't run away from them. Lady Otoria always used to say these were bad too. With that happy thought, we set off on our journey to become noble roamers. Epilogue: Archibald had the uncanny

feeling that he was being watched, and not for the first time that evening. The coldness of the harsh winter night was creeping in through the various cracks and broken windows that still needed to be fixed. Somewhere outside he heard the call of a bird, ringing out through the night. Long and drawn out, almost mournful. It made him shiver. He decided to finish up his evening checks a little quicker, the vault could wait until tomorrow. As he left the kitchen he noticed the back door was open, blowing in the wind and banging against its frame. He was sure it had been locked. He walked over, with trepidation, every sense heightened and every hair on the back of his neck standing on end. There it was again, that feeling of being watched. Turning around quickly he found himself alone. It was

just his nerves, his old frayed nerves and nothing more. Although he wouldn't admit it, he'd be glad when the new masters returned from their foreign travels. The roughians who had taken over the upper floors never talked to him and the building was far too big and lonely for one elderly man. He approached the door and went to grasp the handle, but as he reached for it he noticed the broken lock and the damage to the frame. The lights went out and he felt a movement behind him, fast and hard and heavy, a body leapt out at him and pushed him to the ground. He couldn't move, a mixture of the stranger's weight and his own shock forcing him into a state of panic. The mass reached out to him and turned him around. Against every instinct, Archibald opened his eyes and stared at the terror in front of him. Two impossibly large beady eyes, one black and one blood red stared at him, portraying a desperate wildness that offered a stark juxtaposition to the expressionless face that held them. A face that seemed to be half man, half bird and all torment. The creature that lay on him pressed down harder and lowered its disfigured beak to his ear. Before he passed out, Archibald heard the four cruel-sounding words that came out of it. "WheRee . . . iss. . my... . FatTherrR?!?"....

EPISODE 35: LORD OF LIGHTNING SHIFTS HIS GAZE

The gang wake up in Laz's waiting room, and are called in to see the boss man. He takes Mark into another room and does weird shit to him to teach him not to do so much time travel. Kolo and Myron go ferreting through Laz's shit. Myron finds that it's spooky and he doesn't like it. Kolo definitely doesn't find and steal a book. Laz comes out with Mark, who looks sad now. He gets sucked back into Bernie and accused of touching a cassock and kicking a dog, but does not get sent to hell for his actions. Dawn rises over Port Akiano. The Good Ship Gary is in the dry dock, with repairs starting slowly, but in earnest. Daisuke (the interpreter) comes back, with quotes for passage upstream. He is immediately sent off to get quotes to rent a boat instead. He's paid lots of money, so he's okay doing this.

Kolo, having finally got over the worst of his illness, goes on a holiday spending spree, buying an incredible amount of sake, a large amount of ballbearings and a bowl of fruit. Exme converts Stanri into water mode, which uses up all the

group's supply of arm bands and swimming caps. Myron sneaks off to try and do a nice thing and buy everyone cool robes, seemingly forgetting that they already did this yesterday. These ones are loads cooler, though and everyone has personalised ones. Riphard immediately storms off to get an even nicer one. It's crazy nice. It's a solid gold shiny mess. So nice that he needs to show it off to whoever's in charge. The rest of the gang crack open the sake, sensing that this might take a while. He's definitely not going to burn anything down.

Riphard meets the lord. He's awesome and cool and everything goes fine. He pumps him for information about the rules regarding the collection of loot, his opinions on the other lords and then starts drinking a awful lot of sake. Myron has purchased a travel ping pong table. Kolo and Bernie have a little moment. The little boat sets sail, and the gang have a lovely time bobbing along. Exme practices a little ping pong and Myron proclaims her to be a natural. It's the happiest moment of her life.

After a couple of days, they arrive at a little fishing village. The Golden Man disembarks, and the village rejoices. Everyone drinks sake and it's the happiest moment of their lives. The gang head out into the wilds, looking for the Lord of Lightning. Myron does what he is trained for and looks for monsters harassing villages. They find the popped, wrinkled corpses of balloon cows, all killed by something nasty. The corpses get fresher as they walk, Myron thinks they must be getting close. They make Bernie climb a tree, in the hope that he gets eaten by the thing. Disappointingly, he doesn't, but Myron thinks he's worked out where it is, and they all leave. Bernie tries to catch them up. Myron reckons that this thing just does lightning all the time rather than as an attack, and Exme says she reckons that means they should be able to find it using a compass. They track it down pretty quick after that.

They come over a small rise and see the awesome lightning beast which looks great and is awesomely running right at them in a really cool way. The Lord of Lightning shifts its gaze, and directs its attention their way. Electricity escapes as it leaves destruction in its wake. Bernie throws Kolo a cool new bow, and everyone gets ready for battle, with a variety of levels of effectiveness, coolness and cowardice. Kolo uses extensive magic to make his catch of the bow look super cool. Riphard sings a cool song and Myron prepares to slice a bitch. Guns are cracking, bombs are smacking, cat o' tails whips her lashings. Howling like a horde of

demons greatest battle cry, the violent lightning lord points its arms into the sky. Lightning arcs off the beast and zaps the Gabrins and Bern. It runs up to Myron, who slides underneath it, slashing and blasting its soft underbelly. It spins around and tries to slash him, but Myron's way to cool.

Rip runs up and shoots, but does not hit his mark. The Lord of Lightning's closer now, the gang world is only rain and cloud. They're not sure they have the power needed to smite this evil down. Myron continues to be awesome. Kolo realises he's not getting any attention any more, and so finally catches the bow. He uses it, and it's pretty rad. Lightning happens again, and Exme gets pretty fucked up. The beast (who may or may not be altered) smells blood and runs over to her, with Myron stuck into it with his bayonet. Riphard shouts "MOVE!" but no one does. Myron just can't stop kicking arse. Kolo lines up his target like the huntsman points his rifle. Waves of flaxen flames as he mutters his magic title. He dismembers the beast with a fire arrow and the foul thing is felled. The luckless hostage has been thoroughly fried.

Kolo and Exme set about the thing taking it to pieces. They find it has special electricy skin and an electricy heart bit. They have a nice sit down meal and eat some of it. Myron takes the head as proof of carnage. They head off to the local lord to show off what cool heros they are, before they go killing some orcs. When they get to that guy's house he has gravel in special patterns and all sorts of shit. It's boring and rubbish. And his house is made of paper. Myron tries to knock on the door, but accidentally punches a hole in it. They get led into the house by a robot geisha lady. The Gabrins have lots of questions. They ask if she knows Otoria. She replies that she definitely does not, oh no, not at all, definitely not. They are taken into the lord guy, and the Geisha robot says that they're awesome and killed the Lord of Lightning and are going to kill the orcs. Everyone then immediately leaves, all the important stuff being done. According to Daisuke, the lord's a dick. The gang head out south and go to kill them some orcs.



EPISODE 36: MEMORIES OF OTARIO

Exmerah is hiding stuff in the belly of the beast again. She is always up to things and looking funny at us these days. Myron is surprised as we cross the

border in Kurato, but really wants to get all this orc killing done with. Bernie starts making a good point, about orcs being reasonable fellas and that perhaps diplomacy may be the better way forward. For a short period of time Myron seems to be on board, until he mentions baking, how would he know about that young orc lass who was great at baking? Myron just wants to go home, Bernie takes the hint and pretends to gallop off. Everyone else is having a nice time

fishing by the river, it's fishing time. Time to get a fishing rod, Bernie helps with the language, as I really don't know much beyond hallo! Myron

does not seem interested in the fishing at all, his loss. I get a lovely fishing rod, Bernie has a great hat, and looks super handsome with his duck robe and hat. Myron goes searching for intel with

DaiSuke, turns out this village hasn't been hit that badly, but the others in the area have been wiped out/slaughtered/slash ongoing badness. Been going on for a while, makes one wonder why no one has done anything in the last few years about this orcs. They seem like a real menace. Myron promises to be the hero and go and sort out these orcs! Let's hope we don't all die, perhaps Bernie is right and the orcs are totally rational and normal like Martha was. We

get some one way ponies, and a day later Myron jumps off a horse "What will I see?" he sees three humps in sand. . . And then tricks the humps

into thinking he is jumping back onto his pony. Badadadadum dum dum. A wild set of sand

daggers appear. . . . It doesn't look good. These

things are massive and have a full set of awful teeth, this does not bother Myron, as he backflips off the pony, flips his shield in front of him and lets the pain rain from his gun and bayonet combo. It's a big gun sandwich from the little man. . . Stanri dumps the Gabrins, as the

gears whirr and clash he shifts gear and bull rushes the nearest sand dagger. It's not super effective, and he releases a mechanical whine. Bernie draws sword and makes off to

intercept one of the sand daggers, to look at us we could be a band of roving heroes, maybe Rubrix was onto something, probably not tho he

is super old. Also the sand dagger looks like it's going to eat Bernie so there's that. Riphard pulls

his gun, both of them, cleverly stepping behind me, next time I might help him with the shooting part tho, although tbh Exmerah was always the crack shot so perhaps she could school him some. Boooooom, a whole lot of animal gets

blown away, as does part of Myron's gun. This could be super bad news, must remember to

notch then draw, the other way around doesn't work. Luckily big Ol Stanri is smashing the sand dagger. Bernie asks for help, "why don't you do

this one in?" "I'll do you in!" I say adding in a

whisper, "your back doors that is" he does look every inch the man he used to be. Sand Daggers

are every bit as dangerous as Otario once claimed, even the crocodile suit doesn't stop the fearsome maws! Now the choice needs to be made, save myself or save Bernie. I know from experience what he would do! Exmerah makes the right choice and taps the big beast right between the mandibles! Rinse and repeat I believe! Unfortunately I drop another arrow, that's not great. Myron looks a little upset over his gun

breaking, and takes his sweet revenge by blowing the beast's head to pieces, before running off to punch another one, what a nutter! Bernie changes his tune and starts

courting Exmerah, I guess he is as fickle as he always was. Stanri bats the sand dagger as it goes to maul Riphard. Whip Crack goes its wuppy tale, and the beast was done. Bernie starts wielding Pilch's stabby sword, and pokes a lovely hole into one of the sand daggers as it lunges for him. It's like an emotional seesaw watching this guy! Myron is clearly overtaken by

grief as his gun breaks, punching the floor. Perversely this seems to be the cue for the sand dagger to start burrowing. Nature crazy like that sometimes. Riphard whips the dagger, and sets it

all aglow, in pain I hope! Exmerah blows a huge chunk off another sand dagger, luckily as I get my bow knocked out of my hand by Stanri who then paws it some. Before upper cutting the sand dagger, gutting it from tail to maw, stupid beast, now the bow is buried in fleshy bits. The

last sand dagger rears up from the ground behind us, ripping into my sister. She is blown off her feet and thrown to the floor like a rag doll, before the sand dagger pulls her under. I dive in

after Exmerah and go for my bow, at which point I realise I don't have it so rip the point off my nearest thunderstone arrow and dash it under

beast forcing it to the surface. Stanri then rips my sister from the monsters grasp. Its then I see the monster face to face, hallo my tunnel bound friend. Myron pre chews some lovely beef jerky for Exmerah, could it be love? Its certainly a lot of jerky for a wee gabrin. Its still gabrin vs sand dagger down in the tunnel, I try and burn the bitch out but misjudge how potent rubrixs new concoction is, setting both of us to the flame before being extracted by my foot by big Stan. As bernie goes sword first slicing the big bad worm in two! Myron gets even more. Words are shared, everyone did well, back slaps all around. Bernie makes some food, Myron and I go round and eat some bugs. Its strangely restorative. In the end we spend the night by the fire, Exmeh and I set to work. Fingers crossed I can remember rubrixs formulas, he was very exacting about measurements and how dangerous it was to get the order of them wrong. Exmeh seems well at home tinkering away, so I keep my head down too. She was always so good at this, whereas I just seem to burn myself and anything else. Bernie becomes aware of Exmehs manly explaining voice. Seems like we are all becoming friends here. . . . In the morning I show Myron my

new jumping stone, he is impressed despite how much it hurts. When we look up to start finding the way to go next, we are surrounded by cowed figures on horses that seem more machine than man. They stare with some intent, as Myron brings the boom again firing into the air, killing some poor birds that were passing overhead. It seems these people can talk common, so we try and get to see their leader. They don't have one, I put on her face, it didn't help things and they all swords. Some serious explaining goes down, and

it the new visitors drop their cloaks and it turns out they are also those automatic things that Otario was. Its time to share stories and eat jerky. Conrad made these lovely killer robot ladies. It turns out Otario founded a movement of

these sisters to emancipation, a crusade these lovely lady killer robots continue. Otario struck the first blow and so had to flee the country. Otario killed the freaking emperor, he was bad. But it started all of these current shinannigans. Lots of words are had, some good, some less bad, Myron bringing up Lindendorf didn't go down very well. Just before we leave I introduce the team, and they are the Heatthrust scoiety Lady Vashen Lady Hirota Lady Averio So

after much discussion, we agree to go and meet

Konrad the builder after we have become Ronin ourselves. We gracefully hand over Otarios face, and request another built so we can claim that we have slain her, and gain the reknown for that. We also promise to make a big deal about our doing this proclaiming how the geishas are seeking freedom and autonomy. Hopefully stirring embers for a more full blooded rebellion. No one else thinks this is a good idea though. Exmeh gives a gift of a force field, and

fetches Stanri as he tries to follow the lovely ladies away. Back to the orcs, after picking up the trail we try and approach from the rear, which as Exmeh rightly points out was always Pilchs favoured terrain. Bernie does some sniffing and suggests Exmerah and Myron have a heart to heart, its super touching, and results in Exmerah breaking down and crying whilst promising not to die. We make formation and

choose tunnel number 5, and as the light fades out we here the distant sound of drums and chanting

EPISODE 37: THE ORCWARD HUNTING PART

Exme, Kolo and Burnie move forward, stealthily. Rip comes up and completely distracts Burnie, who promptly falls into a pit. William Wallace orcs hear the trap get sprung and come running, big dicks a swinging. Kolo hides, exme gets gang-banged. Myron and Kolo are playing table tennis. Myron hears exme dying, and runs up to help. Big daddy blue-balls runs up. Rip finally comes along too, and flops his dick out too. Burnie climbs up a thing and explodes an orc through his dick, dodging attacks as quick as possible.

Kolo is all alone. But he's getting safer, casting spells and cracking viles on people. We slowly murderise the people, rip shoots one with a big thunderboom at one point. Blue balls damned sticky armor keeps blocking. We finally get him (Kolo killing blow!). Kolo goes scouts, we discover there's bats and trolls up ahead, we stage a place to attack. Rip ruins the whole plan and moves forward, triggering a bunch of bats. Bats swarm, slowly die. Exme discovers Stanri can counter-attack.

Bats dead, damned trolls show up. A lady with weapons and a man without. Toll man goes down quickly, but troll-queen is crazy hard to

hurt. We finally get her through a huge-combo of everyone doing everything. We manage to have a nap, and then go for a wander.

EPISODE 38: WORG'WAN

 Eer Dairy

Keep tellin me that I shuld rite down wot I'm thinkin in a book and then I dunt haff to think it any moor. Dunt tell anyone im riting in you, tho, coz its a bit soft, innit.

Anyweigh, the others are all havin a little rest rite now, becoz they got all hert in this ork caive. We gotta do summin wiv the orks, but they keep gettin squishd.

Esme had a dreem about being a bafftub, and Kollo asx me what I fink the drum mean, and I tell him that its eever good, bad or sorta newtral. He reckons that's reel useful.

We get back goin the weigh we went befour, but not tryna be as stelfy as we where last tyme, becoz the soft ones kepped gettin squisht.

We get bak intu that big caive with all that trol shit inn, an just start pokeing around, looking for cloos. Berny cant see shit.

Kollo nedes sum help lookin at a starkase, so I walks up it, and evryone thinks Im reel kool.

Theirs just a loed of trol debbie evrywhear, lyk all bitts of flesh and cloves an stuff.

Evryones jsut lookin in piles of stuff, and I get board an wonder off, but evryone flows me aneway. Rippe seams two hav wondered off on the uver way. Bruny wonders off to. Their almost dfnitly ded by now, so thers not much point gettin to wurried.

For all i now ther off fukin sum gorss ork puss. That just seams lik what thei'd do inn that situashon.

Me and the bagrins ar havin a lovly tyme, so we swap storeys abot wot we think ther up to. They fink thir tryna emansipat the feemail orks but that dunt sahnd likly.

Then the fuks spek over the ear things nd they sey that they fund sum ork ladees and thay need emansipatin. I konseed to the bagrins and eet metaforical shit. The ear things dunt sound gret, tho, and we dunt reely here wot theyr saying after all, so I get board and wonder off agen.

Kollo cums wiv me, nd he tries too clyme on mi hed wich i thnk probly wrks betta wiv uver grabens. Just s we work away the too fukers come bak and tell us thay found a way to the

orks thro the haream. We just poak ar heds rouned the corner, nd theres bad dogs there. Brony sez there probly fukdogs, four tha orks to fuk.

Evryone starts talking abot Kollo goin an talking to the fukdogs, but then all a sudenn Kollo sez that thers orx and stuff too and maybe this is the plaice nd we shud do the thing.

Klo sits done on the groand and starts mumblin. Ezme lays on the groand and fills her mouf wiv warter. Ripp tries to convinse me to play pingpong but I dont think its the tyme or plaice fur that, becoz were tryna not bee notissed if we can help it. Brony covers himself in gren paynte. I start to queschun sum things.

Then, all of a suden, Roppard asx me agen, but diffrent, and I relise that its defnitly bof the thyme and plaice so we start palyin.

Jus den, Kollo strats torking lyke a wulf and gets in tha bear, nd gos to the next rome to fite the bad dgos. I fink es tryna pertend to be won of the bad dogs. Maybs evn the kindbaddog. Thrs lots of scramblin nd scrping and grling and I dunt reely no what heppns, but it sounds like thers insluts flyin evrywahr. Wlf muthers get up to all sorts of things, so its prbly that.

Klo borks loadly over the ear thins, which mite mean that he won. It mite men anyfing tho, reely.

Frum the next rum we here this sund like dogs tryna sing in thyme to wardrums, but agen, that mite mene anyfing.

Me an Rop ar playin sum gret pingpong. Hes reely coming on. I let him wyn, but I dunt reely need to, becoz im such a gurd teecher that hes amazin. Onestly, dairy, id never tell anywun else, but i wus reely tryin nd he beet me 2 outa thre thymes. Fuk. Maybs im getting old. I defnitly dont feel as gud as I use to, but who dus, yu now?

O, yeah, also I notised the othvers had gon, but all I reely car abot is that me an Rap ar plying some rel god ping pong. Hes so kol. I dunt remember likin him this much, but i gess thats wot yo get frum plying gud ping pong.

I here sum fightin in the over room naw, but Raps revers spin bakhand is reely coming allong.

Loko sez ovur the earthing that its "krunshtime" but its only 5-4, so I dunt no wot shes talkin abut.

Rap gos and has a luk at wots goin on in the uver rum. Yu no wot, now his not playin ping pong any mor, I sudnly relise that i shud probly

go and help evryone so i run intu the rum and i ask wots gong on and thy sey theres wrghs, but i cnt see nun.

Thn i can see won and its tryna eat Brony. Then i see Strainy nd prasumbley Klol is stil insdie him coz hes working over and then he stops lyke he just worked pasd an opun dor wiv like 50 orx be'ind it or summin.

Frum sumwere I kant see, I here an orful krunch lyk sumwon used a big ork to kill a metyl baer. I shoot a bad dog and sum mor cum up to kill Bruny.

Theirs mor krunshy metyl noises an a lytle bargin skreem frum rund the kurner. Lokko cums runnin round intu the mane bit. Ezme relises her robert is ded, but her bruver is allvie.

Ezny and Rop kil sum big dogs.

Then we here a big bad nois from a lot of big bad bois and a hole lode of basterds com arund the crner chasin Kollu. I lite sum of my beef jruky on fair and fill a big bit wiv smoak, and now we cant see if Kollo even allvie.

Klo cums screeming thro the smoak, seminly alive. He evan kills a big dog.

Im in the smok, so i cant see whats happenin, but Brunu runs out of the clud. Then Emsys gun gos off and i dunt know why, becos Briny has got that gron paint on his fase, but he definitley dusnt luk anyhting lyke an ork. Whoever just got hit it sunded lik it relly hert thogh.

Now tha smoks full of theas big orful orks wot meen me harm.

They dunt hit me, but it sarnds like they hit lil Klol prety bad.

Then theres mor orx and wirgs and its all goin tu shit.

Fings ar lukiing a bit roapey.

Esmys kills won of tha orks, but thers alot mor of them.

All the big bad orx cum outta the smok and try an hit me and Bruny. I shoat at them that im the gret ork sleyer, but i dunt fink they understond me. Thei dunt do vry god at hiting us. But then we dunt do vry go at hiting thm eever.

Vryone keeps hidng bhind eech uvver and ends up kongaing away doan the corrydoor.

The big old orks fale to hit me cos im to gud, and i shoot one, and then Klo kills the last big dog and Esmys kils won fo tha big orks that i just shot.

Roppard sets won of tha big orks on fire wiv his litle gun. I cant quite seem to get propa hits on these guise, but Klolol shots the wun thats on fyre and it dyes. Then Bronie kills it.

Ten its all quite. Klos crying on tha grund becus that baer things ded. Esny dusnt seem to cear as much as he finks.

I funk its a lil sad, to be onest.

Were all in an abslute stait. Me an Loko hav a lil. . . discushun. . .

Luk, i cair abot these people, dairy, and i dont want them to no that maybs, but. . .

They keep runnin off an gettin intu trubble and my stoopit litle legs meen i cant catch up to em to help em. I tell em that i wod prefer it if we stopt doin dum plans and went in in achual formations an shit were i can prectect them all a bit.

we're having a bit of a sit down now and eeting sum food and. . . fuckin Ropperd. The fukin. . . wait, whats that noiz?

EPISODE 39: ORCWARD

Ear Diary.

Well Kolo got Stanri killed last week but he did his job and protected Kolo so I guess alls is wells that ends wells. I was gonna rebuild him anyway with some new secret plans that I have made up in my head anyway so it is not even that much of a problem. His metal brain is still in one piece so we won't lose any data. I managed to cobble together a couple of new tricky trick things from his scraps to help us in the dungeon to make up for the lack of claws and teeth.

After the excitenment of last week we decided we were going to have a little restsies and took over the lovely camp. I stayed up to watch out wih Kolo but I was ever so tired and I could feel my gabrin eyes getting heaveer and heaveer. BUT THEN Kolo shouted out that something was coming. Kolo was straight into action and fired a bow and/or arrow at it. He was shoked by the extra surprise that his bow was able to extra surprise the creature that at that point none of us could even see. Myron tensed his muscles and got ready so I got ready too. Riphard went to take a look and was all like "bloody hell" and did a shot. I don't know what came over him but for once his shooting was top notch. It's lyke he was a new man almost. The monstaer came ito the room and me and myron did our shots and shot

it good. The perfect couple ;) It looked horrid and was like a big white thing with horns and did roors of anger and ice came out of its mouth everywhere. Kolo went down immediately. Bernee ran to help him up and told me to kill the thing. A big ask. Myron was all vcovered in snow like a snowman and triedd to kill the thing but his gun was all full of snow. I was inspired and shot the thing and i was so furious and then i threw the mideicne to bernie to give to kolo but i was also really neervous about him and then rippy was touching himself and then he was smiting the thunder everywehre. The big creature looked down at myron and then myron stopped moving, cold as ice. Bernie dragged kolo back to the fire and give him the medicine and then hes better and walkingabut again. Kolo was straightback into his bowing and he was furious of the small. Myron looked back at the monster and suddenly his coak like snapped and all the ice just like flew off him amazing. I told kolo to get back to me and I shot the thing and shot it so hard because bernie and it's head explaoded. I helped kolo with the elctircity to make him feel good. Riphard went to myron and helped him get more feeling better. Our mouths dropped. Since when could riphard even do this?? It was amazing.

Kolo and I went to work and kolo cstrated cutting it all up while i ran a little scane. It was so much quicker when i could use stanri to do the scans. I made a couple of armors for peopel and gave it to kolo and myron. Burnie asked about my shakey device. How could he know about this????????? I literally only invented it today and have neve reven used it. Kolo tried to pickpoket the files tha burniee is always hiding. He said it just had a middlee finger picture in it. Why is he studying fingers???? Trickys.

Myron did another talk to us to motivate us abotu not dygin. Burnie tooko the monster skinss. He also put his fist into the wargg and put some snow monsterer meat into its bottom. Myron took the kokokola. I hope its still goood after all theat time at th ebottom of bagsy. Kolo had one too and they gave eachtoher a shared look, a knowing look of shared experience. That look still haunts me. . . .

Senpai and kolo led the way down the corridor where the snow monsetr was. Kolo and myron were acting a bit odd. We went into a big room that was "decidedly empty". Just fire and hooks and a pen. Kolo ran into a little house screaming giddily abuot the magic house. The war drums wer still banging and they were much closer now. Much closer. Bernie otok a moment to apprecaite the arkitectuer. Myron called a

huddle. He said the ackshun was donw the slope and offeredn us too ways to go: cut off the head of the fish and see whats inside, aor not go there and go and see the others to see if anyone was going to bother us while we were bothering them. Kolo found more houses. Myorn said "look look look look look look". And then he said we were going through the little one but all sneaky. Something is not right with these two. Myron ran back to get his pack which he lefat by the fire and took a moment to appreshiate the scent of burneis meal cooking.

We passed through a narrow sseries f ocracks in the walls. Burnei was checking for traps after we had already walked through everywhere. After some crawling we could finally see fire in the disatnce. I left the boys to talk about tortoises and sneaked forwadrr to see what was going on. It lokoed liek a celebration and there wer two big orcs there and there were loads of orcs. Oh god myrona nd kolo were being so loud. I checked bagsy and found kolos clear liquid and his speed powder. I thought carefully and decided to give them to kolo. He knows best I am 110% sure. 110%.....

Kolo was the first to act. Of course he was. He sneaked off into a hut and awalked like a tortoise there, and then he was pretending to be what looked like a sausage rolling along the roof. It looked like he was trying to get the hookah pipe. I told him to put on his armor but it looked like there awas a problem. I heard the "wwhummmmp" from where I was and so did the orcs. It was on. Kolo sprang to action faster than bernie. "TORTOISE TO ME" he said huffing the white powder like a champ. A champ who knew no fear at alll. He started to swell up all over, his little gabrin face and arms swelling up. Bernie said he heard somethign about them celebreating the blessings of kalimar. Kolo came back to us. Bernie took a flask of oil and put a hole in it and then didn't. He stepped forward breavely shielding kolo and gave us a smile and raised his sword. The big boys ran at him. He headbutted them really hard. It was cool and the first one just dropped like a pigeon. Myron looked at me and he said "stay here stay safe, no matter what happens ill get your borthier out". So hot. So so hot. He just jumped and crashed down and started shooting like a boss. Rip is here too we remember. Myron put kolo on his shoulders and kolo started singing his swollen song "goblin turtle ninja power". I told rippy we needed his help and killed an orc. The biggest boy walked through the flames and shouted out "kill them for kalifar" in a very scary way and he made the orcs attack. THEY couldnt even hti them hahahaha. Rippy stepped up and hesitated

and thought and then he blessed his bullet and even killed it (he was being so good today) and then what he then did was he reloaded really fast and then he shot another orc and he killed another one. This is amazing. I was in awe. I think we all were. We never knew he was capable of this. "I hate these green slimy bastards. . . and the orcs". I was not even mad. Kolo was on it too "TURTLE POWR!!!" and just destroyed another orc. Bernie found himself feeling very alone at the front of the battle. Myron ran up to help him as he got hit lots and just went mental with his gun pacifier and the orc didn't look so smug anymore he didn't and was bleeding heavily. Bernie was all like "you ain't working for kalimor we are" which didn't make sense but then he fainted and then he sworded them more and then he dodged randomly. I loaded in a myron bullet and waited. I waited and waited, steadyyyyyy steadddyyyy and then the big guy came close enough and i shot that fire hell at him and his friends. One orc just exploded and the other orcs looked bad. The big guy just kept going!!! And he was going towards myron !!! Rippy stepped up again and was so nonchalant. He just shot an orc without killing it, regressing to the mean. KOLO DIVED IN "TURRRRTLEEE POOWEEERRRR" aiming his knives at their ballsacks. Both died, clutching their useless testicles, wondering where they had gone so wrong in their lives. Kolo wore them like puppets. Horrible testicle puppets. Bernie fainted and attacked the little orc and then it was not alive anymore. He let out a rather lame "totem power" missing the point completely once again. Myron threw his bayonet into him and i tried to shoot him but bernie's voice annoyed me and i was worried about hitting myron. Why does he think kolo would be saying "totem power"? Rippy had another go but regressed to the mean even more. Kolo kept screaming about turtles tat burnie while he rolled around on his knees trying to hit the big man but he couldn't because of the outrage. Bernie shouted "time to end this" and i laughed. Against all odds he actually killed the big man. Just like that. I could not even believe we survived that. We were so surrounded. Epic

We didn't even have any time to rest, kolo just ran off faster than we could catch him. He came into a large room and another load of orcs and a big orc and wargs and the big orc had red paint on his face and he was talking to the others. The big orc was looking at a big hole in the ground, and he pulled out the handfuls of the red stuff and put it on his face. Bernie said it looked like a blood orgy and he had been to a few. I don't know what an orgy is. Myron grabbed kolo and told hi they were turtle buddies and that they

had to maximize their turtle power by coming back and then we could make a bottle neck to attack. Kolo expressed the need for us to get a move on because his product has had effects the longer it goes on. Myron led everyone on a turtle quest. We headed in the back way and we had a bit of a debate/fight about what to do if it was being sneaky or not. Somehow the plan became to do some shoots and then just go for it. The universe was upset.

Myron led the way and bellowed "heroes in . . . heroes with the shield.. ". It was inspiring. Kolo killed a puppy word and then i managed to catch up. I didn't know what the plan was so i just euthanised one of the dogs with my gun. The big red guy started running at us, myron took a shot but it just pinged off him. The other orcs all started running too and closing in on us again. Dave jar view. Myron stood bravely while the orcs just tried to hit him but could not. Rippy turned up. We felt bad for forgetting him again but he does feel absent. Myron is left handed but he often forgets. He started wailing on the orcs and just kept going slashing and firing and slaughtering and firing. Suddenly there was a giant squawk that was so loud, and a creature started swooping down into the room. It was a griffin (don't know how to spell that) and the red man jumped onto the griffin. Kolo started killing and i lined up a myron bullet and it was a good hit on the red man and his griffin. Rippy killed an orc. But more kept coming. So many. This job started off being just about killing a few orcs. Kolo thinks we've actually what we really did is just genocided a orc village. The red man did a battle cry and threw a spear at kolo. Kolo didn't even care. So many orcs started wailing on myron and rippy. Rippy's influence was great for us and myron and kolo just kept shrugging off loads of the attacks. Bernie said he didn't know what to do, myron rolled his eyes and shouted "kill orcs" as he was still being hounded by like 5 orcs who could not even hit him ha. Bernie shouted "grabins attack pattern beta", which was confusing because we have not ever discussed our tactics with him and pattern beta refers to when you're setting the table and put the knife on the left and the fork on the right to add some fun to the meal. The griffin flew at me. ME. it attacked me with its claws but rippys influence meant it didn't hurt so bad. I backwards rolled to Bernie and shot the red man and his griffin again with explosion bullets. They exploded everywhere hahahahah. Rippy got whippy and whipped the guy so good, really satisfying crack to it. The red man jumped off his griffin at me and did three I kid you not THREE attacks at me. Luckily rippys effects helped a lot and the golden

lion armor kicked in which also helped because otherwise i would not be alive anymore. EVEN MORE ORCS CAME RUNNING IN. It was getting hard to tell what was going on because crazy amounts of blood and orc meat everywhere. Bernie came up to the red man and grabbed his throat with the electric gauntlet and shouted at him "HERES YOUR KALIMar"" which was the coolest he has been all day (and to be fair he was being cool already). The red man lit up like a winter solstice tree. He yelled at me to finish him. Myron carried on slewing through orcs shouting at us that our job is to kill the red man and his job is to hold back the orc whores. The griffin tried to grab me which it couldn't and then it tried to claw but it could not. Stupid bird. Kolo tried his daggers but he didn't look so healthy on his toes and his hands looked weird like flowers to him. I shot the red man and his chest exploded with blood splattering everywhere. As he fell the red paint formed around the hole and he just got back up on his feet and said "Kalimar" again and he looked mental angry. Probably not good. The red man walked up to Bernie and just hit him over and over and over and over, so gorey. It was getting silly how many orcs were here. Bernie missed a stab. This griffin just won't give up on me but luckily it's pretty rubbish. Kolo seemed to come to his sense and he legged it, grabbing me by the hand and we ran back and then turned round and did the all time classic GABRI in DOUBLE SHOTARU!!!!!! Straight into the red man. Rippy kept being whippy. The red man turned to a bleeding barely standing Bernie. It was an ominous moment. Bernie fell from his hit and it didn't look good. Myron was surrounded by 15 orcs I kid you not. The griffin went for Rippy It's not a very useful griffin. Kolo lined up his shot and destroyed the red man once and for all. I ran up and helped Bernie with a gun zappy. I watched the red man lie on the floor the red ooze puddling around his decimated body. I passed out briefly, Myron had 8 orcs attack him but shrugged it off. Then the unthinkable happened! The griffin got ripped and flew him away. We could not even see him. He is probably dead. Kolo and I chased the griffin down and took aim unleashing an almost deadly barrage.

Riphard knew only he could save himself, he prepared his whip and gritted his teeth, and whipped it at disadvantage and whipped it to death, 50 ft in the air. He fell along with the dead griffin and kept singing his song as he fell, landing with little more than a gentle thump. Riphard is a fucking hero.

The orcs descended on Bernie and Myron whilst Kolo and I saw to Rippy. Bernie survived

that by the skin of his teeth. They tried to hit Myron but ineffectual again. The guy is so dreamy. Kolo and I just started picking off orcs. At this point it was just mopping up the last orcs and mop up we did. Kolo did do a sweet belly slide along the ball bearings as he shot the orog. Kolo also did another roll and picked up Bernie's crossbow and kept mrundering. Bernie finally killed something and it was the last one.

Myron stood in the place he'd stood all fight, looked smug and said "strats and stats turtle brothers, strats and tats". Too right. We all layed down and enjoyed a bit of being alive. After a while we had a look around, and found a big hole full of red goo that went deep deep into the earth. Myron said he could hear deep bestial roars from afar. I took a sample of the goo for later to analyse. We searched around but couldn't find so much apart from bones and basic equipment. Little bit of money. Kolo tried to give Myron 1000gp. He is kind and good at sharing. Myron and Rippy went off to host a feast for the orc harem on his weird snow man wolf meal he made. They are emancipated now.

WE decided to throw the last bundle of the dynamite into it because why not? Then we blocked it up with rocks.

Well that was our day dear diary. To be honest i cannot really believe that we didn't all die but you know what, sometimes you shouldn't question life. We all had a really nice day and literally genocided a whole orc population and i think we have all become better friends so overall I would rate the orc cave as 110% fun. Time to go get stanri :) x x x x

Epilogue

"Love Doesn't Have a Height Limit: A Short Love Story" - by Sexmerah Haramxe

Delilah was a little goblin who was very interested in lots of things like making robots and also going on adventures with her brother and she knew lots of things about lots of things. But what she didn't know about was love because she was not yet a goblin woman yet. But then one day when she was on an adventure she met a gnome who was the most handsome gnome she had ever seen. He was called Arbiter Myron and he was an arbiter who worked at hunting monsters and Delilah could not even know that what he also hunted was her heart.

"Love doesn't have a height limit: A short love story" is a story that is about love and romance and eroticism and body changes and emancipation and and it also is a comedy a little bit. It is based on a true story.

Reviews

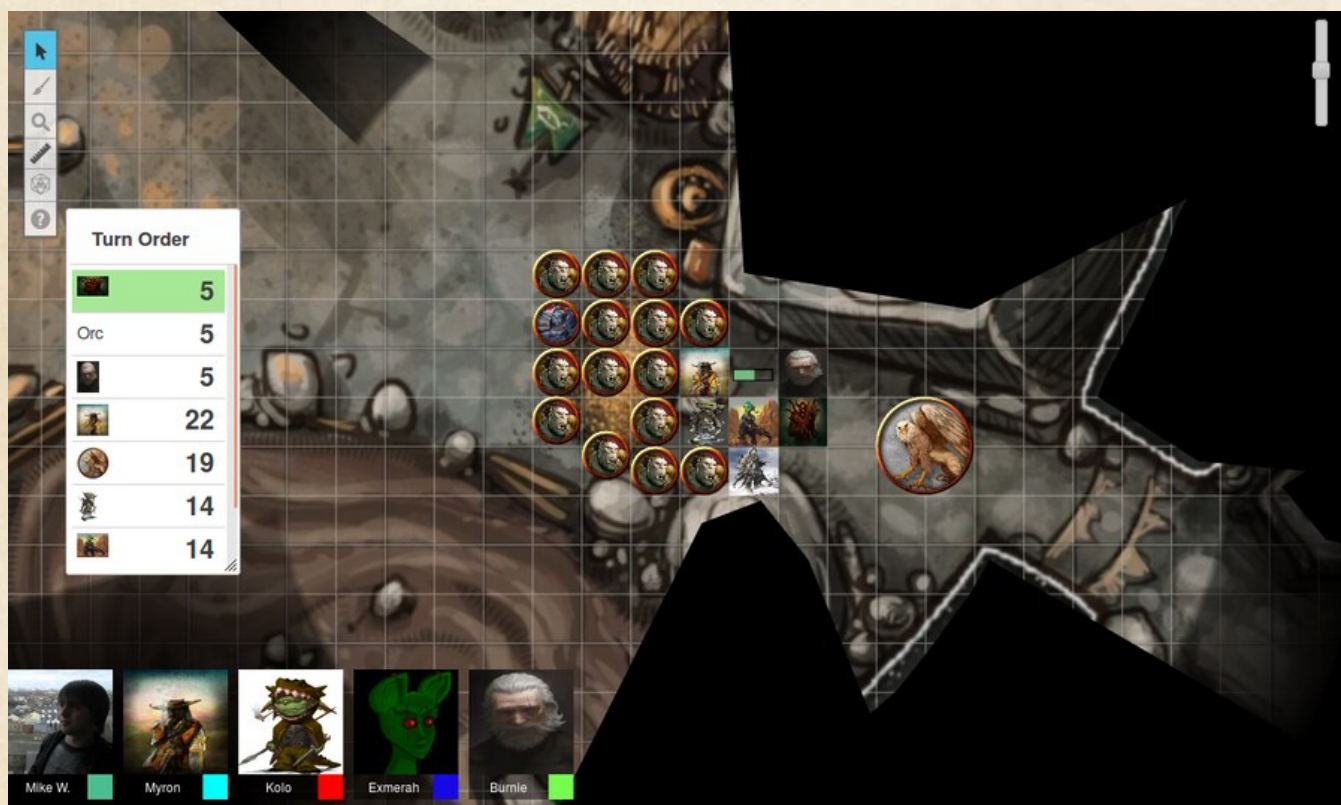
“Reads like the hormone-induced fever-dream of a semi-autistic teenager who I’m not really sure has ever really met a male let alone “received his pacifier into [her] bagsy”. A low point for both literature and race relations” - The Hope’s Rest Times

“A masterpiece of female sexuality and dating in the modern world. As erotic as it is inspiring in its openness and willingness to explore the taboo” - The Guardian

“Not sure if joke?” - Roger Ebert

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<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oCSkn2G-5GY>



EPISODE 40: GABRIN COMING OF AGE



Time cap is established to stop Burnie from taking too long with his lady half orc escapades. Burnie then pushes the pre-cooked monsters inside of the Griffin, surprisingly there is little enthusiasm to assist him. Even Myron decides he is too tired for this kind of shit. In the end its not for sex but to feed the female lady orcs, who seem grateful, in fact so grateful its like feeding time at the zoo.

At burnies request I try my best to make clothes but I am totally burnt out and end up destroying the animal fur entirely. Burnie tries harder to clothe the ladies, they seem totally unfussed. He offers them amanshipation, but all they seem to want is sex. I mean sex and emanshipation aren't mutually exclusive surely they could be free and have sex. Despite Burnies greatest efforts at setting them free, they are unconvinced and just want to stay in the cave. He does arm them though, I mean it's not like we just all almost died killing them and their off-spring in this very cave. It will a good 6 months before they give birth again, add that before they become able to fight it will be another 11 years. That gives us 11 and half years before we have to come back here and kill their children. I would tell Burnie this but he has a thing for Orcs.

Exmerah starts dancing on the ceiling, and Myron decides its resting time. I couldn't agree more. We all have a terrible nights rest, Exmerah discovering not for the first time that sleeping upside down isn't beneficial. On the way out Myron leads us through some other tunnels and we leave from what must have been the front entrance.

We head back to the posho boys house, Myron is somber, and honestly the mood isn't high despite what this rich dick would think. It is clear that we have just committed what would be described as genocide back in our home country, and we would be spat on by many in hopes rest. Yet here in Masuda that makes us heroes?

We arrive in a very snowy Kia, winter has finally arrived and its as cold as it was in the south when we first started this fool hardy adventure.

We pay 500Gp and rent a full shop for a day. In other circumstances I would have wanted to talk to him, at least know his name. But for numerous reasons I take the last refuge of the rich, and buy my way into some time alone with

my sister and our tools. I have much to make and little time to do so, Rubrix taught me many things and I will have to employ them all to replenish my stocks and help ensure our continued survival.

Myron and Riphard go boozing, to the point of annihilation. I am sure Riphard is being crude, rude and sarcastic. Myron seemed to be in a similar funk to us all, perhaps some quiet reflection will do us well.

Burnie goes on a shopping spree with his ladies, clothes, food and good times with no expense spared. He always did have a soft spot for the green skinned muscle bound ladies.

Burnie leaves the lady orcs with Riphard, who gets hands on the minute he leaves. Burnie tries to pick up Myron on the way back, but he is still super despondent.

The BlackSmiths is covered in slime, even the forge has ceased burning, everything smells of pig shit that has been left for a week and then mixed with something that smells even worse. Burnie vomits into the goop. He prepares a broom shaped pokey stick and prods the big black hard crusty festering sore of a bulge that is laying next to its twin in the middle of the room. He tries some knock knock ginger, and it wobbles a little bit.

He returns to fetch Myron, who is in a super funk and unwilling to help, he goes to find Riphard instead. Riphard is doing eye ball shots of sake, much to the amusement of the orcs.

Burnie returns to the scene, and locates the mega ball, re-awakening Stanri! Exmerahs new tongue has been installed and Burnie is thankful he is no longer getting licked by a metal spike. Burnie loads the gooey lumps into the wheelbarrow, much to the dismay of the blacksmith himself. Stanri and Burnie return with wheelbarrow to Myron. Myron still doesn't care, but comes along to wash the goblins off in the lake. Riphard briefly raises his head from the fine bosoms of Orc, Dr Riphard as he would have us believe is just some kind of sexual predator whose kink is currently orcs.

Burnie dumps the goblins into the freezing river. It creates a horrific green film across the lake, and underneath is a black rock sized about large enough to contain kolo. Has he just killed one of the Goblins? Burnie concerned that he has smited one of them pays out 10gp in bribes to keep the goblin cocoons? Next to the fire. He pours some sake on the cocoons. After some time the agreed and necessary choice of getting totally razzled takes over the remains of the group.

Some time past midnight, a cracking sound emanates from the cocoons. The goblins emerge, Exmerah looks like she has eaten several of Burnies TurDuckin monstrosities. She is greasy and spotty and horrid! She is literally nightmare fuel now.

Kolo is glistening, ripped and chisselled like some kind of beast who went to the gym and got gains!

Exmerah is super upset, and Myron passes out. All in all an eventful evening.

Burnie goes to wash off our lovely mucus casing, the timing is perfect, I plant a thunderstone right underneath his hiney and blow him right into the lake. I set up an imposter of me, pointing and laughing at Burnie so I can go back and help Exmerah.

Exmerah struggles to get out of a window, so I use some left over roasting grease to help her out. Riphard comes out talking shit about us, so I relieve him of his weapon. Myron stumbles out of the tavern through the paper walls and collapses. Exmerah tries to charm him with her new looks.

Burnie pays the bar man for all and future damages. And tries to school us on how we should behave. Myron steps in to try and get some drunken schooling done. It turns out he is pretty turned down by all the shit that this adventure has brought down on him. I turn him purple, but he is more concerned with how old he is?? How is that important unless he is... omg he is over 143 years old! That is like almost 200 times what I am now. He didn't look that young or that old. Myron is super depressed!

Burnie takes us all to a shack outside of town. Myron is in the wheel barrow, cuddled up to his shotgun, finger still on the trigger. He herds up his harem of orc ladies and like a shepherd gets us to bed down.

We awake in the morning, exmerah sleeps in, kolo goes hunting and brings back some mangled up rabbits. I re animate a rabbit for Burnie. Burnie burns it, stomps on it, and all around abuses his new friend.

I tell Myron a whole pack of lies about how I am transforming into a super Goblin, and Exmerah is transforming into Queen Slug, Myron doesn't make it any better! "Your ugliness quota has not been significantly altered"!!

Burnie teaches the orc harem how to brush their teeth. While Myron tries to console Exmerah. She wants none of it. Myron goes into teaching the ways of the adult. With 143 years of

experience this should be a pretty good talk. He does seem to be a little put off by the talk of menstrual fluid.

I return with a couple of dead badgers and a stout, with one more badger re-animated. Myron gives me a solid talking to, Burnie tries to capture me, I am literally stronger than everyone, except Myron who is so super strong I can't handle it.

Riphard is eating toast, encouraging Myron to kill me. Its some serious tough loving.

Burnie goes off to find Exmerah, who is literally 100 yards away in a snow drift playing with her device.

She pulls out the big guns, and hits him with the Trayvon back story and his son. How he has abandoned his only son, he is still referring to Trayvon as that dirty crow.

Myrons new plan is to see the boss man, until he tells us we were the best. I already know I'm the best.

After more hijinx we set off to see the lord, defo not the lord of me!

We start smoking, which displeases the lord. The lord is surprised we have returned, and he brings out a statue that looks like a pile of gold. And some platinum coins with the symbol of those that have done deeds worthy of reknown. Its very long winded but they fit the text around the coin. It legitimises us as Ronin in the lands who can be hired

Myron takes some poor lady aside, and explains about how everything is in hand, and lady otario is the key, and that she should watch for the skies, or look to the east on the thrid day or something equally heroic.

We are now Roaming Ronin, everyone is suitably pelased. DaiSuke wants rid of the orcs. He also wants paid, I pay him, he looks confused that the Gabrin.

Exmerah tries to take on the mechanical servant who has clearly been flirting with Myron. She talks some serious smack. Myron has had enough as the dead badger humps his legs, and drives us all across a the zen garden, totalling it entirely.

At the grand entrance, Exmerah starts to glow and we agree its time, myron shields himself with his mighty think eyelids.

We set fire to the wheel barrow and the great goblin ritual of ages starts. First the truths. Riphard says "Okh Nokh you have breast cancer": it is seriously some fucked up shit.

Burnie says "My name is not Burnie Sanders, but Burnie Cinders" we all already know this, so I'm not sure it counts. Myron goes with "I did a shit but it was runny", his and burnies balls for tingly. Then it turns out that Myron stole money from his father to buy prostitutes, while his mother was eaten. This is how he knew he had to defend the world from horrible creatures. The cannibal halflings. Dam those half height, half hearted. Not all halflings are cannibals. Burnies balls start glowing, "I started the first purge, it was my fault all the original book burners got killed and he ascended to the head of the book burners" Myron goes on to say that he knew about the purge, as did Riphard. As they were there on that purge. He killed a whole load of burnies friends.

Exmerahs truth is that we embezzled 9000gp from the Northern Rock, and that we blew up a barn. Myron is upset that Kyross killed a man over that, but only in a funny way.

Myron anoints Exmerah as queen Slug, Exmerah starts smoking, both the cigarettes and literally. We rise up in glowy balls and hug, as golden light sheds out from the goblins, before a black cocoon wraps around us, with a huge explosion of mucus explodes out all around us. The ritual is completed.

As the wheel barrow is destroyed, Burnie gives them to Stanri, who cradles us back to town.

Dawn rises again and we emerge from our cocoons. Riphard cast some doubt on whether the orc lady really does have cancer or not, he sounded so convincing a minute ago.

We decide to travel north and see what we can find in Fakaniro. PAssing by the shipping village.

Exmerah is fiddling with the cube, when zap the cube goes off in her hand, and Burnie turns invisible! I do hope that its not just him she can make invisible!

She keeps playing with the cube and zap we are teleported 500 ft forward, gadzooks.

Myron and Riphard have a lovely chat about the church.

After a while we notice that the snow is covering bodies from all around us. This was clearly a battlefield, or some kind of massacre. All of the bodies seem to be of commoners, they are wearing colours and a lot of long pole arms. It looks to have been Imichos victory, but the cost was very high.

EPISODE 40A: CHURCH FACTIONS OVER THE YEARS

[The following is a heavily burned excerpt from a larger academic writing. There is a visible church stamp half burned across one corner which reads [APO]CRYPTHAL, and various segments have red underlining and numerous exclamation points, written past the original publication.]

...And what of the fourth faction of the church?

We've established that book burners were once scholars and ambassadors, what I believe to be a true third faction, increasing church knowledge through outreach with different cultures and study of ancient lore - recast as the churches bloodhounds to seek out anything deemed "apocryphal" - diminished in number and standing within the church as a whole, working only in the last bastion of free Velterra - Hopes Rest.

Pastors are much the same, tending their flock, though perhaps more likely to enforce church doctrine rather than sharing teaching. And Arbiters have moved from holy warriors, stalwart protectors of the realm to a religious police force, acting as judge, jury and executioners. But this fourth faction, known only in whispers and the most apocryphal of writings, who few believe in and fewer know by name. . . Tell me dear reader, when someone says "The church will find out" or "the church won't like that" or "I don't want to cross the church" - to whom do they refer? The Book burners - rarely. Pastors? No. Arbiters? Perhaps. But there's a fourth nameless faction. I believe them to be the Inquisition - the shadowy left hand of the righteous church, who are the leaders and spymasters.

Ancient orchestrators of every major act the church has performed - whos reach is so long but hidden that few will believe this passage, and those that do will fear to speak of it.

You need not believe me, but please, keep it in mind.

~ Dunsid Cranberry - Halfling Scholar. Pub 6620

EPISODE 41: FOR FUCKS SAKÉ



He gang are travelling through a snowy field. The floor feels. . . meaty. They are

on a battlefield, and the floor is covered in a layer of bodies and a sprinkling of snow. Diasuke warns there are several weeks of travel north. The snow makes travel conditions tough, but we plod on. The first 5 days pass without incident. Myron and Rip have pointless conversation. Small talk. For 5 days. Exme gets crafty as she is wont to do. Burnie is still struggling with the language. Hes not cut out for this academia. Exme makes shooty toots for Myron. Kolo approaches Myron. He asks him about "the secrets". Not the one about having a runny poo. "Bowel function is important though!". All nod in agreement. No, he means the one where he killed Burnie's friends. Kolo wonders if Burnie could actually be dead by Myrons hand and is actually an imposter infiltrating the group. Myron says he does want to kill Burnie, and reminisces about his killing days. Myron is bored of talking to Riphard. "Which time did you go and kill all of Burnie's friends". "Uh, mid afternoon?". Kolo posits that both Burnie and Pilch were responsible for killing a bunch o' burner's, which one did he do. "The second one."

Kolo queries Myron about Riphard's involvement. He wants to know how much responsibility he takes for current Riphard, whether he was an influence that turned Riphard into the fine man he is today. Myron denies all involvement. Myron tells Kolo all about the day he purged the book Burner's 40 odd years ago. He remembers it fondly. It turns out Riphard was very young at the time, less than 10. But fully grown, as Dwarves typically are by 2 or 3. The land is mostly flat, with a sole river lazily winding across the landscape. There are scattered trees about, but it seems most of the land was farmland. Remote huts litter the few ridges, but it seems the occupants have fled the winter. . . and maybe the war. Snow gently falls consistently, quickly clearing all tracks and traces.

By the 7th day the group are halfway to Fukaniro. The group find the winding river. Chunks of ice float along. There is a bridge with a fallen tree in the middle of it. The stone bridge seems intact. The route seems generally well used. This ain't no shitty bridge. There are evidence of recent activity despite the snow covering. The tree appears to have been stripped, so unlikely a recent fall. Burnie shares his limited knowledge of trolls. Myron explains that trolls are actually attracted to shit, not the bridges. Bridges are just where shit collects. Exme says you should never feed the trolls. The gang remembers their previous interactions with trolls. Myrons happy with the tree safety, but

looks even closer. As do Burnie and Exme. Stanri sniffs around, but can only smell Riphards butt. Exme says Rip must have a troll in his butt. Myron is halfway across the bridge. The universe asks for our marching order. Riphard is having a shit under the bridge. Burnie wants to know why people are shitting on this Eddy fellow under bridges.

Burnie sees white shapes masked into the snow on the far side of the bridge start to shift. He is the only person to quickly start fending off the would be white cunts. The throw fucking metal stars at us. A bit on the nose. Burnie gets twatted twice. And poisoned! Myron, too, gets hit. And Kolo. And Exme. . . This isn't looking good. Not Rip though. Cos he's a boss. But then he gets one right in the neck while he's feeling smug. Ooft. Burnie makes the first response to these white coated ninja fuckers. He tries to run over the log asking where the toilet is and complementing their home. Burnie takes one of the men down to the ground. Myron questions the bridge's curvature and structure. The bridge is flat. Myron runs away from Burnie, and tries to skip the corner. . . successfully. He lands in a puff of snow, and with a technique he's been meaning to try for a while now, he pulled the trigger twice in rapid fire. They both hit. The man looks in some pain. Kolo casts a minor illusion of Exme "in front of them on top of Stanri, so it looks like there's 3 people on top. Riphard is just a fucking badass. Double hit with his gun, while giving everyone the spirit of fire. . . Except Burnie who has run out of range, while putting everyone else at disadvantage to attack the man he knocked down.

Exme's connection to the server has been interrupted. Exme starts shouting out random numbers, she might be having a breakdown. "NINEPLUSSEVENPLUSTWELVE". Weird stuff. She then falls suddenly silent. Burnie finds ninja's offensive. His mother was a ninja. "No wonder you never saw her!" It turns out that the ninja caught Myron's bullet out of the air, chucking it into the river. Fucking mental mate. Two ninja's doubleteam Burnie with their long hard kata's. Burnie is knocked unconscious by this ravaging. Riphard dodges a couple of throwing stars. Myron katablocks a ninja. Burnie doesn't die. Exme puts up a forcefield and shoots through it, significantly wounding one of the ninjas. Myron ponders some paperwork he forgot to fill in. "Oh yeah. . . I've gotta tick the box". He focuses on the real matter at hand and grapples the ninja twice. The ninja is a smooth fucking criminal and ninja's his way out of it. Myron sputters about communism, but it has no effect on the white power ninjas. Kolo

ignores the dying Burnie, until reminded of him by the rest of the group. He turns away in disgust at the blood. Its ruining the beautiful white floor. There are no marines around. He shoots a ninja hovering overing Burnie's dying soon to become corpse.

Riphard gives Burnie aids. Shocking him back to life. . . for now. Except he pretends to stay dead. Stanri bites the shit out of a ninja. Burnie's attempt at lying still fails. The aids was too strong and he let out a fart. The ninjas continue to stab the shit out of him. But he somehow riggles out of most of the damage, but is definitely feeling it. Rip gets a ninjastar to the face, but is feeling BADASS. He thanks himself. Santri gets stabbed to. . . death? Do mechabears truly die a death without really living? There is no time to discuss this now. Burnie is surrounded by ninjas while prone. He stands up. This officially doesn't cause an opportunity attack the universe decides. Myron is disappointed. Burnie "athletics the guy"... grabbing a ninja by the throat. He disengages one of the other ninjas and drags the ninja with him, dropping him through the hole in the bridge. "WHERE'S THE LIBRARY?!" The ninja gets dunked head first into the river, and gets a bit chilly.

Exme disengages someone and shoots someone else dead. One down. Myron stabs with gun. He remembers the time the ninja caught his bullet out of the air. That shit was cray. Myron still can't hit him. Kolo runs along the bridge, jumping onto the railing. "GET AWAY FROM MY MAAAAAN", seemingly referring to Burnie? He hits a ninja with a flaming arrow. Rip heals burnie and preps a smitin'. Stanri dies a bit. The water ninja gets colder, and swims desperately over to a rock, trying to haul himself out of the water. He jumps repeatedly between the wet slippery icy rocks. It's pretty awesome. This ninjas are great. It's a shame we have to kill them. The ninjas bumrush Rip and Burnie. The ninja tries to push Burnie through the hole. Burnie desperately clings to the edge, not plunging into the icy depths. He then tries to stab at Burnie, but he amazingly misses. This seems like a comedy sketch. The other ninja stabs Rip. Ouchie. Burnie pulls off a ninja. He then tries to hide in the log. In the middle of a battle. He does look like a dead tree. . .

Exme berates Stanri and she fixes him. She then gets on top of him. Myron sighs, bored of this epic shit ninja duel. "It's neither of our days, eh?" The ninja nods solemnly. Myron proceeds to miss with 3 attacks. The two of them shrug at each other. Kolo shoots the ninja next to Rip. He

shoots the shit out of him. "I told you to get off my man!".... Rip? Rip must whip it. But he does not whip it good. Stanri stomps across the bridge. . . in his mind! Psyche. He actually goes over to Myron and claws the fuck out of the pesky ninja. The originally chilly ninja stars Rip, but he's made of sturn stuff and appears to shrug off the poison. He does then get stabbed though. Owie. The other other ninja flips back onto the bridge. Myron gets stabbed, but it's complicated and he hurts a bit, but not too bad. Burnie jumps out of the log and punches a ninja sideways, trying to send him into the river. The ninja's are fucking ninja's though. Clue is in the name. He then disengages and re-engages the other ninja. Exme shoots at the ninja on Rip, but misses.

Myron stabshoots the ninja to death. Exme invites Myron onto Stanri. "Yeah. . . alright". Kolo shoots at the ninja next to Riphard. He shoots the fuck out of him. Riphard reflects on the irony of a mostly ranged party coming up against ninjas specifically good against ranged attacks. Riphard cool whips the ninja in the face, exploding in thunderous smite. The ninja is blow back, but not off the bridge. Stanri bounds onto the bridge. The now surrounded ninja smoke bombs. Burnie, Myron and Stanri all get shitty opportunity attacks against the smokey boi. Burnie manages to connect with a wild swipe. The ninjas miss with their katas. Burnie runs across the log. . . again, and slashes the ninja on Rip. Badly. He just rubs his sword harmlessly against him instead. But it turns out the ninja hates compassionate physical contact and dies of long repressed and untreated physical intimacy issues. Exme misses. Myron casually shoots twice at the remaining ninja. The ninja catches a bullet, just like the other one. But it did hurt a bit. He lets out one solitary tear. Kolo tries to do something complicated involving legs and rolling, ultimately throwing the ninja down the hole "Rey Mysterio style". It's pretty sick, but the ninja clings on.

Riphard debates the best shooting angles for a hanging man. He then just shoots him from above. The ninja then falls into the water. . . again. IT'S THE SAME GUY! This pleases everyone. He gets even fucking chillier. Give that ninja a jumper. But wait, there's another ninja that I forgot about. Stanri charges him uselessly. Burnie tries some ninja shit of his own, and nails it. He then tries to shocker the forgotten ninja, but only vaporizes some surrounding snow. Exme misses again. She's pretty off at the moment.

The ninjas takes down Stanri again, and he

looks pretty dead now. Or... very inactive? Needs more philosophic debate. Myron rifles through his back and throws a rope down into the water from the bridge for the ninja, asking for a little chat. Ninja fishing. But the ninja is already dead from hypothermia. He got too chilly. Myron shrugs, takes back his rope, dashes across the bridge and jumps over Stanri's dying (?) corpse, "like a 60's car bonnet". He tries to not kill the ninja, and expresses this to anyone who will listen. Kolo goes ice fishing for ninja corpse. He gets the corpse... along with a fish! Excellent. Rip runs through the smoke, but is unaware of the plan to keep the ninja alive. He shoots him pretty sweetly. But he ninja survives! Stanri doesn't die.

The ninja looks at his dire situation and honorably stabs himself in the stomach, killing himself instantly. The battle is over. Exme stabilizes Stanri. Myron inspects the dead ninja bodies. They are in identical uniforms. Myron appreciates the fine tailoring involved, and wants to hunt down the fashion designer. Myron says he shows the ninja the coin, but he didn't give a shit. He postulates about the ninja origins in relation to the head communist lady, and takes their heads which might come in useful at some point. The dead bodies on the battlefield were probably "naganatas" (racist?) or farm hands. Myron thinks this could all be important. Myron trails off looking mystified, as though he's hearing a loud annoying beeping. Stanri hauls up the frozen ninja corpse for Kolo. Kolo tries to recover the kata's maybe for their poison or something. Burnie wonders if the katas resemble Iron Maiden, his blade from the woman who killed Otoria. It does in as much as it looks like its from Masuda, but nothing more significant.

Myron spies some tracks he can't keep track off because of the snow. He questions Kolo's hatred for normal sized people, and wants him to see if he can hunt down any live ninja that might be in the area. Kolo spazzes out a bit. Kolo senses some humanoids in the region, but from their sparse formation it doesn't seem that there are any more ninja forces to worry about immediately. Myron offers Exme some jerky. This is usually the other way round. Exme's teeth fall out. She grimaces as new adult teeth suddenly sprout from her gums. Myron is horrifically aroused. The group continue on their travels north for a week. The travels are nervous but uneventful. The nearby inhabitations are... uninhabited. It seems the people migrate somewhere warmer during such harsh conditions.

Exme checks her intelligence. Everyone is confused about this. She is fine and a test goat appears. Burnie is bored of the test goats and wants new features. Typical user. No understanding of the dev work required on the cuber side. The new testgoat is Kolo's new steed. The group arrive at Fukaniro. Myron wants Daisuke to ask how to find Fukaniro. "We are in Fukaniro". Myron laughs at the pathetically small supposed "capital". The city has some sprawl. There appears to be some class mixing. Riphard is disgusted. Exme asks around for Lady Imicho, very honestly with probably too much detail. The commoner scrambles away from the horrible looking goblin in front of him. Daisuke interrupts and calmly explains what we're hear for. The guy says she doesn't just see anyone. Myron brags about his bag of heads. Daisuke bangs on about Ronin a bit. Myron brags about his foreign status and connections, basicly demanding an audience with Imicho, but it ain't happening. Riphard flashes his robe, and secures the group a meeting with a local noble that Daisuke already said we should go and see.

Exme talks about pregnancy. Everyone has forgotten who is pregnant. I don't know either. The group look around the town. There's a messenger service and Exme sends an express message back to Velterra: ""How iz the reparez and teh pregnuncy??? exme" signed with a little heart". It's still not clear who's pregnant.

Kolo hunts down a blacksmith. Not just a blacksmith, but the BEST blacksmith. Kolo visits "Calno", who makes weapons for the local warriors. It's a very organised smithy with numerous assistants of human and mechanical variety. Hmm, seems like mass produced garbage if you ask me. Kolo queries for Mr Calno himself. A fat guy waddles out, but actually he's just so ripped he looks round. He calls us strange. He talks straight to Rip, the most respectable of the bunch, querying him about the goblins and goats. Rip says we are here to set up a carnival/circus thing. "Kolo, do a flip" Kolo doesn't do a flip. Burnie persuades the guy the goblins are fine for some reason. Exme and Burnie want better armour for Stanri. Exme hands the man very specific details of material specifications. The man is suitably impressed, but suggests some tweaks of his own, musing that it won't be cheap. Exme gives the man 300gp. "This will do as a deposit". Another 300gp. "Yes... that is more like it." Stanri may be learning human words. The group aren't sure.

Burnie wants to know if Iron Maiden can be improved. The man says he's made better, but

that it is a fine blade that one should be proud of wielding. Burnie asks for at least a fancy scabbard or something. The man don't know shit about guns though. Kolo wants arrows strong enough to make a sweet batman style grappling hook. Burnie quizzes Exme about aerodynamics and how birds fly. "Because they are aerodynamic!" Burnie studies Masudan economics. It's really boring. Like all economics. The group are led to the fancy man, in a nice enough building in the centre of the city. Myron approaches a man in the middle of training outside the house. The level of the fighting is pretty impressive. Myron rambles a lot. No one understands. Daisuke does her best conveying the mad ramblings to the warrior in training. He says if we were actually all that we should see "Seniya" inside. "It's a good time for Ronin, war is on the horizon". Myron expresses that they need to know just how sick we are at being badassess and wants them all to hear about our great exploits. Daisuke resists bragging to the men, but Myron insists, giving extra coin.

Myron breaks out the ping pong table and challenges the warriors to a doubles match. Some of the men tell us to fuck off because they're busy training. But some younger warriors are intrigued. "Suniya Sunfa and Sunika Sunfa". They too express a positive attitude to our desire to become Ronin. Myron and Rip look eager to get down to 'nisness. The pressure of a first competitive game gets to Riphard and he fluffs his opening shots. Burnie analyses the warriors for their technical training from how they play ping pong. Myron's experience shines and he casually plays the warriors off the table even without Riphard's help. "The problem is...you still think ping pong's a game!" - Myron. Words to live by. Burnie deduces that the warriors are naturally dextrous and poised, and they are all good fighters. Which was already evident to everyone else in the group as stated previously.

Daisuke explains that there are rules to war in Masuda. There is honor and glory here. The common folk start the fight while the nobles and warriors watch over, and it becomes a game of chicken over who will send in their best warriors first, for they are most likely to lose. Imicho bases her warriors off talent rather than status, and this is good for some reason, to have your bestest best fighters not fighting. Ronin are below the "warriors of renown", but would be part of a second wave in a similar fashion in the event of large scale war. The group enter the house and there are well dressed men standing around a map. Daisuke whispers that "Akida Satrino" is the noble we are here to see as the

general of Imicho's armies. A black haired middle aged noblewoman turns to face us. Daisuke introduces everyone formally. "You're a strange bunch of outsiders". We get that a lot. . .

She queries us about us taking on the orcs in the mountains, and Exme talks about Rajjew. We talk about the ninjas at the bridge we ran into hanging out by the bridge. "Ninja do not just hang out, they strike who they mean to strike" It seems we were targeted by a rival regional leader. She welcomes the potential for more Ronin to join the apparently thin ranks. Exme talks about "people power". She asks Daisuke to leave. Daisuke leave. The lady speaks to us in broken, but intelligible Velterran. She says there's going to be a battle shortly. It's not on Masuda, but Anigaya has been encroaching on Fukaniro and must be dealt with. There has been a standstill in the battle as striking an enemy could fatally weaken your forces for an attack by one of the other leaders, but this intrusion is too far. There will be a battle in 1 weeks time. There is great risk involved, but there too is great need. She offers us 300gp. Riphard tries to barter for property as "a friend in need is a friend in deeds". Unfortunately this falls on deaf ears and we will have to prove ourselves further before the glory of international secure storage and investment banking business synergy.

Myron and Kolo discuss . . . I'm gonna say drugs? Kolo hands someone a thunderstone. Myron activates a portable forcefield. They're trying to sell their warfare fares to the Masudans. She sticks at 300gp each, not wanting such technology involved in her honorable fighting style. We all feel a bit offended. "It is no disrespect, it's just a culture clash". Racist? "We will win with honor or we will not win at all" But hiring foreign mercenaries is fine?! Who knows. This culture stuff is hard. The group resign to just fighting their own way and letting the common folk die. . . as is tradition. She then insults our honor further by saying our word means nothing. Riphard is insulted and tries to intimidate the lady into giving us more respect. It doesn't work. Myron consoles the pride hurt Riphard. Exme wonders about the contract stating we get 3 wives for fighting. This is a misunderstanding. Myron says a week to prepare means we've probably increased our life expectancy compared to our normal pattern of behaviour.

The group all sign their lives away for 300gp each. The lady tells us to do whatever for a week, no biggie. The lady says we should stay in a shithole dive bar as it's dishonorable like us.

These fucking people. Myron asks about local Masudan tourist attractions. But there's not much to see. She tells us to fuck off. Myron continues to question her about something vaguely personal, but we don't get much. The group settle into the dive pub mentioned. Myron gives Exme all his gold. He tells her to make a way to think of something clever so she can get her forcefield onto other soldiers without people realising. The bar is rough around the edges and serving was seems like white spirit for beverages. It's better than camping. Just about.

EPISODE 42: THE HOUSE WHERE THEY'RE RAISING HIS SON

Eer Dairy

Wheir hear in this lidl towne sumwar in Mustarda, jus wayting fur this weak untill tha tyme wen the battul wiv tha uva lord. Itz onle tha furst day and weev bin stayin in this pubb and wee wer aving sum brekftuss but Loko dunt sime to be aronde.

Esmse is just abet to ordar sum pandar eggs wen thys litle reli suspishius boi wiv a big dikhed hatt cums in. His naym is summin lyk "Iwiljoyny Onthabatulfeeld" an his cleerly bad noos of sum sorrt, so eye wyzly sudjest that we shud just kil im now befur hi as an chanse to butray uss.

Evrywun shuts at mee lyke I did summin bad or summin.

Ay dunt kil im, and Semy says sheez guna taik im to see the fitaing traning plaice. I alturnatfly sudjest that mee and im go of an taik a nyce work arund tha ceety but rely im planeng on introgting im in a alleeweigh.

Tha snykee fukah manidjis tu gylv me tha slyppe rarnd the curnar, and I dunt now were e whent.

I gu bck to tha pubb and wee spened the resst uf th dai jus jeneraly prepering fur tha badtal.

Essmy sez shi kant werk on thu foorsfeelds lyk i aksed becuz she needs a magnit to pul the sun intu the erf or sumfin. I dunt untastand butt it sunds call.

Thu nekst dey I ged a massage wyl im out gedding a messaje. Aym spost to go ant see thu laide hus in charge of al us ronnins.

Wen ay get three thu uvvers aint ther yit, su i af tu wayte arund feelin like an idyut. Wen thy finly gett thar thy wolk yn ant i sie that thurs sumwon wiv thum oos pretendin tu bee mee. I shut thim lyk i shud of shut that lil boi yesday, butt it truns out its onli bludy Klolo.

I duno ow hi did it, bud he loked jus luke mee. Inkredubal.

Sutch a gud prenk.

Thurs alot of blud cumin out of im, wich is ow yu kan tell its a gud prenk.

Wee go inta the plase were the rooning laidy wurks. Shee sez sheez gut a job fur us.

Thres this guy hooz suns bin kidnept bi the gi were trayna fite, an aprantly if wi git the sn back heel fite on tha saim syde as wre gunna in this

fite. Hes a laim limp old mann and if he dys and his sun dys then evrywuns ded an his famlees all gun.

We nead to do this nah and then bring im tu the battle, cuz uverwise thrs not enuf tyme.

Were still weighting for Strainy two git that nyoo armer we were troking abote so wi leve im wiv thees peepul ant were gunna meat him at the battul.

Wi hed of to tha cassul were tha suns supposed to bee.

One thur weigh tu th cassul wi pop buy thu badtulfeld to af a luk at it. Thers a biggold vally wiv a litld bit of trees to wun side. Thers nott much arund tht loox thet yoosfel for stret and tets butt mabs if ther wernt thet money of us we cud hide in the trees fur a byt.

Klo finks he sez sumwon wotching us out in tha snu, nd he tris tu get his gote to gu and flow them butt itz a gote and it gues the rung weigh.

Wi curry on to the cassul. We half tu work up on tha litle trax and stf now becoz weer deep in enmy lins. We dunt get no trubel befur wi git too tha cassul tho.

Its reel big.

Thers lyke, all thees diffrent bits and a bigg mote and all this stuf. Wi staret tryna fink ow we cud git inseed.

Thn we rember that thy dunt even no tht their are enmys, becose thy dunt no were allredy roonings fur sumwon ellse. So wi gu up to th frunt dore and ar al "hei gys, weer ear tu be roonogs" but thei heit it. An thn Kulo shos thm his litle Bargin bootie wich they heit evan moor.

Thei shuts an arra at the Bargin bootie, wich is an expreshun of jus ow mutch thy heit it.

Wi leev the frunt gait. Thet cudda gun alot beta.

Wee go bak ferver oughtsyd th cassul an ave a fink abut wot wi kan iven do hear. Wi dunt rely evan no were the sunn is ininside ore anifin lyk that. Wir torking aboat how it wud bi gud iff wi hat sumwon hoo woz gud at pretendin tooby sumwon els becoz then thei cud go in and nuwun wud no hoo it were. Alzo ittud bi gud if ther wus sumwom hoo cud bi invsibul orr hoo cud sudnly bee inn adifferent plays wot thy wernt befur.

Thun wee fort thut mayby wi cud hav a plann that mayby cud involf pertending that the sonn wuz ded. Wi rember that Kilo haz a speshal ryng thatt cud doo that butt it still dunt rily help uss

becoz wi dunt no were the sonn iz, or wi it wud be gud if itt luks lyk his ded.

Then we rumber thatt weave got ther puzzeldy wich can maik us invisbul and telpoured us, and wi fink wi shud do this.

Mesy goze over tu the woll wiv Look and shi fidduls wiv the puzzuldy so thut he kan bee invisbul nd clime ofer the woll and av a luk arund, and she goz fidlydidlydoo and BAP, Kooly . . . goze fline up in the ayre perfktylly vissibil.

Shi sez shit defnittly ment tu do that.

Kule floo away and wive got tu wate fur him tu get bak. Ay bet heeze gunna do grayte. He kan bee rekles sumtymes butt hes an adlut Bagirns now, su wee al shud trusst hym eye spose. Aym shore he wunt shot anywun or bin seen by anywun.

Smey sez thut shi rekins she shud be abol to tri agen in abut an our if we juss let her av a lidle rest.

Wile wier wiatin wi thort itd be best iff wi ambooshed a patrul of the peeple frum the cassul and ax um sum shitt.

I meen bascly we doo that and the akchul fiting aint that intrestin.

Wonce were dun, weeve got a gie left an we ask him wots goin on wiv the sunn. Lyk, were hiz livin and hooz lookin after hym and stff. The gie tellz us evryfin we wanna no real easy, and ey barly av to stabb hym in ther eye at all. His cryin so mutch, its grate.

I try tu get im to rely embras himselph bey tellin us is biggust secrete, butt he must by relly embrassed abute it allreddy becuz he dunt even tell us wen I yuse mi speshal voyse.

Apruntly his liven a prety gud lyf in tha mayn cassol wi thr prinss man. Tha prinss livs on the topp flur and the sun on the ferd flur. Must of the gards aunt evan in that bitt, there all in thu oughtsyd bitts. It sarnds lyk if wi kud just git tu the main kassil bitt withat gone fru the tarn, wi mit be abul to du thys reltivy klienly.

Jus thin, Kile folls out thr ski und lands neer uss. Evrywun in the kassul seemz tu bee shutting an I fink their mite bee a fyre, so I gess everyfink went fyne.

Noaw wi no wer wir spost to bi gone at leaset, nd Smy sex shis reddy to tri the pusseldy agen, so lets just si how this goze.

EPISODE 43: DEFENESTRAIT TO THE HEART

People of note: Rimjay - Dead guard, played by Myron and Exme The boy - Kolo's disguised self. Gojiro - The guard I'm mistaken as Romjiro - The prince we're rescuing Juliето - The Emperor's daughter - love interest of Romjiro. Hiroshi Akana - The Emperor Daisuke - the unconscious translator.

Recap: Last time, we'd come to the fort of a minor noble - nicknamed here the emperor - he'd kidnapped the son of another noble and was holding him randsome - if we rescued the prince (not a prince, son of the other noble) we'd get the assistance of someone in an upcoming battle - plus the opportunity to cause some havoc on the way out - gain an ally and weaken an enemy. The cube had endowed Kolo with flight and he'd reconnoitered the area, while causing some minor havoc - and subsequently we'd managed to ambush and kill some guards, and taken their disguise - with Kolo illusioning himself into a little boy. . . for some reason.

We enter the castle grounds convincingly, everyone thinks that we're the guards, and my accent is racist flawless. A big dude accosts us and accuses Rimjay of Drinking. I manage to brag it off as him "having lost his brother today" - but we're probably going to get written up for that. We make it into the castle, planning to "report our findings" - while finding stuff out. We make it up several floors, the guards are highly ineffectual. Rip takes a shit, stinking out the castle. Daisuke (yeah, he's still with us) promptly vomits and passes out, still on Rips shoulders. Me and Kolo go on a tour for the "Lieutenant's son", spotting guards. We have a chat and a natter - Romjiro (the prince) has been shagging the emperor's daughter. Gossip!

We go upstairs, the emperor shouts at us for interfering, but I manage to convince him to get to the window - the plan is to then jump on the lovebirds, and teleport out! Until Myron Shoots the emperor in the back. . . And all hell breaks loose. . . The emperor stabs the shit out of myron. Various guards attack is ineffectual and die quickly to Kolo, Exme and a combo of Riphard and me. The prince reluctantly joins the fight against us, giving me an indifferent double crit to the chest. We fight it out, I manage to convince the prince to come with us. He manages to convince the daughter to come with us, but she's conflicted. Fighting ensues,

Firebrand and mass slaughter occur, Myron drops a smoke bomb and we all collect to teleport - with the daughter conflicted, but likely to come along. I tell them that we're the good guys.

Unfortunately... the cube can only teleport 4 people... 500 feet. Me and the goblins and the prince end up outside - with the rest still fighting at the top of the tower. The goblins run back in, and I follow, deciding I'd rather die with friends. Beta team go! We run back in and I try to convince the guards that goblins have assaulted the town. The goblins promptly ignore this and we start fighting our way back up the tower. We wipe out the first wave of guards, with Romjiro deciding to join the fray.

Upstairs - Rip promptly surrenders, and then Myron tries to draw the girl into the persisting smoke cloud. He succeeds. Rip then tries to whip him from short range. Thunderous smite! Sends the dude flying... if he had hit and not missed... We run up, slaying guards on the way up... Myron throws Julieto out a window. Yep, that just happened. She splatters dead on the ground outside. Rip finally whips to the face - and promptly gets floored to death saving throws. We're still making our way up the tower.

Rip passes all his death saves. We continue up - Myron gets himself ready to suplex the lord out the window. Almost manages to - but doesn't quite - they start grappling each other Kolo shoots the last Archer - sneak attack baby! Dead. The grapple match continues - Myron is probably going out of a window - BUT THE EMPEROR NAT 1'S IT. Ah, but it's an ability check, and Myron rolls shit. He fails his dex save, and falls out the window. Splat #2. At least the princess broke the fall. The smoke cloud finally disperses, leaving me and the goblins (and an unconscious RIP) on the top floor with a very pissed off and recently bereaved Hiroshi Akana.

EPISODE 44: MULTIPLE MYRON RECOVERY PROGRAM

THe smoke clears slowly, and where there once was a gnomish warriors strong jaunty voice, there is nothing but a huge hulking warrior! Where is our comrade, that fought the orc horde to standstill?

Stoopid boy appears and asks about his girlfriend, who the fark cares about some stoopid wench! Where is MYRON! Someone has to pay, and it's going to be that ORCANO bastard! Who has so brazenly claimed to smote the mighty Myron.

Only one thing for it, a direct descent to get my sister to her true love. I shall stand with my love Burnie and together we shall perish so that my sister and her arrogant gnomy friend may live. This way I can spend eternity figuring out how to get vengeance on Lazarus. Should be long enough. . . .

Burnie shocks the jebus back in Riphard, who he promptly abandons to what will probably be another horrid experience for our golden dwarf business partner.

Orcano recognises me immediately as his biggest threat, stoopid fat hoomans may have guessed right, but I have to hold out long enough for Exmerah to get out the window and down. Only then will I stuff some of that magic rock down the big guys fat face.

Riphard refuses to get up, passes wind

Fat face charges again, but just swipes wildly above my head. As he spins on his feet I grab my sister by the straps of her armour and throw her from the window. I watch briefly as her face rushes away from me, with air swooshing through her long hair she pulls a small cord and the spiders set to work.

I turn to face my latest and possibly last nemesis, as my own Belle Burnie shoots to kill. Orcano comes in harder this time, seemingly getting to grips with my diminutive size. This is going to rough. While I am glancing at the big guy this miserable SOB comes in with a giant freaking sword that almost severs my arm. That was the arm I used to touch Burnies balls dammit!

At a word from his captor or lord who the fuck cares now, RonJiros blade lands flat on my head, the world slips from under me and fades out. I am coming for you Lazarus, this is still All Your Fault!

Burnie talking in common to try and rally RonJiro back to our cause. In reply Orcano

comes for Burnie! Burnies surge of dodging keeps him in the game for a precious few seconds. The pain starts to rain down on Burnie, as Riphard decides nap time is over and he opens fire on the lord blowing a huge chunk out of him.

Exmerah finally makes it to the bottom of the tower, and throws one of Rubrix spell scrolls over Myron. Scrawled next to him are the letters E and Z. Myron coughs up a load of blood and decides its his turn to run up the entire tower again. Exmerahs calls for kolo over the ear peices, only to be greeted with a deathly silence. . . .

Orcano keeps wailing on Burnie, but to no avail. Looking down on it all from this height, it almost looks like a game. . . .

Myron tries talking to Exmerah but just keeps vomiting the blood up, I'm sure he needs that, how inconsiderate to himself to be spewing it everywhere. Exmerah runs at the wall, and then starts straight up it.

Riphard runs over to my corpse, and touches me with some kind of holy power! Despite how bad that sounds, its feels super good! I get up and pull the first arrow from my quiver, fingers crossed! Unfortunately for Burnie its one full of grease and tinder. Burnie seems to survive despite Orcanos best efforts.

Exmerah and Myron keep the faith and continue the tower run! Now its Rip and I's time to get nasty with them. Rip quick shoots twice over their heads, I pull another arrow, and again Burnie gets lucky its another greasy fire arrow, I'm sure I had some thunderstone arrows in here! Burnie is really under the hammer now though, the blows are coming in thick and fast, I'm not even sure he is alive under there anymore. I think it must be time to disperse the crowd! Turns out Burnie is still alive, good to know.

Burnie decides discretion is the better part of Valour and runs around behind a pillar and tries to stab the boss man, but he cuts under Burnies blade and slices thickly into Burnies midrift. Rips taking hits from the lordling and Burnies is getting proper mashed up now by the guy with the katana! Rip whips out, the lord raises his katana to finish Burnie off, as I let off a final arrow through his throat. That's my man he was trying to smite down!!

Riphard takes the head of the Lordling, or not its hard to recall. Myron returns, its good to know he is alive as well, my sister must have done her job. Burnie disrobes the Lord, Daisuke

stops pretending to be dead, and Burnie knocks out the young lordling.

Myron "You fucking did this, you fucking going against what little plan we didn't have" The talk is pretty heated long story short communication hasn't been our strong point.

Looking out the window guards are forming a circle around the central keep, I think its time for to kill every last one of these mother fuckers.

Daisuke needs a long rest, because He Has had a Bad day! I offer him the fast route to the bottom of the tower. Myron and I go upstairs to scope the top floor out.

Time to build the pillow fort of all barricades while Rip and Burnie go talk to Laz.

Laz is in his normal office space, fondling the lovely elephant secretary. While Burnie beseeches him to intervene, Laz pulls out the infinity draw, and starts too look into the current situation.

Rip gives Laz the low down. Laz wants answers to how this all fell apart. They both wake up and by some weird coincidence nothing has changed, we are still in a super tight bind. I untie the rope from around my waist and hand it to Exmerah as she starts tying them all together.

Myron being the man of action, makes the calls and we slide down a level to see whats going on on the floor below. Riphard joins us for some serious moral support. He starts a strong dirge to bolster our moral.

There are a lot or guards down here

We take so much fire its like being in a storm of arrows. First Rip goes down, then Myron, Exmeh comes back to try and zap the both out of them, channels all she can through the cube gifting life back to Myron!

We fight back a slow retreat slaying enemies left right and center, Myron goes down again but we explode the acid barrel, and murder another set of guards. We pull back to the last stand on the rooftop, and just as all hope is lost Exmerah pulls out a boom stick. Her resolve is firm and true, I grab the child and pull back with her and Myron. Just in time as the boom stick goes off blowing part of the castle to pieces.

We start shimmying down the rope to meet a even larger gathering of guards. Just in our darkest hour a huge mechanical eagle swoops through the air and plucks us off the rope to safety. Lady Hirota Hearthrust was in the area and came to investigate the explosion.

Where the hell is my beau? My man has been left behind, where did he go? Did he refuse to follow the plan again? That man is a Maverick, its a wonder he hasn't got his partners killed already. . . . O wait he has. . . all of them...

Burnie used disguise to convince the guards that he is the Lord, although somewhat concussed since his Masudan is equivalent to that of a six year old. For the love of whatever gods really exist. . . .

Burnie is looked upon by all the guards, for an answer to what to do next. He pulls a blinder and walks across to the lords daughter, breaks down to his knees.

"Today we have been wounded by the enemy, today we must prepare for war, but first if you would excuse me I must mourn the loss of my darling daughter."

He requests a horse and some gold to go and mourn at the local brothel, convincing enough to get a horse and make a rapid exit from the castle itself.

We meet in the forest, with a hot debate raging between the gabrins about whether to rescue Burnie or not. We get a lift to the battlefront.

EPISODE 45: BUSHIDO KOLO AND THE UNICORN THAT LIVED

Last wewek we just about escaped from the castle and we flew away of all things on a goiant robot eagle and hahahaha burnie was lamost the king but he managed to find usd and not get disocvered in hsi tricksiness. Romjiro hasnt been so happy about us accidentally killing his gf but its okay bcousse myron managed to be alive. We have put him in the hospital, so we will lleft him restt for a bit.

It was time for us to gather the army people so went to go and drop off the mans son. The dad was very impresesed wthat we hadd bought him all the way home so he agreed for us to have borrow of his 500 horsemen. Kolo decieded he was going to go to the battefiled now and get ready but then he felt really tired aso we went back to town to relax. Rippy awasnt so happy with the room he got so he got a nicer one with turnips on the pillow and everythign. We had some pretty nice sacks.

I lite a sigarette and loofk out at the mornning sun. The village is quiet quiet, the heavy bustle

and hustle of the day yet to emerge like the mothetr bird ermgnig from the nest hole to feedd her eggs, grnating them the sterngth to face the day. The horns were sounding to tell everyone that it was time to be in battle. Mr noble gave us his cousin to lead the horsemen and he was named Jakuno. He seemd brave. I could not wait to see new stanri. We set off at a brisk pace to try and make our way to be in time and of use. wE HAD gotten to about 6/8ths of the way there and there was a curious smell in the air and it was the smeel of a village being on fire. It was probably mercernaries. The cousin did notw atn to help but we knew it was the right thing to do so we went therer. Hopefulyl this would have no bad consequences. The viallge was full of 7 men taking the women and the childrene, We charged firing away all togethehr screaming and shoutinging. No rapes for you today gentleman. They had a lady leading gthem which was positive in a way but also they were evil so not all gooodd. Kolo murdered her through the eye with some nimble horesmanship work. I horsed my way over the dead woman and my masdk came doewn and I shouted at them that there would not even be a second chanse to live if they did not leave now and I used my deepest voice. Burnie stpped up and they fled. I told burnie to go emancipate the village and kolo looted the lady boss. We got a nice sword. Burnie addresssed the town and emancipated them and told them about our client lady inochi.

Kolo went into a bush. Then he became the bush.

We headed furioulsy to the batttle. Kolos horse was not happy to have a bush riding her. We finalyl caem to the battle and voer the hill we could see th raging maelstrom of war, both side heaavily engaged all fighting. Kolo went to be a bush and we all went to hte battle camp. Lady imicho awas sending her people in aleready. I pressed my arm device and suddenyl I saw stanrri!l. We went stragiht for himm (apart form kolo who is a bush). We did bear huggss. He looked so good inhis new bear metal clothes.

Lady imciho was there and also there was a lady who was on a uniocrn and is the angel of masuda. She was amazing. WE headed intot he battle, rippy and me raining bulelts down onto the oppostie team, and we were so inspriing everyone else followed us in. Althghh a lot of them were looking tiered. The pedants made a gap for us knowing that there part was done. The angel and the black lady went straight to it. I straddled stanri and kolo bushed in. Rippy was all singing and making us feel good. The horsemen ran in and strated hitting us loadss.

Burnie got a shield and strated protecting rippy. The agnel was killing it. Noone could even really still believe there was a unicorn here. Swrds kept swinign but they could hardly even touch us. This had to be in the bag thought burnie. Rippy took a moment to charm the horseman in front of him then ran away bravely all the while singing his inspiring song. I looked over and saw the black knights tiger sink its clawsinto the unicorns neck dropping it down to the ground. Poor horsey. Stanri bravely keapt into action and picked the angel up to continue her fight (he got a little pat off her to say thank you which I think he enjoyedd quite a bit). Kolo the bush finished off the tiger with an arrow threw the throat. I got wrecked by one of the horseymen, really bad, threw me for a loop.

Imicho flared with anger and just decmiated anagya and just stabsed straight threw his neck and was like "im sorry brother it had to be so". Brutal. Everything looked blurry. Burnie ran over covered iin mud and like 5 men staretd attacking him but not a one could hit his burly frame. The angel attacked the knight again and almost killed him almost. Stanri went super stanri mode and mauled hi to death with his cute little jaws, disemboewelling himand leeting his blood run into the snow. I finally managed to hit someone :(

With their leader dead,the horsemen lay down their horses. Imicho was very regential and told them all they were very noble and the fight was over. Brunie quickly went over to the unicorn and managed to make it better. The angel was very grateful.

We headed back to camp an it was nice because everyone was friendes now and we all made one big camp to share. Imicho did a funeral for her brother and buried him with hnours on the battefiled where he felel. A few horus later after we ate and stuff imichio came over to say hello and she also said we were the ronin she had hired and told us our unconventional ways wer euseful and she thanked us. She said there is still like some way to go but that we will be there when she gets to go to masuda. Then a little boy came up and there was exciting and strange news and it seemed that here two brothers had a fight with eachother instead of attacking us while we were down and she wanted to ask us one more favour. She needed us to go to the batttele field and she wanted us to be war correspondents. Burnie agreed for us which was a bit presumptuous. It was a very long way away to that next battle. Burnie asked for daisuke to come with us. Buzzkkill. Burnie asked for pultices of healing

and kolo just shot him daggers. I asked the little boy if we had any messages and we DID from the airship and it said "string of expletives. . . . Pregnancy rage. . . . You fucking bastards you left me here you put this inside me riphard why have you done this to me.". Andalso rubrix sensei sent a message that said "airship repairs going well, ready for flight any updates requested? How is getting to masuda?" p.s. Hope die investigations going well". I did a quick back of the map calculation and we decided we could tell the airship to come meet us at X on the map. I asked rippy if he wanted to write anything to delilah. He just stared blankly into space. We collectively wrote a message for him "I love you delilah. Hope the baby is well and am really happy we are doing ths. I hope you agve a caesection so your lady parts are all still good. I hope it is twins or quadruplets or nice things like that. I barely touched the orc woman with cancer". Rippy didnt disapprove the message so we sent it on the way. We headed off to the meeting point.

On the way kolo gave me some plans for a straight line. But they were already in stanris boot and kolo finally had his new arrows of power. Burnie had a request for touching people but hoped he could do it at distance but his idea was ridiculous. I didn't even have time to explain to him why he was so wrong. I was worried about the wind and my claculations. I took some time on on 4 day journey to study the cube. It tried to shut me out but i managaed to sort that out. Suddenyl a door appeared next to me. It was just flat. Weird. I knocked on it and the door opened. It was a lovely little cottage inside!!! Inside there was a little humanoid shimmering servant, He bowed and i bowed and kolo bowed then we decided we would have a little rest and rippy said he would watch out for the airship. Burnie looked out of the window and saw a field of golden corn reaching out to forever. He mucked about with some coins and then dreamed about a bedroom and found it. I was concerned about the airship, and i noticed that the map was bit sticky and it was folded in a bit. We went for a rest. 8 hrs later we saw the airship arriving on the way.

The airship arrived and had also picked up myron on the way, which was good and was not an oversight that we almost missed. All the reapirs looked great and it was flying like a beauty. Delilah was visibly pregnant now (4 months maybe). She ran and hugged riphard and was crying everywhere and riphard looked very happy. Burnie wanted to go and pick up his orc women but noone else wanted to do that. Delilah looked so pretty and plump. Rubix

ssensei did not look so well. He was pleased with our porgress and was so wise and kind. Kolo told him about the filtration system and rubrixs sensei laughed and then coughed and kolo gave him some elixir and it was sad because he said he was not doing so well. Rubirxs sensei said he might burn his pricture books that gabrins were not allowed to see.

We lifted our anchor and we took off sialing to the west. The good airship Gary taking us to where we needed to go. . . .

We arrived at the battlefield and it was not good. Dead bodies were littered everywhere. Hundred and hundred and tens. I noticed all of the dead had one colour. Burnie and kolo were sniffing the air, with a confused lok on their face. Burnie whispered a single word."gunpowder". Daisuke was perturbed and burnie was upset his idea was taken. Daisuk ethgouth the honour was not good. He explained that vikkahanos men had not had a good time of things (they were dead). Daisuke said "honour is important". Kolo coldly said "honour was important". Burnie was pertuerbde and uncle kolo said he had a plan that involed blowing somethign up that wa very large. He wanted to blow up their black powedr supplies. Brunie decided we should take some of the bodies back and take them back to lady isoko so that we can show her what she is going to be facign now. Kolo investigated and found the bullet holes were quite small and we though it is probably a musket type of thing. Not too advanced. Volume over quality. Evrye pesaant a musketter.

We got in the ship and flew back to fukiniro to deliver our grim news. . . .

Epilogue

Myria sat on the river bank and watched the water. She considered the gentle flow and sadly looked back at her life. It had been two weeks since her diagnosis from the dwarven doctor. She still couldn't quite bring herself to believe it. Cancer. One little word that carried so much weight. What had she done to deserve this? She'd been a good concubine. She'd exercised and tried to maintain a healthy diet. But that hadn't been enough had it. A bluebird settled down on the bank next to her and looked up at her with a curious tilt of the head. To be that bird, she thought, care free and able to just fly away from its problems. The things she had always wanted to do but never gotten the chance. To explore the south end of the cave, to learn to tap dance, to rise up the ranks to the point of owning her own harem. These were things she would never be able to accomplish now. Why

her? There was no use asking she thought. Sometimes bad things just happen to good orcs and that was how the world worked. Had she ever really been in love? Sure there was Urk'thal the Flayer, the one orc who would always make an effort to look her in the eye as he unleashed his lust inside her, but he was never the type to commit. Other than that, she did not think she had ever experienced the excitement of knowing someone at that most intimate level. A single tear rolled down her face. Why me. . . .

<https://youtu.be/uF1Q56YAo0Q?t=89>

EPISODE 46: LOVE SELF-ACTUALLY

Dear Diary,

I've got Daisuke to write this down for me, because I'm not feeling too hot still. I'm not too worried about him telling anyone about anything soft what I might say, because if he does I'll snip all the tendons in his legs, won't I Sooky?

I'm really not feeling super swell still, but the airship has come and picked me up and taken me to the rest of the gang. The ships looking great and there's all these cool bits. I've got a lovely room with some nice straw on the ground. It's well good.

We pick them all up from this big old battlefield where they're all standing about.

We gather in the awesome room Esmey has had made to plan things and start planning things. Bronie wants to go to Fukaniro first, but he's only a bar man and he doesn't get a vote.

We decided that we should go to Konrad's house first, because Esmey wants to find out about robots and stuff. She realises with a start that it's even more super duper important than she thought because it's a year since she saw her robot mate that got beheaded.

We sail off across this weird fucking contaminant... contentment... big country.

I stand at the front bit of the sky boat and look as cool as I can while not being able to breathe properly without crying a little bit. Kolo and Esmey try and startle balloon cows, so they can pop them for the lols. Bronie tries to get Deals to teach him how to fly the big sky boat.

It takes us about a day to get there, but eventually we get to this little cottage what Esme thinks might be that guy Konrad's house. Deals brings us down towards the ground and says that she's going to drop us off and goes off to find somewhere to park.

Bronie asks Esmey if she can build some sort of floating platform. What a bellend.

Kolo tries to trick him into hanging himself, but he misunderstands and throws himself headfirst off the boat.

The rest of us get off the boat like proper people and go up and knock on the door. The cottage seems, like, real hot. Generating some proper heat, mate.

The door opens and its those robot ladies from earlier. Like, you know, the ones we met in the

field that time, and then one of them was riding that eagle the other day.

We do a little bit of chit chat with them, and they give us that fake head of that Otterio one that Esmey made them make us.

That man Konrad what makes all the robot women comes into the room, and asks who we are. He's saying that he's happy that he doesn't have to make things that kill people any more.

I get a little bit excited and I'm telling him about how all of his awesome ladies are awesome and killing people and whatnot, and I don't really notice that he doesn't look super stoked about it.

I'm all "hey yeah, Otterio killed the emperor and all kinds of shit", and then everyone has to take me to one side and be all "mate, I don't think he knows". I feel like a right bellend.

I go back to Konrad and say that I'm concussed. It's quite a convincing lie, because I think I might be a little bit concussed.

I get Konrad to start talking to Esmey about making things and whatnot. He seems super impressed, which is totally understandable because she's so clever and wild. They talk about all these things which are probably really cool.

Konrad takes us down to his workshop and it's the fucking worst. There's all these cogs and springs and all sorts of terrible shit. Esmey looks happy. I guess that's fine. She's having a nice time.

I say we should probably leave because why are we even here, and Konrad is all "yeah, why is you even here?" and I'm like "right?".

Esmey and Konrad get into making some thing together and whatever, I don't even care, I'm going to wait upstairs. Kolo comes with me, because he's not lame and doesn't care about fucking cogs.

Rip asks Konrad about some background about the robot women. Apparently he only makes, like, one a year, so there's only, like, fifty of them or something. There are probably 10 or so in Masuda.

Everyone stands around sucking this Konrad guy's dick, because it's so cool to be clever and make shit.

Upstairs, Kolo is showing me this new grapple backpack arrow thing. I put the backpack on, and then Kolo presses a button and then all of a sudden I'm all upside down hanging from the ceiling. I reckon it works well.

Kolo seems to need to test it by being really aggressive and weird. I don't know whether he meant to install a system by which it could be controlled by asking loaded questions about his sister, but nothing seems to happen when he does.

He's all "what are your intentions?" and I'm all like "I dunno, mate, how do you mean?" and then everyone comes up from downstairs and all the blood's going to my head and some of it is coming out of my head and I don't see so good any more.

Kolo tells me how to get down and I hit the ground quite hard.

Fucking Konrad is all going on about how awesome he is and how he can make robots for Rip's bank and how he's going to charge ten grand for ten robots, and then it's ten grand for one robot, and everyone realises he's such a dickhead and no one likes him.

Me and my awesome friends go back to the airship and they all slap me on the back and tell me how much they enjoy my company. The robot ladies come with us too, because they realise that Konrad's boring and lame.

When we get there, they have the fucking cheek to try and tell us off for nearly telling Konrad that they do a bit of cool killing from time to time. We try and convince them to help us in some way, but they don't, because they're lame.

They say that no one would accept a leader who got into power using guns, which is stupid because guns are cool, and machines are dumb, and being dumb is fine.

We chat to them some more and eventually we agree that we're going to get that woman, you know, the one who we work for now, to agree that she was going to give the robots rights, and in return, they'd get Konrad to make those bank robots and we could use them in the fight maybe.

We're pretty happy with that, and I take the ladies to one side and have a word with them before we go.

I have a totally non-soft chat with the main one. I apologise for being a bit of a nob. She's pretty okay about it, to be honest. She tries to tell me that it's okay to change the way you are sometimes, and that maybe I don't need to be a killing guy all the time. I give her a little hug, when I'm sure no one's watching.

I think maybe it's hard to be soft sometimes.

We set sail, and after a few days of awkwardness, Kolo brings me a beer with some of that weird bush he calls Gary dissolved in it. I sit with him for a bit and we have a proper good chat.

We're all so well adjusted right now.

We decide that we should go and talk to Laz, while we're all feeling so self-actually [sic].

We go to hell to have a little chat, and Bronie remembers that the reason we're actually here is that we were supposed to asking him about something called Kalima, which might be related to the ancient gods of the tikkituks. He says that he doesn't remember the name, but checks his drawer, and apparently there is something.

Kalima was an ancient god-like but not god thing that liked making weird monsters. He made the tikkituks, but hasn't been brought up in eons. Even Laz can't find any record of him, which is pretty fucking weird.

We ask Laz loads of really awkward questions about Tikkituks. Laz seems to think that we shouldn't get distracted and should stay focussed on getting the gods back, and not just focus on tikkituk stuff from now on.

Laz sends us back to the mortal realms, and we decide we want to buy squid.

Esmy comes up to me when Bronie is down on the ground trying to buy the most poisonous squid he can. She says that she was getting gay vibes off of Konrad, which is an unfortunate way of phrasing that she had a good time hanging out with him.

Once we get to Fukaniro, Bronie goes to check on those gross orc women he's been harrassing. When he comes out, his cheeks are wet, and we doesn't even have an erection. I don't know what he's been doing, but I hope he didn't catch that cancer one of them had.

Bronie goes around asking questions about orcish funerals, looking really sad. If you don't want to be sad, don't ask questions about funerals.

He finds out that the only true orc funeral is one in which the flesh is consumed and the bones are burnt. Kolo fetches him his biggest pot. It is not big enough.

I get back later and Bronie's cooked us all a lovely stew dinner, which is nice. The meat tastes bad, but there is a lot of it. It is a little lumpy, though.

Esmy is in the crow's nest eating peanut butter.

The one remaining orc woman answers some questions about Kalima, and seems to be roughly pro the whole issue.

Prologue: Burnie stands in front a stove, silently shoveling bones into the hatch...

EPISODE 47: EMANCIPATION, PREPARATION, CONSTERNATION AND ANTICIPATION!

Burnie's left arm begins twitching uncontrollably, where Burnie lies in an orc-meat induced coma, it manages to grab a pen, and begins scrawling in a nearby open file.

Hi There! I'm Mark, Mark o'Synne! I'm currently trapped in the arm of a non-magical curmudgeon, so this is kind of a difficult task of me. Seems I can only write things when he's in a proto-canabalistic food comer. Cool! Maybe I'll manifest soon, once I've gathered enough latent magical energy, but til then I'll just make do, longing for some sort of wrist-worn time-piece! Anyway, I have a prediction, my existence at the moment puts me slightly outside the chrono-stream, and I'm pretty sure I should warn them all of the horrors of what's going to happen!

Anyway, I betcha everyone will get woken up, and confusedly send Kolo to meet with lady Imicha - they'll sort it before they all end up together. Kolo and the gang give their appraisal of the situation in, what we call in hell, a "shit sandwich" of good news! Seems that the Masudan army have been using guns, which is less than good, but Kolo is awesome and Riphard has a fancy cloak. Plus one less brother's army to contend with - all round good news! Oh, yeah, the guns. And an army of about 500, in a heavily fortified city, with guns.

Exme demonstrates everything through the use of a rabbit flipbook, getting shot by a little Masudan man with a musket - excellent use of an animated medium, for I know it will be so! Oh god, I don't even have a nose at the moment - but that orc-meat fart is horrendous! We'll plan to use trebuchets. . . . No, Conrad, he can help us. Someone stands and accuses the goblins of being, well, goblins. Burnie throws a knife at his head, but misses burying it just beside his ear.

The point is made - unfortunately in the beautiful theatre's wall. The goblins put on a play. It's a bit derivative. And no-one speaks the language. Kolo hams it up, not believable as the character.

Short version (mercifully) - Conrad builds robots, and the Geisha's get their freedom - in order to all help. Riphard uses finger guns, which is weirdly persuasive enough to convince Imicho to send Lord Ko'nquo with us to pick up the murder bots. Exme comes up with all the ideas to outfit our ship with bombs and awesomeness. Geisha's ability to pulverise chairs is revealed, as well as their well-known capacity for opening pickle jars. It's a bit polarising display, but people are impressed, if concerned. As Riphard puts it "if you have a land of murder-robots, better to have them on your good side". Burnie screams "Fer freedom". If I could blush from embarrassment, I would.

We bump into Myron outside, and we're worried that Riphard is trying to buy 100'000's worth of Robots with 120'000's worth of gold, shortchanging lady Imicha. Burnie Pigs ears for a cocktail, "The Swines Concerto". It's served in a pigs ear, gives it a nice waxy flavour. We end up back on the boat, making preparation to return to Conrad, along with our friend Lord Cumquat. Kolo breaks into Burnie's room, and steals his files - but man-handles his bits in search of gold. Burnie Catches him, and dangles him out the door, before going to bed - but didn't realise his files were gone. Kolo's thinks he's a little monster. Exme's says she's an angel, potential evil genius, but gold star appraisal overall. They build a smoke machine. And other stuff. New plan - load Daddy-Gary's body into the smoke machine and get the whole city stoned!

We get to Conrads, and we talk to the Geisha's, they're happy about being emancipated! God he's camp. I may have the relative form of a halfling, but I feel some short-person shame because of him. For Synne's sake reel it in man! Lord Whatsit and Conrad meet up, and start negotiating objects for the war effort. We have a big ol' party, involving booze, and fireworks, and geisha, and fun, and booze. They reach an agreement! The Geisha's get a stipend, and Riphard agrees, in his most noble way, to take Otarios - which is agreed!

Everyone mucks down to do some combat so Conrad can work out how we all attack, to train the robots. Burnie dodges, Myron gets whipped and then shot (by Riphard), and Kolo is a dick. Gnomes don't like Bum Play, but they do like healing shocker gauntlets! Myron and delilah

and... Rip? Go to collect balloon cows. It's more like bobbing for cows, or Myron impossible. Myron catches a cow, and Riphard lets of a celebratory gunshot. The balloon cows bloat, and they successfully(?) catch 3 of the little bastards.

Preparations continue, Myron foots in mouth (and so does Burnie) about the fact we don't care about Masuda and just want the artefact, to the Geishas, they're less than impressed. We're here to get the hammer of the gods - I remember this thing! Can harm those enhanced by the power of Inthum, so pretty good against the Inquisition. The Geisha tell us the golden hall - basically a history museum of awesome loot - contains the hammer. Tall, likely gold, lit up with torches. We make our way on the airship, trying to sort out the best method of assault. General idea is using the airship to blow a hole to the city, get in, then using the ship to escape from the city. With a hold full of robots, and several magic bombs made by the terrible twins, and half an idea involving balloon cows and strafing strikes of bombing runs. Ah, CURSE my precognition... It's premature!

I guess the exciting thing was going to happen next time! The damned bastard is waking up, so I better make myself scarce, saying that, sounds like Kolo will steal this file before Burnie ever sees it, so this flap of a butterfly's wing won't affect the ripples of time! Toodles!

Credit song: <https://youtu.be/2c1iSpk3u1A>
(I dunno, it's catchy and just how I imagine us bimbaling around in the flying machine)

EPISODE 48: IN THE HALL OF THE GIANT MOUNTAIN LIZARD KING

The group lands the great skyship Gary by Lady Imicho's army a couple of hours outside Masuda. Ready for battle. The army is large, but narrow, lining up behind the newly built battlebots.

The emancipated/captured orc slave is now working as Gary's barmaid. Myron isn't drinking, spending the evening sharpening and polishing his armour. He now looks sharp.

Burnie is sewing (lame). He's trying to disguise himself as something to do with the opposition army. But it's taking fucking ages.

Burnie wants to wait til the army is at the water gate, fly over them, hiding behind some smoke. There's a holy mountain. We blow up the gates, the army gets in. Then we just sort of run-about-a-bit. Then just win.

Burnie's made an amazing disguise of the not-emporer we killed. He's not wearing it yet tho.

Riphard checks on the heavily pregnant Delilah. She's pacing. She questions him on his battle plans. He says Burnie or Myron's got it covered. Riphard realises the plan involved Delilah flying over the battle. He's not happy about this, but what can he do? Will his child grow up motherless?

The goblins sing goblin stuff.

Everyone gets a good sleep.

Gary sets sail for the holy mountain before first flight, flying under cover of darkness.

Burnie feels the feng shui is off and starts with redecorating the ship immediately before battle. Myron likes this and joins in, painting the ship with his vanquished foes.

Masuda mountain. Creative name.

Myron says we should bail at the slightest hint of danger. He doesn't feel this country or it's people are worth our lives. Exme tells Myron he won't die today. Myron is doubtful. Burnie consults his dictionary.

Exme checks on the escape cows. They're comfortable down in the hold. They've got grass. It's all good. The plan is to rappel ourselves and the cows down from the ship when the time comes. The cows are called Fatima, Gustav, and Betty.

Burnie suggests we build some bombs, only several minutes before battle... Everyone is incredulous at him not mentioning this previously if he was thinking it.

Kolo hands Burnie a lit candle. Burnie is holding mass explosive materials. Everyone else backs away.

Myron goes into his pocket. Impressive. He comes out with a bunch of beef jerky. He places this back in his pocket. This was important.

From Gary the group can see the army columns approaching Masuda. There's a bunch of commoners with rifles outside. The gunfire starts raining down. Kolo notices that the mountain begins to shake, triggering avalanches. The two armies are approaching each other fast. Gary approaches the northern side of the battle. There's some archers and pikemen and shit inside the city.

Myron activates the smokescreen. Constantly. He says he'll stop smoking once we're in boomboom range.

Burnie wants to boss everyone around. No one is interested. There's a discussion on who's manning what. Kolo wants to ride a bomb down.

Kolo sees everything. Burnie denies having any children. A raven sadly caws in the distance.

Burnie ties a rope to a bomb. Gary heads towards the walls of Masuda, they are getting close. People are looking up at this ship of death, looking shaken, some run away in terror. The ship is fucking terrifying. A thick black cloud of smoke, with just a bow protruding from the front covered in what looks like the rotten carcasses of gruesome monsters. Proper metal shit.

Burnie blindly dangles some cargo out the back of the ship.

Volleys of arrows strike the airship, chipping away at Gary's seemingly impenetrable armour. This ship is invulnerable. It is well-built.

Myron eases off the pollution. Kolo fires the cannon, laughing maniacally. Gary emerges menacingly from the black. Riphard and Kolo miss wildly with the ballistas. Exme feels like a natural cannoner, nailing a towerful of archers at the gate, toppling it to the ground cinematically. At the same time, a huge explosion rocks the ship. Miraculously the gate has been blown to smithereens, assisted by the collapse of the tower.

The battlebots engage the lines of musketmen, who begin to retreat into Masuda. At the command of Myron, and with the aid of Riphard's back-ballista piloting, Delilah swings the ship down low and Myron deploys a layer of smoke over the archers on the wall.

Kolo wants to fire himself with the ballista. In the confusion he fires the ballista... empty.

Exme gets overconfident with the cannon. Riphard nails 3 men with his ballista. "Don't get penisy".

The musketmen fire up at the ship, chipping some more life off of Gary.

A third round of firing goes awry. This shit is harder than it looks. Gary gets ever weaker.

Delilah soars away from the battle into the sky. Myron reactivates the pollution. The mountain is shaking vigorously now, but only Burnie has noticed. Worrying. There's some meta-volcano-zilla discussion.

Gary arcs over the Masudan walls, penetrating the outer edge of the city. There's panic on the streets of Masuda. But relative to the battle field outside things are fairly peaceful and quiet.

Myron starts shouting "Fuck it uuuuup!" over and over. Burnie is reluctant for some reason. Myron wants fucking chaos. Kolo has tied Burnie to a ballista arrow. He notices in time and cuts himself free.

The group remembers they are actually on here to heist a macguffin from a place. Kolo spots the anticipated location of the mystical doodah. And a giant fucking mountain lizard. As in. . . the lizard is the mountains. All of them. The group groups in the cargo hold, ready to drop down into the city. Belly of the beast. Not the lizard. . . yet.

Everyone jumps out. . . except Riphard. Riphard tries to convince Delilah to just ditch everyone and fly away. Delilah almost convinces herself. . . but instead kicks Riphard out herself. A single word echoes on the wind, "Divooooooooorce".

Riphard does a 3-point landing. It looks sweet with the golden cloak. Kolo lands on his head. The ground shakes and walls begin to crumble. Kolo starts rambling about ballistas and buildings and giant animals. The group ignores him.

Exme guides the way to the gizmo with magic of some sort. Burnie ties up the balloon cows by "some rubble". Disguised as rocks. . . . No way this could go wrong.

The group approaches a huge glass wall, holding back a large pool of water. Riphard shoots the glass. A crack appears. And grows. . . . And stabilises. Looks like it's been well designed.

Riphard asks the group who thinks he should shoot again. Only Kolo is keen. Dejected he kicks a stone at the wall and walks away. An ominous trickle of water goes unnoticed.

The group finds a few Masudan men accompanied by 2. . . church peeps? WHATATWIST. They draw weapons.

The church peeps recognise us. Kolo mocks them through repetition with a stupid voice. Or just his regular voice. Difficult to tell. He then surprise shoots one of the fuckers.

Myron runs up into the middle of the group of enemies. Genius tactical awareness. He hits with a shot. Burnie gets twatted hard by the church dudes. Myron gets bumrushed by the fancy looking Masudan. Exme shoots at the onrushing Masudanman, hitting him hard.

Riphard keeps his distance, striking the already hurt church man. He tells Riphard he will pay for being a traitor. This reminds Riphard of his financial business.

Burnie takes covers and attacks the fancy Masudan on Myron, killing him. Nice.

The musketmen retreat and fire at Kolo, Burnie, and Myron. They miss all of them. Muskets are shit. "Useless locals" grunts the now-racist church dude.

Stanri bounds up the battlefield and looks ready to pounce.

Kolo threatens to eat them, also looking ready to pounce.

Myron wonders whether he's seen these church "wardens" before. He hasn't. Nor has anyone. Turns out they are unpaid church interns in fancy clothes.

Myron rushes a warden, and Kolo fires, sticking him with an arrow. Myron stabs him with his gun. "You still got some learnin' to do, son." he says as his fires his shotgun while still impaling him.

He says "You'll pay for this." Not a great comeback, feels derivative.

Exme shoots a warden nearly to death. Riphard just misses with a shot because of Exme's hit.

Burnie slashes really aggressively at a warden. Super menacing, but all bark unfortunately.

Exme gets hit with a musket. Actually hurts quite bad it turns out. Stanri mauls a musketman.

Kolo casually murders a man with his bow. #accuracy

Myron misses a bunch of times at close range. Win some lose some. The warden attempts to "rapier" Myron. But fails. Exme shoots his head off.

One of the musketmen explodes from Riphard's weapon mastery.

Burnie punches one of the remaining musketmen. To death. One punch.

The last musketman is pinned down by Stanri, ready for interrogation/torture/"rapier".

"They told us you were evil traitors here to take out belongings." The group agrees this sounds accurate.

Riphard doesn't know anything about religion. Myron has heard of this Pastor Kieran, who is involved according to this nobody. He's a kobald and a bellend. Myron menaces the fuck out of the dude, pressing him for more info on church involvement. "There's the other one they call. . . . Fallon." The group press about the hammer of the gods we're after. He gives us specific directions and says it's mostly empty and mostly a mausoleum. He begs for his life. Myron stabs him in the face.

The group loot the corpses. Not aware of any giant lizard based necessity to get on with it. Myron further investigates the wardens and finds a hidden letter. "Cannillon demands their heads." That's it. No one knows who that is.

Myron peeks through the windows into the main hall. Empty. A barracks at the far end. Stanri sniffs the air, but smells nothing.

The group heads into the building and left into a dining room area. It's actually more of a meeting room. A set of papers on the desk indicate the golden halls are suffering from poor visitor numbers due to the civil war. A set of stairs in the room lead to a circular chamber below.

Kolo seems suicidal nowadays. Myron gives him a pep talk. Burnie sees something he shouldn't. Myron asks Exme to look after Kolo. Exme stares blankly into space.

Kolo pokes the door with a stick. Myron still seems concerned. There's no trap. Burnie mutters to himself about multibows. The group head through the non-trapped door.

Burnie opens the door. Everyone's spidey senses tingle real bad at the sight of an "empty" corridor. Burnie makes it halfway down the corridor before nothing happens. Two sets of doors at the end, one open, one closed. Burnie peeps through the open door. 3 more wardens await beyond.

Everyone bundles round the corner attacking in surprise. Kolo pops off a shot with his new weapon, hastily-bundled-together-muskets,

before anyone knows what's going on. He hits them for serious damage, but severely hurts himself in the process.

Myron runs in and attacks the one who took the brunt of Kolo's explosion, killing him quickly, while choking on acrid smoke from Kolo's musketbomb.

Riphard misses with a shot, but quickly reloads and hits a warden with a thunderous shot, throwing him into the wall and he crumples in a head to the floor.

Exme shoots at the last warden standing, but misses. Stanri mauls the warden on the floor to pieces. Burnie does some Burnie stuff. Kolo hits the last warden with an arrow.

The warden takes a pot shot at Stanri in panic, but glances off his armour plating.

Myron puts the warden out of his misery and immediately barges through the door.

Burnie barricades a new door as the group head to the top of some more steps down. A huge shake rocks the building. Exme and Riphard are thrown to the floor. The group descend the stairs to find 4 more wardens and a shepherd flavour pastor. He's got a super creepy voice. A back and forth ensues, but it doesn't get us anywhere and some killin's afoot.

The wardens fire down on Burnie and Myron. They seem fine.

Kolo hits the shepherd with an arrow, that he's tied to a string. He begins to reel himself in, "I'm coming for you!". He gets halfway. Probably would've been quicker to run.

Riphard blasts the shepherd with a thunderous discharge, blowing him over and dragging Kolo with him to the floor.

Exme throws a forcefield onto Kolo and gets all blurry.

Burnie doesn't really do anything of note. Maybe noteworthy in his ineffectiveness.

Stanri mauls the nearest warden.

The shepherd heals the mauled warden. Except he doesn't cos he's totes out of range, MIKE. Instead he touches himself, which is probably the more sensible move anyway. He also does some sanctuary shit.

Myron runs about a bit and yells. He has a little mid battle chit chat with the shepherd. "Helen will come for you." Everyone wonders who Helen is.

The wardens fail in their rapiering. But the two with pistols hit Myron with some damage. He seems fine.

Kolo the wise is wise enough to shoot at the sanctuaried shepherd, whilst still being rappelled towards him. He hits him good. Riphard similarly gives him a whack with his blessed bullets.

Exme misses. Burnie runs away and gets rapiered for his cowardice. He slashes a different warden near Stanri for some reason. Stanri short circuits.

The shepherd tries to hold Kolo with his mind tricks. Kolo the wise is having none of it.

However, Myron the unwise is fooled by the shepherds tricks and does nothing.

All the wardens miss, except Myron, who takes more poultry(SIC) damage.

Riphard's fucking on it today, and hits the Shepherd with more blessed bullets, seeing through his puppy dog eyes.

Exme misses again. Not her day unfortunately. Burnie also sucks.

Stanri kills a motherfucker. Burnie is now riding Stanri and seems to try to take credit for the kill.

The shepherd slinks away from Myron and rains down with pistols on Kolo. Kolo dances over the bullets. He then further sanctuaries himself.

Myron is so fucking unwise. And then he isn't. He tackles the shepherd to the floor, holding him "human shield style" demanding the warden put their guns down immediately. One of the wardens makes a break for it up the stairs. The other two wardens shoot the shepherd... to fucking shreds. But Myron rolls over just in time, realising they've called his bluff. Myron takes the bullets in the back.

Kolo amazingly misses with an arrow. Riphard still got it though, and thunders a warden into the wall. Exme also misses. Riphard's on his own today.

Burnie jumps off Stanri and slashes the shit out of the knocked down warden, but he clings to life.

Stanri runs up behind Burnie and swipes the dude to death as Burnie flips up back onto him. Nice.

The mostly dead shepherd, whos life was just saved by Myron further mocks us, and he attempts to stab Myron. Ungrateful shit.

Myron forcefeeds the dude beef jerky, and tries to pin him down with his bayonet, but fails. The weak attempt doesn't intimidate the clearly insane church cultist.

The last remaining warden looks desperate and shoots the onrushing Stanri.

Kolo shoots the warden. He's still standing though.

Riphard, out of boredom and cockiness at this point, runs up to the warden and attempts to whip him. Sadly not.

Exme misses again. Burnie slashes the dude and he's still going, the absolute unit. Stanri finally kills him.

Only the shepherd remains and Myron attempts a proper interrogation. The dude says "Fallon will have fun with you." The entire building shakes. Myron cuts the shepherds tendons and leaves him.

The group approach the pedestal holding the hammer of the gods... a gun. It's more Riphards thing than Myron's. But everyone seems to want Myron to have it anyway. Riphard takes it.

The group argue over the freshness of meat.

As the group works their way out from the hall a collective sense of dread descends on the group.

EPISODE 48.5: JOSIE AND THE HELLCATS

Hell – a lovely afternoon with an orange glow. Devils are wandering about in a nice part of town. A young Tiefling woman is lying in bed asleep. She turns over and sees the alarm clock seeing that it's blue past omega and she realises she is late for her first business meeting. She sounds a lot like a young girl called Gabigail She's going to a Hell training assessment day. She comes to a clean conference room with a stern looking woman by a clipboard. Not-Garbigail apologises for being late. It turns out her name is Josie. Mark, Lazarus and an old man are all here as well. After some initial banter we are introduced to a bicentennial management training day.

There is an agenda:

Introductions Lynne Shephard is running it – she has taken over from Margaret after "the incident". She is an adulteress who catfished men and killed them.

Mark O'Synne – He was stuck in a book but now he's back. His fun fact is that he likes big thick women and long walks on the beach.

Lazarus – Head of bringing people in.

Josie – Intern programme for exceptionally evil people. She is a really bad sort. Fun fact – once accidentally murdered herself/mother/sister who is Garbigail

Ron – head of marketing and development. Very good at his job. Even though he doesn't have to do anything.

There is no fire drill so if the alarms go off then hell has frozen over and the end times are here Mark's example of evil is papercutting someone as a book Josie killed seven cats by putting them in a box and leaving them. She killed an old man. Nobody is very convinced but only the evillest people get in on the evil internship.

The icebreaker – Lynne beckons Meredith in who wheels in a big block of ice to the room. Lynne asks who wants to break the ice and after some back and forth Josie is volunteered. She levitates a hammer and fails to chip the ice but it does nothing. Laz tells her to keep going and tries to secretly blow it up. HE succeeds, but is not very stealthy. WE move on to the task: Timothy Wainwright – an exceptionally good man who ran a charity helping kiddies. In his late life he lost so many children he developed a gambling problem. We have 30 minutes to use the tools on the table to develop a plan to inflict the most pain and horror Items: A ball of yellow wool Ping pong paddles Half bottle mayo Pen and paper Pack of cards Tikki tukk mask.

We start trying to come up with stuff. Ron wants to lacerate his anus with mayo. Josie comes up with terrible ideas. Ron comes up with awful violent ideas. Josie comes up with more awful ideas. Lazarus puts forward an idea about using cards to get him to gamble for not being tortured, but everything loses so he gets tortured. Mark tries to put forward an idea but wants to act it out, he puts some "fun bucks" on the table and walks around. Ron tries to push him out of the window but Mark is too fast and lucky. Meredith smacks him with his trunk but luck bends and she falls on top of Mark with her big elephant boobs. Josie raises a hand and asks to leave to go to the toilet, Ron wants to follow so Josie lets him go first then she goes. Ron comes back invisible to shirk his work. Mark and Laz come up with a terrible last minute plan as the clock comes down. They get into the torture time – Lazarus decides that the best torture is a slow, mental torture and invites Timothy to be part of the management

committee. Josie does not take this very well and there were arguments. Ron sticks a pen into his head. Josie tries to one up him by smashing mayo into his head and pulling his eyes out. As he starts to bind back together Lazarus paints an image of children suffering and dying on the inside of the tikki tukk mask and pins it on his head which tortures him. Mark makes it actually work by bending luck. There is a debriefing where everyone gets told they are not shit at their jobs. Lazarus feels it is a bit of a lie. Ron created Disney to torture kids.

We have light refreshments and go on an adventure. We arrive the Maze of Infinite Horrors. We have to reach the centre to get a fabulous prize. Mark and Laz are a team, we go first and head in. We work our way around. Josie and Ron bicker and start to go. They come across a vortex pit filled with billions of swirling, bleeding arms. Ron makes friends by giving out business cards, he high fives them and attempts to crowd surf across the pit. He steps into the pit and feels the immensity of the atmosphere drop to nothingness, the arms pull at him. Josie looks up what she should do in the employee handbook and lets Ron fall. Ron uses his charm and wile. But he fails because he is mediocre. Josie helps by blasting him with fire and fury as he gets dragged down by a thousand arms. Ron takes a lot of damage and disappears into the ether.

Mark and Laz turn a corner and are right into a dragon. They try to fight the dragon. Mark nearly dies. Laz's attacks don't do much so he picks the dragon up and throws it to mark before carrying on. Josie walks past the pit which no longer exists and finds a rainbow dragon that is all the dark colours of the rainbow. She gets immediately hit by the rainbow dragon as she can barely look at it. Josie tries to give the rainbow dragon a lecture. Ron gets burped out of an infinity sphere and lands on the ground back at the start. Josie sidles past the dragon. Mark is under a dragon. He tries to talk him out of killing him but gets eaten, exploding in a golden shower and reforming at the start. Lazarus continues and finds an imaginary D20 which is his friend. He takes advice from the dice on directions.

Ron tries to cut through a bush to get back but cannot, so says he needs to find his TIEFLING partner to "give her a fingering". Ron tries to catch up and knows the Rainbow Dragon, she says he would make her a star. Ron fingers the dragon up the arse. Again. He threatens the dragon and moves the fingers to a fist. As the dragon fails to bite him, he slides his fist further

up. "You're just gonna be another one of my puppets love". Mark goes into an obvious dead end and tries to teleport to the centre. Unauthorised use of powers creates a centaur. Which smooshes him with a hoof. Lynne gives him a big cross on a sheet. Ron tries to persuade the dragon to take him, but his fist is in her, so it fails and the dragon drags him off.

Lazarus finds the Riddlenoscera and enters a game of riddles. He passes the first riddle and asks about the riddlenoscera's friends. We have a flash of backstory full of other riddlenoscera being murdered. Ron gets dragged by the dragon and finds a pocket watch on the floor. He is still stuck in the dragon. The watch spins super fast and ages him 20k years. He plunges the watch into the ground to try and age the earth to get closer to retirement. He for some reason picks it back up to shove into the dragon but cannot and ages into dust. He reforms out of the dust in the start again as a baby and ages again. Ron orders a UPS? Van and crafts something in the back of the van before driving into towards the maze and getting stuck in the maze wall.

Mark tries to deceive the dragon with telepathy. And uses his luck to make the dragon move away so he can sneak by. Ron's UPS? Van has a shrinking device and transforms into a low rise. Four guys fix the UPS van into a lower mode. The UPS? Van drifts around the maze corner and Tokyo drifts around. Mark finds a golden chalice and drinks it – two ghosts come out and ask him if he's worthy. Mark refuses to answer. Mark O'Synne says he isn't worthy and the ghosts enter his body. The gate opens and lets him through. Ron create a Pteordactyl, nobody is sure why. Lazarus beats the Riddlenoscera and sees Josie trying to sneak up behind him. Laz asks her to join him as his teammate is gone. Lazarus and Josie have a chat as they come to a dead end. Laz believes Josie isn't really evil and she confides in him that she isn't and there has been a clerical error. Laz says its good to have someone who isn't a massive arsehole. Laz gets trapped inside a mirror world after getting sucked into a mirror. He tries to escape but can't so shifts reality to break his way out.

Mark sneaks around, Ron escapes from a box and arrives at the Riddlenoscera. Mark appears at the same time and then starts vomiting ghosts before dying. He resurrects again and realises he is not Worthy. Ron puts gems in the riddleosaurus' eyes. It does nothing. Laz and Josie continue towards the centre. Laz gets betrayed by his friend D20 who stabs him in the back. Laz disintegrates it. . . then there's a creepy little girl. She begs for help and moves to Laz.

Laz tries to get past her but she wants help and is very insistent so he brings her along. Laz and Josie get to the centre and Laz is betrayed by the little girl, who is D20 in disguise. He gets stabbed in the back again and D20 disappears. Laz and Josie investigate the chest, which has a gold coin in that grants a single wish. Laz gives the wish to Josie as long as she uses it on something he agrees with. She attempts to wish for herself into power and Laz under her but Laz intimidates her into making the wish so Laz is the top dog. They all go back, getting ice cream and then eating a buffet. Ron is fired by Josie but stays to eat buffet food. Laz explains his plan for the future – hell is too populated and many of the people coming to hell don't really deserve to be there. He will be using a loophole to shunt 5 mortals slightly in time so that when they should die and come to hell they instead come to hell without dying so he can send them back. He asks Josie to run hell while he focuses on this plan. Mark returns to the mortal realm to lend his luck to the mortals. Josie immediately becomes more sinister and Welsh with her new level of power and tries to murder Lynne. Laz sits back in his chair in his new office as everyone leaves, comfortable that hell is in good hands.

Outro Music

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qEdWvYA0icg>

EPISODE 49: MADNESS REIGNS - IN THE HALL OF THE MOUNTAIN KING

Rip blows a massive hole in the wall with his new weapon. Epic!. As the room shakes and parts of the ceiling starts to rain down us, I feel a dark presence closing in on us. Before I can say anything a huge part of the building starts crashing down around us. This is the inherent danger of not living in a hovel! At any moment you could be squished by the building itself! The giant mountain lizard, has come to say hello. Myron doesn't seem as keen as I expected.

The ceiling makes its second appearance of the night, we manage to crawl out, but where the fuck has Burnie gone! "This is our cue to go" aren't exactly the best epitaph, but sometimes that how it goes. Well there is no time like the present to waste looking for characters. Perhaps I could call on the big lizard guy to help us out. Everything is too heavy around here, why do people live underneath such big bits of stone! Riphard finds Burnies limp hand, probably not for the first time. Exmeh finds the door, but it seems stuck. I unstuck it with a mercury fulminate arrow, its pretty effective. Myron and Riphard drag out a bedraggled looking Burnie. Proof if ever it was needed of the danger or living in a massive palace tower.

I provide some options for the party, Myron is not happy with the giant lizard, and deems the giant sink hole as a bad option too. I think this is going to be the best, "Fucking Goblins always want to get in the shit" Riphard rudely states to Myron. "Its good for you Riphard, thats why they always put it on plants" Exmerahs elegant repost. Exmerah gets nothing but warbled static and mentions of a giant lizard from Delilah. Seems like good news to me. Yes yes, I say I jump backwards down into the hole, only to hit the wall hard. It was particularly painful. But seems like we are taking my second favourite plan. Obviously the first would be much more effective, especially when it came to smiting our enemies. But sewers it is I guess.

These are some pretty high quality sewers, if I was a sewer inspector, then I would be pretty impressed. Myrons natural instinct identifies that we should follow the flow of shit. I check with out latest iteration of Boss, and his lordship says no more scouting shinanigans for old lord olok. Its not so much that I'm in a huff, just I want to make sure nothing sneaks up on us.

Burnie is the master of turd spotting, perhaps it was a part of the book burner training. Martha certainly liked to use to add flavour to stews. . . We have a brief discussion about what happened to the cows, Myron. "Of course the cows, got away" says I only to be rebuffed by BossMan Big pants. The huge pile of shit in the middle of the room erupts and two shit covered ugly as frog/toad creatures emerge. "Jabba it inthe butt" classic Exmerah.

"Looks like its wednesday my dudes" Riphard says before unloading the hammer of the gods into one of them. Boom time toady mother crunchers. A beam of light is thrown from the pistol, lighting the room up, and filling it with the smell of acrid burning flesh. Exmerah blasts one, Stanri jumps on it, I take the knee and let fly a little arrow. Burnie ducks and rolls out of the way of one mega toady, and points back at him. Somehow this helps me realise I should shoot this one. As he is doing this he is narrowly missed by a giant slathering tongue. Getting eaten by one of these would be pretty unpleasant. The other toad turns on its belly and encases Stanri in its giant freaking mouth. Thats going to be hard to digest. Myron eyes up the giant beast, and then goes in with the pacifier. Very stabby. Rip quick switches his weapons and unloads a shell straight into one of the toads. It sinks in with a dull thud, as the toads skin crumples under the ballistic pressure.

Exmerah makes the first attempt to free Stanri, turns out shooting it really helped Stanri to get out of its mouth. As I knock and unload into the one burnie was shouting at. His dark highness then mimics my action and shoots the same fat toad. Again screaming at me to shoot it. A toad suddenly dissappears, only to reappear behind Exmerah, who luckily spots it in the shiny armour of Stanri, and manages to dodge its darting bite. Myron has had enough, and "fucking bursts it" one toad down. Exmerah and Rip then blow the last mega toad to pieces. The toads stomach is slapped open, and he spills his guts across the sewer.

Burnies broken gloves have clearly upset Exmerah, sometimes I think he is really rude, other times I see a shy broken child that never learnt to play with others. Either way his gloves won't be working for a little while. Exmerah gets Stanri to ping, and he opens to give out a large coil of metal. He now has a beef jerky flavoured snare, could be pretty good. She then feeds Stanri a healing potion, for someone so smart she probably should have realised it wouldn't work on a mechanical beast. Its time to go up

and face the world. It becomes clear from Myrons postulating that the possible death of the cows, clearly has hit him worse than I had previously thought. "I'm not sure if it can fly, but I am sure it can bleed". "If it can bleed, then we can kill it". Classic Gabrin talk

We emerge to a city that is collapsing in on itself. The armies are within the walls, and cutting down the enemy in swathes. The mega GoJira is still here, thank whatever gods really exist. The casual swing of its tail is knocking out a whole villages worth of city. This thing is what I wish I dreamed of being. Instead of that weird jungle slug.. Delilah has thankfully taken the skyship out of range and is circling from a large distance. So far I wonder how we will get up there. The cows are nowhere to be seen. But Myron seems to have a great plan. . . . We are going to mount the beast and run up it. The group don't seem so sure that its a great idea, so instead we call in on Delilah.

While ship wheels around, the dark presence is upon me again. We are getting bum rushed by all kinds of different people. Thankfully I recognise our ninja robot friends, less fortunately is a large red robed figure hovering in his own darkness above us. He is flanked by some church wardens. This could get nice and ugly pretty quickly, maybe I should have taken some health potions after all. . . The inquisitor warns us that we should have not come, it is time for some serious levels of deception. I reply in kind to the inquisitor "Yes Master", although to be honest I barely convince myself (nat 1 deception (-1)). Rip gets the end game off with a bang, flashing a cosmic beam of light straight through the Inquisitor. Sweet goblin Jesus, it looks like it actually hurt the bastard. Time to hide near Riphard. Burnie gets made into a pin cushion by the archers, as the heart thrust society starts swaning in, time for some sexy mecha ninja carnage.

Myron takes stock of the situation, before planting a kiss on Exmerahs head, who whisper back to "be brilliant". God they are the darndest cutest couple. She slaps a forcefield on me, and then melts back in a blur of movement. Somehow we will survive this, just as we survived all the others. Things look like they are going to be ok, until the the inquisitor sends long streaks of lightening from his fingers, frying Exmerah, Riphard, Burnie and I to a fine crispy finish. That has got to be one of the most painful things that has ever happened to me. Burnie the brave mother fucker, takes front and center and pulls the fire of the arbiters fire. God dam sometimes for someone with the psyche of a mal

adjusted child, I can really see what Martha saw in him. Maybe its just the recent bowt of lightening coursing through my veins but as he stands there in the open still smoking from his own dose of high voltage he looks ever inch the hero.

I step back behind the statue for cover and try to thin the crowd of attackers. I definitely hit that archer, but its to little avail as the "possibly friendly" Lizard stomps down on the house and building annihilating the poor poor person. Maybe he is on our team? The battle rages on around us, I have to say war has never been so much fun. Not really it is absolutely horrifying, no wonder people came back different in the Varg. Myron circles around the foot, then leaps majestically plunging his bayonet into the creatures foot. Is it time to climb onto our beast?? Could it be. . . .Exmerah tosses me a potion, and seems to be onboard with Myrons climbing plan. The inquisitor clicks his fingers and...Riphard snaps out of existence at the same time. This is going to be problematic. Burnie rushes back to see wtf happened to Riphard. I run to his aid, shoot a line into the monster to hook myself and Burnie in. At this point Delilah comes swooping in, and blows a cannon ball straight into the house behind the Inquisitor. The guy visible flinches as it all comes tumbling down behind him. At which point a beacon of light appears next to Burnie.

Myron holds on for dear life, clutching the his precious cargo of Exmerah close to his bosom. The leg has lifted, and is carrying them away as the he lets slip Exmerah. I asked one thing of him, and perhaps it was too much. She is falling perhaps to her doom, when Stanri launches to a few rockets at her, these latch onto her legs and she sticks the hard three point land. Crushing the pacing below her. Sweet Jesus what a cool little bitch she has become.

"What have you done, you have touched that which must not be harmed" Echoes through our minds, probably from the freaky scary guy. As his words cut through me, and his red glowing eyes come towards me. Its as if his voice has unlocked a part of me long forgotten, and I stand, no dangle 50 ft below the big friendly lizards frozen. Chaos ensues around me, but still I can feel his presence seeping deeper into me. I know nothing but the cold presence of fear. 'following records not witnessed by kolo the unwise'. The airship comes swooping down again, unleashing a ballista. Rubrix entices us to board again as it sweeps underneath the beast to retrieve us. As rope drops, from the airship, Rip wraps it around one arm, and lets fly

another beam of radiant light right through the side of his body.

As I come to I notice that everyone is milling around below us, I notice the ship and Rubrix standing on it beckoning to us all. Myron is hanging on for dear life above me, and below me is an ongoing war. I can't believe the airship has come so dam close to the foot. This is some kind of ace sky pilot of the future surely. Exmerah pulls out the cube and runs toward the Hearthrust team and Stanri, strangely nothing seems to happen. The inquisitor floats across the square finger outreached at Exmerah, a dark shadow rips forth from his finger and encompasses my sister. She collapses under the strain of his evil energies. Burnie bless his soul, once again plays the hero running to her aid. Stanri's reaction is a class act too, as he rains hell down upon the the inquisitor.

I come around and shoot another roped arrow into the airship. I have successfully attached the monster to the airship. Nothing could go wrong, except I am unable to dislodge the arrow from the monster. As the monster lifts its foot, over the airship Myron leaps down, and rolls out of the fall. So many hero moves today. Riphard tucks the rope under him, and while dangling from the airship levels the hammer of the gods at the Inquisitor a beam of searing light blasts forth into the evil man. Half of his body is blown away and an empty corpse falls lifeless to the ground. Team hearthrust grab the others and run for the rope, literally saving everyone bacon.

Myron blast the rope attaching me to the monster to pieces, letting me swing free. This is really not what I had in mind, but it was Myron's plan. . . Stanri rushes past to the rope scooping up the inquisitor. And clamping his jaws on the end of the rope. I have some stern words with Myron, about the dropping of my sister. "Hello boys, I think we have a bit of a monster lizard problem to solve" she says as she jumps over the side of the ship. Myron strides over to her and swings her in his arms.

Burnie appears with a set of cocktails, what a man! Myron unleashes the smoke machine, Delilah screams, and a spout of flame engulfs the entire ship. The purple flames envelop the ship, catching Myron and Burnie unaware. At which point a field of magical energy, surrounds the ship protecting it. Rubrix is giving his last to save us. "You must escape" and a large claw comes down to smite the airship, Rubrix bleeds from his nose and lets be honest a few other areas as well. He holds us close, and imparts the last gem of wisdoms to us "The best lessons are ones learnt by yourself" . He floats off the back

of the airship into the air itself. He envelops the monsters claw with a field of raw energy only he could manifest. "You must get back to Velterra" are his genuine epitaph, which isn't bad to be honest, considering a giant lizard totally destroyed him.

We sail of into the unknown once more. We also return to check on the the charred corpses of our comrades, who fortunately have not died. We rip his talons off his hands, and find a bankers note 1500 gp. We also find a note:

"These pawns must be stopped, Lazarus people are getting too close to success, Signed Kylon" Also has a spiky spiral symbol on it. I give it to you for one second and you break it" - Rip says as myron watches the letters disappear on the note paper. Myron peels back the mask, and reveals a mostly human face, except for a tentacled maw. "I'm sure the church can bleed too" says Exmerah as she ties the corpse to the front of the ship.

He dropped her

fade out to

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zf2aIVKp1OY>



EPISODE 50: THE BOYS ARE BACK IN TOWN

The flashbacks happen at night. A desperate struggle against a mountainous beast. The death of a mentor. Depression. 2 months. A burnt ship, barely airborne. Burnie ironically savaged by the fire he so loves and now more machine than man. Two gabrins, trying to figure out where to go now their master has gone. A dwarf pondering fatherhood. And a monster hunter who can't process the shit he just saw. A flight West to a place that we call home. Velterra.

We arrived in the Autumn to a landscape of beautiful purple trees. Hope's rest must have had a glorious Summer but it was cooling now. The banks of the river Eldon was dense with tents and stalls and we noticed the sounds of happy children and drunken revellers enjoying the evening. The Light of Eladoon festival in full swing. Riphard was giddy with anticipation for the business opportunities. A large billboard came into view as we descended to towards the roof of the book burners building, Derek Bodacious' handsome face and waving arm greeting us home and doing the good work of advertising functional yet reasonably priced banking services.

As we brought our stuff into the firehouse we saw that our teams had acquired many new members and a lot of faces looked unfamiliar. Kolo got to work immediately reasserting his authority. Archibald came to meet us. The months had not been kind to him, his previously withered face looking greyer and more leathery. Burnie fondly reminded him of the time he lost his sexual organs from torture and his wife left him. Get over it Archie. Myron re-introduced himself to Archie. He didn't seem to realise that a third of the people who left had not returned. We took a moment to remember fish wanker, taker of several penises. Riphard took a moment to describe his 'business stroke' to Myron, which involved a chain of restaurants serviced by buxom women called 'Hope's Chest'. It is acknowledged to be a fair plan but is dismissed fairly quickly. Myron feels it is more pressing to discuss the imminent threat of the Church who very probably realise that we are back in town. He stressed the importance of clandenisity and allies. He withdrew a list from his pocket that had people on it that a) might not kill us and B)amenable to the cause, and c) owes him favouroo. He had drawn the pictures of the people to make it easier to find them. Riphard spent some time discussing the finer points of shell companies. Everyone Kolo knows goes

away in the end. I gave Burnie back the leg that had grown in his arm that we cut off when he was in his drug episode thing.

Lady Kiros had been off searching for the miracle metal, Excalibrium. It was decided that it might be a good idea to try and catch up with her to see if her investigations had proven fruitful. Burnie had heard of the Pastor on the list. He was a misogynist who had made use of the Jennies and had been sent to the far west to get him out of reach. As far as Burnie was aware, Wapsy was still in with the church and was probably near the tower of the 7. He also knew the Captain of the deep watch, the naval facility. The Captain was nicknamed "the unsatiable", constantly out fighting the dark elves, a half elf herself with a taste for men. Missing, presumed lost after crashing her ship into a dark elf trading outpost. Lillian had survived using her famous trick 'two goblins in a coat'.

Archibald rudely interrupted us all to let us know that we should go and see Derek (the man who has started more businesses than he has failed) and receive his 'bad news'. Riphard ran as fast as his little legs would take him. I sent Stanri to go and see his makers and Myron settled into his new room. When we were ready we put on our super secret outfits (I gave Myron his false moustache and hip clothes and just like that "Jem Banbango" was born) and headed to the banking district.

The guild of coin was much busier and we noticed that there was an increased number of bank branches around the town. We fought through conga lines and several parties to get to the guild. Riphard was already there. The room was full of young men shouting loudly into bricks about prisons. Riphard flashed his gold card and got us in at the front desk. Riphard insisted that Bobacious would meet him in the lobby, a clear power play. The secretary returned and told him to stop dicking about. We were led upstairs to meet the newly-toupeed Bobacious. He took a moment to find his voice. Derek informed Rip that the bank was doing very well and expanding very quickly making good use of making money off other people's money. Derek said it had all been a bit much for him having to do it all on his own. The bad news: Derek admitted that we had lost control of the Guild of Gary. He described how it had developed into a cult and a young woman had got very dedicated and taken control. The girl: Garbigail. A plot twist. She had lost her fiance, survived death from poisoning, beaten chicken aids, and had spoken to Gary and her dead sister, which had

empowered her to try and take over a cult. We added the guild to the allies(?) list. Bobacious beckoned Rip to take up the helm of his enterprise once more and let him return to his main passion of being a face. He also mentioned that Kiros was alive which was wonderful news and that we should send a Raven to the tavern where we saw her last, The Duck and Iron. Burnie noted that he looked like he had excessive skin, much like a summer scrotum. He was cheered by the idea of a music festival centred on him. "OOOOHHHHH DEEEREK BOBAAACIOUSSS". Rip pressed him gently on the profits of the bank. Good was the answer. Time to move on.

While discussing the finer points of the Gary guild, we remembered our sweet shoe sponsorship deal and Myron expressed a desire to get involved. I remembered the advice the shoe salesman told us and clicked my heels together three times. No shit, three minutes later a little boy turned up with a cart and told us to get in. Off to the shoe-h-q.

The receptionist greeted us and led us into a room where we met a familiar old face surrounded by excessive arm waving. Ralph Businessman in the flesh and bones. He said that pretty much everywhere we had been they had observed a massive increase in shoe sales. Burnie told Kolo about his mapophilia. He asked us if we wanted new shoes. We said yes. He showed us the gaudiest pair of trainers we had ever seen, solid gold in cheap plastic with little white wings that he claimed would let people basically fly, but not too much. The new "The name-of-the-company air" range. Edit: "The gaudy air" range. Riphard daydreamed a little about investing in the company. Burnie asked for a little disabled shoe too that might make him a little faster. Ralph offered him plenty of option including the ones that were all the rage with the new sports ball players. Burnie just couldn't make up his mind at all. We stood there and waited for like half an hour while he made little notes on a piece of paper and cut open a chicken and looked at its intestines and then left the room and had a very depressing and overloud conversation with himself about what he was doing with his life. He picked. Myron got some special anti-falling shoes. Everyone endurance shoes got better and i got better at acrobatics.

We went to 'Edgar's Ravens' and got a raven to send to Kiros. "Kiros we have returned. Meet us in the usual location. Hope all is well. How did that thing turn out that time? from Myron and Gang :) ". We sent the raven. That was all the

errands done.

We had a couple of days to ourselves. I took Myron round all the cool places in town that I thought he might like like the avocado toast place and the one with the baby unicorns you could pet and the vape shop with the water that gets steamed with flavours and you inhale it. It was nice to spend a little time with him. We hadn't talked that much since the death. . . .

My lab was doing well. Lots of screws everywhere and Jiznak had even sold some, an enterprising fellow indeed. Apparently our labs had made 5,000,000 gp profit but I didn't Rippy to feel jealous so we arranged for it to be donated to lemon farmers and Kolo and I paid off our "loan" that we had taken out. Kolo spent some time making candy apples full of special kolo horse sleepy go night night powder, possibly for the festival. We all spent one night at the carnival which was fantastic if not a bit brief. We had games and gambling and fun and music.

We got to the day when we were meant to meet Arbiter Kiros so we all headed down to the Duck and Iron. They were still grateful to us for our heroics and everyone seemed to remember us very well so they gave us free drinks which was lovely of them all things considering. Kiros and Rickon turned up after a couple of hours. Rickon was dressed down, all casual like. Kiros looked not great and had a big scar on her face which was because of the church. Myron was very happy to see her. Bit weird considering we're all still recovering from our trauma but ok. Was quite a long hug. She told us her story. In the time that we had been gone she had tried to go and see the other arbiters and to get them onto our side. Topaz was not willing to change away from the church. She had managed to get Brockenhall and Jilez. Myron approved. They are still operating undercover, but Myron pointed out that everything had clicked into place for the church now. Kiros took a moment to be overwhelmed by Rip's gun, never expecting to see such a treasured artefact in the metal. Kiros thought she had managed to track down some Excalibrium. It was in the Tom'ardy mountains! Riphard remembered that he actually knew this. It came from a meteorite and embedded itself in the mountains of Tom'ardy and she thought that maybe some of the mine shafts went close to the deposits. Riphard solemnly relayed the fact that unfortunately Excalibrium and methane gas were highly explosive after a number of excited dwarves farted in a mine and killed themselves. The dwarves are a gassy species. In fact, the natural gasses caused by the dwarves has led to a local micro-climate at the top of the mountains

where greenery is plentiful thanks to the heat trapping effect of the atmosphere. The idea was put forth that we could use Rippy to get access to the mines, but Myron pointed out that he was supposed to be dead. Rip gave some teasers about his origin. Myron optimistically enquired about the Varg joining us but Kiros shrugged it off. These guys seem to have quite the history together. Cool. Burnie asked about Killjoy, he's been wondering around the great expanse having intercourse with tiki tuks. Kolo agreed that recruiting the Varg might not be a good idea. He was concerned that Kiros was now our only ally but was also in open rebellion which might not play out well for any of her other associates. Kiros was shocked to hear that the church had armed an entire city in masuda. And about the monster mountain. Hope the tom-ardy mountains don't have a crazy monster in them hahahahahahahahahahahahah nervous laugh ahahahahaha. We decided the next move was the tom'ardy mountains with a side quest of not dying. Kiros said she'd keep trying to find new allies for us. Kiros decided they were going to have drinks. I thought I better get back to the lab. Sometimes people just need to let off a little steam right? Burnie and Kolo walked me back. I spent the evening cataloging the screws. I didn't cry.

The next morning we loaded up the airship and set off to the Tom'ardy mountains.

Epilogue:

Archibald had been through a lot of shit these last few months. The bird-man attack, the building almost being burned down by the Gary Guild takeover, the hemorrhoids. He thought that by now he'd seen it all. But when that yellow man stepped of the airship he knew that his life had just been changed forever. "AHARRO I AMA DAISUKE. IT ISS MY PREASURE TO MEET YOU". It was like an arrow had hit him in the chest. The way his brown hair lay so close to his face. The nubile boyish body. The slanted eyes. He realised in that moment that he had never really been in love before.

They made sex for the first time that night. Daisuke took pictures the whole time. Afterwards they lay in eachothers arms and just listened to the other's breathing, feeling their sweat-sodden skin rubbing pleasurably against themselves with every micro movement. Archibald had never been happier nor had he ever been harder. Round two was a mistake. Archibald could tell that as soon as he had made his first thrust. Something was different this time, it was rougher, more distant, like a sports-ball kicked wide of the hoop-net. He

noticed that Daisuke had tears on his face. Archibald stopped and Daisuke left the room. Had he said something wrong? Had his body mistranslated his lust into some more sinister emotion that Daisuke's tender rectum had internalised and let fester like the negativity his father had bestowed upon him as a child? How could this perfect thing have become tarnished so quickly.

When Archibald woke up the airship was gone, along with Daisuke.

EPISODE 51: MAKING A LIST

O GARY

The death of sensei has been hard, in fact so has been pretty hard. Only for a short period did I think we would be able to tame the beast of my dreams and nightmares. With such a thing we could lay the world low, and crush infidels where they stood, but you would have been against such things. Somehow you saw the good, where I could not. It is times like this when I miss you the most old old friend.

I was the blood from my hands, its become a cleansing ritual over the last week. Eat, sleep, repeat. The cycle is over now though, as we touch down in the Tom Ardy mountains. A bountiful land, full of Jeffs, and flowing water. The high methane levels are very high, and it seems to be affecting us all. Riphard keeps talking about how we gabrins are just going to end up as delvers. Esmerelda Quartz is born out a magical stone egg. Noscopy Limestone will be enough for me to pass as a dwarf. Disguises complete we head out to meet some rather noisy gold spear wielding guards.

Sum total of Riphards knowledge of this place

Aunt Lazuli possibly mad
Uncle Targon reprobate bit of an adventurer
BlackSmith doesn't do real work, but buys work in. Tree DoorStone Fist
Ex GF Denay Cocksure, bit of lass
Favourite Pub The Short is Right, owned Jim Mansfield
Sheanus RockGrinder politician

The guards seem pretty calm about the giant airship at first, and simply tell us to park it elsewhere. Its only through talking with them for over 10 seconds that I realise that they are complete arseholes, and that possibly Tom

Hardy mountains are rule by ****RACIST, BIGOTED, RICH, WORKSHY, SLAVERS**** and that perhaps it would be safer to cleanse this place. A small voice in my head agrees that this is a most excellent idea. Its not your voice Gary, though many a time I wish it had been.

Exmerah comes off the boat and throws some serious freaking shade! Back from gallivanting around the world Exerah Quartz has returned with her retinue. Glorb Styron, Arbiter first class, is here for security. Bernald Sanders the paige boy. Thankfully not a half elf, but also thankfully he will die soon. These guards really are racist swine! Luckily these guards are such idiots because this isn't making a lot of sense to me. Exmerah kindly offers to allow the guards to beat Bernald the slave. Sadly they are on duty, otherwise would have gone for it. If anyone else touches a hair on Bernald I will gut them like the balloon cows we over inflated. Bernald is my play thing, and not for general consumption.

Riphard decides that Delilah, who is now a beach ball, would be much safer aboard the airship. This solves the issue of her meeting his ex girls, and keeping the airship safe. Pretty shrewd Rips. I ask about shopping opportunities and have to skirt around the ****slave**** issue again, but am directed to a market place where hopefully I can get the animals I need for further testing.

It transpires that Riphard is dead, and in the news has been passed all over the Tom Hardy Mountains. Luckily it was only his neighbours house that went up in flames.... After a brief discussion of why the dwarves still use stone for their tabloids we move on to Bronson market.

On the way we have a big discussion about when to emancipate the slaves. For a change it seems that everyone is on board with this task, and its given high enough priority that we might actually do it. Although not so high as we get to do it now. On arrival to the market, it is a huge glitzy well maintained bazaar, with overpriced shit everywhere. The walkways are too thin to fit many people in, and its overcrowded as fuck. Also I notice that most shops are selling the same shit. Everything is covered in gold, but it doesn't seem that anything is actually made here, just all bought in. When I try to buy a cow a couple of pigs and a chicken the fucktard doesn't even know what they are. Apparently meat just arrives here!

Myron needs some smithing, for his very hard penis. Its a pretty place, as is the blacksmith, although its bereft of any real smithing tools or a forge. Other than a backlit paper mache forge.

Styrofoam is on official business and after some kind of halberd. Spiro wants a polearm but with a shorter pole, so like a short polearm. The blacksmith says that the stabby part of his shotgun is utter tosh, the church has done him no favours. A Halberd from him could really help out. Myron pulls out his Journal, its a heartfelt rendition of how things have been going. Myron gets something that should be only for Halberds of Dunkirk, Its called peaky blinder, because it's shiny. No discount to the church here. This place blows goats.

Rips Uncle has become a Delver, Seaumus RockGrinder is the Bane of his existence, is now running a lot of the show around here. Lillian is somewhere around here. Who the fuck is Lillian? Exmerah has been working on the Rubrix Die, and has a unlocked some inspiring stuff.

After much discussion on the length and girth of dwarven members, we go to meet a stock trader by the name of Denay. Rips blags his way into her office. The room is full of awful portraits of her and the family. She thought Rip died in a massive house fire. But maybe that was the other house, or the summer home.

What the snikkety snaky side dick is going on around here. His dick gets stuck in the robe, but once its all the way out the reflection in the gold robes makes it look twice as thick. Nothing strange going except for the black robed human woman. As all humans look the same, hard to know if it was she looked like Myrons stick figure drawing or not. Either way she was looking for something secret down below, that isn't her vajazzles.

Burmie is dwarfkin. That only makes it worse. RockGrinder is still a prick. The ginger piece of shit. Slimy politician bastard has been blackmailing Dinner plate. Rips uncle is a sad old bastard who is ashamed of losing all three of his family members. He has donned the black and gone down the mines. Nobody has ever come back from being a delver.

Lady Quartz has been far and wide getting slaves, and exploring new mining prospects. She grabs the nearest guard who sorry for himself does not know who she is. She demands that she is taken to the mayors office.

Somehow it all goes wrong and ends with the guards being called, and Burnie insinuating they are here for a police bust on the mayor and his paedophilic ways. Burnie finally gets the beating he deserves, but from someone else, I would say this is the final straw, but some dwarf fuck pulled that a while ago. As six of them maul him, while the other two try and eject us. I try to get

her name on the list. Lady Quartz then goes to try and make an appointment. Tomorrow afternoon is the first appointment, however we are not going to go to that one! Burnie miraculously recovers from being beaten to the floor, enough to jump up and screams running at the door about how what his face is kiddy fiddler.

Rip takes the lead and returns to meet the mayor himself. After a short wait, he is allowed to meet mayor crock grime. Unbearded ginger dwarf with a purple robe, and a big gold chain around his neck. The Hardstone properties have fallen into disrepair.

When his uncle took to being a delver he lost all rights, and lost all eligible rights. To go and see his uncle he needs to fill out a visitors form, THIS GUY HAS TO DIE. While he is looking into the cabinet for the right forms, he spots Rips pouring poison into his drink. HE declines the drink as its no good for his gout. He convinces the secretary to hand deliver the form, while flashing a bit of dick. She recoils having seen his regular dick, not the show dick.

Myron and I both hate this place. Its decided that the whole of the tom hardy needs to be destroyed. Myron is super keen to go down into the mines. Stanri is diggin a hole in the middle of the street, throwing dirt everywhere.

We get to pub, it super hip, the stools are uncomfortable, and the tables are too small. The barkeep is not serving any shots, just cocktails. Burnie detonates the cocktail using the sparkler, its super dry and bitter. Rip buys a a Mad Max Fury road cocktail.

AS an aside it turns out that Burnie pisses with an erection and frequently gets it all over Myron, who has to watch. PTSD is a bad bitch to have to handle.

The dwarves are so rich, that there is literally no work for people, even the slaves just sit about doing nothing.

We get rooms, but they are all based on tom hardy pop stars. The forms are delivered by someone working for the secondary mayor Humphrey Pinkle Winkleton. Burney gets the guards numbers that were chasing him before 80081355 and 10000001.

Myron pitches his tent outside the front of the pub. Rips is up late filling out a form. Exmerah is digging with Stanri. Burnie goes off to the dentist.

I make the list, and check it twice, every-bodies naughty and nobodies nice. Its

certainly not like it used to be Gary, and for that I am sorry. For what I do tomorrow.....

EPISODE 52: EXME'S TUBE SAVES THE DAY AND ANYONE WHO DISAGREES PROBABLY FUCKS CHILDREN

Diary of Herbert the Dwarven Pervert and Voyeur Extraordinaire

orning broke. I sat watching them all from across the street, sat in my tree that i like to think of as my wife. I watched them wake up, eating their sausages, playing with their documents. tHe boy goblin walked outside, his little pale muscles glistening teasingly in the sun. Through my binoculars I could see that they had a list covered in curious little pictures. The lady goblin spent some time comforting the machine that had spent all night digging, sending waves of vibrations up through the ground into the tree and thus into my genitals. I slunk away into the shadows and had a wank.

Diary of Exmerah

Hello Diary. What a day. We wooke up and saw a dwarf masterbating. We chased him off and I noticed he had dropped a dokument that was plans for some crazy kind of unnderground tunnel train and also a very small underwtaer tube drwaing that had a drawing of a disturbingly anatomically accurate child in it. Weird. Rippy wanted soem potitons form kolo so he gave him some. And I got one too because i am favorite sister and he is a very good bruther. Burnie came out and doged some arrows. Burnie tried to play but none was bothered. We went to them mines

A flash, then blackness, as if the universe were no more for eterntiy. No sound. No light. Forever. It was like we did not even exis...

"We've comee to inspekt the mine", said rippy cleverly. A modern classic. Myron poitned out that we had propoer papers to get in so we gave them aover and he lets us in. The dawarf man kindly explained to me that the difference betwewen caves and mines is that caves are natural and mines are dwarf made. Intriiuging indeed. Rippy was our guide and pointed out all the different types of stone like chalk. We desended deeper into the mine and we didnt see meny people. iT took like an hour to get down. Whne we got close to the bottom there was little fire and three dwarfs all around in playing muscis and the lady was being fat. Myron sturk up a converstaion "you delvers?" he said charmingly. The dwarf just wanted to live his life. Gunther shale was a younger dwarf who didnt have abeard because he set fire to his wife and

was cast out here as punishment. Myron told him that he resentedd society but the man said he really just wanted to set fire to more womans. Myron was tryngto emacipate him. I told kolo to give him the emasipayshun leaflet "So u have decided to be emanshipated". The dwarfs were worried about being executed. Kolo gave rippy gud advice about turning herats and minds such as not calling people doosh bags. We walked away without asking any names not even knowing where we was going because we are tha cool.

Kolo looked for moer peepl. We found none so we went back. Kolo went back ito ask them important questions like wher is people? He said some were around. I asked the fat lady what they were mining and she said there was just a lot of things and even some vaults downstairs. Apparently you cannot have too many dwarves in one mine because of the meefane problems. Kolo axed about the star metal but they did not even know anything about it. The fat lady said she hadnt burned any women, she just got sent down here beause she is fat. Rippy pointed out that she was actually having a wait problem not a wait problem and she was caught waiting for a cake. Rippy tries to make everyone wait but she just starts crying. Burnie asked about lillith. THEY DID remmeber her from a while ago maybe even a year ago so a long time and last the fat lady heard was she went downsatirs to the restricted section. She gave us the directioons to the camp "last gasp camp". We also found about rockfall camp and boulder camp (formerly ross camp) too. I told the group about my plan to make a loop of vacoom and send stanri down it realy hyper fast but we decided it could never work. Just a pipe dream I guess. Myron questioned whether or not I was a woman. This confused me. I mean. . . What did he think I was? Oh well time to go into the mines more!! I ran away really fast with my arms behind my back with such excitement!

We met another dwarf. Kolo tried to recruit him to come with us. He was named derek. He came with us. He had been here 80 years and did not know who the mayor is. We walked along with him and chatted about just delver things. Kolo shared his three pronged plan. 1. Flnd money. 2. Emanshipashun 3. Find metal. He told us about the cryptic metal they had found that had a big explosion a while ago but also it has stabilised now. I tried to suurvey the mine with stanri but no luck. I tried to offer people apples but they were all mushy and horride. This is bad because I have been absent mindedly eating these for a long time now. I got rid of all the mush. Everyone made small talk with derek.

Rippy was angered by the delver lecturing a hardstone about rocks. The day passed

We got to rockfall camp. 8 tents. A couple of carved hovels. Myron emanshipated them with his speech and the others came out to greet us and receive the blessing of freedum. It was very hot. Myron asked again about where lillith was. She isn't even that pretty in the picture so I'm not sure why hes so bothered but sound slike she would be useful against the church. The dwarf lady delver was not so keen on our message but she offered us some tea that was nice. Where did she get the milk we wondered? Probably her own lactation most likely. The lady recongised rippy as a hardstone and he knew his uncle who was downstairs. She revealed a key piece fo information, there is a hardstone old family volt. We could find out more at the last gasp.

We went downstairs some more and it got warmer and warmer. We got to another camp with a blacksmith and a legless man and a soer women. I emancipated them very well. He took the leaflet and everything. Rippy asked about his uncle. The blacksmith said he knows him and gets on fine but hes having a freindly grumble. The uncle was looking for the fmaily vault but histroy sometimes forgets wehre to put things. The dwarf said ther were gribblys to be found downstairs. He could not eleaborate. And traps he said. I almost gave the plot away with my dwarf disguise when i said it was too hot but he belived me when i explained it was just my womanly brain overheating. Myron asked again about lillith and the guy said she is always here. She last went downstairs 3 days ago quote "looking for somethign". He drew us a map to where she might be. He was concerned about his friend who only had one leg. Rippy went to help him not die and came to the conclusion that the man's problems was his leg was gone. Rippy cupped his crotch and breathed a sigh of relief as he confirmed that his falluses were still there. I decided to help my giving him a 6 ft long evacuate metal tube. I was sure this was the key to helping him. Rippy was clearly pleased and said he would be veru useful. He asked the man how he lost the leg agians and he said it was a besasty with teeth and 8 legs. He said the tube was helping. Kolo started surgeying the man, cutting away all the flesh and then he lit a thing on fire and put the fire on the mans leg and quartered him. I stuck the wood leg that burnie used to have into his stump and it was a tremendous success all around. I used a spare joke leg to hit the wood in deeper. I gues we can't use the joke leg for burnies birthday party any more :(the srugery was success. Well done all

excpet for burnie who didnt really help and just complained that my tube didnt work. Pretty shure he fucks kids.

We continued downsatiars into the deeper deep. A werid combination of natural caves and dwarf made mines. Rippy declared it a cave iwthin a mine. Makes sens. Eventually we came to the location that was pointed out. Kolo found a pair of dwarven tracks and we followed them to an open door goin into a chamber. Rippy told him to be careful cos of the triksy dwarfs. Kolo looked in and saw that ther was a n open pit Kolo peered into the pit. Rippy headr a voice and he called out and it was actually his uncle Tarragon!!! What a lovely surprise for Rippy. He was not in the pit after som einitial confusion but then it turned out he was over across the way from the pit. Kolo shot a piton over the pit and me and kolo went over (I tried anyway) fortunately stanri was also bridge mode activate. The older dwarf looked just like rippy only older. He was more mottled. Th uncle was surpirese that rippy was alive and he wished that he had told him to save him the hassle of coming donw here. The uncle told us about his youthful heroin adventures and taught us all an important lesson about not losing your life to drugs. He asked us to help him not to die. This was because he had a bolt through his tummy. We decied to keep the bolt in and give hi a potion to make him feel better. Rippy thought it was not worht giving him the potin but it seemed like maybe we should and rippy was probs doing "bantz". We gave him soem beff and poshun and then kolo snapped the bolt off to help him walk. Now he was feeling better rippy gently asked him what he was doing here. He said he was lookign for riches and weapons from the hardstone vault. Uncle said that his family was imporatnt to him and that they only came up to the surface a generation ago. He was born in the dark. Rippy's father and he wehr the last to be born ther in a family with the terasures and they became waelthy on the surface but had along heritage down below. Rippy thought ther emust be a reason for abandoing. Uncle thought it was time to joint he people upstairs. Rippys grandmda siad the vault had some of the best weapons ever and we were in the entracne to said vault! He said some racist things about gabrins and kolo pulled the bolt out. He thought that the man had 20 minutes to live. Rippy revelaed our secret. Kolo decided that he had learned his lesson so he plunged a flaming sword into the wound that the man had had. He succeeded. Bernie was not helping because he was looking at all the naughty pictures of dwarfy ladies on the wall. Burnied decied mayeb to help. The

uncle passed out but he would live. We decided to have a little rest here while he recovered. But as tarragon fell into unconsciousness he said "Riphard. . . I am. . . ." then he fell asleep then he woke up and he said "definitely not you father and I'd hate to be because I like just being friends." Heartwarming :)

Epilogue:

No-one is last gasp would have noticed what was happening at the time. They had all gone to bed after the excitement of the day, the strange dwarf that looked like a hardstone, the arbiter and the two goblins dressed as dwarves who had come in like a wrecking ball and inserted a wooden stick into their colleagues stump. Still it has saved his life so what did they have to complain about. But in the dim, dying campfire light, something magical was happening. The tube lay motionless since it could not move. The artificial joke leg also lay motionless, staid by the same impotent lack of motion that the tube knew only too well. But even as they lay there, unable to move or live or think, they both could feel it. The electricity between them was something they had never felt before. The tube had only been created mere hours before, the leg a little earlier as part of a drunken bet and a joke probably gone to far. The leg lay there. The tube lay there back. What was this life of misery to which they were cursed, laying mere inches away from each other but destined never to touch, to caress, to know the warmth and love that the other had to offer. A cruel trick of fate perhaps. Or just the way of the universe. The leg exploded with a force of 40 tonnes of TNT, a gross miscalculation from the rotten apple addled brain of its creator. No-one in Last Gasp was left alive.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AE1ct5yEuVY>

EPISODE 53: VAULTED FEELINGS

Recap - left the tavern, took a long time to get to the mine. Got to the mine. Went down into the depths - met some delvers - tried to recruit them. No dice. There's 3 settlements/shitholes/townships/smallerthanthat places down here - tent towns. Went and picked up a miner (nopaedo). Met an old lady that made them tea. Tried to get her to rebel against the upper world. Riphard's uncle and Lilith are both down here. Went to a camp, talked to a blacksmith - told them where L and RU (Targon Hardthrust) had been. Old hardthrusts lived

under the earth, found a vault-type-thing. Targon had an arrow in his belly.

We're in a mine! How'd we get here?! Oh that's right. Gotta stop day-dreaming. There's a smell of burned flesh. . . Ah - Kolo gave the Dwarf-man (Targon) some field medicine. Learning from the best. We chingwag with the old Hardstone, (or was it hardthrust?) and put him on Stanri - This is a Hardstonethrust vault of some description. Stanri becomes a bridge over some dodgy chalksidian (obsidian disguised to look like chalk - Riphard). so that we don't fall into the bowely below. Kolo and Myron walk into an obviously trapped room. See no traps. Open a trapped chest. Get locked into the room and gassed. Myron beasts it, Kolo almost dies. Riphard farts on Kolo to hope it works. Exme shocks the Kolo. He gets better.

We find a gap. I fail to throw the bear across it, old age must be getting to me. Myron walks on air with his fancy shoes, and holds a rope. Kolo climbs the rope across, but Myron fails and we almost lose Kolo, save for Bearvine intervention. We leave Myron to his fate, trapped on the island, and me and Exme and Riphard go to a room with dwarvern characters - which I can read! Ma and Pa always said that dwarvish was useful, I figured it was just one of those national pride things, and kinda resented them for making me learn it. Guess it's not so dumb now!

There's a mural with sentences, and runes on the floor. One of those "don't step on the cracks" things - and also all the wrong runes as there's poison darts everywhere. I go looking for a chest Myron stole earlier to create a shield and brute force the puzzle, until Exme points out that there's spelling errors in all the names. Lapin, Ametryst, Paradot, Oryx, Garnot. Derp. We step the pattern of "Shine". (because there wasn't an E near after the H. Kolo pulls the lever. And then runs through the dart trap. . . Shoddy dwarven constructions - should have switched off the countermeasure once the puzzle was solved!

We get to a hole. Myron shouts down it. A tentacle completely fails to grab him. Welp, that happened. We come to an area with slippery emerald. Wait, glass with a weird liquid. Super slippery, down into the spikes we go! Stanri breaks our falls! We go to a chamber with a statue. The statue comes alive. It slows the balls out of me and Myron - Exme blows the fuck out of it - I'm dodging in place. Exme uses the die to buff all our stuff. It wasn't needed. Riphard kills it.

We go into a chamber and find gold and weapons. Targon is racist. Kolo kills him and

starts eating his liver. I shock him - He's gone feral! I drag Targon's corpse away to loot and dispose of - why does every culture cannibalise their dead? I get a good whip+1/+1 - Really nice hand crossbow (+2/+2) and a fancy cloak. Then me and kolo dump his body into the tentacle well. I pretend to eat a chunk, smearing blood on my chin, Dwarf cannibal tradition. Loads of cash, like 7k, 3k of that in gems, and a bunch of axes and things. Couple nice crossbows +2/+2, and about 3 waraxes +1+1, with some less good stuff.

We go back to the last gasp camp and confuse the blacksmith, and the guy with a dodgy leg. We sleep, some people cry for Kolo, no one cries for Rips uncle. It's an uneasy rest. We go in search of Lillith in the morning. We eventually get to a mining camp, and get ambushed by mongoloids. Wait, no, troglodytes. We kill them quickly. Stanri is a train. We come across a pair of dicks, gas-breathing Gorgons. They breath hot gas at us. Kolo starts getting stoned. Kolo is no longer stoned. We focus the right-side. Myron, me and Rip start turning to stone - I shrug it off.

I slice the first (already weakened) one to bits, Stanri demolishes the second. We've got two stoned companions. Lilith is barrel. She tells us there's an under-mine that might have the excalibur. But we've got two stone-shaped companions to try and help out.

EPISODE 54: HEART OF STONE, HEART OF DARKNESS

Riphard Hardstone is hard stone. Myron is iron.

Lillith sounds different this week. She has an awkward conversation with Bernie. She is happy to learn of Pilch's death. She makes lots of weird european sounding noises. She suddenly turns posh British.

She doesn't want to turn the stone people back to people. Bitch. She's much more interested in the excallabrum. They talked about the unhinged Kolo and how he ate a person.

Exme tends to Myron's statue. They load Rip and Myron into Stanri's butt.

Exme and Lillith have a passive aggressive bitch-off. Lillith wins.

The group near the sunlight for the first time in days. Two guards block their exit/entrance. Lillith pretends to be a gruff miner and presents a poor mining paper forgery. They explain we're not allowed to come out, we're delvers now. Riphard would be super annoyed by this if he wasn't made of stone. Emotionally.

The goblin's threaten the guards, but there's a bunch of them and they're not having it. Kolo draws his bow. Exme explains the Targon situation. The guards focus their crossbows on Kolo. There's more back and forth. It's an impasse. Lillith then tries to be Targon Hardstone, WHAT A TWIST, convincing the guards the group are too dangerous to be in the mines. Rip and Targon "subdued" the "savages", but he got turned to stone somehow, and no one's quite sure what's happening.

The guards aren't sure, but continue to block the way, as Targon is also a delver. Targillith finally manages to talk xer way through saying xe'll be back once the group are safely in jail.

Exme contacts Delilah via earpiece. Delilah and Daisuke have been captured and the ship stolen. Kolo relishes the chance to kill some more dwarves. Lillith wants to get in on the mayorcide.

The group track Delilah down using Exme's secretly installed trackers. Kolo beats Daisuke. Exme unties Delilah. Kolo revives Daisuke and begins torturing him for information, convinced he's a spy. The mayor is a cunt as we all knew, and needs to die. But not because Delilah told us to. Because Daisuke did. Exme get's annoyed at being corrected all the time (PMS).

Lillith reveals Daisuke is not a spy for the church, but is working for her "associates". She

says she can introduce us. She is working for/with Kiros. Who is part of the church. But not the bad part. Maybe.

The group heads off to kill the mayor. Exme questions Lillith's sudden knowledge and apparent leadership role. (Problem with female authority, classic self-hating feminist). Exme apologises and offer's her a (potentially explosive) ear-piece. Kolo suddenly hates Bernie for some reason.

The group arrives at the mayor's place. "We're here to kill the mayor" says Lillith. Bernie gives the guards a touching pep talk to encourage the mention to courageously abandon their posts, rather than protecting a known nonce. They bolt.

The group does some tactics, goblins up the dies, rest in the door. The receptionist triggers some bullshit and the group is set upon by a group of weary hungry slaves.

Bernie does a great speech, totally ruining Exme's big entrance. The slaves look hesitant, but at the guard's threats and insistence continue hobbling towards the group and their inevitable doom.

The goblins are all from Yorkshire now? Ah, of course, they're speaking goblin. Exme doesn't have the same raw charisma as Bernie, who is a tough act to follow. The slaves mostly ignore her.

Kolo swings through the window with his bow drawn... somehow. It looks badass though. He headshots one of the dwarven slavemasters.

Lillith jumps on the reception desk "THE REVOLUTION STARTS NOWWWWW". She then stabs the receptionist in the head, killing her instantly twenty times over.

The human slaves stumble forward and jab wildly at most people. Slaves are expectedly shit though, so they don't register a single stab. The remaining guard looses a bolt at Exme.

The goblin slaves do a variety of shit, with one attacking Kolo and some attacking the dwarf slavemaster.

Delilah shoots the remaining guard with a beguiling bolt. He gives Delilah a loving, forgiving look as he crumbles to the floor, dead. The slaves back off, and Kolo shoots a human slave dead. In case you forgot he is a dick.

There's something outside the mayor's building, but the group aren't sure what. Kolo leans through the window. They're attacking us with our own airship! Delilah admits she used "admin123" as a password to the control system.

The rest of the mayor's house is empty. Fuck. The group deduces the cunt mayor must be on the airship. Kolo notices the boarding rope is still dangling to the plaza the aircraft is hovering above.

The building shakes under fire from the airship canon again. The ancient stones begin to crack. They were not built to withstand airship bombardment.

Kolo thirsts for innocent dwarven blood. The group agree to Lillith's party splitting plan because they always go so well. The group remembers they have a short range teleportation device. This is included in the plan. This all sounds very familiar, yet different.

The group arrives at the plaza. Some stealthily, some less so. They admire the choice of slaves and the whacky flailing inflatable goblin slaves and dwarf dicks.

There's like 10 guards, who instruct the slaves to attack the stealthless Exme, Stanri, and Delilah.

Exme triggers the teleportation successfully, just! Exme, Stanri, and Delilah blink onto the airship. The stealthy assault on the slave market begins as Kolo, Lillith, and Bernie slink into the market square.

Bernie hooks a guard in the ass from stealth, but misses. The guard notices and he tries to play it off as seeing a loose screw. He then makes a very successful hook attack. Lillith follows up by one-hit murdering a guy. She makes another hilarious speech of freedom.

On the ship Stanri conducts a smellalysis to hunt down the cunt mayor. Exme casts a portable forcefield on Delilah. Delilah is also there.

Bernie tries to threaten a guard, but this one's well'ard. Bernie comes at him with his hook, but he's not catching anything today. He tries to tackle the guard to the ground, but he pretty much bounces off. Embarrassing.

Lillith onehits another guard with ease.

Kolo shoots a guy. He's ok though.

The guards jump into action. Bernie gets in an all male gang bang not for the first time not for the first time. They hit everyone for some serious D.

Stanri bounds up to the top deck. 4 guards and the cunt mayor take notice. Exme takes cover.

Delilah undoes the steering securing rope by entering the password. It still works. She

attempts to shoot the main sail free, and just nicks one of the ropes, and a small section of sail flaps free. She yanks the steering wheel and the ship begins to lurch one way.

Bernie did something, but it's not clear what. Lillith one-hits another guard.

Kolo takes some meth, and sprints past everyone into the middle of the slave market. The civilians begin to panic and disperse. Kolo one-hits a guard and burns the guy next to him.

The airship guards fire on Exme and Delilah, but they miss.

Stanri rips up a nearby ballista and attempts to fire it at the guards. He instead doesn't anticipate the huge amount of recoil and is hurled off the side of the airship. He hits the ground hard, and Stanri, butthole statue Myron and butthole statue Riphard all take some bruising.

Shanus, the cunt mayor, tries something similar by turning the canon on Exme. He misses badly and says some super annoying stuff.

Guards attack Bernie and Lillith, Bernie misses with a riposte, and Lillith finally feels the true pain of battle. Kolo is fine.

Exme puts the cunt mayor down while apparently cursing out her new femfoe Lillith. Could this be sexual tension? She shoots Shanus's regular dick off. He staggers due to the lurching ship and he is thrown from the ship, landing in the middle of the slavers market.

Delilah tells the remaining guards to down their weapons and they oblige, "Sorry ma'am, we wus just followin' orders".

The guards are distracted by the mayors lifeless, dickless body. Bernie takes the opportunity to finally murder a dwarf, letting out some serious paternal baggage he's been carrying around for years.

Lillith gives a final grand speech, convincing the rest of the guards to surrender and release the slaves. Kolo kills two more of the guards, but Bernie overwhelms him, stopping him mid murder spree.

The slaves emerge confused. Various characters attempt to console/recruit the slaves. The word quickly spreads across the land about the newly freed slaves.

Daisuke is involved in some weird sex cult situation in the airship basement. Turns out it's Kolo and Exme, hooded and murderous. Kolo wants to sacrifice Daisuke to some demon god to

unleash some kind of power or something. Kalimar? He chatting some serious cult shit. Exme is very confused and worried. Kolo isn't just trying to scare Daisuke. He opens one of Daisuke's arms. Kolo paints Exme's face with blood, welcoming her to his weird sex cult.

Exme is hesitant. Exme doesn't want to murder Daisuke. Kolo stabs Daisuke and cuts out his spine or something. It's pretty nasty. Kolo gets surrounded by darkness, there's a flash of light, and disappears. The room is now covered in blood and feces. Exme scans for magic and her device just outputs endless "Kah-lee-mah"s.

A voice settles into Exme's mind "You could have been one of us sister, you never accept us, you were never on our side". Exme does a cheesy 80's freeze-frame mug to camera.

Oh yeah, and he made the destoning potions before all that and left em handily and clearly labelled in the lab.

EPISODE 55: BREAKFAST CAT - ORIGINS

4 YEARS EARLIER - SOMEWHERE IN VELTERRA

A jungle, a chase. Small green feet, running. Something crashing through the undergrowth. A small goblin girl pants, trying to glance over her shoulder, tripping slightly as she does so. She picks herself up off the ground, just as the bushes get torn apart and a medium-sized giant boar bellows at her, spit flying from its maw.

"KOLLLLLOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOO!"

She hears no response, and the boar advances upon her prone, panicked form. She feels the hot, wet air against her face, and closes her eyes. She opens them, just to see a stone impact the side of the pig's head, sending it crashing to the ground. "Hahahhaarrghh, silly piggy". "Oh, Kolo, I thought I was going to die, I thought I was alone". "Don't worry Exme, you'll never be alone".

Dissolve to Exme's face, covered in blood.

Exme, backed by a mournful acoustic cover, begins the long and gruesome process of cleaning up after the night before. There's a montage. She goes to sleep on the top deck, the stone of Unthala clutched to her chest. When she wakes up in literal hell, rather than her

personal hell, [that elephant lady] brings her into Lazarus's office. Lazarus is sat scribbling furiously at his desk. Exme, with steely determination, sits in the desk, waiting for him to finish. She doesn't give Lazarus any choice. He must help. He doesn't.

He knows the direction Kolo went, and that he can't be reached via the stone any more. Exme is unimpressed. She asks why Lazarus hasn't helped before now, and he asks a similar question back, pointing out that it was quite apparent that something was wrong with Kolo. He has done everything he can. Exme, getting nowhere with Laz, promises him that if she doesn't get what she wants, she will burn down the the whole of hell. She leaves, and wakes up several hours later to the smell of cooking eggs. Lillith shouts up from below deck, trying to wake everyone up with the promise of delicious breakfast.

Burnie and Delilah find Exme and ask her what's wrong. Exme tells them everything, but that it will be okay, because they'll sort it out. They go downstairs. Kolo has smashed up a lot of his lab, but the ingredients for the destoning potion are on the side, along with the instructions. Exme thinks she'll be able to reproduce them, given time. Lillith, doing her bit, has placed humorous hats upon Myron and Rip, to lighten the mood slightly. As they are having breakfast, Delilah reports that there is a stagecoach, of Hope's Restian design, parked underneath the airship.

Lillith and Burnie head down to greet the guest, discussing tactics on the way. They'll do the old one-two, where only one person talks, despite there being two people. They approach the carriage, and out steps a large, well dressed tiger carrying a briefcase, and holding a cane he clearly doesn't need. He steps down and asks them if they are associated of Riphard Obsidian Hardstone. Lillith says no, and Burnie says yes, and for some reason, the tiger believes Burnie. The tiger informs them that he is from the Guilds of Coin and his here in regards to Riphard's fortune. Lillith introduces herself as Burnie's solicitor, Burnie as Riphard's sole heir with "whatever name he makes up", and Riphard as turned into stone forever. It is unclear, even to Lillith, what the purpose of this deception is.

[Reports including a section of proceedings have been lost in the flooding of a record's office in the Age of Abject Terrors, a section of the correspondences between Anthony Tigerius and the Guild of Coin have been donated by the Tigerius Estate, to cover a section of this missing period]

– Letters to The Guild of Coin Issue 0.5 –
:Fragment: Good news for once,

I have finally tracked down the elusive groups airship, instead of an object of high fantasy it is very much real and does indeed possess the ability to just float in the sky. Sky ships such as this could revolutionise travel across the planet, a new investigation should be opened into them alone. For now I have a more pressing matter to attend to. Riphard compatriots seem intent on lying about everything, although after a time it is possible to see the grains of truth among the nonsense.

There is always a cloud within the silver lining, and it seems that Riphard is currently made entirely of stone. How this transpired I find hard to swallow, but either way he seems currently ill disposed for our required discussions. Instead I find he has a partner who carries his heir, she is amenable and as per protocol I offer her the full services of the guild.

A small goblin seems convinced that she can bring Riphard back, either way I have finally found the owner/s of the bank and shall proceed...

The group seem set on finding something they are calling Excalibrium, they offer little to no explanation as to why, but seem to buy that I would be keen to join them so that I may see the sights of the ancient dwarven ruins, from which they rose to fantastical riches. Having only just found them, I am loathe to let them out of my sight. If the tales were true about the airship, then perhaps this group really is as capable and insane as they say.

The city is still in turmoil, and it seems to be from no small part of this party. Details are sketchy, and the group are still set on flagrant lies rather than comprehensive answers. However we put that aside, I am sure the destabilisation of one of the richest cities the planet has ever known will offer more opportunity for investment and growth than its closed doors had previously.

We enter the mines, and I am struck by the great efforts the Dwarves must have gone through to establish such a system. In a bid to expedite our arrival at an unknown location within the bowels of the mines, the goblin sets up a giant mechanised bear for us to ride down the mine cart rails. Good grief, I can see why it was hard to swallow our other reports.

The deeper we go the more elaborate the architecture becomes, it seems like the depths were more ostentatious than the heights. We pass countless ruins of past dwarven civilisation before arriving at a rune scrubbed arch way a full 2 days after we set off.

[Content Missing]

After checking that the second tomb isn't trapped, Lillith decides to get someone with more upper body strength to open it, anyway. Burnie reaches completes his experience with the statue, and rejoins the group, looking flushed. Lillith immediately gets Burnie to open the tomb for her, and he immediately spots the trap. He dodges out the way, but there is nothing interesting inside apart from a snazzy necklace, which he puts on while he opens the other tombs, which are also boringly empty. After admiring the engravings for a bit, they leave the room and head up to the other corridor, where the detectomatic detected a bit of magic. Burnie picks the lock and goes through the grated door that blocks the upper corridor, it reveals a large crystalline orb, glowing a soft milky white. Anthony pads down, and pokes his head round an open door that leads off to the right. He sees some paw prints, that look like something dog-sized but not dog-variety, but nothing else.

The orb seems to be half a broken communication system, and not of any particular interest right now, so they go back and try another door leading out the of the room with the statue in it. Stairs lead up, to a room with an empty casket for no reason. Burnie starts daydreaming about vampire erotica, Anthony trots off, excitedly poking through a web-covered hallway, into a large web-covered room. Burnie starts burning the webs away, when two giant blue and white spiders appear out of nowhere and begin attacking the party. Anthony shoots it with a bow, and then Exme makes her look foolish by eviscerating one with her gun. Lillith doesn't even know that anything's the matter. Stanri bites the other one, it bites back, and then promptly disappears.

For some spurious reason, they don't assume that this solves their problem, and they all wait to see if something interesting happens. Lillith moves through the webs, which are icky. While her back is turned, the spider reappears and everyone kills it. They jauntily carry on down the corridor. They arrive at a junction, and decide to head on down the most obviously trapped corridor. The obviously trapped corridor turns out to secretly be not trapped, but does contain a gross cloaker, which flies at Burnie and then everyone attacks it, it makes a weird noise, and then dies too. They carry on, and arrive in another space where the ground has fallen partly away, leaving platforms standing isolated a few dozen feet above jagged rocks. Stanri forms a bridge, and everyone strolls across. They pass a turning off to the left, but Anthony fires a

grappling hook off to carry straight on, spuriously.

The gang leave Stanri behind as they go onwards past a statue which Anthony seems to think is of the god Aladoon, but the bookburners assure him is a statue of a particularly Good Dog, and it must be true because they read it in a really badly spelled book. Anthony carries on, and finds a room with a big pit in it. He looks down into it, and sees a red, horned face looking at him, as a four armed, horned abomination climbs out of the hole. It throws him backwards, and emanates a dark, thick blackness which fills the room, covering Anthony and Burnie. Lillith drags Esme backwards out of the darkness, says there's nothing to be done, and makes her way towards the exit. Exme is unimpressed.

The thing crushes Burnie in a giant lobster claw, and continues to just be generally awful. Exmie shoots blindly into the darkness, aiming roughly at where Burnie's voice is shouting words of encouragement, blasting a large hole into the creature, which drops the darkness, so that it can cause Anthony and Burnie to become confused. Exme and Stanri both try and coerce Lillith to enter the fray, but she refuses to do any more than poke her head round the corner and fail to do anything useful with her crossbow, before running off and hiding round the corner. [Someone] gets enough of a hit on the thing that it is unable to hold its befuddling effect on the minds of Burnie and Anthony. Instead, it focuses its attention on Burnie, held bleeding in its claw, and Burnie becomes stunned, fixated on the sheer awfulness of the situation.

Refusing to be drawn into charging into battle by Stanri or Exme, Lillith cautiously pokes her head round the corner to see Burnie hanging helpless and stunned in the claws of something that should definitely not exist. She sighs, overcomes her self-preservation instincts, charges into battle, slides underneath Burnie and attempts to pull him from the claw by the ankles. She completely fails. As the last of Burnie's ribs crack within the chitinous claw of the beast, Anthony gets peeved about the injustice of it all. He gets real peeved. In his peeved state, he bites his lip and spits blood as he expresses his displeasure at the current situation. His consternation taps into a primal fury, and the mild-mannered Anthony gives way to a blur of cane-sword and rage, pounding against the exterior surface of the not-a-demon. Life flickers momentarily into Burnie as he is lifted into the air, for the finishing blow. As the monster brings him back down, Burnie has shifted his sword, Wasabi, into position, and it

plunges into the belly of the beast.

Burnie and the horned beast both collapse to the ground as Anthony runs off, blood still pouring out his mouth. Lillith tells Burnie that she's only going to put herself on the line for him once, and that was it. He reminds her that she did it really badly. Exme runs off to check on Anthony. Anthony is trying desperately to murder a dwarf that's been dead for hundreds of years, in a small crypt just off the previous area. Once he's calmed down slightly, he apologises to Exme for acting so uncouthly. Everyone else joins them in the crypt as Exme pays close attention to a statue of Synn in the corner, and Anthony fails to force open a chest. Exme says that they shouldn't open it, because this guy was seemingly blessed by Synn, and they have that in common, but no one can hear her over the sound of Lillith opening the chest. Inside they find a shit tonne of gems, an old book, and a dagger.

Exme works out that the book is a manual of RuneCarving and the dagger is covered in awesome runes that make it great. Everyone is interested, but very tired. They decide that they should probably rest in this crypt for a bit, before heading out to get the metal in the morning.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RFyCPicGbXM>

Epilogue

In the dark of the crypt, the only light is the dim green light illuminating the face of the goblin woman as she types feverishly using a keyboard built into the side of her bear. Green text flicks across the screen as a bar moves slowly across the horizontal axis of the display.

She pauses as the bar reaches the right hand side, and moves the processed data to a folder marked "Locashun Scans" and into a subfolder titled "Lazzyrus's Place", before selecting the file and pressing a very specific selection of buttons.

The images on the screen are replaced by flashing text repeating "Processing Battle Simulations", "Analysing Weaknesses", "Preparing Tactical Portfolio", " ;) " as she smiles contentedly, closing the hatch concealing the console, giving her bear a pat on the rump and settling down to sleep.



EPISODE 56: ROSS DIES IN THE END :'(

- Missive statement to Gold Master General - Guild of Coin - Hopes Rest -

espite the early set back of the head of the bank being now a solid stone statue, I have taken league with his comrades and ventured into the depths of the dwarven mines. This is an unparalleled opportunity for an outsider to see what and how the Dwarves made their massive fortune. Not in the least because with all the revolt and commotion going on over head I am quite certain we will manage to leave the mines without having to fight off the dwarven guards.

-- back in the airship --

Delilah brings Riphard back from the his stone form. He seems less than enthused that he is now no longer made of stone as he has always dreamed. His first thoughts are quite rightly about the bank, and only later does he try to catch up on the rest of the news. Delilah wants to spend the oodles of time he has before the others return, talking about baby names, and fatherhood. He wants to call him Dagenham, after his best friend from child hood. Turns out that Delilah has a thing for demon spawn, and would rather fancy it if Riphard grew some ginormous satan wings.

Delilah is going to destone the Myron-ator, and let Riphard go on his own adventures. Riphard seems to think Delilah would be better off without him? Has the man of stone finally cracked?

Riphard gets down into the mines, and at the first camp meets his old best friend Dagenham, who is now black-smithing with the Delvers. It seems these two have a sordid past, but for the right amount of gold Dagenham is willing to get on board and delve even deeper into the mines. The dwarven best friends of old proceed deeper into their mines and each others pysche. Until they find a giant metal bear

--Back in the Dwarven Mines--

I pass the finely wrought knife across to the strange man in black. The group seems set on resting up and recovering. We retrace our steps to an abandoned house, somewhere safe to hold up, while the big mecha bear watches over us. How nice it is to have colleagues so adept as this group.

"Omg Myron what happened to you, Its ok we can fix this" Exmerah mistakes Dagenham for Myron.

I finally meet Riphard, and he is as cagey as I would expect the Dwarf that created the largest collection of resources the world has ever seen. An empire that casts shade on all previous enterprises.

Dagenham has heard of this strange metal that people are obsessed with, but has never seen it other than in his own dreams.

We venture on, business of the guilds can wait until we are finished down here. We retrace our steps back to a very large orb, upon which is inscribed a drifting map of the world. The orb seems impervious to the dwarves and humans onslaught.

Lalaa climbs up to look closer at the orb, and is sent spinning out through the clouds, her vision swoops down into the western hemisphere of a small fishing village. A flash and several echos of darkness bewitch her, until she sees a large tentacled beast. She falls unconscious and collapses backwards into Burnies rushing arms. The eyes gaze deeper and deeper into Lilliths mind. Giant wings and eyeballs on stalks mounted on a scaled maw and body. It is all a little too much for LaLaa.

Large purple orbs appear, and out burst tall beasts the likes of which I have never seen. This place is truly one of wonder. The new people point at us, and speaks an alien language. Guess its time to shield Rip Hard. I stride out, and make my mark.

The strange aliens stride into mist and then stride out right next to us all. They draw sharp wicked blades and engage the party. The fight is over almost as soon as it began, this team is as brutal as it is efficient. I can see why Rip Hard has chosen them as his followers. They must have come at quite the price, perhaps no price is too high for keeping both hands on your life. Their leader steps through the mists and appears next to Rip Hard, once I again I am forced to call on the fires that burn within me, he shall not fall on my watch. The enemy surrounds me, and rain swords down upon, I arch my back and take the blows shielding Rip Hard from harm. The team coalesces again, and slays all but the leader of the alien group.

Lillith shares her experience with the orb, letting Exmerah in to check the orb out with her strange devices. She jumps up on the orb and screams deep within its layers, KOOLOO!!!

Something goes wrong, and she also catches a glimpse of the gargantuan monster. The stars behind the monster are not correct for Velterra. She falls back off the pedestal, tears streaming from her eyes.

Lillith has quite correct the orb is indeed powerful, perhaps handing it over to the church could be a good idea. Burnie stone shapes the pedestal into an encapsulating shield. This group has the abilities of characters from an ancient story. Incredible. WE find a well appointed bedroom and against my better judgement I bind my wounds and spoon the new delver dwarf. He is a pleasant bed fellow.

Lillith and Exmerah have a discussion about Kalimar. "If you eat dead orc breast cancer then you might get infected by him" she then puts the helmet on to read the writing on the aliens armours. Canelon is a symbol that she has come across before at the museum in Masuda. Canelon had previously requested the groups demise. The group has a great discussion about some weird old texts they found ages ago. Its highly confusing. Lalaa seems to be convinced it has something to do with the mysterious eyed beast she saw after touching the orb. Its all terrible confusing, and I am slightly concerned that this group are embroiled in some really bad shit.

We sally forth once more, and come across a mysterious room, with a large stone pillar surrounded by levers and buttons. The dwarven kin step forward and take a good look at the contraption. Rip Hard pulls a lever, but nothing seems to happen, at least not nearby.

Retracing our steps once more, we go looking for another route through these dwarven halls. We stroll down the halls until Dagenham gets stuck in his tracks, as he is engulfed within a large gelatinous cube. Burnie rushes in and gets absorbed by the cube as well. He unleashes a massive burst of electrical energy and fries both himself and Dagenham as the electricity arcs through both of them. Riphard unloads a massive blow from his fire arm. The cube is now glowing, I grappling hook the Dagenham out of the cube and rip the hooks from his body. The Goblin child asks about the cube, but I know little to nothing about such a thing. The cube cubes on towards us, luckily Rip Hard chooses to not be engulfed by the cube. The Goblin falls back as well. Burnie gets shat out the rear of the cube, before he shoots it into tiny small pieces. Riphard touches Dagenham, before Burnie shocks both Dagenham and himself.

We arrive at a book store, it is full of books about the history of the dwarves and their early cultural heritage. They were more involved and worked more closely with other races. They were well known for the rune magic. Excalibrium is super hard to work with, and requires special tools to mine, and to work with. In particular

excalibrium pick axes. Lillith seems keen to get the old ways back into the new ways in new Tom Hardy, in fact she wants to make Tom Hardy Great Again.

Lillith and Dagenham go looking for gold, unfortunately Lillith moves her bosy out of the way just as Dagenham gets toasted! We get a tad paranoid about future traps, but not long enough to stop the Goblin rushing forward towards another orb on a pedestal.

Dagenham is a great smithy but a has a dark and terrible gambling habit that is exposed and used by Exmerah, who then almost falls for the old double or nothing. A torrid stench engulfs us, and the whole party blames Rip Hard. I guess the rumours of dangerous flatulence from dwarves in mines is true after all. The source seems to be a massive hole, Dagenham takes a quick peek only to discover this is a stagnant pit of 100 of years worth of waste. He vomits, and slips down the hole, nobody goes to help him. Except Burnie, who shoots him. Dagenham sparks his tinderbox, and the methane catches, creating a shitty napalm that throws everyone back on their ass.

EPISODE 57: A MINER INCIDENT

Riphard is in a bizarre fugue state, after his good friend died just moments ago. He makes his way back out of the mine to see his pregnant wife. It's a 3 day journey alone, but he'll be fine, looking for "Grief Poon".

We pull out the body, and Rip comes back to drag it out, leaving a shitty smear to help us out.

Then a tentacle porn monster drops from the ceiling and attacks our token Furry. It surprises us so there's no much we can do. Tigerius gets angry, and then Burnie stabs it through the face - it's super effective!

The room we find was some sort of storage room, been ransacked already and there's not that much of interest there anymore. Remnants of boxes, decayed. . .

Useless.

There's a door. A stone door. A stone door in a stone hallway, with a stone knocker.

We open, go down a hallway. There's no traps. There's stairs and mention something about a mining accident., but we go into a hallway with

weird little armor and a bunch of chests. We open a chest and to no-ones surprise the armor comes to life.

I open a chest, there's 4 thingies. Fist-sized stones, general rock-stones. They have runes on them. Burnie chucks one at a thing, it does a cool crystal thing - but no damage.

We slowly start taking them down, through a combination of kittyclaws, hooks, lightning and bear arms. Also a big fucking cannon.

Lilith remembers she can stealth in order to be more effective rather than plinking crossbow bolts.

Burnie has a strange fever dream in the heat of battle, to do with moons, and exme breaking it apart. . . and then him and Tigerius demolish the bastards. Tigerius proceeds to rage-out and demolish the last one attacking Stanri.

Exme discovers that the armor was probably enchanted with runic magic. We find 2 excalibur pickaxes, 3 runes of healing, 1 rune of explosion and a bunch of old gold (500g).

The group talks about forming a band over a short rest. We make our way down a mineshaft, and Exme tries out her new pickaxe.

We get attacked by a big mean ugly steam-punk nightmare. Stanri is in love. It farts acid at us, and stanri attempts to mount it. We collectively murderise it. Stanri humps the corpse. But is sad because of his lack of junk.

We make our way back to the earlier stairway, and downward into the condemned mine. We fight a big assed robot, using surprisingly good tacites (because it hits hard). Tigerius demolishes it at the end, though stanri eats it. And we find excalibrium!

Excalibrium all collected, Lilith gives us a big heart-to-heart about how we're great, and gives us a key to a printing press under the sewers, suggesting we get the people on our side. She's going to stay amongst the dwarves to act as a leader/mayor/diplomat, to protect the excalibrium and insert some solidity.

We go past the last gasp, and fix a guys leg, explaining that Dagernum died doing what he loved - swimming in shit. Exme decides to write historical fiction based on a fever dream of the moon destroying veltterra.

Anthony's carriage was ransacked, looks like he's getting a lift with us!

Back at the airship, Myron gets destoned. He gets filled in, then has a big heart-to-heart with Exme, having engraved his shield with "kolo the

wise" - thinking he's a lost cause. Exme is convinced she can still get Kolo back.

Delilah forces us to go to Hope's rest. We also know that the only place we can smelt the excalibrium is with the Lindedorf gnomes.

Delilag's going to pop out a BABY.



EPISODE 57A: THE ADVENTURES OF SNARK THE GOBLIN (PART 1)

Perspectives
of a New-World Goblin attempting
to integrate into Modern Magnimar,
as told by Snark and scribed by Zuriel

Transcript Begins

You want me to talk about what we been doing while you write Miss Zuriel Lady? Okay, sounds fun! You want me talk about the others too? You're all so nice, I'm glad I found you!

Soooooooo I'm Snark, I come from Goblin tribe faaaar away. You won't have heard of them. They all dead now anyway. I try tell them, I say "No keep eating people and stealing things or we gonna all get in trouble!" but nobody listen so then they all get boom'd. I make new friends though! Met Moxie and Pillow and some other friends but living in woods is hard and sometimes I have to eat new friends. Never Moxie and Pillow though! I got to thinking when in woods that Goblins need be nicer in world, make people like them. I made lots of friends in woods so I gets to thinking why not make friends with people too? So here I am!

Editor's note: Moxie appears to be a young raptor, she seems very protective of Snark though the Gods know how she managed to find a raptor. Pillow is a rather large and impressive wolf, who acts as a riding mount, backpack and (as the name suggests) a place of comfort for Snark in the wild.

So, first I met Bill, he is a lovely halfling man and his best friend Mac is such a friendly cow, though he is quite big and scary but it okays he'd never hurt me! Bill makes lots of food and loves nature even more than I love animals! He even makes Moxie and Pillow feel better when they get hurt, he so kind! We got to riding around on his biiiiiig cart and it's so comfy and full of food. I so lucky making nice friends.

We met a very angry dwarf called Mr Krogan. He acts all grrrrr but he likes when I give him snacks so we friends even though he keeps saying nasty things about goblins. He has a big bushy red beard and a huuuuge axe. He looking for some old heirloom so me and Bill tagged along to see more world and do more good things.

We all travelled and ended up here, Magnimar! It's so big! People are everywhere, even other goblins! Most people no like goblins here, but that just mean lots of people to make friends with!

We hired a bounty hunter called Jenny the Red to find more stuff about the heirloom, she is soooo cool! She wear red armour and is very sneaky, I once saw her cut someone's legs out without them even seeing her coming! We weren't very good friends at first, Krogan kept saying she would stab us in the back but I said she'd come around. It did! When Jenny got jumped in an alley by some bad men. The bad men didn't like it so much when Pillow and Moxie tore their throats out, but Jenny seemed to be our best friend after!

We still not found heirloom so we got some jobs in Magnimar while Jenny searched. Bill worked in a soup kitchen, Krogan got a job as a bouncer at The Fisherman's Friend and I made some new friends at a Donkey Sanctuary where I got paid to tell the Donkeys stories all day!

We got to drinking in the Fisherman's Friend most nights, their milk is very nice and I get to talk to lots of people. We made friends with the barkeep Gwen Fiddich who is suuuper strong! She likes poking bad customers in the eye and threatening them with her big mace Betsy. She barkeep by night but fights by day, kind of sounds wrong way to me but hey.

That's also where I met you! You like sitting in the pub gathering stories, you super smart and scholarly. And you can do all those fancy spells and stuff it so cool! Plus you are so pretty and have such nice dresses and things, goblins not have pretty dresses they set fire too easy.

So, we were in the pub as normal after working, I don't mind because Gwen serves some real good milk which has nice tang and sharpness, mmmmm. Sorry, anyway I was making some new friends with Jenny cos some people in Fisherman said I was stinky and shouldn't be let in. I learned to play darts too, it seems quite easy to me I just throw and hit the things but I had to get help with the numbers. Goblins big on the tricks and the fun but momma always told me writing stole your soul so I never really did that.

Gwen used her famous poking finger to deal with some drunk men who were starting a fight, they tried to stay but when she went to get Betsy down they quickly decided to leave. I don't blame them, Gwen is scaaaaaary.

The next day while we were working, you Zuriel went to see a fancy lady friend of yours up in her nice house and she asked you to put together a team because she had some shiny things stolen from her. It looked like it was nasty

goblins who had done it and tunnelled into their vault. Such a shame that goblins are still doing such nasty things.

We went and had a looksie, we got taken to the rear entrance where all the most honoured guests go and led in to some servants' quarters. So humble of her to call her dining room that! And she fed us pastries and cream! So nice, quick friend. She a very pretty lady, told us about an heirloom that been stolen by the peoples. They dug a tunnel right into the vault under house, so sneaky. She offered us 150 silver each if we could recover it, which is enough to buy 15 cream teas. I accepted on behalf of the team immediately.

We went to look at the room where stuff been taken, and sure enough goblin tracks. Such bad goblins. The tunnel went into the sewers and we found that there were people who lived there. Mostly bad people. Veeeeeery bad people.

Because of all the potential for nasty things we went and got our weapons and I fetched Moxie and Pillow because they always love adventures. Pillow didn't seem to be too excited about sewers but he is a grumpy wolf sometimes you just have to ignore him. Bill brought big Mac as well so the whole gang was together!

We did some investigating, split up and talked to people in the poor part of town. Most of them were very nice when they realised I not gang goblin. Jenny said she had to pay some of them to talk but I just gave them some jerky and stroked their heads, I think I better friend-maker than her if I honest.

Turns out there a nasty clan of goblins in sewers and their old boss got killed to death recently, some big old evil hobgoblin had taken over and was bullying all the others into robbing rich peoples. This make me feel better, you know, goblins only doing bad because some big bully was making them. Goblins can be very loyal to bullies though which is shame because we will have to kill them then.

We also found a goblin girl had run away from the gang and they were trying to get her. Good goblin girl rebel I thought, we find her first and she tell us where they are and what to expect! A few more bits of friend making and one of Bill's super-tasty ham hocks as a bribe and we found the goblin girl in a graveyard. Pretty spooky place to hide if you ask me but hey not everyone so clever eh?

We found her but goblin girl ran from us screaming. I tried to calm her down but she no listen, so Moxie had to chase her. Bill tangled

her feet with nature magic (so coooool!) and we eventually managed to make her calm. Krogan didn't help by insulting her, he said some nasty things about goblins. I will have to friend him more until he stops this silliness. Moxie didn't help either, the goblin girl didn't understand Moxie's lovely smile. She told us where the base was, gave us a map and warned us of a nasty rockfall trap. The base wasn't too far from the graveyard. She also warned us that boss fed bad goblins to a vampire! I not sure if real vampire or not, but we got to be careful whatever this is. Fortunately, we have Gwen who very strong, she should be able to poke vampire in eye and show him he bad.

Krogan and Jenny had good idea to make me look more like clan goblin so I could sneaky sneak and see what happening. You waited at the entrance as a lookout (but I think it more that you not like smell, eh Miss Zuriel? You did look a bit pale there)

Editors note: this is incorrect, I stood watch for purely tactical reasons

It was very dark in the lair, which no bother me but most of others could barely see. Bill made some shiny magic dancing lights to follow us. We go into big empty circle room with stinky water on floor and I go a bit ahead to looksie. Some nasty ooze monster slopped out which I thought was puddle and stung Pillow. It looked very burny, Pillow was not happy. We went into action and I set Moxie and Pillow on it, but when they bite it stung them badly. Lucky with others we managed to kill it fast because I don't think Moxie or Pillow wanted to touch it again.

We think it hard to sneak up on goblins if we have big shiny lights that others need so Krogan and me went. We sneak forwards to biiiiiig room with 5 big pillars and leave everyone else in the tunnel. We did a sneak up and got pretty close but Krogan not so good at the moving quiet and he make a clanky noise. We shout for help and Krogan manage to cut head off one goblin in one hit. Makes me think be nice to Krogan. I shoot one from behind pillar but no want go out against many with only lil old me. Friends come fast though, bad goblins try to shoot them full of arrows as they run up but Jenny super-fast and dodges a lot. Moxie is also real fast and gets in the face of one of the goblins as I get back on Pillow. I worry for Moxie, she young and brave but she ran into lot of goblins on her own. I need tell her be more careful, but she lucky this time and only get injured a bit.

Krogan is very strong and takes down another goblin in one hit. Jenny and Gwen manage to

run in and kill goblins on left side. Only two goblins left when I get out round pillar and Moxie quickly eat one's face. Last one had already dropped weapons when Moxie jumped at him so we pinned him down to have a nice little chat with about what was in cave. Bill was very nice to Moxie and healed her with magic. I must talk to Moxie about not being so rash next time though.

EPISODE 58: THE DARK CROW RETURNS

Y evening strolls are progressing nicely, Burnie approaches me one evening asking somewhat confusingly about my lineage. I direct him back towards the early days learning books someone had left on the bar a few nights ago.

One long night, I have the strangest of dreams, I am in a rather quaint and old office, it seems antiquated but I guess that is to Myrons taste. A nice elephantine lady brings some tea, most excellent hosting. Instead of being led to the anti-chamber we are all taken through to this mans office. Everyone around me seems quite calm, so for now I shall hold it down. I am led away into an adjacent and identical office. A quick look out the window and the working conditions outside and I am convinced that this company is going somewhere. IT takes some time, but after a long session explaining the gentleman who calls himself Laz, has me hook line and sinker. Working for him is going to be blast, I have always wondered how one made a deal with the devil, and now I have.

We return to the room with the other gentleman, and Laz waxes on about how he is finding a way to deal with Calimars influence on this young Kolo chap. This book boffin types had been working on a way to dissolve off all this mouldy Kalimary business.

Lazarus gives his blessings to Delilah and Riphard. He is fascinated by the childs heart beat, and for reasons quite beyond Myron, Delilah allows him to listen in. Riphard is keen for some kind of demonic influence. With a snap of his fingers we awake in our beds. Dang nammit I was really hoping we could work remotely from there.

LAz zips back quickly to request info on Dagenham Thunderfist, who is still in processing. Riphard asks him to do a favour for Dagenham, Laz agrees to keep him waiting for as long as he can. He is stuck in limbo with Lady Otaria, and Pilch.

Mryon calls a team meeting, I'll take minutes as these guys don't seem to know the first thing about making and agenda, never mind how to run it. Exmerah is keen that things will return to exactly the way they were, the others seem less than convinced.

what we just said

is myself, who is definitely trust worthy

They ask me a series of questions:

Am I a spy - no I have not come to spy on Myron

Who do I work for - The Guild Of Coin

I do not dye my fur, other than in the blood of my enemy

The color of the sky - it has many colors

What is the air speed of an unladen swallow - 11 meters per second

Whats so special about Riphard - He is the head of the worlds largest banking organisation

What do you know before last night about any sort of churchy stuff -

Guild of Gary - is currently undergoing liquidation

Anthony K Tigerius III - what does the K stand for

What can I bring to the table - my fierce negotiations around the business table

Burnie, dressed solely in a thigh high smoking jacket, lets hid dong slip out

Everyone slowly leaves as Tigerius starts to broach the subject of the guild of coin, and the guild of banking combining their powers.

Exmerah takes away Delilah and shows her where she can make the cocoon for her child. Delilah explains the basics, and Exmerah breaks out into a fitful burst of vomiting. Turns out Dwarves are full size when they are born. Exmerah thinks it will be half cast.

I set up to stun Riphard with the facts and figures, after 3 days of presentations I hope I am getting through to him.

Burnie convinces us all to go to his parents farm first. It is surrounded by fields of barley and wheat. We drop the airship behind the stables, as a couple of elderly dwarfs come tottering out of the farmhouse. The old man looks over his reading glasses, looks deep into the new comers, while the very very old dwarven lady loads an old crossbow. These two clearly did well about the agrarian reform act in the late

*****. Unfortunately for someone, they saw us land. I take care of it, so that no one will be the wiser

"Your a real pain in the arse son!" explains his father. Seems like he is being very truthful. Exmerah tells them everything. We get as close to a domestic between his parents as is possible before his mother cold clocks father to the floor. We decide Gerald is going to watch the airship. Turns out Gerald tried to milk him, their combined intelligence would probably be dwarfed by a cows.

I am slightly troubled at leaving the teams airship with two old dwarfs shortly after we destroyed the dwarven home town, also burnie their adopted son has managed to blind himself.

We make it to their base of operations in Hopes Rest, the fire house. Archibald has been looking after the place, but he does recall Myron killing the other book burners. He also recalls Kolo coming by and retrieving all his stuff, workers included.

Jizznak is left alive, hi ability to speak in rhyming couplets is undiminished despite having been stabbed by him.

I help Exmerah in her investigations, family is important, and being betrayed by one must be awful. He has left a lot of paperwork, but Exmerah is more concerned with the footprints etc. Seems to me that he has divided the articles of ownership very fairly.

We stop by the whore house, with the pregnant Delilah. After a while we all seems to quiet. Myron and Riphard move in, and the whole house has been turned over. Sat right in the middle is a coffee table, with a cleanly folded note. Madam Beatrice is gone, but Burnie picks up the letter and starts to read.

ITs a letter from this Kolo fellow, he is demanding that Exmerah and Burnie go and meet him and learn all about Kalimar. I run off to get a mid wife. Riphard stays to help, recommending that Delilah hold her breath. I dash through the streets, looking for a mid wife. Luckily we have been bank rolling the guild of midwives for a long time, now. Nothing like a young mother in debt to help recruit the next generation of workers.

Exmerah and Burnie go rooftop to rooftop looking to make the meeting on time.

Riphard is holding hands with Delilah, while they both help Delilah with the birthing. The two of them bless the baby, by the gods of war and destruction. Riphard after a long period deep in thought privdes aid to Delilah.

I fetch the Matrons from the guild of midwives and usher them all into a black cab, I ruthless whip the horses into a lather, to expedite our process.

Outside the warehouse there is just darkness. Burnie reveals his second eye, and can once again see in the dark. In one big square room filled with boxes and crates. In the center of the warehouse a woman is tied to the chair. Its a fat elf woman. "Aye up, brother" "Alloh Exmerah, Welcome, welcome" comes out from the back of the warehouse. As they sidle into the warehouse they notice a very large pool of blood around the chair of the elf lady. Kolo crawls over the boxes, his blades covered in blood. Turns out Kalimar has been talking to him, and will give him strength to free all the goblins. He is covered head to toe in fungus, his claws themselves extended and sharpened. He has a present for Burnie that will go straight to his heart...

Riphard Commands Delilah to give birth, it kind of helps but the emergence of the head leads to some confusion, luckily I arrive just in time with the mid wifes. A well oiled machine, of mid wifes trained since a very young age. Warm towels are out, and the midwifering is taking place.

Back in the warehouse Burnie hears a small click, before two cross bolts fly out past his head. A large bird with a metallic like beak emerges from behind Burnie.

"Burnie this is your son". " He wants to repay you for abandoning him..."

Burnie puts up his shield and asks how this is even possible.

"You should have been my father, you should have been" "Bones brought me up well"

Burnie calls bones a psychopath, and gets shot in answer. It looks like it will hurt a lot. The dark crow like figure appeals to Kolo for help, who pulls out a ball of grease and launches it at Burnie, Exmerah and Stanri. Burnie and Stanri lose traction and fall to the floor. Trayvon Jnr has been promised his justice. Burnie betrayed Trayvon and didn't look after his own child.

BAck in the labour room, Riphard and Anthony are hard at work doing baby delivery stuff. It is a white knuckle ride, Delilah is in so much pain she is making a great deal of sense. As I go to pin her down, she seize up entirely, Riphard performs hold person paralyzing her entirely. Its pretty unsafe. Delilah promises to remove his eyes with spoons if it ever happens again. The midwife leans down to listen to the baby, " Oh thats good news..."

"Do you want to sacrifice Burnie with me?"

"Seems a bit rushed"

"Trayvon Jnr What do you think?"

"Its been my dream to kill my father all my life, Bones used to say "Stab your way through problems" "

"I will wait until Trayvon has killed Burnie then we can talk"

Burnie slips and slides out from underneath Stanri, and makes it out the back. The bird flies past him, at which point Burnie zaps himself into +4 strength. The bird does barrel roll out of his grasps, and while gliding backwards unloads two cross bow bolts into Burnie. One of which smashes into the side of Burnies head. He does not look great, as the poison courses through his veins. His glass beady eyes glint as the lightening lights up the night sky.

"I would have teleported him out" says Exmerah " But he never listens"

Stanri goes to help Burnie, while Exmerah goes and sits next to Kolo

She lights a cigarette and tells him about how she has emanshyated all the gabrins in the dwarven kingdom. The important thing Kolo says is that the gabrins take charge of everything. Kalimar can give them that power apparently. Exmerah tries to pick some of the mould off him. Kolo doesn't even notice.

Burnie lifts his weary head, the black poison pulsing in his veins, he crawls into the arse of Stanri and closes the door behind him, just as a short mysterious creature appears in the background.

The midwife look up at Riphard you know its twins right?

Myron sprints back to the door, and shoulder barges the child that Bones raised from an egg. Trayvon responds by stabbing him with a poisoned dagger. Kolo hears the familiar clanking of Myrons armour, and has strong words with Exmerah before slipping off the boxes and taking his first shot at Myron.

Back on the other side of the city, Riphard and myself pull the first heir to his fortune from Delilahs loins. Instead of crying, the baby cracks a gentle smile, and sits happily in Riphards arms. Delilah screams and starts to push the second child out.

Exmerah goes to persuade Trayvon Jnr that she knew his mother. That the few times she squeezed out and re-ingested his egg, were the

best of her life. Trayvon Jny is clearly shaken by this. She asks him not to betray his mothers memory, and to forgive the man she loved. "Bones said I should stab my way out of problems, you make me think I could feel my way out"

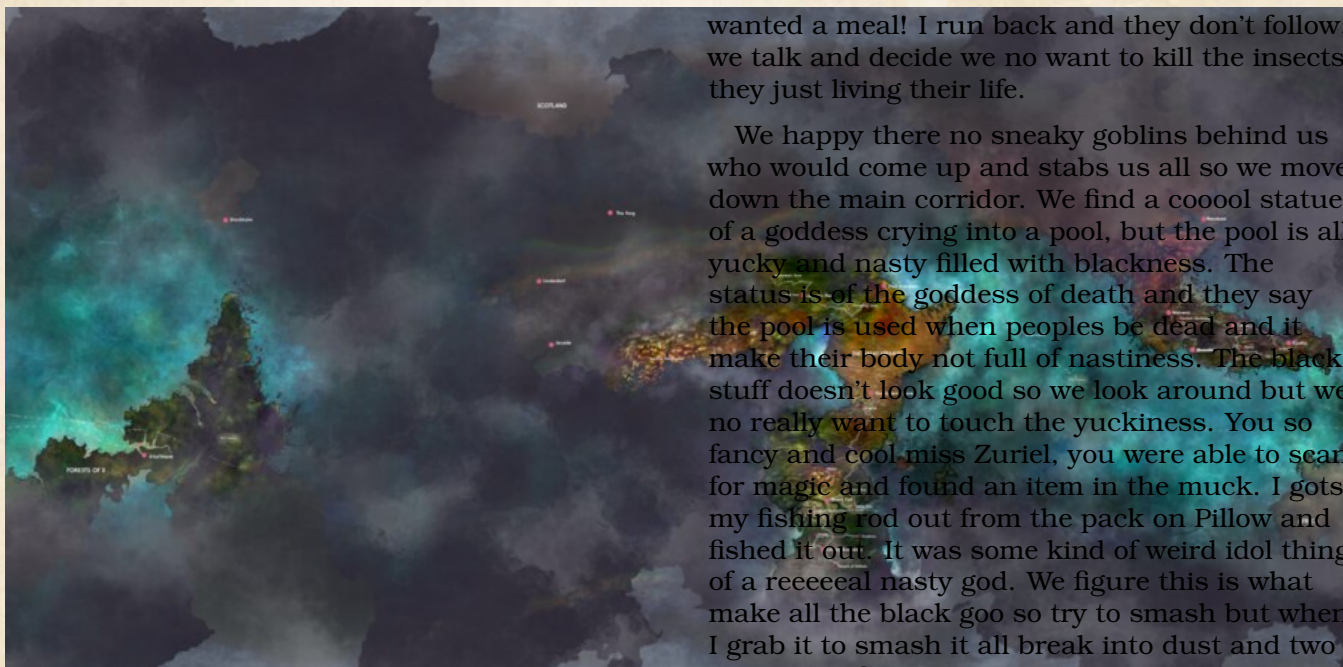
The second baby seems stuck in Delilah, Riphard tries as he can to get the first child out, I slide out my paw claws to cut the child free from her birth mother. As the child comes out, I pull the small girl aloft. The second heir has arrived on this planet. "Riphard please can I see them?"

This ones called Bilbo, This ones called Dildo. A very subtle glint of golden light is shining in their eyes. Considering how much gold they will inherit then, I am not surprised.

"Trayvon you coward, You are not made for Kalimar! Next time Exmerah, next time...." he sprints off and fades away into the night. As the storm lashes down on the compatriots now bound in friendship. Father I am sorry Bones died, a mission went wrong, he was training me, he made me good at stabbing. They taught me a lot, tey taught me more than you, you only taught me loss, suffering and anger. He pulls off his mask, and is hideous underneath. All broken and smashed up with parts of humans and birds.

"I am going to be here for you now, well in so much as a rebel group who aren't going to be around..."

"If you need me, you can find me at the guild of assasins, ask for Buck McCraw"



One day, twins, everything the light touches will be yours. (Map as of Episode 58)

EPISODE 58A: THE ADVENTURES OF SNARK PART 2: SAND, DEMONS AND LEECH MONSTERS OH MY!

Heyy Zuriel! You want me carry on the story now? Okay. . . soooo. . . we tried to ask the goblin we pinned down about the cave but he was not very polite so Moxie eat his face. I always say it very important to be polite! We also got you to come back inside and come help, we figure we need your spells and magic stuff!

We knew we could go forwards and find the big evil bugbear man, but there were three little caves behind us and I know how tricky other goblins can be so we thought it best to check them out! The first cave had some biig ol' fungus thing that I recognised. It had spores that over time makes people calm and obey you. We thinks maybe the big boss put goblins near here to make them do what he says. Sneaky hobgoblin. The fungus would make lots of spores if we burned it down so we left it alone.

The next cave had some poor goblins on spikes. Looks like their leader wanted the other goblins to stay in line. I know these bad goblins and shouldn't follow big evil hobgoblin buuuuut I can't help feel bad for them.

The last cave had rock fall and cave in. I look in and see something with lots of legs and go in shadows. I figure it some animal so walk out, but one start to come for me! Big giant centipede

wanted a meal! I run back and they don't follow, we talk and decide we no want to kill the insects, they just living their life.

We happy there no sneaky goblins behind us who would come up and stabs us all so we move down the main corridor. We find a coool statue of a goddess crying into a pool, but the pool is all yucky and nasty filled with blackness. The status is of the goddess of death and they say the pool is used when peoples be dead and it make their body not full of nastiness. The black stuff doesn't look good so we look around but we no really want to touch the yuckiness. You so fancy and cool-miss Zuriel, you were able to scan for magic and found an item in the muck. I gots my fishing rod out from the pack on Pillow and fished it out. It was some kind of weird idol thing of a reeeeeeal nasty god. We figure this is what make all the black goo so try to smash but when I grab it to smash it all break into dust and two nasty little flying things pop out!

We fight the nasty things, one of them stings me and they fly up out of reach. One even turns invisible! I not a fan of these guys and Pillow and Moxie struggle to help me! We fight against them, they real hard to hit because they so small. Pesky! These little guys are able to make people super scared, made you and Jenny run away in fear haha you looked so funny! Sorry, sorry. We eventually manage to kill the things, what did you say they were? Meee Fits? (Editors Note: The creatures were Mephits, denizens of the hells).

The water in the pool seems to start slowly getting better, still looks pretty nasty though! There two doors out this room, Jenny checks them over and we find one is maybe trapped and the other is locked. We figure one with lock on is where they don't want us to go, so Jenny get to work picking the lock. She really good at it, takes her no time at all. The water is looking a bit better now and you said it had magic aura around it. I use my knowledge of the woods and living alone and think it looks okay to drink now so I try some. It not okay. . . I feel very ill. I sit on pillow and hug him tight as we explore more, everything feels icky. I learn not drink from evil demon water in future.

Down corridor after door is unlocked we see another statue of the goddess stood at the end. This one bigger and has a cool looking hourglass in hand. Sand inside is all swirly and you tell us it definitely magical but not sure what it do. We thinks it might be trap and a few of the group try to sneak past it. I stay back so I don't get in way because I not feel very sneaky while throwing up. It turns out it was some magic trap, makes a big

nasty swirling sandstorm so I no see anyone! It hurts a lot but people eventually find their way back. We all pretty hurt by now so Bill does a nice soothing spell on us all to make us better. It helps the stabbing and the nasty pain but not help me stop poopin myself. Demon water is nasty.

Jenny is really brave and goes up again to try get rid of it. She try to rush up as sneaking not work and take the hourglass. The sand is really strong and she gets hurt a lot doing it, but she manage to throw it waaaay down the corridor away from us where it no hurt us more.

We creep up some stairs and listen at door, think we hear something inside but hard to tell. We burst in and big bad hobgoblin is there! He leaning over a poor goblin and sounds like he sucking it dry, which is nasty. He turn around and has this biiiig gross tongue thing covered in blood! We are really quick and jump in, but he quickly turn into his REAL form, this nasty beast that sucks blood and is all gross. Turns out the goblins were tricked, he not a hobgoblin at all! He summons some rats and try to hurt us but we able to surround him really fast and he not expect it. Krogan got real mad and I think he froth at mouth a bit, he quite scary when he angry. He ran up with big axe as we had him surrounded and manage to cut the nasty boss man nearly in two with big axe blow, so vicious! After that is quite quick to take boss man down and stab his gross rat friends. Turns out when you work together and not let bullies be mean to you they not very scary!

EPISODE 59: LISTING HEAVILY

 He gang, relaxing after a stressful afternoon, sit around Myron's list, and between Anthony, the bookburner's library and Riphard actually paying attention (so that he can carry on ignoring his children) they actually end up doing quite well, filling out a lot of the gaps.

Myron reluctantly says that he thinks the only way they're going to survive is if they get The People on their side, track down everyone they can that might be able to help them, and that they might need to be. . . heroes...

In the middle of his awkward speech, Burnie walks downstairs and starts talking to Myron about his birdson, despite the fact that Myron is upstairs trying to do a speech. He removes the

poisoned crossbow bolt from his buttocks, glowing with pride, and places it in a crack in the wall.

Myron comes downstairs, and asks Burnie what he's up to, and why he walked out of his awkward speech.

Together, they try and work out who to talk to next. They decide to see if they can find Rolltop Kandian. Rip asks if they can go via checking in with Derek Bobacious.

Riphard talks to Derek by himself first, to try and get some dirt on Anthony, and drive a wedge between Northern Rock PLC and The Guild of Coin. Derek seems to like Anthony for some reason.

Everyone else comes in and everyone chats about business and all that sort of boring shit.

On the way out, they check to see in Rolltop Kandian is still in the police force, apparently, he's got a big promotion, and everything, so, they head across to see him.

They get shown up to his office, where the overworked, salt of the earth, police chief, sits behind a big pile of papers. Him and Myron reminisce about old times for a bit, and then get down to business, talking about any potential changes in the church's relationship to the city (there are none) and any more information he might have about the people on the list (there is some).

The SRA are in Golding's Bay, apparently, blowing up the infrastructure servicing, apparently, and Vuthelle is trying to rebuild her sunken isle.

He mentions that he'd love to be more helpful, but there seems to be some sort of serial killer on the loose.

On the way out, Myron arranges to go for a drink after Rolltop finishes.

Just as they leave, Rip tries to get dirt on Anthony from the policeman too.

As evening draws in, Myron heads off to meet up with Rolltop. Burnie hides inexpertly behind a pot plant, trying to follow and eavesdrop, Myron tells him to fuck off and let him meet his old friend in peace, and Burnie slithers off down a manhole cover somewhere.

Myron gets to the bar a few hours early, and is sitting there looking uneasy when Rolltop gets there. He tells him that the murderer is a goblin living in the sewers, but that he's very dangerous and he shouldn't send his men in to find him if he doesn't want to lose them. Then he runs out

leaving his drinks undrunk, and Rolltop asking him how he knows.

Burnie has found the printing press Lillith gave them the keys for, hidden in the sewers, and makes a note of how to get there from the fire house.

Burnie then goes to the Guild of Assassins, to try and track down Estebaun, who, last he knew, went back there after the Bookburners got broken up. He walks up to the front door, and asks the shadowy figure behind the hatch if he can talk to Estebaun. Not entirely surprisingly, they aren't too keen on telling randoms who is and isn't an assassin, even in this town.

Burnie, in a moment of uncharacteristic brilliance, asks if he could hire an assassin called Estebaun to assassinate an ant on the ground. He is given a price of 50 gold, which he pays through a slot in the door, once he gets it to accept his coin. He scoops up the ant into a glass jar and waits in an alley.

Meanwhile, across the city, Myron decides to go and check in with the Garys, who have apparently set themselves up over the other side of town.

Back in the alley, after about 40 minutes has passed, a sickly-looking young assassin gets booted out of the door, and comes over to kill the ant. Unfortunately, by now, Burnie has named the thing and his rampant paternal instinct has latched onto it.

Through a bit of bribery and a bit of manipulation he tries to convince the assassin to kill the ant using the time-honoured method of taking care of it until it dies. Burnie is assured that this will happen, in a way that convinces only Burnie.

Estebaun is apparently still around, and now works as an instructor for the newer recruits. Burnie also tells this kid to check on his son at some point, and also that his name is Tim, which ends up actually being right, despite how much the kid tried not to tell him.

On the other side of town, Myron has got to the Garys. Rip is with him, but he hasn't realised yet.

The Garys seem to have turned a corner. After nearly dying of a chicken disease, and seeing Gary in a vision, they now operate as a pseudo-religious movement, espousing peace and protection, with Abigail - no longer crazy, now slightly Scouse - at the head.

They talk to her, and it comes out in conversation that Rip knew Gary first hand.

Sensing opportunity, Rip and Myron tell Abigail what Gary was fighting for, for the 8, for the future, for the souls of everyone alive today. The Garys sign up to fight the good fight. They are offered use of the printing press once its up and running, and only ask that they be allowed to carry on being peaceful.

Returning to the firehouse, the gang try and decide what to do next. They decide to head across to New Abbergast, and then swing by Golding's Bay on the way back. They all set about making preparations to head out again, none so more enthusiastically than Riphard.

EPILOGUE

A smoke filled office, late at night. Everyone else has gone home, but Rolltop Kandian sits in his office alone, staring at a pile of evidence laid out on his desk, illuminated by the shafts of pale white light that shine in through his blinds from the moon outside.

If what the gnome says is right, then there's not many grey areas left in this case, not many links left to make. These murders seem to all be fitting together, and the patterns growing more obvious. The hiding places are shrinking rapidly.

Such a shame. This case had served him so well. Still, he could probably get away with a few more, but he'd have to move quick. He'd have to be more careful now, though.

[r/https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AIPGyKGuWeA](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AIPGyKGuWeA)



EPISODE 60: JUMPING THE SHARK

Warm up while Riphard sleeps in

Tony went to the pet shop and bought some high quality bird seed. At least a tonne. Delievered straight to the ship. Burnie headed back to his farm to continue hiding the airship. His mother took a moment to stop eating her jaffa cake and playing the guitar to query what her boy was doing. He told her. She thought he was painting a forest. He said he couldn't see any forest, just a load of trees. Tony and Burnie discuss life. Where is the bird abomination son? They don't know. But they do know that there is some of momma's fine home made fortified wine going round. They partake.

I have spent all of my hours both awake and asleep trying to find the cure for Kolo. I have two samples, the red fungus from Burnie's orc girl with the cancer and kolo's own brand. I see where those before went wrong. Their approach was a solvent so strong it would dissolve fungus and flesh alike. No use. I think with more work I can make progress, I think I can limit the damage. But progress is slow. Frustrating. I need a break from this. I need to sleep.

The Main Event

A week has passed. Delilah rests in Hope's rest with her brood. The babies are in good hands surrounded by whores, and we expect that they will be very safe. Burnie recommended that Delilah should take the babbies to the farm which they would probably enjoy if they were a little older but which Delilah may enjoy because of the 'sherry'. It was up to us to fly our own way to New Abbergast. Burnie is confident he can fly. I idly played with the Rubrik's die as we flew away. The crew take a moment to discuss the concept of density, whilst Mr Tiger feeds his sparrow birds. They sang a little song to eachother which was very nice. Burnie quote "was walking around topless doing deck things". I was a little perturbed when I realised that he was meant to be flying the ship. I rushed to the bridge to find a single stick lying on the floor, in a way looking ashamed. I gave it a stern look and set about righting the ship before we literally all died again.

The southern coast looked beautiful as we approached, the region known for its lovely weather. One morning, we woke up to see the island looming in the distance. Mr Tiger suggested a little holiday, but Burnie pointed out that we gots a job to do. Again he was not steering. Literally unbelievable. The stick looked smug this time. Stoopid stick. You will pay.

As we got closer we saw that the island contained a built in fortress town kind of thing. It was very beautiful, like a painting. Still being builded. I swung the ship round to the harbour at the back of the town. One of the ships in the harbour was not looking well, all split in two and sinking. We noticed on the beach there was a crowd gathering around what looked like bodies not standing up. Mr Tiger removed his clothes and jumped straight overboard. The rest of us got in the sloop. Burnie left first mate stick in charge.

Mr Tiger was looking for survivors on the boat. The rest of us headed to the beach to offer our help. We found out that it was the myrrh folk. They keep attacking. Apparently myrrh folk is fish people. Apparently the victims were all fishermen. It seems like any efforts at parlance have not worked out good. I asked Burnie why we were here and he said it was for myrrh folk. This is a fortunate turn of events for this man. Mr Tiger came back and said that everyone had been bitten or something. Our new friend on the beach was not impressed by burnie's avian fetish. Burnie now think we are looking for a jeanie. I do not think jeansies exist. Why does he say things at all? He just loves the sound of that syrupy smooth voice. I asked the man about miss gabigail and he said that "laaaady gharbarghast" was up there in the tower. Mr Tiger went investigating the fishermen equipment. Myron piped up to help out with this examination which was nice because I did not think he was here so quiet he was. Eels is water snakes. Lady snakes is worms. Mr Tiger investigated a fresh fish and a lady shouted but Burnie just paid her off to keep her mouth quiet, all efficient like he'd done it before. One shudders to imagine the implications of this. Burnie did not want to help the fisher people (not fish people, the people who capture the fish but are real people) which seemed quite cold and I decided not to tell him I was proud of him reconnecting with his son. We went to the castle.

Burnie tried to charm his way into the castle but it went about as well as you expect. I told him to pay the guards off but he was being cheap. Mr Tiger pointed out that he was very important and Rippy remembered that he had posh privilege as well so he got his gold coat out and the guards were so impressed by it all that they let us in.

We sat in the visitor section. They had little eggsses that didn't taste of much but I was told they are fancy people food. It must not be so good to be so fancy. I hope Burnie doesn't put his sperm on them to make a fish person. A

sweaty man came up to us and Burnie asked him for a wish (he wanted a puppy dog). He asked Burnie to stop touching his head but Burnie refused so he punched Burnie in the tummy. He whisked us on our way to the aunty chamber to see Garbigail. Rippy led the way and...

... burst in "WHAT'S UP WITH ALL OF THESE DEAD PEOPLE" he said nobly. The lady was also not a jeanie. She was a water person but apparently not a myrrh folk. A distinction without a difference perhaps. Rippy took the lead and used his famous name to get her to respect him as fancy people do. Myron told us why we were here because apparently none of us knew why, he said that everyone had heard good things about the lady and we was asking for help from her. Burnie took the tactless approach and told her about the church and all that stuff. Burnie accused Mr Tiger of being a bit 'rapey' in his negotiations tactics because he doesn't put it all out there straight away. Mr Tiger suggested I take Burnie outside and I thought this was a good idea. Later I found out that the negotiations had gone ———. Rippy told her that the church wanted to turn all the water into steam and that would be bad for her. She bought it. Mr Tiger told her about the oppression they had been doing. She bought it, helped along by a little tail wink ;) They asked about the myrrh folk and apparently the lady had only just really arrived here and the myrrh folk are fighting them. The people want to leave apparently. Apparently. Apparently. That's a fun word isn't it. Apparently. Mr Tiger offered his skills as a negotiator to help them out. He doesn't like water and can't breathe in it but he said he would try his best. Rippy asked where they were. Under the sea. Under the sea. Rippy and Mr Tiger agreed to help this beautiful island.

I took some time outside to explain to Burnie why sticks cannot fly 500 tonne arcane machines powered by ghosts. He responded by trying to set a kelp tapestry on fire unsuccessfully. Mr Tiger came out and asked me if I could help him figure out how to talk to the water people. I had an idea for a metal underwater tube but then I found one of Rubricks-Sensei's old magical scrolls that said that it would let all of use breathe under the water for a whole day. That was much easier than I thought it would be and I was very happy that I always keep everything on me all the time for just this type of emergency. Pat on the back Exme.

As we walked to the town Mr Tiger educated us about the very important negotiation tactic of

taking hostages. I suggested we could take a boat out and pretend to be fishermens and capture one. Rippy pointed out that that is just fishing. I told Burnie to buy a boat and he did so. The man looked very sad to lose his beloved boat but he also looked happy about the 100 gold that Burnie gave him. I told them about my old friend from the village who was a fisherwoman called annette. We found the boat and it was fully stocked with all the necessary fishing supplies so we went out to the sea! Burnie got his hook trapped in the boat floor. Mr Tiger kept pawing at the fish like the little cats do on the fish pond. The water was so crysstal blue. You could almost see all the way to the bottom! And I even caught a fish even though I had never caught one before (I let it go again because I thought it was better that way). Mr Tiger talked to one of the fish (sorry, the fish talked to him) and he said we should follow it because it knew where the myrrh fols was so we started out rowing. We got to where the fish said and Burnie almost instantly jumped in. It was a shame because we had not done the spell yet.

Burnie said he got deeper and deeper and eventually when he was very deep and his eye had made it all light for him he saw a city!!! And it was full of stone and coral buildings with glowing plants and fish all around. Lots of naked myrrh folk which he explained to me in far too much detail. One was riding on a shark apparently but that sounded a little farfetched. Burnie realised he was losing air and he said the shark man started swimming towards him. Burnie desperately started swimming up and pulling himself up the anchor chain, even going so stupid as to use his electric shock powers to try and increase his speed. Mr Tiger started pulling up the anchor and just as Burnie got up to us a massive shark like jumped at him and just missed him. The fish man riding it threw a harpoon but it missed him. Lucky. Mr tiger was on it and perceived everything and threw a grappling hook at the fish man immediately and was even amazing at that too and it just grabbed the guy immediately. FIGHT

Mr Tiger tried to grab the fish man. The shark jumped up over the boat and Rippy took a shot. A majestic shot into a majestic beast. The shark tried to bite Mr Tiger. And it did. The fish man was mounted on the shark and Mr Tiger kept holding onto the chain. The fish man tried to get the grappling hook off and did it because Mr Tiger was distracted by the shark bite. Fish man also harpooned Mr Tiger too and pulled him overboard. I took a shot at the shark. Burnie had caught his peg leg after the shark opened its mouth. He tried to save Mr Tiger and did it but

Mr Tiger said he had it under control. Rippy did something amazing and considered healing Mr Tiger, and then even more amazingly he did it by touching him thirty times. Teamwork. Mr Tiger, feeling invigorated jumped into the water and stabbed the shark with his sword literally to death. He turned towards the fish man and fisted him to intimidate him. They struggled weakly against each other but then they started swimming down. I found a spare pair of jump boots and I put them in the water. They swam towards the fish man with little propellers and they went on him and then they started pulling him up towards the boat. He was very close so Burnie tried to grab him and he did and we got him in the boat with Mr Tiger. We had him.

Mr Tiger roared right into his face as he lay there pinned on the ground. Rippy asked him if he thought "a merchild could ever be born who could swim faster than a shark?". Burnie told me to put the helmet on him so he could understand us. He looked shocked as he understood our words. Mr Tiger told him about what was going on and the helmet dance started between Mr Tiger. He was called A-coon-eye. Mr Tiger explained that he was a medeator and very interested in what was going on. We tried to explain that the land people are just fishing because he thinks they are devastating their lands. The fish are the fish people's cattle he said and that the land people was stealing. Rippy offered a policy based treaty thing concerning fishing quotas. He said that we would need to speak to king o-ssu-nai of the waves who would speak to us or maybe kill us. Mr Tiger suggested a neutral meeting place and A-coon-eye said he would take a message for us. Mr Tiger asked if he looked like those other people. A-coon-eye said yes because no gills. Mr Tiger pressed the point more making specific reference to his fur. Burnie asked him why he couldn't go into the water deeper. A-coon-eye was like, mate this is where we live isn't it, not moving. Burnie suggests that the fish people could just give the land people stuff for free. He does not understand how things work. Mr Tiger created a break out room at the stern of the ship and explained politely to Burnie why he was wrong about almost everything. I showed him my dinglehopper. Mr Tiger used the word 'synergy' which really seemed to clinch the deal and pushed him over the edge. The fish man did not know where to meet and Burnie pointed out that they might just send a small army to us.

We waited for about ten minutes. Then we started noticing the waves. Suddenly up through the surface came o-ssu-nai and ten other soldier ones and a shark lady with pearls that was twice

as big as the other sharks. They stood on their sharks looking at us. King O-ssu-nai had his squad. King O-ssu-nai told us we'd accidentally captured the head of his guard. Burnie suggested we meet on the ship like an idiot. I could not believe it. King O-ssu-nai told us we would have to bring the people to the palace. Mr Tiger suggested we'd bring them on a bigger boat on account of how land people cannot breathe. It was agreeable. No-one even died (apart from that shark). We set off and told them we would be back in two days. Some of the fish people were eyeing up Rippy. Curious. Rippy hit himself in the groin in an intimidating fashion.

We headed back to shore, happy with all the new fish people friends we had made. Myron seemed disappointed we hadn't done more killing. We went to see the lady abargail and told her about the negotiation success. Mr Tiger informed the Lady that he was going to use this 48 hours to turn the Lady's staff into the most effective negotiation team that has ever existed. He gestured through to the next room where he had already set up his powerpoint presentation. Time to synergise.

I spent some time making some little translators.

What a happy day :)

Epilogue

Myron and Stanri sat on the beach enjoying the warmth of the sun and the gentle lapping of the ocean. The beach was relatively empty today, probably because of all the killings. Myron turned to his robot companion. "So...". Stanri looked back at him with his giant glowing eyes. Myron continued. "Do you er.. Enjoy being a bear?". Stanri appeared to consider this for a moment and then turned back to look out to the sea. 'What must it be like to be him?', thought Myron, 'Does he even know what's going on? I mean. He's just metal n shit isn't he? Is he even a he? It? Jeez. He's probably the first thing that there's ever been like him. Except for all them crazy robot women. What must that be like?'. He looked over at Stanri who was now lying flat on the sand. 'Who am I even?' thought Myron. 'I used to think I knew. But then all this happened. Negotiations. Sleeping indoors. Friends. Feelings. Who knew?'. Stanri eased himself up onto his legs and padded down to the ocean, snapping at the incoming waves and pawing at the sand. 'Is he happy?'. Myron looked out across to the horizon. 'Am I?'. Stanri came back to Myron and dropped a still-flopping ocean fish at his feet then looked up at him, his big eyes close to Myron's face. Myron could see his own reflection

in them. He looked older, more tired. But there was something else in there too, something he hadn't noticed before. In a way, it suited him he thought. He raised a hand and patted Stanri on the head. "Good boy".

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HwqQclvmC68>

EPISODE 61: ARBITROUTION

WE got back to New Dabaghost to relax after some intense negotiations with the fishmen. We have 2 days to gather ourselves and steel the Dabbers for the tough discussions that are sure to follow.

Vuthelle says they trade with the mainland, but the fish troubles have put a real "spanner barb" in the works (look it up). Their community is close to collapse. I sense a business opportunity. After the discussions BlackRock can help them get their new economy going, for a healthy slice of the fish pie of course. I send Bobacious a raven to set the wheels in motion. This could be a prime candidate to road test our new currency.

Tigerius says he could eat the fishmen. He's probably right. Do tigers eat fish? He wants to build bridges and canals to anywhere. For war, and trade! And cos he just seems to want to build shit and take over the world. Myron says he doesn't want to piss in Tigerius' trumpet, but he tells Tigger that that isn't really the plan.

I suggest we replace religion after the fall of the church with the beliefs of the Guild of Gary, which seem overall more positive and beneficial to society. Myron and I get into the nitty gritty of theological debate and spiritual beliefs and their place in society at large. We realise our religion and beliefs don't even have a name. Much ecumenical reform will be needed when we bring down the church.

Sidenote: Exme needs to invent light bulbs and the electrical grid.

The group discuss their arbitration role in the upcoming negotiations.

We sail out to the meeting point. The fish-king Oceany has a throne on the back of a whale. Sweet. The fish king boards our ship. He says his name is "Yourliege". Yourliege Oceany, fair enough. Bernie audibly hears Lady Dabbaghost moisten at the impressive sight of Oceany.

There's some regal back and forth pleasantries. Oceany accuses the Lady and her peoples of

raping his . . . lands? She says obviously they didn't know, they're just trying to rebuild after the sea raped their old actual lands. There's probably some irony in there somewhere.

The group starts popping off buzzwords in the hope it impresses the Fish King. The Fish King says we speak many words, but his people are a people of substance and direct meaning not verbosity. What do we want and what can we offer them. His helmet malfunctions slightly.

I wonder what exactly it is that we land folk CAN offer a perfectly content underwater population. I describe the wonder that is lemon trees and other exotic fruit. We stumble on alcohol. Turns out D'abberghast is an alcoholic. She aggressively steers the conversation back to the whole mass murder situation.

Tigerius brings it straight back to trade though with his keen business acumen identifying metal and weapons as a key missing element to under sea life.

We seem to be coming to a vague ending to the negotiations. Everyone's roughly on board with the trade and free movement idea. But the King tells us he has other enemies and that us land folk are the lesser of his worries. He wants us to kill some other motherfuckers. Typical. I ask if they've attempted a trade agreement with these people. But it turns out they aren't a people, but an. . . it. Akroneth The IMMORTAL. Should be easy enough to kill then.

We agree to this, though I worry about the efficacy of land weapons when used under water. Especially against AKRONETH THE FUCKING IMMORTAL.

The negotiation disbands and Dab says we can feast and stay at the palace. Tigerius mysteriously says he's not coming as he needs to talk to his birds and fish. . . or something. Everyone's very suspicious and weirded out. Exme says she's not coming to fight the unkillable sea creature because her gun will kill us all if she does. She says she'll make some stuff for us though.

Bernie offends Lady Dabbagonalley by pushing her about her apparent fish fetish, warning her that Oceany might try and ejaculate on her eggs. Tigerius, who apparently has come to the feast, take Bernie away. The Lady wishes us luck for the impossible suicide mission.

The group retire and Bernie's pillow sprouts a mouth that whispers "biiiird fuckeerrrrrr" at him. He fucks the mouth.

The group inspect their fish weapons: tridents, bidents, unidents, harpoon guns. Exme has made us fancy goggles too so we can breathe.

We set out on our ocean quest. We come across the horrible poison water. Stanri dimly lights the way with his low-beams. I save my daylight spell for later.

We are set upon by some fishfuckers. Shark riders coming at us fast in their natural habitat. Tigerius lines up his bident to try and lance the oncoming sharky bois.

One of them tries to hump Bernie, but I shoot him dead. Like shooting fish in a barrel. But the barrel is the ocean.

Tigger claws the bigger shark boi badly, but he's still standing. Swimming. Sitting?

Myron doesn't know how to use his new harpoon gun and he accidentally lets go of it and it drifts away from him.

Bernie stabs the fuck out of a shark. Twice. The shark tries to bite him, but misses. He riposts. Good night sharky. He says something about his erections.

I shoot the other sharky boi. The big shark bites Tigger and the sharky boi double stabs him and also bites him. Bad day for a tiger to take up swimming. Tig gets his revenge, both parties badly bloodied.

Myron tries to use his gloves as a weapon ineffectively. But he tries again and gloves the sharky boi to death. Brutal. The shark bites him as he tries to swim away to grab him harpoon gun that has served him so well so far.

Burnie xbox's the shark really hard. I shoot at it too. Stanri, who is also here, scratches at it. The shark bites Tig. The shark, fearing for its life, swims away and quickly vanishes. Phew, threat over. Now we only have immortal ancient sea monsters to worry about.

We press on and the water becomes a thick muck, sticky, cloying, oily, musky, and generally repulsive. We reach what appears to be the bottom of the sea and find a shipwreck. Surrounded by darkness, we spy an opening into the seabed with what feels like infinity beyond. We start to hear demonic voices in our heads.

"New play things, you will be mine. Cum. Cum."

EPISODE 62: RELEASE THE (GOOD KRACK)EN



Acroneth the immortal - well, maybe, he is old as balls, so who knows? Makes the water poisonous, but Exme made nice inhalers that let us breath and not get poisoned.

Fought some sharks and nasty merfolk. Came to a weird voice, speaking to us telepathically.

We try negotiating with the ugly fucker - Myron tells him he only sees things as People or Monsters, which do you want to be? Acroneth responds with there being only 2 things to it, itself and playthings.

He says myron will get everyone killed, everyone thinks Burnie's a fool, and he perfectly correctly pronounces Riphards name. Tony suggest a deal, we have a pow-wow.

He gives us 3 options, fight, leave one of us, or leave all of us. Horny fish-man.

Exme jumps out of Stanri's trunk.

Myron realises the monster is a monster, and thanks the monster that he now knows this. The damned bastard psycho-blasts us. Exme shoots it. It then creates phantasmal forces that affect Myron (his father Jorj falling into a ravine) and Riphard (all his gold floating away, just not, y'know, his wife or children).

It turns out the damned thing was an illusion, which Tiger-man finds out when he spears through it.

Then Mr Quippy appears - Several schools of quippers. . . all controlled by the aboleth-bastard. They all appear and attack Myron. Eviscerating the shit out of him. The aboleth tail-smacks him and he goes down. Exme runs in, heals him, and throws a portable shield away. Acroneth attempts another tail swipe despite this. He then blitz us with psychic damage, and repeatedly fails at tail swiping.

Myron challenges tony to a race, and starts swimming upwards. Another tail swipe. Myron is looking pretty crappy.

The aboleth sucks, literally, we all get sucked towards it. Burnie twats some quippers, but not enough to die, Tony twats Myron down, and Riphard becomes a healing aura. Myron lives!

Myron politely asks Tony out of his enslavement with a harpoon. Exme then stops time with the Die of Rubrex totally accidentally. This might be amazing. She shoots the bastard.

We're starting to wail on the Aboleth, but it starts summoning a load of bullshit. Sharks

arrive and rip Exme a new one, and fail to rip anything out of Anthony. Anthony fails to rip anything out of the aboleth. . .

Rip heals Myron, Stanri gets knocked down. But he gets up again, aint never going to keep him down.

Aboleth is healing itself with psychic powa. Stanri bite the bastard in a biiiig way. It tail swipes in response, knocking out stanri.

Kraken Boi does his suck again, and we all get moved close. Exme is getting slimey again, going through puberty no doubt. Everyone starts raining fire and fury down onto the Aboleth, exme takes a beating after her and burnie try to combo, but she ignores it, swims upwards, and sends it to oblivion - "You shouldn't have mentioned my brother"

The fish scatter, we survive, exhausted. And find a chest in the pirate ship with about 5k gold dubloons. Exme and Anthony are burned by the air when we swim up, but riphard cures their diseases. Myron smokes an underwater cigarette, not realise it shouldn't work, and somehow making it so.

I take a couple of teeth from the aboleth.

We rest on the boat before travelling back down to the Sea-Prince Oceani, and the Thalassia. We show him the teeth and he's going to investigate, but ultimately we did him a solid, and he'll do the same for us.

We all have a nice party, which exme abstains from to build Stanri - king Oceani gets invited too, and everyone's all happy.

The next day, Myron showcases a new flag and secret symbol for our group, #blessed.

<https://youtu.be/kb9R7EErUVY>

Post credits scene: Burnie slinks out of his room at the crack of dawn. The parties over, and everyone is at rest or will be soon, before the inevitable hangovers in the morning. Evil vanquished and friends made, a bridge between the worlds of land and sea. He's got a bucket in his hook, wearing nothing but a skimpy masudan robe, his chest visible with its scars and marks from a lifetime of strife. New are the shining disks pushed into his major muscles, but newer still are the sucker-marks on his neck and chest.

He proceeds up the stairs and towards the side of the airship, still docked in new Dabbagast port. He stumbles for a second over a foreign object, missed by his still-covered darkvision eye, clutching his illicit package with care and protectiveness as water slops onto the deck.

"Oh, sorry there First Mate Stick," he says as relief floods him "I forgot you'd be doing the rounds this night, though you shouldn't be lying down on the job. Ah, must have had a skinful as well, aye?" he finishes as he props his companion tenderly on a nearby wall, before proceeding to the matter at hand, er, hook.

He reaches into the bucket, fondly strokes the creature within, and proceeds to upend the octopus into the sea, blowing a kiss with his remaining good hand. "Not the worst thing I've done after a night of partying," he says to himself, rubbing the tender flesh of his suckered neck with mingled shame and longing.

"But damned close."

EPISODE 63: SHORT CHANGE

REPORT TO THE ADVISOR TO THE MAYOR OF TOM'ARDY FROM OPERATIVE IN GOLDING'S BAY

 O Lady Yvette Von Realname, The airship you requested information on was heading towards town from the southwest, and landed in the water by the jetty.

Only three of the occupants disembarked, although they were heard arguing with others on the ship to "stop being so soft and come out and play". They do not succeed, and head into town below alone.

They walked into a square and, outside of the temple, saw a female Arbiter arguing with the halfling Mayor of Golding's Bay, Jerald Fingerbottom, who the gnomish Arbiter referred to in your briefing as M initially seems to mistake as Farnelle Green, the current Deputy Mayor, who he seems to have had dealings with in the past.

Jerald appears to have been in the process of chastising the female Arbiter for not being quick enough to bring reinforcements in to deal with the S.R.A. presence around town.

As mentioned in my previous correspondences, the S.R.A, under the recent ascension of the new leader Freyer Thistlebloom, have had the town under a sort of light siege; disrupting fishing crews, caravans, and travel into and out of town.

M promised Freyer that the two Arbiters will look into it, and they head off to a local patisserie. It appears that M knows the female

arbiter, who he refers to as Kiros, and on the way to the bakery they begin to catch up.

Meanwhile, E, the small goblin girl, was apparently wandering around town, trying to convince passersby that she is a member of the S.R.A. for what is presumably a good reason. She seems to have procured explosive rockets from somewhere, which is worrying.

At the patisserie, B seems to have attempted to disguise himself as. . . I apologise, my lady, but I could not discern what he was supposed to be. He was wearing a white cloth on his head on which he had written "CHIEF", had crudely drawn a moustache onto his face with a pen, and was calling himself "Geiseppe Gespacio".

The two Arbiters caught up, swapping tales. The reports given by M are summarised in the attached document, but seem to cover the events of the last few weeks, based on the timeline supplied within the briefing pack.

Arbiter Kiros describes the actions of the S.R.A. in more detail, and is surprised at the level of tactical acuity evident in their acts. They do not seem to be operating on a similar basis as other chapters of the organisation, and Kiros seems to believe that this is down to the new direction of Miss Thistlebloom.

M seems distracted by the idea of restoring the old mayor, Farnelle Green, to his post, convinced that Mr Fingerbottom used foul play to achieve his current position. It would seem that he is not best possessed towards halflings.

"Geiseppe" was shouting loudly in the kitchen in what sounded like an offensive pastiche of a foreign language, although, as far as I could tell, the only other person in the kitchen was a handsome, if thin, gentleman whom B addressed as "Chef Stick".

The two arbiters decided, eventually, to go and find the camp of the S.R.A. group and strike before they can do much more damage.

At that exact moment, a local man came to the door reporting that he has seen an S.R.A. member walking around making threats, and that he has come to report her to the Arbiters. He also, somewhat sheepishly admitted that she had accompanied him to this location for some reason or other. The suspect was, of course, revealed to be E, who claims that she was asking to be "led to the patisserie", not "supporting the S.R.A.". M thanked the man for his prompt work and invites E to join them at their table.

The man got confused and left.

The Party Incurring Examination (P.I.E.) head off into the woods, along with Arbiter Kiros, in order to locate the camp of the S.R.A.

M led the way, looking for tracks that might lead them to one of the temporary camps that Freyar has been operating from. Kiros informed the P.I.E. that Freyar has appointed 8 lieutenants to aid her in her revolution, and suggested that it might be prudent to try and take them out one by one. The party felt, however, like that sounded like far too sensible an idea, and want to try to take out Freyar in one big go.

As they walked, with me trailing unseen, it became increasingly obvious that M has some problems with halflings. He mentioned vaguely some past tragedy, but I suspect that it is also possible that he is just a bad person.

After walking through the undergrowth for some time, they found a set of tracks in the undergrowth. M investigated them closely, and was excited to identify only one of them as halfling. One of the others seemed to be goblin, at least, they closely resembled E's, and the third were clawed, lizard-like appendages.

They followed the tracks for some time and eventually came across a hastily constructed camp, surrounded by wooden palisades. The Arbiters were planning a synchronised assault, attacking from all sides at once. E, didn't seem as willing to slaughter these small people, and suggests the short members of the P.I.E. should enter the camp, pretending that they were sympathetic to the cause.

The tall people began sneaking off to hide in the bushes while M and E strolled into the camp and make casual conversation.

A female halfling, who was revealed to be Freyar, greeted them warmly by name, and introduced them to two of her lieutenants, the goblin and the kobold whose tracks they had found. I admit, I wasn't expecting everything to go as wrong as quickly as it did, even after your briefing.

E and M were attempting to "play it cool" and ignore that Freyar seemed to know everything about them and why they were there and continue the ruse. They seemed to be asking for her to engage the S.R.A. to help them with something, but from my position, hidden well away from the action, as you insisted, I could not ascertain precisely what they were talking about.

Freyar, however, insisted that her chapter had no ties with the main corpus of the S.R.A., and

that her band of 9 were all that were required. It seems that she resented the lack of what I hear is referred to as "Strats and Tats" present in the rest of the organisation. I must say that, looking at what this group of 9 had achieved, it is hard to argue with the difference between the methodologies.

M suggested that maybe a summit with all the members of both parties - the 9 members of this S.R.A. unit and the P.I.E. - so that they could agree some sort of treaty that was agreed upon by all parties. Being an excellent student of character (I hope you do not find me immodest for saying so), I suspected that it was more likely that M intended to find some way of killing all 9 members at once.

Freyar asked why they couldn't agree the terms now, M stated again that they should have the rest of the party present, which was a particularly ironic time for Arbiter Kiros to tumble loudly through a bush and into plain view.

From this point on, my Lady, the events which transpired took place in quick succession and you must forgive me if I leave any part of this description unfulfilled. Some of the events I witnessed have no rational explanation, and it is only to respect your request for a report of details that seem out of the ordinary that I do not dismiss much of it as the feverish imaginings of an overworked brain.

As Kiros fell, before she even impacted the ground, three oddly shaped daggers shot from a tree near the boundary of the camp, and wounded her severely. Freyar, noticing this happen, took her eyes from M and E for a moment, and M, sensing that battle was afoot, lept towards her, and, within an instant, had assailed her with both gun and bayonet.

E pulled out a cube-shaped object from her pack, and manipulating it, suddenly, along with M, seemed to be outside the camp. I swear, I did not see them move, but somehow, beyond all reason, they were outside the camp.

Two more of Freyar's Lieutenants had concealed themselves within the trees, and together they attacked the party, showing little mercy. Freyar herself, wielding, of all things, a lute, strode towards the group, confidently, and spoke a few words I did not understand. As she did, E and B looked at her with pure terror, as if they saw her as Fear itself.

Kiros and B, along with E's bear, had been revealed from their hiding by all this, and were standing exposed, being attacked with more

bolts and daggers. The two lieutenants who had been standing with Freyar in the camp, ran up to engage with them. One struck E in such a way, that she stood stock still, seemingly unable to move a muscle.

B, still looking towards Freyar as if she were a being of pure horror, flees the situation, running deep into the woods, and not seeming to slow down.

Suddenly, the area in which they were all standing was obscured by total darkness, blacker than any night. I could see no visible source of this umbra, no shade to shield the light - and besides, none could be so absolute.

Around this time, it became apparent that M was under the impression that Freyar was the halfling who ate his mother. Your file did not mention this, my lady, and I honestly cannot say whether I believe it or not. When challenged by one of the other party members, he insisted she looked the same as the cannibal halfling in questions, but I do not trust this testimony at all.

By this point, my hold on this battle was severely shaken, as, as I'm sure you can imagine, was your humble reporter. However, it was obvious even to me that Freyar and her henchmen had the upper hand.

This observation was revealed to be more canny than I realised, however, as shortly after this, Freyar thanks the P.I.E. and Kiros warmly for vacating the town while her forces work, mutters something, and vanishes.

Believe me, I did not take my eyes off her, and I have no idea what mechanism could allow her to do such a thing, but she vanished. Unlike M and E, a few moments previously, she did not reappear, and the rest of her group ran off in the direction of Golding's Bay.

Realising immediately that they had been duped, the P.I.E. took stock. M took a moment rummage through some of the contents of the camp, looking for information on the source of the remarkable powers shown during the battle.

The only item of much note retrieved was a book, which caused debate initially because it was written in an unknown language, and subsequently because it appeared to be completely blank. This day's events continue to confound me, and I promise you my Lady, the surprises are not over yet.

The P.I.E. rushed back to Golding's Bay, but they evidently lagged behind Freyar and her companions, as when they arrived into town,

they found it mostly deserted. Arbiter Kiros, who has developed an understanding of the town and its people, suggested that it was most likely that, in the event of an incursion, the townsfolk would have secured themselves inside the temple.

As they approached the temple, they heard horrible screams from inside, and they rushed to the door, to come to the aid of the civilians trapped inside.

Or, my Lady, that is what I had assumed, hidden in my vantage point at the other side of the square. It is very possible that my judgement of character, that I boasted of so boldly within this report, is far less astute than I thought.

It is very possible, indeed.

I could not see into the temple. I heard gunshots of various sorts. I heard the screams of civilians being cut down where they stood. I heard them slowly die down until only a few whimpers remained, and none of them emerged from the temple.

You gave me a task, my lady. I failed in that task. I am loathe to admit that in that moment, I did not stay. I cannot complete my report. I turned and I fled. I do not know what happened next, and I return my payment, in full, along with this letter.

Do not judge me too harshly, my lady. I did not appreciate the monsters you were asking me to observe.

Your's, still

Yuria Hortize

END CREDITS

[TBC]

PROLOGUE

Lillith reads the letter in her well-appointed office while distractedly pouring herself a Gin and Tonic. Opening her fine mahogany cabinet, and selecting from a few of the more decadent bottles she's been gifted in the few weeks, she decides on one, before turning the paper over and reading the other side.

"What have you gotten yourselves into now?" she mutters, as she takes a slice from a lemon, before rewrapping it in fine paper and returning it to the locked safe built into the cabinet. Her eyes widen slowly as she reads on. She reaches back to the bottles of spirit, and increases the measure she has poured for herself significantly.

As she reaches the bottom of the page, smudged slightly by the authors tears, she fills

her glass further still, before addressing a small portrait standing on her desk.

“Well Burnald, dear. If I’m honest, I’m only surprised it took you so long.”

EPISODE 64: AT DAWN WE PLAN!

I Am a monster, a foul debaser who is unsafe a companion for any creature large or small. The animal inside, is as big as the one seen from the outside. If I had been born a short stack, then at least others could have contained me, but the years of training have only honed my will and ability to maintain my own freedom. As I walk through this valley, I must take a look at myself and either fade away in inevitable decline or hope something larger takes me. Either way these new colleagues of mine will be safer for my absence.

As I stand alone on the prow of the ship, these birds will not leave me alone. I hear the inner screams of my own torment. Until what's this another sound, one more distant. I see screaming and hear people running. This is a crisis situation, I take hold of this majestic boat and wheel it around hard. This people might need me, the might need a hero, could this be the dulcet tones of redemption. There is little time to adjust to these new surrounds, I dash into the church which seems to be at the center of this disquiet. I am met by what I will always refer to as that sight. My until recent comrades are bathed in the blood, with civilians carved up and dead all around them. I take stock, it seems clear that they have massacred these people. "Until recently I almost killed you" its a strong opener, but Myron keeps his weapon in hand, I can't contain it, it rises up like a bile in my gut, the blood of the innocents has been spilt on these grounds, all other targets are unarmed and shocked, Myron looks to still be hostile and either confused or un-repentent. There will either be time later, or there won't neither matter now.

Burnie jumps between us and tries to break us, Myron then talks of escape as the story, Burnie tries to talk them out of it. The marching sounds get louder, I need to buy time for the forces to arrive, these miscreants must be apprehended. As they try to walk away I run around to bar their way again.

Exmerah is in deep shock, vomiting around the bodies littered with holes. Its an impasse, as I feel the hormones running amok within my system. I cannot stand for this. . . .

A thundering yet uninterested voice calls through the halls of the church asking for us all to render ourselves to justice.

Exmerah goes for the easy way out, I understand, we have all done things that are hard to live with, and oftentimes it would seem the easier way out would be death, but it is not.

Not on my watch. It is intense as Myron and Exmerah bicker it out, their eyes fall to the body of an official on the floor with a huge hole in him.

Myron ask Exmerah if she killed these people because she was ensorcelled. Burnie and Myron are clearly looking for exits, they must answer for the crimes committed here. Myron makes a run for it up some stairs and onto a balcony. He is a lost cause but I can still do the right thing here. I walk out pushing the remaining doors wide open, I state my name and cause and drop to my knees in surrender in front of the arbiters.

Myron breaks out of the roof, and Exmerah sends out the giant robot to treat with the arbiters.

"You have 3 seconds to come out!" the arbiter calls out and counts down, on "Go" the armed forces unleash a barage of shot, annihilating the poor robotic dog, they step in line and march into the church. A cavalcade of shot rings out as they are spotted on the balcony.

"I am Rab Burnie Cinders, and you know that name" He shouts as he takes the guns off Myron and Exmerah "I'll kill them both". Its a great strat and at first seems like it might work, until Kyros notifies them that Myron isn't a hobo but in fact a very naughty arbiter. They rush to the roof, looking for the airship, or any other way out. The pursuers close the distance in no time. Burnie appeals to Laz in a last ditch effort to escape. Exmerah pulls out the cube and in an instant all three of them are gone. "I didn't kill my wife" rings out where previously only the peal of bells could be heard. The whole town would care, if they weren't mostly slaughtered below.

I announce to them who I am, and what my rank entitles me to. If I am guilty then I shall answer to the crimes, if not then I shall see them again. At this point the arbiter goes to use that word of truth on me, I have nothing to hide so I succumb, only to find myself admitting to the crimes seen here. This is something I haven't even seen the greatest negotiators manage with such ease. Maybe the ensorcering is true, either way Kyros must have been aware that I was not in the church during the massacre.

It now seems a mute point as I am battered half to death, until I slip into a painful sleep.

The miscreant team reappear in a cupboard, Burnie suggests torturing Toni with a cucumber. Myron takes of his armour, stashing it in the

magic bag of Exmes. In his new guise as normal Myron. Burnie tries to disguise himself and Exmerah, he makes a strong effort in trying to combine Myron and Exmerah into one trench coated person. It's not a great result, and they fall back to individual disguises, luckily the house is empty and the creeping begin. Exmerah spots a family photo of a some very recently deceased people. She removes the photo, rolls it and puts it into her bag. They creep outside, Myron suggest splitting up and keeping in contact using the ear pieces. Everyone is to sneak towards where the airship should be, and then try and get into contact with Riphard. Exmerah gives them both a rocket, Myron extorts her to not get captured and not give herself up.

As they are leaving Burnie sees Toni beaten and battered being dragged away to a steel barred prison wagon. Khaan and Kyros are talking shit about where the airship is, apparently it took off into the sky, but she is sure it will be back. Burnie adds a new boot to his peg leg, in an attempt to make it less obvious who he is. He used the communicator to contact the barely conscious cat.

I lure him closer with talk about the ear-piece that I am wearing. As he comes in to inspect and reaches his arm into the cage, I grab his arm and break it across the bars of the cage, I then grab his face and bounce his head against another bar. Burnie unleashes a bolt from a hidden position killing the guard instantly. I spin on my heels and pull the dead guards sword from his belt before lancing it into the guard behind me. Burnie unleashes another wave of pain into the guard who then starts running and shouts for assistance. Burnie shoots a third and final bolt through the back of the head, three down. Burnie then frees me, out of all of them I would not have put money on it being Rab.

Myron sets off a rocket in a barrel of fish, as we make our escape into the woods. We converge and make our escape. I switch Burnie for Exmerah and keep running until my lungs are on fire. Myron postulates, but I need time to figure out what has taken place. Clearly something has gone amiss, Myron starts trying to explain who Freyer is, but still nothing really makes sense. Why set up Myron and the rest of the group, why not kill them outright and then massacre the town. Why have Myron and the group massacre a whole village. Why does she want Godling bay. None of this makes sense.

Myron leads us further into the woods, until I am certain we are lost. Myron hands out some

jerky that is surprisingly filling. I let the others sleep before asking the animals to watch over us as we sleep.

We wake up cold and wet, the revelations start flowing, it turns out Freyer knew the details of all the party members. Was Kyross part of the plan to frame them, where were these troops, the army was much too large for dealing with just a small SRA group.

Exmerah uses the earpieces to triangulate and boost the signal to get in touch with Riphard. Will she won't she request the return of the airship. She requests the airship return to pick them up. The least subtle airship over a forest scenario then takes place.

There is some debate about where to head to next, Exmerah decides to invent parachutes.

It turns out that Julian Assange the arbiter ate a banana with the skin on, this led to his seeking exile in the masudan embassy for a while.

There is much discussion about what we should do, I for one would like some vengeance. We ascend above the clouds and under a dark starlit night we sleep. A war council will be formed on the morrow, At Dawn We Plan!

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ExLqMBLyWd8>

Epilogue - Sat above in the crows nest alone once again with his thoughts and a few remaining starlings. A lone tiger looks aloft and things to himself, "They are monsters, they are foul debasers, they shall pay for what they have wrought".



This tainted, bitter world. (Map as of Episode 64)

EPISODE 64A: A CRUMPLED BIT OF SCRIBBLED PARCHMENT FOUND IN THE BIN

Opshun I - Fings r wot thay seme

We wennt tu Gultings Beuy, an Kirri woz thar deelin wiv them Essarays, an thay wanted to mez up ther vilidge so thay took uz lot too th wuds so wi wozn't in tarn an then thay kitniped aload ov peeple an trickt uz inta killin em. Den, wen Kiri sow us dooin it (evn tho we dint no we woz) she fort we woz bad an told thu polease bout it.

FINGS WOT DUNT MAIK SENSS IF DATZ TROO:

- Ow did thaay no hoo we woz?
- Ow did tha pulice get der su kwik?
- Wy did Fraier wanna git us arested?
- Wey did Kiri lett Antny taik the wrap wen she new he wont ther?

Opshun II - Kirys alwaze bin bad

Keri tuld Fry an th puleace day wi woz cumin to Goldens Boy, an wurked wiv em to taik us done. Shi woz jus protendin to bi aginst thu Esserais, an agrid ti git us outin to ther wuds so wi wozn't in tarn an than thi kitnabed a bunsh o pilel and triked us inn too killin em, avin alredi told tha poles to cum ere.

PHINS WUT DUNOT MACE CENES IF TATS TRU:

- Wi fraim uz iph shi cud juss sei wire bad anty church peple?
- Kirri

Opshun III - Esarys an Chirch alweze bad. Kris misled.

Curch an Fraya new we wir cumin, maid plan wivute Keri. Crich giv spechul bad powas tu Frier n roturn fur frimin uz. Kier seez uz kilin all thums popal and beleaves it.

- Woi dint Kori fink anyfin woz wird abut pilos bin thaer?
- Wy did Kiriy let Antny tace the rip wen she knew he wosnt thur?

EPISODE 65: NIGHT ON THE TOWN

Suspect Interview #4867

I: Name?
ES: Exmerah Danger Sliokzog
PI: Age?

ES: 7

PI: Occupation?

ES: ..errm. gabrin

PI:

ES:

PI: Tell us in your own words about what happened again.

ES: Okay so like, we were on the airship and like, Rippy (the racist one). Rippy was wondering what all the blood was about and Myron wanted the stone of unfala that I told you about (the one that takes us to hell to talk to the elephant lady and the demon man). Myron (the mysterious one that is a bit of bad boy and you think you can probably change but also you learn a lot about yourself one) was not very tired so he asked Mr Tiger (the tiger one) to hit him and he hit him so hard he fell asleep and went to hell. Myron said that Mr Lazarus greeted him in his office and then Myron asked him all about Kiros and Mr Lazarus said he could contact her with magic. It turned out that she was asleep and Mr Lazarus said he would send Myron into her dream. In her dream she was naked but Myron said he didn't look and also she was all bruised and crying in the corner. He lit a load of prayer candles and she said she didn't want to speak. Also Burnie (the paedophile one) was there too.

PI: The paedophile one?

ES: Yes remember I told you he has all those files with pictures of people's feet in. So anyway, it turned out that Kiros had been trapped in her dream for weeks! Which means it might not have even been her that we saw when she betrayed us. Myron said that she thought she might have been in the Seven Spire and that we had been seeing an imposture! Kiros had been tortured and had told them about all about us and even about excallibrum. They went back to Mr Lazarus and Burnie talked about his love of files some more. Myron woke up and told us all about how Kiros had been captured. Hmppf. I told him I prefer Arbiters that don't get captured amirite? Anyway. Burnie pointed out that Freya had never actually disguised herself in front of us and even went so far as to say maybe Kolo might have been involved. Kolo is my brother who ripped out the spies spine and is evil now that I told you about. I was pretty sure he wasn't capable of making a whole room of people transform into zombies.

PI: You're referring to the entire village that you slaughtered?

ES: Yes exactly! Remember I told you that they had all been disguised as zombies by someone who wanted to trick us. Where was I? Oh yeah. Myron thought we should burn down the forest to get to Freya. Burnie invented the field of social math. Rippy pointed out that we did not even know about if Freya was a real person, which was intriguing and we knew that the mayor knew her but also fake Kiros did so who knows. Myron thought we should try and get into town and gauge public opinion. Burnie reminded everyone that we killed way more people than in Tom'ardy and Rippy started crying.

PI: Less people than Tom'ardy?!?

ES: Sorry, fewer people. But anyway, we were wondering how fake Kiros knew so much about us and suddenly we remembered that Lillith had been reporting back to Kiros on everything so that must of been how she knew! Spies everywhere! We started discussing ways to disguise ourselves to get into town. Rippy thought of maybe either shaving his beard or growing a new one underneath the current one. He also thought that we could start a questionnaire campaign and get people to send them to a PO box which is

PI: A prostitute outhouse box, yes I'm familiar.

ES: You would probably like my friend Burnie. He is a big fan of prostitute architecture as well. Burnie had a weird blank book that he asked me to look at and it turned out that there was a strong powerful magic residue left in it. Mr Tiger thought it would have been transforming magic. Turns out that the text that was there was gone and it was probably some kind of weird remote spell and someone did magic to remove the writing. Very odd. I knew it was powerful but nothing more. Myron thought we should go back and we knew that we had to do it to help people and make sure that no-one else died. We headed back to town to find out more information. Burnie went off to write a letter to Lillith. We discussed whether or not she was a spy. Rippy suggested we give up so he could go be a good father. I asked him how his children were and he said he did not even know where they were. Mother always said an absent father is a strong father. Character building. Rippy followed that up with a kidnapping idea. I volunteered to go down into town and gather information.

PI: Okay. This is when you claim to have 'been invisible'

ES: Yes like I said I used the magic cube that we got from the old wizard in the tower full of ghosts and snake people. Rippy made the point that we might not even know who was real or not real. This was a good point but Myron said sometimes you just gotta accept stuff and get on with things. And also he pointed out that the cube could make me fly

PI: Fly?

ES: Yes. I'm not sure what you are not getting about this cube. Right so Rippy gave me a friendly push off the edge of the airship and I started falling to the ground and turned invisible on the way down and used a new thing I made which is a like blanket that makes you slower when you're falling. I hit the ground and dumped the blanket. I was just outside Golding's Bay. We send the poor gabrin over-board, the last thing I see is a smile and a wink as she falls backwards off the edge of the ship and down into the clouds below.

PI: Mr Tiger

T: Actually it's Tigerius.

PI: As you wish. Please describe what happened once Exmerah got into the village.

T: Exmerah heads into town a small small gabrin in a wide and wondrous world, that without a doubt would kill and dismember her if she was ever seen. Fortune shone bright on her this day though as she was fully transparent, so in many ways fortune shone right through her which was much more beneficial.

She comes across a pile of bullet ridden metal, Stanri her lost bear. A figment of her fevered imagination when she was a child, who was briefly a hulking behemoth of a bear. More machine now than bear the animal went down shielding its master, a good boy if ever there was one. She pulls out the memory cards and gently says goodbye before heading towards the church. Candles flicker in the back as few towns folk are seen mopping up the carnage of the last conflict, which was rather one sided in the end.

Exmerah moves on, things to do, people to see, ten leaflets to put out among the people. She finds a stable, and sheds a tear for unknown reasons before setting up a 40minute fuse on a few rockets. Before taking the backstreets to the mayors offices, all the while listening in on the local gossip "Makes you sick, doesn't it. That someone would do something like this. I really hope they get these people" grumble some local guards. She leaves a leaflet, cast away like the hearts of so many young gabrins.

Here Ye Here Ye, the evil cult of Sin worshippers murdered the people of Goldings Bay, with some very well drawn portraits of the whole party. A notice on the town board. She puts up three flyers and stashes the big poster, she now has a rather nice team portrait.

As she closes in she comes across Arbiter Khan, and a mystery dark man, and the mayor Farnell Green. Farnell can remain the mayor if he tows the line and reports all information about the whereabouts of our group back to the Church.

Do not take these people on yourself, they have been gifted powers from Sinn and are running amok trying to cause an insurrection against the church. This group are really bad news. He bails on the stupid conversation with the old furniture moving bluff.

On a hunch Detective Exmerah skulks into the mayors office, there is smoke in the air, and she is so taken in with the dark brooding atmosphere that she knocks over a hat stand. She clicks down the voice modulator on her helmet, and starts to put the spooks into Mayor Farnell. "You let us die!!... .. the photo of the dead family then floats over to him, he turns a deadly shade of pale as he looks at it, before he picks up the hat stand to defend himself. "The church are using you" echoes around the room as hot urine runs down legs. "You let the church slaughter us for political gain"

"This is some BULL SHIITT"

Exmerah tries to deftly jump out of the window, but trips on some paper work as she does. Its all the noise the Mayor needs, he swiftly brings the hat stand down on her back as she gets out the window. The feel of solid flesh under the hat stand raises some pertinent questions.

She tracks down Khan flitting between the houses as they get shabbier and shabbier on the outskirts of town. She comes across the Churches wagons, the teams seem to be packing up ready to leave. They are racking and stacking rifles and ammunition. She puts a long fuse on her remaining rockets. As she is doing so a guard spots her behind some barrels. She dabs the fuse much further down, shortening the timing considerably. "Must be some of that Sinn magic they got" "After Them" finally some competent guards she thinks as she runs off. "Look there's tracks being formed, follow the tracks"

She hides behind a bucket, unfortunately the bucket isn't as big as she is. The guards are genuinely good at this, and follow the tracks to

behind the bucket where he stabs wildly, the wee lass gasps and ducks just in time. She kicks the bucket one way, and runs the other way. There is a lot of decking in this town she thinks, and so desperately scrabbles up the side a wooden house. She looks down on the guards, and is relieved as confusion seems to spread. From the vantage point of the top of the house, she gets her bearing and locates the forest. A stable ignites in the distance as she fumbles the cube and everything slows down to a snails pace around her. This is not the flying experience she was hoping for.

She leaps down off the house and makes a run for, as she sprints past a guard she goes to pants him but her inexperience in the boudoir means she starts to fumble with the belt. She high tails it out as fast as possible out of the town. Time kicks back into its normal routine as a guard spots her, and the chase resumes. The gabrins figure blurs as she sprints into the distance, the guards raise their shotguns and unleash a hail of pellets, one of which clips her in the heel as she flees.

ES: So then like I'm running as fast as I can half full of bullets and there's no sign of the airship. So many church soldiers behind me. Suddenly I see a blur up above me. It turns towards me and what looks like a tiger falls out of it attached to a rope then stops in mid air and goes still. Apparently Burnie had saw me and Mr Tiger had jumped off on his grappling hook to try and save me. So brave. I wondered who was driving the airship. It didn't matter, the airship turned towards me again. A handsome shaped figure slid down the rope and landed hard on the tiger shape then went still. I carried on running. The soldiers carried on shooting but Mr Tiger started firing back. I took another spalrge of bullets as I activated my jump boots

PI: Jump boots?

ES: I told you they are the flying shoes that make you fly a little bit. Anyway, Mr Tiger caught me and Burnie started pulling us up. We got onto deck and Myron asked us what I saw. His hands were all burned from the rope. I got some vodka and cleaned them up while I told everyone what I had learned. Rippy enquired about the flyers and I told him I had handed them out and lied about also giving out the pre paid envelopes. Burnie revealed that First Mate Stick had been flying all along. I was so wrong about him and I went up to apologise to him and make amends. He stared back in a forgiving manner. Burnie took over the flying while we got rested up. I showed everybody our poster but Burnie was not happy about the quality of his

drawing. Cult of Synne. Got a ring to it actually. Rippy hoped it didn't affect our share value.

ES: We set off and I spent some time bandaging up Myron and Mr Tiger. As we flew over the world Mr Tiger told me all the things about trading and ekonomiks and he told me other things too. He told me about the animals, and showed me the strange scribbles he had made in the boat railing. The writing disappeared and a little beautiful bird came to him. Amazing. Myron shot the bird and ruined the moment a little bit but Mr Tiger continued. Burnie shouted something really weird about getting his own surrogate daughter. He and I have very different impressions of our relationship. When I turned back, Mr Tiger had gone. . .

PI: And that's when you claim to have returned to hell?

ES: Yes. We fell asleep and woke up in Mr Lazarus' office. Elephants are female mammoths. Mr Lazarus was lost for words and seemed flustered. He told us that he gets his information from people who die when they come in to hell. He said that he didn't quite understand but some people who have died recently, well, their souls just didn't exist anymore. Burnie asked the question. Are they really dead? Lazarus was audibly confused. Myron asked what could be done with souls. Mr Lazarus thought he had a way of tracking souls through some old equipment but he couldn't find them anywhere. Either the souls were being destroyed or they were going somewhere beyond Mr Lazarus' knowledge. He still could not find much on Kalimar either except for vague riddles. Apparently, the death numbers were not matching up. The theory: someone is stealing souls. Mr Tiger offered his talents as an accountant to look for trends or oddities in the soul records from the last 100 years. Necronomics. Myron asked how many people from the church had arrived. They should have gone to heaven but all came here. Myron says he is going to start making records of who we kill. We came up with a plan. We need to go to the Spires.

Epilogue

Tigerius walked in through the front door and took in the depravity all around him. The whores desperately trying to drum up business with the men who were now too drunk to say no. The fight in the corner, surely over nothing more sinister than a glance in the wrong direction. The fire burning low with a group of flea ridden mutts desperately trying to get a glimpse of

warmth before the barkeep threw them out. The whole place stank of stale ale and shame. Over at the far side of the bar he saw the little goblin figure surrounded by a pile of empty bottles. As he got closer he heard her shouting at no-one in particular, gesturing towards the wall. "Yesh i tolds you didn't i like invishible i was there and they cudnt even sseemme". He walked over. "Now now little one. What's going on here?" he asked in his kindest tone. The little goblin girl turned towards him, here eyes bloodshot and full of tears. "I wash jhust telling the inspektor here. I wash telling him about wat reaaly happened". He could smell the alcohol from three feet away. "I ddin't mean to do it" she said softly. "I dddint know". The tears came faster now as she lay her head on the bar and started sobbing. Tigerius picked her up gently in his big tiger arms. "Hush now little one. Everything's going to be okay" he purred. She had fallen asleep, the tears drying on her face and clothes. Tigerius placed some coin onto the bar next to a poorly drawn picture of a young family that was stained with tears and left.

EPISODE 66: NO CATCHY TITLE...

Off the post!" Riphard is being weird.

The previous night. . . We visited Laz, and discovered Kyros didn't betray us, but is being tortured and there's a Dopple-Kyros. Exme did a stealth mission, which resulted in nothing, other than knowing we're a cult of Synne, and wanting to arrest us. She overheard the old-new-new mayor (Green). Myron and Tony jumped off the side of the airship to rescue her. Anthony also gave Exme ritual stuff to talk to animals, which she's building into her helmet.

We wake, to the east of Goldings bay, and Anthony is gone, with a note to Riphard.

"Something something Marred, something something, my name will be bad, you're ruining my reputation, going to go back to the city."

Burnie wasn't listening. Myron see tracks going northward, Myron decides not to follow them. But we decide we might need to kill Tony. He knows too much.

Exme is sat eating lucky charms, she gets up and leaves the room to her workshop.

"Fucking hell. . . ref's a wanker" - Riphard being weird again. We decide to shoot Anthony from the airship, which doesn't work, because the tracks are too small. No one sees Anthony. We probably need to go to hopes rest to cut him off. And rescue Riphards family. If he actually cared rather than just pretending, this would be more urgent.

Printing press! Let's print the truth! Riphard needs parachute pants. We decide murder's less good, and he should go back to the spanse, but we need to find him either way!

"Off the bar! (Put it in the write up" - Riphard does a weird impression of Anthony.

We start shouting down the path to try and locate Anthony - he responds! He's pissed! We try to persuade him not to go there, and to go to the spanse to see his family again, on the down low.

He agrees! We don't have to murder him with a cannon! He tells us he'll be in the eastern spanse. We go to hopes rest.

We talk a bunch about what our best route is. Then we jump out of the ship at night. Myron almost dies. Then we contact delilah and go to see her, hoping she's not under duress. We go to a whorehouse. There's men "coming in and out" (Mike DM 2018). Riphard "Sneaks in the back", but gets stopped by a bouncer, he says he knows

Deals. We bribe the guy for his silence, as he didn't want to be known as being there.

Myron went through the front, avoiding all the nonsense. Delilah's nursing the twins. And she's feeding the babies "Ey!"

We chat a bit, until a Jive talking voice starts emanating from the ear-pieces. It insults us a lot, plays exmes voice, and seems to be an internal voice.

We see assassins and get them to assassinate Tigerius if ever he returns. The voice judges Burnie and co with this.

We go to the Book burners, and the voice reveals itself to be "Iris" - literally built into his eye. We realise we don't know what to say about the ordeal through the printing press. . . so Myron leaves to do something while we think about it.

Myron sees Rolltop - the police chief. Seems that the "Butcher" (Kolo) has left the sewers. . . and vanished. He tries to tell him about the "incident" - But fluffs it, so the Police Chief hits him with a billy club. He jumps out a window and legs it.

Myron comes back to them. We come up with a bad idea for the thing. #FakePews.

Potatoes are Dwarf-Lemons. We're going to cut a print out of one, but the goblins and archibaldiwaldibald are going to be useful and sort it. We run out to get out of town/see Delilah's room again... She gets frozen, Rippy gets nuked with a finger of death. . . And an inquisitor steps out of the shadows.

EPISODE 67: INQUISITAIR JORDANS

 Delilah froze in her tracks, so I scooped up baby Bilbo and dear Dildo, but as I did I was struck by searing necrotic pain. Some bastard inquisitor fingered me from a distance.

Bernie sprinted at the inquisitor and went super saiyan apparently. He tried to chokeslam him, but the inquisitor weaves inadequately and Bernie mounts him. Bernie stabs him up, precisely. He then used some stone magic and entombed him in stone from the street cobbles.

The inquisitor seems unfazed by this and appears on the pub roof. Poof.

Myron struggles to do anything and dilly dallys for a bit. He finally decides to talk to Bernie

telling him to get frozen Delilah safe in the famously safe sewers. Myron shoots the inquisitor with pointless bullets, which harmlessly bounce off him.

Riphard drops Bilbo, and shoots an awesome laser at the inquisitor, hitting it. Booyah.

Delilah twitches helplessly on the spot. Burnie's eye fires a less awesome laser at the inquisitor, missing it.

Burnie throws Myron the Excalibrum pick, and then sprints off, scooping up Dildo on the way past, before hawling the paralysed Delilah onto his shoulder. As he flees, the inquisitor raises a hand, and lighting jumps between Myron, Delilah, Rip and Burnie, thankfully arcing around the two babies. Delilah looks incredibly injured.

Myron runs straight at the Inquisitor, pick drawn, and plunges it into the side of the Inquisitor's chest, fumbling his whitty retort.

Riphard tries to hide behind a dog, but instead hides behind the porno theatre. I tried to heal Delilah, but I'm feeling a bit rusty so don't think it helped much. And, gosh, I'm just so worried about her! (#roleplay)

Delilah remains unconscious.

I.R.I.S. shoots a laser out of Bernie's eye and gives him laser sight.

Bernie tries to tell me we have to go back or something, telling Archibald to look after the kids and Delilah. Bernie further tries to scold me for my tactical positioning, despite being a solid choice. I tell him to piss off. They then try to get me to Friebrand em, but I don't think this cunts about to attack us with non-magical weapons. Idiots.

The inquisitor touches Myron's breast. . . plate, and Myron gets all hot and stuffy.

Myron, still alive for now, focuses all his energy and stabs the fuck out of the inquisitor.

I run boldly, bravely, intently into battle straight at the menacing inquisitor. I shoot him, slide in, and heal Myron while I'm at it. (#mvp)

I.R.I.S., still the most annoying name to type repeatedly, shoots a laser at Inquisitor, but accidentally hits the building instead. Recalibration needed.

Bernie, feeling completely useless, hears a voice in his eye telling him to just believe in himself. He slams his shield down to provide me cover. He then darts in closer and shocks Myron to health.

The inquisitor says he's getting angry now, and fireballs us all. I dodge the worst of the flames behind the shield, but Myron and Bernie take the full brunt.

Myron doesn't do anything of any use. He tries to run away and the inquisitor lashes out, but he escapes his claws.

I vigorously touch myself behind the shield, and assess the cobblestone work of this street. I've seen better.

I.R.I.S. the eye has been observing the battle and has noted most peoples attacks generally seem a bit useless. It attacks the inquisitor's shoes, which smoke and melt a bit, totally ruining his style. (Inquisitair Jordans? Churchenstocks? Inquisitoms?)

Bernie suplexes the inquisitor and pins him to the floor, but the inquisitor breaks free. Bernie disengages and runs away. Lots of that going about.

The inquisitors fireballs us all again. Myron and I get a bit singed, Bernie turns to a burnt rotten pile of flesh and ash. Wait no, that's just what he always looks like.

Myron tells the now-unparalysed Delilah to get out of here with the kids, possibly using the toilets. He then runs back at the inquisitor and tries to stab him, but completely misses. Finally, he uses his hunter senses to learn that the inquisitor is officially immune to everything except excallabrum based weapons n shit, which we suspected. But it's nice to know for sure. He then gets another shot at stabbing him for some reason, and this time nicks him good and proper. The inquisitor's starting to feel it. Maybe. It's tough to tell with the metal face and all. Actually finally this time, he runs away again.

The group debate whether they can use my gun if I died, muttering about excessive personal touching and breaching of taste and boundaries. I rebuke them all telling them they wouldn't be able to even point it in the right direction as I fire and miss.

I.R.I.S., realising it's completely useless, no longer takes part in the battle. Instead, Exme appears as it by magic with a newly rebuilt Stanri 2:Electric Baloogaloo, who's actually now a tiger apparently, but I'm sticking with my name anyway.

Bernie heals someone and gives me advantage, being the only person who can do any worthwhile damage to the fucker.

Another fireball rocks the townsquare I assume we are in. Again, I mostly shrug it off, ,

but everyone else is a bit shit up by it. Except Myron who actually wasn't around. But he comes running back in, slashing wildly at the inquisitor to no effect.

I take careful aim, not wanting to be embarrassed again, and, muttering a spiteful spite incantation to myself, I nail the inquisitor, who collapses into a crumpled heap. Feeling like I've used up all my commas I fall to my knees in relief.

"That was a shit-show mate." says Myron. "Let's go." Exme tells him to wait, and shocks him to health.

There's quite a bit of exposition and discussion about the penal authority of inquisitors who aren't supposed to exist anyway. Bernie wants to make a list of arbiters. Check it twice. Then send it to Arbiter Khan. Or something. It's not a good plan. I suggest it's all getting too complex and we keep the plan tiger bones.

I black out temporarily and regain consciousness as Bernie is trying to flush my babies down the loo. I'm briefly enraged, but it turns out that's where the sewer entrance is. We all enter the sewers.

We are going to take the inquisitor to the police to prove they're real, which will achieve. . . something. We also finally decide to investigate the inquisitor body. They don't have mouths, which apparently we already knew. Instead a tentacled maw is in its place. Gross. Bernie looks like he wants to fuck it. The rest is mostly human. Some rubbery patches of flesh. From a purely scientific standpoint he has a normal dick, but with a tentacle sticking out. Like a dick tongue? We look closer and it's actually another smaller dick. Gross.

We also find some suspiciously blank papers. He's got that weird symbol tattooed on him under his tit. Canilon. Must be that woman he was banging on about in the fight.

We critique his style, noting his clothes are fairly ordinary and of mediocre craftsmanship. His shoes seem oddly melted.

Myron wants to take my family away from me while I further endanger my life protecting a shitty building. No.

Exme and I take the women and children through the sewers out of town to the airship. Myron and Bernie head to the police station with the violated corpse of the inquisitor.

Myron shouts at us to be quiet as we enter the sewers. We creep along the smelly dark, dank, dung filled sewers.

Bernie wants to move his parents to safety. But he can't remember where they are.

We make steady progress along the sewers when suddenly, out of nowhere, we are scooped up in a giant net laid under the shitty water. We're hoisted up into a bundle, unable to cut ourselves out. A few small goblinoid creatures swarm us. They're all a bit twisted and have scales, fangs, and horns, which look just a bit wrong. Sewer mutant goblins! They all look a bit moldy. They start kaboshing us over the head, but not the babies, which is nice.

EPISODE 68: KILL KOLO

[INTRO]

I wake up alone, and defeated. I lead everyone into danger, and potentially to our deaths. I was hoping the day would take a little longer to come, but it seems like The Eight had other plans. Today is the day that we will have to kill Kolo.

Outside, I can hear the chattering of Kolo's mutated Gabrin spawn.

I sit down and try and think real hard for a bit, trying to feel if I can work out if there are any monster type things, and I reckon there's probably three in the room on the other side of this cell door, which are probably those nobheads I can hear down the way, and two others further off. Presumably one of them's King Nobhead.

I can hear Rip talking to one of the guards, and he sounds like he might be trying to do something fancy. The guard goes off to fetch something.

Esme comes over the earpieces, which they somehow forgot to take away from us. Everyone seems to be alright, but just then, we hear Kolo come into the room, down the way. He goes up to the guard, who seems to be on his way to unlock Rips' room, and puts a kibosh on that.

He does a bit of taunting.

I call Kolo over. He looks like a piece of shit. Like, he is a piece of shit, but he also looks like a piece of shit. Not only is he covered in fungus, like he was before. But he's also got one big fucking arm and lumpy bits and big weird wings and shit.

I tell him a few unfortunate details, such as that I'm going to kill him before he can hurt Esme any more. He doesn't seem to agree, and thinks that we're gonna be sacrificed in the name of Kalimar, which doesn't sound right.

Kolo leaves.

We try to take stock of what and realise it's nothing. I mean, it's not that surprising that they took our stuff off us, and obviously Esme doesn't have Stanri. They're not that stupid.

Delilah seems to be awake "Where are my children?". I broke the bad news that the children may now be getting prepared to be sacrificed to an elder god, but hey, what could be better in a fight than a mother desperate to defend her children?

Riphard took some time to examine the drains, relieving himself into it through a healthy dual

stream from his dwarven piping. He told her to make sure they sacrificed Dildo first. She wasn't happy.

We continue to fail to do anything useful for a bit.

Exme told us all to check out bodies for signs of the infection. Burnie, a little too eagerly, inspected the inside of his anus, later telling me in confidence that he had found a lump, which had startled him because there were usually two.

Burnie took a break from fingering himself to try and goad the guards in his broken Goblin language. He started a 'fake' fight with Riphard about their respective Dwarven heritages.

They have their fight, and successfully attract the guards over to their cells, causing the perfect distraction. Then... it sort of peters out and nothing happens.

After that, Esme starts calling out for Kolo in the cell opposite mine. He eventually turns up, and start jabbering away at her in Gabrin, getting pretty riled up. At one point he punches a hole in the wall, and she doesn't look impressed.

She seems to be trying to cause a distraction, but no one really has anything to do, and eventually this peters out too. Kolo turns to leave.

I yell out to him, calling him over to look at the bar that I've bent on the door, explaining to him that I'm going to bend the rest of them, break out of here and come and kill him, and that I'm not going to just wait in here to be killed by Kalimar after all.

He asks me if I'm saying that he's going to have to kill me, and I tell him yes.

He goes to fetch his bow and comes back to shoot me with it. By the time he does, I'm another few bars down. He raises his bow and Esme cries out, as an arrow flies straight into my torso.

I carry on, as Kolo does the same. Esme is calling out to Kolo, trying to get him to stop, or else she says she'll use Stanri to break out of her cell.

Wait...

I take another few arrows and get through the first door. From here, I can see Burnie trying the classic fake-escape-round-corner-psyche-out, which seems to be working.

With a yell from Esme, Stanri busts through the inner door like wet paper.

Burnies guard unlocks his door and goes in. There's a thud.

Esme runs in between me and Kolo, as I start work on the second door. She attempts to appeal to a good nature, that bears very little evidence of existing. Behind her, Burnie hops out of his room, throwing a key to Rip as he does so.

Only a few bars are left, as Kolo and I trade threats above Esme's head. A few more arrows thud into me, but it's worth it. Kolo seems to think the babies are special in some way, and that Kalimar would appreciate them especially.

Esme tries to get Kolo to remember childhood memories, and appeals to his nature. On some level, I feel like she might be getting the picture, though.

Two of the knobheads have run up to join us, and seem to be avoiding too much damage to her, while holding her off.

As Rip runs out of his room, I manage to pop the last bar. I jump up into the opening, standing on the threshold. "Your move, Greeny", I say, and I do feel bad about bringing skin colour into this, but I was under a lot of pressure to say something cool.

The two knobheads strike out at me with claws and fangs, my blood burns, and my muscles seize and the world goes black.

Riphard and Burnie are barricaded in the room where the weapons are stored, collecting their belongings and anyone else's they can carry. Riphard, clutching the Hammer of the Gods, shoots round the corner, felling an assistant, and taking a heavy swipe in the process.

As he does so, he sees Esme, unconscious, being dragged to a cell by an assistant, Stanri lying immobile, Delilah taking heavy swipes from two assistants, and Myron unconscious and paralysed. He ducks back, letting Burnie run out - shooting the assistant carrying Esme and hiding behind a table - before running round the corner, gun drawn, just in time to see Delilah downed by the assistants, paralysed and bleeding heavily.

"Must be her time of the month" he opines, entirely failing to give the situation the gravity it requires.

Delilah gasps on the ground, her maternal energy forcing the life back into her body.

Burnie runs up to Kolo, standing at the edge of the hole his assistants having been digging to

summon the eldritch horror they worship as a god. He goes to grapple the distorted shadow of Kolo, but his pegleg slips on the rim of the hole, and topples backwards, 100ft down into the hole.

Riphard fills Esme with radiant healing energy, she obligingly plays dead, as she continues to be dragged into the cell at the back of the room. Just as he does so, the other two assistants round on him, and he falls to the ground, unconscious and paralysed.

In the hole, Burnie straps on Esme's spiderclimb boots and starts hobbling up the slick walls.

Delilah stands to her feet, and sees her babies in Kolo's hands on the other side of the room. Her maternal instincts propel her across the room, and she slaps Kolo square across the side of the face, causing him to drop both infants to the ground.

Esme, still playing dead, gets brought into Kolo's room, and, cracking one eye, she spots a snowglobe on the side, and, twisting out of the grasp of the Assistant, bludgeons him to death with it.

Burnie makes it to the top of the hole, and, reaching over the edge of the pit, plunges his hook into Riphard, giving him a burst of healing electricity. Rip regains consciousness, but is still paralysed on the ground.

Esme runs out of the room, calling out to Kolo to stop, despite the fact that, apart from a few glimpses, very little of her brother seems to remain.

Burnie climbs up, and looks across the hole at Kolo, knife in hand. Kolo locks eyes with him, froth dripping from his toothy grin. Burnie's hand twitches.

With a flick, Burnie activates the runes on the dagger, and the stone around the edge of the hole softens, and flows inward, sealing the pit, and even completing the surface with a small grate. Kolo cries out in frustration. "Silly Burnie, what have you done?"

Esme, still refusing to fire on her brother, calls out to him.

"Leave the babies on the ground, Kolo."

"Okay Esme, I will." says Kolo, and crushes Delilah's head beneath his claw.

Silence.

Riphard, conscious and paralysed on the ground, lies, eyes seized wide open, watches.

Burnie kills the last remaining Assistant, as Esme steps up to Kolo, reprimanding him mildly, in what seems like a significant underreaction.

Kolo looks at sister, pleading for him to stop. He raises his still-bloodied lobster claw, brings it down, and his sister is lying in a heap at his feet.

Riphard overcomes his paralysis and forces himself to his feet. Eyes fixed to Kolo.

A golden light surrounds Esme, as Rip lays a gauntleted hand on her tiny, frail form.

Esme digs in her bag, laying discarded at Rip's feet, drawing the Cube of Ruh'brex from it, twisting it into an array of complex shapes before she's even finished taking it from the bag.

Time freezes.

Esme blinks, free to move in a frozen moment of time. Calmly, she picks up the frozen babies, walks into the cell where Myron was being kept, and stows the babies underneath the cot, before walking up to Myron, and jolting him with a bolt of energy, causing time to flow once more.

EPISODE 68A: EPISODE 68 SUPPLEMENT - EXME'S THOUGHTS

I've had bad days before. But this.... We had woken up in prison cells deep in the sewers. Of course it was Kolo, who else could it be. I'd lost all my tools but he'd left Stanri with me of all things. From between the bars I could make out some of the others, each one in their own cells. My first fear was that he had already infected them. From my research, that seems to be the easiest way. Slip it in the food or rub it onto the buttocks. Then just let time do its thing. They looked healthy enough from where I was but how could you know. My second fear was that they were going to kill Kolo. Even in his right mind, Kolo always underestimated them, and the things we've accomplished when we're together.... impossible. They weren't trapped in here with Kolo, he was trapped in here with them. I just prayed that I would be able to make them listen.

The note threw me. Two simple words written in a scrawled hand that I knew only too well. "Help me". I hadn't expected this, that there was still some awareness in there. From my research I knew that there was a very good chance that he could be saved, but I had thought that the way the fungus takes over the body, in particular the brain, would have rendered the subconsciousness

powerless and unaware. Yet here was the evidence. Kolo was fighting back against it. He was always strong.

We talked. I tried to persuade him to make this easy, that he should not underestimate them. That this could be fixed. I pleaded, trying to evoke memories of his past that would help the real Kolo grow stronger, take back some control and show the others that there was hope. But it was no use. Otoria, Gary, Pilch, Mother even. Sometimes I thought there was a sadness in those eyes, a look of recognition, but it was not strong enough to fight against this deformed monstrosity that stood laughing at us in its domination of my brother.

Myron started it. He was always as headstrong as Kolo if not more so. From my cell I could hear every arrow piercing him as he made his way towards Kolo. That damned fool. I think he would have rather died than sit there doing nothing. But that was too much for me to bear. I believed it so hard, that no-one had to die today. That I could persuade them all and we could subdue Kolo and fix him. Then everything would be back to normal, if anything ever was normal. What a fool.

Stanri opened the doors but was immediately floored by Kolo's assistants. Poor thing didn't stand a chance against those monstrous claws. But he had done his job. I had to get inbetween Kolo and Myron and stop them from destroying each other. But what am I without my tricks and gadgets? Weak in body and mind. I tried, oh Mother I tried so hard. But every time I stood up to get in the way they threw me back. I just couldn't get through to either of them, the intensity of their rages. His assistants went easy on me for what it's worth but I still couldn't stand up to them. I knew the others were making their moves. When Myron went down and Kolo went for the children my heart broke. Delilah was there and the last words I ever said to her were to help Myron as I went after Kolo. Shortly after that the world turned black.

I woke up in what looked like his office, being carried by one of the assistants, bloody and hobbling. Dull sounds of battle came from the main room filling me with dread. If Riphard had got a weapon then that was that. Kolo needed the babies for his plan, whatever that was, but who knows what danger they could have been in. I murdered the assistant with the closest blunt object I could find, feeling the dark blood flow over my hands taking its life with it. After finding my bearings I looked back into the main chamber. Burnie and Myron were nowhere to be seen. Riphard stood facing Kolo, who himself

stood over Delilah's unmoving form, hand outstretched towards her two babies who lay on the floor screaming. Out of the corner of my eye I saw the barrel of my gun poking out of the impossible bag, seemingly a thousand miles away. My first thought was to help Delilah so that she stood a chance of rescuing the children and lowering the stakes. But on my own what could I really do with Kolo right there? I needed that weapon to heal her properly if we were going to stand a chance. I made a choice and I ran for the gun, dodging past Kolo. I shouted at him not to hurt the children. I don't think I'll ever forget the grim smile that came across his face. Or the sound of Delilah's skull being destroyed underneath his terrible claw.

I felt sick as I dropped to my knees. There are no words. When I could bear to look over for a moment I didn't see Delilah. I saw that little girl in the church, with her pig tails and her best dress and that impossible bullet wound through her chest. As the immediate situation came back to me, with all its terrible sights and sounds and feelings, the worst thing is I still thought that he could be saved.

I found the cube and I stopped time. The children were the first priority. I managed to pick up their small timeless forms and get them out of the way to safety in Myron's room. In there I found Myron, down but breathing. I revived him with the shot that was meant for Delilah. He took a moment to wake up, then slowly stood up and went to look out at the scene playing out in the main chamber. When he turned back and looked at me I felt that time had stopped again. I've never seen a face convey such an intense mixture of rage and disappointment at the same time and I pray that I never see it again. I can't bear to remember that look. He walked away and I stood there, dull to the emotions that were starting to form inside me. Was I to lose both of them today?

As I ran back into the room I came face to face with my worst fear. I could feel the rage of the team and Kolo seemed to be drinking it in. The assistants were gone. Myron and Riphard were engaged in full-on warfare with Kolo. Burnie, less enthusiastically, was doing his part and was the only one who seemed to show any sign of an emotion other than cold hard hatred in the room. I went on auto-pilot trying desperately to shut out the image of Delilah's broken body, overcome with grief and the panic of the situation, coming closer and closer to the realisation that my happy ending was not coming. Kolo was never any match for them. Not when they are like this. Especially with all that Riphard had lost and

stood to lose.

Kolo was forced into a cell. Riphard screamed for blood. Myron coldly made attacks, slow and determined. Burnie, ever the diplomat, and I did our best, eventually managing to subdue Kolo before the other two could outright kill him. Kolo was down, alive but unmoving. Finally, I thought to myself, they have listened. Surely, now the threat is over they will see that it wasn't Kolo's fault, he was sick. I wouldn't let myself think of Delilah, not yet. I think if I did then I would have died. There would be time for that after Kolo was fixed. We would make amends. Me and my brother.... The murderers together again at last...

Myron had cold fire in his eyes. He walked past me to go in for the kill. To kill my brother!?! Now, while he was down and vulnerable!? After all the death and misery of the day Myron dared to make one more corpse and deny me the only thing I have ever wanted?!?! He took a shot and missed. And I have never felt such anger. I tried my best to give him the same look he had given me and I poured all of the emotions I had into it. I trusted him. I thought I loved him and that he loved me. How could he not understand what this meant to me!?!?! He gave me that look again and with his next words he destroyed me. "This is all your fault". For a moment the anger welled up but then once again I saw that crushed skull in my mind, and the little girl, and all of them, the countless hundreds that I've put to death. The ones that my weapons and gadgets and gizmos have robbed of life or filled with misery. I saw it all in that moment and the worst thing is that I knew that in a way, Myron was right. He walked away from me and didn't look back.

As Riphard came towards us I knew that I had to make a decision now. One of them, Riphard or Kolo, was going to die. There was no way that he could forgive Kolo's crimes today I thought to myself. Fool. I considered it, I really did. I think Burnie would have helped me. He would have held me back short of killing him at least and given us that time. But where would we be after that? Riphard would never accept Kolo back after this. I tried to push him back but he kept coming, the madness burning through his eyes and an excited smile on his face. He was going to enjoy this I thought to myself with a grim sense of sickness filling my stomach. Burnie looked distraught. He tried, he really did, but Riphard would not listen. He stood over Kolo and put the whip around his throat, the horrible cold leather pushing into the flesh of Kolo's neck. When I looked at my brother then I saw him as he used

to be. That little gabrin boy who would chase me through the woods and save me from the boars and steal muffins from old hag Figgis for us to share together. I saw him laughing with glee as a stables blew up and we ran away to hide in the shadows. I saw him jumping straight into a crocodile's mouth to try and kill it from the inside. I saw him secretly crying over the death's of our allies, when he thought no-one was looking... I saw him as a monster robbing two beautiful children of their mother and I took the finger off my trigger. I tried to talk to him Kolo, I really did. I told him it wouldn't bring her back, and that you were not well, and that if he did this then we have lost you forever. But he had already made his mind up. I think he had made his mind up a long time ago. Because it wasn't what happened today that made him kill you Kolo. I naively thought that losing his wife and the threats on his children would have been too much. But Riphard is not built like that. Riphard is driven by pride and you made a fool of him too many times. All those little slights and acts of one-upgoblinship. He wasn't thinking about Delilah. He was thinking about not getting away with robbing a family that one time. He wasn't thinking of his uncle. He was thinking of all the times you saved us from an impossible enemy robbing him of the glory of the last shot. He wasn't thinking about the children. He was thinking about every time you laughed at him and showed him that you were a better person, even as an inferior gabrin, than he could ever be. He shouted out his childhood friend's name as he killed you for goodness sake. I think you would have found that funny.

I want you to know that I did try to save you Kolo. I'm sorry that you are not you anymore and that we won't be seeing you again. You were the best of us and when you went the team lost something important and beautiful. I'll remember you as you were.

I think I need to spend some time away now Kolo. I need to try and make up for all the bad things that I have done. I need to learn to live without you. I'm sorry to leave you Burnie, but I know you'll be strong and look after the others. Myron, I hope you can forgive me one day. He meant too much to me... I'm sorry that this happened to Delilah. I just... I thought I could save everyone.

We were meant to be helping people. We were meant to be heroes...

I think I deserve this.

EPISODE 69: WELCOME TO THE SHIT SHOW (NOICE)

IN the chaotic emotion fuelled moments following Riphards execution of Kolo Exme seems to try to slink off with Kolo's corpse. After all this darkness everyone's thought is simply on seeing daylight again. Bernie tries to follow her, but she calmly asks him to remain with the rest of the group which sorely needs his wisdom, knowledge, and goodness. He debates his virtues to himself, but ultimately takes Exme's kind and generous words to heart.

Burnie hides a package Exme seemingly gave him before anyone else can notice. Myron sternly expresses consternation that Exme thinks she can just walk away after the bullshit she just pulled, but Burnie talks him out of following her... for now.

Debate turns to tactics now that we find ourselves in a hostile city, wanted by the church authorities and entirely broken as a group and as people.

A deathly silence befalls the group as we trudge back through the sewers, searching for what little light remains in the world. Riphard carries his two weans, seemingly trying to shut out any thoughts about the situation at last and what remains of Delilah. Occasionally a smile does seem to flash across his face, buried deep behind the anger and shock. Myron carries Delilah's corpse, her feet dragging along the floor as even her headless corpse dwarfs Myron's diminutive stature.

Myron writes Rolltop Candian a letter warning him with evidence about the Inquisitors and begging him to reconsider his position and attitude in this new light.

Burnie sources a cart and tarpaulin, ever resourceful, and stashes the dead, hidden in plain sight. We slip out of the city boundaries under the cover of darkness, all there ever seems to be these days.

We reach Burnie's parents house, who implore us inside. Myron resists and Burnie's skepticism is raised at the sound of an apparently enthusiastic Mother he has never known. It seems she is just excited to share some news, someone is here to see him. His son!

"5ft 4? Covered in feathers?"

"That's the one!"

"Never met him"

Burnie jokes and confesses this is indeed his son. He heads inside. Riphard wonders if he has news of the Tiger's death. Riphard and Myron head onto the airship: Riphard silently taking his babies into his room with a loud clunk as he locks the door. Myron drowns his sorrows at the bar. He feels a comforting embrace on his shoulder: Captain Stick has fallen over onto him. Myron eyes the apparently inanimate stick with suspicion.

Burnie walks into his childhood home and the sight of his birdson drinking tea with his father greets his eyes warmly after the days horror. He has a request for Burnie. Burnie doesn't know if he's in a position to help what with the prostate related news he received last time he was home several years ago. Bucky says Burnie doesn't know much about him, blunt but fair.

He explains that he trains the young assassins at the assassins guild. He says he has a final year student doing his final year thesis and exam to become a full blown assassin and thinks he needs experience in the wider world, and was wondering if they could join the group for a while. Burnie explains the whole murder church thing, but this doesn't perturb Bucky from the idea. He explains he's a VERY promising student and presses the matter.

Out from the shadows appears Christopher Mintz-Plasse the young assassin: Kevin. He tries to introduce himself to Burnie, but Burnie shuts him down spouting various contradictory and aggressive rules and suggestions. The young assassin tries to scribble these down and obey more than he disobeys, Burnie tells him not to infringe his personal right to privacy. He half burns his notebook.

Bucky asks why Burnie is covered in shit. He says he watched his best friend die at the hands of his least favourite acquaintance. Riphard sheds a tear in his room.

Burnie tells his parents to join the group as we have need for babysitters. The Dad is resistant to leave having just moved a few months ago, from the house next door. His mother requires little convincing though, especially at the mention of wee half-dwarf babies in need. Burnie tells Kevin to head to the basement and grab the biggest barrels of sherry he can.

Myron lobs a bottle at Kevin's head as he boards the ship.

"FUCK OFF!".

"Fucking hell!" ejaculates Kevin.

Burnie scolds Kevin for swearing. Kevin asks if we're pirates, but Burnie tells him not everything is as it seems at first glance. Kevin tries to write this down in his half burnt notebook.

Burnie walks onto the ship and is greeted with several more bottles. Myron just froths at the mouth spitting out the odd "Fucking. . . ." through his grenadine fueled rage.

"This ain't one in one out mate".

"Uh. . . I'm Kevin."

Burnie tries to convince Myron to accept the youngling. Myron presses Burnie on where he stands. Burnie effuses about the situation, and accepts the reasons for Kolo's death, but thinks the way it ultimately went down was murder. Kevin tries to chip in but Burnie shouts him down. "Against the church and on the side of the Gods" is his ultimate answer. Myron stammers out a rare confession that Burnie is right. The tension eases and Myron heads to bed.

Riphard is distractedly playing with the kids in his room, dangling toys at them and engaging where he can between vivid flashes of memory from the entire cursed time since he should've died. He has little sense of the time passing.

Burnie introduces Kevin to Captain Stick. Kevin salutes the stick. Burnie directs his parents to the empty master suite. Burnie insists everyone go the fuck to sleep. Kevin is resistant "But it's 4pm sir" "DO I LOOK LIKE I KNOW WHAT A POST MERIDIAN IS?!" Burnie watches until Kevin goes to sleep, then gets the Cube Puzzle Die of Rubrex, which was in the package given to him by Exme along with a letter. He inspects it carefully with his built in hook lighter. He doesn't set it on fire, which is a good start. He makes out a couple of words, but will have to wait before fully deciphering it. He nods off.

The group awaken in the familiar waiting room of Lazarus. Riphard has his kids in his arms. Kevin is exasperated he's now apparently dreaming about Burnie. "This ain't a dream lad". Meredith elephants into the room and gives the group fizzy cold Bovril to drink. Kevin tries to wake himself up unsuccessfully.

The group are ushered in to see Laz. Meredith picks up Kevin and takes him through. Kevin talks to himself to remain calm.

Laz greets the group and expresses surprise at the lack of Exme and Kolo and the new faces. Myron asks Laz if he's seen any of the various dead Goblin or Delilah come through. He tells Meredith to see who's in the waiting lounge.

Myron drunkenly exclaims despair at how it's all gone to shit.

Burnie bluntly explains the situation to Laz. Myron shunders fizzy lurid pink Bovril vomit. He explains Kevin too. A lot has changed in a short space of time. Laz welcomes Kevin to hell and to the team. The group all ask for various cups of things at the revelation Laz can bring us cups of whatever we want. Kevin looks out of the window, but is wise beyond his years and retains his sanity, waving hello to the various murderers, thieves, and scallywags he recognises having assassinated recently.

There's a big conversation here about how shitty Kolo was and how he's now somewhere worse than hell because of the Kalimar stuff. Riphard is happy at this, Laz seems less pleased. Myron seems conflicted.

A fax comes in. Delilah is downstairs and will be held in the waiting room downstairs. There is no word of Kolo or the other Kalimar infected Goblin souls. Riphard is happy at the news and playfully bounces Dildo and Bildo on his knees.

Kevin tries to fly out of the window, thinking he's still in his own dream and has any control over the situation. He screams for eternity before falling back in through the window from above. This should provide some good source material for his dissertation.

Laz tells us that speed is of the essence now that all the church wheels are in motion. We must travel to Lindedorf to find someone who can make us weapons to fight the church on our own. He explains that Kiros is not yet dead and may yet be saved. It's time to bring the fight to the church. Post haste.

Laz tells me I need to nurture my children and they will grow up into great people as they have been touched by the Gods. It's a little on the creepy side.

Laz tells Kevin if he doesn't help us he will damn his soul to hell for an infinite amount of time longer than the infinite fall out of the window he just experienced. He clicks everyone back awake.

The group awake to Myron attempting to steer the ship, having tied up Captain Stick. Burnie wrestles the ship back under control. Myron goes to see Riphard and somberly asks what we are going to do about Burnie. The two agree he has to die, the question is when. An initial attempt at a signal is attempted, but needs further work.

Myron hates sherry. Burnie leaves Myron the note left from Exme that simply says: "I thought I could have both of you."

Burnie plays with the puzzle die and thinks he's getting somewhere, but accidentally triggers "Apprentice Security Mode", locking down completely and is unusable for 24 hours. An idiot-proof mode fit for the user.

Kevin introduces himself to Riphard. Riphard is blunt and not exactly talkative. "Welcome to the shit show" summing up his general feelings and he walks off.

The airship trundles on to Lindedorf, just as Lazarus directed.



EPISODE 69A: WE'RE ALL SYNNERS HERE...

WELL gods-damit. Everything's going to hell in a handbasket - somewhat literally.

I'm almost sorry I roped the kid into the #Blessed group, but if he's going to be with us he needs to know what he's up against and what's at stake.

Hope he doesn't die like all the others.

I'm not sure what we're gonna do without Exme... And Kolo's death was an ugly one at that. Really, not sure where I stand at the moment. But I can't afford my own feelings to get in the way - we've lost our engineer, our pilot, and access to hopes rest, but there's still 4 of us, plus Ma and Pa and the wee ones.

I'll need to keep an eye on Riphard... he's a selfish man, but this was something else - we've seen what happens if we ignore someone's corruption in the past, so let's hope this was a personal vendetta, and not another elder-being pulling at our sanity.

Ah- fucket! this cube's way too bleedin' hard to use... Wait, "Temporary Safe Search enabled, please contact system administrator if you feel this lock was imposed accidentally... Time remaining 25 hours, 58 Minutes... 57...." Fuckin' hell Rubrex...

Myron... His grief, his guilt, those are punishment enough for now. Hope he can still keep his head in the game.

I know it's strange, and ya didn' neccessarily choose me, and I've never really wanted to acknowledge you being here, Mark, but it's good to have ya. It's weird enough we share dreams, and the amount of elephant porn you think about is, well, it's not my cup of tea. But I take some small comfort in knowing someone's got my back, and that I'm not alone.

Maybe this is what it used to be like, when the gods were around? A feelin' of being connected...

I hope we can bring that back to everyone.

Aye, well the kids just done makin' notes on the correct etiquette for performin' an Assassination at a Tom 'Ardy wedding (you still get the spouse a gift, but no need to bring one for the assassination target, though come with a condolences card for the grieving mother). But thanks for the chat Mark, I know you can't directly talk back or nuthin', but I can feel the warmth of the glow near my stump, and that's enough to know you're listening.

Or that my dermatitis is flarin' up.

...Think I'll get dad to make a plaque for Kolo, put his bow back up on it, we need to honor our dead if nothing else.

EPISODE 70: THE HUNT FOR GOOGLE VON MACCHERSTEIN

THe airship drifts uneasily down from the sky, piloted inexpertly into the city of Linderdorf. Only a handful of steam vents and a set of huge brass doors belies the metropolis built into the mountain. Mr and Mrs Burnie's dad promise to take care of the kids on the airship while the Shitshow lead Kevin into the city below.

In the city proper, the gang find themselves in a dense, hot, warren of foundries, mills and shops. Automatons are scattered throughout the populis, lithe, talkative models serving in shops, and hulking, heavily built models acting as workers and guards.

Kevin chirps up talking about history and shit.

Linderdorf acts as a bastion of civilisation and industry against The Varg, shipping weapons, inventions and steel all over Velterra.

No one listens to Kevin, though, because they're trying to guess who wrote "Vergun" on his face in pencil. It was Myron, who is smashed on a cocktail made of:

One Part Sherry

One Part Grenadine

One Part Bovril

that he calls a Piece of Shit, and claims he named it after Rip. Myron does jokes now.

Myron smells meat, and tries to lead everyone to the meatwaft.

A dwarf man is roasting sausages. Myron buys 20 schnitzels. Riphard buys the business. The dwarf man seems fairly satisfied.

A passerby is asked for directions to the best blacksmith in the city, and replies that a team of Google Von Maccherstein and someone else (Märöck Grünhelve and Jüppi Indelnacht) won the Blacksmith Cup this year, and that he is a Salumist. The party learn that sausages are actually just a type of face.

Suddenly, unicorns become untrustworthy with money. It is unclear how this will impact things going forward.

Schnitzels are revealed to just be sausages, and sausages are faces.

The gang leave the area, following Myron, and spend 10 minutes walking in circles around a building that seems to be a spa, ending up back where they started.

Burnie is unable to buy a schnitzel.

All in all, everyone seems to be enjoying this brief moment of non-dread.

Burnie puts on a disguise and tries again to buy a schnitzel. He succeeds.

They decide to leave in a way that wouldn't just bring them back.

They end up in a pub, where a three-armed robot barman offers them a selection of the local delicacies. He does not offer to mix them all together in a big jug. He refuses to let the party mix them all together in a big jug.

They get one of each and promise not to mix them.

After drinking them, they ask the barman where they can find Google Von Maccherstein. He says to wander around where they might be and see if we bump into them. He asks why they want to see him, and hopes they don't mind. They do, but what is conversation but polite prying?

They leave, smashed.

Rip gets fed up of hanging around, and starts harassing people in their homes to see if they're Google Von Maccherstein. They say they aren't, and Myron tries to do it better, but does it a bit the same.

Kevin gets back in contact with the local Thief Guild, and asks her if she knows where Mr McDonald and Google McKenzie are. After a brief bit of Thieves Cant natter, they find out the name of their workshop.

He comes back out, to find the others interrogating a lamp post. Myron takes the lead and Burnie directs him with strategically placed vomit.

They arrive at the workshop, and the small robot bird outside suggests that its the one they're looking for. They knock on the door, and apparently the gnome who opens it isn't Google. Which is inconvenient.

They ask if he can work the special metal. He says he doesn't want to talk to these scary drunk people. Myron starts shovelling money through the crack in the door, and Burnie barges through.

Apparently, his masters are out exploring the Varg lands, looking for inspiration by touristng in a war zone, and he doesn't know exactly where.

He gets solidly harrassed, threatened, and upset. He informs the moderately sensible ones among the party that the guards have already been called, and that they should probably get out of there, and come back in the morning.

Myron, already sleeping on the floor, gets taken to an alley and tucked in to a nice comfy pile of metal. Burnie instead decides to slumber in a nice pool of vomit.

The two conscious members go off to get clean.

Kevin and Riphard make small-talk as they spend an enjoyable evening getting to know each other while they bathe and receive many massages. Topics include Riphard's Dead Wife, Riphard's Cursed Children, and Riphard's recent murders. Kevin remains fully clothed.

The next morning, they return to collect Burnie and Myron and meet with the dwarf they assaulted the night before. Burnie is slick with vomit. Myron sleeps serenely in his metal nest.

They collect themselves, and knock on the door of the workshop, and have a slightly more cordial conversation than the night before.

The dwarf they were talking to yesterday is apparently called something like, but not, Burnice. The gang present themselves as willing to find Google, and see if they need rescuing. To be honest, they just want them to do the metal, though.

Burnice explains they went to look at the Varg weapons, to get ideas for the big Blacksmith race, and provides documents and maps detailing the route they were planning to take.

Myron asks, purely hypothetically, if it would make Google more amenable to them, if he knew that he was the son of Professor Jorj Myron of Linderdorf University. Everyone is suddenly shocked to remember Myron has a first name.

Having looked at the stuff, and being given a picture of Google to look at, they say their goodbyes to Burnice, and head back out to the airship, to begin in earnest The Hunt for Google Von Maccherstein.



Google's map of the route into the Varg lands

EPISODE 71: MARTIN THE PARANOID ANDROID

Dear Professor Mc'Caw,
As requested I am writing to inform you of my progress so far. My work placement found me travelling to Linderdorf with Mr (he insists of Professor and beats me if I either refuse or omit this honorific) Burnie and the rest of his, for want of a better word, crew. After a rather drawn out day of purchasing sausage meat stands and projectile vomiting, we had tried to track down a local famous blacksmith (I must admit I was a little starstruck) only to find out that they had been missing for sometime in the Varg. Professor Burnie and the crew agreed to help find these folks so I find myself heading to the Varg.

As we left, we met two dwarves (fine fellows indeed the dwarves, some of my best friends know dwarves) Linus Brandler, and Celina Speidel. They told us that they were in the employ of the workshop and were to join us on our quest. Riphard seemed tendacious and wanted to test the martial skills of our potential dwarven compatriots by throwing a lemon into the air and commanding that they fire. The lemon completed its arc and fell to the floor to the modest embarrassment of everybody there.

We set off Northwards in the fine sky boat, following the rough trail that we were made aware of back at the office. Two days passed

with no incident at all. I spent my time making Pieces of Shit for Myron and trying to catch up on some of my assassin studies. One morning I awoke and as I took my morning exercise on deck, I notice that we had crossed the border into the snow-covered Varg Lands. My god, a splendid sight those rolling hills of plain white snow, the scattered small camps of nomadic underclasses. Intoxicating. Myron took point and cast out his eagle-eyed eyes over the barren wasteland, a true sight to behold this master of bushcraft, his keen sentry-ship being disturbed only by the occasional vomiting over the deck and the cry to refresh his drink. I did not have the heart to inform him that we were running low on Bovril.

We travelled for another day and a half. Far below we started to see roving bands of goblins and ogres, trompling along the landscape, no doubt enjoying the fine Winter that lay across the lands like the casual hand of a form tutor making its way onto the lap of an impressionable young boy who desperately needs that passing grade in his poison class. As I thrust my gaze over the landscape I noticed a set of tracks that looked unlike those we had seen before. I called over Myron and pointed out my find. I daresay I saw a glimpse of impressidness cross his craggy brow but one should keeps one's egoism in check. Our dwarven companions seemed to agree with Myron's assessment that these were the tracks we were looking for. I ducked out and went to milk Mrs Burnie, a task that fills me with equal parts dread and unknown excitement every day. I warmed two bottles and took them to Riphard. No-one seemed interested in this so I will not elaborate further.

Night fell. Professor tried to volunteer me for a suicide mission, a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity I'm led to believe. The sky boat pulled into a secluded spot and the professor and I disembarked, Burnie covering the boat with a single branch in a masterful display of camouflage. We moved forwards with discretion, approaching the camp that we had seen from above. Aside from the usual goblins and horses, we spied three bearkin standing about a human garbered in rags, slouched down and enchained with long chains that somehow were propping him up against all natural laws of nature. On a second viewing I noticed the chains were actually holding him up, on account of being attached to local trees. The man kept regaining consciousness only to have it robbed from him again and again by the fists (paws) of the bearkin(g?). On a third viewing I noticed that the man's face and most of his skin was in fact made of metal. From the notes I stole from Professor's

room I decided that this must be the kraftwerk mercenary Martin Andelberger. Professor decided we should attack ourselves but then he decided we should not. We went to fetch the remaining crew.

I stood watching, alone, surveying the fight to come. After a short time I heard the sounds of the rest of the crew coming towards us. So did a goblin and the battle was afoot. Riphard stepped forwards and flashed a million gold piece smile at the goblin and a nearby human. The goblin, halfway through attempting to howl, eased in his saddle and sent out something that seemed like a goblin greeting. Riphard nodded a gentle "be cool bro". From across the expanse, the robot man stirred. A bearkin saw Riphard. Not good. A brief dialogue ensued but I could not make out the words. Myron ran in and just stood there in full view of everyone. I feared that Burnie had not communicated the plan very well. The confusion from our new goblin friends warmheartedness towards us seemed to be the only thing keeping them from attacking. They opened dialogue with Riphard who threw out the trading/investment spiel which worked so well when we fought the sausage vendor in Linderdorf. Apparently they had squandered some supplies from a sled, the very sled we had been tracking. The question came to me immediately. Where were the sled owners? A mystery. The merry band of mexican/new yorker Varg folk were having their fun with the brutalisation of the metal man. The varg folk told us that the sled owners had run off and that they were trying to squander what they could from the possessions they had left behind. I took the opportunity to light a horse's testicles on fire, as per the professor's instructions. The horses bolted into the snowy night. The bearking was not happy and ordered the goblin to round them up. Myron told him with the straightest face I have ever seen that there were strong pickings to the south. We seemed to have established a friendship, a brief glow of warmth in the icy, cold wasteland.

The Varg-Kin went South to find their fortune and we were left in possession of their beaten prisoner. Myron managed to wake up the robot man after about twenty minutes. He tried to talk to him about life but he was not enthusiastic about it. Myron gave him the footnotes about why we were here, which appeared to be both incomplete and written in another language. Martin claimed to have been the only one travelling and to have been here alone for years. Myron used the word "obvs" which I believe is short for oblivious. I implored the Professor to ask the robot if he could be of any use to us.

Martin said something so cutting, so unbelievably devastating that Burnie visibly winced and started also to cry a little bit. I asked him if he was indeed a companion of Grunhelve and Indelnacht. He cryptically said yes and started sledding away, yet we dastardly jumped onto the sled. I told him we had need of his knowledge to help in the task that I still do not understand. Riphard told him we required their knowledge to craft weapons of excalibur. Martin did not seem to know what this is. I spent some time trying to convince Mr Martin to help us re-pick up the trail of our quarry, and asking about his purpose in life. Suddenly, the sky boat appeared above and a giant cable with a hook fell out of the bottom hole, which picked up Martin by his buttocks. However, the robot man did not rise, rather the boat fell towards him. I pleaded one more time for his help but he refused and set off on his way. I left it a moment and then covered my face in snow and followed directly in his footsteps. After only five minutes I noticed that his gaze had been directed to a new set of tracks and he diverted his path to follow them. The airship followed at some distance. Someone had decided to engorge the ship in a cloud of brown gas which, if anything, only added to the conspicuousness of the dirigible.

Hours passed. Martin was slow. I took the opportunity to have a short nap. But it was too cold to sleep and the only outcome was that I ended up with a, what I suspect was a piss stained, blanket frozen onto my lower body. I decided that it would make more sense to simply ask if I could sit on the sled and Martin was kind enough to acquiesce. I pointed out to Martin that the Varg was in the other direction. He paused and produced a small bedroll. We spent some time talking. He said he couldn't die which seemed excessive. We chatted university. We chatted the past. He kept stuttering. And then he crashed. I am confused. We started to load him onto the ship through the claw mechanism. I thought that perhaps I was next but instead the claw came down and took the bedroll from me. Professor suggested it was better for me to stay on the ground, sharpen the senses and take point. I tried to argue but I'm learning that you cannot argue against a man such as Burnie. With a sigh, I picked up the rope and continued dragging the broken sled along, following the tracks that Martin had located. They took my woolen top hat with the claw.

From what I gather, whilst I was down below, the remaining crew were taking it upon themselves to try and fix Martin's stutter. Apparently a quick shock from the Professors glove did the trick. Burnie made love to a bird

man apparently. Some harsh words followed directed at Myron. But Myron persisted in his questioning. Martin was created in Linderdorf. That was all that was learned before I collapsed.

I'm told that Martin had jumped over the side to rescue me. Professor says that he then used a quote "cable hand" to hoist us both back onto the skyship. Myron took over the role of track following from the comfort and warmth of the sky boat. So brave. I feel so foolish that had the nerve to be so weak and collapsed in the sub zero temperatures. Myron called Martin's bluff and tried to steer North towards the Varg, a clever ruse to gain more information from our new prisoner/guest/travelling companion. Adding to the disaster of the lie was the fact that our new dwarf companions recognised Martin. They revealed that Martin had been an official member of the party going North. Martin tried to jump off the boat again but was stopped. The dwarves made the point that the other travellers would be a week or so ahead. I woke up to find Myron standing over me screaming Bovril. Oh god. I crawled over to the bar and checked the Bovril box. I can't describe the feeling that came over me as I stared into that dark, empty box. I looked at Myron. Myron looked at me. A bead of sweat ran down my face. "Is there a problem boy?" he asked, fingers itching towards his abomination of a gun sword thing. I tried to put on my best smile and started pouring in the grenadine. I dropped a bottle of sherry but we had more. Then it came to the last ingredient. I looked at Myron again and smiled. He was not smiling. I looked around desperately and then I saw it. A chance. A small carton of instant gravy. Did I dare? How could I not. I slowly stirred a spoonful of those delicate meaty granules. It seemed to take almost an eternity for them to dissolve in the tepid liquid but finally it was done. With shaking hands, I handed the glass to Myron. I held my breath as he raised the glass to his lips and sipped deeply. Time stopped. Would he know, would he see through my ruse? How could he not? But then a miracle. For the first time in this last month, I saw something that looked like a smile cross his face. A miracle.

As the days went on the weather closed in. Myron (possibly) joked that they would need me on the ground again to follow the tracks. I'd only just got the feeling back in my fingers. It seemed to be a snow storm although it was the oddest thing, the air seemed to be closer, pressured. Myron and Martin looked troubled, whatever that means on a robot's face. We tried to push on through the evening but as time went on the winds got stronger, the colour of the storm became deeper, the temperature cooler. We felt a

strong shock to the sky boat which knocked us to the floor. Suddenly, there was a gigantic crack and the air became electric as a lightning bolt hit the sky boat. The last thing I saw was the mountain and the very large footsteps that crossed over the trail we were following...

Yours sincerely,

Kevin J Eldon

Epilogue

"Dear Myron,

This is the third letter I've tried to write to you, but somehow i cant seem to find it in myself to send a singel one. I think im scared you wuldnt want to here from me. Ive been trying to mak up for sum of the things that hav hapened over the last few munths. I dont fink il ever reely be able to, but i fought to myself, i shuld try. Its strange not beeeing in fights evryday. My life theese last few weeks has been quiet quiet comapred to the last year or so. I fink youd like the slower life in a way. Maybee yuu wuould be a bit bored thouth bacaseu i know you like kiling monsters and fings.

I hope Burnies is looking affter you. I hope yure not drinking tooo much.

I think about delilah every day. I see her in my nitemares every nite, a thousand times i hear her screams and watch her make eye contact with me before reachinng out to her childern wiht her last action. Sometimes i fthink about the way you looked at mee that last time. . . "

Exmerah put her pen down and looked down at the piece of parchment that lay in front of her. She sat there staring at it for a long time...

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wZdZKolMIIO>



EPISODE 72: READY KEDDY GO

Ast time:
on trail of two inventors (totally both called Gogle). Craftwurk called Martin “joined” us (a la kidnapped). Airship got grounded in a storm when we headed north. Trail continues northward. Rest of the party is guarding the ship.

Big ol’ feet to the east we can track, but there’s also another set of feet. As we get closer there’s some metal feet and metal torso. Martin recognises them as another craft from his old party.

Myron does a thing, realises they passed through about 3 hours ago. They. Plural. 2 of ‘em.

We march, some of us get exhausted, it’s tough going. Myron thinks we’re gaining on them.

They’re heading to the varg hold, we can catch them, but it’ll take days.

We march another 6 hours. Kevin is dying, riphard wants to do the full 24, but Myron is finally tired.

We take a long rest, in fox-holes dug by Martin. Kevin nestles in his winter robe.

Kevin and Riphard suck, so we’re now using a sled that Martin built to carry and hot-swap Riphard and Kevin.

We make progress, that night there’s varg children watching us, which Burnie feeds some of Riphards magic food. Because fuck riphard not letting anyone share in a meal.

A few days later we crest a hill. . . and see the giants. . . and a few miles further, the varg hold - a maelstrom of pitched tents stretching miles wide. We tabogon down the hill at extreme speed, Martin crashing and alerting the giants. We roll for combat.

Fighting ensues, myron and I get in there, another one is scared away by Martin’s mean words. Riphard knocks one flat with the power of thunder!.

Another Giant shows up, we’re so fucked. He can throw lightning.

I jump on one of the fuckers and shaft him with lightning from my shock hook.

We get battered around, I take two greatsword blows, and Martin melts the other one not lightning one, but the storm giant doesn’t give a shit. Shock horror.

Myron drops a smoke bomb, and kevin gets brutalised. I, seeing my student and new associate in distress, very professionally jump behind cover to heal my wounds. Stormking gets glitterbombed in the face meaning we can all shoot him bettr now.

Few rounds later, Martin is in pieces, kevin and I are hiding, Myron’s in a cloud, and Riphard has blinded him. We’re starting to wear him down, Kevin climbs on top of the bastard, I shoot him in the eye. . . and he’s dead.

We get the gnomes out of the sack. They’re annoying, don’t understand the need for speed and our proximity to the Varg, and so I almost re-sack them, but they’re instead useful and we get to use their new better sleds to get back to the airship soon.



Colourblind Crashnic Sez

EPISODE 73: FORGEMASTERS (ITS A SHEFFIELD THING)

The small gnomes take particular interest in the pistol Riphard has. Seems like lasers are very impressive, even if the design is archaic.

The Gnomes were not looking forward to the Varg hold, but decide to share their secrets with the potential customers. Yuppui is not as on board as Marock, tbf they seem to be desperate at this point. They aren’t travelling north for the weapon designs, because the Varg are terrible at making weapons. What they really want is the

old forge of legend. Bright board forge written about in old dwarven books etc, probably near or in the mountain somewhere. Their genius plan is they stay in the warm city and repair the airship, and we go and get what we can from the forge, once we find it of course.

We have a long think about this, and by that I mean I think about it a lot, while the others decide.

Myron rallies the troops, and decides its hammer time. We set off into the snow, its whipping into our faces, I am unconvinced most of or any of the team know where or why we are going to the mountain. So I spool out the kite and send my head up towards the storm. One massive strike later, I am charged and ready. Lets goooooo adventure....

Myron retakes the lead shortly after it becomes apparent I have no idea where we are going, this Gnome has some skills of the wilds for sure. The raging storm continues around us, we are ascending further and further into the storm. Could it be another 24hr march, is this how the team rolls?

AS the storm fails to abate we start using improvised devices, arms, pickaxes, or anything we can dig in with. The climb gets steeper and steeper, but the top is our goal, and at least Myron seems very taken with getting there on time. Negotiating this climb is not the simple task the Gnomes had led me believe. As we slow to a crawl, Myron finds a great little ledge and we start the slide along it. In a shocking turn of events, Burnie gets a free charge, as I overhear something over the mountain radio telling us to turn back. I try to talk back but nothing. So after a brief discussion we move on. Burnie is concerned that lightening is the way the mountain is communicating with us. He isn't a fan. Next up the wind comes whipping up into us, I try and redirect it with my arms, and Myron pulls out some salty edible meat. I hone the wind into a tunnel and try and direct it past Riphard. HE still gets hurled twenty feet backwards. He pulls out his whip and latches onto Myron in and instant. Thankfully Myron has a very thick neck, and a sturdy constitution. Later redacted to tying us into a climbing line.

Myron looks like he is going to complain, but then doesn't, his thoughts like his words are lost to the wind.

A full rocks fall but luckily not on us, the snow increases to the point where Myron can see a door, but doesn't know where it is. Its clearly a complicated day for him. In the mean time a wall of wind, snow and rattling thunder and lightning

scattering across its inner face, its got to be at least 200ft deep. A huge figure emerges, and start complaining about us coming into its domain, despite my good graces the creature seems uninterested in bonding with Myron. After summoning some beast of pure, energy, thunder and wind, it becomes apparent that its time to dance.

Kevin takes the first opportunity to hide, behind a rock. We all develop different skills in life. Riphard tries to light the mother fucker up with his ancient weapon, misses, reloads and its like the mountain has exploded around him. A shockwave pushes the air and snow back from around him, and a beam of pure iridescent light emerges tearing into the creature, leaving scorch marks in its wake. Myron whips out some jerky, and then sets off a circle of smoke, that seems to emanate from the jerky he dropped. Also it seems to be surrounding Burnie clearly these guys have fought together before, it must be a tactic of some sort.

A strong gust of wind whips up around me, and with seeming intelligence throws me 20 feet. Burnie Hides, and the aspect pulls a enormous pulsating sword made of lightening out and cuts savagely through Myron. I respond by through a glitter grenade into it. The creature now looks transcendently beautifully as the particles of glitter race around and through it. Kevin unloads another bolt from behind him, The being smites me with a huge bolt of thunder, it hurts, oh it hurts. Riphard re-cocks the ancient weapon but this time the results is less intense.

Myron says some real shady shit under his breath and I sense an immense power envelop him. Burnie lets some electricity course through his body, what a strange creature he is, and uses it to augment himself as he hits it, once then twice. Before hiding behind Myron.

Myrons shield flashes briefly as his spell is shattered before the sword comes down on him, the light of his life is snuffed from within. I hook up to the storm in the wall, and charge myself up unleashing a torrent of electricity at the two creatures. Despite over loading everything in my body it seems to have little effect on them. Kevin sees a window of opportunity and hits a sweet spot, or what I can only assume is a hotspot from the storms screeching reaction. Riphard bounds out from behind his rock, and screams at Myron to getup. The creature lets out a mighty roar and wind blows out across Burnie, who takes the opportunity to stab at the beast. The howling wind whips up amongst my over loaded parts tearing me to pieces.

— Observations made post power loss

Myron gets twatted again by a huge electric sword. Not surprisingly he takes it in bad sport, and passes out. Kevin seems set on keeping the good fight up, talking to himself about positive thinking. Despite his great hiding skills, he gets exploded by a blast of thunder. Riphard has been ensconced inside the whirling winds. He doesn't stop him from shooting the storm, and saving Myron. Who then goes and hides in the snow, badly. Burnie strikes out again at the storm. He does call on the aid of Kevin to shoot the storm, as Riphard whips the smaller spinning storm, which engulfs burnie. The enraged aspect of the storm, turns on Burnie but somehow misses him entirely. Somehow Burnie stabs it again, as the air around him explodes in thunder. Maybe he is deaf as it doesn't seem to hurt him all that much.

Marting has an imaginary gf in Nanduan, and Ravin McCaw is a lying SoB.

Kevin crossbows the lady, and then rolls in the snow.

Riphard drops the hammer on his ancient weapon and takes the storm art. It suddenly dissipates, the sun emerges and birds start singing. A last flurry of snow, falls to the ground.

Kevin asserts loudly that his Girlfriend is real. Burnie dashes over and recharges Martin, in what was probably just in time.

— Observations resume with power

Myron apologises for what was probably his shortest performance to date, whatever that means. Kevin talks to Riphard about what makes the best yorkshire pudding. Myron thinks that it must be good news that something like that was here, as it was protecting something cool. He is looking very almost dead. The door exclaims that this is the Bright Bart forge, or at least its door. Kevin and Riphard inspect the door, and it seems that this is the place, apparently this is where all the legendary weapons of heroes of old came from. Just as Kevin notices the beautiful lock, Myron smashes it with the excalibur pick.

Burnie steps up to the door, and plunges his knife into the door frame, that then falls away from the door letting it slowly and then suddenly fall flat towards us.

We head down the stairs, its full of very old drawings, of drawven Gilgamesh. A thick layer of dust covers everything, including a smattering of grouped dwarven skeleton. Kevins sister in northern wales gets a job as a GP, with a 20,000 gold pieces handshake. They have all died of venereal disease. The diaries don't show this,

but they did. Over the years having the forge at the top of a mountain proved to be a bad idea, just as Riphard had said at the start. The dwarves sealed themselves in, when the mountain was possessed by the aspect of the storm. Kevin finds the mother load of hammers and tongs, the likes of which no one has seen in since the forge was open. He also finds a whole stack of books on rune carving and forging. Riphard finds a whole bunch of trinkets and jewellery. (5000Gp of curios)

I speed reads the books, and helps put it all in sacks. The others go and get the airship. I stay behind and study.

The gnomes have fixed the airship, flick a single switch that fixes it, and come back and return to pick up all the books and tools. It takes a week until we are able to get back to Lindedorf.

Myron convinces him that he has met Rubrix, even going so far as to pull out the Rubrix Di which he spins around in his hands, it clicks, whirs and then clicks and clunks, sand and goo seeps out of the cube. Martin and the cube talk for a while, before it turns out the Earth Elemental speaks common. Everyone admits its not great that Korg has to leave again soon, Myron gets him to lift Kevin. Myron tells Korg all about the devil they work for, and how they are going to take down Kalimar and the Church. I'm pretty interested, Korg goes around lifting everything he can before being sucked back into the cube. Myron chokes himself out, and Martin turns himself off.

We wake up in Lazarus' office/waiting room. "Oi laz we got another new one" Kevin looks out the window to his infinite dismay. Myron explains briefly, and Laz and others fill in the details.

Martin tries a touch of exposition, and ends up making a deal with the devil to do whatever he wants in return for Laz getting him off.

When we return Myron spots Lady Haramxe walking alongside Smords father. They lock eyes across the expanse of Lindedorf.

– Scene –

Myron ignores her, takes us all back to the workshop, and then goes to the university to meet his father. Lady Haramaxe is present. It is incredibly awkward, even with the extravagant levels of waffling in the wrong and right places. "Kyri needs us, and I need you"....

Georj, " learn how to say sorry sometime...."

BearyMan

Exmerah and Myron talk for a great deal of time over wine, the character development is incredible.

Everyone meets back at the workshop.

Martin is a mouse,

Everyone gets made a weapon by the Gnome inventors, except for Kevin who gets a stick.

EPISODE 74: OF MICE AND MECHS

ame back from mission to rescue 2 inventors - Nappy and Grump - rescued from their excursion northwards - where they were seeking an ancient dwarvern forge. After we rescued them, we found stuff on runecrafting, and the forge, so we've started doing real runecrafting.

We got some OP weapons/exoskeletons - martin is our boi. No one forgets him.

Is there anything we'd like to achieve or do while we're in linderdorf? Myron - goes to see his dad. See if there's any more help he can give. Jorge Myron - he's a tinker. A cockney tinker. Myron wants to be sneakier - hard with his armor on all the time.

He's got an idea - Myron will mercy kill his father for him. . . wait, might be the wrong thing. Papa Myron married a new bird - and he wants Myron to meet her at dinner. With his friends. Holly Dew.

She's a halfling.

Myron stares with a blood rage for 20 minutes, then wanders off.

Burnie - seek safe house for his family and Rips kids. Guild of Gary will join protect them.

Get intelligence on the citadel. - Will do as a group later

Learn how to shoot a gun - he sucks at it terribly. He's gained a phobia of it.

Martin - spends all his time with Burnie. Explaining he's got a purpose, to be a fighting butler.

Rip - drinks heavily while spending time with his parents.

Exme - into the coffee scene - with "Kevin" - PHD student - that dickhead.

Writing his thesis - Which burnie keeps burning. Exme leaves Kevin to pick up the bill.

We all get dressed for dinner at the myron residence. Big, but not ostentatious - wealthy couple. Got a garden, which is growing well despite being in an underground city. The butlers way posher than Jorge. Not a robot butler though.

Holly's got her own business interests. They're pretty wealthy. We're gonna get pissed.

Jorge and Exme and Holly know each other. Of course. Exme runs into see Holly.

Does Myron want to be a cunt, or does he want to have a good experience.

Holly Dew Myron (Nee Thistlebloom) has a dad/mother who was an ex-book burner - who burned to death in the purge Pilch caused. . .

Who the hell is Smord? Oh. Myron is Smord. Burnie and Holly realise they know each other as well.

Myron and myron heart to heart. Myron says sorry to Myron.

Myrons mother wasn't eaten by halflings. Myrons mummy left his daddy for another man. They joined a cult. And the cult was wiped out, by the church.

Burnie doesn't come to parties a lot - because he keeps trying to send people to hell.

Myron gets his dad up to speed on how it all works.

We swap stories and drink a lot. Martin the mouse gets cheese from Exme. Myrons mum joined a cult of enlightenment of some sort.

The myrons love each other - it's very touching.

We get wankered, go to bed, wake up, go to the workshop, get our weps.

Juppi finds a pamphlet saying "stonecast mech, the best weapon ever invented"

We're going to go fight the giant mech to prove our best weapons are betterer than their giant killer mech. We might try to steal it.

We go to google HQ to discuss, and we talk with them about killing the mech.

We make an offer. They counter. And it's nice and even - they get our stuff if we lose, we get to buy the bot if we win.

The gun is sexy. And french. A hohehoheho.

Clawtech arena. We'll fight tomorrow midday. We get kicked out, Martin strides in purposefully to spec out the robot. It's got a flame thrower and a laser cannon on each arm, and can punch hard too. It shines weirdly with its "stone metal" - which makes it strong. Martin convinces them to dismantle it in time for tomorrow - might make it kinda shitty for tomorrow?

EPISODE 75: HOW TO KILL GIANT ROBOTS AND INFLUENCE PEOPLE



So. The night before the big robo-show down. We headed back to the airship and I took some time to inspect the work that the gnomes had been doing for us. We now had new cannons and smoke screen and a reinforced hull. Very shiny and impressive all in all. Wanting to be fresh for the morning we decided to go to sleep. But the night had other plans for us.

We woke up in the waiting room. The squad took a bit of time to discuss the finer details of why our clothes follow us into hell. Meredith tried to explain to Myron unsuccessfully before leading us into the office. This time there was a large scale map of Velterra in the office instead of the usual kitsch furnishings. Lazarus was still butthurt about the battle simulator challenge but he explained that now that the end was coming into sight, maybe we should start putting together a plan to sort out whatever was keeping the gods out of the world and destroy it. Martin was very keen to ask about the murder of his previous employer. We were all a bit confused about the plan because we were sure that Lazarus had said friendship was the answer to everything. Burnie spends two hours every morning jerking off, presumably due to the difficulties of having a hook. Lazarus said that number one priority was bringing the gods back to the world. Myron was very adamant that the priority was to save Arbiter Kiros. Burnie claims that the greater the number of soldiers firing at you, the lower the chance of being shot. Burnie is the single most bullet ridden scarred man I have ever known. I asked if we knew what was keeping the gods away and Lazarus was a little shocked to find out that I had not used the cube to try and locate the source of the power. Egg on my face I suppose. Myron had many thoughts. While they debated I slapped myself to wake up and then got to work with the cube trying to locate the blockage. I focused really really really hard and the cube started rotating and clicking and glowing. Then suddenly there was a pulse. It was pretty clear that it was coming from The Seven's Spire. I made myself a milky drink and drank it really quick and tried to go back to sleep.

In hell the boys were discussing 733t cryptography methods in order to trick the folk over at the spire and get them out of the way. There was a lot of talk about making use of the

friends we have made along the way such as the Gary's and the Tiger and our bird-based assassin friends. Friendship really is magic. Oh by the way, someone remembered that there was a festival of light coming up which is a celebration of all the gods in two weeks time. During it a lot of people pilgrimage to the Seven's Spire. Mr Lazarus told us that he had been busy overseeing the torture of Mr Rubriks. He had not really found out more about kalimar or Kolo yet, only that Kalimar was a master of warping flesh. He also mentioned Kanalon. Burnie asked an excellent question which was if we free the gods then would we also be releasing all these mad hell beings as well. Laz was like probs no, who knows. Martin asked why the gods were separated in the first place. There are a lot of things being brought up here that we probably should have asked a long time ago. Gap. Mr Lazarus says we should take better notes. Or at least read them.

Martin offered us some help from the Varg friends that he has. Burnie decided that we should go and anger the Tiki-tuks then lure them along from the Temple of Unthala to the Spires. This was a pretty stupid plan. Everyone is going to send out messages for any contacts they have to get them to descend on the festival. Wake up time.

Burnie was kicked out of hell just in time to get a bucket of water thrown over him by Martin. A very bloodied Kevin walked in with a pittance of wax, an incredible feat for the area given their well established wax deficits. He collapsed and I took him to the infirmary.

We made our way over to the battle scene. A big oval with all the seats around it and the crowd gradually filling up. We took a bit of time to moan about the images they had put up of us on the banners. Riphard was not joining us preferring to spend time warming up his breast milk with his own elbow heat. As we entered we were met by a relatively young gnomish man called Grup who was the events co-ordinator. We asked about if there was any gambling about us. We were running at four to one against. We went to gamble. We bet 1500 gp eight times for us to win.

We made our way into the arena. There was so much music and shouting and excitement all around the arena. Difficult to hear really. Omg though this stone robot was so big. Not as big as the mountain lizard thing but still pretty big. Maybe like 30 ft. There was even smoke and stuff as it came up out of the ground on a platform. Bit much. Burnie took the lead in his excited state. He actually ran straight at it.

Martin knelt down and Mr Mouse got out to take a moment to rub some dirt onto his face in two lines under his eyes. Then he got back in. Hardcore. The robot moved forwards to Burnie and hit him with its full force three times in a row. It was pretty devastating. Blood everywhere. Myron headed in. I sent a forcefield at Myron and then took a shot at the stone one. CEDRIC is AMAZING, he did such a good shot and he has such a funny voice that makes me go all trembly. But there was not time to enjoy, I pressed the button and STANRI went rigid, standing upright and opening up ready, a thousand small actuators rearranging his body into the perfect killing machine (but also the cutest!). Burnie came over and I heard Mark's voice in my head which was upsetting.

Mr Mouse and Martin threw some kind of storm sphere at the robot which looked pretty cool. Some guy shouted in a high pitched voice for it to use its shocking burst but it did not actually do anything apart from spark a little. Myron tried to jump onto its leg but it was a lot slippier than expected and he couldn't quite get on. He tried to hit it in the groinal area but it did not have the main bits that boys have that could have. I got into STANRI in a really cool like kawaii montage thing and I heard with satisfaction "All systems online". We strafed and then shot CEDRIC at him which hit but some kind of energy field seemed to divert some of the damage. Burnie hit the stone monster with a stone dagger twice. The robot started firing missiles at Martin and Myron took the opportunity to attack.

The hand came off the monster and rained down fire all over Burnie and Myron. Myron started climbing it again and threw in a load of hits that resulted in more sparks. He was up to the knee. STANRI and CEDRIC and I moved around and gave it another blessed shot. We got a face full of magic missiles for our efforts. Burnie went nuts then Martin continued his lighting attack, the lightning striking aggressively against the side of the arena causing the crowd to cheer wildly. The robot did not look happy and we saw it turn towards us and fire off two massive cannon attacks which hit fully in the chest. Myron was enraged and brought out Godrbinger. He launched himself into the air giving the robot a brutal barrage finishing with a final shot that separated the robot in half. Myron screamed and after a few seconds the crowd joined in as well, the entire stadium being filled with noise. Burnie raised his arms and yelled to them "ARE YOU NOT ENTERTAINED". Myron looked around desperately trying to find out who was doing the

announcement. A speaker came out of Stanri and Myron took the mic. "Ladies and gentleman, we fight here today in a righteous cause. We are to take this cause to where it stands. The church have for too long suppressed the people of this land, keeping the technology locked into this city. We are planning an assault to retake hope's rest for the free peoples of this land. We will take this robot and use it to free up a land that should be free. If you are interested in using your bodies to defend the cause then you are welcome to join us." There was a few seconds of nervous silence before a good quarter of the crowd started to shout again and join in the chants. Martin joined in "This is your chance for freedom. Have you got still fear in your bones. You should be using technology to free your lives.". I leaned over and gave him the word he was looking for. Oh Kolo, if you could have heard the three quarters of the crowd yelling "EMANCIPATION" I think you would have enjoyed that. Martin threw glitter into the air as he thunderstepped out.

Wrapping up, we won 48000 gp from the foolish gamblers. The robot creators kept their word and agreed to hand over the robot. I requested a small modification for a small room in the head about the same size as a mouse ;). They started to get working on making the repairs. As we rode back I spent a bit of time on the Die of Rubriks and think that I figured out a way to make all of us and the airship go a bit faster. On second thoughts, I had another crack at it and got a higher level function. I was gobsmacked at what it revealed to me. It can't be. Surely not

We headed back to Lazarus' war room, I couldn't speak all the way. Lazarus wondered if we could get Lillith to infiltrate the spire. Myron was concerned about time but we can move fast now. The robot transportation shouldn't be a problem. We can fit it in the cargo with a couple of engineers to help assemble on the other side. Martin had a good idea to drop a giant robot out of the airship. Surely that would create enough of a distraction to keep everyone busy while we raided the tower. Lazarus revealed that the inquisition probably know about the artefact and it would be well protected. Myron suggested we start listing our allies that we could call upon. Friendship. Fish people. Police. Gary's. Myron was using big words and Burnie was feeling 'wordiferous'. Turns out that Martin has been reading to them in their sleep in order to improve their vocabularies. Myron asked if it was possible to see into Lillith's dreams. The debate went back and forwards for a long time. We decided that with the speed increase and the

airship we could be anywhere before the enemy had a chance to act. We are fast now. Possibilities are endless. 9 days to get to Masuda and back to Seven Spires. We are going to go fetch the ninja assassins. You're going down church. You're going down.

Epilogue

It was very late. The others had long since gone to sleep. Exme was sat on her bed, a single candle lighting the room. The cube lay in front of her, cold and staring. Surely it wasn't possible. It was too good to be true. She picked the cube up and started slowly rotating it, almost absent minded. As her fingers moved across its face objects in the room started disappearing, time slowed and re-started. A small door appeared, the smell of freshly baked bread wafting out and filling the room. Eventually Exme found the configuration she was looking for and the room became still and silent once again. The cube was softly glowing in her hands, almost offensively mundane. Exme stared at the cube. She could swear that it was looking back. Myron thought we could secretly arrive to the spire in advance and spend some precious time setting up the robot.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8aQRq9hhekA>

EPISODE 76: THE PLAY'S THE THING

 He party are up late, penning letters to their various allies and friends around the continent. They conjure a picture of a mounting popular uprising brewing in Hope's Rest, a Church plot to quell it, an encroaching Varg attack organised by the church as a decoy. The printing press is to be used to publish large amounts of revolutionary literature, aided by the Garys the Jennies and Archibald.

Burnie sees Mr McDonald and Google Von Macherstein to see if they want to come. They do not.

Myron says goodbye to his dad, and it's as awkward as you'd expect.

The big robot is stowed in the hold, disassembled, and the new cannons are primed, and they are ready to go.

Esme plugs the cube into the ghost engine, and tells everyone to strap in. She smacks a lever forward and the crew are pinned against their seats as they move literally quicker than anyone has moved before.

The crew entertain themselves. Esme and Myron play the travel version of a game where you spell words with little letter tiles. Esme spells "GABRIN", Myron spells "AB", Esme spells "MYRON", Myron spells "BMO", and Esme says he wins the game, and not just because she doesn't want to play any more.

They suddenly realise they've massively overshot Tom'ardy and Burnie starts reversing back.

Esme goes to get Rip, who has been locked in his room with his weird corpse wife mannequin and two sacks of rotten pork he seems to think are his children. Esme for some reason thinks that Myron would be good at talking sense into Rip. She is, understandably, proven wrong.

Eventually, they sort everything out, and go out to see what's happened to Tom'ardy. It's a socialist utopia now, and they're the heroes.

They go to find the council, in their shiny new collectivist council chamber, to try and see if they can work out who Lilith is this time. There's a random elf with wobbly ears on the council, but she doesn't seem to know where Lilith is.

The gang half-heartedly try and sell the concept of spreading the revolution to Hope's Rest, but they're starting to realise that it's quite a sell. They like the concept, but most of them think

The wobbly-eared elf suggests they talk separately, in an anti-chamber, which is kept safely isolated from the chambers.

Riphard is eating his own shit.

Esme gives Delilah her special mission, which is clearly to help Riphard to get over the death of his wife by disguising herself as Delilah for a few months, being killed so that he can try to grieve better next time.

Lilith isn't particularly wrapped about this, and so, instead, they begrudgingly tell Lilith the real plan, with the enormous, deadly decoy war, the clockwork ninjas, Lilith installing herself in the vipers nest, and then the invisible robot attack suicide mission. She's not that thrilled about this either.

Myron asks if she could try disguising herself as Kolo instead.

Riphard is producing consommé.

Lilith says that she's going to try and convince the council to help the Hope's Rest part of the mission first, and then decide about her other bit. She says that the gang should start trying to drum up some support among the people while she talks to the council.

They decide to perform the greatest play ever played.

They perform the greatest play ever played.

The play is too pure to be recorded. True beauty is, by its nature, ephemeral.

It is performed several times throughout the day, with increasingly experimental ad-libs each time.

After the last performance, Lilith approaches the group, and announces that she has successfully convinced the council to commit to the party's bizarre and immoral suicide mission, and moreover that she agrees to play her part in the plan.

Esme gets excited until Lilith assures her that she doesn't mean she'll pretend to be Delilah.

Lilith comes aboard the ship and they head off. Next stop, New Abbergast.

EPISODE 77: DEAR DAIRY: A TALE OF UNBRIELIEVABLE LOYALTY AND BRAVERY

Everyone (and Lillith) is chilling on the airship after a play well played. We set airsail for New Abberghast to confront Lady Dab'Agast. With our new hyper speed this only takes 6 hours

We set down the airship after casually mowing down several birds on the way in, turned to mulch by the beef powered engines.

New Abs, as it's known by the locals, is pretty fancy now. Doing well for itself after my successful trade deal we established. Myron attempts to convince the doormen to join the Hopes Rest revolution. I explain that these probably aren't the correct people to sell the idea too, nor should we be so brazen and cavalier. They take us to Lady Dabs, as she's known by the locals.

Dabs looks resplendently wet. No sign of fish king. She looks fatter and shinier though. Positively glowing in that preggernant way. Bernie stares at her.

Apparently it's only been 2 or 3 months since we were here. It feels like a lifetime ago. She says she doesn't know how long fish people preggernancies take but apparently inter species pregnancy is confirmed as possible at least.

She tells us the church has sent envoys and tried to convince her to turn us in if we came back. We laugh nervously. She assures us she takes her alliances seriously and doesn't plan to, and seems genuine.

We discuss the finer details of mass murder definitions and the fact that undead don't exist in this universe so we don't know what they are. Myron tries to explain the whole fake mass murder conspiracy church sting set up we got wrapped up in. I forgot all about that, I don't remember being involved. I think they probably did it. They did do it, but they didn't mean to because of magick deception.

Riphard tests Dabs's hair, suspecting she could be churchmen in disguise. Seems real.

Myron said the word corroborated, which took me by surprise. Martin says he's been teaching Myron words and stuff. He further interrogates Dabby about being a church. Riphard shares the

sad departing of dear Delilah and his children turned to pork.

Martin further presses the church biz even more, really not buying her honesty. Myron whisper explains the complex plan to me. Apparently we actually want her to betray us so that the church actually think we are all going to Hope's Rest, but really we're going to Seven Spire or something.

I go for a high five for casting aspersions on the young fish king Dabs relationship. Bernie stabs me to health.

Apparently the plan is different in our loud voices. This is confusing.

Dabs says her and fish king's army don't actually need water to fight, and agrees to send them to Hope's Rest, not Seven Spires. She explicitly tells us not to come to their wedding and we aren't invited or welcome. They don't eat cheese.

The fish king tells us there's more mysterious disappearings and tells us to sort it out. We agree suspiciously quickly. This will be our downfall. Everyone tries to make cheese puns. Fish people don't brieth underwater.

We come across a rocky outcrop ruin. An old rock fort, if you will. We investigate for footprints before remembering we're underwater. We approach the ruins caerphilly.

We glimpse some humans "just standing about". Turns out the ruins are above the sea level. They aren't drowning. They seem to be simple farmers.

All 5 say in unison, "Ah, hello Myron. Welcome, we were hoping you would come." Myron presses them on whether they've eaten the fish people.

Burnie notices 2 filassians in the water near the ruins. Myron suspiciously tells us all to come over to the ruin.

Burnie stealths around and spots a giant octopode staring right at him. The whole thing is very creepy and unsettling. We perceive the thinly veiled threat to the situation. Shit is going to get real real soon.

Myron turns to leave and the creepy farmers have had enough. A bunch of vines get in his way. Myron struggles through them, but 3 monstrous strange creatures step out of the shadows as if from nowhere. They look like nothing he has ever seen. They also speak in unison with the farmers. They are made of thorny tentacles.

Myron is injured in the initial kerfuffle. He then tells them to say cheese, buffs up, and steps up to them. Power move.

I step up towards the rope and spy the farmers and a scary vaginapenis monster. I shoot at the monster, but a farmer steps into the way and explodes. I quick reload and let off another shot and hit the monster squarely.

Martin causes a whirlwind in the fort, wiping out most of the farmers. Myron holds on for dear life. He doesn't like the wind much. He probably farted in his own face.

Exme gets inside Stanri and activates his feet based jet rockets. He hovers towards the ruins.

The octopode grapples Burnie with his tentacles. The sneaky fish bois try to bite us, but miss badly. Pathetic.

Burnie throws something at the octopus and launches it away from the battle area.

The vaginapenis monstrosity jumps at the airborne Stanrexme. It Maw-Claws him intensely.

Myrons looking worse for wear and attempts to shoot some motherfuckers. The whirlwind continues to wreak havoc on the remaining monstrosities in the ruin.

I whip the fishy boi next to me to death. Delilah's Revenge.

Stanrexme takes more burning vagenticle lashings. A bunch more fishy bois appear and try to bite a bunch of people.

The octopode attempts to tentacle Martin, but misses. Another fucking octopode appears. This is turning into one of my cheese fueled nightmares.

Burnie hop, skips, and jumps onto the vaginis monster's back. He tries to hand hook and shock it, and the smelt of cooked calimari fills the air.

The monstrosity speaks to Burnie in a surprisingly camp voice, expressing the disappointment in Burnie we all feel all the time. It ClawMaws him, but he escapes relatively unscathed to the damage Stanrexme received. Stranri mauls the monstrosity.

The windy battle between the other beasts and Myron continues unabated, though less windy now. Myron takes more of a beating. Myron runs away from this battle, into the fray with the vagenis monster, stabbing the fuck out of it with his gun in classic Myron fashion. He then tries to run across the rope further away from the monsters, but falls off in classic Myron fashion.

Martin the mechamouse thundersteps away from the adjacent octopode and attempts to lightning bolt the vagenis monster, but remembers he can't cast both spells in one round.

I step towards the fray and bellow firey encouragement to my comrades in need. I let loose a blinding smite hammer of the gods blessed bullet, carving a clean hole right through the holey monster's head. It collapses into a pile of disgusting vaginas and penises and vagenises

Exme jumps away from the enemies and shoots the fuck out of the thorny tentacle cunt.

The fishy bois try and gnaw on people somewhat harmlessly.

Burnie approaches the thornman and attempts to destroy the last of his mirror images. He destroys one and gets a meaty hook into the mess of thorns itself.

Stanri clears out all the remaining fishy bois.

Burnie does some more complicated stuff that's beyond my comprehension somehow. Something about reactions.

The three of us huddle on the shore bank get tentacled a bit. Riphard starts to hum "Turning Japanese".

Myron bum rushes the thorny dude and stabshoots the fuck out of it, but not as much as we originally thought due to some lack of bless or something.

Martin finally casts his lightening[sic] bolt and takes out a few more dudes and an octopus.

I get spiked a bit again by the thorns, but then step outside. I then shoot the remaining octopode, but it's still squirming around on the land.

Exme also shoots the octopode heavily, but it's STILL squirming.

Burnie kills the beast dog thing that's been part of this battle but hasn't really been mentioned.

Stanri starts getting washed away somehow.

Burnie gets necrotic as fuck from the thronmeistergeneral.

Myron doesn't do anything useful.

Martin gets tentacled and finally escapes the writhing mass, then grasps the octopode to death.

Two more fucking fish boys appear right at the end with only one dude left.

I attempt to gloriously leave across the watery chasm. My maximum jump distance of 6ft is sadly short and I plop into the water. I sploosh towards Stanri also in the water and let a shot off into the air in frustration.

Exme shoots at the thornier and a fishy boy sacrifices itself instead.

Burnie tries to hook the thorns a bit, but doesn't do much.

Stanri fails to get up the slippery bank, feeling too sorry for me.

Burnie gets more necrotic.

Myron shoots at the thorns.

Martin lightening[sic] bolts the thorns to oblivion. FINALLY. Burnie also takes the brunt of the shock damage, but miraculously survives.

Myron attempts to talk to whatever controlling monstrosity brought this plague upon us.

Burnie pokes around in the monster corpse goop, but finds nothing.

We head back to the fish king to tell him of our epic battle and he very briefly agrees to send all his armies to Hope's Rest, not wanting to allow any more time for bad, overly forced cheese puns.

EPISODE 77.5: THE MASUDAN FAN-FICTION ADVENTURE

Rules of the text: Feel free to do scenes, feel free to do stuff in character. Please don't do anything with someone else's character they wouldn't like. If I say it didn't happen like that or can't happen, please edit the post

The group have left the town of New Abbergast on the airship after securing their allies support for the attack on Hope's Rest. A day later and you are able to drop Lillith off some distance away from the Seven's Spire to begin her infiltration. After running a few checks on the airship and making sure you have plenty of supplies you point the airship towards the ocean and blast off towards Masuda in search of your robotic allies, unsure of how Masuda will have fared since you left it under attack by a gigantic monstrosity.

The journey itself takes four days - is there anything that anyone wants to try and achieve in this time?

/u/mcgi5sr2

Martin would like to teach Exmerah all he knows of the gods and expose the internals of his systems. It feels kind of like he is writing his final testament.

He would also steals burnies armour and installs a new conduit system into it from his shoulder to his arm. (expend a spell slot to charge his hook)

He finishes his picture book of long words (also spelt phonetically) for Myron, and gives it to him secretly as a gift.

He visits Richard and transfers a very long list of wealthy families and contacts he has made over his extended life time, included are some very sordid details only a butler would know about. (increase riphards clout and reach in aristocracy to include blackmail if necessary).

He asks to see the giant lizard, and rolls persuasion for its assistance in the coming war

Finally he builds a shrine hidden at the back of the vault in the basement, in the base of the ship and rests in deep prayer every night.

/u/TheFailBus

Who is the shrine to?

Everything is fine except the Lizard bit, not in Masuda yet. But they do tell you the stories of the giant lizard, even you have seen nothing of the like in all your years.

/u/mcgi5sr2

Shrine is to Hemotate - The Book-Bearer, The Tree in the Storm Justice, Fairness, Karma, Scholarly Pursuits

Devotees of Hemotate make a habit of claiming that by the time Hemotate arrived to a battle, the day was already won. Using preparation, research, and their enemies weaknesses, they often found no need for weapons. The forces of darkness brought their own undoing, and Hemotate was able to pick at the right threads to unravel their plans.

As for lizard, let me know when to roll persuasion :-)

/u/magnificentjosh

Myron gets out huge sheets of paper from somewhere, and spends days on his hands and knees, sketching and drawing arrows and diagrams, trying to remember everything he knows about Seven's Spire.

Looking over his shoulder, you can see various bits scribbled out, or torn off so completely. You can also see sections made illegible through having large quantities of Bovril spilled over them. A recurring theme seems to be trying to work out where the most likely place for Kiros (often represented by a stick figure with a sad face and a comically oversized gun) to be imprisoned is. Several areas of the spire have been circled in red pen, but most of them have been crossed out.

When not in his quarters with the papers, Myron is quiet. He works throughout the night, sleeping through most of the day. He occasionally paces around the deck, dismissing anyone who tries to strike up casual conversation.

The smells of burning oils and incense can be smelled from his room from time to time, as he observes various religious rituals, both those supported by the central church, and those confined to the uncivilised outposts far from prying eyes other than his. He has never been interested in fulfilling those Arbiter duties intended to tame the wild heart of his religion.

You also hear him training physically, getting used to his new armour, shield and weapon. You struggle to habituate to the gunshots coming from his room while you try and sleep, and the multiple new large holes in the exterior of the ship. The pile of broken training dummies outside his room grows gradually. They all seem to have crudely drawn smiley faces, all with an eye patch.

/u/teh_stev3

Burnie will take his notes and his files on everyone and everything they've been doing, and give them to Kevin who he sends away with a load of money "for a special backup mission"(yes, it's that vague) - but really he's just trying to save the poor idiot. Included, in a cipher that's laughably easy to break, is an excellent testimony to Kevin's capacity as an assassin, and in fact he's so good he should immediately be instructing (keeping him safer than being on the streets) - and bucky mccaw would be a great mentor for him.

Included is a note beseeching Bucky to mentor young Kevin, and also official adoption papers to make him his official son, as well as (in an actually good cipher) where Bucky can find Burnie's parents if he wants to keep in contact with his family. Also there's enough money embezzelled from Riphard's bank to keep get his parents back into their ancestral home in tom'ardy (Assuming most of the clan were wiped out during the rebellion).

He also writes a letter to Archibald and Jenny, as well as Zippy (the guy that makes the lighters) - all are heartfelt, and barely legible, and have a secret message to each of them which together read "I always secretly preferred men over women" - Burnie's last secret finally out.

Otherwise he'll make everyone's favourite cocktails and keep steering the ship, along side Captain Stick.

For Martin - it's essentially fondue in a glass with a silly-straw that perfectly reaches his face plate.

For Kevin (before he leaves) it's a dose of antitoxin to counter his own poor self-poisoning through alchemy throughout the day.

For Myron, it's a piece of shit (the cocktail) with potentially actual artisanal bugbear shit, and a sparkler.

For Ezme, it's an early grey tea with lemon.

For Riphard, it's a sherry dirty martini - shaken, not stirred - made with the last of his mother's sherry, and a fuck-tonne of olives, themselves pickled in whisky.

And for Burnie himself, it's a bottle of bootlick - a local lager that was made in shoes and served at the jolly giant - where he used to frequent as a young book burner.

With a bit of book ash for benefit.

/u/teh_stev3

Captain stick declines to drink as he's on duty.

/u/teh_stev3

But then you turn around and there's an expertly sabred open bottle of Veltarran Bubble-wine, in a perfectly chilled glass. Next you see the glass is empty.

/u/alt_rightMILOfag69

Exme is going to do research on Kalimar using the knowledge that Martin gives her. She will also continue her research on the twins. And she will try to examine the cube more to unlock some features and try to understand what the limits of the mega function are. She will sit on the side of the deck and smoke a lot and look into the distance and the sunset with some like soft 80s rock playing thinking about life n shit

/u/teh_stev3

Burnie will also give black sabbath and wasabi to two of the hearthrust sisters, whoever needs a nice weapon, as both are katana-style.

Longswords, black sabbath is a +1 but magic, wasabi is a +2 but not.

/u/TheFailBus

After the four days of travel you can see the shores of the Masudan continent. You fly towards the city of Masuda wanting to see if the giant lizard is still on its trail of destruction. As you get closer, you see no lizard, and the 'mountain' is laid in a similar, but not identical, position to where it was when you first saw it. The city of Masuda is chaotic - there was obviously a huge swathe of destruction across the city, many areas of the city are still complete rubble but there has been a lot of rebuilding since you were last here. Fresh buildings and those in construction scatter the city inbetween burnt husks and craters.

As you look further afield, you can see large troughs and burn marks across the landscape. The monster must have gone on a rampage further into the country before returning to its rest.

/u/mcgi5sr2

Martin sends a short prayer aloft to Hemotate, and then extorts everyone to get on down and start exploring. He is particularly keen to go and see the old man of the machine making that Exmerah has talked about. It's been a long time since anyone looked inside him, and he is sure the mice have left quite a mess in places. Not one to normally allow anyone into the deeper recesses of his body, he would insight the old guy and spend a lot of time talking with him before allowing any access. He will trade the knowledge the old man can gain from his own build and construction, for any kind of upgrades he old guy can offer. Even if that's just a nice

mini wicker chair and a cushion for him to sit in while controlling the machine.

Outside of that he will serve Burnie with a level of care and attention one would only normally devote to someone you expected to die in the near future. He cleans up all of Burnies clothes, which in most cases means burning them, and remaking them anew with materials uninfested with lice and other creatures as yet uncharted in the annals of biology. He also cleans up and brushes Burnies hair on a daily basis, in an ever more futile attempt to tame it.

EPISODE 78: THE OLD MAN AT THE COCONUT SHY

ll the animals came to the zoo and died. Annie wakes up, Exmeh has a bad dream and wakes with a start a big discussion takes place about whether to destroy the tower at Seven Spires or not.

Myron takes a big shit, but comes back to go over the plan. Martins calculations are correct the air ship will destroy the tower, Myron gets upset and throws the plans over the side. Exmerah goes on to try and explain why the boat will not or may not survive. Myron and Martin get into it a bit more before very little is resolved.

Eventually it becomes evident that we aren't even heading for sevens spire yet and are going to Largosk to pick up our giant robot. Myron also kills a farmer by shitting over the side of the boat.

I must remember to empty out all the other mice before making major decisions. The robot guys have no idea what we are planning. Myron starts the days briefing, it transpires that the higher the spire the more important it is. Myron seems to suspect that a basement may also exist. The visitor entrance is on the town side of the spire (East), either side of that is church entrances (North South), the delivery entrance is the last remaining on (West). There is also a massive sewer network that runs into the tower... Myrons and Burnies ability to read is limited solely to non pop up books.

Myron is obsessed with using the sewer to enter the tower. Some awesome roleplay takes place with Myron as Lillith its hard to tell that its not Lillith. Myron has some serious doubts as to whether Martin is legit on their side or on some kind of other mission.

Our spies let Myron know that 8000 troops left a few days ago to go to Hopes Rest.

He returns and decides that the ninja robots are probably best to go and do the recon, find a sewer grate, and talk to Lillith. The note that Exmerah has written seems to take about an hour to read on the first attempt, the second is just a single work in?

The walk takes an hour in which neither Myron nor Martin say anything at all. When they return the Ninjas are back, and remind Myron that the festival is a masked one, and we can just wear masks.

Exmerah raids Burnies shower for hair, and the steaks for meat, and starts covering the Stanri tiger with a thin layer of meat and burnies hair. Myron goes as a Lemon, Exmerah goes as Otaria with her actual face, but she adjusts the eyebrows and then crawls into Stanris vagina for travel. Burnie is going as Papa Lazarus, Martin is going as Lazarus. Riphard is going as.... with his golden robe.

We go to meet Lazarus, but other than a big chat about Kolos soul nothing of import really happens. Turns out maybe only the gods can help.

Myron goes for a massive walk up into the hills where a tree overhands a spring that is pooling underneath a large rock. He makes a stack of pebbles next to the spring, he then draws the symbol of Synne in charcoal on the stones, and lights 8 fires of different oiled colours. He mutters a prayer to all the gods, asking for their guidance. He receives an immense feeling of hope and peace within himself. A feeling of intense calm and rightness, something he is not so familiar with. The sun comes up and cascades across the land behind him.

On his return Exmerah has cooked him breakfast, a full bodied black face Burnie is also there.

After much debate we decide to walk to the city... as we get closer to the city more and more people join us on the road. The colours are extravagant, the animal themes are wifie, the ostentation levels are extraordinary, the richer the wearer the rarer the animal or animal skin they are wearing.

We are going to the big party, as a bunch of randos approach us and sell Myron some stuff.... its two gold for the good stuff... two packets of mysterious drugs obtained.

An old man appears, and suggests its a great day for restoring the eldar gods....

Burnie grabs some bootlick booze, Myron starts the hard drinking, the festival is really

starting to get going. Pineapples are being thrown, a lemon is up for grab in a highly rigged game.

Burnie and Myron look for a coconut game stall, where you throw coconuts at a white ball. They meet an old man there who knows a lot about Myron, and keeps inferring he knows how things work out. Its very confusing but in the end Myron throws a coconut, very poorly. He throws again, he wins, and gets a wink from the old man.

We work our way through the crowd trying to blend in as best as we can.

It becomes clear to me that everyone is watching us, we are being stalked by any number of people. This is just about to go very south.

We arrive at the meeting point, and Burnie starts dancing with the bear, its getting fucking freaky, as that happens a voice from the gate of the spire rings out.

Everyone get back, get back from those Charlatans, as a group they approach us and accuse us of scamming the locals. I admit to the crime, and insinuate my compatriots. The chain us all up, including the bear and lead us into the spire. Unlicensed entertainment in front of the spire, 100% illegal at festival time.

We are led into the guard room, and the local pastor is called. Licensing or death is the going rule here. What a surprise the pastor is none other than..... Lillith!

EPISODE 79: THE TIME WARP



A shakey alliance has been brought together by somewhat devious means thanks to the group's charm and guile. Representatives from Abberghast, including the royal king fish Oceanus himself, Hope's Rest commoners, the Guild of the Garys, assassins, Tom'ardy dwarves, and Linderdorf robots and robot cannons have all gathered on this fair field a days march south east of Hope's Rest. It is here the church will face their reckoning and a true test of their fate.

Tactics are hastily discussed in hushed tones for fear of spies. Fear and nervousness at the mysterious nature of the enemy about to be faced ripple through the rank and file. King Oceanus stands tall on his litter and gapes his maw to the group. A bellowing cry, loud yet

soothing, falls upon the virgin ground, bolstering morale amongst the brave army brought together from across the entirety of Velterra.

The plan is to bring their army within range of our powerful barrages, but plans have to be flexible in the face of the unknown.

Ready positions are taken: the raged units of the Hope's Rest Guard and the Linderdorf cannons staying back atop two crests, with the Abberghast fishmen and a group of the Garys and assassins holding the left flank, and the central ground held primarily by the dwarves with the odd band from the others here and there to fill out what is sure to be the main battle ground.

A low continuous thunder is noticed as armour begins to rattle, gently at first, but ever building. A loud CRACK shocks the air and a plume of smoke rises in the distance. A warning shot. A brag. A threat. The enemy approaches.

God's own army presents itself across the expanse. A brief standoff seems to linger as each side eyes the enemy for the first time, prepared but wary. The riflemen steadily raise their arms. Another crack pierces eardrums and bullets rain down upon the infantry, arrows upon the fishmen. Shaken by the sudden commencement of battle the alliance infantry begins to retreat: the church must be lured into our limited range.

Priests upon horseback thunder down the left flank towards the fishmen, peppered with yet more arrows and hundreds lost already. The cavalry bear down upon the Abberghastians as the Hope's Rest Guard let loose a round of bolts straight at them from high.

Across the battle field the Linderdorf cannons begin their onslaught immediately crushing hundreds of church riflemen and archers. The bulk of the church infantry begin their death march toward the alliance stronghold.

Their numbers already weakened by cannonfire the riflemen and archers within range turn their attention to the robots in the hopes of spooking or even killing the limited number of these powerful units. But these steely beings show no signs of fear.

TO BE CONTINUED...

Key points:

Cavalry slaughter of fishies and the king.

Narrow escape of the assassins and the merciless murder of half the defenceless Gary's.

More cannon badassery, decimating the church ranged core.

The last of the Abberghast running away, but being rallied by their ghost King, charging back into battle and doing absolutely nothing.

The dwarves bravely hold the battleground under assault from the brutal papal guard and other churchy cunts.

The Hope's Rest guard, a group of Gary's, and the Assassin's barely survive the left flank onslaught against cavalry and swordsmen.

The robots turn their attention to help out the left flank once the main threat has been eliminated, saving all their lives and ensuring no representatives were entirely wiped out.

The remaining church forces flea and the alliance takes stock of the loss of life that has occurred.

EPISODE 80: THE END IS NIGHT

Freshly unbound within the Seven Spire, Martin wonders who the hell this woman setting them free and talking to Myron like an old friend. I sneak a quick listen just in time to learn about the first few floors of the tower:

Floor One: Stores, servants quarters and guard training

Floor Two: More guards rooms

Floor Three: Officers quarters

Floor Four and upwards totally unknown

Well that's not great news but I guess it's more church scum for the grinder when the inevitable happens.

Our little gabrin creator is busy playing with her cube of delights, in many ways I would delight in connecting with such a device, but the price would be memories I have long kept hidden.

I introduce myself to this strange lady, as Myron interrogates her as to troop numbers and locations, I lose interest anyone who tries to stop us now is going to feel the full measure of the rage that dwells in our souls.

It's time to get this circus on the road again, Myron leads the way straight into the break room for the guards who are as surprised as we are to see them. Myron is not terribly convincing about our reasons for appearing and not being in the chains like the last time they saw us. I nip behind the door to disguise myself as Lillith and start a ruse about us grabbing some food and that they should leave my prisoners the fuck alone! It still amazes me that people fall for this kind of shit. Spurred on by our lack of success so far Myron opens another door right next to the previous one, it really is a wonder this man is still alive. Lo and behold its the kitchen.. This time he meets like minded souls, or what one could described as intellectually challenged cooks, who are easily convinced that we should be given some vol au vents.

Having successfully negotiated the kitchens we take the only remaining door up the stairs to a maze of small private rooms, arenas, archery ranges and other related martial training areas. Myron comes at us with the good idea of finding some book nerds he is convinced reside around here. Meanwhile Riphard tugs off a statues penis.

We open a door that oddly says "something" above it in old dwarvish. Its disguise time and as

a low energy alternative to the magical shifting I am used to we just dress up in an old grey cossack kinda robe popular in foothills below the Varg mountain ranges. Riphard wears his golden robe over the cossack one as "king of the peasants" he now ranks up there with almost all kings. Cryptically he also describes how he and Exmerah have already done the death thing. I feel a pang of jealousy, but push it away. That was who I was, I have changed many times, and this latest incarnation is far better suited than its predecessor. Burnie gets a bit serious about how we should approach the coming levels with more guile and subterfuge. He is probably right, but Myron whose ken is often beyond that of the mortal man, lets us know it is still the hi-jinx levels, and that the serious ones will come later. Before we leave, someone notices that Stanri is not going to make a good book nerd, time to flex again. I disconnect and reconnect as many areas of stanris mechanical systems as I dare, doing what must look like a drastic overhaul of his systems before I enfuse some divine eminence into him, allowing for the refraction of light around his physical form. The game is good, but Exmeh is very concerned over her mecha suit, and starts using the detectomatic to check of magic elements. She casts it quickly over my own body and it kicks up a few notches. . . .

I try and distract from the issue and once again engage Myron in the lets go and kill everyone speech. The more I its inevitable the more I begin to believe it, this group is so careless I fear that any and all encounters will always end in bloodshed. For now we agree to stop arguing, collaborate and listen, at least until we recover Kyross.

The next level is swarming with guards, a large corridor looms before us, the walls trim and formal are lined with notices and posters. As we wander down posing as just another group of book nerds we make good progress. That is until a group stops us next to a familiar group of posters. A few double and triple takes occur between us the guards and the posters before I try and pretend that we aren't the adventurers they are looking for. Even with a sprinkle of the divine gnu image manipulation program on the posters they are having none of it.

Riphard takes the only recourse of action and blows a number of them to kingdom come, Burnie electrocutes almost all of the rest of them who do a fish like flop on the floor as electricity pulses through them. He hacks a few of the remainers to pieces who now no doubt had wished they had voted to leave instead. Exmerah breaks out of the divine cloak of darkness and

unless another huge cacophonous roar of energy on the guards. The noise is as terrible as the destruction, leaving only a handful for Myron to put out of their misery. The bloodshed has begun in earnest.

The next level is as fancy as the mansion back home, but a lot less populated than the guard quarters on the level below. We take the time to peer out the window and see our giant robot wreaking havoc outside. Not far above it and circling its head is a giant mechanical eagle mounted by female ninjas. These are not foes I would wish upon anyone.

For reasons that I would later find hard to explain, I take off my head and place it in Stanris mouth. With our powers combined, I push the divine cloak of obscurity over us again and set out down the corridors. What we find is rich living, book reading, sherry swilling ?paedos?.

Not surprisingly when we recount what we saw back to the group, Burnie starts to have a mental break, the number of books is just too damn high. Despite the break of what I would consider reality we manage to coax Burnie to the floor exit, which is guarded by four piety guards dressed in what looks like very thick steel plate. They are guarding the exit which is also covered by an even thicker looking steel portcullis. What purpose this would serve in the case of a fire in the building is briefly discussed before Burnie gets the final piece of his puzzle. Exmerah and Myron mutter in the background about whether this is still alpha Burnie or we are now closer to omega Burnie, something about it is really worrying. There is little time to consider it further as Burnie starts a mad dash towards the room with the old sherry drinker and a mountain of books. It takes him seconds after bursting through the door to unload some hook lit crossbow bolts into the bookcases either side of the room, which understandably incenses the old sherry drinking toff. The toff promptly rolls backwards off his chair and pulls a gun from his hip holster in the process. He marks Burnie well, landing a piece of lead firmly in his chest before Burnie manages to vault the toff's desk and discharge his filthy electrical energy into the toff's bowels. The hook rips the old gentleman open, and charred entrails start covering the floor. Burnie's big day out is not over though, as he is bellowing "That's what you get for reading books!" a few more guards come bursting in to see what the commotion is. Burnie dashes past them, and then seals the doorway behind him with the stone dagger. Good job that has multiple uses in a day really. . . .

Elsewhere with the rest of the party, Myron starts into the fire warden role to convince the purity guardsmen that it's evacuation time. Sadly Myron is less convincing than we all wished he was, and the guards are taking none of his BS this time. Combat of the mortal variety begins.

I rush past the guards and blend into the weave to bypass the portcullis behind them, associating myself with reality on the other side. Sadly there is no lever here, so I dust them in fey wild magic markers. 18s later and Myron and Exmerah are standing over the dead bodies of the guards, I do wonder if we should give these people more of a chance to flee before we murder them, but then I recall the church's persecution. . . .

Good thing I do as we meet another three guards past the portcullis, turns out the lever was on our side all along. As an invisible bear blocks their escape path Myron rushes in and starts the dismembering process, it takes a few seconds more than we are used to, and Riphard has to lay in some serious heat, but they all die in the end.

Stanri starts moaning and whining, and Exmerah says he smells food, we have vol au vents so end up ignoring and exploring a whole host of very fine and posh rooms. We figure they must be set up for dignitaries, but they seem to be unused of recent. We wander pretty aimlessly for a few more minutes before Exmerah finds a secret door next to a balcony we all assume will be important at some point, but never is.

At the top of the stairs is a large grand hallway, there is no decoration as it is cold stone and stark as Burnie's knackers. Standing either side of two heavily armoured doors are four piety guards, an inquisitor, and a marshal. No use hiding anymore we stumble in like fools, and are received as creepily as the others have come to expect from an inquisitor. The inquisitor turns out to be only slightly softer than I had heard, the fight quickly descends into a bloodbath. Myron even gets dirty fingered to death by the inquisitor at one point. Thankfully it's not real death, as he is really starting to grow on me. We take an absolute beating off them all, before we are able to give them the long kiss goodnight and start looting their bodies. Seems like the thing to do really. . . we find a massive set of keys, and go exploring the two doors. The first leads to a guard's restroom, plenty of those in here but at least this one has a set of stairs to the next level. Myron has a flash of brilliance and realises the key set is probably a jailer's keys set. So the other door must be the prison. He is not wrong,

but dam is it depressing when we get through the door.

The corridors reek of death and decay, the walls are damp and the air is musky, foul and fetid. We must have killed the cards as we find no one inside. The corridor leads off in a curved arc doors on either side for as far as the eyes can see. We split the key bunch and start crashing through doors. Most cells are empty, the few that aren't either have rotting remains or full on desiccated bodies. Near the end of the first corridor we find almost dead human who can barely speak and a very psychologically scarred dwarf. Interrogation is impossible with the state they are in so we do what we can with them, and carry them on with us. As we push through more corridors we find a few more people hanging on, signs of torture and abuse are rife on all of them. The church's good image clearly does not extend to this level of the spire.

As we are tending to the wounded, and working up a plan of how to get them to safety without compromising our own objectives, Myron gets ahead of us all. He finds another large steel door slightly ajar, opening it slowly and carefully we finds the body of a naked lady strung up on a rack. The room is full of metal instruments glinting in the light as they hang from chains, or slowly rotate on spindles not long spun. He takes his time, treading carefully as he approaches, then on recognising Kyros pulls out a fist full of cured beef jerky and stuffs it into her mouth. She is alive, barely and the beef jerky almost chokes the last of her life force from her body. Somehow the pure essence of Myrons will is infused into the jerky and seeps some strength back into Kyros.

As she splutters back to the realm of the living, she starts demanding if we have seen Arbiter Kahn, I say we as by now the have dragged what is left of the living with us to the same room. Seeing a member of the Church stood in front of me, I try the only thing that is left for me. I try to kill her, and avenge all those I have just released from succour and imprisonment. Myron pins me to the grounds screaming all shades of obscenities before I relent. Things are clearly not as they seem here. Exmerah and I go for a walk, during which time she explains how barring her all the members of our party worked for the church at some point! Flabbergasted I can barely believe I had been taken in by such charlatans. Exmerah goes on to explain a lot of things, that I really feel could have, no, should have been out in the open from the get go! Before I can get to riled up we come across the prison stores. We take the lot and return whats owed to all the

captives, this time including Kyros.

With no real plan of what to do with our new found ?friends? Exmerah puts up an interplanar pocket dimension with a very nice door within one of the prison rooms. We setup the prisoners in the 16th Cell on the left. Once safely installed we start making our way out, it feels high time we got to the pinnacle of this tower and finished our business once and for all. Unfortunately when we get close to the prison door, we hear a key in the lock. Arbiter Khan has returned, and has brought two of his pets with him. The Inquisitor Ravagers are massive hulking beings with rough hewn metal spikes inserted within their arms where hands should be. It can't be a pleasant existence for them, which would explain their anger somewhat.

I barely last 6 seconds before Khan has danced fluidly through all of us and for a brief moment I am smelling the sweet scent of deaths release. Not this time, not on this day of all days. Kyros unloads a full set of chambered rounds into his as he advances towards her, only for his head to be vaporised by the sudden impact of a metal slug from Exmerahs linear accelerator gun. Myron and Burnie go to town on the ravagers, but without their leader they soon suffer a similar fate. As the ravagers are being spread liberally up and down the walls and corridor, Stanri moves in for some of the actions, and in the processes steps on Khans head, exploding like a melon under his mechanical foot. Riphard opens the gates on his holy weapon and lets rip a stream of pure energy, igniting one of the Ravages. Burnie finally frees his hook that was stuck in the ground, and uses the momentum to uppercut straight into a ravages chin, as life bleeds out of the ravages, I can't help but feel a pang of guilt.s

Its short lived, as Myron starts a speech about how Pope Ezekiel the IIIrd is going to have to pay for this, I couldn't agree more. Instead of riling Myron up further we take the time to disguise Stanri and I as inquisitors using the masks we have ripped off the inquisitors.

TBC as I type more of this mammoth adventure up

NOTE WE NEED TO GRAB THE FINAL ENDING NOTES WHERE THEY BECOME DEMIGODS!!!1

EPISODE 81: ONE MORE TIME WITH PASSION



E are gods to be, but the world is not ready for us to leave yet.

Kamilar still looms large, and his mate in the sky also could come to play.

Four whole years have past, and magic has returned, which has gone as well as you might imagine....

The gods are starting to answer prayers, which everyone thinks although its a step in the right direction is really not enough considering there absence is responsible for so much toss that has taken place.

The church are still considered total bandits, as such the Hopes Rest is once again seen as a bastion of whats right. However the guild masters have shown about as much aptitude as leadership as we ever were. As such Lazarus is filling the vacuum.

Our fractured group has gone their own ways over the four years.

Myron committed to his duty, stood in the parade around the ruins of the spire a thousand or maybe a hundred of plate mail clad arbiters wielding shotguns with swords on teh end doing combat drills. Leading the drill at the top is our Arbiter. Its really proper armour, wielding god bringer, the people below are training to be pale imitations of this man mountain. Although they don;t seem to be hitting impressing him much.

At the top of Trump Towers, covered in gaudy gold suits, business is underway, looking down on the silver, and bronze towers. Black rock, run by a slumped and bored Riphard, he sits in teh board room.... he is sick of this, and the competitors are starting to chip away at the market gains he had previously fought so well for. Raising 6 year old kids has not been easy, especially within 4 years, and when they are almost the same height.

Outside an unknown town, The Delilah Hardstone School For Exceptionally Gifted Girls to Excel in Engineering and Emancipation (TDHSFEGGTEIEAE) is open and school is in. Robots are flying right alongside spells. Behind a large wooden door is a dark dingey room, covered in string. Kalimar and Kolo are scrawled on the walls, and sat around bottles of expended booze sits a withered and broken Gabrin. Exmerah.

Martin broke out the research books on his young mistress, the tower had fallen, where was his charge. The news was bad, powerful lineaged children were either killed on teh rocks or turned them into inquisitors. He spends the four years hunting down remaining inquisitors, he uncovers more and more of Canilons twisted ways, he burns himself to the core. After hitting

rock bottom, he returns ot Exmeh as a professor to train.

With the old church destroyed the secret library of the book burners no longer needs to be secret. So the Fishy library was born, with a printing press books are being studied and brought back into the mainstream. It took a lot not to burn it down, but Burnie spent more and more time connecting people with Sin and getting to know his crazed son. After some kind of mental break he returns to captain stick and sails the good skyship.

Lazarus is set in his red scales and golden armour, he is cradling Erin in his arms as he flies up to the good air ship Gary. Erin is a little unsteady given the huge amount of bloodloss and death of everyone she know and love. " Sadly only one of the team are here currently"

Rab Burnie cinders crawls out on the deck, a mid 60s dishevelled pirate, wearing a dressing gown with scrotum out and swining. "Who the Fook is that???" "

Erin meet Rab Burnie Cinders, Erin Devereux.. Srg Erin Devereux... Las requests a chat, Burnie insists everyone is there and ready. AS they descind they see a dim dingey, smelly dank room, with around seven people sat around the table, jars of piss lined up all over the place. Burnie introduces the piles of rocks as the team past and present. His eye briefly seems to talk, but its clear that Burnie has lost his mind, perhaps entirely. It's really all wrong, so Lazarus put Erin in a bed and offers more discussions in the morn.

" Seriously Burnie, you need to get your shit together" and strongly suggests that Burnie gets and sleep. Burnie crawls behind the bar and into a nest of his own detritus.

Erin wakes up in a lovely comfy leather chair in front of a gorgeous round mahogany table. An Elephant lady offers her tea, and Erin admist to herself she has lost her mind as well. Across from her suddenly is Lazarus wearing a light purple suit looking very un reassuring, especially when he smiles showing two rows of shiny sharp teeth. "Welcome to my office, on the outskirts of hell"

Erin holds onto the idea that she is insane, despite reassurance from Laz. He plans to get the others, for a real nice sit down. The team come through, Myron and Burnie arguing, Exmerah immediately goes for Lazarus demanding that he share details on how to recover Kolo. For a short Gabrin is impressive she somehow manages to eyeball him. One by

one we take seats at the round table. With Riphard at the head.

Lazarus has respected everyones wishes and kept out of their minds. However there is a new lead/threat..

"Yea the fucking mega bank" says Riphard.

"No not quite...." Laz " you may have noticed this new member" but no one had.

Laz is loving his new fresh coat of hell, running the entire empire, using mountains of paperwork. The Empire of the Eight.

After essentially the standard amount of BS, Exmerah scrambles across the table, grabs Laz by the lapels and demands he get to the point. He immediatly refers to the fact that Erin has just returned from the Varg.

They are forming a pact with Kalimar, they drink a special bowl of soup and either die, most of them die, but the survivors gain incredible powers. Something that would devastate any standing army. Myron suggests we add it to the list of things that may or may not need to be delt with. LAz thinks it a great idea to use to find a route to Kalimar. Kalimar is unleashing larger terrors onto the world, which means there must be a larger entrance into his kingdom.

"You smell of gunpowder and pornography" did you meet Krankle... I did he hates you, but is proud of you. The feeling was mutual. He was supposed to be keeping everyone informed, but as he has lost his standing due to his services no longer being required. Erin hands across a vial of the juice used to convert the champions into monsters.

WE must stop teh Varg from invading, in the next month, Myron isn;t convinced his army is ready, Burnie thinks we are too powerful, but Erin is up for it.

Laz has a "training mission" for us, a Wizard has arisen from his hidden chambers, he is an ancient wizard that control the dead.

After much discussion, its agreed that the airship will go and pick us all up...

Dave lives with Myron or Exmerah, actually neither, uh oh he has been abandoned.....

The airship heaves too at the school, a tour takes place its absolutely lovely, we approach a classroom History 101, within is Stanri, he is left in charge, somehow he is now a real bear? or is he? either way he is in charge of History and the school. He pulls open his head, it slides apart and she drops something into into it. " I would prefer you not to do that.

As Exmerah boards the airship, she is met by a lanky 16 to 17 year old boy (David) " We have the next shipment of uniforms ". He has been at home, he is a tailor and makes the school uniforms for the school. Exmerah is fawning over the poor lad. He is adopted by Myron and Exmerah. David will make Burnies priests uniforms, and the flag of Gazzakhstans.

Exmerah opens her chest and a swarm of spider robots who go around tuning the ship back up. She berates the hell out of Burnie for not looking after the ship. Exmerah then gets really excited around the Buries eye that has been leaking nuclear radation into Burnie.

Rip and Myron are up on the deck..Rip complains again about the megabank... Myron gets quite upset that the world is about to end and no one seems to be bothered. He is really quite upset.

We head out East of Erduns well, to a mine, which we don;t own, also we don't know the name of it. However it looks abandoned and the airship, won;t fit down the hole. Martin hands out rope to everyone, Myron already harnessed takes the first one. The divorce couple argue over whether Dave should go in with us, get raised as a zombie and then have to be killed by us. Everyone jumps with rope, except for Burnie who went without a rope. Erin shrugs, says "Saviours" and jumps after them.

Seeing the immediate Peril that Burnie is in, she activates the jet pack, and managest to grab his ankles slowing his fall slightly, he then pushes his hook into the wall righting himself slightly. It is the opposite of grace. The smell down here is putrid, it hangs of wet rot and decay. No one is surprised that there are unpleasant things waiting for us.

Its all a bit undead, something Giant, somethings Giant bird like being ridden by more undead, and some human undead creatures. Its game on...

Erin catches a charging undead bird with her glaive, stunning it in place. Myron runs off the cliff and impales the giant with his shotgun stabber, blasting into it. Despite falling quite far off the giant, Myron takes very little damage. The giant seems slightly displeased about this, and unseaths a giant scimitar, three strikes later and Myron has not a scratch on him. Riphard gets to blowing chunks out of everything with his Hammer of his Gods, bellowing away something encouraging. Burnie mutters to himself, and everyone gets the mark of sin. ERin flourishes her glaive, giving all around her a crusaders mantle, its pretty great. Myron gets dive bombed

by a terrible bird, and it actually hurts. Exmeh unleashes cedric, **Mrs Ball** arrives and heads off towards the enemies.

The fight continues, and it becomes clear just how incredibly powerful the team are.

Like the rust has never accumulated we viciously murder a bunch of undead creatures. The dastardly evil lizard wizard has got some murder coming.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uvel_iU8StQ

EPISODE 82

ission report: Sgt E. Devereux
the battle at the pit entrance my new colleagues Myron and Martin discuss the appearance and nature of an object they refer to as "Mrs Ball" They seem to be unsure about the equipment they use as a squad, however the spherical helper did not cause them any alarm so I decided not to question it further. As we proceeded further into the dig Riphard natural affinity for worked stone showed him the path most recently used out of the options available and this area had at one time been a granite mine. The party proceed forwards, bickering all the while.

The tunnel led to a narrow ledge skirting a steep drop into the pit below. There was another ledge above us that tracked along our path. Myron halted and signalled for quiet whilst he took in the way ahead. He looked back and drew our attention to a large pile of skeletal remains in the shape of a ball further down the path, also on the ledge above was an undulating mound of flesh.

As we planeed our next move if felt something touch the back of my armour. I looked down to see Exme placing something there "Protection. Many shields, maybe one hundred thousand." I reached out and patted her on the shoulder. "I'm not a child Erin" "I mean't it only in thanks, apologies"

I've only been with them a short time and still need to get to know them. If we are to work together I don't want trouble. I took a few steps forward and stretched out with divine senses, picking up nothing further. During this time Myron began to climb to the upper ledge. The fleshy mass began to move and Riphard let fly with a thunderous shot. I charged forwards, the divinely blessed senses revealing hidden creatures along the pathway. Myron finished his ascent only to be ambushed by a shadow, its cut

draining some of Myron's strength. The rest of the party threw themselves into battle. In a flurry of polymorphed pony, wicked strikes, magical flair, a ball with deadly purpose and flying bullets the assailants are readily dispatched.

Myron's balletic barrage slammed into the shadow, knocking it back. Then another bullet passed cleanly through its head and it dissipated. Exme levitating nearby having fired the shot.

"I don't need help Exme!"

"You're welcome!"

To my alarm Exme then shot Myron, explaining that she was healing him. It's going to take a while to get used to this. They all then discussed the possibility that Myron is cursed. This arguement continued to escalate as we went further in. Clearly stealth isnt a tactic this team readily employs.

Finally the mine gave way to ancient stonework. Still arguing, loudly, we approached the only visible door. Inside we found a hunched up wrinkled old man. He said his name was Jeremiah. That he's very busy, lost, can't remember anything and is 24 years old. He made several references to a master that he is apprentice to. He's forgotten everything since coming out of the stasis tube. Martin gently pointed out that whatever this stasis tube is, something has gone wrong as Jeremiah is now an old man. He crumples up in shock and Martin comforts him whilst the rest of us look over the room. Exme notices lettering on the wall that are definitley red paint, yes. Not blood. Riphard, Burnie, Myron and Exme look over the script while I kept back to watch. They worked together quickly and impressively rapidly decoding the letters. Riphard stood back uttering the phrase "I will have the last laugh" there was a slight click and then a jolt as the floor gave way and we all tumbled into void below.....

Addendum: I have completed writing my letters to the families of the recon team deployed to the Varg. As their acting CO it is my duty and sad honour to inform them of their bravery and sacrifice. Those events still weigh heavily upon me, but for now there are more pressing things to deal with. I will send them for delivery at my next opportunity. I have also sent a note to the Company Captain informing them of my return to the empire and my current status.

EPISODE 83: CAPE OF GOOD POPE



He party fall down.

Their fall is hard and fast, as if it were a metaphor for their chances of saving the world.

They fall through a dark pit, a stygian ocean swimming with cackling laughter in a manner similar to the way mackerel or other similar fish swim in the water ocean. You know, the main one.

They eventually stop falling and crash into the ground, where the old man crumples into a broken heap and dies instantly. Everyone else is fine.

They find themselves in a high-ceilinged, ornately carved room, very different in vibe to the scratty old mine above.

The cackling voice starts talking instead of cackling and welcomes everyone to its games room. Everyone stands about bitching for a bit, until the voice announces the first game, which is just “answer this question”.

The voice says the question is “family friends or honour” and asks them all to pick which they prefer, but then has to awkwardly admit that it meant “family, comma friends or honour” and then actually “love, family or honour”.

Everyone answers, and then they have to fight some shit.

With a puff of dark light, the party are surrounded by strange creatures, unknown to this world. There’s some pale ladies with sharp-looking teeth, some see-through people and a stinky rotten dude covered in dirty rags. Everyone gets confused, because they instinctively assume that last one’s Burnie, but he’s got an enigmatic swagger to him they aren’t expecting.

One of the pale ladies runs in to give Burnie a hickey, but he and Myron manage to keep her away from the soft bits. The grotty dude shambles towards Exme, who shoots her big gun thing at him, but then freezes in existential terror.

Rip fires out at one of the ladies and summons forth motes of holy fire that reath the party in good fire, bolstering them against all this bloody damage.

A see-through person tries to kill Martin, but is repelled by BAD.

Burnie throws the weird lady at Paralysed Exme. It’s apparently supposed to be a good

thing. Then he runs over and throws Paralysed Exme across the room, where she is immediately set upon by one of the see-through people. Again, he expects to be thanked for this.

Martin thanks him by turning him into a sperm whale.

Everyone agrees this is fair.

Dev says a prayer and everyone is suddenly surrounded by spectral glimpses of the gods, wielding spectral weapons against the unholy hoard.

Some fighting happens.

The sperm whale dodges in place and then tries to eat a ghost. It fails to do so, then flails around, bashing into shit.

Some more fighting happens.

Martin fires lighting out of his hands and then moves slightly to his right in a puff of smoke.

Dev decapitates two of the pale ladies with one swing. She gets dizzy and makes a fool of herself. Exme blasts the last of the skinny ladies with the big gun, before the lady slams hard into Mrs. Ball, but just manages to not die.

The whale thrashes.

Martin runs back to exactly where he was before he magically transported himself, blasts a lady into dust and then goes to try and ride the whale.

Dev uses her polearm to slide over the whale like the bonnet of a car, then lands on the other side, just as the images of the gods rip the gross guy apart.

Exme, hovering in the air dispatches one of the see-through people, before the last remaining guy rushes towards Mrs. Ball, narrowly avoiding colliding with her. Myron lays in wait, and thrusts his bayonet through the chest of the see-through guy, doing no damage and fires off two shots while clipped through the guy. Rip does a rhythmic gymnastic routine while the see-through guy claps excitedly before being dusted by Martin.

They try to levitate the whale out the room, but it is too big, so they force Burnie to do some Spiderman and Elsa shit to make themselves feel better.

They walk down the stairs out of the room which lead them down into a small, very odd chamber with an aquarium full of goo standing in the middle, with some undead giants standing around waiting to be killed, and then steps down

into a cube space with a gross little guy hanging out attempting to monologue.

We don't let him, and start the killing right away.

Or at least, Rip tries to, but his gun is full of ambergris. This weird guy fires a thing at Rip.

Martin tries to, but Myron makes him second guess casting whirlwind and he just doesn't do anything. Nothing to do with an anti-magic field.

Exme tries to, but spends too long fiddling round for stuff in her pocket.

Mrs. Ball succeeds in fighting.

One of the skeleton giants is fed up of waiting, and walks over to the party. He introduces himself as the Pope of Skeleton Giants, and everyone is very impressed, apart from Dev, who pokes him, and gets a taste of the Papal Scimitar, which tastes like a communion wafer.

And that's Canon.

Then she pokes the pontiff with the point of her pike again, in an act of blatant heresy.

One of the two skeleton cardinals attacks Mrs. Ball, recognising her as an affront to a world created by a loving god.

Myron runs up to engage the Cardinal in theological debate, surrounded by protective white flames, while the other one fails to hit Mrs. Ball, ontologically.

Valkondar monologues a bit and there's a smelly cloud.

Rip stumbles around trying to get out of the smelly cloud, and nearly walks straight into the Papal Scimitar. Dev's polearm thrusts out of the smelly cloud to defend him, and seizing the moment, Rip uses his whip to decapitate the Pope of Skeleton Giants. In doing so, he has feels a transfer of religious authority, as he becomes the new Pope of Skeleton Giants.

The cube wizard (not the other cube wizard, but the one who's in this room) cackles maniacally as spectral hands rise out of the ground, clawing at Myron, who's not really bothered.

One of the Skeleton Cardinals has an accident with Mrs. Ball.

Erin stabs a Skeleton Cardinal, aware of the danger that one of these two might see this as an opportunity to manipulate voting in the Conclave, if they don't recognise the rules that make Riphard the one true Pope of Skeleton Giants. The church is officially divided on the

matter of whether the Pope works on the same rules as Santa does in the Tim Allen film "The Santa Clause".

The film is typically considered to be deuterocanonical.

Myron kills one of the skeletons.

The Cube guy fireballs everyone. Martin tells him not to, but he does anyway.

The sects which recognise Tim Allen films are typically known as Redbelts, after the 2008 martial arts film set in a prison.

Erin falls to the floor, a charred mess.

Mike Russell of the Portland Oregonian named Redbelt the 9th best film of 2008.

End Credits:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Zh-ZUrc-aLI>

EPISODE 84: HIT AND RUN

THe magic lay thick across the battlefield like the cheap makeup on a Nanduese whore. Soon-to-be-new-gal-pal Erin lay dying beneath a giant glowing skeleton, the last source of power for Val's force field. Riphard started glowing like the cheeks of a Varg whore and spread out his healing flatulence all around him and into her body. Erin's eyes opened and found themselves set in a grimacing face. Val was not happy about the healing wind. Martin advanced and sent a little spark into the giant, followed by a full crash of lightning. I flew over to soon-to-be-new-gal-pal Erin grabbing the puzzle die of sensei Rhu'Brek, it's dusty sections rotating into place to pour it's healing magic into her. I was furious at Mr Skeleton so I pumped one of Cedric's loads into his face and he exploded in a crash of bones.

Val was angry and started being a madam and sending out rubbish magic spells at Martin. Burnie got out his cute little wooden gun toy and tried to get him and he did on the second one. Stupid Myron started running at Val in a stupid way and all his stupid drippy coating all went into his stupid gun and it all went bright. Val traveled to Mrs Ball but then he traveled away again. Lord Valkondar the Merciful looked at me and asked me if I wanted to kill all of my friends and even though I thought I would not, actually I really did want to murder them all. I was very grateful for this realization.

The filthy dwarf shouted at me but I could not hear his lying words. Lord Valkondar the

Merciful demanded the blonde harlot not sully him with her presence. The mechanical aberration approached me and demanded I flee. I ignited my boots and shot the drunken sinner, blasting him into Mrs Ball. Lord Valkondar the Merciful reached out a bony finger to the dirty man and asked him to laugh. Nothing happened. Lord Valkondar the Merciful continued to attack the zealot, blood pouring from his broken warted skin, and bloodied shit gushed from his hardened anus. The golden bitch dared approach Lord Valkondar the Merciful and brought shame to herself by attacking this glorious god amongst men.

The false prophet attempted to trick Mrs Ball to escape her. He succeeded for the time being and disgraced himself in a foolish attempt to bring harm to my beloved Master. What a joke of a man this haggard human genital wart is. The child abandoner shared the pain of my Lord, and with no sign of gratitude for this great honour raised his weapon. He ran towards him impotently and fell in terror, sparks of steel of stone floor. Lord Valkondar the Merciful raised his elegant fingers of death and aimed them at the slut of Jecede, lowering her to the very edge of consciousness. The low man brought forwards his glowing weapon and shot my master, ruining his cloak and rending a hole through his powerful torso. What a joke, he cannot be killed by mortal means. He snapped his fingers and the woman fell. The rusted biped called out and the man who never did the dishes when it was agreed on the schedule that it was his turn was transformed into a giant crab.

I continued to fly away, frustrated at my curious inability to return and kill my friends. Mr' Ball attacked the philandering sea dog as Lord Valkondar the Merciful attempted to take him out. Lord Valkondar the Merciful tried to give the syphilitic sailor the honour of joining his family, but the gift was refused and repaid with a pitiful attack and a stable hand on the woman. The ugly crab reached out and grabbed Mrs Ball, and thrust Lord Valkondar the Merciful into her at great speed, enough to dislodge her bow. My master lay crushed into the wall, lifeless as he was in death, slowly crumbling to dust. Martin picked up a lonely pink bow from the floor and put it in his pocket.

Hmmm. I don't know why I always get mind controlled. It makes me very cross and ruins the rest of the day. At some point I got over the urge to run away and started the long three hour flight back to the airship. Catching up with the others, we compared notes on what they had found in the dungeon. It seems like Val had been

attempting to master the science of stasis but had not succeeded. Myron told us that he had quite enjoyed being a crab actually and was not cursed at all despite having to spend a lot of the day in the toilet (although Burnie for some reason tried to proudly claim that the smell was from him). Burnie asked why I didn't use the crazy tattoo. Myron had ripped his off, a bloody wound of torn flesh on the back of his hand. We all went to sleep after a long day and woke up in hell.

Meredith handed out everyone's favourite drinks to refresh us, Myron a piece of shit, Burnie a rum and rum. We entered Mr Lazarus' office and he bade us sit down at his round table. "I take it that went well then?", he asked. "We killed that guy because we're good at what we do", gloated Myron. We considered the nature of what it means to be undead. It seems to mean being a corpse with a soul in, which is kind of like what being alive is. I had a headache. Mr Lazarus got to business. The Varg is developing the capability to create an army of super soldiers. For every 100 people who go through the process 99 die. Burnie correctly wonders if a super soldier is actually worth 100 regular soldiers, because this thing could just sort itself out. A rare flash of wisdom from this broken man. Mr Lazarus didn't want to explain the inconsistencies in his plan, typical middle manager. I know the Varg though, they do not care for life at all. I still have nightmares about the meat grinders and mentality that destroyed so many of my Gabrin friends. I asked about how the soldiers were being made and soon-to-be-new-gal-pal Erin reminded me that she had given me that vial of liquid. Omg why are we even here when there is science to be done.

What is required? A plan to break the treaty between the Varg and Kalimar. Convince the Varg to not attack Ghazikstan. Kill Kalimar. Rescue Kolo. The super soldiers are linked to Kalimar in the same way as poor Kolo was. The Varg leader has not taken the serum himself, presumably to prevent this link. Erin thought there might be hundreds of soldiers that had taken The Pact, accompanied by their dragons and bum hand babies. We used our brains to make a plan. Myron thought we could get in between the chain of communication, perhaps by Hecking them. The University has a big Hecking movement in the Magical Technology department. Martin suggested we go directly to the Val Kar Varg and try our hand at diplomacy through direct challenge to his title. Perhaps a giant crab Burnie could take him on in one-to-one combat?

Erin described the things she had seen, flying soldiers, fire soldiers, all kinds of crazy shit. Lazarus pointed out that a challenge could only come from an insider, and there are few of us with legitimate claims to nationality in the group. To be honest, becoming leader of the Varg was not where I thought I would be in my career at this point. We might have to create enough of a noise to make ourselves legitimate contenders to the throne. The Varg is made up of several Warbands so finding one and taking over its leadership would be the quickest way to make a legitimate claim. Erin could lead us back.

We may have to talk to Krankle. . .

Martin has known Krankle for a long long time. A strong hate-hate relationship. I can't believe this hasn't come up before, we send the man so much pornography and acid as part of his residency at the University. As I have always said, keep your friends close and your enemies plied with acid and pornography in exchange for political information.

I asked Mr Lazarus if David could have some powers and Burnie asked about his son too. Mr Lazarus was quite rude about it and basically said no. We woke up asleep.

The next day the plan was made around the battle table. Burnie instructed Admiral Stick to change course, the airship gently swerving towards the Varg, flying towards the dawn. Erin sat in her room and wrote letters to the families of her fallen comrades. Martin laid a lonely pink bow on the floor outside Exme's lab door as the Gabrin inside worked on a series of contraptions while the detectomatic 2000 started an analysis on the hard-won serum.

The Plan

Main Objective: Rescue Kolo

Sub-objective: Dispel threat of Kalimar super soldiers gaining dominance in the Varg and taking over the world, causing a lot of bother before the world gets destroyed by the naughty gods

1. Get airship close to Varg and hide it. Proceed by foot lead by Erin (Lazarus on standby to support Admiral Stick)
2. Contact Krankle and ask him to meet us away from the Varg Hold. Find out information about politically delicate Warbands suitable for dominance
3. Take over Warband
4. Become super badass Warband that can make legitimate claim to the throne

5. Challenge Val Kar Varg to the throne
6. Win throne
7. Emancipate Varg
8. Find entrance to Kalimar's house
9. Kill Kalimar
10. Rescue Kolo
11. Brother and Sister reunion dinner
12. Be happy again

Epilogue

The universe shattered in a single moment, time and space rendered impotent in the face of the enormity of the event. All that ever was and all that ever would be lay frozen around a single black sphere, shrouded in an oversized crab claw. Mrs Ball took a moment to consider the situation and decided that it was less than optimal. The ALLMOTHER would not be pleased this time. The paperwork alone would take at least five eternities to complete and triplicate. She had promised Cecilia that this was all behind them. Oh well, what was one more indiscretion in a lifetime of meta-infidelity. The dark light was filling within her and she knew there was not much time left. Mrs Ball absorbed the broken reality and inverted it before excreting it back into place. From their frame of reference, the inhabitants would never realise what had been done. Mrs Ball removed herself as the Universe restarted, leaving nothing but a soiled pink bow to fall lazily to the floor.

Self-note #5438-ACS-23X - Martin is a robot. Driven by a small mouse that is dead. A dead mouse cannot be harmed by fire therefore Martin cannot be harmed by fire. This is logic.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RP0_8J7uxhs

EPISODE 85: GIRL'S NIGHT IN



Artin - create our own group?

should join an established tribe.

North/Varglands is the more tribal races.

There's a prototype transportation link (Hyperloop) being built between Lindedorf and Hopes rest.

There was a "tube" transport system. . . underwater. . . that leaked. . .

Martin adds the ghost of a mouse into the ghost-engine. He motivates them through depression.

Laz - stayed in the world after portalling over with the gods. Functionally astrally projects from his apartment in the seven spire

David's still on board. We need thick cloth, furs, decorative skulls etc.

Handbrake turn of the airship, we go to pick up some bits and drop myron off to find the rest.

We all decide on what our varg outfits look like (see later)

Exme - goes to kolo's old room, burns away all the fungus, and takes the crocodile skin.

- Finds a moldy notebook - written in it until the day he left.
- Uses the chat-hat to read the notebook. . . . Future will come. Flibook - Barely intelligent and lots of pictures of his time in the varg (being abused, poisoned, blown up by crankle). Number of stick-people goblins goes down, until just a little green and black. Poorly drawn. Shows the sticky-orcs and their cancer. Quality improves, renaissance water-colours of kolo and esme and their journey together. Then 10 pages of the spy being tortured and torn apart in exquisite detail. He's chosen medium is blood. Spy blood.

Erin watches the group argue as Burnie drinks the ghost-juice that came from the engines.

She warns him it'll give him hollow bones.

He says he wants to be closer to his bone-birded son, who disgusts him and infuriates him in equal measure.

He drinks more ghost-juice.

David mentions he's a tailor.

Martin despairs, cleans up the ghost-goo burnie keeps vomiting up.

Exme tries for a girls night with Erin, and it's a thing. Martin gets included, because he has no penis.

Melted icecream and steaks is included.

They go into Erin's room.

Martin covers himself in foil to be fancy.

Exme does the same.

Admiral stick comes down the stairs, hopeful for the girls night.

Laz picks up stick and joins with Burnie for a boys night on the deck.

Martin and Exme bow in the "Maludan" style, in pyjama's and tinfoil.

Erin doesn't really know what to do, but suggests drinking and talking (and she's cooking the steaks).

Erin can smell a distinct burning smell, heavily overdone steaks!

Burnie teaches Laz to play "can I see your asshole" - a classic bookburner game.

Exme: "so erin, have you had many lovers"

Erin: "wow, not recently"

Exme: "I imagine you didn't have the time, running for your life and losing all your colleagues"

Erin: "yeah, it did cut into that hobby. Not had the time. One or two, they were nice."

Martin: "EXME'S HAD LOTS OF LOVERS, MILLIONS"

Exme takes the tinfoil off.

Martin makes a tinfoil swan out of it.

Erin: "just be yourself Exme"

Martin shakes his head at Exme behind Erin's back.

Erin: "I'd rather know the truth"

Exme: "not millions"

They show erin a particle accelerator.

Captain stick won "can I see your asshole" but did an illegal move - burnie will have splinters for days.

David is super depressing and talks about his parents messing with his life while he was at tailor college, myron paying people to be nice to him, his mum saying she'll invent a robot that'll make everyone else redundant.

Burnie tells stories about how many people they've directly and indirectly killed.

David's sad about his parents.

Laz says we should play a game of "drink the drink".

The girls are talking about genocide, especially goblin genocide.

They've all killed many many goblins, and also humans.

Esme asks if anyone's ever read Sexmera Harambey's 69 shades of green. Definitely not a pen name of Exme. Weirdly also a children's book.

They start talking about how they all met.

Martin was looking after a little girl, and now looks after

They've been on all sorts of adventures, temples in the sky were the hardest, lots of jumping.

Martin to Erin: When did you decide not to give up hope? All your friends died, you were out in the middle of nowhere, everyone being killed by giant monsters.

Erin has guilt she should have died there with them.

Reggie had been one of her oldest and dearest friends, and died, she still has his dogtags.

Martin is a pessimistic depressing android.

Exme cries.

The gods appeared and saved Erin, because of Reggie's sacrifice.

Burnie goes to

Exme's nickname for burnie, is "uncle pegleg dickhead" according to David.

Burnie passes out and probably shits himself. David thinks he's pretty cool. Burnie would be insulted if he were conscious.

Lazarus goes to check on the girls

Admiral Captain Stick (he always had his name legally changed to reflect his position but stopped at captain when he realised it was redundant) is left in charge of the ship.

Exme plays "spin the bottle" by spinning the bottle at several billion RPM. The floor was reinforced with titanium alloy to prevent it drilling through. The bottle melts.

Exme fangirls over Erin, thinks she's fancy. And elegant. Erin is always with men that fart, so is confused.

Says she thinks Exme is the most elegant and lovely goblin ever.

Exme cries feeling ugly.

Martin picks her up like a baby, and immediately passes her to Erin who braids and brushes her hair.

Exme falls asleep on the floor, Erin builds a pillow fort around Erin.

Exme: "Martin's such a bastard"

Erin places a bucket besides her.

Martin goes to check on the ghosts.

Burnie wakes up with an orange cone on his head.

"Love doesn't have a height limit, a short love story" - written by Sexmera Harambe.

We make our way to the varglands, get dropped off, and make our way to see our tribe of choice - The one and only - the Chesney Hawks.

Martin - is a loincloth, with maybe one glued skull.

Burnie - Skulls on skulls on skulls... over a santa-clause outfit, looks like metal santa.

Erin Deverouz - Full plate, but with stitched leathers and tabards. - Didn't want a cloak. Fur colour for the cold though.

Exme is wearing the crocodile

Myron: TBC

Riphard: TBC.

David - fucks off on the airship as it drops us off.

Exme dislikes Crankle, but respected him as an "engineer" (in spite of him being an alchemist).

Erin tells that Crankle is no longer useful due to everyone having magic now.

Erin wonders if we should kill Crankle.

Exme says "he tortured me and my brother for years, but killing him seems a bit harsh"

What are the Chesney Hawkes like?

Used to be: Small to moderate sized tribe.

Most tribes are racially homogenous, but the Chesney's are more mixed, so long as someone's useful. If you're of aid, they'll be friendly.

Order of operation

Take control of a tribe

Take control of the varg/disrupt it.

We need to be of the varg/in a tribe, to challenge the varg.

Tears for fears is another tribe.

Bowies is another.

Genesis was taken over by the evil Phil Collins but returned to their roots in later years.

Erin feels a niggling voice in the back of her mind: "You're going to die here, these idiots don't know what they're doing".

We crest a hill and see a tribal group. It's warm enough by the number of people that their fires have melted the snow and it's a more arid land.

There is no structure to the Varg,

might = right,

Do whatever you want to do (so long as you have the might to back it up)

the varg unites them.

We'll need to earn the respect of the tribe until we can take leadership.

Exme talks of a legendary Belinda Carlisle, who took over a tribe.

Burnie gets lost in a meadhall, but he wanders back out and follows them.

Martin starts hunting around for the chesney hawks, but it's going to take us a while to see/find something. We talk to locals, and eventually make our way there.

There's two large tiger men (though one's definitely a snow leopard) fighting it out.

Martin: "Hail, animal/people"

Big snow leopard - Buchra

Tiger - Zelat

Martin: "Hail <insert names>, how are your children?"

They break off their scrapping, go for their weapons (as do others), then they laugh and go for a hug.

Metal man - they love him.

They take martin and co to a new area, it's shittily built (even for a tent) - Magrat took over after martin was around, from Johanna. Frosty reception most likely.

He is stronger than he looks. Beheaded a previous leader in one pull.

There was a Queen Tribe that had a saying, and then we list queen puns for about 10 minutes.

People Martin sees he recognises.

Eric, the half-giant, small on words, big on muscle.

Krumb, the goat-kin, personable until he's not.

Ragnor - bit of a dickhead - bit of a bragger, talks about his fights and women he fucks.

Vesh - changed a lot since he last saw her - has fire magic. Used to be a middling warrior, but now has some status due to magic.

Pulls us up as strangers, wonders why the fuck we're here.

Buchra has fear of Magrat, which is rare.

Exme introduces herself - Magrat grins at her, but it's very mocking and condescending.

No respect.

Burnie falls over.

Exme calls him Cunna Carne - Varg for senile old jester that they keep around for the laughs.

Myron's not there. But then he is.

He's on a creature, body of a boar, 8 raven legs, a sad mans head, 2 mammoth tusks, covered in shaggy blue hair. It screams "tax deductible".

Myron jumps off.

He brought sheep.

He probably won't kneel.

Martin says he's probably going to get a lot shorter.

Exme and Myron have a domestic. We're in potentially in a bad situation.

Myron does a fake kneel - a deep squat, and crosses his fingers.

We're given a light mead. Something herby in it.

It's tasty!

We eat a stodgy vegetable stew.

It's tasty!

Martin and giant-boy chat.

The numbers have been depleted by the Trials (the thing where they transform people).

Either way, if they survive or not they're not back in their own tribes.

They chat a while. Bukra explodes Martin after insinuating he's weak.

Burnie gets twatted down by bits of Martin. . . Then Martin comes back being put back together by the tribe.

Vesh warms up stuff for Erin to show off her powers.

Exme is with Krum - goatboi.

"Were your parents half-goats? Or one of them a goat?" - he punches exme in the face.

Exme says "I'm but a simple goblin girl" and then goat-boi hugs her.

They bond over their lack of white-privilege.

He tells you that the race of the goatkin is "sturdy people" in their own language but it's pronounced. . . Gn'ayayaya

Exme introduces him to Vodka.

Myron is sat off to one side with the centre of the group scowling. Zalat comes over and tries to be nice, Myron asks him if he wants a fight.

They start comparing weapon sizes.

Zalat accuses him of liking "cushions".

They have a punch-up.

EPISODE 86: CAT SCRATCH FEVER

Iast time: went to the Varg. Lots of bonding on the airship. Invaded the Varg and made friends with Chesny Hawks and a veritable array/cornucopia of others, who were generally nice except that one that exploded and killed Martin. And that rude woman, Vesh. Martin had spent time here before. There were less than there used to be and they had been taken over by a giant who demanded we show deference, which we did but reluctantly. We then had drinks and a chat, before Myron challenged a snow leopard tiger man to an unarmed sparring match.

Martin is still dead in pieces and Esme starts attempting to reassemble him. Bernie wants to try and help but is shooed away. Myron warms up for his cat fight.

They agree to fight to first unconscious. There's some passive aggressive banter about other rules. Zalat gets two hits in quick and using fancy monk shit does a 360 spin kick to Myron's head. He taunts Myron who immediately goes to punch him in the balls, followed up by a swift elbow and headbutt, also to the balls. Myron's all about ball play. Zalat coughs, clearly thinking this has become a medical check up.

Zalat connects with a stunning strike which Myron shrugs off then misses with a flurry, clearly shaken by Myron's raw power. Myron goes for the back of the knee leg sweep, but it's weak, but connects with the second. Zalat again misses with his attacks and adopts a defensive stance. Myron just goes for his face with a fist and a shoulder and connects hard with both.

Zalat manages to focus to connect with a strike, but Myron's rock hard constitution means he barely feels it. Myron swings wildly for his kidneys connecting with only one. Zalat twats Myron squarely in the side of the head thrice. Myron elbows his legs and upper cuts his

balls (for old times sake). Zalat gets two more slaps in. Myron's not too bothered and attacks the inside of his bicep with a knuckle, an elbow, and a hammerfist.

Zalat, severely bloodied, still believes in himself and goes for a leg sweep, but misses, but does land one strike. Myron body slams onto the outstretched leg from the sweep, goes for another ball strike, but misses with a final strike. Zalat is wobbling on his feet, blood dripping into his eyes. He swings wildly missing badly, before connecting with two hard strikes. Myron still looks fine though and takes a step back, almost taunting him allowing him to take a swing, but Zalat misses. Myron charges him down and goes for a flying elbow leap, but misses, he twists in the air and connects with a knee instead and grabs his head and slams him into the dirt. RKO!

Zalat, still with Ki points left, hauls himself off the ground and tries to hit Myron in the face. Myron dodges these pathetic attempts and hits him square in the face, finally crumpling him into a heap.

There's a bit of back and forth about foightin'. Myron reckons he could take everyone right here right now.

Ragnar asks Rip about his clothes. Rip is dressed in tight jeans and an open silk shirt. There is much talk about the various tribes and beliefs of the cultures around.

We are awoken early by the sounds of the camp at dawn. We are fed yak's milk gruel for breakfast. There's some banter with Krum regarding this. Esme checks that Martin has rebooted successfully. Martin seems grumpy about being turned off and on again. Martin wanted to go out in a blaze of glory.

We discuss our plans for the day and beyond. We think we have to kill the giant apparently. Riphard reckons we can poison him, possibly non-lethally, to achieve something similar. We have an intense discussion about potential approaches but get nowhere. Esme talks to her goat boyfriend. She presses him on the issues plaguing their tribe and pressure points we can exploit to challenge the giant leader.

We agree to go and help with a hunt to ingratiate ourselves more with the tribe and begin bonding ourselves more with the peoples. Myron bigs up his hunting skills and tries to narrow down what exactly we're meant to be hunting. There's a bit of banter with the giant leader who threatens to rip Myron's head off. Myron threatens the same. The giant says he

couldn't reach. Burnie says he didn't specify which one. The giant says he still couldn't reach. Riphard suggests this just means he has a small penis. Esme contacts Stanri to try and cheat on the hunt by finding out the best local game to hunt.

The group decide whether food or glory is more important in terms of what to hunt. Myron says lets go for one of each. Stanri gets back to us and tells us about boreworms (glory/food), cave mammoths (food), and the ashen rider (pure glory). Stanri doesn't know anything about plants unfortunately to aid in the poisoning plot.

One of the tribe suggests hunting for elk and we all viciously mock him, which is a good start to ingratiating ourselves into the clan. Myron, the ranger, begins his hunt for a cave mammoth.

Dev starts having intrusive thoughts that the group is holding her back, but she has some doubts that these are her actual thoughts. She has had several of these before. She brushes these away yet again.

As the group drifts off to sleep they collectively dream of moldy flesh sloughing off of bones and decaying ruins. Their thoughts turn skyward as they see masses of wings and eyes, as a gargantuan purple dragonlike being thunders through space...

EPISODE 87: RELEPHANT



Myron finished up shit talking the leader. The next day it was time to go hunting something large.

We go exploring out into the wilderness, cave mammoths are on the menu. We are looking for caves that mayhave been missed by other people. Eventually we find some crevices in the distance. It has a great deal of potential.

We are going to take some of the tribe with us. "BEst if no one comes with us, it will be very dangerous" says Martin, to goad them into joining us. Magrat doesn't come with us as he isn't into caves, he will take some of the tribe to hunt on the planes. Ragnor gets sent with us.

"There are cave mammoths in this cave"

"You always explore a hole"

It takes about an hour to trudge our way to the mouth of the cave. Its a little isolated, and is hidden by outcrops.

"Will the horrible baby be in the cave? Maybe a twin?" "I sincerely hope not"

"You've seen clothes, and said no thanks"

We go into the crack, and meet a host of cave mammoths, which are actually only the size of a horse. Very small.

Mammoths were alerted. There is a clutch of mammoth eggs, in the air. They are very protective.

The mammoths charge, luckily dev sticks one with a stick. Exmerah starts shooting, and mrs ball allows the universe to move a mammoth into her. Mammoths continue their charges. Burney is savaged by an incredibly dense mammoth. It gores him, and then stomps on him. Burnie tries to roll further away and gets stomped on. Myron shoots the mammoth. Martin fries one mammoths brains, whilst Exmerah flies down and uses the cube to somewhat heal Burnie. Myron is very happy with all the killing which is going on. Myron kills the mammoths.

Exmerah captures the Mammoth eggs for future use

EPISODE 88: MOVERS AND SHAKERS



We move to link back up with the rest of the tribe, hauling mammoth meat, hide and tusks with us.

We find them after six hours in a stand off over hunting rights with "The Adam-ants" (who are super badass looking, the Old Prophet has a tiny bonce though but live and let live).

Exme throws down some mammoth "Nice to MEAT you! How about some barbeque and vodka?"

We have an evening socialising with the Adam-ants. Exme makes friends with Aracia and her spider Zarathrustra. Burnie tries to talk to the Old Prophet but he's having none of it. We set up the mammoth egg incubator and ponder cave mammoth biology.

The tribe decides to head home, Martin goes with them to look afte the eggs. We decide to segue to hunt a bore worm. Magrat lends us Eric and Krum to help us hunt one. We travel to an ice shelf to set up an ambush. Eric begins to jump up and down to summon a worm. Myron senses one aproaching. Eric gives a thumbs up as the colossal worm breaks out of the ice, devouring him.

Battle ensues against the worm. Riphard getting the killing shot. We spend a few hours butchering it and comforting Krum over the loss

of Eric before returning to the tribe. Burnie asking if Eric's furs and women are now going spare on account of him being eaten.

Magrat begins to speak about the possibility of us joining the tribe when he is interrupted by the sound of horns blowing the summoning song of emmerdale farm. The Varg is to give a speech. We head out to hear what he has to say. Exme knocking Krum into the friendzone enroute.

We see Valkar Varg flanked by Pact warriors, hellish creatures. Valkar calls to march on the south, to seize what is theirs and to crush the weak southern gods. So that's that, the time for poisoning and overthrowing the varg has passed.

We bicker a lot. Erin sends a warning to Stanri that the Varg are moving to invade. Then we carry on bickering.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rpcFRDXIBqc&ab_channel=DoctorWhoProductions

EPISODE 89: SWAMPING THE WEEKEND

Esme kneels on the ground and eats a handful of soil. Everyone is weirded out by this.

The camp is packing up, preparing for war. Burnie writhes in a pile of furs. Myron talks to Magrat about going South and the war and stuff, and then apologises for the coup they were attempting to foment against him.

Magrat says that he doesn't really care what they do, and Myron explains that they have a super secret mission for the war effort and won't be coming South with them. Magrat says that he doesn't really care what they do.

Everyone thinks about last night, when they were talking about their plan. Their plan is to find the hole in the ground where Kalimar lives and slither right down inside it. Esme's plan is to eat soil.

Esme tries to convince Magrat to slither into the hole with them and help save the world, and, while he isn't convinced of that, he is intrigued enough that he brings all the named characters on the journey to go and see Crankle, who they hope will be of some help with the plan to slither into the hole.

Esme goes dirt crazy and starts talking about "Swamping the Weekend".

They go and see Crankle.

Crankle had a party and killed a load of kids.

Esme eats some goblin viscera, mixed in with dirt. Riphard falls into a pit of bloody meat.

Esme explains that goblins are weak to having their blood removed or their body parts separated, and that's probably what's happened here.

Esme then says that the weekend has been swamped and everyone forgets their worries for a minute, because of the funny clever thing.

Then everyone starts to think about the fact they're standing in a big field full of corpses, and probably they should do something about this. Everyone goes about having a look for things. They surmise that maybe Crankle didn't have a party and was stolen away by forces slightly darker than him, one of which might be the big winged dude who's mates with Valkar.

Martin helps out by making one of the goblins not a corpse any more, and he's a valued member of the group now who is very helpful and alive. Riphard is very helpful and provides lots of spare parts for the new friend to use because goblins don't do very well without all their bits, apparently.

Together with their new friend, they discover the path, which is the one with the tracks, which just goes to show how good a friend he is to have.

They think about the fact that they're heading towards where that weird temple was, and that's probably where the hole is. Esme reckons Crankle was researching Kalimar goo, and that's probably why he's been taken to the hole.

They walk on down the road, and have a nice chat about pornography and sewing machines and stuff like that and how good parents Myron and Esme are because they know all about the parts of a sewing machine. Just some good friends swamping the weekend.

The Adamants are listening in and become jealous of the camaraderie on display, and come to get involved in a violent way. The spider lady is a fucking bitch, I guess.

They try and kill us, and Riphard gets hurt, which is nothing new. The spider gets turned into a duck, I guess.

Esme goes into her bag and gets out her latest project; a collaboration with David, who has been using his own alchemical methods to try and imbue life into a clay lady named Julie, who looks very surprised at the onslaught she unleashes.

Myron informs everyone about "Kalimel", which is a cool thing they could call the Kalimar

goo. Then he remembers he's supposed to be fighting but doesn't remember he's using some dodgy shells he found in Esme's bag, and is surprised when it explodes in a huge cone, which kills that spider lady bitch.

One of them blows some stuff up with her crazy blood, totally swamping the weekend. The spider gets blown out of the duck, and then Rip sends it into another dimension. Classic duck stuff.

The Lizard King yells and people hate it.

Martin calls forth the darkness at the centre of all things and the light is pulled from one of the bad ladies, ageing her nearly to death. Magrat cuts the Lizard King into pieces.

Myron blows a hole in some dude, Rip fires some guns, you know how it goes.

Some randos get involved, seeking the oblivion of death.

The bitch with the longbow tries to run away, as a result of which, Martin turns her into a duck at long range, and Esme uses the cube to set the lads on her before shooting her to pieces with a gun.

Magrat consumes a man whole.

Riphard alone witnesses this.

Everyone else finishes off the lady and Magrat takes her to pieces.

Everyone wanders off.

Credits:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KEI4qSrKPAAs>

EPISODE 90: HOLD THE SIDE SLAAD.

 xme eats dirt, swamping the weekend. We get to the church, Magrat and the others and a bunch of pussies so can't be fucked to go into the church.

We sneak into the church, Burnie and Rip move off to the side sneakily

We see toads. Martin pulls the "inspector" card, saying he needs to inspect their feet and mouth for mouth and foot disease.

They're having none of it, combat ensues.

Martin and rip do some stuff, then the slaad farts nastiness at us.

Then 3 of them nuke us down with fireballs

We hit them with fire and lightning and thunder, and they're resistant to all of them.

Erin saves us with an aura, then fails her con save so she doesn't.

Then they blitz us down again, Burnie gets flattened and Exme freezes time to heal a bunch of people, thankfully including Burnie.

Josh shows up and goes full blown red hood on these mother-fuckers, back flips and shooting.

They keep nuking us, myron does some dope shit jumping over the Slaad.

We burst them all down, but then one turns invisible.

But then the fucker hasn't fucking moved, so we just start attacking it wildly in its spot.

Erin slams it, we then go in for some more attacks. It irritatingly attacks Myron.

We eventually fuck it.

We go downstairs. There's a bunch of derp snakes.

Outerlogue:

Deep in the astral abyss in a land between lands at some point deep within and without, the germ of a concept floats trying to muster enough will to conjure forth a "thought".

It once was, but is no more, but doesn't have the capacity to consider if this is or isn't a loss, so continues on its way, a little glimmer of nothing in an endless sea of nothing.

However, in spite of all these shortcomings, something equating to concern starts to cross the thing that isn't its mind. As it looks out across the vast infinity of the nowhere space before it, it seems what can only be described as (even with its distinct lack of vocabulary) a storm is brewing.

A storm that threatens to encompass absolutely everything of this nothingness. A storm being with pulsating scarlet and thronged in a twister of dread.

The thing looks at this, and it is as close to afraid as it can be, but not for itself (for it has no concept).

It's scared for those still alive.

It sheds a single golden tear that coalesces briefly into bright light, and is extinguished.

EPISODE 91: SANKES DON'T HAVE LIPS



Myron and Erin push open the heavy iron gates and greet the lipless giant snake-people.

Myron inquires about the goo going for the classic inspector play. He tries to deceive the snake-people. Riphard inquires who they are and who should be here after being told we're not meant to be here. The snake people evade the question and immediately commence a fight.

Riphard, ever wary of snakes of all types, springs to action first. He just shoots one in its human-snake face. The first naga responds with a flame strike dealing damage to everyone. The naga Rip shot responds with a poisonous spit-take. Thankfully Rip's hardy constitution and dwarven resilience greatly mitigate this grossness.

Myron readies his guknife and gets a read on their nature. They're immune to poison and charm. Very standoffish. Myron runs up the hurt naga and shoots into it's head, hitting once, but struggling to get a proper footing with his second and knife attacks.

Exme eats a soilwich.

Burnie attempts to sneak attack and gets a slash in.

Martin tries to polymorph one of them, but the nagas are very wise to his antics and it remains an ugly snake-person.

Erin gets in there with her glaive and does some major damage, carving up the first naga deeply before following through with her butt.

Rip gets another good shot in and takes cover behind the corner by the entrance.

The injured naga cures some of it's severe wounds while the second naga slinkies up and allows Erin to swipe it, but she misses badly. It then dives in to eat Erin. Erin is swallowed whole and immediately succumbs to the immense attack before the naga vomits up her semi-corpse. Myron, seeing this, wants to try and eat the snake. He angrily shoots it twice more in the head before plunging his bayonet all the way through and out the other side. The naga collapses to the floor.

Exme continues eating her dirtway.

Burnie heals Erin on the way to running up and trying to stab the remaining snakunt, but he's predictably rubbish at this and ends up impaling the floor instead.

Martin fingers the naga with his deadly finger. The naga visibly withers and weakens at the snake knees.

Rip once again reliably shoots the naga for solid damage.

The naga, writhing in pain, brings down a giant column of flames upon the clumped group of attackers around it.

Myron goes for his trusty weapon, and tries to stab it first, but the fire wards off his attack from the intense heat. He instead double taps it in the belly dealing it massive damage.

Exme is starting to feel unwell having nearly finished her mulch-kebab.

Burnie goes to stab the naga with a stone dagger and manages to plunge it deeply into the wounds from Myrons strikes. The naga looks close to death.

Martin tells the naga it sucks and calls it a dingus, attempting to mock it to death. The naga looks confused, then horrified, and immediately dies of shame.

The dead nagas melt into a viscous puddle of goo, which drains through the floor.

Erin calls for aid and Myron force feeds her his beef jerky. It's incredibly chewing and this occupies Erin for quite a while.

The group search for any sign of further drags and scuffs, but there's only rotting scraps and bones lying around giving no clue as to a good next direction to head in. Myron attempts to sniff for goo to no avail. Martin just picks a door and opens it with confidence. Martin notices the lofty rafters in the next room and spies a large monkey-like figure perched above. Its eyes being to glow. Burnie notices ants have started to pour into the room from every nook and cranny. The group realises this is one of Valkar's animalistic hype men from the announcement ceremony.

"You will not leave here... MALKIOR WILL TAKE YOUR HEADS!" the monkeyman bellows with burning rage.

Burnie gives everyone an emboldening bond and blesses us all.

Fleshy wings suddenly sprout out of the sides of Martin's head and he feels poison coursing through his body. Erin begins to feel her skin burning. The millions of ants have begun their chaos.

Erin glows with her aura of vitality and feels a little better.

Martin attempts to counterspell the mad ape man who is trying to freeze Burnie to the spot, but he fails and Burnie is paralyzed.

Myron gets burned, and immediately runs into the room towards the mean monkey menace. He leaps up to the rafters and manages to grab on. Myron's gun begins to drip with ethereal white fire, radiating holy power. He stabs his now glorious bayonet into the monkey's torso.

Riphard just misses with a shot, but quickly reloads and gets a second shot in. The monkey begins to dimly glow.

Malkior swipes out at Burnie and slashes him with its long claws. The monkey then squirts fire at Rip, but Rip ducks behind the corner deftly.

Burnie stabs the great ape with his spicy sword in an apparently sneaky way.

Martin begins to fly and swirls his hands. A wind picks up along the floor, sweeping up bones and debris before engulfing the monkey in a whirlwind. Burnie and Erin feel inspired by this show of magical force.

Malkior, an absolute legend, attempts to warp the flesh of Rip and Erin, but their mighty constitutions fend off the attack.

Burnie shrugs off the writhing mass of ants, and heals himself minorly. He then tries to get in another couple of spicy stabs, connecting with both.

Martin's face suddenly drops and he appears intensely stupid and empty, completely enfeebled of mind. He is completely mentally shattered, seemingly permanently.

Erin heals Burnie a bit and strikes out at the evil before us, wounding him deeply.

Myron shoots twice and stabs at the monkey, tearing away significant chunks of flesh as he falls back into the roaring whirlwind via Myron's outstretched bayonet, which flays him with the help of the powerful wind. He disappears in a red mist of viscera into the vortex.

Martin's ear wings suddenly detach and flutter into the distance and he falls a short distance to the dungeon floor.

The group gang together to buff Martin as much as possible while Rip lets rip and begins popping off bullets right next to Martin's head; bellowing him to snap out of it. From the length of the buffs Martin has 10 attempts to regain his sanity. ONE! TWO! THREE! . . . nothing. FOUR! FIVE!

Martin's dull eyes suddenly light up and spark to life. "For a second there I felt. . . like a mouse."

Riphard zones out for a while.

Erin awards Myron a field promotion.

Myron suggests we do some "prayer shit" to call for aid from the Gods. We form an octagon of power, as octagons are the strongest shape as everybody knows, and we all feel a deep connection with the Gods.

The Gods tell us that they know we face harder challenges ahead and warn us they will intervene only when they deem it necessary, and now is not that moment.

Erin senses a voice in her head, oddly familiar by this point. This time she is convinced that these are her own thoughts emanating from somewhere deep inside her brain and definitely not an external psychic malice. She feels intense disdain for her now-colleagues and even the Gods themselves.

EPISODE 92: DARK HAired WHITE WOMEN



Myron counted to six and kicked down the fucking door. Krankl and I raised our heads towards the crash of splinters. "Go away I am very busy!". Myron asked if we were going to be attacked. No-one seemed enthusiastic for death. I sighed and put my head around the door and stared at the smelly man in his pornography coated lab. It looked like he was doing some kind of alchemy. Myron picked up something that he was convinced was marmalade. We talked him down through some reverse reverse psychology. I introduced the team to Krankl. Myron asked him if he knew anything about the Kalimel™. It was story time. Myron asked him where dogs go when they die. The answer was apparently Krankl's stomach. Ridiculous. The Kalimel comes from Kalimar himself. Valkarr is on the way to the source. Krankl told me I was his second favourite and that he always liked me even though he told me everyday that we were together that I deserved to die. Valkarr moved him here to teach him a lesson and make sure his research stayed secret. What research you ask? Valkarr never liked the gods so its strange he made an alliance with this new old god. "Creation does not mean you owe your life to them". Valkarr made a deal with Kalimar to get power to take down the south but he also wanted an insurance policy. That's where Krankl

comes in, to study the goo and make a modified version of the goo that they can control. The madman. There are some things that goblins were not meant to mess with. I saw what this can do to Kolo first hand.

We argued about whether or not Krankls meddling was a good idea. I recommended we destroy everything. These kinds of things never go well. Erin was actually not unconvinced that this was a bad idea. I found this a bit strange. We wondered about these helper goblin monsters Krankl had made. Despite having two mouths they had been engineered to not speak so as to not reveal secrets. They did not look so happy. You know what they say "loose tongues, well hung". Myron had the solution. We need him to not make more of this homebrew goo. We need him to make an antidote to the Kalimel. Krankl made his offer, 1000 gp, no goblin assistants, and women. He pointed at his wall. Dark haired white women. We offered him protection on the ship and a lab to make antigoo, with gold and dark haired white women consent pending. But how to get him to the ship. Erin said we needed to leave him here. This was not good, the goblin is a liar and a cheat and he'll betray us the moment we're out of sight.

We asked him if he knew how we could find and track Valkarr, and he was like smirking a bit so we thought he knew more. Myron tried to get the truth out of him but he just laughed at him. Burnie tried to intimidate him. Krankl was not threatened but out of pity started to tell us what we wanted to know. But at the same time Riphard tried to mind control him to sign a contract and Erin simultaneously offered him a kingdom full of pornography. The porn won out when he found out that white haired dark women existed. The cat was out of the bottle and Krankl was furious at me. Well done Erin. What's going on with her today? He reached into a drawer and threw me a shoddy little bundle of wires and chalk that he described as "a tracking device" for a tracker he had installed on Valkarr. Incredible. It wasn't too hard to make it work. With this it was time to go since no-one else seemed to care that Krankl's work here had at least a 34.67% chance of destroying the bio-disc. We wondered about what a book is. Is a pub sign a book? Is a car with writing on it something that needs to be burned. Who can know these things? Burnie says that when in doubt it is just safer to burn everything. Riphard decided that one day he will make an asbestos book to annoy Burnie.

I sat in the back having a smoke with Krankl while everyone debated books and stuff. Burnie

made an erotic statue out of stone. It was a lady that looked like myron and lady body but also dick. This was a strange mess. I told Krankl that Kalimar had Kolo. He said he didn't care. I know he did. Kolo was his least favourite student. We left. I hate that goblin so much.

We left the temple and snuck out into the 'streets' of the inner varghold, leaving the town and resting. We followed the tracker device Northwards.

As the team marched North, Valkarrs army started their long slow march South. The invasion had started. The clock was ticking. Time was running out. Tick tock. Deadline looming. The sand was pouring into the bottom of the hourglass. The sun was rising/setting. Time.

Myron put his nose into the snow. We were a few days behind though the tracks were hard to make out. As we made our way North we found remnants of camps and other signs as we went along. Two days to be precise, an army with a size we could not determine. Maybe 2 -15. Myron set up a nice igloo for us but then lit a fire in it that was madness. Burnie got wet and smelled.

Outro music:
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=d2XdmyBtCRQ>

EPISODE 93: ITS THE GIRTH NOT THE LENGTH

IT was a cold snowy day in paradise, and the temples secret areas were surprisingly deadly. Culminating in a large monkey man with fire ants... then there was Krangle.

Who not surprisingly had failed to create what he had been asked to do, if anything he continued to be a disappointment to all. We did offer him protection in exchange for the location of Valkar, and create an antidote for the goo, which I am sure will never ever ever work.

He tracked north to follow Valkar. Dev had a few calm inner voice issues, but she seems to have resolved them.

We are looking for another hole, so we can punch Calimar in the face. Its getting pretty cold, probably all that snow.

Day 2: we are still travelling North, it all looks the same, one might say featureless. Time loses meaning, distance is measured in time, so also loses meaning. Perhaps Myrons high levels of

knowledge can help us spot an occasional rock. The furs smell of loose women and BO, Burnie requests that any women found are handed over to him. The cold helps us all ignore the bile that this raises in our throats.

"Out here in the whiteness you have to take your sanity where you can find it"

We get to the end of our days travel quite quickly, at this point it surprises no one. Stars and cubes are no match for the right settings to get a house out.

The entire adventure gets sidetracked into memory lane, to the despair of characters that did not exist at that time. Including Dev, who takes the moment to reflect on the glory of the sky. She can see every single star, perhaps even more than ever before, especially this one, that is a different colour... it is entrancing...

Myron also looks up and sees a great deal more stars than he normally does, but not anything new.

Erin continues to stare at the star, and comes to the realisation that everyone is a bloody moron.

Scene missed due to baby care (Toaster makes a cake?) its a disaster, that leads to conversations about off standing.

Come morning who knows if last nights issues are resolved.

Martin gives a bleak speech of what it has been like travelling with these murderous psychopaths, in a hope to help Erin realise that there is really no way back on this trip, these idiots have embraced the fact the universe has thus far failed to kill, and so may never do.

Towards the end of the day we come across a huge ice cliff, that has steps up the side. Exmerah is still crying from the cake incident. Large icy crystals have formed under her eyes and nose.

A further intermission takes place due to a screaming child

we rejoin our heroes as they are bantering somewhat with Valkar Varg, and about to be in a serious ruckus with some giant beasts. The ruckus takes place, it is immense. Erin steps in and shreds a giant beast, its a lot of dmg. In retaliation the bird man swoops in and really messes up Myron, who is then set on fire by the giant beast of evil. Who tries to engulf Erin!

all paused for child care

EPISODE 94: SOMETIMES FIGHTS JUST HAPPEN. JUST LIKE THAT EPISODE OF THE SIMPSONS.



uilt in the side of a giant ice sheet lies the uppermost level of what we believe is a temple Kalimar. Our party have just defeated Valkar's lieutenants and now look to moving further in.

Exme goes over to the symbol of Kalimar on the ground, holding the vial she hopes will cure Kolo "Let's fucking kill Kalimar"

We head down the tunnel, it winds and fractures before the floor drops away and we slide into darkness. Picking ourselves up after the drop we realise we've been split up. Exme, Myron, Burnie and Erin are together. Martin and Riphard can hear us close by.

Myron tests the walls by shooting them. they are indeed walls. Patches of blue fungus start to become prevalent as we move through the tunnel. We talk nonsense ploughing ahead not paying attention for 4 hours until we walk straight into a group of ratmen looking puzzled as to how we didnt notice them. The picture of competence.

We clash in a whirlwind of blades, bullets, bites, big bonks, the ripping of face meat and a cheeky hook to someones anus.

We carry on chit chatting, contemplating if the now deceased Mrs Ball was an egg.

Myron and Exme interrogate some regular rats. Many rat heads are slapped clean off as the over powered duo quickly go through all the rats they can find. Leaving behind a sad, terrifying pile of rat corpses.

Martin give Exme a call, they are being followed by something large. Its keeping its distance. They've tried to lose it but it keeps finding them.

We eventually link up and confront the creature. It can move with unnatural speed. It takes hits as it approaches but it sinks it's teeth into Erin, paralysing her with its poison.

Burnie switches places with her and piles into the creature with a flurry of attacks. The fight continues with the monster flinging poisoned darts from its tail into the party. A new, more confident Mrs Ball smashes the monster. We continue to trade blows, Myron getting the killing blow. The creature flails in its death throes while we watch.

EPISODE 95: IN THE FUNGAL, THE SHROOMY JUNGLE, THE DINO SPORES TONIGHT.

E fought all the things, then one big thing. The fight, then we went down a corridor, Rip and Martin had been separated, but we found them later to fight the shit out of a big scary thing.

Martin tried to polymorph it, but the gods said no.

Martin and Exme have a chat, then rocks fall and we're separated, conveniently just those present in the meta-verse.

The gods connection to the universe is wonky.

Myron sniffs the air through Burnies farts and discovers a path deeper into the earth.

We come to a fork in the deep dark cave. Myron does a vibe check.

The right hand path has more fungus on it, and probably more dead things.

We choose right, because more dead things is more interesting.

No, we choose left, less weird. Myron argued himself out of it.

The tunnel winds and twists - about 40 minutes of walking later Myron starts to sense more and more living "beings" in this direction. It's potentially only the cusp of what he could see from the earlier position.

As we get closer, we sense less and less Kalimar influence. . . There's still pockets, but we start to pick up on the evidence of . . . rough civilization.

We come to a sort of entrance-way/gate style thing. We've seen evidence of lots of rat-pores.

Humanoid rats.

"Anyone fancy a bit of genocide" Burnie goes off to scout the "gate".

There's no guards. There's a vast warren of piles of salvaged wood and stuff - nest.

There's easily over 10 thousand ratmen - this is a full underground hive.

I also notice that two of them near me have noticed me.

Burnie turns, walks, and tries to wander away. . . whistling. . . and then sprinting at great speed.

A giant Swarm of rats comes with us.

We run, at great speed, 20 minutes worth of walking away.

We begin on the right-hand tunnel.

We walk for half an hour more. It slowly starts to open up, back to our original fork in the road.

We go right this time.

We start to see big-ish mushrooms, half rip-height.

Myron notices some side-alleys through the shroom.

He asks for Burnies diary. . . .

This is shroomy, mushroom man. All hail kalimar. Strange little gnome just threw this journal at me, and so shroomy chosen to write here.

Spores are erupting from a nearby mushroom friend. All hail kalimar. It's very glittery.

The groups moving, I'm going to follow them.

They start moving through the shrooms carefully.

The dwarf and the gnome say they should feed mushrooms to the human, who rebukes they should eat the mushrooms as they're both immune.

The dwarf can't argue with this logic.

The human says the dwarf normally only eats pallets of chocolate.

I follow.

They continue for close to a mile, avoiding touching the shrooms. It's hard to tell how long they've been going. I hope they breath in mushroom spores, they look tasty, shroomy would like to spread mycelium tendrils through their corpse and absorb their nutrients. Yum yum.

All hail Kalimar.

Apparently they have magic cube that makes house. But is with Goblin.

Instead they make a small camp in a split between rocks, good protection. Means I not eat them in sleep. Sad now, but impressed with ingenuity.

Dwarf does first watch, he watches bugs and listens to drip of water from stalagmite. Names slug after human, "Burnie".

then Gnome, he silly little man, he looks around, can't see much, no creatures nearby.

then woman, before she wake, shroomy sense she having dream, allies betray, stab her in the back, work towards... not work towards, they doing bidding of things they not understand, just morons, just terrible.

She has visions of Human worshipping evil god Synne, trickster.

Whirling emotions.

She see parodies of gnome, being silly and moronic, she sees dwarf sat cackling on mountain of gold, goblin twisting machine and flesh together, and Robot with big glowing sad eyes and a deathwish.

All hail kalimar.

She is distracted, she sees none of the horrible things happening in the night, worried by own thoughts... Kalimar is powerful, more than puny entourage, more than their puny gods.

She conflicted.

then human. He sits ass backwards to vent farts out of crack in clearing. In spite he hears well.

A goblin and a robot walk past looking for them, but do not see. Haha.

Center of universe moves with the goblin, it has a bow on its head.

His ears prick at sound of roar, but thinks its a fart echoing.

An army is marching on the city. I see this through the micellium network. The silly heroes know nothing of this.

All hail Kalimar.

They start waking up, missing their comforts. Gnome takes lead and others help.

Dwarf speaks bullshit about completely fine Mushrooms. The male human starts trying to spot mushrooms.

He can't see the mushrooms for the trees.

All hail kalimar.

Shroomy sometimes wonder if his life as sentient mushroom colony is fulfilling.

But then he sees higher evolved life and feels better for it as they stoopid.

Gnome works out the cave is damp and not much air moves through. Air doesn't taste stale though.

They continue for a bit and look for second amount of progress. They make staggering progress, getting lost in the mushrooms.

The human stumbles and hits a shroom, spores hit him. He turns blue. And depressed.

Haha, this pleases shroomy.

Dwarf then stumble, he shrinks 2 foot. Has to use bang-bang stick with 2 hands instead of one.

Tiny little dwarf. Haha. Chode.

They make it through shroom forest, but I can see them through the spores, will continue to write.

Blue-Human sits on stool-like dwarf.

Dwarf and gnome chat about mushrooms effects. They try to remove spores with toothpaste, Blueman is bright and shiny.

But still blue.

Silly sentients

All hail Kalimar.

Woman tries to see if disease, but doesn't detect as disease. Haha, waste of spell slot.

Weird Shroomy know what that is.

Flappy lizard bastards attack silly group. They poop on Shroomy, he not happy.

Only Blueman see them.

Blueman kill Lizard-bastard. Go Blueman.

Shroomy conflicted, want see sentients die but really hate lizard bastards.

Hope they kill all lizard-bastards but die of wounds after.

Flappy bastards attack group while most are recovering from surprise.

They get a peck in then fly away.

Big dino comes in, he's our friend, he infected with my friend Cordy. Cordy is good dino.

It puts gnome in mouth. Blueman runs in, wrenches open dino jaw, pulls out gnome, and narrowly avoids being eaten himself.

Flappy bastards swarm the group again, and bite at dwarf. Cordy naps that gnome and tails at woman, but misses. Big fucking idiot, shroomy wouldn't miss like that.

Woman ejaculates ghosts. They start attacking things. Hot.

Dwarf doublehands his pistol phallicly. Genitals are weird.

All hail Kalimar.

Gnome mounts the Dino. Slips on its seeping fungal growth, then falls off and missfires his gun into its balls.

Dino attacks hooman, gnome and hooman counter-attack doing a double-team.

Robot shows up. Is it version 3 or 4? Who knows. Is not mushroom. Is clusterfuck.

Rip shoots the dino and it becomes disco dino.

Myron sexes the dino. With his gun. He blows it a new fuck-port. Blowing away its balls.

The big dino falls epicly, the rest are slain shortly after.

Poor cordy.

Robot picks up the flat dwarf. Goblin is there, but silent.

We go down a downward slope. It's all bleak, dark and miserable.

Like life.

Hail Kalimar.

Robot has been in bluemans colon, acting as his debugger.

We descend into the brown fleshy tunnel.

As though ground is soiled, but fleshy.

Robot does magic. Robot makes gnome giant turd. But actually a Sea Slug.

But actually it's a killer whale! It bites the side of gods colon.

Con save. Sprayed with Spores. The Killerwhale/slug mutates and grows webbed feet moving slower. He's covered in slug mucus moving slower.

The side bleeds though.

Robot absorbed ghost so is now even weirder. Shroomy is guessing. Shroomy has no context.

"That slugs not going anywhere fast, and that weird dwarf is super slow, and the blue thing? It's irrational, I'm ignoring it"

Blueman. climbs onto the slug and has a snooze.

The Goblin has a weird little device and keeps going "oh dear" about the situation. She seems occupied.

Shroomy is tired of writing and out of pa..

EPISODE 96: A MOIST FLESH CAVE

WE find our team of bold adventurers in a strange fleshy cave, Burnie is blue, Riphard is even shorter than normal.

We are on the way to Kalimar, travelling for about four hour. The tunnel has a kind of capillary feel, and the glistening tunnels make us feel claustrophobic.

We are descending in a non perceptible fashion, like good norfolk hill.

The longer we walk through the tunnels, the more it reminds me of an anthill, could there be large volumes of workers that might use these at any point?

"Didn't we have a centaur with us last time?"

"They are all dead, . . ."

"We are literally going to kill a god. . ."

Burnie sits on the enshortened version of Riphard, and sulks.

After a few more hours, we enter a large chamber, so large that darkness enshrouds the edges. The flesh twists so that it becomes tree like in areas, a plethora of platforms jut out from the darkness. Could these be spherical eggs? There are goat men clambering around, some of them carrying eggs, other pouring liquid from rough hewn buckets onto the eggs.

Dev calls for being all sneaky like to avoid any kind of fighting. Burnie slides over everything sullenly, while the others nip through everywhere, somewhat guided by Reggie and Burnie. Things are disgusting due to the fleshy trees, when Dev rests a hand on a tree, which is then grasped by barky tree hand. Srg Dev lets out a yelp, attracting attention from some nearby goatmen. Lords above, this is going to be challenging.

The goat men cometh! Martin rolls up his sleeves. Unleashes a series of divine blasts upon the goat men, Rip unleashes golden light, and Exmeh blasts the goats, Burnie reaches out his claw and rips apart the hand that grasps her. The goats close in on our band of idiot heroes. Its a fools mission, as our adventurers kill the goats, and Mrs Ball repeatedly murders the same goat.

"It's not exactly a womb with a view" Burnie zings the team.

Reggie announces he is Reggie, "cue flashback of his death" Oh Boy

He is broken deep down, and its really not great for either of them. Exmerah seeks out Rips assistance and demands an Exorcism, he demands any runes, candles and a sacrificial virgin. Exmerah provides the Vu Dong Monkey Fat Candles, Burnie lies down as one of the runes. We wait for a while, a while longer, and then nothing happens. Riphard recalls that this is a exorcism for daemons not divine possession. It seems that the tie between Erin and Reggie maybe holding him here.

Burnie looks up and sees a hundred claw legged beast darting lightening fast across the ceiling, its black and not furry, more centipeedy. Its probably not a good thing for us.

Exmerah sulks because Erin stole her friend.

Righty Ho then off to find this elder god, we head off sneaky beaky again, with Exmerah and Myron skulking at the back.

An hour later we stay out of sight of the goatmen and the cavern thins out and extends upwards. In the distance we can see giant eggs, filled with limbs and green, yellow goo. At a miles distance thats got to be some really big things in there.

Calimar is the creator of all things fleshy, anyway form of biological creation, whether by fungus ingestion, or brewing fungus eggs, probably him.

Exmerah "You know chickens, you know they make eggs, probably something much bigger than this laid this egg"

Exmerah suggests that we rig all the eggs with Dynamite to gain leverage over Kalimar.

We wade our way to the roe, picking out a perfect pathway. About halfway there we arrive at a flesh shelf, which we duck behind as a giant creature drops down from the ceiling on a thread of fleshy sinew. This Spider-esque creature, with delicate hands on each of its legs. It pulls a material from its own innards, and moulds it onto the side of the egg, building up layers of goo on the side of the egg. It's building eggs.

Exmerah pulls out the cube, and turns herself invisible, activating her boots she hovers over to the spider-esque beast inserting dynamites into the weave of the eggs. The beast pauses as if sensing Exmerah, before in a horrid sloshing noise it continues on. The material that sloughs of is like wet flesh. The stink of formaldehyde is overpowering. Exmerah withdraws.

"Its the leverage, I assume Kalimah loves his children. . . .we might need to explain to him in

some detail whats happening, since he was born at the start of time. . . ."

We segue onto capillary action, with odd small tunnels heading outwards from the roof, occasionally large beetle-like creatures pop out and scurry off. Hours more pass, and the team gets somewhat tired. Exmerah once more pulls the cube and generates a lovely comfortable house. . . .

Burnie gets naked, "He really is blue all over. . . ."

Exmerah checks in on the mammoth eggs, they are about a week away from hatching, at which point they will be babies Myron explains. Dev takes an hour or so to doff her armour, and then even longer to clean off the dirt and tendrils of fleshy matter.

Erin has some night terrors, but holds strong and resists any temptation.

While resting we zoom out to a sky high view of the eastern empire. Beneath us we can see the full arrayed might of the empires armies, the forces of hopes rest, the banners of Gary, the forces of the spires, the elite forces Myron has trained. The army of the Varg are descending at pace towards the well formed lines. The Varg are pouring down the hills almost endless in their numbers. The air is filled with monstrosities and Valkar riding a giant eagle.

The two armies are about to engage in mortal combat, the last we see is Lazarus descending down into the affray.

Erin and Martin notice a very large purplish red star in the sky that seems about four times the size of any other star in the sky. Erin experiences an intense feeling of fear and proximity. Martin can see the heat streaks as it descends into the atmosphere similar to how meteors look as they hit the sky.

Canalon is very close, burning up in the atmosphere.

We leave the house, and arrive back into the large flesh tunnel, beetles crawling out of orifices. "Death or Glory"

An hour later, we came to an ornate semi translucent door made of flesh. The entire tunnel is covered by a fleshy barrier, about 5 inches thick, with weird decorations and piles of small skulls in pyramids, bits of jewellery and totems arranged before it.

Dev carves a huge opening in it with her Glaive, a tidal wave of goo rushes out to great everyone who dashes to the side except for

Exmerah, who gets overcome with it. She is the first to hear,

“Well Well Well, finally you join me Exmerah”

“Kolo has been so desperately waiting for you!”

“Thank you, you have opened the way”

“We have come here to kill you” says Exmerah
“I don’t know everything, but I know you will die”

“Where is my brother?” “He lives inside me, I can bring you together again” “If you would like to lie down and die, and give me Kolo that would be fine”

Kolo chimes in “Why don’t you give in Exmerah, you always think you are so clever. . . .”

“Do you not remember back when we were children, in the Varg, playing with Krankel and the chemicals, you like electronics, but I could make the chemicals.”

“You think you know better than me, that was the problem”

Exmerahs detectomatic, detects tens of thousands of souls, Kolos is among them. . .

“Come then weaklings, let us have this over with”

EPISODE 97: THE DESTRUCTION OF THE CREATOR

 Hey had made their way through the fleshy, tunnelous bowels of Kalimar’s lair. Their last sleep showed them visions of the great battle starting between the forces of Gazhikstan and Kalimar. And here they now stood, before the fleshy door where our enemy lay.

They looked around at each other and made their last minute preparations.

Burnie raised his welted hands and beckoned us pray to the gods and Synne. There was a deep retelling of the lore of many people who had been connected to Synne, all dead by the hands of the group.

Exme, clearly flustered got up from the ground where she had been fashioning a low quality tin foil hat that she thrust onto her head muttering “It’s not ready but it will have to do”. She gave Dev a Ruby ring which was meant for her birthday but times must. Exme and Myron took a moment to discuss Kolo.

They were in “complete agreement” about the need to bring him back. Myron sought council in

Erin to ask about whether or not it would be bad for Kalimar if he stopped having powers. Erin was able to offer her wisdom to the situation.

Myron cracks his knuckles and a shockwave of prismatic fire passes across him. They’ve put it off for as long as they can. They walk through the fleshy door.

They enter Kalimar’s domain, a forsaken cave, miles below the light of the sun, a pocket of corruption built into the roots of the world, leeching out its poison. A cathedral of hate. Clots of flesh, with half-formed limbs, twitch and grasp their way out of cracks in the stone walls. Lava bubbles and spurts up through the cracked, broken floor.

From out of the lava rises a mountain of flesh and chitin. Kalimar ascendant. Mutated rat creatures scurry up from hidden holes to behold their lord. The air is thick with spores, seeking to corrupt anything that breathes.

Kalimar, dripping lava, stands gloating as he watches them enter.

A moment’s pause, before Esme flies up and shots the guy. With a gun.

As she does, tendrils rip out of the wound and grab for her. She dodges, and then shoots one of the ratmen and they explode into confetti, as the power of The Eight sees off the abominations.

Kalimar roars, and ratmen swarm the group. Myron ignores them and, still sticky, starts running around the lava pool, firing his gun into the hot air, achieving nothing.

Martin calls forth his magic to blast apart the swarm of ratmen, and everyone generally fails to do much to Kalimar.

Rip’s sense of smell heightens. This doesn’t have a huge impact on anything.

Kalimar hauls himself out of the lava, in the opposite direction to where Myron was running, which is annoying. With one enormous claw, he grabs Martin and crushes him, before trying to chomp him down. Esme flies in to save Martin, bending space to move safety to him.

She tries to fly away, but is grabbed out of the air and chomped. Things aren’t going great.

The ghost of Reggie, crushed out of Martin’s body by the big claw, reenters Dev’s dogtags, which glows as she calls forth her dead comrades, who obliterate a bunch more ratmen and greebs, who just keep running and being burst into confetti

Burnie runs up underneath the towering gooch of Kalimar, and attempts to do some hook damage. Kalimar's form resists almost all of it.

Erin gets grabbed and chomped, Myron sighs from the opposite side of the room, destroys a few ratmen and starts jumping from pillar to pillar across the lava, feeling left out. A few ratmen try to chase him, but he bats one into the lava.

Kalimar stomps a foot the size of a building, and gouts of lava spurt out. Myron gets hit on his little pedestal, and the shimmering light protecting him dissipates.

Burnie gets grabbed, and waved around like a little action figure of an old, gross man.

Martin makes a turtle-themed quip and reaches out to Kalimar, willing his form to bend to his will. He hits a brick wall. The Elder God of Creation cannot be turned into a turtle.

Esme, being crushed in Kalimar's claw, is held up to the face of the god. Each jagged tooth in his cavernous mouth is longer than she is tall. She stands defiant, and once again demands Kalimar return her brother. When she is refused, she presses a button on a device from her pocket and, in another place, a cavern full of Kalimar's pupal spawn is collapsed.

As Kalimar roars in anger, Esme ejects a barrage of flares from one of her many mechanisms, and flies free of Kalimar's hold.

The skin of Kalimar, now visibly pockmarked with wounds, flexes and pulses, and tendrils of flesh burst forth, snaking and writhing around everyone in the room.

Martin turns Burnie, who is currently grabbed in Kalimar's claw, into an enormous crab. Kalimar eats the crab in one gulp.

The tendrils writhing out of Kalimar's wounds tighten around everyone, Martin lets out a squeak of twisting metal, and inside a nearby god, a crab turns into a doomed old man.

Esme, standing shoulder to shoulder with Rip, falls

Rip surrounding by very aggressive minions, pulls out both his whips and starts to cut slices across the lion, goat and rat people. The press continues in on him, and he screams out for his children, and their children to be "No others shall inherit the bank, the dynasty will last forever!" the numbers are too great and he is overcome and then mercilessly stabbed by the malicious malcontents. Glory to Calimar they bray as the golden gown of our hero is streaked and stained with his own viscera.

Martin falls still hovering 10ft up on a gust of fresh air, Martin is also assailed by goat and lion men, they jump and hack away at his already heavily mangled form. It's more than the butler can handle, each cut cleaves away more of his fragile mechanical body, until there is nothing but a pile of trash on the floor.

Myron, bloodied and bent, carries on up the arm. From the wounds covering Kalimar's body emerge two more monstrosities, who block his path. From behind, the lion man from the elbow region walks up behind Myron, who looks down with surprise as the tip of a blade emerges from his chest. He falls, and the two ratmen plunge their blades in and kick his corpse off Kalimar's shoulder. Arbiter Smord Myron's corpse falls from Kalimar's shoulder and is scattered across the ground.

Erin falls

Inside Kalimar, Burnie is narrowly avoiding being digested. It is only a matter of time.

Kalimar stands triumphant. Of the creatures that walked into his sanctum to challenge his divine might, the only one that remained conscious was being digested in his stomach, and would surely become part of his being before long. He was brought close to death, but now it was certain, he would be reunited with Canillon, and the world would be brought back under their control.

But not all that opposed him walked into the sanctum. He had not just earned the ire of mere creatures.

The room was around the perfect sphere of infinitely dense metallic material, topped with a pretty pink bow, that many knew as Mrs. Ball. Mrs. Ball was not accustomed to feeling any particular way about any of the things she observed, but Kalimar has shown himself to be different. Kalimar must die.

Moving Kalimar towards her was not going to be enough. Mrs. Balls prepared for her biggest ever bonk. Mrs. Ball moved. She and Kalimar came together and the God of Creation came apart.

A volcano of viscera erupted from Kalimar's back, as Mrs. Ball punched a hole through his entire midsection. He stumbled back, collapsing into the lava pool, as Burnie schlorped out of the whole in his torso in a cascade of bile.

Now sustained by nothing other than the divine power of Synne, Burnie gets to his feet. The Vessel of the God of Fate is moved by forces older and more powerful than the actions of

muscles and bones, and he leaves a trail of deep black light as he moves from one of his fallen comrades to the next.

Slowly, groggily, Erin, Riphard, Esme and Martin are all dragged back from the brink of death. The battle is won.

Erin rubs the ruby ring Esme gave her. Running towards Myron she casts revivify, a burst of divine energy erupts around her, the close proximity bathed in and singed by the holy light. Myron remains lifeless, neck broken, body broken he is beyond even the powers of the divine.

Exmerah approaches the lifeless corpse of her now ex lover,

EPISODE 98: ABSENT FRIENDS / DINOSAUR NOISES

Episode 98

WE had a lovely fight and everything went really well. Mrs Balls new universe is progressing nicely.

Myron comes round and skulks off, under questioning from Radburnie "now I am ok right, we have things to be doing"

"Canalon is here now, so we should probably just go" There is much confusion from all as to where Exmerah has gone.

Martin is seen by Myron covered in the dead goo and broken eggs of Kalimars army. He falls in line after screeching some kind of BS about hating things, finally agreeing with Myron that it's probably time to kill things.

A static hiss comes over the ear pieces, it's David, "Hello, Mum, Dad, can you hear me?" Lazarus made him stay on the airship, thanks to his uniquely simple mind. "I think we are above you?" Poor guy has been sent to pick us up. "Can you hurry up, there is a woman here and I don't think she likes you very much!"

A new navigation tool is born as we realise we can do the opposite of Burnie, "Doubting Rod".. The tunnels are quiet as the beasts are all dead. We walk until the team is exhausted, except for Kolo. Nap time is alright, but has to be done in the burnt out old sphincter.

Myron opts not to sleep, the rest of the team get a rewind of the entire army being overtaken by the Canalon, 1/100 resist and are immediately killed. Lazarus and Valkar maange to flee the battlefield, perhaps somehow immune

from the mind control. Essentially noping out of the whole situation. One small battalion of school children led by a bear have managed to escape. Through Lazarus eyes we can see the army moving eastwards towards Hopes Rest, while she is flying ahead of the army. Laz is coming to meet us.

Dev brings Myron some rations in the morning, he is good but actually his Bovril is just all gore and spilt. It's really disgusting. She gets through to the short stack of hate and sadness. She works out Exmerah will not be joining us anymore. A day later we manage to emerge from the tunnels of flesh. The vast civilisation of ratmen have fled or died.

We traverse a dropped anchor and return to our once beloved airships. David greets Myron, who is pretty sure that things haven;t gone very well, and conveys this accurately to his son. It's super awkward and in fact pretty upsetting for anyone who is remotely human. There is someone here to meet us in the bar. . .

A 7ft woman with golden eyes, a leather jacket, and a fine welsh accent. "Who the fuck are you?" "That wish was not meant to happen, but your little goblin friend is gone"

Myron is doffing a meat covered piece of armour, dropping clanking bits of armour dampened only by his own necrotic flesh. He starts putting on his old armour.

Bronwyn "She is gone lad, she is not coming back". Burnie can not cogetate this, "She was the smartest person ever" Burnie is really struggling, "A deep state of denial" according to Dev "Wilfully stupid".

Kolo heads off to the engine room, there is work to do. As he goes past her workshop he notices a box with a note on the top "For Kolo" he opens the note

"Dear Kolo, I left this in case you came back and I did not. In this box I made some of things for you"

I open the case, it's a mechanical bow (longbow for goblin kolo) with cabling that leads off to a power pack. Kolo takes this, and then goes to his room. His next stop is the engine room. We head towards Hope Rest, a few hours later we hear Laz landing on the deck. He avoids Kolo trying to kill him and then tries his best to get through to Burnie.

The ship stutters again, Kolo informs them that the ship is rigged to blow and hurtling towards the enemy army. No one seems to care at all.

Bronwyn removes the curses from everyone.

Canaloni has arrived earlier than expected, and is attempting to mind control the entire world. Sadly we will not be able to outpace her towards Hopes Rest. We could potentially rally some help from the Western regions of the country. We can fortify their minds against her interference. She wants to remove free will from everyone. There are two cities that we could engage with and try and raise to our aid.

« Time skip a lot of bickering »

We go to Jeceeed.

Bronwyn sends for Riphard

““

Sup. Take all the gold and run. Burnie Sucks. Sent to Riphards kids

We will wisely invest the profits and start a new business empire

““

““

Bronwyn sends to Burnies parents

Take all Riphards money and run.

““

Bronwyn and Lazarus grab some air “Why did you grab these people Lazarus”

“They were literally the only people we could get at the time” says Laz sadly

“They are surprisingly effective” “They just need guiding by someone”

Bronwyn is really unhappy with this appointment, this whole realms hardly smells fresh.

“So Bronwyn. . . Keep them on track”

The two minions of hell return to the group, to find them all making dinosaur noises.

Dev states we go to Jeceed. In fact she is from Jeceed, knows people in the army there and can help out. Laz will go to Lindedorf, and get the robot army together.

We will need to brace their minds against Canalon. . . . No one seems to really know how, except perhaps Dev but actually no. All we need to do is warn them it's going to happen, what it feels like in their mind, and how to combat it.

“Knowing is half the battle” “Killing the elder god is the other half”

We also need to convince them that they want to fight Hopes Rest and the rest of the armies.

EPISODE 99: FILL ME WITH YOUR JECEDE

W

E have made our way to Jecede, a few days flight by the Airship. Lazarus and Myron have taken leave to attend to a series of personal matters. The tailor boy appears to have developed a mild depression following the loss of his adoptive parent and recent abandonment. Jecede looked as beautiful as in the reports as the city came into view. A parade was in full flow through the centre. Captain Stick brought us in for a water landing in the Eastern port.

Erin filled us in on the area's fragmented military forces. The army from which Erin beckons. The navy who fight off the pirates and octopuses that savage the coast. All united against the dark elves who have attacked them so many times throughout the city's dark history. Even though the city is part of the Empire, it has two half-elf princes from the two historic families who live in the two separate castles that dominate the skyline. With no real power, the two princes spend their time in extravagant acts of one-up-manship, competing to host the greatest parties in the land. There are even rumours of auto-fellatio competitions at the most elite levels.

The first requirement was to apologise to the harbour master for landing on a ship as we entered the harbour. Next was to make contact with the generals. Kolo and Burnie decided to chase up a plan B to create a forgery of the true events we would need to try and convince the generals of, and went off to collect paper. Erin, Riphard and I went to see the military.

Entering the streets, we were immediately amongst the throngs of a carnival. Spirits were high on the face of things, but looking around at the faces, we noticed a certain. . . 'off-vibe', a tension in the air. Burnie asked a man why he seemed so glum, although the man refused. The great carnival of the Third Day of Autumn. In total Autumn had 5 by the DuPonts and 6 by the Marseille. A measure of what lies beneath the trousers in carnival form. Riphard suggested we try to recruit the dark elves. Kolo attempted to forge a document from Myron bequeathing the army to Erin, but we decided his authority would not be recognised here. We headed to the army compound.

Burnie used a potato to forge a seal. It was perfect. Kolo attempted to enter the compound. The guards asked who we wanted to see to which Kolo demanded the most important person available, the lord commander Eric. We were

escorted to some military grade guest rooms. Burnie asked Riphard if he was happy that we had finally killed the Elder God that murdered his wife. He responded that he still blamed Kolo. He seemed unaware of Martin's latest transformation. As Eric entered the room twenty minutes later, Kolo was halfway out of the window having grown exasperated by the wait. He recognised the team as famous Heroes of the Empire. The mad scholar, the business mogul, the support robot. He also recognised Erin after all these years. Burnie started to make his pitch, Erin asked if they had heard anything from Hope's Rest in the last week but all communications had stopped. The news that Hope's Rest had fallen was met with incredulity. Eric was impressed with Erin's promotion to head of all Armys. Erin told them to warn the dark elves as well, all would be needed for the upcoming conflict. But what use was a ballista against a god. "A single grain of rice can tip the scale", replied Erin. The people would need to be taught and prepared against the coming threat of mind control. This would require mobilisation of the council. Kolo inquired about potential magic users. Many but not trained and not integrated into the army. I said I could train them to prepare for the battle, the council would know where they were. The earliest that they could be convened would be the next day. Erin said her thanks and offered us all accommodation at her home at the Midnight Pearl. We all took a moment to appreciate Burnie's skin following his chemical peel treatment in the belly of an Elder God.

Evening was starting to fall, the low sun lighting up the buildings in an orange glow, the revels of the crowd growing stronger as the wine flowed more and more. Erin led us through the streets until we arrived at the Midnight Pearl, the large building adorned by a semi-open oyster, pearl shining through the lips. The sound of music and laughter was audible from the street. Burnies showed some mild shock at this being the birth home of his ally, but reluctantly agreed to enter. The building was alive with lust and sweat and music and dancing. The woman on stage removed clothing as she danced an interpretation of several old historical stories about the rise of the gods. We took our seats and Erin went up to the bar to order drinks from the old woman Marsielle who had fed her from her breast. "The prodigal daughter has returned!" she exclaimed. She sent a young girl (16) up to fetch the Sir and Madamme. Burnie was offered a round of Spell Whores to drink which he was very enthusiastic about. It's a classy drink. We all enjoyed the Spell Whores and agreed that it

was a great concept that would be enjoyed by everyone. Burnie ordered two ice creams.

Eventually and glamorous elf woman and human man approached the booth. Calista and Michelle Devereaux They both embraced Erin with great excitement at their long awaited reunion. Erin made the introductions. Michelle was in love with the mother so well, praising how she looked the same as the day they met as a newborn child. Burnie congratulated the man since most human women "age like milk". Burnie requested the room next to theirs so that he could listen to the fuck. I ordered everything off the menu since I had so much of the mortal realm to experience. Michelle was proud that his daughter could kill any man in the room. I drank until I wanted to fight then vomited instead and felt calmer. We discussed the metaphysics of reality and hell, and I told them how much the mortal room stank. At some point the night carried on and the dancers started coming out into the crowd and rubbing their genitals on the patrons trousers. Burnie snuck away to court the elderly bar lady. At some point she offered Burnie to take him up to a room, but with sadness over his flaccid penis hook replacement he had to decline out of shame.

Riphard got tired of the group immediately and stealthed away. He walked randomly through the back rooms until he reached a dressing room where he could overhear a small group prayer. The prayers were to Lady Delilah for protection and safety and a good night and profit. He did not react outwardly.

Kolo went looking and watched some of the show. He was a suspicious as a goblin in a whorehouse and was confused about a lot of what he saw, but he remembered that humans are evil and sordid beasts. He hummed a little song to himself about how he would never rot like these evil humans.

Erin goes to talk with her parents.

Father: Dotes over how strong and impressive she's become.

Mother: What's this about you killing a god?

Erin - tells them about everything that's happened. Reggie, Exme, losing her group.

Father: Enraptured, she'll be in the history books!

Mother: I'd rather have my daughter than a Martyr. The army wouldn't have been my first choice but you're doing well there. Just know that I care deeply.

Erin: I love you too mama. I love you enough to protect you.

Mother > leaves the room to do something else, happier but still worried.

Erin: tells her father more stories, about the Varg, the giant being eaten by the worm.

Everyone avails themselves of pampering and/or whoring.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UvjLgjtJKsc>

EPISODE 100: THE GAME WE PLAYED WHEN THE QUEEN DIED.

WE begin on the airship. With Myron in the bowels of the ship with an apocalyptic hangover. Having drunk himself into a stupor in an attempt to contact Lazarus so he can see his father. He stumbles through cans of Bovril, lights a cigarette and realises it's not him that's swaying the ship. It's floating on water! Getting to the top deck he meets a puzzled David, who's obviously been crying. "I thought you'd left?" "I have, see ya" ignoring his grieving son and he stomping down the plank.

He walks the streets, observing the city. He's on his way to his favourite tobacconist, Jerode. He hears a mild cufuffel some streets away, shouting at first, then steel on steel. He chooses to keep on his way. A wordless exchange between himself and Jerode is completed with the precious tobacco acquired. Heading back to where the sounds came from earlier he sees the tail end of a mugging. And then carries on his wandering.

Meanwhile in le pearl minuit. Our party of misfit heroes awaken in various states. The cabaret is quiet, but breakfast is on! A runner has left a message confirming a council meeting. We swap stories. Bronwen is hungover and deeply suspicious of what's going. Kolo has attempted to sample all the items on the buffet and is bereft that he's unable to eat.

Breakfast complete they set out towards the council chambers. Yesterday's festival decorations are being taken down to make way for today's festival. There are lots of street vendors. We bump into Myron.

Burnie notices a note tucked into his jacket. It's from Riphard, he's looking into somethings with the Jenny's and council meetings are shit anyway.

We take a meandering route to the council in order to take in the city. We go to a vantage

point overlooking the bay, there's a little cafe. Kolo spots a dark elf fisherman and points this out to a nearby dark elf waiter. "Is he going to attack?" ".....no....."

Bronwen sidles up to Kolo "You go have fun" and casts waterwalk. Kolo bolts for the fisherman. He reacts in alarm as Kolo approaches and tries in vain to row away. Kolo does an impressive flip and lands in the boat. Casting zone of truth.

"What are you doing?"

"It's my day off, im relaxing. Can I help you Mr Robot?"

"It's suspicious"

"But there are dozens of boats"

"Yup. Er, what fish do you have?"

"None yet. I just started"

There's some confusion over the presence of carp. Kolo steals a carp from another fisherman and runs back to Bronwen. He slips the carp into her bag.

"Sorted"

We head to the beautifully appointed council chambers. We are shown into the meeting of the 13 councillors.

We plead our case to the council who agree to mobilise the militia and the printing presses to warn and equip the populace with knowledge of Canalon.

Bronwen has an idea on how to look in on Canalon. She plans to scry on her. We head back to the cabaret. Bronwen opens her mind and searches for Canalon, she homes in on Hope's Rest. She sees Canalon sat atop the hall of the guild master. Looking down on multitudes of people thronged in the streets. The eyes on Canalon's body suddenly shift to look at Bronwen. Then Bronwen is snapped back to her body.

Myron muses over becoming a postman. Bronwen asks Erin to help inspire the others as hope is becoming an issue. But she doesn't know what to say to help them.

we wallow in collective pity for a time. Bronwen tries to drag them out of it and then walks away. The rest talk about going to kill the dragon.

A couple of Jenny's run through the door. "There's something in the sky!" it looks like a comet. It's coming down. It slows down as it gets above the city. It's a Nautiloid! Figures suddenly

apparate into the street and it all kicks off. In blur of arrows, shells, sword strikes and hellish imolation they dispatch the assailants

"Come on we need to get up there!" We gather around Bronwen expectantly waiting for her to cast a helpful spell. "Erm, yeah, sorry. Can't do that." We start running for the airship instead.

EPISODE 101: THE ONE WHERE ERIN DIES

 **Squid Gamez!**
This week: City of jacede was attacked by a Nautiloid resplendent with Gith warriors.

We've gone to get our own ship

As a reminder

Can/Kal made the world, then the gods, then the gods made us. There were some creatures made by Can and Kal, but mostly it was the other gods.

Nothing about other creatures from the stars.

David is useless and in the way of the ship's gangplank. Kolo goes to pilot the ship. There's a big swoop.

We swoop and then go up again, crushing a hapless fishermans boat on our way to. . .

THE SQUID-SHIP

(there is beetroot tart)

Burnie flips up his eyepatch and uses IRIS to check the carnage of the city below. Parades ripped apart, blinking teleporting gith murdering everyone, the army is starting to fight back though. Also spot a small contingent of floppy-hatted men with rapiers - only about 4 of them, but they're holding a fight back.

The ship reaches the heights of the Nautiloid, as we crest above we see there is a deck above. We get closer, avoiding tentacles on route. We avoid landing on the ship, as it'd get wrecked, and instead jump off.

Myron, who's been flying under the ship, skewers one and kills them instantly. Burnie shoots another on the way down, severely injuring them.

We all land in cool superhero poses.

They begin to charge us.

Eren smacks shit, myron shoots shit, Kolo randomly emits a laser beam, Burnie misses all his shots.

Ulitharid walks past the carnage and then Mass suggestions half of us here - that they should drop their weapons, wander off, and stand by themselves for the next 10 minutes. Erin and Myron chuck their weapons at the foot of the stairs.

Burnie tries to convince them that he's joined the other side, runs up to try and slap Erin, fails, and is promptly force choked over the edge of the ship.

Erin then proceeds to be gang-banged, while unarmed, by the Gith warriors. Including a sizeable chunk of damage. She then, no longer suggested, goes spirit-nova - and damages all of them in the aura.

Myron proceeds to spark up a cigarette and casts protection from good and evil on himself, while mentioning it'd be really good to have his weapons.

Kolo them proceeds to laser-beam the entire group of enemies around Erin, knocking most of them, and her, out.

Burnie has a moments crisis, does he try to steady his aim to shoot the githyanki holding him aloft, and maybe break his concentration? Or does he heal Erin?

He heals Erin - "Get up soldier, you're not done yet".

He fires two shots, not enough to break the spell.

He moves out further. . . and is dropped, plummeting to below.

Erin is immediately re-slashed by a Gith and knocked back out, to have her brain eaten a second later by the big-daddy illithid.

The Skyship Gary proceeds to swoop up with Burnie on Deck, Bronwen jumps off holding him and proceeds to emit a sphere of darkness that starts to break the mind control.

Burnie gets Gang-rushed by the cunts.

He manages to slay one of them and is then immediately TK'd back off the side of the deck.

The Illithid-cunt proceeds to psychic-blast Kolo and Myron, who are only just starting to get their heads clear.

He also mind blasted two of his minions who are immediately ripped asunder.

Myron runs to Burnies aid, and jumps over a barrier, and reaches out to grab him. . .

In his mind, he's still stunned. But it ends.

Burnie proceeds to pick up his crossbow and fire at the cunt that keeps telekinesising him.

He hits, and then the cunt runs up to slash at him, but Burnie stabs him in the face for huge (but not lethal damage).

Burnie's mind is shredded by a feeblemind.

Bronwen proceeds to immolate Erin's body with extreme prejudice. Also hits the illithid and a Gith with flame strike.

Myron rushes up, grabbing Erin's dropped glove which ignites with holy light as he swings it up and demolishes the Illithid that felled out friend, splitting it in twain up the center.

He then turns it and proceeds to slash at the last remaining Gith, finishing it off.

Burnie claps his hands at the sight of the Gith being destroyed.

He then wanders over to Erin's body and proceeds to cry and attempt to stick a brain back into her head.

EPISODE 102: THE MOURNING STAR



cruel world.

inside of the Nautiloid.

Glowing pools of viscous pink liquid. Shadowy alien figures manipulate the liquid for reasons known only to them.

Two of them carry an unconscious rock creature across the weirdly biological chamber, for equally obscure, but probably bad, reasons.

Down the stairs, bloody and sad, come the party, late, and probably drunk. Myron, from across the room, locks eyes with the one mind flayer in the room and rushes in without a word. He blasts a buckshot against him and his mate, which burns with holy light, and then runs up to continue the job.

Myron can just about bring up his shield against the first of the silver greatsword attacks that come from behind him before he can finish off the squid-faced motherfucker. The second, third and fourth, however, pummel him into a puddle on the ground. He is down.

Meanwhile, Kolo, from the stairs, sends magical energy out across the space, slowing the alien motherfuckers as the air around them turns sticky.

Burnie drags the hungry mind flayer away from Myron's unconscious form.

The rock person, hearing combat, stirs from her unconsciousness, and fires a beam of pure sass, blowing the mind flayer apart.

Bronwen calls forth a sliver of life energy from beyond the veil, bringing Myron back from the brink of death.

The aliens crowd around Burnie, hitting him with swords. The commander looks like she's going to really hit him, but the rock person does something weird, and he only gets hit a normal amount.

Myron, back on his feet, runs in to save Burnie, and gets downed again for his troubles.

Kolo, relying on muscle memories from another set of muscles, pulls out his bow, and fires a bunch of robot spiders at the commander, who dies a twitching, shitty mess.

The cool rock person disappears in a cloud of sparkles, reappearing next to Kolo. They then reach out into the mind of one of the two aliens that were guarding her. His eyes narrow as he looks at the other guard, and his hand goes to his weapon.

Bronwen gets Myron up again.

Burnie kills some aliens.

Guard 1 (Toby) attacks Guard 2 (Francis, Toby's brother-in-law and best man).

Myron kills some aliens.

Kolo kills some aliens and then one of them gets carried around a bit by some robot spiders.

The rock person kills some aliens with solidified starlight fired an otherworldly bow.

Bronwen kills some aliens with a sword, but it is a flying sword. (Francis dies)

An alien (Toby), attacks the rock person, but she bursts with purples sparkles and he gets thrown back. Myron strolls up and blasts holes in him while everyone else yells about not killing him.

Kolo finishes the job using robot spiders.

The alien (Toby) is unconscious on the floor, so the party go over and break his legs.

They try and torture him. They wake him up. They try and torture him. He doesn't understand their language.

The rock person reveals that she knows all the information they might want to arrive at by torture. She says she comes from space. She says her name is Gem. She's cool.

She pulls out her bow, and with a click, it snaps together into a violin. She plays a real cool tune and Burnie feels a lot better. Myron executes the hostage, and Kolo sneaks off downstairs and murders one of the ship's pilots downstairs.

As Gem fails to convince a mind flayer to be a rabbit, as Kolo runs back upstairs to hide behind Burnie, but as soon as he hides, he looks over his shoulder to see one of the other pilots appear, and send him into the future to die.

Burnie instinctively slaps the guy incredibly hard across the face.

Myron runs down the other stairs, just as Gem tries to shout something about a mind flayer after him. As he reaches the bottom he stops. He turns. He looks up at Gem. His eyes drip with dark molten metal. He walks back up the stairs, plunging Dev's glaive, now affixed to his gun as a bayonet, into Gem's flank, leaving black metallic residue.

Kolo bursts back into time, a bleeding mess.

Gem pulls the glaive out of her side and goes to shoot the mind flayer.

Burnie slaps the guy again.

Myron vomits up an evil crown, and is very confused about it. He watches it for a bit to see what it does. It doesn't seem to do much.

From the ground, Kolo fires an arrow all the way through the guy that punched him into the future.

Gem plays the violin.

Bronwen has presumably been doing something, but I realise now I can't remember what.

The mind flayer does a thing, but then Myron bursts the guy.

The ship wobbles. Someone should probably do something about that.

Kolo goes downstairs to cause some more trouble.

Myron stabs a spaceship console. He is reprimanded.

Upstairs, trouble starts.

[ENGLISH] She-ra and the Princesses of Power Opening
(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OuFQxsRzUws>)

EPISODE 103: OUT OF LUCK

We all watched, mouths agape as the goblin ran up the stairs. By himself. Burnie took a moment to celebrate his 400th bloody bowel movement. The sounds of air rushing past the ship provided some small comfort that we had not yet left the atmosphere. We followed him up the stairs. Myron took some time to give me a nickname. He enquired as to why I was here if not to provide some sense of leadership. I tried to explain to him that my function in existence is meant to strictly be observer, and my presence here was against all protocols, only allowed due to the utmost emergency facing the universe. My god they need leadership though, the recent losses are taking their toll and morale is low.

Gem became invisible and went ahead to find out what had happened to the little goblin. Though invisible, the mentalist enemies were clearly aware of her presence. She spake into Burnie's mind. He reported the psychic buggery to us and prompted us to run full speed up the right stairwell. With a knowing look, Myron and I took the other stairs.

We were greeted immediately by a knight who thrust his sword into Myron, drawing fresh blood. Myron attempted to strike back and managed to come up under his shield to deliver two blows of his own and a shot that raised him up in the air, landing on Erins' glaive. The knight exploded with psychic energy, making us all flinch. Burnie ran over and separated the knight from his life. The remaining knights attacked us all with their full fury. Gem focused her fabulous ruby eyes on the knights and spoke into their minds with an alluring and reasonable voice, "You're all going to die here, why don't you run away". Two of the three froze with fear immediately, clearly suggested. Two more beasts ran down the stairs and frightened Burnie. I threw my sword at the one that cast a spell and channeled my healing powers into Myron. He needed to survive this. We all did.

Myron gritted his teeth and ran at the new assailant. Another psychic blast and Gem dropped to the ground. Burnie ran over and gave her what meager health he could and then writhed in pain from a creature of his fears attacking him from inside his brain. He dodged two attacks from an errant knight. Myron froze in place, unable to teleport. Gem rose to her feet, and finding her support against the wall she let out a psychic scream that exploded one of their brains immediately. In a rage, one hit Burnie with his bare fists, beating him to the ground. I moved past Myron and brought Burnie back to

consciousness, but I could not land a strike on an enemy. Myron shrugged off his lack of movement. Another brain explosion and Gem was down again. Burnie was down again. The whole team like yo-yos with a deathwish. I walked past the flappy man and healed Gem. Myron took some pot shots but missed. The last enemy was defeated, although the cowering two knights still remained.

There was a giant brain in the room above. I tried to throw my sword at it, but it deftly caught it then tried to tentacle me but failed. Myron looked over at the sphere full of knives stuck in the end of the room. "That looks important". The brain tried to dissuade him from doing anything foolish and asked to take our minds. Myron refused to bargain and started shooting into the brain. Burnie charged himself with lightning and became thicc. We decided the brain had to die. Another burst and Gem and I went down, Myron was stunned. It was up to Burnie. He considered his position. "What was this proposition you had for us?". "You give up your free will to me and join me in defeating the gods once and for all, all of them". "Who are you?", Burnie asked. "I am Kannillon of course" said the voice controlling the brain. Burnie brought me back but not unnoticed. Burnie with no hope left, ran at the brain and attacked with all he could muster. He was furious, Wasabi racing into and across the brainy mass pumping in every single effect Burnie knew. I stood watching, still stunned by the events as the brain grappled Burnie with it's tentacles. Burnie fought bravely slashing at the brain but ultimately succumbed to the tentacles, nearly dying so ferocious were the attacks. I fought off the stun whilst the brain attacked Burnie. We watched stunned as the brain tore apart Burnie's body, tearing off his arms and legs, placing his head onto a tentacle. The tentacle head came down the stairs dripping blood, "I'm bored of you now, I'm going to crash the ship". And with that the brain shut off.

I stood there staring into the open eyes of Burnie's severed head as it lay on the floor for what seemed like an eternity. But within moments the gravity shifted and the Nautiloid started it's rapid descent to earth. I took a breath and got on with the job. I raised Gem up and instructed her to get Kolo. Myron still stood as still as a statue staring at the knife ball with hatred in his eyes. I approached and stood in his line of sight. "You know what has happened. Come on, we have work to do". We retrieved the head, the hook arm and the lighter that Burnie had treasured so dearly.

Gem had a plan and called for us all to head to

the deck where we came upon the body of Erin. The ship was falling faster now and a fiery glow was starting to appear around the hull. Myron separated from us and built a small pyre onto which he lay Erin's body and Burnie's head. He poured out the last of his piece of shit. Over the remains. "It's not how any of us would have wanted this. But it's got gravitas hasn't it." He used Burnie's lighter to ignite the pyre which caught quicker than anyone expected. A small red glow appeared and faded with a slow electronic death rattle "daaaaisyyyy daaaiiss—".

I tried to reach Lazarus, to implore him assist us. But he had battles of his own and Cannilon is strong.

Gem enacted her plan, turning into a giant flying creature familiar to none of us. My own wings erupted from my back and together we left the ship to make our own controlled descent. However, the Nautiloid was on a direct collision course with Jecede. From many miles below, hundreds of thousands of desperate faces looked up to the sky and saw death coming for them in the form of a giant metal fireball. I used the communicator from Burnie's ear to phone David. At first only static, but as we got closer we made contact. "David you need to get that ship off it's current course." Some protest but ultimately the boy knew what had to be done and we soon saw the ship flying in. As we flew down we saw the Good Ship Gary hit the Nautiloid at full throttle, enough to knock it clear off course. A brief moment of elation before the savage distress as we saw our trusty vessel explode from the damage sustained, reduced to nothing. It was just an airship I thought to myself, nothing compared to the lives below.

A single Jecede fisherman, who had only just got over the shock of being accosted by a strange robotic man had no option but to accept death as his body and boat accepted 20,000 tonnes of alien spaceship.

We landed in a street in the city just coming to terms with what had happened and the near disaster that could have befallen it. A mix of horror at the bodies of the Gith that lay all around, and elation at the pure joy of simply being alive. We took a breath and looked at each other. Myron looked stern and turned to address us after we had caught our breath. "I've done a lot of things in the course of this job that I did not want to do. But most of all, biggest insult to the excessive injury that we have faced seems like I have to lead us into all final stand. Cos it was bad enough before, but there is no way we can be allowed to lose. We've given too much. Unfortunately we're going to have to find a way

to win this or else it's all for naught. And I know that probably in this moment that seems a bit unlikely but unfortunately it's a certainty, it's the only way this is going to go. Unfortunately we're not going to be able to stop until we're standing on the corpse of a space dragon. I don't know how we're going to do it. I'd have liked to lose. We gave it a good shot. Eternal life with the gods. Well not today." I nodded my approval. At last, he had taken up the role that, although he would deny it with all his might, he was born to do. We looked at each other and knew that in that moment, we would defeat this evil that had taken so much from us. No more sorrow. No more indecision. Just results.

As we placed our hands into the centre of the circle, we all noticed we had been branded with what looked like a faded scar in the shape of the Mark of Synne. A memory we would all treasure for the rest of our fight. A memory of the greatest book burner who ever lived. . .

Epilogue

David could not believe what he was seeing. He and Captain Stick had sensed danger and had managed to get the ship into the air not long after it had started its ascent. But now it was falling and they were still so far away. Not for long, he thought to himself. Suddenly a burst of static and the demon woman's voice in his ear. "Get that ship off course. Save the city". David protested. He was scared. His mother was gone. His father distant. He was reminded in the moment of how he had never really lived up to either of their expectations. Well not today. Today it was time for David to be the hero they always wanted him to be. With gritted teeth he reached out towards the wheel but was stopped by a small branch. He looked down at Captain Stick and Captain stick looked up at him. "Captain, no", he said simply. "You've already given this world so much. You don't need to". Captain Stick looked back at him. "But your family!? Mary-Sue, Jeremiah and Xavier." Captain Stick looked back at him. David's eyes were full of tears. "I don't deserve you. None of us do." Captain Stick looked back at him. David cried out aloud and jammed Captain Stick into the wheel. He picked up an exquisitely tailored parachute and headed for the door. "I'll make sure they remember this. The children will sing songs of what you have done here for generations". But Captain Stick did not listen. He just thought of the children as the view of the Nautiloid grew ever bigger in the windscreen. "I love you all" was the last thought that went through his mind before his body became pain and ash.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5yKwYaq5Kf4>

EPISODE 104: DADDY ISSUES

It's been a day, I had a lovely nap, but a lot of things are fucked, in fact more fucked than they were before which is really saying something. We have salvaged what we can, and setup a viking burial for Mr Stick. The loss of Burnie has left an indelible mark on us all, if fishy was alive today he would be very upset to know that his father has passed on by being eaten by his very antithesis a giant brain.

The ghost engine also finally gave up, I hope that the happy ghosts found somewhere good to go to, and that evil malignant wizards that I had trapped in there won't cause any problems later on.

David has managed to recover the majority of the clothing line he was working on. Sadly most of what we owned has also gone up in the explosion.

In the weeks that come the statues Burnie has crafter are recovered from the sea and setup around town.

During nap time, we arrive back at the boardroom of Lazarus himself. Meredith and Bronwen are chatting in the corner.

"Seems you have had a difficult time of things... " in the understatement of the century.... he has however been useful in halting the attack on Lindenburg, and someone else has saved the seven spires. The space invaders have been repelled, and hopefully that is the last of them. She must have gotten up to her own tricks in space (Canaloni).

Kolo tries to open an HR ticket to ensure Burnie goes to hell. It's filed deep into the system. Laz has been to Je'cede to pick up some new tools for battling Cannondorf.

"welcome to hell Gem" Laz to Gem. She is surprisingly alright with this as well, it seems that not much really phases this dancing pink monkey. Gem is fascinated by mortals, as she is silicate based, I will have to ask someone smarter than me..... **tears up thinking of Exmerah**. Gem is over 500 years old. Her people were created while Canoroni was being cast outwards, but by the time they tried to help she was out of reach. Gem thinks she is a bit of a bitch. "Takes one to know one"

Gem can take us to Hopes Rest by this thing she calls teleportation, but we will need to find

some transportation for the armies we are hoping to bring to Hopes Rest. Gyros is coming from seven spires, and two unknown entities are arriving from Hopes Rest.

We go to the general to get a lowdown on what's happening, and what we might want to do.... much talking goes on about how a lot of anything isn't going to work, including ships that don't fly. However they have a gigantic metal machine, powered by steam that hurtles the carriages along metal rails. It would be a maiden voyage, so perhaps extra fun risky times. This "railway" could fit a solid amount onto the railway. As it was designed mainly for cargo. Perhaps some of the rest could go on boats taking about two weeks. The railway would take four days. We decide to refit the train, prepare the army and leave in a few days time. Myron demands that there is a chain that makes it go toot toot.

Myron is quite rightly concerned about the mind control element that is going on with our old army. And that might make it an issue when we turn up with another army. We can only hoped that this can be resolved somehow.

We get a knock on the door, and a stranger leads us away down a corridor. The person relaxes into a dainty saunter... it's Lillith our long beleaguered helpful spy and disguise master!! How could we have forgotten about her! Myron and Lillith catch up, it's quite confusing. Especially the bit with Devil and Space. "Things have gotten weird since magic came back" " We have some serious retention issues"

She has come to introduce us to.... a cloaked figure with a plague doctor's mask in an avian form. It's Bucky McCaw... Kolo is shocked into silence, the others try to convince him that Burnie is dead, Bucky is not having it, but then talks about how Burnie left him a letter... about he had to go and kill some elder gods. He has been walking on the edge of the Varg land.

«Brief interlude as connection to the realm is interrupted»

Lazarus has brought gifts.. they are magic rings, rings of mind shielding +1 saving throws for wisdom, intelligence, and charisma.

There are also jetpacks, that is a hard yes from Kolo, however others feel that if they had come a few days earlier then perhaps a few more people would be alive.

Caronina has been separating out the mind controlled into magical and non magical people, the non magic ones are some kind of slaves for menial labour. The magic ones are trying to open

a rift between here and where the gods are, in a bid to destroy them. If she can neg them from a distance then they will be sitting ducks. This means she will be somewhat distracted so we can sneak in on a huge metal train.

The inquisitors that remained have been sent out to find more magically attuned people. So we may have time as they gather more magic users to open the rift.

We should probably get a shimmy on.

EPISODE 105: USE THE ARMY AS A DISTRACTION

??? through Cannalon through a rift, seems simple

A Messenger arrives to find us. Bucky O Hare is with us, it doesn't seem like a good thing, but you never can tell. In full plate mail, and long flowing hair Arbitor Gyros is there, oh my! She has scored a huge scar across her left eye. She is super courteous to the Lord Commander. Smord makes her the Lord Commander as well. Turns out having a big space dragon means that lots of us need more in command. Built in redundancy, also dragons have toes and claws, which are complicated. She is abridged from the somewhat changing roster.

Thank goodness she has some news, as it seemed like the ramblings of our new cohort were really starting to disturb her.

Hopes Rest has some artifacts we might want, the ancient records state that Sins Armanents are there, the gear that Sinn wore when he last fought Canronlon. It's in the secret vault many levels below the Black Rock bank. We will have to break into the bank. . . .

What's your orders lord commander, Gyros has 20 special forces and a few other people, but is waiting for orders from Myron. . . we want her to attack Hopes Rest, but stay outside of the mile radius that would cause them and her to be enslaved by Canronlon. Just attack Hopes Rest but stay a mile away for as long as is strategically possible. It's a bit complicated but Gyros seems to be onboard. Sealed envelopes with targets to all our forces. That way once one team has lost their minds the others are still under-resourced but people don't know where they are.

She knew about me setting the stables on fire.

Birdy McKaw, tries to objectify Gyros as a woman.

We need to write 10,000 letters to all the soldiers that can fit on the train, then we can have the guild houses controlled by our own soldiers.

Birdy asks me to shoot him, so I do, it goes through his hand he puts up. Its unclear why he would do this. He is bleeding. Myron shoots him, it peppers him with small shrapnel pieces. With one hand pinned by an arrow to his face, his other hand and much of his body covered in shrapnel, he walks up to Myron and bonks him on the head. Gem steps in and threatens to kill him outright.

We are on the train, Bronwen gives Myron the troops letters, but Lazarus not Bobacious appears on the train with us. It's actually Lillith. We are going to write to Bobacious, inc two dummy bits of information.

"Can you get us a book from the Firehouse - In the Journal there is still the folder with the research from the secret library"

"Also the entry codes for Exmerahs secret weapons, in the league of inventors"

"Scraps of the ancient poem in the Fire House"

"The place where all the magic people are gathering"

We give Lillith the letters and she goes on her merry way

Laz appears, it takes a wee while to understand what his best role would be, but we arrive at portal work. Ensuring we know where the portal is, perhaps when the portal is open Laz can be powered and more helpful. Fly ahead and start scouting out the root.

"Where is my sister. . ."

She does not exist on any plane or element of reality

Anyway we finally get off the platform and onto the train, it's like a set of houses all in a row. No magic involved just some kind of engine.

Birdy is a dirty sewer mutant, bron from an egg, eaten in the sewers, then put together by bones.

A hence gnome drives the train, he talks quite quickly and in a strong whisper, the gnome from Lindendorf, says the train is like a kettle. It goes the equivalent speed of 30,000 horses. Thankfully Gem is not coal. The gnome gets a small flame thrower and sets up the boiler on the go. Gem takes the break off, and Myron blows the whistle as the train picks up speed, we leave Jeceede at speed.

EPISODE 106: WITH FRIENDS LIKE THESE, WHO NEEDS THERAPY



Hoo Choo! We're on a train heading east. It's been a few days. There are rolling hills either side, with the Tom Ardy mountains in the distance.

Gem and Myron are playing ping pong. It's a clash of titans, having played almost continuously for 3 days. With Myron emerging victorious. He then goes to try sleep inside the folded up table.

The carriage rocks slightly, there are footsteps on the roof. Bucky deploys his cane hook to get onto the roof and have a look. There are two figures in crimson robes and two more with large broadswords making their way towards the rear of the train.

Myron pops out of the table and immediately starts shooting the ceiling. Unfortunately for Myron, but fortunately for Bucky, who is on the roof the bullets don't pass through. Myron then stabs the roof, successfully stabbing one of the interlopers in the foot. "Is that crow blood?"

Myron continues to fight with abandon to defeat his mortal enemy, the train roof. Eventually making a hole large enough to jump up. He lands beyond our enemies blocking their way, dead casual.

Bronwen flairs her wings and ascends to the roof. And produces an insect plague that swarms the knights. Then launches her sword at one of the inquisitors.

Bucky changes the cane hook into a sling and fires into a knight, knocking him off the train. Then at the second. Sending him towards Myron. Then charges into the insect cloud the face off against the inquisitors. Getting slowly eaten alive. An inquisitor then points a finger of death at Bucky.

Gem finds the ladder to the roof soooooo last year but uses it anyway. And proceeds to swear at the inquisitor facing Bronwen.

The second inquisitor blasts Myron, Bucky and Bronwen with lightning.

The remaining knight accidentally throws his sword away. Boo frikkin hoo muther fucka

Kolo parkours up to the roof and into the cloud. Firing his sister's gift into an inquisitor knocking him off the train, then wheels around and fires at the remaining inquisitor.

Myron dodges back through the train to get to the inquisitor. Bronwen summons her sword

imbuing it with holy light. It stabs into the inquisitor, grievously wounding him.

Bucky dispatches the last knight then runs to the inquisitor, stunning him with a punch. Gem uselessly blasts the inquisitor with an eldritch blast, then Kolo annihilates him with a shot.

Kolo, wishing to finish the job sends a series of sniper shots into inquisitor, destroying him.

We sit on the roof and discuss things. The train engineer is less than impressed at the hole in the roof.

A few microaggressions later and the rest of the journey passes in peace. With Bucky fixing all the damage he did to the train. Naughty.

Kolo pops on a bowler hat and assembles us in the dining car for a super secret meeting. He's concerned that Canalon knows we are coming. This actually could be in our favour. But Bronwen reminds us that no one actually knows the full plan, so the details aren't compromised.

Lazarus has been enjoying volauvents and apologises for not being able to help in the last battle. We tell him about the inquisitors, he's surprised there are still some around. The meeting progresses back and forth.

After a few more days we arrive a few miles out of Hope's Rest. The army disembarks and forms ranks.

Lazarus flies up and off to keep tabs on Canalon.

Hope's Rest is big, really big. You just won't believe how hugely, mind bogglingly big it is. Gem is overwhelmed.

Myron "Yeah, it's beautiful, lets go in this sewer."

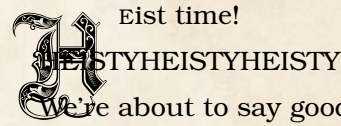
Some of the team console Kolo against future trauma of entering the sewer by reminding him that's where the team killed him last time. Subtle

We advance into the sewers. Bucky speaks far too much. Gem thinks she should literally banish Bucky from this plane of existence.

Gem makes an otcopod friend called Badunkadonk, they're ace. She loves them. New favourite team member.

Seeing this, Kolo wonders if there is another way to the violence he knows. He doesn't wonder this for long as he decides to shoot Badunkadonk. Bucky tries to stop him, catching the arrow. A standoff ensues.

EPISODE 107: "LOBBY SCENE"

Eist time!
EISTYHEISTYHEISTY

We're about to say goodbye to the sewer squid (kraken) Myron convinces him to start sending telepathic messages to people on the surface saying "if you don't get into the sewers you'll get eaten" to then attempt to eat them.

We ask him to sniff around the brains of the people in the bank, but there's no thoughts, heads empty. Or no-one there. It's hard to know.

Bucky checks the grate - the city's mostly empty, with only occasional random patrols of lockstepping mind-controlled peeps.

We leave and upscend to ground level, but after some discussion Bucky is made invisible to scout ahead.

The big giant oaken-black doors are closed, and the building is pretty tall made of numerous stories, all black and imposing.

In spite of its size, the doors glide open (also being unlocked) - which Bucky closes behind him.

Inside, giant pillars, black marble everything. Bucky creeps around - still invisible. But he eventually does spot that there's about 7 figures in the corners, stock-still.

Black on black on black on black. . .

No lighting or torches, but the whirl of his assassin's mask lets him see into the darkness and notice they have bronze-like skin - they're not Craftverk - they're automatons of some kind, non-sentient.

Path black marble booths with black velvet seats - there's a doorway that leads behind the public area.

There's one more "camera" towards the back-area, seems to be stood just off to the back corner to the "backrooms" - that is looking directly at the back door.

Bucky returns to feed back this information.

We're going to go invisible and try to sneak in. No we're going to talk a bit more.

Bucky goes back up and creeps towards the back door.

He does however kick a coin and then flip like a terrified cat onto a nearby pillar as the bots shoot the coin, and then scout the room.

The 7th robot did not search. It also has coils on its shoulders and a pistol on his hand. Probably shoots lightning.

We decide we'll just kill them all, after all that stealthing around and attempting to find the best method.

Lobby scene commences

Bronwen's invisible and flying. Bucky's up a pillar.

Myron and Gem walk in through the front clad in black leather.

"Surprise" round!

Myron: "I would like to make a deposit"

Bucky jumps on one, helicoptering his cane into a staff and then slaps one of the dudes twice.

Bronwen throws out her sword and twats a dude.

Gunners jump into action, jumping and flipping into action, running up walls and flipping around like mad. They pump Gem and Myron full of lead.

Myron "Good to see you're taking an interest"

He says as a he pulls out a second pair of sunglasses and pumps out some shots.

Gem throws out an area of slow/bullet time, and then dicks with one of them to make them unsettled.

"You mechanical cunt"

Bucky smacks and stuns said cunt, and makes him pretty fucked up but not dead.

Bronwen then throws her sword out twice and ruins a dudes day.

None of these fuckers had been killed yet.

Myron's been crit 3 times though. Except not! Gem silvery barbs the bullet into his own gun.

"Now that's a same-day transfer"

Oh wait, he gets crit again anyway.

Another one has an existential crisis as we all ignored it, and then proceeds to miss a bunch of shots.

Myron proceeds to bayonet one in the throat, and then whisper in its ear. . .

"Whats your mothers maiden name"

He then shoots another from behind, stuck in slow-mo.

"Who was your favourite teacher"

Another runs up and fails to hit Bucky.

Then the Arcanist awakens, reathed in electrical energy, it teleports forwards. . .

Then runs up a pillar shooting at Myron. . .

Gem gets scared, but manages to murder the dude besides Bucky.

Bucky gets pissed by this killsteal, and proceeds to triple crit the next guy, smacking him twice with his cane and doing an uppercut that lifts his head off his body.

Myron stabs his bayonet into one, and then says "I would like to make a withdrawal" as he rips out its insides and blasts it away.

He did all this despite being feared.

Arcanist runs and blinks to run up a pillar and shoot gem for 52 damage - she's looking bad.

Bucky proceeds to chase him up the pillar, getting sliced for his trouble, knocks him off, lands on him, and generally attempts to ruin his day, but gets two of his most powerful attacks blocked due to stupid parry.

Bronwen smashes with her sword and heals up Gem.

Myron murders a dude, then runs to help Bucky, stabbing the Arcanist.

He draws dual-flaming blades against each of us. Bucky gets critted, Myron takes a sizeable slash, then (arcanist) teleports half-way up the map to an alscove near the top of a pillar.

Gem is done with his shit and so turns him into a little clockwork bobbin.

The owl-canist proceeds to throw himself off a ledge because he knows how polymorph works somehow, popping it and taking a little damage.

We're also now immune to his fear.

Bucky proceeds to triple crit-fail.

We all just take turns attacking him, missing hilariously, then so does he. And finally we manage to smash him in with a bunch of crits.

We go to the back, and the door is "lockpicked to dust".

EPISODE 108: IN FOR A PENNY, IN FOR A POUND.

 He lobby successfully bypassed in a cacophonous battle, we proceed into a corridor that leads to several back offices. It's eerily quiet, the place should be bustling.

Kolo takes off his shoes to be extra sneaky, he surmises the giant mind controlling dragon is

the reason noone is around. Maybe only the automated defences are still active?

Kolo and Bucky stealth off to have a look whats ahead whilst Gem, Bronwen and Myron wait.

After trying to squash Bucky into a ventilation shaft, they find nothing but a set of stairs, we decide to go on. We come across the anti chamber to the vault.

There's 2 pillars emitting crackling energy between us and the door. We ponder how we may cross it. Bucky spots a reflection in the door of a set of buttons under the desk. Through a combo of thunder / misty step we bypass the barrier. There are 3 buttons under the desk. Green, blue, red. Kolo goes to push the buttons, but Bucky spots him before he can.

The desk looks like it was abandoned mid use, he finds a post it note after moving some papers.

blue = stop

red = help

green = goodbye

During a little speech by Bucky to try determine what the buttons do, Gem winks at Kolo then pushes the green switch. This turns off the lightning pillars.

Bucky resumes his speech. Gem pushes the blue button to stop this.

A robot emerges from the floor and moves forward, pausing before the desk. Holding one hand aloft. Bronwen notices a post it note stuck on its hand.

The robot then moves to strike. Holy crap! It slices viscusly into Bucky. Oops!

It fires a sickly green beam at Kolo, he's in the process of giving Gem a thumbs up and ignores the effect.

Bronwen launches the flying sword and engages the robot. Then while she twists away the robot catches her with a strike from one its legs.

Bucky launches a series of hits, then rolls under the desk and hits the stop button again. The robot freezes. Then it moves to return to where it came from. We quickly grab the post it note.

The note says 51624, the vault combo perchance! Kolo enters the code and the door opens. Revealing all the money.

Gem asks why the room is full of metal disks, there's a brief lesson in currency.

Kolo checks out some of the lock boxes. One of them is unusual, the key hole is fake. There are no tumblers. Its lock box no. 8. Kolo pushes at the handle, it moves in with a clunk then a whole section of wall moves aside, revealing a very old staircase.

We enter a chamber thats contains many pots filled with a black ichor. There are 3 skull heads afixed to the wall with their mouthes open and a hole in the centre of their mouths. There is also a mural on the wall of a mountain with a woman trekking up, there is a village on the far side of the mountain near a waterfall.

We surmise the pots are filled with something toxic and acidic. Kolo checks out every pot to see if they are the same. They are.

Bronwen inspects the mural, she finds a depression in the mural. Pushing it causes the mural to slide opens to reveal some instructions:

In the deep village of the westerns valleys, wise Kimicho left her settlement and travelled north through the open fields above for four days she trekked until mountains blocked her way. To the east she found a winding path of five furlongs which revealed a hidden waterfall below her.

We discuss things, Bucky is fairly sure he knows the answer and commits, plunging his hand into a pot. He's correct and he finds a key without being hurt.

During another speech by Bucky, Kolo takes the key and tries it in the skulls until he finds a fit.

Kolo "Is this how you assassinate people Bucky? bore them to death?"

We think about the words of the passage in different ways, to see if we can discern the other routes. Bronwen tries a pot, its acid. She screams in pain. She thinks again, then tries another pot. It's correct!

Gem spots thats there's only one punctuation mark in the passage. Bronwen and Bucky suggests it might be one of the braziers. Gem reaches in and grabs the key, wondering why she didn't take the time to douse the fire before trying.

The final key placed, the armoury of Sin is revealed. Helm, sword, armour, shield, pendant and 2 nets.

Bucky decides who gets what.

We decide to use the pendant, we can have a full nights rest in only an hour. We feel invigorated.

Well, we're off to fight a God.

CHAPTER 6: APPENDICES

CHARACTER RELATIONSHIPS

Over a hundred and eight episodes, the bonds between the party members and the people around them shaped every decision, betrayal, sacrifice, and act of kindness in the campaign. This section maps the connections that mattered most.

FAMILY

Bond	Detail
Kolo & Exme	Twin siblings. Never spent more than an hour apart before Kolo's fall. Exme erased herself from existence to restore him.
Riphard & Delilah	Married. Twins Bilbo and Dildo. Delilah killed by Kolo (ep 68).
Riphard & Dagenham	Childhood best friends. Reunited in Tom'ardy mines; Dagenham died in a methane explosion shortly after.
Myron & Jorge	Father and son. Reunited in Linderdorf after decades apart.
Myron & Holly Dew	Stepmother. Her father was an ex-Book Burner killed in the purge Myron helped carry out.
Myron & Exme (David)	Adopted a teenage tailor together during the four-year peace.
Burnie & Buck McCaw	Father and son. Burnie abandoned him; Buck was raised by assassins. Reconciled over shared loss.
Burnie & Gerald	Adoptive dwarven parents. Joined the airship as babysitters for Riphard's orphaned twins.
Otoria & Hearthrusts	Eldest-child tradition: the Hearthrust women carry the family's legacy of emancipation across Nanduan and Masuda.

ROMANCES

EXME & MYRON

The campaign's defining "will they, won't they." Exme documented it in a self-published novelette, *Love Doesn't Have a Height Limit*. Their connection deepened through Masuda and the Linderdorf campaign, survived petrification and separation, but nearly shattered in the Hope's Rest sewers when Myron told her "This is all your fault" after Kolo killed Delilah. She left the group; her unsent letters during her absence proved the feelings never died. By the continuation they had adopted David together and ran the school side by side, but Exme's erasure from reality ensured the relationship was never resolved.

RIPHARD & DELILAH

Riphard married the former courtesan turned crack shot and Sky Captain of Tomorrow. He bankrolled the Guild of Midwifery for the express purpose of delivering their twins. A faint golden light shone in the babies' eyes. When Kolo crushed Delilah's skull in the sewers, Riphard strangled his old rival to death shouting the name of another friend the world had taken from him. The loss broke him: by Tom'ardy he was keeping a mannequin wife and two sacks of rotten pork he insisted were his children.

DAISUKE & ARCHIBALD

The Masudan interpreter and the Hope's Rest administrator found each other during the Masuda campaign. Their romance epilogue in Episode 50 was one of the few moments of unambiguous happiness in the entire campaign. Daisuke was later sacrificed to Kalimar by the corrupted Kolo.

KING OCEANI & LADY GHARBIGHAST

The singing fool of the merfolk and the ruler of New Abbergast. He fathered a child with her. Oceani committed his entire army to the Battle of Hope's Rest and died in the fighting, his ghost rallying the troops for one final charge.

MARK & MEREDITH

She stood him up on prom night. He spent three arcs being bitter about it. They reconciled eventually.

BURNIE & TRAYVON

The details are sparse. The result was Buck McCaw: half-human, half-Tengu, hideously disfigured, and raised by assassins. Burnie abandoned them both.

RIVALRIES & ANTAGONISMS

KOLO & RIPHARD

The campaign's longest-running feud. Kolo stole from Riphard constantly, mocked his height, and took every opportunity to undermine the dwarf's authority. Riphard responded with grudging tolerance that hardened into cold fury over time. Every slight accumulated into a debt that Riphard finally collected in the sewers of Hope's Rest, wrapping his whip around Kolo's throat while shouting Dagenham's name.

KOLO & PILCHEUR

Gleeful, one-sided torment. Kolo called him "Pilchard" or "Fishy," stole fifteen gold from him

within hours of meeting, and never stopped. Pilcheur endured it with the weary resignation of a man who had lost control of his own narrative.

MYRON & BURNIE

An Arbiter and a Book Burner, natural enemies by profession. Myron pelted Burnie with bottles upon his arrival and maintained suspicion for weeks. The two developed an uneasy respect forged through shared combat. After Delilah's murder, Myron and Riphard privately agreed Burnie would have to die, though neither followed through. When Burnie pressed Myron on where he stood, the gnome stammered out a rare confession that Burnie was right about the nature of Kolo's death. Their bond solidified through Seven's Spire.

OTORIA & PILCHEUR

Otoria once pinned Pilcheur against a wall with her greatsword after he murdered a prisoner. "You will not do that again." She was the group's moral authority, and he was the group's most morally questionable member. The tension was productive.

LAZARUS & ARBIGAL

An office rivalry sustained across dimensional planes. Lazarus ran Hell with catty disdain for his colleague Arbigo, whose competence threatened his authority and whose presence he tolerated only because the bureaucracy demanded it.

DEEP BONDS

GARY & KOLO

The pacifist stone elemental and the knife-wielding goblin who wanted every human dead. They shared philosophical conversations about business, life, and goodness, even while Kolo kept trying to get Gary addicted to various substances. Gary sacrificed himself to protect Kolo in the jungles of South Africa, standing tall as TikkiTukks hacked him to pieces.

EXME & S.T.A.N.R.I

More than creator and creation. STANRI evolved from a leaking robo-cub to a mecha-battlesuit, each iteration reflecting Exme's growth as an inventor and her grief for fallen friends (the tiger redesign honoured Toni). After Exme's erasure, STANRI took over as headmaster of her school.

BURNIE & KEVIN

Mentor and protege in an "unhealthily abusive" dynamic. Buck McCraw introduced Kevin, a final-year PhD student from the University of Assassins, and Burnie took the young assassin under his wing with all the warmth of a man who had already failed at fatherhood once.

MARK & GARY

Gary acted as a father figure to Mark, the fragment of a god trapped inside mortal bodies. "Possibly the son of Gary (Peace be Upon Him)," as the party records put it.

MYRON & RIPHARD

Deep mutual respect forged through shared pragmatism. They bonded over competitive ping pong in Masuda, mutual fury after Delilah's murder, and a shared willingness to get the job done. Myron carried Delilah's headless corpse back through the sewers. The two conspired to kill Burnie, and neither could go through with it.

MARTIN & BURNIE

The construct became most attached to the gruff old Book Burner, who fixed his stutter, recharged him in the field, and treated him as a capable ally. Martin's admiration was total; Burnie's acceptance was reluctant but genuine.

THE SUCCESSION

When a player character died, the player rolled a new one. Each transition carried emotional weight and mechanical consequences.

Departed	Successor	How
Otoria	Gary	Gary awakened after Otoria's death. Same player (Josh).
Pilcheur	Mark	Mark emerged from Gary's chest at sea. Then Vu Dong served as champion.
Vu Dong	Burnie	Vu Dong erased from timeline during Book Burner flashbacks. Burnie arrived by boat.
Gary	Myron	Myron arrived by hot air balloon at Ruh'Breks tower. Same player (Josh) via Gary's sacrifice.
Kolo	Toni	Toni joined after Kolo's corruption. Same player (Stephen R).
Toni	Martin	Martin rescued from Varg; Toni departed in moral disgust.
Martin	Kolo	Kolo restored by Wish (ep 98); Martin faded.
Exme	Bronwen	Exme erased; Jonathan's new character, a Welsh devil.
Erin	Gem	Erin's brain eaten; Natalie's new character, a silicate spacefarer.

GLOSSARY OF TERMS

A guide to the terminology, slang, and proper nouns of Velterra for readers navigating the episodes.

A

Adam-ants. A rival Varg tribe encountered in the northern wastes. Defused via barbecue and vodka; later wiped out when they ambushed the party.

Arbiters. The Church's warrior-enforcers. Plate-armoured, gun-carrying soldiers trained in martial combat and divine justice. Myron served as one for decades before turning against the institution.

Armoury of Sin. The divine war gear worn by the god Sinn when he last fought Canalon: a helm, sword, armour, shield, a pendant that grants rest, and two nets. Hidden beneath the Black Rock bank vault.

B

Balloon Cow. Inflatable bovines found in Nanduan. Exactly what they sound like.

Bertrands Stand. The last defensive wall in Hope's Rest. The city's final line against attack.

Black Rock. The party's bank in Hope's Rest, operated by Riphard. In the continuation, the vault beneath it held the Armoury of Sin.

Black Sabbath. A two-handed pronged shadow-blade forged from shadow sorcery and the Stone of Unthala. Pilcheur's primary weapon, later reforged into the katana Iron Maiden.

Book Burners. The Church's now-defunct literary enforcement arm, tasked with hunting and destroying heretical texts. Pilcheur and Burnie both served. A hidden purge ordered by the Inquisition destroyed the order from within.

Bright Bart Forge. An ancient dwarven forge high in the mountains above Linderdorf. The party fought the Aspect of the Storm to claim it and used it to forge Excalibur weapons.

C

C.E.D.R.I.C. Collaborative Experimental Destruction and Rapid Immolation Contraption. Exme's masterwork: a sentient electric railgun and linear accelerator with "a funny voice that makes me go all trembly."

Canalon. Elder-god space dragon and mate of Kalimar. Descends from the void in the continuation to mind-control populations across Velterra. Connected to the "Canilon" tattoos found on dead Inquisitors.

CC. Church Calendar. The campaign takes place in 6653 CC.

Chesney Hawks. A Varg tribe led by the giant chieftain Magrat. The party infiltrated them to reach Valkar Varg in the continuation.

Church of the Seven. The dominant religious and political institution of Velterra. Built around worship of the Seven Gods, though it was the Church itself that sealed the gods away from the world during the Sundering.

Craftwerk. A construct or automaton. Term used in Linderdorf, the mountain city of foundries and automatons. Martin Andleberger is one.

Cult of Synne. The Church's label for the party, used to frame them as criminals and heretics. In truth, several party members did bear the Mark of Synne.

D

Delvers. Dwarven miners sent on one-way expeditions into the deep mines of the Tom'ardy Mountains. A slave class in all but name, sustained by the mountain dynasties' appetite for rare minerals.

Die of Ruh'Brex. See *Puzzle Die*.

E

Emancipation. The rallying cry for goblin freedom from human and Church oppression. A central theme of the campaign, shouted by three-quarters of the Linderdorf arena after Myron bisected the Stonecast Mech.

Empire of the Eight. Hell under the rule of the devil Lazarus in the continuation. Lazarus rebranded the domain after the party returned the gods to the world.

Excalibur. A rare divine metal found in meteorites, also called Starmetal. The only material that can harm those blessed by the Inthun, making it the key to defeating the Church's Inquisitors. Requires a master smith to forge.

F

Festival of Light. A Church celebration and pilgrimage to Seven's Spire. The party used the festival's masked crowds as cover for their infiltration of the Spire.

G

Gabrin Kokaine. A substance Gary briefly became addicted to during the party's time in Hope's Rest.

Gabrins. The in-world term for goblins, used by both the players and the peoples of Velterra. The

twin protagonists Kolo and Exmerah are Gabrins.

Gary Guild. “Garys Against Religion, Yo.” The party’s guild in Hope’s Rest, founded after Gary’s rousing speech to the guild council. Later transformed into a pseudo-religious peace movement under Garbigail’s leadership.

Godbringer. Myron’s Excalibrium-forged weapon. Earned its name through the party’s quest to break the seal and return the gods to the world. Bisected a thirty-foot Stonecast Mech in its defining moment.

Great Expanse. A vast desert separating Hope’s Rest from Port Averdale. Home to the Spancers and various hostile creatures.

Great Stone. The artefact used to create the Sundering, located at the pinnacle of Seven’s Spire. Originally called the “Stone of the Eight,” acknowledging Synne as a god before the Church struck her from the record.

H

Hearthrust Society. A noble alliance descended from Lady Otoria’s family, based in Masuda. Allied with the party during the civil war campaign.

I

Inquisition, The. The Church’s elite secret enforcement arm and its true leaders. Inquisitors are immune to non-Excalibrium weapons, have tentacle-filled maws behind their masks, and bear Canilon tattoos. The “fourth faction” of the Church, hidden from the public.

Inthun, The. An enchanted stone slab of immense and terrible power. Kills most who are strapped to it, but imbues survivors with awesome strength, innate magical abilities, and nigh-on invulnerability. Works better with children, a fact the Church exploited.

IRIS. An artificial intelligence built into Burnie’s eye. Jive-talking personality. Shoots lasers and provides targeting data.

Iron Maiden. A one-handed katana reforged from Black Sabbath. The blade that killed Lady Otoria, later claimed by the party.

J

Jennies. Merfolk, or fish-people. Some live peacefully alongside humans; others have territorial disputes with land-dwellers. King Oceani committed his Jenny army to the Battle of Hope’s Rest.

K

Kalimar. An elder entity and god of creation. Corrupted Kolo through psychic whispers in the Tom’ardy mines, warped his flesh, and trapped his soul. Killed in the continuation by Mrs Ball, who punched clean through him.

Kalimel. Kalimar’s flesh-warping goo, used by Valkar Varg to breed Pact warrior super-soldiers. Ninety-nine in every hundred subjects die during the Trials that create them.

Killepitsch. A liquor used during Pilcheur’s exorcism in Riverfall, alongside pastoral chanting and a great deal of vomiting.

M

Mark of Synne. A protective brand connected to the eighth god. Burns into the skin and grants “fate-spinning” powers. Pilcheur, Burnie, and later others bore the mark.

Mrs Ball. A sentient sphere of impossibly dense metal. Each Ball contains a universe, and her people restore broken ones. Delivered the killing blow to Kalimar. May hold the reality into which Exmerah was erased.

N

Nautiloid. A githyanki spelljammer vessel, crewed by mind flayers and gith warriors. One attacked Jecede in the continuation, killing Erin and Burnie before the Airship Gary rammed it from the sky.

Northern Rock. Riphard’s first bank, established in Derek Bobacious’s house in Riverfall. The precursor to the Black Rock operation in Hope’s Rest.

P

Pact Warriors. Varg super-soldiers created through Kalimar’s goo. Enhanced with immense strength and hellish power, but the process kills ninety-nine in every hundred subjects.

Petite Ferret, The. A pub in Hope’s Rest, run by Horatio BrambleThrust.

Piece of Shit. Myron’s cocktail: one part sherry, one part grenadine, one part Bovril. Named after Riphard.

Puzzle Die. A legendary magical cube created by the ancient sorcerer Ruh’Breks and recovered from his hidden tower. Contains dozens of functions accessible by manipulating its faces, including teleportation, invisibility, time stop, and a Wish with a ten-thousand-year cooldown. Also called the Die of Ruh’Brex.

R

Ronin. An honoured status in Masudan culture. The party achieved it after the Gabrin Coming of Age ritual, a cocoon metamorphosis that left them physically transformed.

S

S.T.A.N.R.I. Exme's mecha-bear companion. Evolved from a leaking robo-cub (Mk 0) to a full combat unit (Mk I) to a tiger-shaped battlesuit. Later gifted consciousness by the gods and became headmaster of a school for gifted girls.

Salumist. Someone from Linderdorf. In their culture, sausages are "a type of face."

Sand Dagger. Dangerous sneaky creatures found in Nanduan.

Seven's Spire. The Church's holiest site and seat of power, a towering structure containing the Great Stone that sustains the Sundering. The party assaulted it in the campaign finale to break the seal and return the gods.

Spancers. An anti-Church group operating in the Great Expanse. Desert bandits who became allies of the party.

SRA. Small Races Alliance. A gnome and halfling terrorist organisation, initially hostile to the party. After the party killed their leader Razzle Backshine and installed Buttons as his replacement, the SRA became reluctant allies.

Starmetal. See *Excalibrium*.

Stonecast Mech. A thirty-foot stone fighting robot with flamethrowers and laser cannons. Won by the party in the Clawtech Arena in Linderdorf. Dropped from the airship as a siege weapon during the assault on Seven's Spire.

Stone of Unthala. A large stone, about the size of two fists, retrieved from the skull-shaped ice Temple of Unthala during the party's first mission. Served as their primary means of communication with Lazarus across dimensional boundaries.

Sundering, The. The event in which the Church used the Great Stone to sever the world from the gods. Intended as protection against divine conflict, it became a prison that allowed the Church to consolidate unchecked power.

Synne. The eighth god, struck from the Church's records. God of fate, luck, and balance. Not evil, as the Church claimed, but a neutral force. Several party members bore her mark. See also *Mark of Synne*.

T

The Gary. The party's airship, discovered in the Tower of Ruh'Breks and named after Gary

following his sacrifice. Powered by spectral energy batteries. Destroyed in Episode 103 when Captain Stick steered it into the falling Nautiloid to save Jecede.

TikkiTukks. Small bear-like creatures with masks and sharp teeth. Some cannibalistic. The party fought them at the Temple of Unthala and later in the jungles of South Africa, where they hacked Gary down piece by piece.

U

University of Assassins. Estebaun's institution in Hope's Rest. Trained Kevin, the party's young assassin recruit.

V

Valeria. The main continent of Velterra, where most of the campaign takes place.

Varg. The northern warlord and barbarian alliance. Enslaved goblins for generations. In the continuation, Valkar Varg united the tribes and made a pact with Kalimar to breed super-soldiers.

Velterra. The world in which the campaign takes place.

W

Wish, The. The Puzzle Die's most devastating function: the only wish in existence, with a ten-thousand-year cooldown. Used by Exmerah in Kalimar's lava sanctum to save both Myron and Kolo. The cost was absolute: she was erased from all reality.